Sta630 Quiz 1 FALL 2020

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B.ed (1.5) vu semester 2 group
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STA30 quiz 1 by Amjad
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1. All of the following options describe the research except:
   A casual inquiry to seek required information to resolve problem
2. Which of the following is the type of research that helps to find the magnitude of the issue as well as its solutions?
   Applied research
3. Descriptive hypothesis contains
   One variable only
4. A system of systematically interrelated concepts definitions and propositions that are advanced to explain and predict phenomena is known as
   theory
5. Which of the following is also referred to as working definition?
   Operational definition
6. Which of the following is observe at the empirical level?
   Reality
7. Which type of review tells the reader how a project fits into the big picture and its implications for a field of knowledge?
   Context review
8. Which of the following variables is undesirable because it adds error to an experiment?
   None of these
9. The scientific research operates at two level one is at the abstract level of concepts and other one is the ------- of variable.
   Empirical level
10. What does a good literature review look like?
    All of the given option
11. is the purpose of explanatory research. Ans : The desire to know "why"
12. A statement concerned with the logical relationships among concepts is called_____.
    Ans : Proposition
13. The scientific researcher operates at two levels: on the abstract level of concepts and on the other one is the_____of variables

Ans : Empirical level

14. The Research that is done to examine the findings of someone else by using the "same variables but with different respondents" comes under which of following_____.

Ans : Replication

15. _____ meanings attached to a concept create problems of measurement.
    Ans : Vague
16. Concepts represent various degree of_____.
    Ans : Abstraction
17. What research is?

Ans : Systematic inquiry

18. Realities that are observable through sensory experiences are said to be:
    Ans : Empirical
19. What is Cross-Sectional research_____.

Ans: The collection of data from more than one case at one moment in time

20. An operational definition is_____.

Ans : A definition of a concept in terms of specific, empirical measures.

21. In_____we collect same type of information from different respondents in different times.
    Ans: Time series Research
22. In_____definition, a concept is explained in terms of other concepts.
    Ans: Theoretical
23. Research improves the decision-making process by following all important stages EXCEPT:____.
    Ans: Only relying on personal assumptions
24. Concepts, created and developed for conducting any research study, are:_____.
    Ans: The building blocks of theory
25. Logical Process in which we arrive at a reasoned conclusion by logical generalization of known facts is called.

Ans: Deduction

26. Which of following is a type of applied research? Ans: Impact Assessment Research
27. A research study, in which the unit of analysis remains same at specific intervals, over a longer period of time, is known as .

Ans: Panel study

28. If a researcher was studying the use of various instructional approaches to the ..... Which type of research And:

Applied

29. An Elementary or basic form of research, in which little is known about the situation and previous theories or ideas do not apply, is known as

Ans: Exploratory study

30. Social research helps.
    Ans: Improve Public health
31. Which of following best describes an Operational definition ?
    Ans: all of the give above
32. Which of following best describes a Concept?
    Ans: A key idea/ a key word
33. Which of following is true about a concept ?
    Ans: All of the given options
34. Every Research Project Should Begin with: Ans: A Statement of the Research?
35. All of the following are the type of Applied Research EXCEPT: Ans: Formulative Research
36. The "Deterministic" Characteristic of Scientific research deals with:

Ans: All of the given options

37. Operational definition is also Known as Ans: working definition
38. Which of following is a concept? Ans: All of the given options
39. A study conducted by Lever brothers to find out impact of job satisfaction on employees' performance is studied at:

Ans: Micro Level

40. Which of the following is a procedure agreed upon for translation of a concept into measurement of some kind?

Ans: Operational definition

41. The "Verifiable" characteristic of scientific research deals with:

Ans: All of the given options

42. Which of the following statement is true?
    Ans: Theory and research are interrelated
43. According to Empiricism, which of the following is the ultimate source of all our concepts and knowledge?

Ans: Sensory experience

44. The application of scientific method to the study of business problems is called
    Ans: Businesses Research
45. One of the major hallmarks of scientific research is
    Ans: Objectivity
46. All of the following are true about theories, except.
    Ans: They are tentative until the fact prove them true
47. Rationalism is the application of
    Ans: Logic and arguments
48. Which of following refers to abstract concept?
    Ans: Racism
49. The "Verifiable" characteristic of scientific research deals with all of the following EXCEPT Ans: The result interpretation

50. If a researcher is studying the effect of using laptops in his classroom to ascertain their merit and worth; he is likely conducting ..... type of research

Ans: Evaluation Research

51. If a researcher is going to explore a new topic, he is conducting which of following research?
    Ans: Formulative
52. Which of following is at the highest level of abstraction?
    Ans: Theory
53. Descriptive Research can be either

Ans : Both Quantitative and Qualitative

54. The Organization of concept in sequence from the most concrete and individual to the most general indicates:

Ans: the degree of abstraction

55. A Researcher is conducting study to find out the reasons why students are not cooperating with teacher is an example of

Ans: Explanatory Study

56. What is the Basis of the Scientific Method?

Ans: To formulate a Research Problem, test the hypotheses in carefully controlled conditions

57. Which of the following statement does best represent the purpose of research?
    Ans: All of the Given Options
58. To explain, predict and control phenomena are the goals of
    Ans: The Scientific Method
59. a theory is a coherent set of_____used as principles of explanation of the apparent relationship of the certain observed phenomena

Ans: propositions

60. The Scientific method is preferred over other ways of knowing it is more.
    Ans: All of the given options
61. Descriptive and Explanatory Are the classifications of research on the basis of
    Ans: Purpose of Research
62. Concept is

Ans: Key idea about any object

63. Qualitative and Quantitative Research are the classification of the research on the basis of
    Ans: Techniques Used
64. The term “Extrapolation” is better explained by the statement

Ans: Theory Predicts Facts

65. Which of the following is not a function of clearly identified research Questions?
    Ans: They make scope of your research as wide as possible?????
66. A study conducted by Pepsi To find out impact of salary On employees turnover is studied at what level?

Ans: micro

67. Basic research can also be called as-------

Ans: Fundamental Research

68. Research methods Are applicable to all of following domains
    Except Ans: Imaginary world
69. Which of the following statement is not true?

Ans: A research proposal is an unorganized and unplanned project

70. A Concept is generalized idea about_____.Ans: All of the given options
71. According to scientific method, which of the following is Not an empirical reality?

    Ans: None of the given options

72. All of the following are the purposes of descriptive research EXCEPT

Ans: The desire to know

1. One of the major hallmarks of scientific research is:

Objectivity
Intuition
Subjectivity
Instinct

2. If a researcher was studying the use of various instructional approaches to the ‘‘ multiple intelligences’’ of his students, he is likely to be conducting which type of research?

Basic
Applied
Evaluation
Grounded theory

3. ‘‘ research methods’’ helps in all of the following ways EXCEPT:

To avoid biasness
To develop analytical skills
To analyze the revelations and intuitions
To convert research concerns into research situations.

4. Self-study review helps to

Increase the readers confidence
Place a specific project in the big picture
Traces the development of an issue over time
Summarizes what is known at a point in time

5. The details of a reference should include

Full name of Author’s
Title
Volume, issue & page number
All of the above

6. According to Empiricism, which of the following is the ultimate source of all our concepts and knowledge?

Perceptions
Theory
Sensory experience
Logics and arguments

7. Which one of the following is not an assumption of science?

There are reoccurring patterns in the world
Events happen because of preceding causes
We can discover solutions to problems of interest
Theoretical explanations must agree with common sense.

8. Which of the following is/are the objectives of the literature review
To learn from others and stimulate new ideas
Identification of variables
Helps in developing a theoretical framework
All of the above

9. If a researcher is going to explore a new topic, he is conducting which of the following Research?
None of the given options
Explanatory
Descriptive
Formulative

10. A review that only demonstrates familiarity with an area is rarely published but it often is part of an educational program is which type of review?
Integrative review
Theoretical review
Self-study review
Historical review

11. While conducting a literature review, the researcher engages in:
An evaluation of the library's location
An evaluation of the library's electronic sources
An evaluation of the literature
An evaluation of the library

12. Which of the following can be the best possible reason for using a scientific method to make a decision?
It provides systematic inquiry into the matter
It helps to make decision randomly
It starts each research study from the scratch
It helps researchers to make decisions based on common sense

13. What is the most basic skill required by any researcher?
The ability to source data
The ability to generate ideas for research projects
The ability to understand major philosophical issues and ideas

The ability to calculate statistics

14. Which of the following best describes an operational definition?
All of the given options
It specifies measurement criteria
It specifies testing criteria
It gives meanings to a concept

15.The primary source of communication's means among researchers is
Scholarly Journals
Government Documents
Media Reports
None of the above

16.Integrative reviews helps to
Increase the readers confidence
Place specific project in the big picture
Traces the development of an issue over time
Summarizes what is known at a point in time

17.In ---------- we collect same type of information from different respondents in different times.
Cohort study
Time series research
Panel study
Case student

18.A logical relationship between two or more variables, expressed in the from of a testable statement is known as:
Hypothesis
Variable
Statement
Statistic

19.The 'Verifiable' characteristic of scientific research deals with all of the following EXCEPT;
The results' interpretation
The results' repetition
The results' confirmation/refutation
The results' replication

20.Hypothesis refers to--------

The outcome of an experiment
A conclusion drawn from an experiment
A forms of basis in which subject tries to outguess the experimenter
A tentative statement about the relationship

21.Theoretical reviews helps to
Increase the reader's confidence
Compare how different theories address an issue
Traces the development of an issue over time
Summarizes what is known at a point in time

22.Which of the following is a concept
Leadership
Total Quality Management
Human Resource Management
All of the given options

23.The most difficult resource to locate are;
Dissertations
Policy Reports and Presented Papers
Government Documents
Scholarly Books

24.'high productivity is positively associated with Job commitment'. The given hypothesis is a (an)
Descripted hypothesis

25.Relational hypothesis can be;
All of the given
Causal or simply correlational
Positive or negative
Non-directional or directional

26.A one tailed hypothesis predicts--------
The future
The lottery result
The frequency of the effect
The direction of the effect

27.----------explain the logical relationship among the concepts;
Statements
Propositions
Variables

Events

28.What is cross-sectional research?
A study of a particular section of society
A comparison of two or more variable over a long period
The collection of data from more than one casts at one
One that is conducted when environment is uncertain

29.Abstract is -------
A detail of a scholarly publication's location
A details background of the researchers
A short summery of a scholarly journal article
A detailed procedure to conduct a research

30.Which of the following research approachs is least concerned with the generalizability of findings?
Qualitative approach
Quantitative approach

31.Dictionary definition can also be named as all of the following, EXCEPT;
Bookish definition
Nominal definition
Conceptual definition
Theoretical definition

32.How a particular issue or theory has evolved over time is studied in;
Self-study literature
Context literature review
Historical literature
Integrative literature review

33.The 'verifiable' characteristic of scientific research deals with all of the following EXCEPT;
The results' interpretation
The results' repetition
The results' confirmation/refutation
The results' replication

34.Identity the term which is referred to as 'the confirmation or refutation of the observation through the scientific method by using sensory experience?'
Verifiable
Observation

Empirical
Cumulative

35.Identify the term which is referred to as the 'scope of applicability of the research findings in one organized setting to other settings with the help of statistic'?
Empirical
Determinism
Rationalism
Statistical generalization

36.Which of the following often focuses on generating new theories?
Inductive method
Deductive method
Hypothesis method
None of the given

37.The operational definition is also known as
Working definition
Nominal definition
Conceptual definition
Dictionary definition

38.The primary source of communication means among researchers is
Scholarly Journals
Government Documents
Media reports
None of the above

39.An operational definition is;
One that bears no relation to the underlying concept.
An abstract, theoretical definition of a concept
A definition of a concept in terms of specific, empirical measures
One that refers to opera singers and their work

40.In ---------- we collect same type of information from different respondents in different times.
Cohort study
Time series research
Panel study
Case studies

41. If a researcher is going to explore a new topic, he is conducting which of the following research?

- None of the given option
- Explanatory
- Descriptive
- **Formulative**

42. The application of the scientific method to the study of business problem is called

- Inductive reasoning
- None of the given option
- Business research
- Grounded theory

43._____ is the purpose of Explanatory research.

- The desire to know "what"
- The desire to know " Where"
- The desire to know " How"
- The desire to know "Why"

44. Citation is_____

- A detail of a scholarly publication's location
- A short summery of a scholarly journal article
- A detailed background of the researcher
- A detailed procedure to conduct a research

45. Dichotomous variables are also known as _____

- Intervening variables
- Nominal variables
- Continuous variables
- Extraneous variables

46. The reviewed literature must be.

- None of the given option
- Relevant to the research project
- Readily available
- Easily accessible

47. Why do you need to review the existing literature?

- All of the given option
- To meet the requirement of word-count
- To find out what is already known about our area of interest

❖ To make a good impression

48. In which of the given research design, same people or group are observed across various time periods?

❖ Panel study
❖ Cohort analysis
❖ Action research
❖ Time series research
❖

49. Which of the following is NOT a proper way to write a literature review?

❖ Organize common findings or arguments together
❖ List down a series of research reports with a summary of the findings of each
❖ Logically link statements or findings
❖ Address the most important ideas first

50. The study of research methods provides with you the knowledge and skills you need.

❖ To solve the problem
❖ To improve the decision-making process
❖ To understand the research of others
❖ All of the given options

51. After you locate a source, you should write down all details of the reference, except;

❖ Full name of the authors
❖ Titles
❖ Volumes
❖ Price

52. Which of the following is a continuous variable?

❖ Height
❖ Age
❖ Blood pressure
❖ All of the given option

53. Plagiarism can be best described as;

❖ Giving credit to the author
❖ Revising the original work done by author
❖ Crediting the other person's work as your own
❖ Working on ideas presented in an article

54. Which of the following is the basic unit of a theory development?

- Task
- Concept
- Hypothesis
- Speculation

55. Identify the option that explains that scientific research operates at the abstract level.

- Reality
- Theory
- Variable
- Construct

56. All of the following are the source of literature review EXCEPT;

- Story books
- Dissertations
- Scholarly articles
- Scholarly books

57:A good review of the literature increases a reader's confidence in the researcher's Select the correct option

Professional competence
Ability
All of the above

58: ------- variable takes infinite number of vales

Continuous
Discontinuous
Independent
Dependent

59: A variable that modifies the original relationship between independent and dependent variable is known as

Dependent variable
Intervening variable
Moderating variable
Independent variable

60: A research study, in which the unit of analysis remains same at specific interval, over a longer period of time, is known as

Time series study
Cohort study
Panel study
None of the given options

61: Which of the following often focuses on generating new theories?

Inductive method
Deductive method
Hypothesis method
none of the given options

62:Researcher is supposed to develop a ------- after starting the specific problem to be studied in an experiment

Theory
Conclusion
Hypothesis
Summary of the data

63:Plagirism can be best described as

Giving cedit to the author
Revising the original work done by author
Crediting the other persons work as your own
Working on ideas presented in an article

64: There is no relationship btwn job satisfaction and the employess turnover rate ias an example of which of the following

Null hypothesis
Alternate
Correlational
Descriptive

65: Which of the following statement does best represent the purpose of research

All of the given
Creating the architecture for data warehousing
The identification of quality information not its computerized processing
An application of scientific methods to information collection and analysis

66: A model variale is one that

All of the given
Modifies the original relationship
Qualifies the application of a relationship
Makes a relationship meaningless

67:A variable is

Any characteristics of interest that can take on more than one value

Defined as the groups manipulated in experimental research
The complte set of scores we ise in statistical analysis
Completely specified only in observational research

68:logical process in which we arrive at a reasoned conclusion by logical generalization of known facts is called
Inductive
Deductive
Duplication
Empiricism

69:Which of the following is true about a concept

All of the given
Ab abstract reality
A key about a process

61.

The following type of method can be used in order to create a real world laboratory.
a.correlational coefficients
b.field experiment
c.ok
case study
d.random assignment
ANSWER: B

62.

To be confident that a cause-and-effect relationship exists, it is necessary to
a.engage in naturalistic observation.
b.develop a positive correlation.
c.perform a controlled experiment.
d.test for a negative correlation.

ANSWER: C

63.

An experiment is performed to test the effects of sleep deprivation on rote memory. In this ex
periment, the dependent variable is the
a.number of hours subjects go without sleep.
b.rote memory scores.
c.number of subjects deprived of sleep in the experimental group.
d.correlation between hours of sleep and fatigue.

ANSWER: B

64.

The fortune teller who studies your palm carefully before announcing that "great fortune lies
in your immediate future" is practicing_____psychology.
a.applied
b.commonsense

c.pseudo-
d.forensic

ANSWER: C

65.

Research on the benefit of aspirin to prevent heart attacks used only male subjects in the sam ple. Both men and women are given this advice. The problem with this recommendation reflects
a.gender bias.
b.courtesy bias.
c.cultural bias.
d.age bias.

ANSWER: A

66.

To estimate the degree of the relationship between birth order and achievement motivation, a r esearcher would do a(n) _____ study.
a.naturalistic
b.inventory
c.correlational
d.experimental

ANSWER: C

67.

In the method of naturalistic observation, psychologists
a.haphazardly encounter behavior as it naturally occurs.
b.set up controlled experiments by which they uncover causal elements in behavior.
c.set out to actively observe subjects in their natural environments.
d.interview subjects at different ages.

ANSWER: C

68.

Two variables may be said to be causally related if
a.they show a strong positive correlation.
b.all extraneous variables are controlled, and the independent variable creates consistent dif ferences in behavior of the experimental group.
c.they are observed to co-vary on many separate occasions.
d.they have been observed in a laboratory setting.

ANSWER: B

69.

The problems of observers seeing only what they expect to see is called
a.observer bias.
b.the experimenter effect.
c.the effects of the observer.
d.the halo effect.

ANSWER: A

70.

Giving placebos in drug experiments is necessary to
a.counteract the random assignment of subjects.
b.counteract the side effects of the drug.
c.control for the effects of suggestion and expectation.
d.keep control subjects from knowing they have been given the drug.

ANSWER: C

71.

Which of the following could serve as an experimental hypothesis?
a.Although 25% of U.S. drivers say that they use the seatbelts in their cars, only 14% really do.
b.A case history of multiple personality appeared to be caused by traumatic childhood experiences.
c.College women who are anxious tend to want to be together.
s the temperature increases, the number of hit batters in baseball increases.

ANSWER:C

72. Theories explain results, predict future outcomes, and
a.rely only on naturalistic observations.
b.guide research for future studies.
c.rely only on surveys.
d.rely only on case studies.

ANSWER: B

73. Which of the following coefficients of correlation indicates the weakest relationship between two sets of variables?

a.0.08

b.-0.29

c.0.48

d.-1.00

ANSWER: A

74. A correlation coefficient of -1.09 indicates a(n)

a.strong positive correlation.

b.strong negative correlation.

c.cause/effect relationship.

d.error in computation.

ANSWER: D

75. A representative sample is an essential element of the

a.survey method.

b.psychoanalytic method.

c.natural experiment or case study.

d.clinical method.

76. The effects of brain injury on personality would usually be investigated by the use of the

a.experimental method.

b.case study method.

c.naturalistic observation method.

d.survey method.

ANSWER: B

77. One of the limitations of the case study is that

a.there are few subjects for which it is applicable.

b.there are no control groups.

c.it is not applicable to the study of bizarre behavior.

d.it requires a large and expensive sample size.

ANSWER: B

78. A scientist wants to find out if there is empirical evidence for a relationship between caffeine and aggressive behavior. She would

a.interview people to get their opinions.

b.correlate newspaper accounts and the types of beverages consumed.

c.test the idea by conducting an experiment.

d.research what other experts had thought.

ANSWER: C

79. The essence of the experimental method is

a.accurate calculation of correlation's.
b.obtaining direct reports from subjects about their subjective experiences.
c.careful measurement and record keeping.
d.using control to identify cause-and-effect connections.

ANSWER: D

80. If you're trying to establish a causal relationship between a reinforcer and increased performance, you should use a(n) _____ method.

a.clinical study
b.experimental
c.survey
d.correlational

ANSWER: B

81.

In a weight-reduction experiment, an overweight individual was given what the researcher called a new type of diet pill that would help curb the desire to eat. In fact, the pill really contained powdered milk, but ever since the individual started taking the diet pill, he has reported that his desire to eat has decreased. This illustrates the

a.
curvilinear relationship.
b.
effect of extraneous variables.
c.
natural experiment.
d.
placebo effect.

ANSWER: D

82.

An educated guess about what is controlling some behavior is called

a.
experimental control.
b.
a hypothesis.

c.
an experimental variable.
d.
a theory.

ANSWER: B

83.

A correlation coefficient is best characterized as a(n)
a.
measure of the extent of the relationship between two variables.
b.
index of the causal direction between an independent and dependent variable.
c.
indication of the likelihood that an experimental finding will be replicated by others.
d.
measure of the likelihood that observed differences may be attributed to chance.

ANSWER: A

84. In order to determine the cause of behavior, the questions we ask must be
a.
tentative.
b.
testable.
c.
based on theory.
d.
novel.

ANSWER: B

85.

A common sense approach to psychology is
a.
the most reliable.
b.
often contradicted by empirical evidence.
c.
the basis for most psychological theories.
d.
the basis for collecting data (observed facts).

ANSWER: B

86.

Responding to a substance like a sugar pill as if it were a drug is called
a.
the placebo effect.
b.
an extraneous factor.
c.
variability.
d.
psychosomatic illness.
ANSWER: A

87.

The control group and the experimental group in an experiment are treated exactly the same exc
ept for the
a.
dependent variable.
b.
independent variable.
c.
extraneous variables.
d.
replication variables.

ANSWER: B

88.

A field experiment is one that
a.
uses the "real world" as a laboratory.
b.
tests a field or "range" of independent variables.
c.
differs little from naturalistic observation.
d.
requires no measurement of dependent variables.

ANSWER: A

89.

Characteristics of the scientific method include
a.
anecdotal definition.
b.
controlled observation.
c.
analysis formulation.
d.
adherence to inductive thinking or common sense reasoning.

ANSWER: B

90.

A correlational study is one that determines
a.
the relationship between the independent and the dependent variable.
b.
the effects of the observer on the observed.
c.
cause-effect relationships.
d.
the relationship between two events.

ANSWER: D

STA630 Research Method solved MCQs set 2

0 Comments

The independent variable in an experiment is
Answer: the variable that the experimenter chooses to manipulate.

In order to summarize or organize a series of observations in some meaningful way, psychologists may develop
Answer: theories.

Basic ethical guidelines for psychological researchers include
Answer: providing results and interpretations to participants.

What best describes a double-blind experimental procedure?
Answer: Half the subjects get the experimental procedure, half the placebo; which they receive is not known to subjects or experimenters.

A set of exact procedures that represent particular variables is called a(n)
Answer: operational definition.

A friend states that since he has been taking vitamin C, he has not had a single cold. His

observation has little value in assessing the effects of vitamin C because
Answer: there was no control group for comparison.

A simple experiment has two groups of subjects called
Answer: the control group and the experimental group.

An example of the "experimenter effect" would be a situation in which the experimenter
Answer: unknowingly hints to subjects what is expected of them.

Which of the following is considered by the text to be a pseudo-psychology?
Answer: astrology

To investigate the effects of a particular study method on student performance, two different methods are tried, each with a different group of subjects. If only the experimenter knows which method is under investigation, the procedure being used is described as
Answer: a single blind.

The results of carefully controlled observations of Clever Hans and his ability to solve math problems showed
Answer: he was cued by the owner looking up or down.

The study of unusual events is to_____as information from a large number of people is to _____.
Answer: clinical method; survey method

One of the limitations of the survey method is
Answer: that replies may not be accurate.

I work at a university, and my research is designed to be of immediate use in the classroom. My research would be called
Answer: applied.

In terms of critical thinking and testing, results should be
Answer: metaanalytical.

A variable, such as the personality of a subject, that might affect the outcome of an experiment would be controlled by
Answer: random assignment of subjects.

In my experiment, I am going to investigate how sleep affects anxiety. The number of hours of sleep the subjects have is called the _____ variable.
Answer: independent

With respect to astrology, palmistry, and phrenology, it can be said that
Answer: all are pseudo-psychology's.

A major problem with the survey method is
Answer: obtaining a representative sample of subjects to be questioned.

An observation that the higher the air temperature, the lower the activity of test animals would be an example of a
Answer: negative correlation.

To assess clients' abilities, a phrenologist would want to
Answer: examine their skulls.

To replicate an experiment means to
Answer: repeat the experiment using either identical or improved research methods.

The conditions that a researcher wishes to prevent from affecting the experiment are called
Answer: extraneous variables.

One of the characteristics of the scientific method is
Answer: repeatable results.

In the simplest experiment, the two groups of subjects are treated exactly alike except for the _____ variable.
Answer: independent

The steps involved in the scientific method include?
Answer: experimentation

_____ is an inherent part of the scientific method.
Answer: observation

The story of Clever Hans, the mathematical horse, illustrates the use of controlled observation to test a series of
Answer: hypotheses.

When subjects in an experiment are chosen so that each has an equal chance of being in either the experimental group or the control group, we say that the subjects have been assigned
Answer: randomly.

The survey method involves
Answer: careful questioning of a representative sample of people.

What type of method can be used in order to create a real world laboratory.
Answer: field experiment

To be confident that a cause-and-effect relationship exists, it is necessary to
Answer: perform a controlled experiment.

An experiment is performed to test the effects of sleep deprivation on rote memory. In this experiment, the dependent variable is the
Answer: rote memory scores.

The fortune teller who studies your palm carefully before announcing that "great fortune lies in your immediate future" is practicing_____psychology.
Answer: pseudo

Research on the benefit of aspirin to prevent heart attacks used only male subjects in the sample. Both men and women are given this advice. The problem with this recommendation reflects
Answer: gender bias.

To estimate the degree of the relationship between birth order and achievement motivation, a researcher would do a(n)_____study.
Answer: correlational

In the method of naturalistic observation, psychologists
Answer: set out to actively observe subjects in their natural environments.

Two variables may be said to be causally related if

Answer: all extraneous variables are controlled, and the independent variable creates consistent differences in behavior of the experimental group.

The problems of observers seeing only what they expect to see is called
Answer: observer bias.

Giving placebos in drug experiments is necessary to
Answer: control for the effects of suggestion and expectation.

The following could serve as an_____"College women who are anxious tend to want to be together."
Answer: experimental hypothesis

Theories explain results, predict future outcomes, and
Answer: guide research for future studies.

A correlation coefficient of -1.09 indicates a(n)
Answer: error in computation.

A representative sample is an essential element of the
Answer: survey method.

The effects of brain injury on personality would usually be investigated by the use of the
Answer: case study method.

One of the limitations of the case study is that
Answer: there are no control groups.

A scientist wants to find out if there is empirical evidence for a relationship between caffeine and aggressive behavior. She would
Answer: test the idea by conducting an experiment.

The essence of the experimental method is
Answer: using control to identify cause-and-effect connections.

If you're trying to establish a causal relationship between a reinforcer and increased performance, you should use a(n)_____method.
Answer: experimental

In a weight-reduction experiment, an overweight individual was given what the researcher called a new type of diet pill that would help curb the desire to eat. In fact, the pill really contained powdered milk, but ever since the individual started taking the diet pill, he has reported that his desire to eat has decreased. This illustrates the
Answer: placebo effect.

An educated guess about what is controlling some behavior is called
Answer: a hypothesis.

A correlation coefficient is best characterized as a(n)
Answer: measure of the extent of the relationship between two variables.

In order to determine the cause of behavior, the questions we ask must be
Answer: testable.

A common sense approach to psychology is
Answer: often contradicted by empirical evidence.

Responding to a substance like a sugar pill as if it were a drug is called
Answer: the placebo effect.

The control group and the experimental group in an experiment are treated exactly the same except for the
Answer: independent variable

A field experiment is one that
Answer: uses the "real world" as a laboratory.

Characteristics of the scientific method include
Answer: controlled observation.

A correlational study is one that determines
Answer: the relationship between two events

STA630 Research Method MCQs Solved 1-30 MCQ

0 Comments

1. A psychologist using the method of naturalistic observation would
a.carefully design controlled situations in which to observe behavior.
b.rely on observations of subjects' responses to questionnaires.
c.observe behavior as it happens outside the laboratory or clinic.
d.make records of the behavior of clients treated in therapy.

2.In a study of effects of alcohol on driving ability, the control group should be given
a.a high dosage of alcohol.
b.one-half the dosage given the experimental group.
c.a driving test before and after drinking alcohol.
d.no alcohol at all.

3. A scientific explanation that remains tentative until it has been adequately tested is called a(n)
a.theory.
b.law.
c.hypothesis.
d.experiment.

4. A study to determine the degree of relationship between two events is called
a.naturalistic observation.
b.the correlational method.
c.a controlled experiment.
d.the survey method.

5. _____ is an ability to evaluate, compare, analyze, critique, and synthesize information.
a.Critical thinking

b.Transductive thinking
c.Deductive thinking
d.Creative thinking

6. The phrase "a theory must also be falsifiable" means
a.researchers misrepresent their data.
b.a theory must be defined so it can be disconfirmed.
c.theories are a rich array of observations regarding behavior but with few facts to support them.
d.nothing.

7. The products of naturalistic observation are best described in terms of
a.explanation.
b.theory.
c.prediction.
d.description.

8. A teacher believes that one group of children is very bright and that a second is below average in ability. Actually, the groups are identical, but the first group progresses more rapidly than the second. This demonstrates
a.the self-fulfilling prophecy.
b.the placebo effect in a natural experiment.
c.observer bias in naturalistic observation.
d.the ethical problems of field experiments.

9. A psychologist observes the confrontation between two rival neighborhood gangs from the window of an abandoned building. This method of collecting observations is best described as
a.experimental regression.
b.naturalistic observation.
c.controlled experimentation.
d.clinical case study.

10. In an experiment to find out if taking ginseng increases IQ scores, the IQ scores would be
a.the independent variable.
b.a control variable.
c.an extraneous variable.
d.the dependent variable.

11. Which of the following is considered a disadvantage of naturalistic observation?
a. It provides an overabundance of information.
b. It deals with behavior not tampered with by outside influences.
c. It limits biased observations through careful record keeping.
d.It does not identify the cause of observed behavior.

12. Subjects are said to be assigned randomly when

a.they are assigned to experimental and control groups from a sample which is representative of the larger population.
b.they each have an equal chance of being assigned to either the experimental or control group.
c.they are assigned to experimental and control groups so that the groups differ on some critical variable before the experiment begins.
d.neither the experimenter nor the subject knows whether the subject is in the experimental or control group.

13. A psychologist watches the rapid eye movements of sleeping subjects and wakes them to find they report that they were dreaming. She concludes that dreams are linked to rapid eye movements. This conclusion is based on
a.pure speculation.
b.direct observation.
c.deduction from direct observation.
d.prior prediction.

14. To prevent ethical abuse in psychological research, the APA has suggested that
a.psychologists must treat all subjects with respect and concern for the subject's dignity.
b.psychologists must avoid deception with using human subjects.
c.all data collected from a person must be made public.
d.all psychological harm to subjects must be corrected by counseling.

15. A common method for selecting representative samples is to select them
a.randomly from the larger population.
b.strictly from volunteers.
c.by threatening or coercing institutionalized populations.
d.from confidential lists of mail order firms.

16. Three major ethical concerns of psychological researchers are deception, lasting harm to subjects, and
a.morality of the question under investigation.
b.loss of future research possibilities.
c.falsified results.
d.invasion of privacy.

17. An experimenter conducts an experiment on the effects of a drug to control hallucinations. He declares the results to be "statistically significant," which usually means that
a.even though appropriate statistics were used, no differences could be detected between experimental and control groups.
b.the results have important implications for theory or practice.
c.differences between experimental and control groups of this size occur by chance only 5 times out of 100 (or less).

d.differences between experimental and control groups were so large they could never occur by chance alone.

18. We wish to test the hypothesis that music improves learning. We compare test scores of students who study to music with those who study in silence. Which of the following is an extraneous variable in this experiment?
a.the presence or absence of music
b.the students' test scores
c.the amount of time allowed for the studying
d.silence

19. The statistical technique that combines results of a large number of studies is called
a.experimental correlation.
b.statistical linear analysist.
c.meta-analysis.
d.hypothetical analysis.

20. An experiment is performed to see if background music improves learning. Two groups study the same material, one while listening to music and another without music. The independent variable is
a.learning.
b.the size of the group.
c.the material studied.
d.music.

21 The chief function of the control group in an experiment is that it
a. allows mathematical relationships to be established.
b. provides a point of reference against which the behavior of the experimental group can be compared.
c. balances the experiment to eliminate all extraneous variables.
d.is not really necessary.

22. Which of the following coefficients of correlation indicates the strongest relationship between two sets of variables?
a.-0.98
b. 0.90
c. 0.00
d. 1.20

23. The most powerful research tool is a (an)
a.clinical study.
b.experiment.
c.survey.
d.correlational study.
ANSWER: B

24. A major disadvantage of the experimental method is that
a.private funding can never be obtained.
b.APA Ethical Review Committees often do not approve of the research techniques.
c.there is a certain amount of artificiality attached to it.
d.subjects are difficult to find for research projects.
ANSWER: C

25. A researcher determines that the crime rate in a large city fluctuates with the phases of the moon. He concludes that the gravitational pull of the moon influences human behavior. He has committed what error?
a.He incorrectly inferred correlation from causation.
b.He incorrectly inferred causation from correlation.
c.He failed to measure the gravitational pull to test his hypothesis.
d.He has overlooked the placebo effect.
ANSWER: B

26. Students who do better in high school tend to do better in college. This is an example of
a.a negative correlation.
b.a zero correlation.
c.a positive correlation.
d.a perfect correlation.
ANSWER: C

27. In the traditional learning experiment, the effect of practice on performance is investigated. Performance is the_____variable.
a.independent
b.extraneous
c.dependent
d.control
ANSWER: C

28. Collection of observable evidence, precise definition, and replication of results all form the basis for
a.scientific observation.
b.the scientific method.
c.defining a scientific problem.
d.hypothesis generation.
ANSWER: B

29. An advantage of the experimental method in psychology is
a.the identification of a cause- and-effect relationship.
b.similar to the correlational method in that causality is determined.
c.that the surroundings are always similar to real life experiences.
d.that it is an informal way to investigate behavior.
ANSWER: A

30.A correlation coefficient of 0 means that there is
a.a strong negative relationship between the two variables.
b.a strong positive relationship between the two variables.
c.a perfect positive relationship between the two variables.
d.no relationship between the two variables.
ANSWER: D

Research Methods –STA630
Solved MCQ's BANK A
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1. A good qualitative problem statement:

a. Defines the independent and dependent variables
b. Conveys a sense of emerging design
c. Specifies a research hypothesis to be tested
d. Specifies the relationship between variables that the researcher expects to find

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2. The "tool" function of theory is to:
a. Summarize existing knowledge
b. Summarize existing hypotheses
c. Suggest new relationships and make new predictions
d. Suggest new theories

3. The statement of purpose in a research study should:
a. Identify the design of the study
b. Identify the intent or objective of the study
c. Specify the type of people to be used in the study
d. Describe the study

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4. Why is the statement "What are the effects of extracurricular activities on cognitive development of school age children" not a good statement of a quantitative research question?
a. Because there is no connection between extracurricular activities and cognitive development
b. Because there are not enough school age children engaged in extracurricular activities to conduct the study
c. Because the study would be too difficult to do given all the different extracurricular activities
d. Because the statement was not specific enough to provide an understanding of the variables being investigated

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5. A qualitative research question:
a. Asks a question about some process, or phenomenon to be explored
b. Is generally an open-ended question
c. both a and b are correct
d. None of the above

6. According to the text, which of the following orders is the recommended in the flowchart of the development of a research idea?
a. Research topic, research problem, research purpose, research question, hypothesis
b. Research topic, research purpose, research problem, research question, hypothesis
c. Research topic, research problem, research purpose, research question, hypothesis
d. Research topic, hypothesis, research problem, research question, research purpose

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7. It is essential that you evaluate the quality of internet resources because information obtained via the internet ranges from very poor to very good.
a. True
b. False

8. One step that is not included in planning a research study is:
a. Identifying a researchable problem
b. A review of current research
c. Statement of the research question
d. Conducting a meta-analysis of the research
e. Developing a research plan

9. Sources of researchable problems can include:
a. Researchers' own experiences as educators
b. Practical issues that require solutions
c. Theory and past research
d. All of the above

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10. A key characteristic of past research that guides researchers in new research questions is that:
a. Extensive research conclusively and definitively answers research questions
b. Studies typically generate more research questions than they answer

11. Which of the following is a function of theory?
a. Integrating and summarizing current knowledge
b. Making predictions
c. Explaining phenomena
d. All of the above are important functions of theory

12. A review of the literature prior to formulating research questions allows the researcher to do which of the following?
a. To become familiar with prior research on the phenomenon of interest
b. To identify potential methodological problems in the research area
c. To develop a list of pertinent problems relative to the phenomenon of interest
d. All of the above

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13. Sometimes a comprehensive review of the literature prior to data collection is not recommended by grounded theorists.
a. True
b. False

14. What kind of ideas can't be empirically researched?
a. Effectiveness of different methods of instruction
b. Description of educational practices
c. Issues of values and morality such as the correctness of having prayer in schools
d. Factors helpful in predicting future drug use

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15. Which of the following is not a database containing information to be used during the literature review?
a. ERIC
b. PsychINFO
c. SocioFILE
d. all of the above are potentially useful data bases

16. Computer database searches can be done:
a. With a computer with CD-ROM drive
b. At the library
c. Online
d. All of the above

17. The feasibility of a research study should be considered in light of:
a. Cost and time required to conduct the study
b. Skills required of the researcher
c. Potential ethical concerns
d. All of the above

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18. A formal statement of the research question or "purpose of research study" generally_____.
a. Is made prior to the literature review
b. Is made after the literature review
c. Will help guide the research process

d. All of the above
e. b and c

19. Is the following qualitative research purpose statement “well stated” or “poorly stated”? “The focus of the present study was to explore distressing and nurturing encounters of patients with caregivers and to ascertain the meanings that are engendered by such encounters. The study was conducted on one of the surgical units and the obstetrical/gynecological unit of a 374-bed community hospital.”
a. It is a well stated
b. It is poorly stated

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20. Which of the following quantitative research questions is superior?
a. “What is the effect of participation in various extracurricular activities on academic performance?”
b. “What effect does playing high school football have on students’ overall grade point average during the football season?”

21. A statement of the quantitative research question should:
a. Extend the statement of purpose by specifying exactly the question(s) the researcher will
address
b. Help the research in selecting appropriate participants, research methods, measures, and
materials
c. Specify the variables of interest
d. All of the above

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22. The research participants are described in detail in which section of the research plan?
a. Introduction
b. Method
c. Data analysis
d. Discussion

23. Research hypotheses are_____.
a. Formulated prior to a review of the literature
b. Statements of predicted relationships between variables
c. Stated such that they can be confirmed or refuted
d. b and c

24. Hypotheses in qualitative research studies usually_____.
a. Are very specific and stated prior to beginning the study
b. Are often generated as the data are collected, interpreted, and analyzed
c. Are never used

d. Are always stated after the research study has been completed

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25. A research plan_____.
a. Should be detailed
b. Should be given to others for review and comments
c. Sets out the rationale for a research study
d. All of the above

26. The Method section of the research plan typically specifies
a. The research participants
b. The results of prior studies that address the phenomena of interest
c. The apparatus, instruments, and materials for the research study
d. The planned research procedures
e. a, c and d

27. The Introduction section of the research plan
a. Gives an overview of prior relevant studies
b. Contains a statement of the purpose of the study
c. Concludes with a statement of the research questions and, for quantitative research, it includes
the research hypothesis
d. All of the above

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28. According to your text, which of the following is not a source of research ideas?
a. Everyday life
b. Practical issues
c. Past research
d. Theory
e. All of the above ARE sources of research ideas

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Answers:
1. b
2. c
3. b
4. d
5. c
6. a
7. a
8. d
9. d
10. b
11. d
12. d

13. a
14. c
15. d
16. d
17. d
18. e
19. a
20. b
21. d
22. b
23. d
24. b
25. d
26. e
27. d
28. e

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http://www.vuzs.info/

Which of the following is an example of deception in business research?
Select correct option:
The obtaining of company material without permission.
The researcher wearing a disguise during an observation.
The researcher representing their research as being about a different topic.
The researcher failing to ask permission to interview someone.

Measurement reliability refers to the:
Select correct option:
Accuracy of the scores
Consistency of the scores
Dependency of the scores
Comprehensiveness of the scores

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By informing participants that the research is about something different than it actually is, the researcher is purposefully deceiving the participant. To some degree this is prevalent in all research so that researchers can maximise the natural response to the questions asked.

The validity of a measure refers to the:
Select correct option:
Particular type of construct specification
Comprehensiveness with which it measures the construct
Accuracy with which it measures the construct
Consistency of the measurement

Quantitative social researchers rarely claim to have established causality because:
Select correct option:
They are more concerned with publishing the results of their reliability tests.
They do not believe that this is an appropriate goal to be striving for.
They keep forgetting which of the variables they have manipulated.
They tend to use cross-sectional designs, which produce only correlations.

An experimental design allows us to test for causal connections between variables, because one of the variables (the 'independent' variable) is manipulated to track changes in the other (the 'dependent' variable). However, most social survey research uses cross-sectional designs, where such manipulation is not possible. Consequently, degrees of co-relation between variables can be determined but causality remains inferential. If you gave answer (b), you should recognize that very few researchers are interested in mere descriptions of things. They usually want to find out why things are the way they are so that they can be remedied or replicated. Causality is an appropriate goal, simply difficult to achieve.

Ms. Laiba has decided to use the test at the end of the textbook to measure the achievement levels of the students in her study. Which of the following BEST describes the chapter test?
Select correct option:
Definition
Construct
Variable
Operationalized variable

http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_airasian_edresearch_8/0,11083,2525945-content,00.utf8.html

How can we determine if a test has good validity?
Select correct option:

It produces the same result when it is given at different times to the same group of people
It produces the same result no matter which version of the test is used
It measures what it is supposed to measure
All of the questions on it can be answered accurately by the subject

http://www.sparknotes.com/psychology/psych101/researchmethods/quiz.html

The issue here is with the application of the research findings to people who were not part of the research focus. If we select our sample of respondents randomly from the population as a whole, we can be quite

sure that the findings can be applied to the whole population. But if we interviewed people casually, we could not generalize our findings beyond the actual people interviewed. This is the essence of external validation of research: how universally can the research findings be applied? It must be said that even with random sampling, we have no right to apply our findings to other populations, no matter how strong the temptation.

A_____ scale only assigns numbers to objects to classify the objects according to the characteristic of interest.
Select correct option:
Ratio
Nominal
Interval
Dichotomous

Bias is defined as;
Select correct option:
The distortion of responses based on gender, ethnicity, race, or language
A lack of validity
A lack of reliability
A poor interpretation of a student's score

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A telephone company is interested in obtaining customers' reactions to a new service package. Which of the following primary research methods would be most effective in reaching this audience to obtain their feedback?

Select correct option:

An Internet survey

Telephone interviews

A mail survey

Focus groups

The researcher protects the confidentiality in following ways, Except;

Select correct option:

Obtaining signed nondisclosure documents.

Restricting access to data instruments where the respondent is identified.

Disclosure of data subsets.

Restricting access to respondent identification.

Reference

The researcher protects participant's confidentiality in several ways:

Obtaining signed nondisclosure documents.

Restricting access to participant identification.

Revealing participant information only with written consent.

Restricting access to data instruments where the participant is identified.

Not disclosing data subset.

STA630 MCQs from Quiz 2 C solved by vuZs

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Which of the following is not a feature of theoretical framework?

Making an inventory of variables
Specify the direction of relationship
Presenting findings
Making an inventory of propositions

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Nominal
Interval
Dichotomous

Bias is defined as;

The distortion of responses based on gender, ethnicity, race, or language
A lack of validity
A lack of reliability
A poor interpretation of a student's score

The elaboration of the variables in the theoretical framework addresses which type of qestions?

Why we expect certain relationships to exist
How we expect certain relationships to exist
Both of the given questions
None of the given questions

What is the final step of a scientific investigation?

Analyze data
Collect data
Report the findings
Determine whether the hypothesis was supported

An indicator of reliability based on the correlations of each item in a measure with every other item is called:

Test-retest reliability
Cronbach's alpha
Split-half reliability
Inter item ratio

http://methods.fullerton.edu/quiz_ch5.html

The number of people who complete a survey in relation to the number of people contacted to participate is called the:

Response set

Response rate
Response bias
Respondents

http://methods.fullerton.edu/quiz_ch7.html

Which of the following is likely to reduce the validity of a test?

Unclear test directions
Ambiguous test items
Untaught items
All of the given options

http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_airasian_edresearch_7/5/1488/381171.cw/index.html

Which of the following is NOT an unethical issue?

Invoicing irregularities
Avoiding legal liability
Misrepresenting results
Seek approval for research

Which of the following is likely to reduce the validity of a test?
Unclear test directions
Ambiguous test items
Untaught items
All of the given options

STA630 Solved MCQs from Book 100%

0 Comments

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What is the basis of the Scientific Method?

a) To test hypotheses in conditions that are condusive to its success.

b) To formulate a research problem and disprove the hypothesis.

c) **To formulate a research problem, test the hypothesis in carefully controlled conditions that challenge the hypothesis**.

d) To test hypotheses and if they are disproved, they should be abandoned completely

The scientific method requires the formulation and testing of a problem in a variety of controlled conditions. The hypothesis should be challenged in a negative sense. If the hypothesis can be supported (proven), then it can be suggested that implementation of the scientific method improves the predictive power of the theoretical model.

1. Mrs. Smith is writing her daily observations of a student and writes, without interpretation, that the student is not completing the class work and is constantly speaking out of turn. Which of the following objectives does she appear to be using?
a. prediction
b. description

c. explanation

d. exploration

2. Which of the following is a form of research typically conducted by teachers, counselors, and other professionals to answer questions they have and to specifically help them solve local problems?
a. action research
b. basic research
c. predictive research
d. orientational research

3. How much confidence should you place in a single research study?
a. you should completely trust a single research study.
b. you should trust research findings after different researchers have found the same findings
c. neither a nor b
d. both a and b

4. The development of a solid foundation of reliable knowledge typically is built from which type of research?
a. basic research
b. action research
c. evaluation research
d. orientational research

5. Which form of reasoning is the process of drawing a specific conclusion from a set of premises?
a. rationalism
b. deductive reasoning
c. inductive reasoning
d. probabilistic

6. The idea that when selecting between two different theories with equal explanatory value, one should select the theory that is the most simple, concise, and succinct is known as_____.
a. criterion of falsifiability
b. critical theory
c. guide of simplicity

d. rule of parsimony

7. Research that is done to examine the findings of someone else using the "same variables but different people" is which of the following?
a. exploration

b. hypothesis
c. replication
d. empiricism

8. _____is the idea that knowledge comes from experience.
a. rationalism
b. deductive reasoning
c. logic
d. empiricism

9. According to your text, what are the five key objectives of science?
a. prediction, summary, conclusion, explanation, description
b. influence, prediction, questions, exploration, answers
c. exploration, description, explanation, prediction, influence
d. questions, answers, prediction, explanation, summary

10. A researcher designs an experiment to test how variables interact to influence how well children learn spelling words. In this case, the main purpose of the study was:

a. Explanation

b. Description

c. Influence

d. Prediction

11. There is a set of churches in the U.S. where part of the service involves snake handling. The researcher wants to find out why the people attending these churches do this and how they feel and think about it. In this case, the primary purpose of the study is:

a. Exploration

b. Description

c. Influence

d. Prediction

12. Which of the following is <u>not</u> a characteristic of a good theory or explanation?

a. It is parsimonious

b. It is testable

c. It is general enough to apply to more than one place, situation, or person

d. All of the above are characteristics of good theories

13. Which of the following is <u>not</u> a basic assumption of science?

a. Science cannot provide answers to all questions

b. It is possible to distinguish between more and less plausible claims

c. Researchers should follow certain agreed upon norms and practices

d. Science is best at solving value conflicts, such as whether abortion is immoral

14. What general type of research is focused on collecting information to help a researcher advance an ideological or political position?

a. Evaluation research

b. Basic research

c. Action research

d. Orientational research

15. Which “scientific method” follows these steps: 1) observation/data, 2) patterns, 3) theory?

a. Inductive

b. Deductive

c. Imductive

d. Top down

16. Rene Descartes is associated with which of the following approached to knowledge generation?

a. Empiricism

b. Rationalism

c. Expert opinion

d. None of the above

17. Which scientific method is a top-down or confirmatory approach?

a. Deductive method

b. Inductive method

c. Hypothesis method

d. Pattern method

18. Which scientific method is a bottom-up or generative approach to research?

a. Deductive method

b. Inductive method

c. Hypothesis method

d. Pattern method

19. Which scientific method focuses on testing hypotheses developed from theories?

a. Deductive method

b. Inductive method

c. Hypothesis method

d. Pattern method

20. Which scientific method often focuses on generating new hypotheses and theories?

a. Deductive method

b. Inductive method

c. Hypothesis method

d. Pattern method

21. Which of the following statements is true of a theory?

a. it most simply means “explanation”

b. it answers the “how” and “why” questions

c. it can be a well developed explanatory system

d. all of the above are correct

STA630 100% solved MCQ from Book C

0 Comments

Chapter 07

Instructions

http://groups.google.com/group/vuZs
www.vuzs.info

Choose your answers from a-d by clicking the radio button next to each choice and then press 'Submit' to get your score.

Question 01

What is a sampling frame?

a) The report of a pilot study.

b) The selection of specific individuals to participate in the research.

c) A summary of the research process.

d) The listing of all units in the population from which the sample will be selected.

It is important to identify a sampling frame so that a representative sample can then be taken from within a specified unit.

Question 02

How will a researcher usually prevent a significant sampling error?

a) Interview all respondents in advance.

b) Issue questionnaires to the entire sampling frame.

c) Put all the names in a hat.

d) Use probability sampling.

Probability sampling allows the researcher to apply tests of statistical significance which then allow inferences to be made about the overall sampling frame.

Question 03

If an organisation has 12,000 employees and the researcher is able to interview 250 the probability of inclusion in the sample is?

a) 1 in 96.

b) 1 in 20.

c) 1 in 48.

d) 1 in 250.

Simple random sampling assumes that each member of the population has an equal probability of inclusion in the sample. The probability is calculated via a sampling fraction with the total population being divided by the sample size.

Question 04

If a researcher wishes to obtain a nationally representative sample of trade union members but does not have the resources to travel long distances what method of sampling could they use?

a) Stratified random sampling.

b) Multi-stage cluster sampling.

c) Simple random sampling.

d) Snowball sampling.

Multi-stage cluster sampling allows interviewers to concentrate their research more than simple random or stratified sampling.

Question 05

Which of the following is not something a researcher will have to consider when thinking about their sample size?

a) Time and cost.

b) Non-response.

c) Length of questionnaire.

d) Heterogeneity of population.

In general bigger is better when considering sample size however all researchers need to be aware of the limitations of their resources.

Question 06

Which of the following is an example of convenience sampling?

a) A stratified random sample of CEO's drawn from the top 100 UK companies.

b) A random sample of employees who are absent from work through stress.

c) Managers attending a seminar on corporate social responsibility organised by the researcher.

d) Illegal workers.

It is possible that the researcher could take the opportunity of issuing a questionnaire to these managers whilst they are at the seminar. It is unlikely that the researcher will come across the other options in as convenient a manner.

Question 07

http://groups.google.com/group/vuZs
www.vuzs.info

Which of the following is not a benefit of snowball sampling?

a) It can be used when there is difficulty in creating a sampling frame.

b) It is always representative of the population.

c) It can be used within a qualitative research strategy.

d) It can be used to reflect relationships between people by tracing connections.

Snowball sampling is unlikely to be representative of the population because of the difficulty in establishing a sampling frame. The sampling frames that apply when snowball sampling is relevant are usually fluid and constantly shifting.

Question 08

Quota sampling is used intensively in which type of research?

a) Market research.

b) Experimental research.

c) Action research.

d) Ethnographic research.

Commercial research and political opinion polling are other types of research that use quota sampling.

Question 09

The findings from a study of decision making processes within a UK financial services company can be generalized to:

a) decision making processes in all financial services companies.

b) decision making processes in the all UK companies.

c) decision making processes in the researched companies.

d) none of the above.

Business and management researchers should be cautious of overgeneralizing findings beyond the researched organization to alternative cultures.

Question 10

As part of survey research design the sample was selected by the HR manager. What sort of error could this lead to?

a) Sampling error.

b) Sampling related error.

c) Data collection error.

d) Data processing error.

The choices made by the HR manager may have been non-random and could also have reflected a bias on the part of the individual making the choices.

Chapter 08

Instructions

Choose your answers from a-d by clicking the radio button next to each choice and then press 'Submit' to get your score.

Question 01

What is the benefit of standardizing the asking of questions?

a) Each interview will last for exactly the same length of time.

b) A survey questionnaire can be delivered to a room full of people.

c) Answer variation will be 'true' and not due to the interview context.

d) The interviewer can predict the answers that the interviewee will give.

Standardization means that any variation between respondents cannot be put down to the way that the question was asked or the answers recorded in the course of the administration of the survey.

Question 02

A closed question means:

a) the respondent is given a limited choice of possible answers.

b) the final question of the interview.

c) the interviewer can embellish the interviewee's answer.

d) the responses are difficult to codify.

By limiting the number of possible answers that the interviewee can give, their answers are easier to code and it also reduces the potential for interviewer variability.

Question 03

http://groups.google.com/group/vuZs
www.vuzs.info

Which of the following is not a disadvantage of telephone interviewing?

a) The telephone interviewer cannot use visual aids.

b) It is difficult to ascertain if the correct person is replying.

c) People who do not have access to a telephone cannot be interviewed.

d) Telephone interviews are cheap and quick to administer.

This factor is more pronounced when the sample is geographically spread.

Question 04

Which of the following issues should not be mentioned in an introductory statement?

a) The information will be kept confidential.

b) What the findings of the research are.

c) Who is funding the research.

d) Why the respondent has been chosen.

It is not possible to indicate the findings of the research during the data collection period. It is very important that the other issues are mentioned in an introductory statement.

Question 05

Which of the following questions should come at the start of a question section on corporate social responsibility?

a) How strongly do you feel about corporate social responsibility?

b) Are you in favour of corporate social responsibility?

c) Have you heard of corporate social responsibility?

d) Why are you in favour of corporate social responsibility?

Within each section general questions should precede specific ones. If the interviewee has not heard of corporate social responsibility the additional questions will become irrelevant.

Question 06

The benefit of using a show card to prompt the interviewee is:

a) that the interviewee does not have to speak.

b) the interview can be conducted over the telephone.

c) the interviewer does not have to read the same thing out on numerous occasions.

d) the interviewer can demonstrate their artistic skills.

When using something like a Likert scale having the possible answers written out will prevent the interviewer from having to repeat the scale for each question.

Question 07

Which of the following is an example of critical incident method?

a) Asking respondents to describe their response to different advertisements.

b) Asking respondents to talk aloud whilst they are completing a performance appraisal form.

c) Asking respondents to tell a story of an interaction they had with senior management.

d) None of the above.

Critical incident technique can be used either as part of a quantitative or qualitative research strategy. It involves interviewing respondents about particular events in order to understand their significance.

Question 08

The repertory grid method is based on which theory?

a) Personal motivation theory.

b) Personal destruction theory.

c) Personal consumption theory.

d) Personal construct theory.

Personal construct theory (Kelly:1955) is an attempt to identify the interpretative processes whereby an individual constructs meaning in relation to his or her social context.

Question 09

Which of the following is an example of acquiescence?

a) The interviewee answers in a way that they think is socially desirable.

b) The interviewee tends to agree or disagree with a set of questions.

c) The interviewee draws on and creates meaning at the same time.

d) The interviewee agrees to do anything that the interviewer asks them.

Acquiescence can be overcome by ensuring that some questions within a particular set imply an opposite stance.

Question 10

Which of the following is not part of the feminist critique of structured interviewing?

a) All structured interviews are conducted with men.

b) When women interview women using this method it implies a hierarchical relationship.

c) It gives the impression of exploitation.

d) It prevents the feminist researcher from developing genuine relationships with respondents.

The feminist critique of structured interviewing has much in common with wider criticisms of quantitative research and has led to many feminist researchers adopting a qualitative research strategy.

Chapter 09

Instructions

Choose your answers from a-d by clicking the radio button next to each choice and then press 'Submit' to get your score.

Question 01

Which of the following is not an advantage of the self-completion questionnaire over the structured interview?

a) It is cheaper to administer.

b) It is quicker to administer.

c) It is easier to prompt the interviewee.

d) It is easier to remove interviewer effects.

Because the self-completion questionnaire is completed without the researcher present it is not possible for them to assist respondents who are struggling to understand a specific question.

Question 02

Which of the following are disadvantages of the self-completed questionnaire?

a) Inability to confirm who completed the questionnaire.

b) Its unsuitability for some kinds of respondents.

c) Inability to ask many questions that are not directly relevant to the respondent.

d) All of the above.

A number of the disadvantages of self-completed questionnaires stem from the absence of the interviewer.

Question 03

Which of the following statements might assist response rates?

a) Please photocopy the questionnaire five times and pass on to your work colleagues.

b) Please make sure that the questionnaire is completed with a fountain pen.

c) Please read the attached journal article on the ontological foundations of positivism prior to completing the questionnaire.

d) Please put the completed questionnaire in the enclosed stamped addressed envelope and place in the mail out tray.

Enclosing a stamped addressed envelope is very important if the researcher wishes to achieve an acceptable response rate.

Question 04

http://groups.google.com/group/vuZs
www.vuzs.info

What should the researcher do if they have achieved a low response rate?

a) Fill in some more questionnaires themselves.

b) Abandon the research project entirely.

c) Recognize and accept the possible limitations of a low response rate.

d) None of the above.

A substantial amount of published material is based on research that has a low response rate. The researcher in this situation should include a discussion of what the implications of a low response rate are for their research.

Question 05

One of the following statements is correct.

a) A questionnaire should run to at least twenty pages.

b) The questions should have no spaces between them so that the whole questionnaire looks small.

c) Only questionnaires that are A3 size achieve high response rates.

d) Clear presentation is more important than overall size.

If questions are cramped together so that they are difficult to differentiate from each other this is more likely to reduce the completion rate than if the questionnaire is a little bit longer.

Question 06

Should closed answers be arranged:

a) horizontally.

b) vertically.

c) diagonally.

d) circuitously.

Question 07

Which of the following is likely to happen if clear instructions are not given as how the respondent should answer the question?

a) Respondents may delete inappropriate answers rather than select appropriate ones.

b) Respondents may choose only one answer when they need to choose as many as apply.

c) Respondents may complete questions that are not relevant to them.

d) All of the above.

Clear instructions are vital as they allow for the respondent to move quickly and efficiently through the questionnaire which may in turn aid response rate.

Question 08

Which of the following is not a major use of diaries in business research?

a) The diary as a method of data collection.

b) The diary as a document.

c) The diary as a log of researcher's literature search.

d) The diary as a log of the researcher's activities.

A diary can be an effective way of gaining an accurate record of respondent's daily routine.

Question 09

Which of the following is not a suitable topic for research using a diary?

a) The amount of time managers spend on particular activities.

b) The frequency with which managers undertake particular tasks.

c) The locations in which a trade union representative has discussions with individual members.

d) The volume of female managers in the retail industry.

Stewart (1967) used the diary method to look at managerial time.

Question 10

Which of the following comments demonstrates a process of attrition on the part of a diary respondent?

a) 'the researcher never checks that I am completing my diary correctly'.

b) 'I can't be bothered to complete this diary anymore'.

c) 'I keep forgetting to include the number of phone calls I make each day'.

d) 'I have decided to use the diary to record all of my personal thoughts and feelings'.

There is a danger that the respondent will lose interest in completing the diary and so will fail to record accurate data.

Chapter 10

Instructions

Choose your answers from a-d by clicking the radio button next to each choice and then press 'Submit' to get your score.

Question 01

Which of the following is an advantage of open questions?

a) They allow respondents to answer in their own terms.

b) They prevent respondents from giving unusual answers.

c) They allow respondents to put less effort into their answer.

d) They allow respondents to code their answers in advance.

An open question means that the respondent is not forced to use terminology that is decided by the researcher in advance.

Question 02

What is the difference between a closed question and an open question?

a) A closed question means that the chances of unreliable post-coding is small, whereas an open question means that there is a possibility of data processing error.

b) A closed question allows for the researchers terminology to be used, whereas an open question allows the respondent to use terms they are familiar with.

c) A closed question allows for easy processing, whereas coding an open question can be very time consuming.

d) All of the above.

Both closed and open questions have a range of advantages and disadvantages and their use depends upon the research strategy and research design that have been selected.

Question 03

Which of the following is an example of a question about normative standards and values?

a) How many workers are employed at this plant?

b) What is your attitude towards the management at this plant?

c) Do you always cast your vote in trade union elections?

d) Are you aware of the main features of the European Union Directive for informing and consulting employees?

Answer (c) is asking for the respondent to reveal a behavioural norm. These types of questions are closely related to question about attitudes and beliefs.

Question 04

If one of your research questions is 'what role do HR Departments play in manufacturing companies?' which of the following questions should you include in your questionnaire?

a) Does your organisation manufacture red cars or blue cars?

b) How much corporation tax did your organisation pay in the last financial year?

c) Does your organisation employ a Director of HR?

d) Does the HR Department have an annual Christmas party?

It is important to keep in mind your overall research questions so that you ask questions that will contribute to your answering of these questions.

Question 05

http://groups.google.com/group/vuZs
www.vuzs.info

Why is it important to avoid ambiguous terms when designing questions?

a) Respondents may not understand the question.

b) Respondents may operate with a different frame of reference.

c) Respondents may think the question is less important.

d) Respondents may have to ask for help when completing the questionnaire.

An ambiguous term such as 'often' or 'management' may mean different things to different respondents.

Question 06

Which of the following is a double-barrelled question?

a) How satisfied are you with the performance appraisal system?

b) How satisfied are you with investment levels in new and existing software packages?

c) How satisfied are you with the organisations marketing strategy?

d) How satisfied are you with the levels of customer satisfaction?

Double-barrelled questions are ones that ask about two things. This question should in fact be split into two, one about existing software and one about new software.

Question 07

Questions that include negatives should be avoided because:

a) The respondent may miss out the negative word.

b) The respondent may be unsure how to answer if the question includes a double negative.

c) The respondent may be led by the question.

d) All of the above.

When using a Likert scale it can be difficult to avoid asking a question with a negative, however the researcher should attempt to avoid them if possible.

Question 08

Why is asking a vignette question about ethical behavior beneficial?

a) Because it allows for an abstract discussion of ethical values.

b) Because it ensures that the respondent does not have to reflect on their own ethicality.

c) Because it anchors the choice in a situation and prevents an unreflective reply.

d) Because it prevents the researcher from discussing sensitive issues.

By discussing a specific situation it is more likely that the respondent will reflect on their actual behaviour rather than simply give a reply that matches normative values.

Question 09

Piloting questions is important because:

a) it enables the researcher to clear up any confusion.

b) it enables the researcher to collect additional data.

c) it enables the researcher to get an idea of likely response rate.

d) it enables the researcher to see if their questions can fly.

Piloting can be crucial in seeing not just that the survey questions work well, but also that the research instrument is suitable.

Question 10

Which of the following is not an advantage of using existing questions?

a) They will have already been piloted for you.

b) You will be able to investigate any reliability and validity testing that has taken place.

c) You will be able to claim your work is entirely original.

d) You will be able to make comparisons with other research.

You are advised to contact the researchers concerned in order to seek permission to use questions that they have devised.

Chapter 11

Instructions

Choose your answers from a-d by clicking the radio button next to each choice and then press 'Submit' to get your score.

Question 01

Which of the following is not an example of a problem with using social survey research to investigate behaviour?

a) Respondents tend to answer by giving the most socially desirable answer.

b) Respondents may inadvertently omit key terms in the question.

c) Respondents may not give an honest reply to what they see as a threatening question.

d) Respondents may be unwilling to reveal information as they believe they are likely to be identified.

An advantage of social survey research is that the researcher can ensure that the anonymity of the respondent is maintained by administering the same questions to each individual.

Question 02

What is structured observation?

a) The analysis of tall buildings.

b) A technique in which the researcher observes behaviour from one position in the workplace.

c) A technique in which the researcher uses specific rules for behavior observation.

d) A technique in which the researcher observes behavior from a covert location.

Structured observation involves the researcher formulating in advance the rules of an observation. These rules inform observers about what behaviors they should look for and how they should record them.

Question 03

In Mintzberg's (1973) study of managerial work, structured data were collected by which method?

a) A mail record which described each piece of mail and the action taken to respond to it.

b) A travel record which described the number of times a manager travelled between regional offices.

c) A lunch record which described the time managers took for lunch breaks.

d) A banter record which described all of the informal humorous conversations managers had with subordinates.

Mintzberg also used a chronology record and a contact record during his study of managers. These described that activity patterns and the verbal contact of managers.

Question 04

When devising an observation schedule it is important that the observer:

a) has a clear focus about who or what they are observing.

b) uses a recording system that is easy to operate.

c) uses mutually exclusive and inclusive categories.

d) all of the above.

Even if the observer is able to achieve each of these things there will still be an element of interpretation on their part when completing the schedule.

Question 05

Which of the following is a strategy for observing the behaviour of a bank manager in a structured fashion?

a) A daily observation of their morning briefing to the branch.

b) Observations of their interactions with customers.

c) Four observations during the day lasting twenty-five minutes each.

d) Observation of all filing conducted by the manager each day.

By spacing observations throughout the day it is more likely that the observer will be able to ensure the generalizability of the research into bank managers.

Question 06

Following Martin & Bateson (1986) an observation of a specific individual for a set period of time is an example of:

a) scan sampling.

b) focal sampling.

c) ad libitum sampling.

d) behaviour sampling.

Focal sampling involves the observer recording all examples of whatever forms of behaviour are under review.

Question 07

The difference between inter-observer consistency and intra-observer consistency is:

a) inter-observer consistency refers to the degree to which different observers agree, whereas intra-observer consistency refers to the degree one observer remains consistent over time.

b) inter-observer consistency refers to the need for all observations to be conducted at identical times, whereas intra-observer consistency refers to the need for one observer to observe only one behaviour.

c) inter-observer consistency refers to the practice of observers observing each other, whereas intra-observer consistency refers to the practice of observer self-assessment.

d) inter-observer consistency refers to the degree the subjects demonstrate the same behaviours, whereas intra-observer consistency refers to the degree that the subjects demonstrate different behaviours.

Both inter-observer consistency and intra-observer consistency are important tests for the reliability of structured observations.

Question 08

What is the benefit of a conducting a structured observation using a field stimulation?

a) It is an overtly ethical form of research.

b) It ensures that the subjects are fully informed of the research.

c) It reduces the problem of subject reactivity.

d) It is usually conducted outdoors.

A researcher using a field stimulation such as mystery shopping is more likely to observe natural behavior because the subject does not know they are being observed; something which can lead to ethical concerns.

Question 09

Which issues can be observed more effectively during an organisational simulation than in a 'real' organizational setting?

a) Time managers spend on customer complaints.

b) Distance managers walk each day.

c) Decision making and problem solving.

d) Attitudes towards health and safety.

By contriving a situation the researcher can not only look in more detail at issues such as problem solving and decision making but they also have the ability to collect a large amount of data in a relatively short period of time.

Question 10

A criticism of structured observation is that it:

a) neglects the context within which behaviour occurs.

b) neglects the links between behaviour and personality.

c) neglects the role of the structures of capitalism that influence behaviour.

d) neglects the importance of language in organizational settings.

By ignoring the wider context within which subjects operate there is a tendency for structured observation to aim at universal explanations for behaviour which may play down differences between, for example, different occupations.

Chapter 12

Instructions

Choose your answers from a-d by clicking the radio button next to each choice and then press 'Submit' to get your score.

Question 01

Which of the following questions can be answered using content analysis?

a) How do managers behave in the face of employment insecurity?

b) How do the media report corporate re-branding exercises?

c) What effect does organizational size have on marketing strategy?

d) What are the most popular leisure activities amongst the over-50s?

Content analysis is often used to examine the mass media and the manner in which it covers certain issues.

Question 02

Which of the following is not a main characteristic of content analysis?

a) Quantification of the content of selected texts.

b) Systematic analysis.

c) **Discursive deconstruction**.

d) Objectivity.

Content analysis can either focus on the apparent content of a text or its latent content, however either way its focus remains very much on the quantification of the data.

Question 03

What is the first stage of sampling when conducting a content analysis on media reports?

a) Record all television news programmes for a week.

b) Define which part of the media is going to be analysed.

c) Assess the timescales within which you are going to select texts.

d) Identify how each variable will be coded.

It is important when undertaking a content analysis of the mass media that the first task undertaken, when identifying a sample, is which type of media will the research focus upon.

Question 04

What is the benefit of focussing a content analysis on specific words?

a) It enables the researcher to assess a text's grammatical sophistication.

b) It enables the researcher to measure the time taken to construct the text.

c) It enables the researcher to show which interpretative frameworks are used in the text.

d) It enables the researcher to judge the future use of specific words in specific contexts.

Researchers who use content analysis to count the frequency of certain words, sentences or phrases are then able to infer from this which interpretative frameworks different authors are drawing from.

Question 05

What is a coding schedule?

a) A form into which all the data relating to an item is entered.

b) A form ensuring that all of the different categories are mutually exclusive.

c) A form which sets out the interpretative framework of the researcher.

d) A form which measures the relationship between different categories.

A coding schedule is the item that the coder will use to record all of the information relevant in a specific text. A new schedule is required for each text.

Question 06

What does a coding manual contain?

a) Information about the research questions.

b) Information about the research subjects.

c) Information about how the different coding categories are to be defined.

d) Information about how many times the different coding categories are used in a text.

The coding manual is sometimes referred to as the content analysis dictionary. It is a statement of instructions to coders that specifies the categories that will be used to classify the text.

Question 07

What must a researcher be aware of when using a term such as management in a coding scheme?

a) Potential confusion because the term management can have different meanings.

b) Potential confusion because management does not form one single unit of analysis.

c) Potential confusion because management has different meaning in different languages.

d) All of the above.

Because a term such as management can have different meanings it is vital that a coding scheme is clear about the manner in which it is to be used.

Question 08

Which of the following is an advantage of content analysis?

a) It is a very transparent form of research.

b) It is able to easily incorporate a longitudinal element.

c) It minimises the impact of the researcher on the subject of study.

d) All of the above.

Content analysis is a flexible method that allows for information about a wide range of issues to be generated.

Question 09

Which of the following is true?

a) It is impossible to issue the same instructions to all coders.

b) It is impossible to devise coding manuals that do not require coders to undertake some interpretation.

c) It is impossible to understand the social world by studying the mass media.

d) It is impossible to use content analysis to look at elite groups.

This is one of the disadvantages of content analysis because coders act as knowledge participants whose interpretations may not necessarily correspond.

Question 10

Content analysis can be criticised because:

a) it is an obscure and opaque method.

b) it focuses solely on questions of why in business research.

c) relevant documents are hard to obtain.

d) it is atheoretical as it focuses on what can be measured not what is theoretically important.

By focusing on what can be measured content analysis can be accused of diminishing the importance of theoretically significant information. This is not necessarily true of all content analyses.

STA630 Research Methods solved MCQs from Book E

0 Comments

Chapter 17

Question 01

Organizational ethnography is distinctive because:

a) it is concerned with social behaviour.

b) it is conducted across a larger number of environments.

c) it is concerned with social relations that are related to goal-directed activities.

d) its methodological reputation is subject to more intense challenge.

Rosen (1991) argues that organizational ethnography is concerned with social relations that are related to goal-directed activities, whereas traditional anthropology is more concerned with social relations in general.

Question 02

What is the difference between ethnography and participant observation?

a) Ethnography is concerned with an organisations culture, whereas participant observation is concerned with an organisations strategy.

b) Ethnography refers to the method and the written product of the research, whereas participant observation refers only to the method.

c) Ethnography is more subjective, whereas participant observation is more objective.

d) Ethnography allows for a longer period of immersion in a particular context than participant observation.

Distinguishing between ethnography and participant observation is often very difficult. However, one important difference is that ethnography can sometimes be a more holistic term relating the product of the research as well as the method.

Question 03

Which of the following is not an example of a 'classic' organizational ethnography?

a) Beynon's (1975) study of the Ford Motor Company's Halewood plant.

b) Wylie's (1972) study of door to door salesmen.

c) Roy's (1958) period as a machine operator.

d) Watson's (1994) investigation into managerial identity.

(a), (b), and (c) are all essential reading for any business researcher wishing to undertake a period as either ethnographer or participant observer.

Question 04

When arranging access which attribute should ethnographers be prepared to adopt?

a) Ignorance.

b) Arrogance.

c) Invisibility.

d) Opportunism.

Buchannan, Boddy and McCalman (1988) suggest that researchers engaging in ethnography must be prepared to balance what is desired against what is possible, and that they should be prepared to react to different opportunities that arise.

Question 05

Which of the following is an ethical question that researchers undertaking a covert ethnography should ask themselves?

a) What form should the findings be published in?

b) Does it ensure the principle of 'informed consent'?

c) How can the response rate be increased?

d) All of the above.

Informed consent ensures that research participants agree to participate on the basis of information supplied to them. Covert ethnography means that it is impossible to obtain this.

Question 06

A researcher conducting an overt ethnography which involves them fully experiencing the job of a call centre operator adopts which of the following roles?

a) Complete participant.

b) Participant-as-observer.

c) Observer-as-participant.

d) Complete observer.

The participant-as-observer actually participates in the daily lives of those they are studying but is also open about their research. Delbridge (1998) is an example of a researcher adopting this role.

Question 07

To 'go native' means:

a) the researcher takes paid employment from the organisation they are researching.

b) the researcher adopts a covert role.

c) the researcher loses sight of their role as a researcher.

d) the researcher begins a relationship with a key informant.

'Going native' is the term used to describe an ethnographer who becomes so involved in their ethnographic role that they no longer regard themselves as a researcher.

Question 08

Why might an ethnographer wish to avoid taking an active work-role as part of their ethnography?

a) They might be asked to become involved in something illegal or requiring deception.

b) They might expect to be paid for any work that they do.

c) They might believe that this will exploit there position as researcher.

d) They might fear 'going native'.

Most ethnographers find that it is hard not to become involved in various tasks or they will lose credibility. Nevertheless the danger of being involved in something illegal or deceptive is a danger that the researcher needs to be aware of.

Question 09

Which of the following is not a general principle for researchers to bear in mind when they are taking field notes?

a) Notes should be vivid and clear.

b) Copious amounts of notes should be taken if possible.

c) If notes are taken immediately after something interesting has been seen they can be written up when the data collection has finished.

d) Tape recorders can be used to take brief notes.

It is vital that the ethnographer writes up field notes at the end of each day at the research site so that they are more likely to record all important information. If the notes are not expanded upon until all data collection has finished then the ethnographer may be unable to recall specific occurrences that informed their findings.

Question 10

Why is bringing an ethnography to an end often difficult for ethnographers?

a) Because of the enjoyment that many ethnographers experience.

b) Because it is a relaxed form of data collection.

c) Because it is unstructured it lacks an obvious end point.

d) Because writing up is a task to be avoided.

Not only can it be difficult for ethnographers to identify a definite end point the disengagement from the research site has to be managed in an effective manner.

Chapter 18

Question 01

Why might qualitative researchers regard interviewing an attractive alternative to participant observation?

a) It is easier to accommodate into the researchers personal life.

b) It gives a better insight into the day to day functioning of the research site.

c) It is a considerably less time-consuming process.

d) It reduces the problem of reactivity.

Conducting interviews tends to require less of a sustained absence from work and/or family life than a traditional ethnography. One important point to make though is that due to transcription and analysis it is not necessarily less time consuming.

Question 02

Which of the following is a quality associated with qualitative interviewing as opposed to quantitative interviewing?

a) Replicability.

b) Generalizability.

c) Flexibility.

d) Sustainability.

Flexibility is important in a qualitative interview because it allows for the researcher to explore issue that emerge during the actual interview.

Question 03

What is the difference between the types of answers that qualitative and quantitative interviews look to generate?

a) Qualitative interviews aim to generate one word answers, whereas quantitative interviews aim to generate in-depth responses.

b) Qualitative interviews aim to generate answers relating to any unspecified topic, whereas quantitative interviews aim to generate answers about one issue.

c) Qualitative interviews aim to generate detailed answers to certain questions, whereas quantitative interviews aim to generate shorter, more easily codifiable responses.

d) Qualitative interviews aim to generate predictable responses, whereas quantitative interviews aim to generate less predictable answers.

One of the fundamental differences between the two overall types of interview is the amount of detail that they seek within an interview situation.

Question 04

Which of the following researchers is conducting a semi-structured interview?

a) The researcher who has a schedule of fifty questions that they need answered by the participant.

b) The researcher who has planned only one question in advance.

c) The researcher who does not wish to use a tape recorder.

d) The researcher who has a guide which states some specific topics to be covered.

During a semi-structured interview the interviewee will have a great deal of leeway as to how they wish to reply, although the interviewer will have a guide about topics that they wish to cover.

Question 05

Which of the following is not a specific challenge facing business researchers who wish to conduct qualitative interviews?

a) Scheduling time with a senior manager.

b) Managers unwillingness to allow subordinates to leave productive activity.

c) The scarcity of potential research sites.

d) Maintaining confidentiality and anonymity at all stages of the research project.

There is a obviously a significant number of organisations for business researchers to choose from when planning a research project, however the other challenges identified may need to be overcome for the research to be successful.

Question 06

According to Kvale (1996) a successful interviewer is being sensitive when they:

a) relate what is said to what has been said.

b) listen attentively to what is said and how it is said.

c) give a purpose for the interview and rounding it off.

d) respond to what is important to interviewee.

Being sensitive is important because it will allow the interviewer to assess which issues are of particular importance to the interviewee.

Question 07

Why should a business researcher record and transcribe interviews?

a) It allows a more thorough examination of what the interviewee has said.

b) It allows the researcher to demonstrate their technical proficiency.

c) The response of participants can be more readily shared with senior management.

d) It overcomes all possible ethical considerations.

Having an accurate record of the interview on a tape recording means not only that analysis is easier, but also that the actual interview will not be punctuated by the researcher having to take notes.

Question 08

A practical tip for transcribing interviews is to:

a) get the respondent to do it.

b) transcribe only those sections of an interview that are important.

c) invest in the latest voice recognition software.

d) all of the above.

There is little point in transcribing information that is unlikely to be relevant to the research, and so transcribing only those parts that are useful can reduce time significantly.

Question 09

Which of the following is an example of a dilemma that might face feminist business researchers conducting qualitative interviews with women?

a) What role to adopt when interviewing male managers?

b) How many female employees should be interviewed for a representative sample?

c) How to overcome the issue of false consciousness?

d) What data to use when publishing findings?

A significant dilemma for feminist researchers (and possibly all qualitative researchers) is when the respondent's interpretation of their experience and that of the researcher, experience a tension. The researcher may be tempted to assume that the respondent is simply unaware of the way in which they are being exploited and can therefore be said to have a false consciousness.

Question 10

Why does qualitative interviewing have an advantage over participant observation when it comes to longitudinal research?

a) Repeat interviews are easier to organise.

b) It allows for a better exploration of key issues.

c) It is a more focused research method.

d) Participant observers are prone to 'go native' during longitudinal research.

Re-visiting research sites for follow up interviews is likely to be easier than arranging a series of subsequent observations.

Chapter 19

Question 01

What is the difference between a focus group and a group interview?

a) A focus group is used only for political research, whereas group interviews are more widely used in the social sciences.

b) A focus group is used at the planning stage of a research project, whereas a group interview is part of the actual data collection.

c) A focus group is used to discuss a wide range of issues, whereas a group interview looks at one specific topic.

d) A focus group is used to analyse group interaction, whereas a group interview is used as a straight forward data collection tool.

This is an important distinction because focus groups can be said to allow the researcher to think about not just what people said but also how they said it in relation to others in the group.

Question 02

What particular role do focus groups have in business research?

a) They overcome the issue of organising individual interviews with senior managers.

b) They help to bypass the issues of anonymity and confidentiality.

c) They allow for an open discussion of power relations in the workplace.

d) They help individuals work together to identify potential solutions.

The dynamics of focus group discussion make it a useful way for organisational actors to consider new and innovative ways of overcoming problems.

Question 03

How have focus groups been used in market research?

a) To assess the popularity of various existing products.

b) To help plan new HR strategies.

c) **To discuss reactions to new advertisements**.

d) To allow for research into farmers opinions.

Along with testing of new products market research often uses focus groups to assess reaction to new advertisements.

Question 04

Which of the following is not a reason why it is preferable to tape record a focus group session?

a) It is quicker and easier to make brief notes about what is said.

b) It enables the researcher to identify which people are acting as opinion leaders.

c) Without a tape recording it is difficult to keep an accurate record of who said what.

d) It allows for analysis of how certain points are put forward.

The difficulty of making an accurate written record of an individual interview during the actual session is drastically increased during a focus group. As a result tape recording is very important for this particular method.

Question 05

What does the term theoretical saturation mean in reference to the number of focus groups to conduct?

a) The degree to which the researcher is able to present information about complex social theories.

b) The extent that the issues discussed across focus groups contradict each other.

c) When different groups are consistently making similar points about the major issues under discussion.

d) All of the above.

The achievement of theoretical saturation is not something that can be identified in advance, but will be recognised by the researcher when the focus groups are not introducing any new insights into the discussion of particular issues.

Question 06

When is it important for the focus group moderator to involve themselves in the discussion?

a) When the participants become passionate about the subject.

b) When the participants begin to discuss a completely unrelated topic.

c) When the moderator disagrees with a point being made.

d) When the moderator wants to praise a particular response from a participant.

It is important that a focus group is given a fairly free rein so that the discussion flows naturally, however the moderator may wish to re-focus the participants of they begin to go off at a tangent. Having said this it is also important to bear in mind that this tangent may also be of interest.

Question 07

Which of the following questions might be explored by using an employee focus group?

a) What is the extent of employee theft in the workplace?

b) Which manager is the least trusted by employees and why?

c) What are employee attitudes to corporate image?

d) What links are there between salary level and personal productivity?

It is likely that this is the only issue that employees would be willing to discuss in a group environment. The others may all be issues that employees do not wish to reveal their attitudes to in front of colleagues.

Question 08

Disagreements in a focus group should be encouraged because:

a) they take the focus away from the specific issue under discussion.

b) they engender greater reflection on the part of participants.

c) they enhance the possibility of physical confrontation.

d) they help to create a negative atmosphere after the group has finished.

Disagreements in a focus group environment can allow the moderator to explore the reasons behind differences of opinion and also allow participants to think about why they hold certain beliefs.

Question 09

By using the focus group method which issue can feminist researchers avoid?

a) **Decontextualization**.

b) Deconfiguration.

c) Destabilization.

d) Degenderization.

Decontextualization involves studying an individual without an appreciation of a social context. The benefit of focus groups for feminist researchers is that as part of a group dencontextualization is minimized.

Question 10

Which of the following is not regarded as a limitation of focus groups?

a) The potential for the group to conform to one dominant opinion.

b) It does not allow for large volumes of data to be collected.

c) Organization of focus groups is not straight forward.

d) The researcher has less control over the proceedings.

Focus groups actually produce a very high volume of data in a short space of time, hence there is a challenge for the researcher to both record, transcribe and analyse this data efficiently.

Chapter 20

Question 01

What is different between the way that traditional business research views language and the way that methods such as conversation and discourse analysis do?

a) Traditional business research emphasizes the correct use of grammar, whereas CA and DA are concerned more with modern grammar usage.

b) Traditional business research aims to develop a universal business language, whereas CA and DA are more concerned with maintaining distinctive usage.

c) Traditional business research sees language as resource through which business is conducted, whereas CA and DA see it as a topic in itself.

d) Traditional business research emphasizes the importance of managerial language, whereas CA and DA are more concerned with that of workers.

Conversation and discourse analysis regard language as not just being reflective of what is going on in organisations; instead, through these methodologies, language is seen what makes organisations.

Question 02

Ethnomethodology is:

a) a research methodology that looks at prioritises the role of ethnic minorities.

b) the study of covert research methods.

c) the study of how ethnography can be combined with social surveys.

d) the study of the methods of accomplishing social order.

Ethnomethodology argues that the social order does not pre-exist and it therefore focuses on how this order is achieved through social action. It is regarded as the basis for conversation analysis.

Question 03

Which of the following is a definition of indexicality?

a) The process of completing the index to a written text.

b) The idea that the meaning of spoken words depends upon the context in which it is used.

c) The idea that the meaning of any social act can be universally categorised.

d) The process of drawing up definitions of words used in everyday language.

Along with reflexivity, indexicality is a central idea in ethnomethodology and is relevant to understanding conversation analysis.

Question 04

Why is conversation analysis sometimes described as having a positivist orientation?

a) Because it is a multi-faceted approach to data collection and analysis.

b) Because it uses rigorous and systematic procedures for data analysis.

c) Because of its emphasis of prior theoretical commitments.

d) Because of its concern with such things as organisational culture.

Conversation analysis has a number of features that are in tune with qualitative research, however other features such as its emphasis upon systematic procedures for data analysis mean that it can be linked with positivism.

Question 05

Which of then following is not an assumption of conversation analysis?

a) Theories of talk can be deduced in advance of data analysis.

b) Talk is viewed as exhibiting patterned sequences.

c) Talk is structured and cannot be ascribed to an individual's personal characteristics.

d) The nature of social order must be induced out of data.

Despite the suggestion that CA has much in common with positivist research it differs significantly in that it has an inductive approach to theory development.

Question 06

Which of the following business issues can CA make a contribution to our understanding of?

a) The development of the double-entry bookkeeping system to modern accounting methods.

b) The use of balanced scorecards in organisational performance.

c) The range of rhetorical devices used in corporate boardroom meetings.

d) The importance of adjacency pairs in corporate boardroom meetings.

Adjacency pairs are an example of the tools used in conversation analysis. Rhetorical devices are more commonly associated with discourse analysis.

Question 07

How does discourse analysis differ from conversation analysis?

a) Discourse analysis places less emphasis on naturally occurring talk.

b) Discourse analysis has a less uniform approach to language analysis.

c) Discourse analysis can be applied to a range of different texts.

d) All of the above.

Discourse analysis is not a total opposite to conversation analysis however it is important to stress that it is a more wide ranging methodology because it looks to analyse the use of language in many different forms.

Question 08

Why might a charismatic leader use rhetorical devices?

a) To provoke a response from competitors.

b) To establish the organisation's rules and regulations.

c) To provoke identification and commitment amongst followers.

d) All of the above.

Rhetorical devices are a form of discourse that frame how something is formed and socially constructed; the leaders image in this case.

Question 09

Why might the researcher using discourse analysis be interested in corporate mission statements?

a) Because they are a way of categorising organisations.

b) Because they are indicators of corporate performance.

c) Because they are used to convey certain managerial values.

d) Because they are a legal requirement.

Corporate mission statements are a way of conveying certain messages which are designed to ensure that employees identify with the organisation. Through a discourse analysis we can see the mechanisms through which this can occur.

Question 10

Why has discourse not been of interest to mainstream management and business research?

a) It applies only to employees.

b) It is less focused on action.

c) It is does not allow for participant involvement.

d) It is not sufficiently focused on corporate performance.

Discourse analysis tends to focus on how organisations are constructed, whereas much mainstream management research is concerned with actions that these corporations can take to be more successful.

STA630 100% solved MCQ from Book F

0 Comments

Chapter 21

Instructions

Choose your answers from a-d by clicking the radio button next to each choice and then press 'Submit' to get your score.

Question 01

Which of the following is not a criteria suggested by Scott (1990) as a way of assessing the quality of documents?

a) Representativeness.

b) Credibility.

c) Validity.

d) Authenticity.

The fourth criterion suggested by Scott (1990) is that of meaning. This refers to the extent that a document is clear and comprehensible.

Question 02

How does the use of personal diaries for data collection in qualitative research differ from their same use in quantitative research?

a) Diarists are given more scope in terms of what they write about.

b) Diarists are asked to complete multiple-choice questions relating to their working day.

c) Diarists are required to report the exact number of relevant interactions they have had.

d) Diarists have to use the medium of art to express their feelings.

The use of diaries in qualitative research means that the diarist has less of a structure about what they have to write. Bowey & Thorpe (1986) is a good example of the use of this research method.

Question 03

Which of the following questions should the researcher ask when considering the credibility of personal documents?

a) Is the purported author of the document the real author?

b) Has the document survived because it is favourable towards a certain organisation?

c) Does the document actually report the true feelings of the author?

d) Does the document contain codes that are hard to decipher?

This is an important assessment of the credibility of any personal document along with the factual accuracy of reports.

Question 04

What is the problem with using a photograph of employees from a company brochure as a research source?

a) It may be difficult to re-print in published material.

b) It may not be representative of an employee's day to day experience of the company.

c) It might deflect attention away form the main focus of the research.

d) It may effect the anonymity of the employees in the picture.

This is an important assessment of the credibility of any personal document along with the factual accuracy of reports.

Question 05

What type of document is often used by researchers conducting organizational post mortem research?

a) Private diaries.

b) Photographs.

c) Emails.

d) Public documents.

A number of researchers have looked at critical events and disasters and have used publicly available documents to conduct their analyses.

Question 06

What particular use are organizational documents not in the public domain often put to by qualitative researchers?

a) To gain an insight into past managerial decisions.

b) To make profitability comparisons with other companies.

c) To assess the impact of marketing material.

d) All of the above.

Processual studies of organisations often use internal organizational documents to build up a 'timeline' of organizational change.

Question 07

What impact might the idea of active audience/readers have on business researcher's data analysis?

a) It is possible that readers will resist the meaning intended by authors of texts.

b) It is possible that different researchers will have different interpretations of certain texts.

c) It is possible that the conclusions derived from certain data will be a reflection of the business researcher's personal interpretation.

d) All of the above.

The argument that there is no one dominant way to read and interpret a text means that business researchers must approach their data analysis with caution.

Question 08

What is distinctive about qualitative content analysis in comparison with quantitative data analysis?

a) It is a much more laborious process.

b) It allows for the constant reassessment of themes and categories.

c) It is much more explicit form of analysis.

d) It is much easier for other researchers to replicate.

In qualitative content analysis there is much greater movement between conceptualization, data collection, analysis and interpretation than in quantitative content analysis.

Question 09

What contribution has semiotic analysis made to studies of advertising?

a) It has identified universal signs that apply across cultures.

b) It has established the correct way of presenting certain images.

c) It has shown how the same message can be interpreted in different ways.

d) It has demonstrated the links between advertising and purchasing.

Semiotic analysis aims to uncover the hidden meanings that reside in texts and as a result it has been able to show how the same text, or advertisement, can have different meanings for different people.

Question 10

What is a critical hermeneutic approach?

a) One that incorporates all possible interpretations of a text.

b) **One that attempts to understand a text from the author's perspective**.

c) One that uses modern cultural standards to assess historical texts.

d) One that separates the researcher's personal interpretation from the analysis.

A critical hermeneutic approach makes an attempt to analyse a text not just from the perspective of the author but also from the social and historical context of its production.

Chapter 22

Instructions

Choose your answers from a-d by clicking the radio button next to each choice and then press 'Submit' to get your score.

Question 01

Why are general approaches to qualitative data analysis described as iterative?

a) Because they are based on formal, established guidelines.

b) Because they allow for the research process to follow a strictly linear trajectory.

c) Because there is a repetitive interplay between collection and analysis of data.

d) Because they should not fly too close to the sun.

Iterative means that analysis starts after some of the data have been collected and that the implications of this analysis then inform the next stage of data collection.

Question 02

Which of the following is a potential limitation of analytic induction?

a) It is too rigorous to be described as a qualitative method of analysis.

b) It is unable to specify the necessary conditions for phenomena to occur.

c) It does not allow for reformulation of an identified hypothesis.

d) All of the above.

Analytic induction can identify what is sufficient for certain phenomena to occur but not what is necessary

Question 03

The two central features of grounded theory are:

a) codification and quantification.

b) the identification of theory and its testing against collected data.

c) linearity and simplicity.

d) the development of theory from data and recursiveness.

Grounded theory is based on the idea that theories should be induced from collected data and that this should, in turn, inform additional data collection.

Question 04

What is the difference between coding in grounded theory and quantitative data analysis?

a) In grounded theory coding begins soon after the collection of initial data.

b) In grounded theory no pre-conceived codes are utilised.

c) In grounded theory different types and levels of coding are recognized.

d) All of the above.

Coding is the key process in grounded theory as it forms a major part of the iterative loop that is grounded theory's dominant feature.

Question 05

According to Strauss and Corbin (1990) selective coding is the procedure of:

a) breaking down, examining and categorizing data.

b) putting data back together in new ways and making connections between categories.

c) choosing the core category and relating it to other categories.

d) establishing the causal relationships within the data.

Coding is the key process in grounded theory as it forms a major part of the iterative loop that is grounded theory's dominant feature.

Question 06

Which of the following can represent a criticism of grounded theory?

a) There is no such thing as theory-neutral observation.

b) The social world is not 'out there' awaiting discovery.

c) Language is constitutive as well as reflective.

d) Data collection is not a straight forward linear process.

The notion that a researcher adopting a grounded theory approach can suspend their awareness of certain theories and concepts can be questioned. It is more likely that what the researcher sees is conditioned by a range of different factors.

Question 07

Which of the following is not an additional problem associated with grounded theory?

a) The time it takes to transcribe interviews and to engage in a genuinely iterative process.

b) **The reluctance of researchers using grounded theory to adopt natural scientific methods**.

c) The vague nature of many key points relating to the practice of grounded theory.

d) The fragmentation of data in different categories.

This could not be a criticism levelled at grounded theory because, as a qualitative research method, it explicitly rejects the application of natural science methods to the social world.

Question 08

In what way does the practice of coding introduce an element of quantification into grounded theory?

a) The significance of data is sometimes based on its frequency within the whole data set.

b) Coding can allow for the researcher to measure the likelihood that a particular issue applies to the entire population.

c) The core category should always be defined in advance of data collection.

d) None of the above.

Many researchers using grounded theory code their data on the basis of the number of times certain issues occur within their analysis.

Question 09

What is the benefit of subjecting qualitative data to secondary analysis?

a) It overcomes ethical concerns about informed consent.

b) It enables the data to be analysed without the hindrance of a contextual understanding.

c) It is more likely that the findings will be published.

d) It can exploit the large volume of qualitative data that is under-explored.

Whilst a number of significant problems remain with the secondary analysis of qualitative data, there are opportunities for researchers to exploit because of the volume of data that is cast aside as part of the analysis.

Question 10

Narrative analysis in management research enables the researcher to:

a) relate all of their thought processes during data analysis.

b) discard all data that does not adhere to storytelling guidelines.

c) identify how managers make sense of their environment.

d) assess how managers will react in certain circumstances.

A narrative analysis allows the researcher to look at what different stories told by managers and others, reveal about their attitudes towards the organisation.

Chapter 23

Instructions

Choose your answers from a-d by clicking the radio button next to each choice and then press 'Submit' to get your score.

Question 01

What does the acronym 'CAQDAS' stand for?

a) Computer-Assisted Qualitative Data Analysis Software.

b) Complicated Analytical Questions Deserving Answers Soon.

c) Constant Aggravation Queried Directly And Swiftly.

d) Content Analysis Quantification: Durkheim and Statistics.

CAQDAS is one of the most significant developments in qualitative research over the last twenty years. The label refers to a group of software packages such as NVivo, NUD*IST and ATLAS/ti, which are used for qualitative data analysis.

Question 02

How is CAQDAS different from quantitative data analysis software?

a) It only works on Apple Mac computers.

b) It requires detailed knowledge of statistics.

c) There is no industry leader.

d) The programs do the analysis for you.

Within the field of quantitative data analysis SPSS is the most widely known and used statistical software package, but with regard to CAQDAS there is no equivalent industry leader. Some of the most popular programs today are NVivo, NUD*IST and ATLAS/ti, but other researchers may prefer MAXqda or the Ethnograph.

Question 03

Which of the following is not a criticism of the use of CAQDAS in business research?

a) It reinforces the idea that code-and-retrieve is the only way to conduct qualitative analysis.

b) It results in the fragmentation of data and a loss of narrative flow.

c) It may not be suitable for focus group data.

d) It is not very fast or efficient at retrieving sections of data.

Various criticisms have been levelled at CAQDAS, including the idea that it has created a new orthodoxy of 'code-and-retrieve' qualitative analysis, that it fragments the data and that it is only useful for certain kinds of qualitative data. However, most researchers would agree that CAQDAS offers a faster and more efficient way of analyzing qualitative data than doing so by hand.

Question 04

Which of the following is not an advantage of using CAQDAS in business research?

a) It makes the process of qualitative data analysis more transparent.

b) It is faster and efficient than analyzing by hand.

c) It involves learning skills that are specific to each program.

d) It helps you to map out the relations between ideas and themes in the data.

There are numerous advantages to using CAQDAS, most of which centre on its speed and efficiency and the way in which mapping out 'coding trees' of related ideas helps you to develop a grounded theory. While each CAQDAS program is unique and involves different screens, functions and ways of representing the data, the basic techniques of importing, coding, retrieving and searching will be common to all of the programs and so provide you with a useful transferable skill.

Question 05

In what format should you import your project documents from Word into NVivo?

a) .jpeg or .mpeg

b) .txt or .rtf

c) .html or .htm

d) .doc or .mp3

You should import your documents from Word either without any formatting (as plain text files: .txt) or with some formatting retained (in rich text format: .rtf).

Question 06

In which window can you read through, edit and code your documents?

a) Document Browser.

b) Node Explorer.

c) Project Pad.

d) Launch Pad.

Having imported the project files that you want to analyze, you can open each one and edit it as if it were a Word document using the Document Browser. This is also where you can code your documents by applying nodes to sections of the data.

Question 07

What are the two types of node used in NVivo?

a) Seed nodes and weed nodes.

b) Shrub nodes and grub nodes.

c) Flower nodes and power nodes.

d) Tree nodes and free nodes.

NVivo uses 'nodes' to represent codes or other items of information about the data in your project. There are two main types of node: tree nodes are created as part of a network of inter-related concepts, while free nodes are created independently of all other nodes.

Question 08

The Node Explorer dialog box allows you to:

a) apply codes to the data.

b) browse, edit or delete nodes.

c) create a memo document.

d) save and close your project file.

The Node Explorer dialog box appears if you click on 'Explore Nodes' from the Project Pad. Here you can browse, edit/change or delete nodes, which allows you to modify your coding tree as the analysis progresses. To apply the nodes (as codes) to the data, you need to open the document browser.

Question 09

What are in vivo codes?

a) Codes that were established before the data collection began.

b) Codes that reflect abstract theoretical concepts.

c) Codes derived from the language of research participants.

d) Higher level categories of codes, incorporating various node trees.

You can code the data using either the conceptual codes that appear in the node tree and as free nodes, or *in vivo* codes. The latter term refers to codes that are derived from the words or phrases research participants' use, as they appear in the text of an interview transcript or fieldnotes.

Question 10

Which of the following is a kind of search that can be carried out in NVivo?

a) Single node search.

b) Intersection search.

c) Specific text search.

d) All of the above.

There are three main types of search that you can conduct in NVivo: you can collect all the data coded under a particular node (single node search), find data that have been coded by two or more particular nodes (intersection search), or locate all the instances in which 'strings' of specific words or phrases are used (specific text search). All of these can be accessed from the Search Tool dialog box, which you can reach from the Project Pad.

Chapter 24

Instructions

Choose your answers from a-d by clicking the radio button next to each choice and then press 'Submit' to get your score.

Question 01

Which of the following is not a characterization of the natural sciences?

a) The natural sciences are possessed with an epistemological unity.

b) The natural sciences are a complex area just like the social sciences.

c) The practices of natural scientists are revealed in their written accounts.

d) All natural scientists can be charged with the term positivist.

A significant difficulty with the way in which differences between research methods are presented is that they are based on a characterization of the natural sciences as something which it is not.

Question 02

Qualitative research often adheres to a natural science model because:

a) it rejects all attempts to deduce theory in advance.

b) it places a large degree of emphasis on understanding context.

c) it can be used to investigate specific and tightly defined problems.

d) it is always constructivist in nature.

Not all qualitative research follows a grounded theory model as it is often used to address specific issues that are defined in advance; similar to the methods commonly associated with the natural sciences.

Question 03

In what way does quantitative research study meaning?

a) Through detailed description of context.

b) Through careful observation of specific actions in the workplace.

c) Through an attempt to reveal the influence of capitalist structures on everyday life.

d) Through the exploration of attitudes via extensive survey questions.

The claim of qualitative researchers to be better able to gain access to a respondent's point of view is often assumed, rather than demonstrated. Quantitative research's use of prior questioning to seek out different attitudinal positions may give it better access to meaning.

Question 04

Why is it problematic to suggest that the choice of business research method reveals ontological and epistemological assumptions?

a) Because business research should not be concerned with these issues.

b) Because the correspondence between a research strategy and a set of ontological and epistemological assumptions is not straight forward.

c) Because the choice of research method is dictated by the research question.

d) Because the correspondence between a research strategy and either ontology or epistemology is impossible to define.

Research methods are much more 'free-floating', in terms of their epistemological and ontological position, than is often assumed when highlighting the divide between quantitative and qualitative research.

Question 05

Quantitative research does not always adhere to a deductive model because:

a) Its findings frequently suggest new departures and theoretical contributions.

b) Many survey-based studies are subjected to exploratory analyses.

c) There is a great deal of creativity in quantitative data analysis.

d) All of the above.

Quantitative research is not simply about theory testing; it can also be used to suggest new ways of viewing the social world. Correspondingly qualitative research can also be used to test pre-conceived theories.

Question 06

Which method of data collection commonly associated with qualitative research can be seen as artificial?

a) Ethnography.

b) Participant observation.

c) Semi-structured interview.

d) All of the above.

Because an interview requires some degree of planning and preparation, and will normally remove the interviewee from their workstation, it can be said to be an artificial situation.

Question 07

What does Gephart (1988) mean by the term ethnostatistics?

a) The collection of statistical data using ethnographic methods.

b) The study of the use of statistics as a rhetorical device.

c) The use of statistical analysis by the participants of the research.

d) The statistical analysis of one specific context.

Ethnostatistics can be used to show how the language of statistics is used to persuade audiences of certain arguments through the acquisition of greater legitimacy.

Question 08

Which form of data analysis can be applied to ethnographic accounts to establish links between in-depth accounts and statistical analysis?

a) Discourse analysis.

b) Content analysis.

c) Mulitvariate analysis.

d) Bivariate analysis.

Hodson (1996) shows how a content analysis of ethnographies allows for quantitative and qualitative research strategies to be closely linked.

Question 09

What is quasi-quantification?

a) Statistical analysis based upon synthetic data.

b) The application of quantitative methods in feminist research.

c) The allusions to quantity made by qualitative researchers.

d) The testing of the suitability of specific statistical tests.

Qualitative researchers often use terms such as 'many', 'often' or 'frequently' thereby alluding to the importance of quantification in their data analysis.

Question 10

What benefit is there to qualitative researchers in providing information on the frequency of a particular perspective?

a) They are more likely to get published if they can report a high frequency.

b) It gives the reader a clear sense of the relative prevalence of the perspective.

c) It is useful for quantitative secondary analysis.\

d) All of the above

Qualitative researchers often use terms such as 'many', 'often' or 'frequently' thereby alluding to the importance of quantification in their data analysis.

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Chapter 01

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Question 1

What is a 'grand theory'?

a) One that was proposed by one of the major theorists in the sociological tradition

b) **One that is highly abstract and makes broad generalizations about the social world**

c) An intermediate level explanation of observed regularities

d) A particularly satisfactory theory that makes the researcher feel happy

Question 2

What does an empiricist believe?

a) We should not apply natural science methods to social science research

b) It is the sociologist's aim to understand the meaning of social action

c) **Knowledge, in the form of 'facts', should be gained through sensory experience**

d) Research conducted within the British empire was biased and unreliable

Question 3

An inductive theory is one that:

a) Involves testing an explicitly defined hypothesis

b) Does not allow for findings to feed back into the stock of knowledge

c) Uses quantitative methods whenever possible

d) **Allows theory to emerge out of the data**

Question 4

What is the epistemological position held by a positivist?

a) There is no substitute for an in-depth, hermeneutic understanding of society

b) **Scientific research should be based on value-free, empirical observations**

c) Events and discourses in the social world prevent us from having direct knowledge of the natural order

d) It is important to remain optimistic about our research, even when things go wrong

Question 5

The interpretivist view of the social sciences is that:

a) Their subject matter is fundamentally different to that of the natural sciences

b) We should aim to achieve the interpretive understanding of social action

c) It is important to study the way people make sense of their everyday worlds

d) **All of the above**

Question 6

Which of the following is an ontological question?

a) Should I use questionnaires or interviews in my project?

b) What can (and should) be considered acceptable forms of knowledge?

c) How long is it since I last visited the dentist?

d) **Do social entities have an objective reality, external to social actors**?

Question 7

The constructionist ontological position suggests that:

a) **Social phenomena and their meanings are constantly being accomplished by social actors**

b) Individuals are born into a world of rules and structures that they cannot change

c) Building and construction work presents an ideal opportunity to exercise the sociological imagination

d) Social facts and objects have an external reality, independently of the people who perceive them

Question 8

The qualitative research strategy places a value on:

a) Using numbers, measurements and statistical techniques

b) **Generating theories through inductive research about social meanings**

c) Conducting research that is of a very high quality

d) All of the above

Question 9

Which of the following is an example of value-free research?

a) Conscious partiality

b) Sympathy for the underdog

c) Unstructured interviewing

d) **None of the above**

Question 10

An important practical issue to consider when designing a research project is:

a) Which theoretical perspective you find most interesting

b) Whether or not you have time to retile the bathroom first

c) **How much time and money you have to conduct the research**

d) Which colour of ring binder to present your work in

Chapter 02

Instructions

Choose your answers from a-d by clicking the radio button next to each choice and then press 'Submit' to get your score.

Question 1

What is a research design?

a) A way of conducting research that is not grounded in theory

b) The choice between using qualitative or quantitative methods

c) The style in which you present your research findings, e.g. a graph

d) **A framework for every stage of the collection and analysis of data**

Question 2

If a study is "reliable", this means that:

a) It was conducted by a reputable researcher who can be trusted

b) **The measures devised for concepts are stable on different occasions**

c) The findings can be generalized to other social settings

d) The methods are stated clearly enough for the research to be replicated

Question 3

"Internal validity" refers to:

a) **Whether or not there is really a causal relationship between two variables**

b) Whether or not the findings are relevant to the participants' everyday lives

c) The degree to which the researcher feels that this was a worthwhile project

d) How accurately the measurements represent underlying concepts

Question 4

Lincoln & Guba (1985) propose that an alternative criterion for evaluating qualitative research would be:

a) Impressiveness

b) **Trustworthiness**

c) Joyfulness

d) Messiness

Question 5

Naturalism has been defined as:

a) Viewing natural and social objects as belonging to the same realm

b) Being true to the nature of the phenomenon under investigation

c) Minimising the intrusion of artificial methods of data collection into the field

d) **All of the above**

Question 6

In an experimental design, the dependent variable is:

a) **The one that is not manipulated and in which any changes are observed**

b) The one that is manipulated in order to observe any effects on the other

c) A measure of the extent to which personal values affect research

d) An ambiguous concept whose meaning depends on how it is defined

Question 7

What is a cross-sectional design?

a) A study of one particular section of society, e.g. the middle classes

b) One that is devised when the researcher is in a bad mood

c) **The collection of data from more than one case at one moment in time**

d) A comparison of two or more variables over a long period of time

Question 8

Survey research is cross-sectional and therefore:

a) **High in replicability but low in internal validity**

b) High in internal validity but low in reliability

c) High in ecological validity but low in external validity

d) None of the above

Question 9

Panel and cohort designs differ, in that:

a) Cohort studies involve quantitative research, whereas panel studies are qualitative

b) A panel study does not need rules to handle new entrants to households

c) Only a cohort study will suffer from sample attrition

d) **A panel study can distinguish between age effects and cohort effects, but a cohort design cannot**

Question 10

Cross cultural studies are an example of:

a) Case study design

b) **Comparative design**

c) Experimental design

d) Longitudinal design

Chapter 03

Instructions

Choose your answers from a-d by clicking the radio button next to each choice and then press 'Submit' to get your score.

Question 1

Which of the following requirements for a dissertation may depend on your institution?

a) Whether an abstract should be included

b) The format for referencing

c) The word limit

d) **All of the above**

Question 2

The role of a project supervisor is to:

a) Make sure you keep to your schedule and deadlines

b) **Provide intellectual support, guidance and critical feedback**

c) Negotiate access to the research setting on the student's behalf

d) Give you a reading list

Question 3

You can manage your time and resources best, by:

a) Working out a timetable

b) Finding out what resources are readily available to you

c) Calculating a budget for likely expenditure

d) All of the above

Question 4

What did Marx (1997) mean when he suggested that "intellectual puzzles and contradictions" can be a possible source of research questions?

a) The researcher may feel that there is a contradiction in the literature, presenting a "puzzle" to be solved

b) Students can develop their IQ levels by attempting to solve intellectual puzzles

c) Unless you can find a logical contradiction, you have no basis for conducting research

d) All of life is a puzzle, so any aspect of life can be researched

Question 5

How can you tell if your research questions are really good?

a) If they guide your literature search

b) If they are linked together to help you construct a coherent argument

c) If they force you to narrow the scope of your research

d) All of the above

Question 6

Which of the following should be included in a research proposal?

a) Your academic status and experience

b) The difficulties you encountered with your previous reading on the topic

c) Your choice of research methods and reasons for choosing them

d) All of the above

Question 7

Which of the following should you think about when preparing your research?

a) Your sample frame and sampling strategy

b) The ethical issues that might arise

c) Negotiating access to the setting

d) All of the above

Question 8

Why is it helpful to keep a research diary or log book while you are conducting your project?

a) To give you something to do in the early stages of your research when nothing is happening

b) Because funding councils generally demand to see written evidence that you were working every day during the period of the research

c) To keep a record of what you did and what happened throughout the research process

d) It can be added to your dissertation to ensure that you reach the required word limit

Question 9

What can you do to ensure your physical safety during your research?

a) Be alert to the possibility of exposure to danger

b) Avoid interviewing alone in the respondent's residence

c) Make sure someone knows where you are and how you can contact them in an emergency

d) **All of the above**

Question 10

What practical steps can you take before you actually start your research?

a) Find out exactly what your institution's requirements are for a dissertation

b) Make sure you are familiar with the hardware and software you plan to use

c) Apply for clearance of your project through an ethics committee

d) **All of the above**

Chapter 04

Instructions

Choose your answers from a-d by clicking the radio button next to each choice and then press 'Submit' to get your score.

Question 1

Why do you need to review the existing literature?

a) To make sure you have a long list of references

b) Because without it, you could never reach the required word-count

c) **To find out what is already known about your area of interest**

d) To help in your general studying

Question 2

To read critically means:

a) Taking an opposing point of view to the ideas and opinions expressed

b) Skimming through the material because most of it is just padding

c) **Evaluating what you read in terms of your own research questions**

d) Being negative about something before you read it

Question 3

Which two of the following are legitimate frameworks for setting out a literature review: 1. Constructing intertextual coherence, 2. Deconstruction of textual coherence, 3. Problematizing the situation, 4. Resolving discovered problems?

a) 1 and 2

b) 2 and 3

c) **1 and 3**

d) 2 and 4

Question 4

A systematic literature review is:

a) One which starts in your own library, then goes to on-line databases and, finally, to the internet

b) **A replicable, scientific and transparent process**

c) One which gives equal attention to the principal contributors to the area

d) A responsible, professional process of time-management for research

Question 5

What is meta-analysis?

a) A technique of correcting for the errors in individual studies within a survey of a large number of studies, to demonstrate the effect of a particular variable

b) A process of secondary-data gathering to assemble all the possibilities for a variable's effects

c) A substitute for original research, which is justified by constraints of time or money

d) A specialized step in a computer software program (SPSS e.g.)

Question 6

What is meta-ethnography?

a) A technique for reviewing literature based exclusively on ethnographic studies

b) A technique for synthesizing interpretations drawn from a number of separate qualitative studies of the same phenomena

c) A process used to make generalizations from a range of qualitative studies

d) A process of surveying only that literature contained within a single library

Question 7

What is a narrative literature review?

a) An historically-based review, starting with the earliest contributions to the field

b) A review based exclusively on stories about companies, in book and case-study form

c) A paraphrase style of reviewing which does not require referencing

d) An initial impression of the topic which you will understand more fully as you conduct your research

Question 8

When accessing the internet, which of these steps is the most essential?

a) Recording the full URL

b) Noting the access dates

c) Downloading material to be referenced

d) They are all equally important

Question 9

According to the Harvard referencing convention, which is the correct reference?

a) Bryman, A. (2008, 3e) *Social Research Methods,* Oxford; Oxford University Press

b) Bryman (2008, second edition), Oxford University Press

c) Bryman, Alan, *Social Research Methods* (2008: OUP)

d) Bryman, A. Social Research Methods (2008)

Question 10

Which of the following statements about plagiarism is most accurate?

a) It is so easy to "copy and paste" from the internet that everyone does it nowadays. If a proper reference is given, where is the harm in that?

b) How can we say for sure where our own ideas come from exactly? If we tried to give a reference for everything we could never hope to succeed.

c) **Any suggestion that we have written what another actually wrote is morally wrong. Anyway, the whole point of a literature review is to show what we have read and what we thought about it.**

d) Plagiarism is such an awful crime that those found guilty should be obliged to wear a scarlet "P" on their clothing.

Chapter 05

Instructions

Choose your answers from a-d by clicking the radio button next to each choice and then press 'Submit' to get your score.

Question 1

There is a tendency for debates about ethics in social research to focus on the most extreme cases of ethical transgression. Why might this create a misleading impression?

a) Because these studies did not actually take place

b) Because it makes social researchers look like nasty, unscrupulous people

c) **Because this implies that ethical concerns do not pervade all social research**

d) Because most social research is in fact ethically sound and infallible

Question 2

Which of the following ideas is *not* associated with the stance of situation ethics?

a) **Anything goes**

b) Principled relativism

c) The end justifies the means

d) No choice

Question 3

Why is it argued that ethical transgression is pervasive in social research?

a) Because most researchers do not bother to follow a professional code of ethics

b) **Because researchers rarely provide their participants with all the information they might want to know about a project**

c) Because it helps us to justify the more extreme forms of unethical conduct that we prefer to pursue

d) Because sociologists want to present themselves as inconsiderate and careless

Question 4

Which of the following is a form of harm that might be suffered by research participants?

a) Physical injury

b) Stress and anxiety

c) Impaired development

d) **All of the above**

Question 5

Why is it important that personal data about research participants are kept within secure, confidential records?

a) So that the participants cannot find out what has been written about them

b) **In case individuals, places or organizations can be harmed through identification or disclosure of personal information**

c) So that government officials, teachers and other people in authority can have easy access to the data

d) To enable the researcher to track down individuals and find out more about their lives

Question 6

Which method is most commonly associated with a lack of informed consent?

a) In-depth interviewing

b) Qualitative content analysis

c) **Covert observation**

d) Structured interviewing

Question 7

Why is it "easier said than done" to ensure that the principle of informed consent is adhered to?

a) It is not practicable to present every participant with all the information about the study

b) Sometimes it is desirable to withhold certain pieces of information, such as the length of time an interview will take

c) If the participants knew exactly what the researcher was intending to study, they might change their behaviour

d) **All of the above**

Question 8

Apart from the fact that it is "not a nice thing to do" (p125), what is an important ethical disadvantage of deceiving participants?

a) **It can damage the professional reputation of the researcher and their discipline**

b) It makes it more difficult to gain access to deviant or hidden populations

c) It means that records of personal data about the participants cannot be made anonymous

d) None of the above

Question 9

Which of the following factors does *not* add a political dimension to the research process?

a) The researcher's values, beliefs and prior assumptions

b) **The response rate of a social survey**

c) The vested interests of the funding body

d) A gatekeeper's concerns about representation

Question 10

Whose side did Becker suggest the social researcher should take?

a) **The underdog**

b) The fat cat

c) The cash cow

d) The sitting duck

Chapter 06

Instructions

Choose your answers from a-d by clicking the radio button next to each choice and then press 'Submit' to get your score.

Question 1

An operational definition is:

a) One that bears no relation to the underlying concept

b) An abstract, theoretical definition of a concept

c) **A definition of a concept in terms of specific, empirical measures**

d) One that refers to opera singers and their work

Question 2

The importance of measurement in quantitative research is that:

a) It allows us to delineate fine differences between people or cases

b) It provides a consistent device or yardstick

c) It allows for precise estimates of the degree of relationship between concepts

d) **All of the above**

Question 3

The difference between measures and indicators is that:

a) **Measures are unambiguous quantities, whereas indicators are devised from common sense understandings**

b) Indicators have a more direct relationship to the underlying concept than measures

c) Measures are intuitively devised and then applied as if they were direct indicators of a concept

d) Indicators are unambiguous quantities, whereas measures are subjective and value-laden

Question 4

The split-half method is used as a test of:

a) Stability

b) **Internal reliability**

c) Inter-observer consistency

d) External validity

Question 5

Which of the following is *not* a form of measurement validity?

a) Concurrent validity

b) Face validity

c) **Conductive validity**

d) Convergent validity

Question 6

Quantitative social researchers rarely claim to have established causality because:

a) They are more concerned with publishing the results of their reliability tests

b) They do not believe that this is an appropriate goal to be striving for

c) They keep forgetting which of the variables they have manipulated

d) **They tend to use cross-sectional designs, which produce only correlations**

Question 7

One of the preoccupations of quantitative researchers is with generalization, which is a sign of:

a) **External validity**

b) Internal reliability

c) External reliability

d) Internal validity

Question 8

Quantitative research has been criticised because:

a) **The measurement process suggests a spurious and artificial sense of accuracy**

b) The reliance on instruments and procedures makes it high in ecological validity

c) It underestimates the similarities between objects in the natural and social worlds

d) All of the above

Question 9

The term 'reverse operationism' means that:

a) The theories we devise will often hinder our attempts to measure concepts

b) **The measurements we devise can sometimes help to develop a theory**

c) Techniques such as factor analysis have no place in social research

d) Driving instructors always make you practice the most difficult manoeuvre

Question 10

Written accounts of quantitative research rarely include the results of reliability and validity tests because:

a) Researchers are more interested in reporting their operational definitions

b) Researchers don't really think that these tests are important

c) Journal editors have banned these kinds of articles

d) **Researchers are more interested in reporting their substantive findings**

Chapter 07

Instructions

Choose your answers from a-d by clicking the radio button next to each choice and then press 'Submit' to get your score.

Question 1

A sampling frame is:

a) A summary of the various stages involved in designing a survey

b) An outline view of all the main clusters of units in a sample

c) **A list of all the units in the population from which a sample will be selected**

d) A wooden frame used to display tables of random numbers

Question 2

A simple random sample is one in which:

a) From a random starting point, every *n*th unit from the sampling frame is selected

b) A non-probability strategy is used, making the results difficult to generalize

c) The researcher has a certain quota of respondents to fill for various social groups

d) **Every unit of the population has an equal chance of being selected**

Question 3

It is helpful to use a multi-stage cluster sample when:

a) The population is widely dispersed geographically

b) You have limited time and money available for travelling

c) You want to use a probability sample in order to generalise the results

d) **All of the above**

Question 4

The standard error is a statistical measure of:

a) The normal distribution of scores around the sample mean

b) **The extent to which a sample mean is likely to differ from the population mean**

c) The clustering of scores at each end of a survey scale

d) The degree to which a sample has been accurately stratified

Question 5

What effect does increasing the sample size have upon the sampling error?

a) **It reduces the sampling error**

b) It increases the sampling error

c) It has no effect on the sampling error

d) None of the above

Question 6

Which of the following is *not* a type of non-probability sampling?

a) Snowball sampling

b) **Stratified random sampling**

c) Quota sampling

d) Convenience sampling

Question 7

Snowball sampling can help the researcher to:

a) Access deviant or hidden populations

b) Theorise inductively in a qualitative study

c) Overcome the problem of not having an accessible sampling frame

d) **All of the above**

Question 8

Which of the following is *not* a characteristic of quota sampling?

a) The researcher chooses who to approach and so might bias the sample

b) Those who are available to be surveyed in public places are unlikely to constitute a representative sample

c) **The random selection of units makes it possible to calculate the standard error**

d) It is a relatively fast and cheap way of finding out about public opinions

Question 9

The findings from a study of young single mothers at a university can be generalised to the population of:

a) **All young single mothers at that university**

b) All young single mothers in that society

c) All single mothers in all universities

d) All young women in that university

Question 10

The term 'data processing error' refers to:

a) Activities or events related to the sampling process, e.g. non-response

b) **Faulty techniques of coding and managing data**

c) Problems with the implementation of the research process

d) The unavoidable discrepancy between the sample and the population

Chapter 08

Instructions

Choose your answers from a-d by clicking the radio button next to each choice and then press 'Submit' to get your score.

Question 1

Why is it important for structured interviews to follow a standardized procedure?

a) To increase validity, as the interview can be adapted for each respondent

b) **To increase reliability, because all respondents receive the same interview stimulus**

c) To allow for an in-depth exploration of the topic

d) To make it easier for untrained interviewers to carry out complex surveys

Question 2

Standardizing the interview schedule can reduce interviewer variation in terms of:

a) The way in which questions are phrased by the interviewer

b) The order in which questions are asked

c) The procedures used to code and analyse survey data

d) **All of the above**

Question 3

Closed ended questions are those that:

a) **Have a fixed range of possible answers**

b) Prevent respondents from allocating themselves to a category

c) Encourage detailed, elaborate responses

d) Relate to the basic demographic characteristics of respondents

Question 4

Which of the following is *not* a disadvantage of telephone interviewing?

a) **Researchers do not have to spend so much time and money on travelling**

b) Some people in the target population may not own a telephone

c) It can be difficult to build rapport over the telephone

d) Interviewers cannot use visual cues such as show cards

Question 5

The acronym "CATI" stands for:

a) Camera-activated telescopic interviewing

b) **Computer-assisted telephone interviewing**

c) Corrective anti-terrorist interviewing

d) Critical analysis of telepathic interviewing

Question 6

Which of the following might you include in an introductory letter to respondents?

a) An explanation of who you are and who is funding your research

b) An overview of what the research is about and how the data will be collected

c) A statement of their ethical rights to anonymity, confidentiality, etc.

d) **All of the above**

Question 7

A filter question is one that:

a) Ensures that all respondents are asked every question on the schedule and in the same order

b) Leaves a space for respondents to write long and detailed answers

c) **Helps the interviewer to avoid asking irrelevant questions by directing them elsewhere on the schedule**

d) Allows supervisors to distinguish between good and bad interviewers

Question 8

Which of the following is *not* advised when planning the question order of a structured interview?

a) Be wary of asking an earlier question that alters the salience of later questions

b) **Expect some variation in the order in which questions are asked**

c) Leave questions about sensitive or embarrassing issues until later in the interview

d) Group the questions into logically organised sections

Question 9

A show card is:

a) One that prevents respondents from expressing their opinions about a statement

b) One that encourages explicit discussion of sensitive or personal information

c) **One that prompts respondents to choose from a range of possible answers**

d) One that researchers must present when they compete at pony club events

Question 10

The response set of "acquiescence" can be a problem in that:

a) **Some people consistently agree or disagree with a set of questions or items**

b) Respondents tend to give answers that they think are socially desirable

c) The structured interview is so conducive to reciprocity that male respondents find it hard to stop talking

d) Researchers who wear very strong perfume will distract their respondents

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Chapter 09

Instructions

Choose your answers from a-d by clicking the radio button next to each choice and then

press 'Submit' to get your score.

Question 1

Which of the following statements is correct?

a) Self-completion questionnaires are a type of postal survey

b) Postal surveys can include self-completion or email surveys

c) **Self-completion questionnaires can include postal or email surveys**

d) Email surveys are a type of postal questionnaire

Question 2

One of the advantages of self-completion questionnaires over structured interviews is that:

a) **They are quicker and cheaper to administer**

b) They create interviewer effects

c) They have greater measurement validity

d) They are less prone to inter-coder variation

Question 3

Which of the following is *not* a disadvantage of self-completion questionnaires compared to structured interviews?

a) The respondent can read the whole questionnaire before answering the first question

b) **The researcher cannot ask many closed-ended questions**

c) The researcher cannot probe or prompt respondents for more detail

d) The respondent may not answer all questions, resulting in missing data

Question 4

Which of the following steps can be taken to improve response rates to a self-completion questionnaire?

a) Write a personalized covering letter to introduce the research

b) Enclose a stamped addressed envelope with a postal questionnaire

c) Send out polite reminder letters

d) **All of the above**

Question 5

Why is it generally better to present fixed choice answers in vertical rather than horizontal form?

a) It takes up less space on the page

b) It encourages respondents to choose more than one answer

c) It allows questions to be spread over more than one page

d) **It makes the layout of the questionnaire more clear and unambiguous**

Question 6

When using a Likert scale with a long list of items, it is usually better to:

a) **Arrange the answers horizontally, in abbreviated form**

b) List the answers vertically, for each consecutive item

c) Omit any instructions about how to select an answer

d) List all questions on one page and all answers on another

Question 7

In order to identify response sets in a Likert scale, you could:

a) Pre-code all items consistently from 1-5

b) **Reverse the scoring of pre-coded answers**

c) Only include items about socially desirable behaviours

d) Include explicit instructions to respondents not to deceive you

Question 8

Corti (1993) makes a distinction between two types of researcher-driven diary:

a) Valid and reliable diaries

b) Quantitative and qualitative diaries

c) **Structured and free-text diaries**

d) Open or closed answer diaries

Question 9

The 'time-use' diary can provide quantitative data about:

a) **The amount of time respondents spend on certain activities every day**

b) The subjective meanings that concepts of 'time' have for different people

c) The way respondents make sense of their life stories in narrative form

d) The historical significance of clocks, watches and other devices for measuring time

Question 10

One advantage of using diaries in quantitative research is that:

a) **There is little danger of attrition, as respondents tend to be highly motivated**

b) They are likely to elicit data about sensitive issues or deviant activities

c) They highlight the thoughts, feelings and experiences that are unique to each respondent

d) None of the above

Chapter 10

Instructions

Choose your answers from a-d by clicking the radio button next to each choice and then press 'Submit' to get your score.

Question 1

An open question is one that:

a) Allows respondents to answer in their own terms

b) Does not suggest or provide a limited range of responses

c) Can help to generate answers for closed questions

d) **All of the above**

Question 2

In order to post-code answers to open questions, it is necessary to:

a) Count the frequency with which each answer has been given

b) **Categorise unstructured material and assign a code number to each category**

c) Identify the three most commonly cited responses and give them a code

d) Find out where each respondent lives and make a note of their postcode

Question 3

Which of the following is *not* an advantage of using closed questions in a survey?

a) It reduces the risk of variability in the way answers are recorded

b) It makes answers easier to process and analyse

c) **They prevent respondents from giving spontaneous, unexpected answers**

d) Closed questions are quicker and easier for respondents to complete

Question 4

Informant factual questions are those that:

a) Enquire about personal details such as age, income and occupation

b) **Ask people about the characteristics of a social setting or entity that they know well**

c) Seek to find out about people's attitudes and opinions on a range of topics

d) Try to identify the normative standards and values held by a social group

Question 5

Which of the following is a general rule of thumb for designing questions?

a) **Always bear in mind your research questions**

b) Never ask a closed question

c) Always use vignettes rather than open questions

d) Use ambiguous terms to put respondents at ease

Question 6

You should avoid using double-barrelled questions in a survey because:

a) They rely too much on a respondent's memory

b) They make the questions too long, so respondents lose interest

c) They are too abstract and general in scope

d) They confuse respondents by asking about two different things

Question 7

Leading questions should also be avoided because:

a) They suggest ways of answering and so may bias the results

b) They create a mismatch between the question and its possible answers

c) They involve negative terms and unnecessary jargon

d) They ask about several different things at the same tim

Question 8

A vignette question is one that asks respondents to think about:

a) Family obligations to care for sick relatives

b) An intensely painful and sensitive issue in their personal life

c) A scenario involving imaginary characters in a realistic situation

d) Their favourite kind of salad dressing

Question 9

The value of piloting a questionnaire is that it helps you to:

a) Test out your questions on some of the people who will be in the final sample

b) Identify and amend any problems in the question wording, order and format

c) Find out what a trained pilot would think of the subject matter

d) All of the above

Question 10

A question bank is a useful resource for:

a) Studying the way questions have been successfully used in previous surveys

b) Stealing other people's questions without their permission

c) Learning more about your topic so that you can devise leading questions

d) Keeping the money from your funding agency in a safe place

STA630 Research Methods Solved MCQs from Book of Allydog link

0 Comments

1. The following journal article would be an example of_____research; "The benefits of florescent lighting on production in a factory setting."

Applied

Interview

Basic

Stupid (hint: don't select this one)

2. The_____is only useful if the concepts, ideas, questions, etc. to be investigated are both testable and falsifiable.

Independent Variable

Dependent Variable

Experimental Method

Scientific Method

3. Many experiments conducted at universities have Introductory Psychology students act as participants, and then generalize the findings of the study to the general public. In this case, ALL college students in the US can be considered the "population", but those students who participated in the experiment themselves are called the:

control group

sample

experimental group

guinea pigs

4. If you take the S.A.T. exam four times and you receive the same score all four times, we may conclude that the test is_____but not necessarily_____.

valid; reliable

reliable; accurate

reliable; valid

valid; important

5. In order for an experiment to be considered a TRUE EXPERIMENT there must be both random assignment of subjects/participants to groups, and_____.

equal numbers of males and females

preliminary testing to see if participants are eligible

approval of an internal review board

manipulation of an Independent Variable

6. Marsha, Jan, and Cindy are participants in a psychological study of the effectiveness of three different psychedelic drugs. Each participant is assigned to one and only one condition, receiving only one type of drug, in order to examine the effects of each drug from one group to the next. This is a_____design.

between-subjects

within-subjects (repeated measures)

I have no clue

experimental

7. A correlation coefficient of +0.92 means that as one variable increases, the other variable:

increases

decreases

is not affected

is impossible to predict

8. If a participant in an experiment believed that she was expected to act in a certain way, and therefore did not act completely honestly or naturally, her behavior would fit the definition of:

experimenter bias

control

demand characteristics

subjective behavior

9. After a Psychologist has stated the specific problem to be studied in an experiment, he/she must then develop a(n):

theory

conclusion

hypothesis

summary of the data

10. Which of the following would allow me to have the MOST control over environmental variables when conducting a research study?

true experimental design

quasi-experimental design

survey

case study

11. What identifies psychology as a scientific discipline?

its professional status

methods used in studying its subject matter

its subject matter

amount of education needed to be a psychiatrist

12. Hypothesis refers to_____:

the outcome of an experiment

a conclusion drawn from an experiment

a form of bias in which the subject tries to outguess the experimenter

a tentative statement about the relationship

13. Statistics are used by researchers to:

analyze the empirical data collected in a study

make their findings sound better

operationally define their variables

ensure the study comes out the way it was intended

14. What is the final step of a scientific investigation?

analyze data

collect data

report the findings

determine whether the hypothesis was supported

15. What is the variable called, in an experiment, that is manipulated by the researcher?

stimulus

control

dependent

independent

16. What is the purpose of a control group?

make the experiment easier to analyze

show the value of the dependent variable when the independent variable is not being manipulated

to be able to better evaluate the effect of the independent variable

to control all variables

17. When does random assignment occur?

when subjects have an equal chance to be assigned to any condition and/or group in a study

when a subject can choose its group and study

none of the above

all of the above

18. Beth goes to a fast food restaurant and records how many people order hamburgers versus cheeseburgers and whether or not they order a coke versus a diet coke. Beth is involved in a_____:

case study

naturalistic observation

survey

experiment

19. What technique would be useful in determining why a specific toddler is afraid to go to bed?

descriptive study

case study

a placebo

experiment

20. What is one way that distortions can be produced in self report data?

lying

social desirability bias

faulty memory

all of the above

. Which of the following describes single-blind experiments?

(A) They are experiments in which the subjects don't know whether they are receiving a real or fake drug or treatment

(B) They help reduce placebo effects

(C) They help reduce bias in research

(D) All of the above

2. What does it mean if two variables have a positive correlation?

(A) As one variable increases, so does the other

(B) As one variable increases, the other decreases

(C) The correlation between the two variables is 0

(D) The correlation between the two variables is greater than 1.0

3. In what type of study does a researcher study an individual subject in depth?

(A) Naturalistic observation

(B) Laboratory observation

(C) Case study

(D) Survey

4. How can we determine if a test has good validity?

(A) It produces the same result when it is given at different times to the same group of people

(B) It produces the same result no matter which version of the test is used

(C) It measures what it is supposed to measure

(D) All of the questions on it can be answered accurately by the subject

5. What is the variable called that a researcher manipulates in an experiment?

(A) Dependent variable

(B) Independent variable

(C) Extraneous variable

(D) None of the above

6. What is the difference between the highest and lowest scores in a data distribution called?

(A) Mode

(B) Standard deviation

(C) Range

(D) Median

7. The social desirability bias can affect which of the following?

(A) The validity of a test

(B) The reliability of a test

(C) Self-report data

(D) None of the above

8. Which of the following is a research method that allows a researcher to get information about a large number of subjects relatively inexpensively and easily?

(A) Naturalistic observation

(B) Case study

(C) Laboratory observation

(D) Survey

9. What is a common way of controlling extraneous variables in an experiment?

(A) Random assignment

(B) Double-blind procedure

(C) Single-blind procedure

(D) Using animal subjects

10. When doing research involving deception with human subjects, researchers have an obligation to do which of the following?

(A) Tell subjects the truth about the study's purpose and methods after the study is completed

(B) Prevent mental and physical harm to subjects

(C) Let subjects withdraw from the study at any time if they don't want to keep participating

(D) All of the above

Practice Quiz

Chapter 5

Measurement Concepts

1. A reliable measure has more measurement error than an unreliable measure.

True

False

2. An indicator of reliability based on the correlations of each item in a measure with every other item is called:

Test-retest reliability

Cronbach's alpha

Split-half reliability

3. A measure is reactive if it changes the behavior being measured.

True

False

4. A researcher developed a measure of shyness and is now asking whether this measure does in fact measure a person's true state of shyness. This is a question of:

reactivity.

construct validity.

reliability.

5. Scores on a final exam are related to student grade point average, the amount of time spent studying for the exam, and class attendance. What type of validity is demonstrated in this case?

convergent validity.

discriminant validity.

criterion validity.

6. Nominal scales of measurement have no quantitative properties.

True

False

7. Which of the following variables does NOT have ratio scale properties?

job satisfaction rating

reaction time to respond when a stimulus is presented

distance (in inches) that two people stand from each other when conversing

8. My measure allows me to successfully predict future behavioral outcomes. My measure has:

Criterion validity

Face validity

9. Unobtrusive measures reduce the problem of reactivity.

True

False

10. Whenever you divide people into groups, you probably using a nominal scale level of measurement.

True

False

4. The statement, "Interviewers rate job applicants more favorably when they are wearing a pleasant scent than when they have no scent" is an example of:

description of behavior.

prediction of behavior.

explanation of behavior.

5. The statement, "A pleasant scent increases favorability of ratings because the scent creates a positive emotional state in the interviewer" is an example of:

description of behavior.

prediction of behavior.

explanation of behavior.

3. Which of the following would result in finding more articles when using PsycINFO?.

happiness AND marital satisfaction

happiness OR marital satisfaction

4. You found an important article published in 1990. What resource would you use to find articles that have cited your article since then?

Psychological Abstracts

PsycINFO

Social Science Citation Index

5. Which of the following is NOT true of theories?

Explain currently known facts.

Rarely change once formulated.

Generate new knowledge.

7. You are reading a paragraph in a journal article; the topic of the paragraph is the implications of the results for future research. Which section of the article are you reading?

Introduction

Results

Discussion

4. A researcher records the tips left at a restaurant. The amount of the tip is related to size of the check, and the number and gender composition of people in the party. According to regulations, this research would be classified as:

No risk

Minimal risk

Greater than minimal risk

5. Which is not a reason for a debriefing session?

Required by Health and Human Services regulations.

Deal with issues of stress or deception.

Education about psychological research.

4. Which is NOT a problem when the nonexperimental method is used to study relationships between variables?

Direction of cause and effect

Behavior is only measured

A "third" variable may be responsible for the relationship.

5. Which of the following relationships would *most likely* be studied with the nonexperimental method?

The effect of parental use of alcohol on aggressive behavior of children.

The effect of distraction while studying on test performance.

The effect of defendant attractiveness on juror decisions.

. In an experiment, some participants took a standard printed exam; others took the exam using a computer administration procedure. Scores obtained with the two exam procedures were compared. The independent variable was _____ and the dependent variable was_____.

exam type; exam score.

exam score, exam type.

participant gender, exam procedure

Which of the following is used to make sure that the participants in each condition of an experiment are equivalent?

Experimental control

Randomization

2. A researcher devised a coding system to analyze the messages on an Internet bulletin board discussion of the controversy concerning Elian Gonzalez, the Cuban boy who was rescued after a boat accident in the ocean between

Cuba

and the United States. This study used:

content analysis.

naturalistic observation.

systematic observation.

4. A researcher videotaped people while viewing political debates. Raters viewed segments of the tapes and recorded whether the people were smiling. This study used:

systematic observation.

naturalistic observation.

content analysis.

5. A researcher tries to explain why a particular observation does not fit with a theory that is used to explain other observations. This is called:

inter-rater reliability.

negative case analysis.

internal validity.

7. A researcher accessed information on the Internet from a series of surveys of women that was conducted during the 1970s and 1980s. The data were analyzed to examine changes in attitudes and behaviors over time. Which of the following methods was used?

systematic observation

case study

archival research

8. When two or more judges make ratings of observed behaviors, it is important to examine:

inter-rater reliability.

test-retest reliability.

9. A psychologist conducts a study that uses data collected from many cultures in the world. The researcher probably used:

Human Relations Area Files

PsycINFO

2. You wish to make a precise estimate about the characteristics of a population

of individuals. You should use:

quota sampling.

probability sampling.

accidental sampling.

10. A researcher studies memory by talking to groups of people in their 50s, 60s, and 70s about memory problems that they have experienced and worried about. This study has collected:

quantitative data.

qualitative data.

. The number of people who complete a survey in relation to the number of people contacted to participate is called the:

response set.

response rate.

response bias.

6. The question, "Do you think that television should have less violence and fewer shows about sex" is considered:

double-barreled.

loaded.

open-ended.

7. Which type of questions should be first in a questionnaire or interview?

questions about demographics such as age and gender

questions about attitudes and behaviors

8. Which type of question is most likely to be used when the researcher is just starting to explore what people think about a particular topic?

closed-ended

open-ended

10. Which is most likely to yield qualitative data?

Mail survey

Focus group

Telephone interview

2. A researcher studied the effect of defendant physical attractiveness on juror

decisions. The attractive person was 20 years old, and the unattractive person was a 45-year old. The problem here is that:

age is confounded with attractiveness.

it is very difficult to operationally define physical attractiveness.

attractiveness is not related to perceptions of guilt.

4. The same people participate in each condition of an experiment. What type of design is this?

repeated measures (within-subjects)

independent groups (between-subjects)

matched pairs

6. Complete counterbalancing means that:

there were no practice effects

all possible orders of the IV were used

all Latin squares were constructed

9. All things being equal, which design is more likely to result in a statistically significant effect?

Independent groups

Repeated measures

10. You identified the 15 employees in a large organization who were absent from work the most days during the previous month. You require these employees to attend a one-day program on time and stress management in an attempt to reduce absenteeism. In the following month, all of the employees improved their attendance. The improvement could be caused by the program or it might be due to:

statistical regression.

mortality

instrument decay

1. In an experiment, words with either feminine or masculine connotation were presented on a computer screen. The participant pressed one key when they perceived a masculine word and another key when it was perceived as feminine. Reaction time was the dependent variable. The experimenter used a:

staged manipulation

straightforward manipulation

2. The dependent variable was score on a measure of comprehension of material. Virtually everyone in all conditions of the experiment answered all questions correctly. Researchers refer to this situation as a:

floor effect.

ceiling effect.

similarity effect.

4. You are concerned that participants in your study may be figuring out exactly what you are studying. You are worried about:

demand characteristics.

experimenter expectancies.

placebo effects.

6. The session that the experimenter holds with participants following an experiment is called:

deception.

informed consent.

debriefing

7. The galvanic skin response (GSR) is a measure of:

anxiety.

muscle tension.

8. A good way to "debug" a study is to run a:

placebo group.

pilot study.

9. An experiment was conducted entirely on the Internet. This procedure probably eliminated the problem of:

demand characteristics.
experimenter expectancies.
informed consent.

10. A researcher is designing a study on the effect of defendant attractiveness on juror decisions. To investigate whether participants perceive the two defendants as different in attractiveness, the researcher should use a:
sensitive dependent measure.
manipulation check.
strong manipulation.
7. A documentary film director made a series of films about the lives of a set of children when they were 7, 14, 21, 28, and 35 years of age, i.e, the films *7-Up* and *14-Up*.. What type of "research design" is this?
cross-sectional
longitudinal
sequential

8. When Donald Campbell compared fatalities in Connecticut and nearby states before and after a police speeding crackdown, the_____design was used.
interrupted time series
control series
longitudinal

10. After comparing the effects of jail and a drug treatment program on persons convicted of drug-related offenses, a researcher analyzed the societal costs of each. The researcher has conducted:
outcome evaluation
needs assessment

economic efficiency assessment

1. You want to know if males and females differ in preferences for dogs and cats as pets. You ask males and females to indicate whether they prefer dogs, cats, or neither dogs nor cats. When you describe your results, you will compare:

means.

percentages.

medians.

2. You want to know if males and females differ in the length of recommended sentence for someone found guilty of driving under the influence of alcohol. You ask males and females to indicate the number of weeks of jail time the convicted person should receive. When you describe your results, you will compare:

means

percentages

medians

4. You conducted a survey of students in your school. You report that half the students work 25 hours per week or less. The statistic you used is the

mean.

median.

mode

5. Couples who share more similar attitudes indicate that they are more satisfied with their relationship. This reflects a_____correlation.

positive

negative

7. A researcher assessed the following variables in a sample of teenage males: aggressive behavior, anger, loneliness, and perceived social support from family and friends. In addition to examining the correlations among these variables, the researcher tested a proposed model of how these variable are related to one another. The researcher is using a:

partial correlation analysis.

structural equation model.

multiple regression analysis.

10. A multiple correlation is a correlation between one variable and another variable that is measured on a ratio scale.

a combined set of variables.

a manipulated variable

2. The ability to infer that that the independent variable caused the effect on the dependent variable is called:

internal validity

external validity

criterion validity

3. When you discuss the extent to which your results would apply to other people or settings, you are concerned with:

internal validity

external validity

criterion validity

5. A replication in which the original procedures are duplicated is called a(n) _____ .

exact replication

conceptual replication

systematic replication.

. A study on fear of medical procedures was conducted in a room on campus that had been decorated as a doctor's office has:

experimental realism

mundane realism

replicability

8. The participants in the study became very involved in a computer simulation.

This study has:

experimental realism

mundane realism

replicability

10. A study conducted outside the confines of a standard laboratory/classroom is called a:

field experiment

mundane experiment

meta-analysis

STA630 Research Methods Solved MCQs Shared by Power Girls

0 Comments

STA630 1st

Quiz

Shared by Power Girls

Who join our conference and help us in solving these quizzes.

Helpful Links:

http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_airasian_edresearch_8/38/9865/2525549.cw/index.htm

I

http://www.oup.com/uk/orc/bin/9780199284986/01student/cqs/

http://www.uk.sagepub.com/breakwell/mcq.htm

Question # 1

The following journal article would be an example of_____research; "The benefits of florescent lighting on production in a factory setting."

Select correct option:

Applied

Interview

Basic

Stupid

Question # 2

Which of the following is a concept?Select correct option:

Leadership.

Total Quality Management.

Human Resource Management.

All of the given options

Question # 3

After you locate a source, you should write down all details of the reference, except;

Select correct option:

Full names of the authors

Titles

Volumes

Price

Question # 4

The scientific method is preferred over other ways of knowing because it is more;

Select correct option:

Reliable

Systematic

Accurate

All of the given options

Question # 5

Quantitative researcher's preoccupation with generalization is an attempt to:

Select correct option:

Develop the law like findings of the natural sciences.

Boost their chances of publication.

Enhance the internal validity of their research.

Demonstrate the complex techniques of statistical analysis.

Question # 6

What is the basis of the Scientific Method?

Select correct option:

To test hypotheses in conditions that are condusive to its success.

To formulate a research problem and disprove the hypothesis.

To formulate a research problem, test the hypothesis in carefully controlled conditions that challenge the hypothesis.

To test hypotheses and if they are disproved, they should be abandoned completely.

Reference & Explanation:

http://www.experiment-resources.com/definition-of-the-scientific-method.html

The principles and empirical processes of discovery and demonstration considered characteristic

of or necessary for scientific investigation, generally involving the observation of phenomena, the formulation of a hypothesis concerning the phenomena, experimentation to demonstrate the truth

or falseness of the hypothesis, and a conclusion that validates or modifies the hypothesis.

Question # 7

Which of the following is not a concept?

Leadership

Total Quality Management

Human Resource Management

IQ

Explanation:

Concepts are the building blocks of theory, each of which represents a label given to a common element of the social world. IQ is a measure of the concept of intelligence, it is not a concept in itself.

Question # 8

Which of the following is the best hypothesis statement to address the research question,

"What impact will the new advertising campaign have on use of Brand B?"

The new advertising campaign will impact Brand B usage.

The new advertising campaign will increase Brand B trial.

The new advertising campaign will cause increased Brand B usage at the expense of Brand C.

The new advertising campaign will increase Brand B's market penetration.

Question # 9

Which one of the following is not an assumption of science?

There are reoccurring patterns in the world.

Events happen because of preceding causes.

We can discover solutions to problems of interest.

Theoretical explanations must agree with common sense.

Question # 10

A review that only demonstrates familiarity with an area is rarely published but it often is part of an educational program is which type of review?

Integrative reviews

Theoretical reviews

Self-study reviews

Historical reviews

Reference & Explanation:Page # 26, Lecture # 08

Self-study reviews increase the reader's confidence. A review that only demonstrates familiarity with an area is rarely published but it often is part of an educational program. In addition to giving others confidence in a reviewer's command of field, it has the side benefit of building the reviewer's self confidence.

Question # 11

A literature review requires;

planning

clear writing

good writing

All of the given option

Reference & Explanation:

Page # 29, Lecture # 9

A literature review requires planning and good, clear writing, which requires lot of rewriting. Keep your purposes in mind when you write, and communicate clearly and effectively.

Question # 12

The facts that should be collected to measure a variable, depend upon the

Select correct option:

Conceptual understanding

Dictionary meaning

Operational definition

All of the above

Question # 13

Which of the following is the BEST hypothesis?

Students taking formative quizzes will perform better on chapter exams than students not taking these quizzes.

Taller students will have higher test scores than shorter students.

Students taught in a cooperative group setting should do better than students in a traditional class.

Students using laptops will do well.

Explanation:

The second alternative meets the four criteria; all other alternatives do not.

Question # 14What is an hypothesis?

Select correct option:

A prediction of a relationship between certain variables.

An experiment that tests certain predictions.

An independent variable.

A dependent variable.

Reference:

http://www.uk.sagepub.com/breakwell/downloads/mcq/mcq_04/mcq_04.htm

Question # 15

An operational definition is:

One that bears no relation to the underlying concept.

An abstract, theoretical definition of a concept.

A definition of a concept in terms of specific, empirical measures.

One that refers to opera singers and their work.

Reference & Explanation:

Page # 18, Lecture # 5

Operational definition is also called a working definition stated in terms of specific testing or measurement criteria. The concepts must have empirical referents (i.e. we must be able to count, measure, or in some other way gather thee information through our senses).

Question # 16

What research is?

A lab experiment

A report

A systematic Enquiry

A procedure

Reference & Explanation:

http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_leedy_practical_8/0,9599,1569572-,00.htmlResearch is the systematic process of collecting and analyzing information to increase our

understanding of the phenomenon under study. It is the function of the researcher to contribute to the understanding of the phenomenon and to communicate that understanding to others. This chapter explains what research is and what it is not. Eight characteristics of research are presented. The process of research as a helical cycle is discussed.

Question # 17

If a researcher is studying the effect of using laptops in his classroom to ascertain their merit and worth, he is likely conducting which type of research?

Select correct option:

Basic

Applied

Evaluation

Experimental

Question # 18

In the statement 'an examination of the effects of discretionary behaviour on employee performance' employee performance is the:

Select correct option:

Independent variable

Dependent variable

Extraneous variable

Causal variable

Explanation:

The dependent variable is the variable that we are looking to explain, hence in this case it is employee performance. Discretionary behaviour is the independent variable which is to be manipulated so as to assess its causal relationship with employee behaviour.

Question # 19

The most difficult sources to locate are;

Select correct option:

Dissertations

Policy Reports and Presented Papers

Government Documents

Scholarly Books Reference & Explanation:

Page # 28, Lecture # 9

Policy Reports and Presented Papers. The most difficult sources to locate are policy reports and

presented papers. They are listed in some bibliographies of published studies; some are listed in the

abstracts or indexes.

Question # 20

A concept is a generalized idea about---- .

Select correct option:

A class of objects

Attributes

Occurrences

All of the given options

Reference & Explanation:

Page # 16, Lecture # 5

A concept is a generalized idea about a class of objects, attributes, occurrences, or processes that has been given a name. In other words a concept is an idea expressed as a symbol or in words.

Question # 21

What is the reason for consulting handbooks, yearbooks, encyclopedias, or reviews in the initial stages of identifying a research topic?

Select correct option:

They are readily available.

They provide an overview of the issues related to a topic.

They are primary sources. They avoid reporting statistical data so one can interpret the results more easily.

Explanation:

The sources mentioned in this question are all secondary sources, and secondary sources provide overviews of the topics being investigated.

Question # 22

What is opposite of a variable?

Select correct option:

A constant

An extraneous variable

A dependent variable

A data set

Question # 23

Qualitative and Quantitative Research are the classifications of research on the basis of

Select correct option:

Use of the research

Time dimension

Techniques used

Purpose of the research

Reference & explanation:

Page # 46, lecture # 15

One difference between the two styles involves timing.

Question # 24

The organization of concepts in sequence from the most concrete and individual to the most general indicates is:

Select correct option:

One that bears no relation to the underlying concept.

An abstract, theoretical definition of a concept.The degree of abstraction

An operational definition

Reference & Explanation:

Page # 16, Lecture # 05

The organization of concepts in sequence from the most concrete and individual to the most general indicates the degree of abstraction.

Question # 25

The most critical areas of an article to read is;

Select correct option:

Results section

Introduction

Abstract

Limitations

Question # 26

_____ meanings attached to a concept create problems of measurements.

Select correct option:

Unambiguous

Vague

Clear

Dictionary

Reference & Explanation:

Page # 17, Lecture # 05

Vague meanings attached to a concept create problems of measurement.

Question # 27

Rationalism is the application of:

Select correct option:

Research solution

Logic and arguments

Reasoning

Previous findingsReference & Explanation:

http://books.google.com/books?id=875TTxildJ0C&pg=PA232&lpg=PA232&dq=

%22Rationalism+is+the+application+of

%22&source=bl&ots=W9vyQpV_ie&sig=ionJi1mPwBa-XYwE-

iKjwoKtqlI&hl=en&ei=cMTZS6TLCtOxrAfD5q2jDw&sa=X&oi=book_result&ct=result&resnu
m=2&ved=0CA8Q6AEwAQ#v=onepage&q=%22Rationalism%20is%20the%20application
%20of%22&f=false

Question # 28

Why do you need to review the existing literature?

Select correct option:

To give your dissertation a proper academic appearance, with lots of references

Because without it, you could never reach the required word-count

To find out what is already known about your area of interest

To help in your general studying

Question # 29

The application of the scientific method to the study of business problems is called;

Select correct option:

Inductive reasoning

Deductive reasoning

Business research

Grounded theory

Question # 30

An operational definition is:

Select correct option:

One that bears no relation to the underlying concept.

An abstract, theoretical definition of a concept.

A definition of a concept in terms of specific, empirical measures.

One that refers to opera singers and their work.

Question # 31

Which one of the following creates problems of measurements of a concept?

Select correct option:

Unambiguous meanings

Vague meanings

Clear meanings

Dictionary meanings

Reference & Explanation:

Page # 17, Lecture # 05

Vague meanings attached to a concept create problems of measurement.

Question # 32

Which of the following is a discrete variable?

Select correct option:

Age

Nationality

Test score

Income

Explanation:

A discrete variable is one that cannot take on all values within the limits of the variable. For example, responses to a five-point rating scale can only take on the values 1, 2, 3, 4, and 5. The variable cannot have the value 1.7. A variable such as a person's height can take on any value. Variables that can take on any value and therefore are not discrete are called continuous.

Question # 33

Which of the following is a discrete variable?

Select correct option:

height

age

miles per gallon

number of children

Explanation:

A discrete variable is one that cannot take on all values within the limits of the variable. For example, responses to a five-point rating scale can only take on the values 1, 2, 3, 4, and 5. The variable cannot have the value 1.7. A variable such as a person's height can take on any value. Variables that can take on any value and therefore are not discrete are called continuous.

Question # 34According to Empiricism, which of the following is the ultimate source of all our concepts and knowledge?

Select correct option:

Perceptions

Theory

Sensory experience

Logics and arguments

Reference & Explanation:

http://plato.stanford.edu/entries/rationalism-empiricism/

The dispute between rationalism and empiricism concerns the extent to which we are dependent upon sense experience in our effort to gain knowledge. Rationalists claim that there are significant ways in which our concepts and knowledge are gained independently of sense experience. Empiricists claim that sense experience is the ultimate source of all our concepts and knowledge.

Question # 35

If a researcher was studying the use of various instructional approaches to the "multiple intelligences" of his students, he is likely to be conducting which type of research?

Select correct option:

Basic

Applied

Evaluation

Grounded theory

Explanation:

The theory of multiple intelligences is fairly well established, and this researcher is trying to understand how to use this theory in the classroom. In addition, there is no assessment of merit or worth to suggest this could be evaluation research, nor is there any sense that the researcher is conducting the research to solve a local, isolated problem.

Question # 36

Under which of the following research method is not applicable?

Select correct option:

Health care

Business

Government offices

Imaginary worlds

(MH,vuZs)

Question # 37

Which of the following statements is false?

Select correct option:

Discrete variables allow measurement of an infinite number of fractions of units of measurement.

Discrete variables can only have whole number values.

Continuous numbers can only have whole number values.

Continuous measures do not allow for scores that fall between two number values.

Reference & Explanation:

http://www.uk.sagepub.com/breakwell/downloads/mcq/mcq_03/mcq_03.htm

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Any variable that has a limited number of distinct values and which cannot be divided into fractions, is a discontinuous variable. Such a variable is also called as categorical variable or classificatory variable, or discrete variable. Some variables have only two values, reflecting the presence or absence of a property: employed-unemployed or male-female have two values. These variables are referred to as dichotomous. There are others that can take added categories such as the demographic variables of race, religion. All such variables that produce data that fit into categories are said to be discrete/categorical/classificatory, since only certain values are possible. An automotive variable, for example, where “Chevrolet” is assigned a 5 and “Honda” is assigned a 6, provides no option for a 5.5 (i.e. the values cannot be divided into fractions).

Question # 38

To explain, predict, and/or control phenomena are the goal of----------

Select correct option:

Tradition

Inductive logic

Deductive logic

The scientific method

Question # 39

Which of the following is most beneficial to read in an article?

Select correct option:

MethodsIntroduction

Figures

References

Question # 40

Which of the following is not a function of clearly identified research questions?

Select correct option:

They guide your literature search.

They keep you focused throughout the data collection period.

They make the scope of your research as wide as possible.

They are linked together to help you construct a coherent argument.

Reference & Explanation:

http://www.oup.com/uk/orc/bin/9780199284986/01student/cqs/ch03/?view=Standard

It is important to formulate some clear research questions from the outset of your project, because completely open-ended research can lead to the collection of too much data and a lack of focus for the analysis. If you decide on some fairly specific research questions before designing your project, it will help to guide your literature search, data collection and analysis, as well as form a coherent argument throughout your dissertation

STA630 Research Methods New MCQs from quizzes - Research Methods (VT)

0 Comments

Which of the following refers to the extent that all information collected in a questionnaire addresses a research question that will help the decision maker address the current business problem?

- ► **Accuracy**
- ► **Counter balanced**
- ► **Relevance**
- ► **Frequency**

Reference:
Question Relevancy
A questionnaire is relevant to the extent that all information collected addresses a research question
that will help the decision maker address the current business problem (zh,vuzs,jan11)

After a researcher has stated the specific problem to be studied in an experiment, he must then develop a(n):
Theory
Conclusion
Hypothesis
Summary of the data

What type of the interview that is in which questions are already prepared?

Telephonic interview
Personal interview
Unstructured interview
Structured interview

Which method of sampling is least likely to produce bias?
Opportunity Sampling
Random Sampling
Stratified Sampling
Quasi-random sampling

Which type of question is most likely to be used when the researcher is just starting to explore what people think about a particular topic?
Closed-ended
Open-ended
Structured
Semi structured

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Which method of sampling is least likely to produce bias?
Opportunity Sampling
Random Sampling
Stratified Sampling
Quasi-random sampling

Which of the following is false with regard to the benefits of multiple-choice questions over open-ended questions?
Multiple-choice questions are easier to design
Multiple-choice questions are less costly for coding and data processing
Multiple-choice questions are quicker to administer
The use of multiple-choice questions results in higher cooperation for self-administered surveys

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Which of the following true about the relationship between theory building and data collection?
When studies come out as expected, inductive support for the theory is gained.
If an experiment fails, discarding the experiment is an example of affirming the consequent.
When a hypothesis is not supported, virtually nothing has been learned about the theory.
A good theory will be inclusive enough to explain every possible research outcome.

What is one way that distortions can be produced in self report data?
Lying
Social desirability bias
Faulty memory
All of the given options

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When you are confident that the experimental manipulation produced the changes you measured in the dependent variable,your study probably has good _____ validity.

Construct
Internal
External
Casual
(mh,vuzs)

The scientific method is preferred over other ways of knowing because it is more;

Reliable
Systematic
Accurate
All of the given options

In which of the following Tests, we give extra training to the interviewer in case of big research funded by an organization?

Test Run
Pilot Test
Post Hoc Test
T- Test

If a nominal scale is used, it is permissible to calculate which of the following statistics?

Mean
Range
Percentile
Mode

A one tailed hypothesis predicts----------

The future
The lottery result
The frequency of the effect
The direction of the effect

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Which of the following provides insight into the complexity of using interviews?

Potential influence of gender or cultural differences between interviewer and interviewee
The accuracy of the interviewee's responses
The different semantic meanings of the language being used
Accuracy, influences and language used

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The researcher protects the confidentiality in following ways, Except;

Obtaining signed nondisclosure documents.
Restricting access to data instruments where the respondent is identified.
Disclosure of data subsets.

Restricting access to respondent identification.

Which of the following should not be a consideration in writing a proposal?
Understanding the problem situation
The appearance/form of the proposal
Responding to every element exactly as specified by the client
Knowing as much as possible about the proposal recipients

Under which of the following research method is not applicable?
Health care
Business
Government offices
Imaginary worlds
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Which of the following is a concept?
Leadership.
Total Quality Management.
Human Resource Management.
All of the given options

In which way does a ratio scale measurement differ from an interval measurement?
It measures larger or smaller scores on some underlying dimension.
It implies the existence of an absolute zero value.
It requires the mutual exclusivity of all cases.
It requires that exhaustiveness is applied to all observations.

If a researcher was studying the use of various instructional approaches to the "multiple intelligences" of his students, he is likely to be conducting which type of research?

Basic
Applied
Evaluation
Grounded theory

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An operational definition is:

One that bears no relation to the underlying concept.

An abstract, theoretical definition of a concept.
A definition of a concept in terms of specific, empirical measures.
One that refers to opera singers and their work.

In the statement 'an examination of the effects of discretionary behaviour on employee performance' employee performance is the:

Independent variable
Dependent variable
Extraneous variable
Causal variable
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Quantitative researcher's preoccupation with generalization is an attempt to:
Develop the law like findings of the natural sciences.
Boost their chances of publication.
Enhance the internal validity of their research.
Demonstrate the complex techniques of statistical analysis.

Which one of the following tasks is NOT accomplished by theoretical framework?
Elaborate the relationship among the variables
Explain the logic underlying the relationship between the variables.
Describe the nature, and direction of the relationships among the variables.
Relates the previous studies.

What is required if there is a chance that data could harm the respondents?
Change of results
A signed form detailing the types of limits
Free consent of respondents
All of the given options

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Which of the following is not an example of deception?
A part of the truth is not communicated to the respondent
To observe code of ethics
To leak out information regarding any confidential matter
To create bias between respondents before the survey

Which of the the following is not included in Objects?

Tables
People
Books
Weight

The extent to which we can generalize the results of a study to other participants is called:
Sampling validity
External validity
Construct validity
Internal validity

If a nominal scale is used, it is permissible to calculate which of the following statistics?

Mean
Range
Percentile
Mode

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All of the following are true about theories, except;

They organize and summarize existing knowledge about a topic.
They are tentative until the facts prove them true.
They provide possible explanations for the phenomenon under study.
They lead to testable hypotheses through the process of deduction.
(MH,vuZs)

Research questions are crucial because they will:

Guide your decisions about what data to collect and from where.
Help you decide which research area interests you.
Ensure that your findings have external validity.
Prevent you from thinking about research strategies.

What is the basis of the Scientific Method?

To test hypotheses in conditions that are condusive to its success.
To formulate a research problem and disprove the hypothesis.
To formulate a research problem, test the hypothesis in carefully controlled conditions that challenge the hypothesis.
To test hypotheses and if they are disproved, they should be abandoned completely.

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Procedures determining what two issues are rarely used in quantitative research?

Objectivity and subjectivity
Reliability and validity
Accessibility and replicability
Quality and quantity

Ms. Laiba has decided to use the test at the end of the textbook to measure the achievement levels of the students in her study. Which of the following BEST describes the chapter test?

Definition
Construct
Variable
Operationalized variable
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0 Comments

STA630-Solved MCQ's

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1. Endeavors to explain, predict, and/or control phenomena are the goal of

a) tradition.
b) inductive logic.
c) deductive logic.
d) the scientific method.

2. Ms. Casillas has been coordinating the Halloween Festival at her school for the last several years. She wants to be sure the students and parents enjoy the festival again this year. On which source is she LEAST likely to rely when making decisions about what to do?

a) Tradition
b) Personal experience
c) Research
d) Expert opinion

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3. Ms. Turner is thinking about changing her instructional approach to a more mastery-learning orientation. She is interested in knowing more about this topic as well as its effectiveness when working with elementary school students. On which source should she rely for such information?

a) Tradition
b) Research

c) Intuition
d) Personal experience

4. The scientific method is preferred over other ways of knowing because it is more

a) reliable.
b) systematic.
c) accurate.
d) all of these.

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5. The application of the scientific method to the study of educational problems is called

a) inductive reasoning.
b) deductive reasoning.
c) educational research.
d) grounded theor

6. Which of the following statements characterizes educational research?

a) It furthers our understanding of educational issues, questions, or problems.
b) It raises new topics for study.
c) It provides information that can improve teaching and learning.
d) All of these.

7. Which of the following steps of the scientific method is exemplified by the researcher reviewing the literature and focusing on a specific problem that has yet to be resolved?

a) Identify a topic.
b) Describe the procedures to collect information.
c) Analyze the collected information.
d) State the results of the data analysis.

8. If a researcher (1) identified a topic and a specific educational problem related to it, (2) carefully described the ways by which data was collected and analyzed, and (3) wrote a report reflecting on this work and its contribution to what is known about the topic, her work can BEST be described as

a) educational research.
b) quantitative research.
c) qualitative research.
d) evaluation.

9. Which of the following is a limitation of educational research?
a) Research cannot answer value-based problems.
b) Researchers have ethical and legal responsibilities that can constrain their work.
c) It is difficult to fully describe the depth of participants' perspectives given the complexity of human behavior.
d) All of these.

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10. What is the reason for consulting handbooks, yearbooks, encyclopedias, or reviews in the initial stages of identifying a research topic?

a) They are readily available.
b) They provide an overview of the issues related to a topic.
c) They are primary sources.
d) They avoid reporting statistical data so one can interpret the results more easily.

11. Which of the following is NOT a characteristic of a good research topic?

a) It is ethical.
b) It can be investigated through the collection and analysis of data.
c) It focuses on a philosophical or ethical issue.
d) It is theoretically or practically significant.

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12. Which of the following is NOT a legitimate research problem as stated?

a) What is the relationship between the number of books children read and their reading scores?
b) Should competitive games be banned from elementary schools?
c) What does it mean to be a special needs child "included" in Ms. Pierre's fourth grade class?
d) What are the major legal principles applied to educational cases decided by the U.S. Supreme Court?

13. Which of the following is the least appropriate research problem?

a) Does studying Latin improve the standardized vocabulary test scores of seventh grade students?
b) Does drilling fifth grade students with multiplication facts improve their standardized test scores?
c) What is the relationship between students' math attitudes and math achievement?
d) Should students have access to controversial novels in school?

Key: 1-d; 2-c; 3-b; 4-d; 5-c; 6-d; 7-a; 8-a; 9-d; 10-b; 11-c; 12-b; 13-d

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STA630 MCQ's solved by vuZs Team Mehreen Humayun

0 Comments

Research Methods –STA630
Lesson 1-25
MCQ's Solved by vuZs Team
Mehreen Humayun
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Ms. Roshi has been coordinating the Annual Festival at her school for the last several years. She wants to be sure the students and parents enjoy the festival again this year. On which source is she LEAST likely to rely when making decisions about what to do?

Tradition
Personal experience
Research
Expert opinion

Ref: It is likely that traditions, personal experiences, and expert opinions have served Ms. Casillas well in the past and will continue to do so in the future. The limitations associated with these sources of knowledge are not going to jeopardize the success of the festival. Given this situation, research is far too cumbersome.

"Skepticism" is a norm of science. It is better explained by which of the following statement?

Combining the previous knowledge
Critical reading of the previous researches
Providing the proper references of qouted text
Locating research reports in libraries

Lesson 9

Skepticism is the norm of science. It means that you should not accept what is written simply on the basis of authority of its having been published. Question what you read, and evaluate it.

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Which of the following provides a solid basis foundation for the theoretical framework?

Survey
Literature Review
Experiment
Referencing
Lesson 8
Helps in developing theoretical framework.

In _____definition, a concept is explained in terms of other concepts.

Operational definition
Working definition
Theoretical definition
None of the given options

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"The extensive use of chocolate causes pimples". The given hypothesis is a (an):
Select correct option:

Descriptive hypothesis
Explanatory hypothesis
Non-Directional hypothesis
Co-relational hypothesis
Lesson 7
Explanatory (causal) hypotheses: Imply the existence of, or a change in, one variable causes or leads to a change in the other variable.

Which of following statement is true?

Theory and Research are dichotomous
Theory and Research are interrelated
There is no difference between Theory and Research
None of the given statements is true
Lesson 4
Theory and Research: the Dynamic Duo: Theory and research are interrelated; the dichotomy between theory and research is an artificial.

What type of the interview that is in which questions are already prepared?

Telephonic interview
Personal interview
Unstructured interview
Structured interview

Ref: Structured interview: Sometimes referred to as a patterned interview, the structured interview is very straightforward. The interviewer has a standard set of questions that are asked of all candidates.

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Mr. Haris is interested in studying the shared beliefs and practices of the teachers in a small rural school. He is likely to use which research design?

Action research
Historical research
Ethnography
Grounded theory
Lesson 38
Ethnography comes from cultural anthropology. Ethno means people or a folk distinct by their culture and graphs refers to describing something. Thus ethnography means describing a culture and understanding another way of life from the native point of view. It is just an understanding the culture of people from their own perspective.

To what extent our results can be accurately generalized to other participants, situations, and times?

What is ordinal data?

Ordinary data
Well behaved data
Ranked data
Numbers
Ref: Ordinal data are categorical data where there is a logical ordering to the categories.

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The independent variable is;

The variable manipulated in order to observe its effects
The variable that is measured
The free spirited variable
A confounding variable
Lesson 06
Independent variable:
Presumed cause presumed effect
Stimulus
Predicted from …
Antecedent
Manipulated
Predictor

Preliminary Data Collection may be considered as part of ---------- --.

Descriptive research
Explananory research
Exploratory research
All of the given options
Lesson 12
Preliminary Data Collection: This step may be considered as part of the exploratory research.

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Cover letter must include the following information, except:

Select correct option:

How was the respondent selected?
Data collecting tools
Motivation for the respondent
Importance of research topic which is going to be conducted
Lesson 21
Cover Letter: The cover letter that accompanies the questionnaire or is printed on the first page of the questionnaire is an important means of inducing a reader to complete and return the questionnaire. In the letter tell why the study is important, who is sponsoring the study, how was the respondent selected, assuring the anonymity of the respondent could help in establishing rapport and motivating the respondent to respond.

Descriptive and Explanatory Research are the classifications of research on the basis of:

Use of the research
Time dimension
Techniques used
Purpose of the research
Lesson 3
Descriptive research presents a picture of the specific details of a situation, social setting, or relationship. The major purpose of descriptive research, as the term implies, is to describe characteristics of a population or phenomenon.

Explanatory Research: When we encounter an issue that is already known and have a description of it, we might begin to wonder why things are the way they are. The desire to know “why,” to explain, is the purpose of explanatory research.

Basic and Applied Research are the classifications of research on the basis of:

Use of the research
Time dimension
Techniques used
Purpose of the research

Lesson 3
Basic Research: Basic research advances fundamental knowledge about the human world. It focuses on refuting or supporting theories that explain how this world operates, what makes things happen, why social relations are a certain way, and why society changes.
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Applied Research: Applied researchers try to solve specific policy problems or help practitioners accomplish tasks.

What is a cross-sectional research?

A study of one particular section of society
A comparison of two or more variables over a long period of time
The collection of data from more than one case at one moment in time
One that is conducted when environment is uncertain
Lesson 3
Cross-Sectional Research: In cross-sectional research, researchers observe at one point in time.

Before a researcher specified the relationship among variables, he must have a (an):

Inventory of variables
Inventory of propositions
Arrangement of propositions
Schematic diagram

According to scientific method, which of the following is Not an empirical reality?

Emotions
God's reward for good deeds
Satisfaction
None of the given options
Ref: The empirical reality is the reality that can be deduced from repeatable observations of the senses.

Which of the following best describes qualitative data coding?

Numerically representing the concepts identified by the participants
Identify data segments that contain general episodes
Adding all of the scores together and describing them statistically
Dividing data in parts that represent single thoughts

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“High productivity is positively associated with Job commitment”. The given hypothesis is a (an):
Descriptive hypothesis
Explanatory hypothesis
Non-Directional hypothesis
Co-relational hypothesis
Lesson 7
Correlational hypotheses: State merely that the variables occur together in some specified manner without implying that one causes the other. Such weak claims are often made when we believe that there are more basic causal forces that affect both variables. For example:
Level of job commitment of the officers is positively associated with their level of efficiency.

The logic of purposive sampling is:

That a random sample can generalize to a population.
That a few information-rich participants studied in depth yield many insights about a topic.
To include all participants, even though they are not all relevant to the problem.
To use participants because the researcher has access to them.

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Shared By Fawad

http://groups.google.com/group/vuZs

What is a 'grand theory'?

a) One that was proposed by one of the major theorists in the sociological tradition
b) One that is highly abstract and makes broad generalizations about the social world
c) An intermediate level explanation of observed regularities
d) A particularly satisfactory theory that makes the researcher feel happy

What does an empiricist believe?

a) We should not apply natural science methods to social science research
b) It is the sociologist's aim to understand the meaning of social action
c) Knowledge, in the form of 'facts', should be gained through sensory experience
d) Research conducted within the British empire was biased and unreliable

An inductive theory is one that:

a) Involves testing an explicitly defined hypothesis
b) Does not allow for findings to feed back into the stock of knowledge
c) Uses quantitative methods whenever possible
d) Allows theory to emerge out of the data

What is the epistemological position held by a positivist?

a) There is no substitute for an in-depth, hermeneutic understanding of society
b) Scientific research should be based on value-free, empirical observations
c) Events and discourses in the social world prevent us from having direct knowledge of the natural order
d) It is important to remain optimistic about our research, even when things go wrong

The interpretivist view of the social sciences is that:

a) Their subject matter is fundamentally different to that of the natural sciences
b) We should aim to achieve the interpretive understanding of social action
c) It is important to study the way people make sense of their everyday worlds
d) All of the above

Which of the following is an ontological question?

a) Should I use questionnaires or interviews in my project?
b) What can (and should) be considered acceptable forms of knowledge?
c) How long is it since I last visited the dentist?
d) Do social entities have an objective reality, external to social actors?

The constructionist ontological position suggests that:

a) Social phenomena and their meanings are constantly being accomplished by social actors
b) Individuals are born into a world of rules and structures that they cannot change
c) Building and construction work presents an ideal opportunity to exercise the sociological imagination
d) Social facts and objects have an external reality, independently of the people who perceive them

The qualitative research strategy places a value on:

a) Using numbers, measurements and statistical techniques
b) Generating theories through inductive research about social meanings
c) Conducting research that is of a very high quality
d) All of the above

Which of the following is an example of value-free research?

a) Conscious partiality
b) Sympathy for the underdog
c) Unstructured interviewing
d) None of the above

An important practical issue to consider when designing a research project is:

a) Which theoretical perspective you find most interesting
b) Whether or not you have time to retile the bathroom first
c) How much time and money you have to conduct the research
d) Which colour of ring binder to present your work in

Why do you need to review the existing literature?

a) To make sure you have a long list of references
b) Because without it, you could never reach the required word-count
c) To find out what is already known about your area of interest
d) To help in your general studying

To read critically means:

a) Taking an opposing point of view to the ideas and opinions expressed
b) Skimming through the material because most of it is just padding
c) Evaluating what you read in terms of your own research questions
d) Being negative about something before you read it

Which two of the following are legitimate frameworks for setting out a literature review: 1. Constructing inter-textual coherence, 2. Deconstruction of textual coherence, 3. Problematizing the situation, 4. Resolving discovered problems?

a) 1 and 2
b) 2 and 3
c) 1 and 3
d) 2 and 4

http://groups.google.com/group/vuZs

A systematic literature review is:

a) One which starts in your own library, then goes to on-line databases and, finally, to the internet
b) A replicable, scientific and transparent process
c) One which gives equal attention to the principal contributors to the area
d) A responsible, professional process of time-management for research

What is meta-analysis?

a) A technique of correcting for the errors in individual studies within a survey of a large number of studies, to demonstrate the effect of a particular variable
b) A process of secondary-data gathering to assemble all the possibilities for a variable's effects
c) A substitute for original research, which is justified by constraints of time or money
d) A specialized step in a computer software program (SPSS e.g.)

What is meta-ethnography?

a) A technique for reviewing literature based exclusively on ethnographic studies
b) A technique for synthesizing interpretations drawn from a number of separate qualitative studies of the same phenomena
c) A process used to make generalizations from a range of qualitative studies
d) A process of surveying only that literature contained within a single library

What is a narrative literature review?

a) An historically-based review, starting with the earliest contributions to the field

b) A review based exclusively on stories about companies, in book and case-study form

c) A paraphrase style of reviewing which does not require referencing

d) An initial impression of the topic which you will understand more fully as you conduct your research

When accessing the internet, which of these steps is the most essential?

a) Recording the full URL
b) Noting the access dates
c) Downloading material to be referenced
d) They are all equally important

According to the Harvard referencing convention, which is the correct reference?

a) Bryman, A. (2008, 3e) *Social Research Methods,* Oxford; Oxford University Press
b) Bryman (2008, second edition), Oxford University Press
c) Bryman, Alan, *Social Research Methods* (2008: OUP)
d) Bryman, A. Social Research Methods (2008)

Which of the following statements about plagiarism is most accurate?

a) It is so easy to "copy and paste" from the internet that everyone does it nowadays. If a proper reference is given, where is the harm in that?
b) How can we say for sure where our own ideas come from exactly? If we tried to give a reference for everything we could never hope to succeed.
c) Any suggestion that we have written what another actually wrote is morally wrong. Anyway, the whole point of a literature review is to show what we have read and what we thought about it.
d) Plagiarism is such an awful crime that those found guilty should be obliged to wear a scarlet "P" on their clothing

What is a research design?

a) A way of conducting research that is not grounded in theory
b) The choice between using qualitative or quantitative methods
c) The style in which you present your research findings, e.g. a graph
d) A framework for every stage of the collection and analysis of data

If a study is "reliable", this means that:

a) It was conducted by a reputable researcher who can be trusted
b) The measures devised for concepts are stable on different occasions
c) The findings can be generalized to other social settings
d) The methods are stated clearly enough for the research to be replicated

"Internal validity" refers to:

a) Whether or not there is really a causal relationship between two variables
b) Whether or not the findings are relevant to the participants' everyday lives
c) The degree to which the researcher feels that this was a worthwhile project
d) How accurately the measurements represent underlying concepts

Lincoln & Guba (1985) propose that an alternative criterion for evaluating qualitative research would be:

a) Impressiveness
b) Trustworthiness
c) Joyfulness
d) Messiness

Naturalism has been defined as:

a) Viewing natural and social objects as belonging to the same realm
b) Being true to the nature of the phenomenon under investigation
c) Minimising the intrusion of artificial methods of data collection into the field
d) All of the above

In an experimental design, the dependent variable is:

a) The one that is not manipulated and in which any changes are observed
b) The one that is manipulated in order to observe any effects on the other
c) A measure of the extent to which personal values affect research
d) An ambiguous concept whose meaning depends on how it is defined

http://groups.google.com/group/vuZs

What is a cross-sectional design?

a) A study of one particular section of society, e.g. the middle classes
b) One that is devised when the researcher is in a bad mood
c) The collection of data from more than one case at one moment in time
d) A comparison of two or more variables over a long period of time

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1. Dalessha developed a pure model of the "street walker" prostitute to help her study a lare city hetto. She is usin a(n):

a. Parsimony
b. Ideal Type **
c. Metaphor
d. Jaron

2. Dr. Smith said that social science cannot be value neutral, and a ood study requires puttin results into action to help peoplechane society. Dr. Smith uses which approach to social science?

a. Positivism
b. Interpretative Social Science
c. Critical Social Science **
d. None of the above

3. Henry Hoson conducted an experiment in which he tested the theory that the intensity of social interaction amon people increases if they are anxious. What type of study is this most likely to be?

a. Cost Benefit Analysis
b. Explanatory Research **
c. Content Analysis
d. Exploratory Research

4. For the positivist approach to research, a theory looks like:

a. A series of positive statements about the world.
b. A loical system of laws, axioms, and propositions. **

c. A critique which claims that people are bein mislead.
d. A political proram of action and social chane.

5. In exploratory research one does all of the followin, EXCEPT:
   a. Become familiar with the basic facts, people and concerns involved.
   b. enerate many ideas and develop tentative hypotheses.
   c. Determine the feasibility of doin additional research.
   d. Test a theory or explanation. **

6. Professor Tun-jen Chen wanted to study the cause for thousands of people from Hon Kon movin to Vancouver, British Columbia. In order to establish temporal order in his causal arument he must show which of the followin:

   a. There is a correlation between events in Hon Kon and a decision to move.
   b. Events occurred in Hon Kon before people moved to Vancouver.
   c. A fear for the future of Hon Kon and no other reason caused the move to Vancouver.

   d. **All of the above.** **

7. Social research methods include all of the followin, except:
   a. Surveys
   b. Therapy **
   c. Experiments
   d. Interviews

8. A local human service oranization contacted Mr. Tanaka. The oranization asked him to conduct a study to identify the difficulties and problems of the elderly in the local community so that the oranization could develop social prorams to help them. What type of study would this be?
   a. Needs assessment *
   b. Cost-benefit analysis
   c. Plannin, Prorammin and Budetin System
   d. Summative Evaluation Research

9. Which best summarizes the main oal of descriptive research?
   a. Advance knowlede about an underlyin process or complete a theory.
   b. Develop a detailed picture of a situation or issue. **
   c. Extend a theory or principle into new areas or issues.
   d. Provide evidence to support or refute an explanation.

research method in which subjects respond to a series of items in a questionnaire:
   a. random sample.
   b. taret roup.
   c. experiment.
   d. Survey. **

11. Elizabeth Bethouse conducted a study of amblin establishments operated by American Indian roups. She examined two establishments operated by different tribes. Durin the study she spent many hours at each establishment and ained a detailedknowlede of the tribal leaders, amblin employees and amblin customers. She also investiated how the establishments wereoranized, their impact on economic development in the area and how tribal members saw them. She conducted:
   a. a case study **
   b. a summative evaluation study
   c. a cohort study
   d. action research

12. What is the purpose of basic social research or basic socioloy?
    a. Solve social problems and find which policies are best.
    b. Improve social prorams so they become more effective.
    c. Invent new taxonomies and jaron.
    d. Create fundamental knowlede about how the social world works. **

13. Which approach says that the purpose of research is to study the creation of social meanin?
    a. Positivism
    b. Interpretative Social Science **
    c. Critical Social Science
    d. None of the above

14. Social research methods are:
    a. Ways to ather information to answer a question about the social world. **
    b. Ways to convince people to participate in a study.
    c. Ways to manipulate people.
    d. Ways to increase the number of friends you have.

15. Which of the followin is not an example of a qualitative research method:
    a. Ethnoraphy
    b. Time series**
    c. Covert Observation
    d. Informal or Personal Interviews

16. A friend makes the followin comment: “Persons who rew up with a much older siblin tend to treat the older siblin as a parentfiure.” She is makin a:
    a. Verstehen
    b. Theory
    c. Relativism
    d. eneralization **

17. Joe Foss studied ender differences in attitudes toward mathematics and science amon 45 first rade students. Over the next twelve years he studied the same 45 children when they were in the fifth, eihth and twelfth rades. This is what type of research?
    a. Case study research
    b. Cross-sectional research (a study on a cross-sectional sample)
    c. Panel study research (a study on a panel sample) **
    d. Action-oriented research

18. A research method in which a researcher asks study participants several conversational style questions and does not provide a set of responses to choose from:
    a. case study
    b. interview **
    c. comparative method
    d. quantitative study

19. All of the followin characterize applied socioloical research except which one?
    a. Doin research is usually part of a job assinment and sponsors/supervisors who are not professional researchers willjude/use the results.

    b. Success is based on whether sponsors/supervisors use the results in decision-makin.

    c. The primary concern is with the internal loic and rior of the research desin, so a researcher attempts to reach the absolute norms of scientific rior and scholarship. **

    d. Research projects are limited by the demands and interests of

employers or sponsors.

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Chapter 7

Multiple Choice Questions

1. When each member of a population has an equally likely chance of being selected, this is called:

a. A nonrandom sampling method

b. A quota sample

c. A snowball sample

d. An Equal probability selection method

2. Which of the following techniques yields a simple random sample?

a. Choosing volunteers from an introductory psychology class to participate

b. Listing the individuals by ethnic group and choosing a proportion from within each ethnic group at random.

c. Numbering all the elements of a sampling frame and then using a random number table to pick cases from the table.

d. Randomly selecting schools, and then sampling everyone within the school.

3. Which of the following is not true about stratified random sampling?

a. It involves a random selection process from identified subgroups

b. Proportions of groups in the sample must always match their population proportions

c. Disproportional stratified random sampling is especially helpful for getting large enough subgroup samples when subgroup comparisons are to be done

d. Proportional stratified random sampling yields a representative sample

4. Which of the following statements are true?

a. The larger the sample size, the greater the sampling error

b. The more categories or breakdowns you want to make in your data analysis, the larger the sample needed

c. The fewer categories or breakdowns you want to make in your data analysis, the larger the sample needed

d. As sample size decreases, so does the size of the confidence interval

5. Which of the following formulae is used to determine how many people to include in the original sampling?

a. Desired sample size/Desired sample size + 1

b. Proportion likely to respond/desired sample size

c. Proportion likely to respond/population size

d. Desired sample size/Proportion likely to respond

6. Which of the following sampling techniques is an equal probability selection method (i.e., EPSEM) in which every individual in the population has an equal chance of being selected?

a. Simple random sampling

b. Systematic sampling

c. Proportional stratified sampling

d. Cluster sampling using the PPS technique

e. All of the above are EPSEM

7. Which of the following is not a form of nonrandom sampling?

a. Snowball sampling

b. Convenience sampling

c. Quota sampling

d. Purposive sampling

e. They are all forms of nonrandom sampling

8. Which of the following will give a more “accurate” representation of the population from which a sample has been taken?

a. A large sample based on the convenience sampling technique

b. A small sample based on simple random sampling

c. A large sample based on simple random sampling

d. A small cluster sample

9. Sampling in qualitative research is similar to which type of sampling in quantitative research?

a. Simple random sampling

b. Systematic sampling

c. Quota sampling

d. Purposive sampling

10. Which of the following would generally require the largest sample size?

a. Cluster sampling

b. Simple random sampling

c. Systematic sampling

d. Proportional stratified sampling

11. How often does the Census Bureau take a complete population count?

a. Every year

b. Every five years

c. Every ten years

d. Twice a year

2. People who are available, volunteer, or can be easily recruited are used in the sampling method called _____.

a. Simple random sampling

b. Cluster sampling

c. Systematic sampling

d. Convenience sampling

13. Which of the following types of sampling involves the researcher determining the appropriate sample sizes for the groups identified as important, and then taking convenience samples from those groups?

a. Proportional stratified sampling

b. Quota sampling

c. One-stage cluster sampling

d. Two-stage cluster sampling

14. A type of sampling used in qualitative research that involves selecting cases that disconfirm the researcher's expectations and generalizations is referred to as_____.

a. Extreme case sampling

b. Typical-case sampling

c. Critical-case sampling

d. Negative-case sampling

15. Using Figure 6.6 (pg. 178), how many participants will you need for a research study with a population of 120,000?

a. 242

b. 331

c. 377

d. 384

16. In which of the following nonrandom sampling techniques does the researcher ask the research participants to identify other potential research participants?

a. Snowball

b. Convenience

c. Purposive

d. Quota

17. Which of the following is the most efficient random sampling technique discussed in your chapter?

a. Simple random sampling

b. Proportional stratified sampling

c. Cluster random sampling

d. Systematic sampling

18. If we took the 500 people attending a school in New York City, divided them by gender, and then took a random sample of the males and a random sampling of the females, the variable on which we would divide the population is called the _____.

a. Independent variable

b. Dependent variable

c. Stratification variable

d. Sampling variable

19. A number calculated with complete population data and quantifies a characteristic of the population is called which of the following?

a. A datum

b. A statistic

c. A parameter

d. A population

20. The type of sampling in which each member of the population selected for the sample is returned to the population before the next member is selected is called_____.

a. Sampling without replacement

b. Sampling with replacement

c. Simple random sampling

d. Systematic sampling

21. Which of the following is not a type of nonrandom sampling?

a. Cluster sampling

b. Convenience sampling

c. Quota sampling

d. Purposive sampling

e. They are all type of nonrandom sampling

22. Which of the following would usually require the smallest sample size because of its efficiency?

a. One stage cluster sampling

b. Simple random sampling

c. Two stage cluster sampling

d. Quota sampling

23. A technique used when selecting clusters of different sizes is called _____.

a. Cluster sampling

b. One-stage sampling

c. Two-stage sampling

d. Probability proportional to size or PPS

24. The process of drawing a sample from a population is known as _____.

a. Sampling

b. Census

c. Survey research

d. None of the above

25. It is recommended to use the whole population rather than a sample when the population size is of what size?

a. 500 or less

b. 100 or less

c. 1000 or less

d. you should always use a sample

26. Which of the following is not an example of a nonrandom sampling technique?

a. Purposive

b. Quota

c. Convenience

d. Cluster

27. Which of the following sampling methods is the best way to select a group of people for a study if you are interested in making statements about the larger population?

a. Convenience sampling

b. Quota sampling

c. Purposive sampling

d. Random sampling

28. _____is a set of elements taken from a larger population according to certain rules.

a. Sample

b. Population

c. Statistic

d. Element

29. Determining the sample interval (represented by k), randomly selecting a number between 1 and k, and including each kth element in your sample are the steps for which form of sampling?

a. Simple Random Sampling

b. Stratified Random Sampling

c. Systematic Sampling

d. Cluster sampling

30. The nonrandom sampling type that involves selecting a convenience sample from a population with a specific set of characteristics for your research study is called _____.

a. Convenience sampling

b. Quota sampling

c. Purposive sampling

d. Snowball sampling

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Which of the following is NOT a longitudinal study?
Select correct option:

Trend study
Census study
Panel study
Cohort study

The extent to which we can generalize the results of a study to other participants is called:
Select correct option:

Sampling validity
External validity
Construct validity
Internal validity

Under which of the following research method is not applicable?
Select correct option:

Health care
Business
Government offices
Imaginary worlds

Rationalism is the application of:
Select correct option:

Research solution
Logic and arguments
Reasoning
Previous findings

Which of the following means that all the items in a scale or index fit together or measure a single construct?

Scale (NOT SURE)
Index
Unidimensionality
Weighting

The purpose of a literature review is to:

Help you find out what is already known about this area.
Identify any inconsistencies or gaps in the literature.
Demonstrate an awareness of the theoretical context in which the current study can be located.
Find what is already known, identify gaps demonstrate awareness.

If a measure is consistent over multiple occasions, it has:

Inter-rater reliability
Construct validity
Internal validity
Test-retest reliability

Which of the following is not a feature of theoretical framework?

Making an inventory of variables
Specify the direction of relationship
Presenting findings
Making an inventory of propositions

Quantitative data is?

Expressed in numerical form
Concerned with how things are expressed
Big data
Small data

Which of the following concerns is MOST likely to become a problem if Mr. Baber uses purposive sampling techniques?

Generalizability from the sample to the population.(MH,vuZs)
Statistically equal groups.
Subjects participating in the study.
Selection of participants who are thought to be informative, articulate, and experienced with the research topic and setting.

Generalizability is the foremost concern when using non-random sampling techniques, of which purposive sampling is one.

What is a relationship between the literature survey and the theoretical framework?

Provides a solid foundation for developing the latter
Literature survey helps in the identification of the relevant variables
The theoretical framework explains the theory underlying these relations
All of the gven options

Which of the following is NOT characteristic of qualitative data?

Thick, rich descriptions
Unorganized
Voluminous
Concise and succinct

Ref: http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_airasian_edresearch_8/0,11083,2527149-content,00.utf8.html

Setting quotas for hard-to-reach respondents is one way to minimize_____bias.
Select correct option:

Interviewer
Respondent
Instrument
Sampling (not sure)

The key objective of data analysis is to:

Calculate statistics
Understand relationships between variables
Obtain the distribution of responses for each question
Create tables which display the survey results

What is the basis of the Scientific Method?

To test hypotheses in conditions that are condusive to its success.
To formulate a research problem and disprove the hypothesis.
To formulate a research problem, test the hypothesis in carefully controlled conditions that challenge the hypothesis.
To test hypotheses and if they are disproved, they should be abandoned completely.

The number of people who complete a survey in relation to the number of people contacted to participate is called the:
Select correct option:

Response set
Response rate
Response bias
Respondents

Which of the following is not something a researcher will have to consider when thinking about their sample size?

Time and cost.
Non-response.
Length of questionnaire.
Heterogeneity of population.

How is nominal data presented?

In order
In discrete categories
Units of equal distance
Data where there is a true zero

Which of the following is NOT a legitimate research problem as stated?
Select correct option:

What is the relationship between the number of books children read and their reading scores?
Should competitive games be banned from elementary schools?
What does it mean to be a special needs child "included" in Ms. Amara's fourth grade class?
What are the major legal principles applied to educational cases decided by the Supreme Court?

Which of the following is most beneficial to read in an article?
Select correct option:

Methods
Introduction
Figures
References

Which of the following is an example of an issue that would be checked in a pilot testing?

Completion of all questions on a questionnaire

Legible writing
Single responses to all multiple choice questions
Logical answers between questions (i.e., attributes should be rated high if purchase interest is high)

Which of the following describes the nature of qualitative data interpretation?
Select correct option:
Reflection
Integrative
Explanatory
Reflection, integrity, explanation

What is required if there is a chance that data could harm the respondents?
Select correct option:
Change of results
A signed form detailing the types of limits
Free consent of respondents
All of the given options

Which type of sampling strategy is exemplified by selecting two types of individuals: those who are extremely happy and those who are extremely sad?
Select correct option:
Snowball
Intensity
Homogeneous
Purposive

If a nominal scale is used, it is permissible to calculate which of the following statistics?
Select correct option:
Mean
Range
Percentile
Mode

The researcher protects the confidentiality in following ways, Except;

Obtaining signed nondisclosure documents.

Restricting access to data instruments where the respondent is identified.
Disclosure of data subsets.
Restricting access to respondent identification.

When accessing the internet, which of these steps is the most essential?

Recording the full URL
Noting the access dates
Downloading material to be referenced
They are all equally important

Rationalism is the application of:

Research solution
Logic and arguments
Reasoning
Previous findings

If an interview is conducted with a respondent who does not meet the qualifications for a study, what kind of bias has occurred?
Select correct option:
Respondent bias
Position bias
Non-response bias
Instrument bias

What is the reason for consulting handbooks, yearbooks, encyclopedias, or reviews in the initial stages of identifying a research topic?

They are readily available.
They provide an overview of the issues related to a topic.
They are primary sources.
They avoid reporting statistical data so one can interpret the results more easily.

What does Ordinal scale NOT imply?

Characteristics of nominal scale
Rank the object
Does not provide magnitude of object
Provide rate

Which of the following is the BEST hypothesis?

Students taking formative quizzes will perform better on chapter exams than students not taking these quizzes.
Taller students will have higher test scores than shorter students.

Students taught in a cooperative group setting should do better than students in a traditional class.
Students using laptops will do well.

Quantitative social researchers rarely claim to have established causality because:

They are more concerned with publishing the results of their reliability tests.
They do not believe that this is an appropriate goal to be striving for.
They keep forgetting which of the variables they have manipulated.
They tend to use cross-sectional designs, which produce only correlations.

An advantage of computer-assisted telephone interviewing is:

Interviewing time is reduced
Data quality is enhanced
Questionnaires do not have to be coded
There is little opportunity for interviewer bias

In which of the following sampling methods People are available such as volunteer or can be easily recruited?

Simple random sampling
Cluster sampling
Systematic sampling
Convenience sampling (MH,vuZs)

What type of the interview that is in which questions are already prepared?
Select correct option:
Telephonic interview
Personal interview
Unstructured interview
Structured interview

The facts that should be collected to measure a variable, depend upon the
Select correct option:
Conceptual understanding
Dictionary meaning
Operational definition
All of the above

When you are confident that the experimental manipulation produced the changes you measured in the dependent variable, your study probably has good_____validity.
Select correct option:
Construct
Internal

External
Causal

Which of the following can be referred as a Reputational sampling?
Select correct option:
Purposive Sampling
Quota Sampling
Convenience Sampling
Snowball Sampling

Which of the following is a research method that allows a researcher to get information about a large number of subjects relatively inexpensively and easily?

Naturalistic observation
Case study
Laboratory observation
Survey

What does it mean if two variables have a positive correlation?

As one variable increases, so does the other
As one variable increases, the other decreases
The correlation between the two variables is 0
The correlation between the two variables is greater than 1.0

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1. The first step in the marketing planning process is to:
- **a.** Select the target market(s)

b. Define the marketing objectives
c. Specify each element of the marketing mix
d. **Assess the environmental opportunities and constraints**
e. Develop an implementation plan

2. Which of the following is the best hypothesis statement to address the research question, "What impact will the new advertising campaign have on use of Brand B?"
a. **The new advertising campaign will increase Brand B usage.**
b. The new advertising campaign will impact Brand B usage.
c. The new advertising campaign will increase Brand B trial.
d. The new advertising campaign will cause increased Brand B usage at the expense of Brand C.
e. The new advertising campaign will increase Brand B's market penetration.

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3. Which of the following should not be a consideration in writing a proposal?
a. Understanding the purpose behind the request for proposal
b. Understanding the problem situation
c. The appearance/form of the proposal
d. **Responding to every element exactly as specified by the client**
e. Knowing as much as possible about the proposal recipients

4. A_____scale only assigns numbers to objects to classify the objects according to the characteristic of interest.
a. Ratio
b. Ordinal
c. **Nominal**
d. Interval
e. Dichotomous

5. A telephone company is interested in obtaining customers' reactions to a new service package. Which of the following primary research methods would be most effective in reaching this audience to obtain their feedback?
a. Mall intercept interviews
b. An Internet survey
c. **Telephone interviews**
d. A mail survey
e. Focus groups

6. When issues to be addressed are personal, sensitive, or subject to strong social norms, a qualitative research technique generally recommended is:
a. Focus groups
b. Mini-groups
c. Laddering

d. Symbolic analysis
e. **Projective research**

7. What type of sample involves some form of random selection so that every member of the sampling frame has an equal, non-zero chance of being included in the sample?
a. **Probability sample**
b. Census equivalent sample
c. Zero-bias sample
d. All-inclusive sample
e. Non-probability sample

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8. Conditions favoring the use of a sample over a census include a:
a. Small population size
b. Long time frame
c. **Small budget**
d. High cost of sampling errors
e. Low cost of non-sampling errors

9. Increasing the size of the sample is likely to:
a. **Decrease sampling error but increase non-sampling error**
b. Increase sampling error but decrease non-sampling error
c. Decrease both sampling error and non-sampling error
d. Increase both sampling error and non-sampling error
e. Increase sampling error but have no impact on non-sampling error

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10. An advantage of computer-assisted telephone interviewing is:
a. **Interviewing time is reduced**
b. Data quality is enhanced
c. Questionnaires do not have to be coded
d. There is little opportunity for interviewer bias
e. This method tends to achieve high response rates compared to other methods

11. If a company is interested in determining the in-store shelf exposure of their brand versus competitive brands, the most effective way to obtain this information is via:
a. Scanner data
b. In-store intercepts with consumers observed purchasing a product in the category
c. Telephone interviews with individuals who made a recent category purchase
d. **An audit**
e. Diary panel data from individuals making purchases in the category

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12. Which of the following is false with regard to the benefits of multiple-choice questions over open-ended questions?
a. The use of multiple-choice questions reduces interviewer bias
b. **Multiple-choice questions are easier to design**

c. Multiple-choice questions are less costly for coding and data processing
d. Multiple-choice questions are quicker to administer
e. The use of multiple-choice questions results in higher cooperation for self-administered surveys

13. Detailed and unambiguous instructions are particularly important for:
a. Interviewer-administered personal interviews
b. Computer-assisted telephone surveys
c. **Mail surveys**
d. Computer-assisted personal interviews
e. Internet surveys

14. If an interview is conducted with a respondent who does not meet the qualifications for a study, what kind of bias has occurred?
a. Position bias
b. **Respondent bias**
c. Lifestyle bias
d. Non-response bias
e. Instrument bias

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15. Setting quotas for hard-to-reach respondents is one way to minimize_____bias.
a. Respondent
b. Interviewer
c. Instrument
d. **Non-response**
e. Sampling

16. Which of the following is an example of an issue that would be checked in a field edit?
a. Completion of all questions on a questionnaire
b. **Legible writing**
c. Single responses to all multiple choice questions
d. Logical answers between questions (i.e., attributes should be rated high if purchase interest is high)
e. The accuracy of a respondent's phone number (if this information is collected)
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17. The telephone rings, you answer, and the caller asks you to respond to a survey. After a few questions, the caller begins to offer you the opportunity to purchase land at a local lake for a summer home. This practice is known as_____and is_____in many countries.
a. Frugging, unethical
b. Frugging, illegal
c. Sugging, unethical
d. **Sugging, illegal**
e. Sugging, ethical

18. Eliminating a respondent's survey due to many questions being left blank is referred to as:

a. Pairwise deletion
b. Neutral value deletion
c. **Casewise deletion**
d. Imputed response deletion
e. Variable deletion

19. To standardize a scale, subtract_____from_____and divide by_____.

a. The standard deviation, the variance, the mean
b. **The mean, each score, the standard deviation**
c. Each score, the standard deviation, the mean
d. Each score, the mean, the variance
e. The standard deviation, the variance, each score

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20. If a nominal scale is used, it is permissible to calculate which of the following statistics?

a. Mean
b. Standard deviation
c. Range
d. Percentile
e. **Mode**

21. Multicollinearity occurs when:

a. **There are high intercorrelations among the independent variables**
b. The independent variables are mutually exclusive
c. The independent variables are irrelevant
d. There are too many independent variables
e. The dependent variable cannot be predicted by the independent variables

22. The key objective of data analysis is to:

a. **Understand relationships between variables**
b. Calculate statistics
c. Obtain the distribution of responses for each question
d. Create tables which display the survey results
e. Provide those reading the report with as much detail as possible about the survey results

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23. Which of the following is the best way to staff a research department?

a. Keep staffing levels low just in case the work slows down; during particularly busy times the staff can put in more hours.
b. Keep staffing levels high, so that adequate resources are always available for peak times.
c. Develop a broad range of skill sets in each employee so there is flexibility in what can be assigned to each researcher in order to balance workloads.

d. Keep overhead down by exclusively using independent contractors who are paid only for the work they do on specific assignments.

e. Fill as many positions as possible with part-time rather than full-time staff to have the flexibility of increasing or decreasing hours based on workloads.

24. Which of the following is a general rule for research department budgeting?

a. Establish a fixed budget that does not allow for deviations.

b. **Obtain client input in the research budgeting process.**

c. Try to establish as high a budget as possible in order to have extra dollars available for unanticipated issues requiring investigation.

d. Allocate fewer resources to projects focused on current information needs, and greater resources to the investigation of future issues.

e. Consider the budget as simply a starting point for the allocation of resources since needs change over time and flexibility is important.

25. A recent study of car owners indicated that 10% felt Brand A had the best quality, 9% felt Brand B did, and 6% felt other models did. The remainder had no opinion. The advertising claim that most car owners who gave an opinion believe that Brand A has the best quality is an example of_____which is_____.

a. Biased research, unethical

b. Effective advertising, ethical

c. **Misleading reporting, unethical**

d. Incomplete reporting, unethical

e. Accurate reporting, ethical

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Chapter 2

Multiple Choice Questions

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1. Which research paradigm is based on the pragmatic view of reality?

a. quantitative research

b. qualitative research

c. mixed research

d. none of the above

2. Which research paradigm is least concerned about generalizing its findings?

a. quantitative research

b. qualitative research

c. mixed research
d. none of the above

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3. Which of the following best describes quantitative research?
a. the collection of nonnumerical data
b. an attempt to confirm the researcher's hypotheses
c. research that is exploratory
d. research that attempts to generate a new theory

4. A condition or characteristic that can take on different values or categories is called ___.
a. a constant
b. a variable
c. a cause-and-effect relationship
d. a descriptive relationship

5. if one variable causes change in value of another variable is termed as:
a. dependent variable

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6. All of the following are common characteristics of experimental research except:
a. it relies primarily on the collection of numerical data
b. it can produce important knowledge about cause and effect
c. it uses the deductive scientific method
d. it rarely is conducted in a controlled setting or environment

7. Qualitative research is often exploratory and has all of the following characteristics except:
a. it is typically used when a great deal is already known about the topic of interest
b. it relies on the collection of nonnumerical data such as words and pictures
c. it is used to generate hypotheses and develop theory about phenomena in the world
d. it uses the inductive scientific method

8. Which type of research provides the strongest evidence about the existence of cause-and-effect relationships?
a. nonexperimental Research
b. experimental Research

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9. What is the key defining characteristic of experimental research?
a. extraneous variables are never present
b. a positive correlation usually exists
c. a negative correlation usually exists
d. manipulation of the independent variable

10. In_____, random assignment to groups is never possible and the researcher cannot manipulate the independent variable.
a. basic research
b. quantitative research
c. experimental research
d. causal-comparative and correlational research

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11. What is the defining characteristic of experimental research?
a. resistance to manipulation
b. manipulation of the independent variable
c. the use of open-ended questions
d. focuses only on local problems

12.. A positive correlation is present when_____.
a. two variables move in opposite directions.
b. two variables move in the same direction.
c. one variable goes up and one goes down
d. several variables never change.

13. Research in which the researcher uses the qualitative paradigm for one phase and the quantitative paradigm for another phase is known as_____.
a. action research
b. basic research
c. quantitative research
d. mixed method research
e. mixed model research

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14. Research in which the researcher uses both qualitative and quantitative research within a stage or across two of the stages in the research process is known as_____.
a. action research
b. basic research
c. quantitative research
d. mixed method research
e. mixed model research

15.. Research that is done to understand an event from the past is known as_____?
a. experimental research
b. historical research
c. replication
d. archival research

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16._____research occurs when the researcher manipulates the independent variable.
a. causal-comparative research
b. experimental research
c. ethnography
d. correlational research

17.. Which of the following includes examples of quantitative variables?
a. age, temperature, income, height
b. grade point average, anxiety level, reading performance
c. gender, religion, ethnic group
d. both a and b

18.. What is the opposite of a variable?
a. a constant
b. an extraneous variable
c. a dependent variable
d. a data set

19. Which of the following is the type of nonexperimental research in which the primary independent variable of interest is categorical?
a. causal-comparative research
b. experimental research
c. qualitative research
d. mixed research

20. Which of the following can best be described as a categorical variable?
a. age
b. annual income
c. grade point average
d. religion

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21. In research, something that does not "vary" is called a_____.
a. variable
b. method
c. constant

d. control group

22. When interpreting a correlation coefficient expressing the relationship between two variables, it is very important to avoid_____.
a. checking the strength of relationship
b. jumping to the conclusion of causality
c. checking the direction of the relationship
d. expressing a relationship with a correlation coefficient

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23. A researcher studies achievement by children in poorly funded elementary schools. She develops a model that posits parent involvement as an important variable. She believes that parent involvement has an impact on children by increasing their motivation to do school work. Thus, in her model, greater parent involvement leads to higher student motivation, which in turn creates higher student achievement. Student motivation is what kind of variable in this study?
    a. Manipulated variable
    b. Extraneous variable
    c. Confounding variable
    d. Mediating or intervening variable

24. The strongest evidence for causality comes from which of the following research methods?
    a. Experimental
b. Causal-comparative
c. Correlational
d. Ethnography

25. Which correlation is the strongest?
a. +.10
b. -.95
c. +.90
    d. -1.00

26. The correlation between intelligence test scores and grades is:
    a. Positive
b. Negative
c. Perfect
d. They are not correlated

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Answers:
1. c
2. b
3. b

4. b
5. c
6. d
7. a
8. b
9. d
10. d
11. b
12. b
13. d
14. e
15. b
16. b
17. d
18. a
19. a
20. d
21. c
22. b
23. d
24. a
25. d
26. a

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Chapter 9
Multiple Choice Questions for Final Terms
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1. Analysis of covariance is:

a. A statistical technique that can be used to help equate groups on specific variables
b. A statistical technique that can be used to control sequencing effects
c. A statistical technique that substitutes for random assignment to groups
d. Adjusts scores on the independent variable to control for extraneous variables

2. To determine whether noise affects the ability to solve math problems, a researcher has one group solve math problems in a quiet room and another group solve math problems in a noisy room. The group solving problems in the noisy room completes 15 problems in one hour and the group solving problems in the quiet room completes 22 problems in one hour. In this experiment, the independent variable is_____and the dependent variable is _____.

a. The number of problems solves; the difficulty of the problems
b. The number of problems solved; the noise level in the room
c. The noise level in the room; the number of problems solved
d. The noise level in the room; the difficulty of the problems

3. The posttest-only design with nonequivalent groups is likely to control for which of the following threats to internal validity:
a. History
b. Differential selection
c. Additive and interactive effects
d. Differential attrition

4. When all participants receive all treatment conditions, the study is susceptible to:
a. Order effects
b. Carryover effects
c. Analysis of covariance
d. a and b

5. A researcher is interested in the effects of a preschool program on later school performance. Because she is concerned that socio-economic-status (SES) is a potential extraneous variable in her study, she picks children to study who are only from low SES homes. The control technique she used in this study was:
a. Matching
b. Random assignment
c. Holding the extraneous variable constant
d. Statistically controlling the extraneous variable

6. Which of the following terms best describes an interaction effect?
a. The effect of one independent variable (on a DV) depends on the level of another independent variable
b. Eliminating any differential influence of extraneous variables
c. Sequencing effect that occurs from the order in which the treatment conditions are administered
d. The effect of one independent variable on the dependent variable

7. Which of the following terms refers to a statistical method that can be used to statistically equate groups on a pretest or some other variable?

a. Experimental control
b. Differential influence
c. Matching
d. Analysis of covariance

8. Which of the following is not a way to manipulate an independent variable?
a. Presence technique
b. Amount technique
c. Type technique
d. Random technique
9. Which of the following designs permits a comparison of pretest scores to determine the initial equivalence of groups on the pretest before the treatment variable is introduced into the research setting.
a. One-group pretest-posttest design
b. Pretest-posttest control group design
c. Posttest-only design with nonequivalent groups
d. Both b and c

10. Counterbalancing is_____.
a. Usually based on random selection of participants
b. Only used when one pretest variable needs to be controlled
c. Chosen to control for such things as order and carryover effects*
d. All of the above

11. The group that receives the experimental treatment condition is the_____.
a. Experimental group
b. Control group
c. Participant group
d. Independent group

12. Which of the following control techniques available to the researcher controls for both known and unknown variables?
a. Building the extraneous variable into the design
b. Matching
c. Random assignment
d. Analysis of covariance

13. The group that does not receive the experimental treatment condition is the _____.
a. Experimental group
b. Control group
c. Treatment group
d. Independent group

14. There are a number of ways in which confounding extraneous variables can be controlled. Which control technique is considered to be the best?

a. Random assignment
b. Matching
c. Counterbalancing
d. None of the above

15. Which of the following could be used for randomly assigning participants to groups in an experimental study?
a. Split-half (e.g., first half versus second half of a school directory)
b. Even versus odd numbers
c. Use a list of random numbers or a computer randomization program
d. Let the researcher decide which group will be the best

16. Which term is not a related to counterbalancing?
a. Carryover effect
b. Order effect
c. Sequencing effects
d. Matching

17. A cell is a combination of two or more ____ in a factorial design.
a. Research designs
b. Research measurements
c. Dependent variables
d. Independent variables

18. Which of the following designs does an excellent job of controlling for rival hypotheses that threaten the internal validity of an experiment?
a. Posttest-only design with nonequivalent groups
b. Posttest-only control-group design
c. Pretest-posttest control-group design
d. Both b and c are excellent designs

19. Manipulating the independent variable by varying the type on the independent variable that is presented to the different comparison groups is known as_____.
a. Amount technique
b. Absence technique
c. Type technique
d. Presence technique

20. Which of the following terms is a sequencing effect that occurs from the order in which the treatment conditions are administered?
a. Carry-over effect
b. Order effect
c. Sequencing effects
d. None of the above

21. When manipulating the independent variable in an educational experiment, which of the following describes this method?
a. An independent variable is manipulated using the presence or absence technique

b. The researchers varies the amount of the independent variable that is administered
c. The researcher varies the type of the independent variable
d. All of the above are possible

22. Which method of controlling confounding extraneous variables takes precedence over all other methods?
a. Matching individual participants
b. Holding extraneous variables
c. Building the extraneous variable into the research design
d. Counterbalancing
e. Randomly assign research participants to the groups

23. In an experimental research study, the primary goal is to isolate and identify the effect produced by the_____.
a. Dependent variable
b. Extraneous variable
c. Independent variable
d. Confounding variable

24. This type of design is one where all participants participate in all experimental treatment conditions.
a. Factorial design
b. Repeated measures design
c. Replicated design
d. Pretest-posttest control-group design

25. A factorial design is one in which_____.
a. Only one independent variable is studied to determine its effect on the dependent variable
b. Only two independent variables are simultaneously studied to determine their independent
and interactive effects on the dependent variable
c. Two or more independent variables are simultaneously studied to determine their independent and interactive effects on the dependent variable
d. Two dependent variables are studied to determine their interactive effects

26. The design in which one group of research participants is administered a treatment and is then compared, on the dependent variable, with another group of research participants who did not receive the experimental treatment is_____.
a. One-group posttest-only design
b. One-group pretest-posttest design
c. Posttest-only design with nonequivalent groups
d. time series design

27. _____ refers to the influence of a single independent variable.
a. Interaction effect

b. Reactive effect
c. Main effect
d. Proactive effect

28. A sequencing effect that occurs when performance in one treatment condition is influenced by participation in a prior treatment condition is known as_____.
a. Counterbalancing effect
b. Carryover effect
c. Treatment effect
d. Order effect
29. Which of the following is possible in a factorial design with two independent variables?
a. There is only one main effect present
b. There are two main effects present
c. There are two main effects and an interaction effect present
d. All of the above are possible

30. Which of the following is a factorial design where different participants are randomly assigned to the levels of one independent variable but participants take all levels on another independent variable?
a. One-group pretest-posttest
b. Pretest-posttest control-group design
c. Factorial design
d. Factorial design based on a mixed model

Chapter 18
Multiple Choice Questions

1. When a citation includes more than____authors, only the surname of the first author is cited followed by et al.
a. 3
b. 4
c. 5
d. **6**

2. When referencing other works you have cited within the text of the report you should
a. State the first and last name of the author
b. Use the author, date citation method
c. Use an asterisk and a footnote
d. Insert the complete citation in parenthesis

3. Which of the following abbreviations can be used in a research report?
a. IQ
b. sec. for second
c. yr. for year
d. mo. for month

4. Editorial style specifies that_____should be used infrequently or sparingly.
a. Italics
b. Abbreviations
c. Headings
d. Both a and b

5. The factor that should determine whether you decide to prepare a research report of you study for a conference or for publication is
a. Whether the study is free from flaws
b. Whether the study is important enough to justify presentation or publication
c. Whether others would be interested in the work
d. All of the above

6. Which of the following is not true about the use of language in research reports?
a. You should choose accurate and clear words that are free from bias.
b. You should avoid labeling people whenever possible
c. You should avoid using the term "subjects" whenever possible
d. All of the above are true according to the APA Guidelines

7. Regarding disabilities, writers should "avoid equating people with their disabilities" such as in mentally retarded people.
a. True
b. False

8. You should avoid the use of sexist language in research reports.
a. True
b. False

9. Which is more appropriate when referring to someone with a disability?
a. A stroke victim
b. A person who has had a stroke

10. You should try to use italics frequently when writing a report.
a. True
b. False

11. You should try to use abbreviations sparingly.
a. True
b. False

12. Use words for numbers that begin a sentence and for numbers that are below ten.
a. True
b. False

13. You should double space all material in the manuscript.

a. True
b. False

14. Which of the following is not one of the seven major parts to the research report?
a. Results
b. Abstract
c. Method
d. Footnotes

15. The Introduction section should not be labeled.
a. True
b. False

16. The abstract should be about how many words?
a. 50
b. 75
c. 120
d. 300

17. The Method section should start on a separate page in a manuscript.
a. True
b. False

18. It is in this section that you fully interpret and evaluate your results.
a. Introduction
b. Method
c. Results
d. Discussion

19. Where do you provide a step-by-step account of what the researcher and participants did during the research study?
a. Introduction
b. Abstract
c. Procedure
d. Design

20. References should be single spaced.
a. True
b. False

21. Qualitative research reports do not need a Method section.
a. True
b. False

22. When writing the qualitative results section, an overriding concern should be to provide sufficient and convincing evidence to back up your assertions.

a. True
b. False

23. When writing the qualitative results section, you will need to find an appropriate balance between description and interpretation.
a. True
b. False

24. Diagrams, matrices, tables, and figures should never be used in qualitative research reports.
a. True
b. False

25. Your textbook authors argued that in qualitative research it is important to fit the research findings back into the relevant research literature even if the study is exploratory.
a. True
b. False

Chapter 6
Multiple Choice Questions
(The answers are provided after the last question.)

1. According to your text, how many points should a rating scale have?
a. Five
b. Four
c. Ten
d. Somewhere from 4 to 11 points

2. What is the problem(s) with this set of response categories to the question "What is your current age?"

1-5
5-10
10-20
20-30
30-40

a. The categories are not mutually exclusive
b. The categories are not exhaustive
c. Both a and b are problems
d. There is no problem with the above set of response categories

3. You should mix methods in a way that provides complementary strengths and nonoverlapping weaknesses. This is known as the *fundamental principle of mixed research*.
a. True
b. False

4. According to the text, questionnaires can address events and characteristics taking place when?

a. In the past (retrospective questions)
b. In the present (current time questions)
c. In the future (prospective questions)
d. All of the above

5. Which of the following are principles of questionnaire construction?
a. Consider using multiple methods when measuring abstract constructs
b. Use multiple items to measure abstract constructs
c. Avoid double-barreled questions
d. All of the above
e. Only b and c

6. Which of these is not a method of data collection.
a. Questionnaires
b. Interviews
c. Experiments
d. Observations

7. Secondary/existing data may include which of the following?
a. Official documents
b. Personal documents
c. Archived research data
d. All of the above

8. An item that directs participants to different follow-up questions depending on their response is called a_____.
a. Response set
b. Probe
c. Semantic differential
d. Contingency question

9. Which of the following terms best describes data that were originally collected at an earlier time by a different person for a different purpose?
a. Primary data
b. Secondary data
c. Experimental data
d. Field notes

10. Researchers use both open-ended and closed-ended questions to collect data. Which of the following statements is true?
a. Open-ended questions directly provide quantitative data based on the researcher's predetermined response categories
b. Closed-ended questions provide quantitative data in the participant's own words
c. Open-ended questions provide qualitative data in the participant's own words
d. Closed-ended questions directly provide qualitative data in the participants' own words

11. Open-ended questions provide primarily_____data.

a. Confirmatory data
b. Qualitative data
c. Predictive data
d. None of the above

12. Which of the following is true concerning observation?
a. It takes less time than self-report approaches
b. It costs less money than self-report approaches
c. It is often not possible to determine exactly why the people behave as they do
d. All of the above

13. Qualitative observation is usually done for exploratory purposes; it is also called _____ observation.
a. Structured
b. Naturalistic
c. Complete
d. Probed

14. As discussed in chapter 6, when constructing a questionnaire it is important to do each of the following except_____.
a. Use "leading" or "loaded" questions
b. Use natural language
c. Understand your research participants
d. Pilot your test questionnaire

15. Another name for a Likert Scale is a(n):
a. Interview protocol
b. Event sampling
c. Summated rating scale
d. Ranking

16. Which of the following is not one of the six major methods of data collection that are used by educational researchers?
a. Observation
b. Interviews
c. Questionnaires
d. Checklists

17. The type of interview in which the specific topics are decided in advance but the sequence and wording can be modified during the interview is called:
a. The interview guide approach
b. The informal conversational interview
c. A closed quantitative interview
d. The standardized open-ended interview

18. Which one of the following in not a major method of data collection:

a. Questionnaires
b. Interviews
c. Secondary data
d. Focus groups
e. All of the above are methods of data collection

19. A question during an interview such as “Why do you feel that way?” is known as a:
a. Probe
b. Filter question
c. Response
d. Pilot

20. A census taker often collects data through which of the following?
a. Standardized tests
b. Interviews
c. Secondary data
d. Observations

21. The researcher has secretly placed him or herself (as a member) in the group that is being studied. This researcher may be which of the following?
a. A complete participant
b. An observer-as-participant
c. A participant-as-observer
d. None of the above

22. Which of the following is not a major method of data collection?
a. Questionnaires
b. Focus groups
c. Correlational method
d. Secondary data

23. Which type of interview allows the questions to emerge from the immediate context or course of things?
a. Interview guide approach
b. Informal conversational interview
c. Closed quantitative interview
d. Standardized open-ended interview

24. When conducting an interview, asking "Anything else?, What do you mean?, Why do you feel that way?," etc, are all forms of:
a. Contingency questions
b. Probes
c. Protocols
d. Response categories

25. When constructing a questionnaire, there are 15 principles to which you should adhere. Which of the following is not one of those principles?

a. Do not use "leading" or "loaded" questions
b. Avoid double-barreled questions
c. Avoid double negatives
d. Avoid using multiple items to measure a single construct

Chapter 7
Multiple Choice Questions

1. When each member of a population has an equally likely chance of being selected, this is called:
a. A nonrandom sampling method
b. A quota sample
c. A snowball sample
d. An Equal probability selection method

2. Which of the following techniques yields a simple random sample?
a. Choosing volunteers from an introductory psychology class to participate
b. Listing the individuals by ethnic group and choosing a proportion from within each ethnic group at random.
c. Numbering all the elements of a sampling frame and then using a random number table to pick cases from the table.
d. Randomly selecting schools, and then sampling everyone within the school.

3. Which of the following is not true about stratified random sampling?
a. It involves a random selection process from identified subgroups
b. Proportions of groups in the sample must always match their population proportions
c. Disproportional stratified random sampling is especially helpful for getting large enough subgroup samples when subgroup comparisons are to be done
d. Proportional stratified random sampling yields a representative sample

4. Which of the following statements are true?
a. The larger the sample size, the greater the sampling error
b. The more categories or breakdowns you want to make in your data analysis, the larger the sample needed
c. The fewer categories or breakdowns you want to make in your data analysis, the larger the sample needed
d. As sample size decreases, so does the size of the confidence interval

5. Which of the following formulae is used to determine how many people to include in the original sampling?
a. Desired sample size/Desired sample size + 1
b. Proportion likely to respond/desired sample size
c. Proportion likely to respond/population size
d. Desired sample size/Proportion likely to respond

6. Which of the following sampling techniques is an equal probability selection method (i.e., EPSEM) in which every individual in the population has an equal chance of being selected?
a. Simple random sampling
b. Systematic sampling
c. Proportional stratified sampling
d. Cluster sampling using the PPS technique
e. All of the above are EPSEM

7. Which of the following is not a form of nonrandom sampling?
a. Snowball sampling
b. Convenience sampling
c. Quota sampling
d. Purposive sampling
e. They are all forms of nonrandom sampling

8. Which of the following will give a more "accurate" representation of the population from which a sample has been taken?
a. A large sample based on the convenience sampling technique
b. A small sample based on simple random sampling
c. A large sample based on simple random sampling
d. A small cluster sample

9. Sampling in qualitative research is similar to which type of sampling in quantitative research?
a. Simple random sampling
b. Systematic sampling
c. Quota sampling
d. Purposive sampling

10. Which of the following would generally require the largest sample size?
a. Cluster sampling
b. Simple random sampling
c. Systematic sampling
d. Proportional stratified sampling

11. How often does the Census Bureau take a complete population count?
a. Every year
b. Every five years
c. Every ten years
d. Twice a year

12. People who are available, volunteer, or can be easily recruited are used in the sampling method called_____.
a. Simple random sampling
b. Cluster sampling
c. Systematic sampling
d. Convenience sampling

13. Which of the following types of sampling involves the researcher determining the appropriate sample sizes for the groups identified as important, and then taking convenience samples from those groups?
a. Proportional stratified sampling
b. Quota sampling
c. One-stage cluster sampling
d. Two-stage cluster sampling

14. A type of sampling used in qualitative research that involves selecting cases that disconfirm the researcher's expectations and generalizations is referred to as_____.
a. Extreme case sampling
b. Typical-case sampling
c. Critical-case sampling
d. Negative-case sampling

15. Using Figure 6.6 (pg. 178), how many participants will you need for a research study with a population of 120,000?
a. 242
b. 331
c. 377
d. 384

16. In which of the following nonrandom sampling techniques does the researcher ask the research participants to identify other potential research participants?
a. Snowball
b. Convenience
c. Purposive
d. Quota

17. Which of the following is the most efficient random sampling technique discussed in your chapter?
a. Simple random sampling
b. Proportional stratified sampling
c. Cluster random sampling
d. Systematic sampling

18. If we took the 500 people attending a school in New York City, divided them by gender, and then took a random sample of the males and a random sampling of the females, the variable on which we would divide the population is called the_____.
a. Independent variable
b. Dependent variable
c. Stratification variable
d. Sampling variable

19. A number calculated with complete population data and quantifies a characteristic of the population is called which of the following?

a. A datum
b. A statistic
c. A parameter
d. A population

20. The type of sampling in which each member of the population selected for the sample is returned to the population before the next member is selected is called_____.
a. Sampling without replacement
b. Sampling with replacement
c. Simple random sampling
d. Systematic sampling

21. Which of the following is not a type of nonrandom sampling?
a. Cluster sampling
b. Convenience sampling
c. Quota sampling
d. Purposive sampling
e. They are all type of nonrandom sampling

22. Which of the following would usually require the smallest sample size because of its efficiency?
a. One stage cluster sampling
b. Simple random sampling
c. Two stage cluster sampling
d. Quota sampling

23. A technique used when selecting clusters of different sizes is called_____.
a. Cluster sampling
b. One-stage sampling
c. Two-stage sampling
d. Probability proportional to size or PPS

24. The process of drawing a sample from a population is known as_____.
a. Sampling
b. Census
c. Survey research
d. None of the above

25. It is recommended to use the whole population rather than a sample when the population size is of what size?
a. 500 or less
b. 100 or less
c. 1000 or less
d. you should always use a sample

26. Which of the following is not an example of a nonrandom sampling technique?
a. Purposive

b. Quota
c. Convenience
d. Cluster

27. Which of the following sampling methods is the best way to select a group of people for a study if you are interested in making statements about the larger population?
a. Convenience sampling
b. Quota sampling
c. Purposive sampling
d. Random sampling

28. _____ is a set of elements taken from a larger population according to certain rules.
a. Sample
b. Population
c. Statistic
d. Element

29. Determining the sample interval (represented by k), randomly selecting a number between 1 and k, and including each kth element in your sample are the steps for which form of sampling?
a. Simple Random Sampling
b. Stratified Random Sampling
c. Systematic Sampling
d. Cluster sampling

30. The nonrandom sampling type that involves selecting a convenience sample from a population with a specific set of characteristics for your research study is called_____.
a. Convenience sampling
b. Quota sampling
c. Purposive sampling
d. Snowball sampling

STA630 MCQs solved by Mehreen Humayun (Lecure 1-43)

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STA630- Research Methods
Online Quiz
Lecture# 1 to 43
Shared & Solved by vuZs Team
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On which component of his field notes was Mr. M focused when he expressed in his notes his thoughts and ideas about what he observed?

Reflection
Protocol
Formal data
Analysis
Reflection is thinking for an extended period by linking recent experiences to earlier ones in order to promote a more complex and interrelated mental schema. The thinking involves looking for commonalities, differences, and interrelations beyond their superficial elements.

Which of the following is NOT a longitudinal study?

Trend study
Census study
Panel study
Cohort study
There are three types of longitudinal research: time series, panel, and cohort.

A census taker often collects data through which of the following?

Standardized tests
Interviews
Secondary data
Observations
Secondary Data: The data may be a time bound collection of information (population census) as well as spread over long periods of time (unemployment trends, crime rate).
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What is opposite of a variable?

A constant
An extraneous variable
A dependent variable
A data set
The opposite of a variable is a constant.

A literature review requires;

planning
clear writing
good writing
All of the given option
A literature review requires planning and good, clear writing, which requires lot of rewriting.

When we say that science is parsimonious, we mean that:

Scientific theories are based on laws.
We must be careful because causes can occur after specific effects.
The best scientific theories are those that offer the simplest explanations for a law.
Science accurately describes a wide range of behavior.
Parsimonious is a big word for "simple." Really good scientists can explain a whole lot by saying only a little.

If the control variable has no effect on the bivariate relationship then it is:

Spurious relationship.
Not spurious relationship.
Both A & B.
None of the above.
A researcher controls for a third variable by seeing whether the bivariate relationship persists within categories of the control variable. In other words, the control variable has no effect. When this is so, the bivariate relationship is not spurious.

Which term technically describes a situation in which an observer's work in a first-grade classroom disrupts the normal routines due to the curiosity of the students?

Observer effect
Participant effect
Non participant bias
Observer bias

Testing is most likely to negatively affect internal validity when_____.

The information tested is attitudinal in nature
The time between pre- and posttest is short

The instrument is unreliable
The participants are very low scorers

A researcher is interested in nonverbal behavior among young adults. The researcher goes to public gathering places in town and observes smiles, gestures, gaze, and touch. This is an example of;

Blind observation
Quasi-experimentation
Naturalistic observation
Field experimentation

Which of the following is included in research proposal?

Data analysis
Results
Literature review
Conclusions section

“Skepticism” is a norm of science. It is better explained by which of the following statement?

Combining the previous knowledge
Critical reading of the previous researches
Providing the proper references of qouted text
Locating research reports in libraries

Which type of research address major societal change?

Experimental Research
Action Research
Social Research
Historical Comparative Research

Which of the following terms best describes data that were originally collected at an earlier time by a different person for a different purpose?

Primary data

Secondary data
Experimental data
Field notes

The person who leads a focus group discussion is called a_____.

Anchor
Facilitator
Moderator
Recorder
Focus Group Moderator: The person who leads a focus group discussion.

Categorical measures are forms of measurement classified as:

Measures that reflect quantitative differences.
Measures that reflect qualitative differences

Measures that do not require mutual exclusivity or exhaustiveness when devising a measuring system.
Rationale measures.

If variables a and b are highly correlated, then

there is a strong relationship between a and b
a causes b
b causes a
there is no relationship between a and b.

In a study of the relationship between self-concept and resilience for males and for females, the minimal acceptable sample size for the whole study would be

10
30
60
90

Which section of a research report sets the stage for the report and indicates where in the report each component, tables, and figures can be found?

Preliminary pages
Table of contents

Main body
Appendices
Table of Contents: The table of contents is based on the final outline of the report, but it should include first-level subdivisions. For short reports it is sufficient to include only the main divisions. If the report includes many figures and tables, lists of these should immediately follow the table of contents.

Which of the following is the least obtrusive and most accurate method for recording data in an interview?

Note taking
Videotaping
Audiotaping
Writing notes after the interview.

Which of the following is an excellent way to enhance the validity of observational data collection?

Spend an extended period of time in the field.
Obtain participant trust.
Recognize your own biases.
All of the above.

Which of the following is a measure in which a researcher adds or combines several distinct indicators of a construct into a single score?

Scale
Index
Unidimensionality
Weighting
An index is a measure in which a researcher adds or combines several distinct indicators of a construct into a single score.

Which type of research address major societal change?

Experimental research
Action research
Social research
Historical comparative research
Historical comparative research is a powerful method for addressing big questions: How did major societal change take place?

In which of the following sampling methods People are available such as volunteer or can be easily recruited?

Simple random sampling
Cluster sampling
Systematic sampling
Convenience sampling

Which of the following can be referred as semantic analysis?

Latent coding
Accretion
Count behaviors
Intensity
Latent Coding: A researcher using latent coding (also called semantic analysis).

Which of the following group that does not receive the experimental treatment condition?

Experimental group
Control group
Treatment group
Independent group.

Which of the following is a measure of inflation?

Scale
Consumer price index
Weighting
Unidimensionality
Consumer Price Index (CPI) is a measure of inflation and is widely followed by many investors.

Which of the following is newer method of survey?

Mail survey
E-mail survey
Field survey

STA630 Research Methods MCQs Solved with Ref by vuzs Team

0 Comments

STA630 Research Methods Quiz

MCQs Solved With Ref by vuZs Team

STA630 - Research Methods - Question # 1 of 15
If a researcher was studying the use of various instructional approaches to the "multiple intelligences" of his students, he is likely to be conducting which type of research?
>
Basic
Applied
Evaluation
Grounded theory
STA630 - Research Methods - Question # 2 of 15
Which of the following statements is false?
>
Discrete variables allow measurement of an infinite number of fractions of units of measurement.
Discrete variables can only have whole number values.
Continuous numbers can only have whole number values.
Continuous measures do not allow for scores that fall between two number values.
STA630 - Research Methods - Question # 3 of 15
Which one of the following creates problems of measurements of a concept?
>
Unambiguous meanings
Vague meanings
Clear meanings
Dictionary meanings
STA630 - Research Methods - Question # 4 of 15
Which of the following is not a concept?
>
Leadership
Total Quality Management
Human Resource Management
IQ
STA630 - Research Methods - Question # 5 of 15
What research is?
>
A lab experiment
A report
A systematic Enquiry
A procedure
STA630 - Research Methods - Question # 6 of 15
Which of the following is a concept?
>
Leadership.
Total Quality Management.

Human Resource Management.
All of the given options
STA630 - Research Methods - Question # 7 of 15
When we say that science is parsimonious, we mean that:
>
Scientific theories are based on laws.
We must be careful because causes can occur after specific effects.
The best scientific theories are those that offer the simplest explanations for a law.
Science accurately describes a wide range of behavior.
http://books.google.com/books?id=AUDoy-lSe_EC&pg=PP1&dq=inauthor:"Donald+H.+McBurney"&ei=7ebZS7ayLqrgkQTYhLmECA&cd=1#v=onepage&q=science%20is%20parsimonious&f=false

STA630 - Research Methods - Question # 8 of 15
Why, as scientists, do we not want to rely on authority for explanations?
>
Those in authority are often wrong.
Those in authority cannot be challenged.
Those in authority rely too much on objective information.
Those in authority often have no common sense.
STA630 - Research Methods - Question # 9 of 15
The_____is only useful if the concepts, ideas, STA630 - Research Methods - Questions, etc. to be investigated are both testable and falsifiable.
>
Independent Variable
Dependent Variable
Experimental Method
Scientific Method
STA630 - Research Methods - Question # 10 of 15
An operational definition is:
>
One that bears no relation to the underlying concept.
An abstract, theoretical definition of a concept.
A definition of a concept in terms of specific, empirical measures.
One that refers to opera singers and their work.

D
evising measures of concepts is shown as step 4 in the process of quantitative research (fig. 6.1, p141). Bryman points out that this step is often referred to as operationalization, in other words the series of separate steps we will take to make our research work for us. This is very important when we think about tests of validity of the research. The operational definition is, therefore, the very opposite of abstract, attempting to phrase the concept so precisely as to make it capable of being tested in the research context.

STA630 - Research Methods - Question # 11 of 15
_____ meanings attached to a concept create problems of measurements.
>
Unambiguous
Vague
Clear
Dictionary
STA630 - Research Methods - Question # 12 of 15
To say that a theory is falsifiable is to say that;
>
It is based on results that are not replicable.
Investigators have replaced it with a simpler or more accurate theory.
We can imagine results that would contradict it.
It is so vague that it fits any and all possible results.
STA630 - Research Methods - Question # 13 of 15
According to Empiricism, which of the following is the ultimate source of all our concepts and knowledge?
>
Perceptions
Theory
Sensory experience
Logics and arguments

STA630 - Research Methods - Question # 14 of 15
Why do you need to review the existing literature?
>
To give your dissertation a proper academic appearance, with lots of references
Because without it, you could never reach the required word-count
To find out what is already known about your area of interest
To help in your general studying

STA630 - Research Methods - Question # 15 of 15
Quantitative researcher's preoccupation with generalization is an attempt to:
>
Develop the law like findings of the natural sciences.
Boost their chances of publication.
Enhance the internal validity of their research.
Demonstrate the complex techniques of statistical analysis.

STA630 - Research Methods - Question # 15 of 15
In_____ we collect same type of information from different respondents in different times.
>

Cohort study

Time series Research

Panel study

Case studies

(zh,vuzs)

STA630 Solved MCQs from Quizzes A

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http://groups.google.com/group/vuZs

http://www.vuzs.info/

Select the most suitable option.

1. Which is not a source of existing statistics?

A. Government

B. International agencies

C. Personal interviews

D. Private sources

2. Followings are the advantages of secondary data except

A. Non-Reactivity

B. Selective survival

C. Low cost

D. Spontaneity

3. Following are the disadvantages of secondary data except

A. Longitudinal analysis

B. Sampling bias

C. Coding difficult

D. Incompleteness

4. The coding of the secondary data may be difficult because of

A. Differences in content or subject matter

B. Lack of standardization

C. Differences in length and format

D. All of these

5. The researcher must be concerned about the following problems while using secondary data in research.

A. Validity

B. Reliability

C. Both of these

D. None of these

6- Hypothesis refers to

A. The outcome of an experiment

B. A conclusion drawn from an experiment

C. A form of bias in which the subject tries to outguess the experimenter

D. A tentative statement about the relationship

7- Statistics is used by researchers to

A. Analyze the empirical data collected in a study

B. Make their findings sound better

C. Operationally define their variables

D. Ensure the study comes out the way it was intended

8- A literature review requires

A. Planning

B. Good & clear writing

C. Lot of rewriting

D. All of the above

9- A literature review is based on the assumption that

A. Copy from the work of others

B. Knowledge accumulates and learns from the work of others

C. Knowledge disaccumulates

D. None of the above option

10- A theoretical framework

A. Elaborates the r/s among the variables

B. Explains the logic underlying these r/s

C. Describes the nature and direction of the r/s

D. All of the above

11- Which of the following statement is not true?

A. A research proposal is a document that presents a plan for a project

B. A research proposal shows that the researcher is capable of successfully conducting the proposed research project

C. A research proposal is an unorganized and unplanned project

D. A research proposal is just like a research report and written before the research project

12- Preliminary data collection is a part of the

A. Descriptive research

B. Exploratory research

C. Applied research

D. Explanatory research

13- Conducting surveys is the most common method of generating

A. Primary data

B. Secondary data

C. Qualitative data

D. None of the above

14- After identifying the important variables and establishing the logical reasoning in theoretical framework, the next step in the research process is

A. To conduct surveys

B. To generate the hypothesis

C. To focus group discussions

D. To use experiments in an investigation

15- The appropriate analytical technique is determined by

A. The research design

B. Nature of the data collected

C. Nature of the hypothesis

D. Both A & B

STA630 Solved MCQs from Quizzes B

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16- Personal interviews conducted in shopping malls are known as:

A. Mall interviews

B. Mall intercept interviews

C. Brief interviews

D. None of the given options

17- WATS lines provided by long distance telephone service at fixed rates. In this regard, WATS is the abbreviation of:

E. West Africa Theological Seminary

F. Washtenaw Area Transportation Study

G. Wide Area Telecommunications Service

H. World Air Transport Statistics

list of questions which is handed over to the respondent, who reads the questions and records the answers himself is known as the:

I. Interview schedule

J. Questionnaire

K. Interview guide

L. All of the given options

19- One of the most critical stages in the survey research process is:

M. Research design

N. Questionnaire design

O. Interview design

P. Survey design

20- Question that consists of two or more questions joined together is called a:

Q. Double barreled question

R. General question

S. Accurate question

T. Confusing question

21- The number of questionnaires returned or completed divided by the total number of eligible people who were contacted or asked to participate in the survey is called the:

U. Response rate

V. Participation rate

W. Inflation rate

X. None of the given options

22- To obtain the freest opinion of the respondent, when we ask general question before a specific question then this procedure is called as the:

Y. Research technique

Z. Qualitative technique

AA. Funnel technique

BB. Quantitative technique

23-A small scale trial run of a particular component is known as:

CC. Pilot testing

DD. Pre-testing

EE. Lab experiments

FF.Both A & B

24- Field testing of the questionnaire shows that:

GG. Respondents are willing to co-operate

HH. Respondents are not willing to co-operate

II. Respondents do not like any participation

JJ. All of the given options

25- Service evaluation of hotels and restaurants can be done by the:

KK. Self-administered questionnaires

LL. Office assistant

MM. Manager

NN. None of the given options

26. _____research is based on naturalism.

A. Field research

B. Descriptive research

C. Basic research

D. Applied research

27- Personal interviews conducted in shopping malls are known as_____

A. Mall interviews

B. Mall intercept interviews

C. Brief interviews

D. None of the given options

28. _____is used to obtain the freest opinion of the respondent, by asking general question before a specific question.

A. Research technique

B. Qualitative technique

C. Funnel technique

D. Quantitative technique

29. In,_____the interviewer and members jointly control the pace and direction of the interview.

A. Field interview

B. Telephonic interview

C. Both A and B

D. None of the given options

30. Randomization of test units is a part of _____

A. Pretest

B. Posttest

C. Matching

D. Experiment

31. Which one of the following sets is the measure of central tendency?

a. Mean, standard deviation, mode

b. Mean, median, standard deviation

c. Arithmetic mean, median, mode

d. Standard deviation, internal validity, mode

32. Internal validity refers to .

a. Researcher's degree of confidence.

b. Generalizability

c. Operationalization

d. All of the above

33. How many times the students appear in the research class is the example of _____.

a. Intensity

b. Space

c. Frequency

d. Direction

34. Time consumed in mall intercept interview is .

a. High

b. Moderate

c. Low

d. Nil

35. Departmental stores selected to test a new merchandising display system is the example of .

a. Quota sampling

b. Convenience sampling

c. Judgmental sampling

d. Purposive sampling

36. In_____, the researcher attempts to control and/ or manipulate the variables in the study.

1. Experiment

2. Hypothesis

3. Theoretical framework

4. Research design

36. In an experimental research study, the primary goal is to isolate and identify the effect produced by the ____.

1. Dependent variable

2. Extraneous variable

37. Independent variable

4. Confounding variable

3. A measure is reliable if it provides consistent_____.

1. Hypothesis

2. Results

3. Procedure

4. Sensitivity

38. The interview in which questions are already prepared is called_____.

1. Telephonic interview

2. Personal interview

3. Unstructured interview

4. Structured interview

39. The numerical description that describe sample may be expected to differ from those that describe population because of random fluctuations inherent in sampling process.

1. Sampling design

2. Non-probability sampling

3. Sampling error

4. Probability sampling

40. In_____ , each population element has a known and equal chance of selection.

1. Purposive sampling

2. Quota sampling

3. Stratified sampling

4. Simple random sampling

41. _____is the evidence that the instrument, techniques, or process used to measure concept does indeed measure the intended concepts.

1. Reliability

2. Replicability

3. Scaling

4. Validity

42. A researcher is interested in studying why the "new math" of the 1960s failed. She interviews several teachers who used the new math during the 1960s. These teachers are considered as:

1. Primary sources

2. Secondary Sources

3. External critics

4. Internal critics

42. Which of the following is NOT true about stratified random sampling?

1. It involves a random selection process from identified subgroups

2. Proportions of groups in the sample must always match their population proportions

3. Disproportional stratified random sampling is especially helpful for getting large enough subgroup samples when subgroup comparisons are to be done

4. Proportional stratified random sampling yields a representative sample

43. Experimental design is the only appropriate design where_____relationship can be established.

1. Strong

2. Linear

3. Weak

4. Cause and Effect

45. All the persons involved in the collection of data and supervision of data collection process are called

i. Fieldworkers

ii. Researchers

iii. Research assistants

iv. None of the given options

46. While terminating the interview, the fieldworker should **not** do one of the following:

i. He should record all the responses made by the interviewee before leaving.

ii. He should thank the interviewee.

iii. He should close the interview hastily.

iv. He should answer all the questions the respondent asks concerning the nature and purpose of the study.

47. Which one of these is a type of Interviewee bias?

i. The respondent does not tell his true income, age, or contact information.

ii. The fieldworker fails to probe the interviewee properly.

iii. The fieldworker contacted the wrong person for interview.

iv. The fieldworker asks the questions in wrong order.

48. A magazine conducts a survey and asks its readers to cut the questionnaire from the magazine, fill it and send it via mail. It is a type of

i. Purposive sampling

ii. Snowball sampling

iii. Sequential sampling

iv. Convenience sampling

49. The height distribution of a few students in a school is an example of

i. Statistic

ii. Population

iii. Parameter

iv. Element

50. A researcher wants to conduct a survey of the drug users. Which type of sampling technique will be most appropriate here?

i. Sequential sampling

ii. Snowball sampling

iii. Quota sampling

iv. Convenience sampling

STA630 Solved MCQs from Quizzes C

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56- In lab experiment the effect of Variables is controlled to evaluate the causal relationship.

a. Extraneous
b. Moderate
c. Intervening
d. All of the above

57- Internal validity refers to__

a. Researcher's degree of confidence.
b. Generalizability
c. Operationalization
d. All of the above

58- Which of the following is the weakest experimental design?

a. One group pretest-posttest design
b. Quasi- experimental design
c. Two group posttest only design
d. Ex post facto design

59- How many times the students appear in the research class is the example of_____.

a. Intensity
b. Space
c. Frequency
d. Direction

60- Disadvantage of content analysis is__

a. Researcher can increase the sample size
b. Provides access on the subjects to which researcher does have physical access.
c. Sometime documents provide incomplete account to the researcher
d. Spontaneous feelings can be recorded when they occurred

61-. Which of the following statement is incorrect with respect to "An experimental design is a set of procedures specifying:"

a. How the test units (subjects) are to be divided into homogenous sub samples.

b. What independent variables or treatments are to be measured?
c. What dependent variables are to be measured?
d. How the extraneous variables are to be controlled?

62-. Time consumed in mall intercept interview is .

a. High

b. Moderate

c. Low

d. Nil

63-. "Teacher should create a friendly environment in the classroom" this is the type of .

a. Leading question

b. Loaded question

c. Double Barreled

d. Burdensome question

64-. Departmental stores selected to test a new merchandising display system is the example of .

a. Quota sampling

b. Convenience sampling

c. Judgmental sampling

d. Purposive sampling

65-Discrete variable is also called…….

1.

A. Categorical variable
B. Discontinuous variable
C. Both A & B
D. None of the above

66"Officers in my organization have higher than average level of commitment"

Such a hypothesis is an example of…….

A. Descriptive Hypothesis

B. Directional Hypothesis

C. Relational Hypothesis

D. All of the above

67- 'Science' refers to…….

A. A system for producing knowledge

B. The knowledge produced by a system

C. Both A & B

D. None of the above

68- Which one of the following is not a characteristic of scientific method?

1.

A. Deterministic
B. Rationalism
C. Empirical
D. Abstraction

69- The theoretical framework discusses the interrelationships among the…….

A. Variables

B. Hypothesis

C. Concept

D. Theory

70 ..... research is based on naturalism.

1.

A. Field research
B. Descriptive research
C. Basic research
D. Applied research

71- Personal interviews conducted in shopping malls are known as……

1.

A. Mall interviews
B. Mall intercept interviews
C. Brief interviews
D. None of the given options

72- …… is used to obtain the freest opinion of the respondent, by asking general question before a specific question.

1.

A. Research technique
B. Qualitative technique
C. Funnel technique
D. Quantitative technique

73- In, …… the interviewer and members jointly control the pace and direction of the interview.

M. Field interview

N. Telephonic interview

O. Both A and B

P. None of the given options

74- Randomization of test units is a part of ……

1.

A. Pretest
B. Posttest
C. Matching
D. Experiment

75. _____research is based on naturalism.

A. Field research

B. Descriptive research

C. Basic research

D. Applied research

76. Personal interviews conducted in shopping malls are known as_____

A. Mall interviews

B. Mall intercept interviews

C. Brief interviews

D. None of the given options

77. _____is used to obtain the freest opinion of the respondent, by asking general question before a specific question.

A. Research technique

B. Qualitative technique

C. Funnel technique

D. Quantitative technique

78. In, _____ the interviewer and members jointly control the pace and direction of the interview.

A. Field interview

B. Telephonic interview

C. Both A and B

D. None of the given options

79. Randomization of test units is a part of _____

A. Pretest

B. Posttest

C. Matching

D. Experiment

80. Which one of the following sets is the measure of central tendency?

a. Mean, standard deviation, mode

b. Mean, median, standard deviation

c. Arithmetic mean, median, mode

d. Standard deviation, internal validity, mode

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b. Space

c. Frequency

d. Direction

83. Time consumed in mall intercept interview is .

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b. Moderate

c. Low

d. Nil

84. Departmental stores selected to test a new merchandising display system is the example of .

a. Quota sampling

b. Convenience sampling

c. Judgmental sampling

d. Purposive sampling

STA630 Solved MCQs from Quizzes D

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51. When there is a need to apply different data collection methods to different parts of the population, the best sampling method would be

i. Double sampling

ii. Cluster sampling

iii. Stratified random sampling

iv. Systematic random sampling

52. The sampling technique in which every element of the population has an equal, nonzero probability of being selected in a sample, is called

i. Probability sampling

ii. Convenience sampling

iii. Purposive sampling

iv. Quota sampling

53. Target population is also called

i. Population

ii. Survey population

iii. Population element

iv. Population frame

54. Which one of them is the method for probing the respondent?

i. Repeat the question

ii. Give an expectant pause

iii. Repeat the respondent's reply

iv. All of the given options

Note: The correct options are highlighted in blue.

55. Which one of the following sets is the measure of central tendency?

a. Mean, standard deviation, mode

b. Mean, median, standard deviation

c. Arithmetic mean, median, mode

d. Standard deviation, internal validity, mode

85. In_____, the researcher attempts to control and/ or manipulate the variables in the study.

1. Experiment

2. Hypothesis

3. Theoretical framework

4. Research design

86. In an experimental research study, the primary goal is to isolate and identify the effect produced by the ____.

1. Dependent variable

2. Extraneous variable

3. Independent variable

4. Confounding variable

87. A measure is reliable if it provides consistent_____.

1. Hypothesis

2. Results

3. Procedure

4. Sensitivity

88. The interview in which questions are already prepared is called_____.

1. Telephonic interview

2. Personal interview

3. Unstructured interview

4. Structured interview

89. The numerical description that describe sample may be expected to differ from those that describe population because of random fluctuations inherent in sampling process.

1. Sampling design

2. Non-probability sampling

3. Sampling error

4. Probability sampling

90. In_____ , each population element has a known and equal chance of selection.

1. Purposive sampling

2. Quota sampling

3. Stratified sampling

4. Simple random sampling

91. _____is the evidence that the instrument, techniques, or process used to measure concept does indeed measure the intended concepts.

1. Reliability

2. Replicability

3. Scaling

4. Validity

92. A researcher is interested in studying why the “new math” of the 1960s failed. She interviews several teachers who used the new math during the 1960s. These teachers are considered as:

1. Primary sources

2. Secondary Sources

3. External critics

4. Internal critics

93. Which of the following is NOT true about stratified random sampling?

1. It involves a random selection process from identified subgroups

2. Proportions of groups in the sample must always match their population proportions

94. Disproportional stratified random sampling is especially helpful for getting large enough subgroup samples when subgroup comparisons are to be done

4. Proportional stratified random sampling yields a representative sample

95. Experimental design is the only appropriate design where_____relationship can be established.

1. Strong

2. Linear

3. Weak

4. Cause and Effect

96. Rationalism is the application of which of the following?

A. Logic and arguments

B. Research solution

C. Reasoning

D. Previous findings

97 On which of the following, scientific knowledge mostly relies?

A. Logical understanding

B. Identification of events

C. Prior knowledge

D. All of the given options (MH,vuZs)

98. Which of the following refers to research supported by measurable evidence?

A. Opinion

B. Empiricism

C. Speculation

D. Rationalism

99. Research method is applicable in all of the following fields, EXCEPT;

A. Health care

B. Religion

C. Business

D. Government offices

100. All of the following are true statements about action research, EXCEPT;

A. Data are systematically analyzed

B. Data are collected systematically

C. Results are generalizable

D. Results are used to improve practice

TA630 Solved MCQs from Quizzes E

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101. Which of the following is characteristic of action research?

A. Variables are tightly controlled

B. Results are generalizable

C. Data are usually qualitative

D. Results demonstrate cause-and-effect relationships

102. If a researcher is studying the effect of using laptops in his classroom to ascertain their merit and worth, he is likely conducting which of the following types of research?

A. Experimental

B. Applied

C. Basic

D. Evaluation

103. Exploratory research addresses which of the following types of question?

A. If

B. How

C. Why

D. What

104. Which of the following is not the source for getting information for exploratory research?

A. Content analysis

B. Survey

C. Case study

D. Pilot study

105. Which of the following is the main quality of a good theory?

A. A theory that has survived attempts at falsification

B. A theory that is proven to be right

C. A theory that has been disproved

D. A theory that has been falsified

106. Which of the following is not a concept?

A. Leadership

B. Total Quality Management

C. Intelligence Quotient (IQ)

D. Human Resource Management

107. A variable that is presumed to cause a change in another variable is known as:

A. Discontinuous variable

B. Dependent variable

C. Independent variable

D. Intervening variable

108. Which of the following is the opposite of a variable?

A. An extraneous variable

B. A dependent variable

C. A data set

D. A constant

109. Which of the following can best be described as a categorical variable?

A. Age

B. Annual income

C. Grade point average

D. Religion

110. "Income distribution of employees" in a specific organization is an example of which of following type of variable?

A. Discontinuous variable

B. Continuous variable

C. Dependent variable

D. Independent variable

111. “There is no relationship between higher motivation level and higher efficiency” is an example of which type of hypothesis?

A. Alternative

B. Null

C. Co relational

D. Research

112. Which of the following is not a role of hypothesis?

A. Guides the direction of the study

B. Determine feasibility of conducting the study

C. Identifies relevant and irrelevant facts

D. Provides framework for organizing the conclusions

113. Hypothesis test may also be called as:

A. Informal test

B. Significance test

C. Moderating test

D. T-test

114. Which type of review compares how different theories address an issue?

A. Context review

B. Integrated review

C. Theoretical review

D. Methodological review

115. After you locate a source, you should write down all details of the reference, EXCEPT;

A. Volumes

B. Titles

C. Price

D. Full names of the authors

STA630 Answers key to MCQs

0 Comments

Answer key STA630

http://groups.google.com/group/vuZs

http://www.vuzs.info/

Multiple Choice Questions

1. Which of the following dimensions of information does correlational analysis NOT provide?

c. cause and effect.

2. A sociologist wants to know if the proportion of Americans who supports gay marriage has changed over the last 10 years. The best research method for investigating this topic is:

b. analysis of survey data.

3. Suzanne is a subject participating in a study. As part of the study, she gave an electric shock to another subject who made an error on a word recall task. At the end of the study, an experimenter told Suzanne that the study really concerned obedience to authority, that it is normal for subjects to obey the experimenter, and it is important to understand obedience. The experimenter's explanation is an example of:

d. debriefing.

4. Professor Smith hypothesizes that how much students sleep each night may influence their performance on math tests. According to this proposition, hours of sleep is the _____and math test score is the_____.

a. independent variable, dependent variable.

5. The two conditions that must be met for social psychology research to be considered experimentation are:

a. random assignment, relevant variables other than the independent variable are held constant.

6. A random sample is:

b. a sample in which each person in a given population is equally likely to be selected.

7. According to the symbolic interactionist perspective, people can only communicate if

c. They have a consensus of meaning.

8. Mike and Hillary meet at a party, and engage in a discussion of politics. According to Heider's balance theory, which of the following outcomes would illustrate an **imbalanced** relationship:

b. Mike likes Hillary; he supports the Republicans and she is an avid Democrat.

9. Which of these processes guides human behavior, according to social exchange theory?

c. Maximizing gains.

10. Naomi is driving to the hospital very quickly, because she is taking her sick child in for an emergency surgery. On the drive to the hospital, she exceeds the speed limit and runs through a stop sign. She is apprehended by the police, and eventually goes to court to resolve the matter. The presiding judge operates at a level of post-conventional morality. What might the judge say about the situation?

c. It's okay that Naomi violated the speed limit; the health of her child is more important than abiding by the law.

11. Which of the following is NOT a basis for moral judgments according to Piaget?

c. Whether actor has internalized norms of "right" and "wrong."

12. External validity refers to:

b. the extent to which we can generalize the results of a study to other populations and settings.

13. In the play stage of the formation of the self, children

b. take the role of others one at a time.

14. The subset of self-concepts that constitutes the self at a particular time in a particular situation is called:

d. Situated self.

15. Which of the following statements accurately characterizes Baumrind's theory of social class differences in socialization styles?

a. The best way to raise children is with high warmth and high control.

16. Tracy would like to get along well with her boss. In an attempt to understand and predict her boss's behavior, Tracy tries to imagine what it would be like to be the boss. Tracy's behavior is an example of:

b. role-taking.

17. Which of the following statements is true about peers as agents of socialization?

a. Peers often teach each other lessons and reinforce messages that are in opposition to the messages taught by other socializing agents, including parents and teachers.

18. Reinforcement theory argues that a person's behavior is:

b. governed by external events, especially rewards and punishments.

19. The belief that people usually behave in ways that conform to norms and social expectations is a central tenet of which theoretical perspective?

a. role theory.

20. When Danny was young, he witnessed his mother praising his father for doing chores around the house. When Danny grows up, he also helps his spouse with household chores. This is an example of:

c. observational learning.

Examples of full credit answers, Sociology 319, Exam #1

1. Test-retest versus split-half method

Test-retest and the split-half method are two different ways for testing the reliability of a survey. Test-retest is the least practical of the two, where the survey would be given to the same cluster of individuals at different points in time. Test-retest becomes less of use since the surveyees might answer the same as in the first survey in order to be consistent. The split-half method is the more beneficial of the two options since a group of questions, which measure the same component, are divided into two groups of questions within the survey, perhaps in the beginning and at the end. Test-rest example: issue a survey today and then once more in two weeks. Split-half method you would divide a group of questions measuring how "caring" someone is.

2. Participant observation

Participant observation is a form of field study that involves the researcher studying a particular group by involving themselves in the group activities. There are some problems with this type of study. The researcher may display certain types of bias in their research due to connections they may make with those they observe. The members of the group being studied may act differently than normal due to the awareness of an outsider entering the group. An example of this form of field study could be that of a researcher who wants to study the social structure of boxing in poor areas. The researcher becomes involved in the boxing community and actually boxes himself, to enter this private social world.

3. Cognitive dissonance

Cognitive dissonance is the theory that people seek to maintain cohesion in their cognitions when attitude and behavior contradict each other. In response to a contradiction, a person may change his/her attitude or behavior, trivialize the behavior, find information supporting his newly changed attitude, or deny the occurrence of the behavior. People will often choose the least drastic and easiest mechanisms. An example: Calvin is a staunch opponent of affirmative action. One day he enters a conversation with several coworkers about affirmative action. They are all minorities who are for affirmative action. Calvin agrees with them but trivializes the behavior later, claiming to himself the peer pressure to conform was too much.

4. I and me

This theory by Mead says the self is made up of the "I" (the active subject" and the "me" (the passive object). The self is complete when one can function smoothly between the "I' and the "me". Children usually develop this distinction (and therefore the whole self around the age of 4) when language develops because language is very important for this "I" and "me" relationship to work. This uses symbolic interaction theory.

5. Looking glass self

The looking glass self is a theory outlined by Cooley. It states that our sense of self is derived from our interactions with others and depends on (a) our ability to perceive ourselves as we think others perceive us; (b) how we feel others judge us; and (c) how we feel about these perceived judgments. The looking glass self is apparent on shows like “American Idol” where the person auditioning turns out to be a terrible singer. When the judges disapprove of their performance they may say “but all my friends say I sing well.” This reflects one’s perception of how others see him or her and how it has influenced his/her self-concept as a good singer.

6. Racial socialization

Racial socialization, like socialization, is the process by which members of a particular race learn the beliefs, culture, values, norms, rules etc. of the particular ethnic/racial group to which they belong. This is important because it prepares the individual for how to live in society as a member of a particular race and how he/she may deal with difficulties pertinent to being a member of that race such as discrimination from other groups. An example of such lessons learned through racial socialization would be “don’t drive on that street alone at night if no one else like you is around” or “don’t trust white people.”

C. Essay question (25 points)

One of the most widely documented findings in social psychology is that adolescent girls have lower self-esteem than their male peers. Policy makers have hired you to help them understand the reasons for this pattern, and to offer advice for practices that may help to eliminate girls’ disadvantage. You are to address each of these issues in your brief report:

(1) what is “self-esteem” and why is it an important concept? [4 points]

(2) briefly describe three of the following five theories that are generally used to explain self-esteem patterns: social comparison theory; reflected appraisals; psychological salience/centrality; self-perception theory; and self-discrepancy theory. [12 points]

(3) how would each of the 3 theories discussed in part (2) explain the gender gap in self-esteem? Your discussion can be speculative, but should draw on your knowledge of gender socialization. [5 points]

(4) based on your knowledge of social psychology, what recommendations would you give to policy makers or educators hoping to boost girls’ self-esteem? [4 points]

(1) Self-esteem is the attitude we hold toward ourselves, or the overall evaluation we have for the self. It’s an important concept because it affects our behaviors, thoughts, and feelings.

(2) According to the social comparison theory, people are constantly seeking to evaluate themselves. Since there is no objective base to measure ourselves, we compare ourselves with people who are similar to us in important traits. Usually when we compare ourselves with people superior to us, our self-esteem is compromised. When we compare down, our self-esteem is enhanced. However, this is not always the case. When we associate ourselves with superiors, our self-esteem might “bask in the reflected glory” of others.

According to the psychological salience theory, our self-esteem depends largely on domains central to our identity. For example, a social activist might care much more about her leadership skills than her

artistic aptitude. So her weaknesses can't compromise her self-esteem much if it's from a domain peripheral to her self-concept.

According to the self-discrepancy theory, who we are, what we should be and what we'd like to be affect our self-esteem. When our actual self does not match with what we ought to be (often dictated by role expectations) we feel guilt and fear. When the actual self falls short of our idealized self, we feel sad and depressed. Thus, self-esteem is compromised when discrepancy exists between the actual self and the other two selves.

(3) Social Comparison Theory: When a girl sees her teaching praising the intellectual quality of her male classmate's work, whereas she only got comments on her neat handwriting, she perceives the boy as superior to her intellectually. Thus her self-esteem in the intellectual domain is lowered.

Psychological Salience Theory: When a girl believes appearance is more important than knowledge, she'll downplay her mediocre grades and overemphasize her taste in fashion. This method protects her self-esteem temporarily but it shifts her self-esteem, to a different domain from what the general culture or economy expects.

Self-Discrepancy Theory: An athletic and outspoken girl feels pressure to conform to feminine expectations from her parents. Her actual self and ought self are in conflict and her sense of self-esteem is weakened.

(4) If teen magazines used more real-life images of women rather than supermodels, then girls would have a more realistic comparison base when they reflect on their body images. A lower of attractive standards in models might boost girls' self-esteem. A more radical approach would be to replace teen magazines with literary and scientific journals for young adults. Self-esteem rested on physical appearance is too easily crushed in any case.

Quiz #2 STA 630

Shared by Muhammad Naveed

Checked by vuZs Team

http://groups.google.com/group/vuZs

http://www.vuzs.info/

If a nominal scale is used, it is permissible to calculate which of the following statistics?

Select correct option:

Mean

Range

Percentile

Mode

The key objective of data analysis is to:
Select correct option:

Calculate statistics

Understand relationships between variables

Obtain the distribution of responses for each question

Create tables which display the survey results

Question # 3 of 15

Bias is defined as;
Select correct option:

The distortion of responses based on gender, ethnicity, race, or language

A lack of validity

A lack of reliability

A poor interpretation of a student's score

Question # 4 of 5

Which of the following is a research method that allows a researcher to get information about a large number of subjects relatively inexpensively and easily?

Select correct option:

Naturalistic observation

Case study

Laboratory observation

Survey

http://www.sparknotes.com/psychology/psych101/researchmethods/quiz.html

Question # 5 of 15

What is the first step in the research process?
Select correct option:

Preliminary data collection

Problem definition Theoretical framework

Define broad problem area

Step I: Formulating a Research Problem

Formulating a research problem is the first and most important step in the research process.

A research problem identifies your destination: it should tell you, your research supervisor and your readers what you intend to research.

Question # 6 of 15

When you are confident that the experimental manipulation produced the changes you measured in the dependent variable, your study probably has good_____validity.

Select correct option:

Construct Internal
External

Causal

Internal

Question # 7 of 15

What is a relationship between the literature survey and the theoretical framework?

Select correct option:

Provides a solid foundation for developing the latter

Literature survey helps in the identification of the relevant variables

The theoretical framework explains the theory underlying these relations

All of the given options

There is a relationship between the literature survey and the theoretical framework whereby the former provides a solid foundation for developing the latter. Literature survey helps in the identification of the relevant variables, as determined by the previous researches. This in addition to other logical connections that can be conceptualized forms the basis for the theoretical model. The theoretical framework elaborates the relationships among the variables, explains the theory underlying these relations, and describes the nature and direction of the relationships.

Question # 8 of 15

In which way does a ratio scale measurement differ from an interval measurement?

Select correct option:

It measures larger or smaller scores on some underlying dimension.

It implies the existence of an absolute zero value.

It requires the mutual exclusivity of all cases.

It requires that exhaustiveness is applied to all observations.

http://books.google.com/books?id=Eo2HMtTjz0gC&pg=PA56&lpg=PA56&dq=It+implies+the+existence+of+an+absolute+zero+value&source=bl&ots=rcK4H9iA8M&sig=HLMji_muYxECLIxEdYBmYk-faPI&hl=en&ei=n676S5bUHdHBrAe61cC9Cg&sa=X&oi=book_result&ct=result&resnum=1&ved=0CBIQ6AEwAA#v=onepage&q=It%20implies%20the%20existence%20of%20an%20absolute%20zero%20value&f=false

Question # 9 of 15

All of these are characteristics of scientific methods of research except, it is

Select correct option:

Cumulative Deterministic
Unethical (handouts pg#5)

Rationalism

Question # 10 of 15

The elaboration of the variables in the theoretical framework addresses which type of questions?

Select correct option:

Why we expect certain relationships to exist How we expect certain relationships to exist

Both of the given questions

None of the given questions

Question # 11 of 15

Which of the following is the least appropriate research problem?
Select correct option:

Does studying Latin improve the standardized vocabulary test scores of seventh grade students?
Does drilling fifth grade students with multiplication facts improve their standardized test scores?

What is the relationship between students' math attitudes and math achievement?

Should students have access to controversial novels in school?

http://shafiqurrehman1.livejournal.com/1890.html

Question # 12 of 15

A_____scale only assigns numbers to objects to classify the objects according to the

characteristic of interest.

Select correct option:

Ratio **Nominal**
Interval

Dichotomous

http://www.georgiacenter.uga.edu/is/mr/quiz/checkquiz.phtml

Question # 13 of 15

Which of the following is NOT a characteristic of a good research topic?
Select correct option:

It is ethical.

It can be investigated through the collection and analysis of data.

It focuses on a philosophical or ethical issue. It is theoretically or practically significant.

http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_airasian_edresearch_8/0,11083,2525651-content,00.utf8.html

Question # 14 of 15

Which of the following should not be a consideration in writing a proposal?

Select correct option:

Understanding the problem situation The appearance/form of the proposal
Responding to every element exactly as specified by the client

Knowing as much as possible about the proposal recipients

http://www.georgiacenter.uga.edu/is/mr/quiz/checkquiz.phtml

Question # 15 of 15

The extent to which we can generalize the results of a study to other participants is called

Select correct option:

Sampling validity

External validity

Construct validity

Internal validity

. External validity refers to: the extent to which we can generalize the results of a study to other populations and settings

STA630 Solved MCQs from Quizzes 2009

0 Comments

Research Methods –STA630
Solved MCQ's 2009
www.vuzs.info

1. Accepting the information in professor's lecture without asking about the basis of the information is a reliance on authority.

True
False

2. Intuition and authority can be good sources of ideas.

True
False

3. Applied research is not guided by the theories and findings of basic research.

True
False

4. The statement, "Interviewers rate job applicants more favorably when they are wearing a pleasant scent than when they have no scent" is an example of:

description of behavior.
prediction of behavior.
explanation of behavior.

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5. The statement, "A pleasant scent increases favorability of ratings because the scent creates a positive emotional state in the interviewer" is an example of:

description of behavior.
prediction of behavior.
explanation of behavior.

6. An empirical test of an idea about behavior must be conducted so the idea can either be supported or refuted.
True
False

www.vuzs.info

1. A prediction is a statement about the expected relationship between variables
True
False

2. The method section of a research report includes a description of exactly how the study was designed and conducted.
True
False

3. Which of the following would result in finding more articles when using PsycINFO?.

happiness AND marital satisfaction
happiness OR marital satisfaction

www.vuzs.info

4. You found an important article published in 1990. What resource would you use to find articles that have cited your article since then?

Psychological Abstracts
PsycINFO
Social Science Citation Index

5. Which of the following is NOT true of theories?
Explain currently known facts.
Rarely change once formulated.
Generate new knowledge.

www.vuzs.info

6. When the results of a study are consistent with a theory, our confidence in the theory increases.

True
False

7. You are reading a paragraph in a journal article; the topic of the paragraph is the implications of the results for future research. Which section of the article are you reading?
Introduction
Results
Discussion

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Asslam O Alikum
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http://groups.google.com/group/attock-vu-group
0346-5329264

If u like me than raise your hand with me
If not then raise ur standard
That's about me … !

FINALTERM EXAMINATION
Spring 2010
AFAAQ_TARIQ@YAHOO.COM
STA630- Research Methods (Session - 4)

Ref No: 1518507
Time: 90 min
Marks: 69

AFAAQ

Question No: 1 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

An inductive logic is one that:

- ► Involves testing as explicitly defined hypothesis
- ► Does not allow for findings to feed back into the body of knowledge.
- ► Uses quantitative methods whenever possible.
- ► Allows theory to emerge out of the data.

http://www.oup.com/uk/orc/bin/9780199202959/01student/cqs/ch01/

MCQ # 03

Question No: 2 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Which of the following research questions is BEST answered using action research?

► How can I improve the interaction of students of different ethnicity in my class?

http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_airasian_edresearch_7/5/1490/381508.cw/index.html
MCQ # 3

► What factors influence student interaction in multiethnic classes?

► Is there a difference between male and female acceptance of others in multiethnic classes?

► How do students from Asian countries adjust to classroom practices in U.S. schools?

Question No: 3 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Which of the following is characteristic of action research?

► Variables are tightly controlled.

► Results are generalizable.

► Results demonstrate cause-and-effect relationships.

► Data are usually qualitative.

http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_airasian_edresearch_7/5/1490/381508.cw/index.html
MCQ # 05

Question No: 4 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Research may differ along a series of dimensions. Which of the following may be applied to this statement?

► The level of manipulation used to elicit data collection.

► The data-collection technique.

► The type of data collected.

► Type, technique and manipulation of data collection.

http://www.uk.sagepub.com/breakwell/downloads/mcq/mcq_01/mcq_01.htm
MCQ # 06

Question No: 5 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Which of the following is NOT a drawback to free response items?

► Results from free response items take longer to analyze.

► Many participants tend not to answer free response items.

► Free response items allow participants to add information that was not directly requested.

► Many participants tend to be less truthful in free response items.

http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_airasian_edresearch_7/5/1490/381582.cw/index.html
MCQ # 15

AFAQ

Question No: 6 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

After you locate a source, you should write down all details of the reference, except**;**

- ► Volumes
- ► Full names of the authors
- ► Titles
- ► Price

After you locate a source, you should write down all details of the reference (full names of the authors, titles, volumes, issue, pages)
PAGE # 29

Question No: 7 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Which of the following is an example of a question about normative standards and values?

- ► How many workers are employed at this plant?
- ► What is your attitude towards the management at this plant?
- ► Do you always cast your vote in trade union elections?

http://www.oup.com/uk/orc/bin/9780199284986/01student/cqs/ch10/
MCQ # 03

- ► Are you aware of the main features of the European Union Directive for informing and consulting employees?

Question No: 8 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Which of the following is NOT an example of a problem with using social survey research to investigate behaviour?

- ► Respondents tend to answer by giving the most socially desirable answer.
- ► Respondents may inadvertently omit key terms in the question.
- ► Respondents may not give an honest reply to what they see as a threatening question.
- ► Respondents may be unwilling to reveal information as they believe they are likely to be identified.

http://www.oup.com/uk/orc/bin/9780199284986/01student/cqs/ch11/
MCQ # 01

Question No: 9 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Which of the following is an example of a dilemma that might face feminist business researchers conducting qualitative interviews with women?

- ► What role to adopt while interviewing male managers?
- ► How many female employees should be interviewed for a representative sample?
- ► How to overcome the issue of false consciousness?

http://www.oup.com/uk/orc/bin/9780199284986/01student/cqs/ch18/
MCQ # 09

AIAQ

► What data to use while publishing findings?

Question No: 10 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Which of the following is NOT characteristic of qualitative data?

► Rich descriptions
► Concise

http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_airasian_edresearch_8/38/9871/2527149.cw/content/index#topofquiz1
MCQ # 02

► Voluminous
► Unorganized

Question No: 11 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Why is describing the context equally, as important aspect of qualitative data analysis as is describing the participants?

► Descriptions of context are more objective than descriptions of participants.
► Descriptions of context are based on facts, not perceptions.
► Participants' behavior cannot be separated from the context in which it occurs.

http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_airasian_edresearch_8/38/9871/2527206.cw/index.html
MCQ # 04

► Participants are the context.

Question No: 12 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Which one is not the part of non reactive research?

► Physical traces
► Archives
► Observations
► Interviews

Varieties of Non-Reactive Observations
Physical Traces:
Archives:
Observations:
PAGE 124

Question No: 13 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

The information gained by someone other than researcher conducting the study is called _____.

► Primary data
► Reliable data
► Valid data
► Secondary data

AFAIQ

Secondary data refer to information gathered by someone other than the researcher conducting the present study.
PAGE # 131

Question No: 14 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Which of the following is **not** an example of historical comparative research?

- ► Social Forms
- ► Economic Forms
- ► Civil Wars
- ► Turnover

PAGE # 142,143

Question No: 15 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Which of the following would you recommend to a graduate student to ensure the quality of his research report?

- ► Write a detailed explanation of the methods used to investigate the problem.
- ► Explicitly state underlying assumptions related to the topic.
- ► Acknowledge the limitations of generalizability while assisting the reader in understanding the transferability of the findings.
- ► Detailed method, assumptions and limitation.

http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_airasian_edresearch_7/5/1490/381491.cw/index.html
MCQ # 02

Question No: 16 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

In which of the following Tests, we usually go for personal interviewing to test the questionnaire?

- ► Test Run
- ► Pilot Test

Pilot testing also called pre-testing means small scale trial run of a particular component; here we are referring to pilot testing of the questionnaire.
PAGE # 80

- ► Post Hoc Test
- ► T- Test

Question No: 17 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

In which of the following Tests, we should come to know, does a questionnaire look like an integrated unit?

- ► Test Run
- ► Pilot Test

AFAQ

PAGE # 80, 81
A pilot plant would be a way of testing the integrated unit, studying its operational problems, testing design

- ► Post Hoc Test
- ► T- Test

Question No: 18 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Which of the following is that element or set of elements considered for selection in some stage of sampling?

- ► Parameter
- ► Sampling Unit

A sampling unit is that element or set of elements considered for selection in some stage of sampling.
PAGE 89

- ► Observation Unit
- ► Statistic

Question No: 19 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

If you are going on the street and suddenly a TV reporter starts taking your interview regarding any issue, which of the following sampling technique is used by the TV reporter?

- ► Purposive Sampling
- ► Snowball Sampling
- ► Convenience Sampling

Convenience Sampling
Convenience sampling (also called *haphazard or accidental sampling*) refers to sampling by obtaining units or people who are most conveniently available. For example, it may be convenient and economical to sample employees in companies in a nearby area, sample from a pool of friends and neighbors. The person-on-the street interview conducted by TV programs is another example. TV interviewers go on the street with camera and microphone to talk to few people who are convenient to interview. The people walking past a TV studio in thee middle of the day do not represent everyone (homemakers, people in the rural areas). Likewise, TV interviewers select people who look “normal” to them and avoid people who are unattractive, poor, very old, or inarticulate.
PAGE # 90

- ► Quota Sampling

Question No: 20 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Sampling in qualitative research is similar to which type of sampling in quantitative research?

VUFAQ

- ► Simple random sampling
- ► Systematic sampling
- ► Quota sampling
- ► Purposive sampling

Sampling in qualitative research is similar to which type of sampling in quantitative research?

It is similar to purposive sampling

http://www.google.com.pk/#sclient=psy&hl=en&biw=800&bih=411&q=Sampling+in+qualitative+research+is+similar+to+Purposive+sampling&aq=&aqi=&aql=&oq=&pbx=1&fp=791244bbdd532714

AFTER OPEN DA LINK CLICK ON 1ST [DOC] *Sampling* in Quantitative, *Qualitative*, and Mixed - Chapter 9 ...

Question No: 21 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Which of the following **is NOT** a type of Non-random sampling?

- ► Cluster sampling

PAGE # 90, 91, AND 93

- ► Convenience sampling
- ► Quota sampling
- ► Purposive sampling

Question No: 22 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Historical-Comparative researchers sometimes use;

- ► Time-series data
- ► Primary data
- ► Secondary data

Historical-comparative researchers often use secondary sources or different data types in combination

PAGE # 151

- ► Analyzed data

Question No: 23 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Which of the following refers to the partials replicate or reproduce the same relationship that existed in the bivariate table before considering the control variable?

- ► Replication pattern

The replication pattern is the easiest to understand. It is when the partials replicate or reproduce the same relationship that existed in the bivariate table before considering the control variable.

AFAAQ

PAGE # 110

- Specification pattern
- Suppressor variable pattern
- Negative linear relationship

Question No: 24 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

As a researcher you need **Not** to;

- Master the literature
- Take numerous detailed notes
- Create a bibliography list
- Learn your findings

As the researcher masters the literature and takes numerous detailed notes, he or she completes many specific tasks: creating a bibliography list
PAGE # 147

Question No: 25 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Which of the following relates with an abstract model of underlying relations or causal mechanism?

- Analysis
- Synthesis

Synthesis links specific evidence with an abstract model of underlying relations or causal mechanism.
PAGE # 148

- Results
- Findings

Question No: 26 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Which of the following control techniques available to the researcher, controls both known and unknown variables?

- Building the extraneous variable into the design
- Matching
- Random assignment

Random assignment is the most important technique that can be used to control confounding variables because it has the ability to control for both known and unknown confounding extraneous variables.
http://www.southalabama.edu/coe/bset/johnson/lectures/lec9.htm

VUAAQ

► Analysis of covariance

Question No: 27 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Which of the following is more operational with the help of coding system?

► External Appearance
► Count Behaviors
► Content analysis

Constructs in content analysis are operationalizing with a *coding system*, a set of instructions or rules on how to systematically observe and record content from text.
Page # 126

► Time Duration

Question No: 28 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

What is the particular advantage of secondary analysis to business students?

► It is less challenging intellectually
► It guarantees positive results
► It is less expensive and less time consuming than primary analysis

http://www.oup.com/uk/orc/bin/9780199284986/01student/cqs/ch13/

AFAAQ

MCQ # 02

- ► It enables students to gain experience of the workplace

Question No: 29 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Which of the following similarity is found in Qualitative research and Survey research?

- ► Examine topics primarily from the participants' perspectives
- ► They are guided by predetermined variables to study.
- ► They are descriptive research methods.

http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_airasian_edresearch_7/5/1490/381582.cw/index.html
MCQ # 03

- ► Have large sample sizes.

Question No: 30 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

A single element or group of elements that is eligible for selection via the sampling process is called a:

- ► Sampling panel
- ► Sampling unit

A sampling unit is that element or set of elements considered for selection in some stage of sampling.
PAGE # 89

- ► Sampling error
- ► Sampling quota

Question No: 31 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Codes are rules for_____data.

- ► Classifying
- ► Interpreting
- ► Recording
- ► All of the given options

ALTHOUGH CODES ARE GENERALLY CONSIDERED TO BE NUMERICAL SYMBOLS, THEY ARE MORE BROADLY DEFINED AS THE RULES FOR INTERPRETING, CLASSIFYING, AND RECORDING DATA.
PAGE # 99

Question No: 32 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Which of the following contain the captions for the rows of a table?

- ► Boxheads
- ► Footnotes
- ► Source notes

AFAQ

- None of the given options

A table may contain a caption, row groups, and column groups. A row group contains rows, while a column group contains columns. Rows and columns contain cells. Tables are rendered as layers in a specified order from the bottom up: table, column groups, columns, row groups, rows, and cells.
http://reference.sitepoint.com/css/tableformatting

Question No: 33 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

The experimental design that uses one-group, a treatment, and a posttest is called _____.

- One-shot case study design

One-shot Case Study Design: Also called the one-group posttest-only design, the one-shot case study design has only one group, a treatment, and a posttest
PAGE #117

- Pretest posttest control group design
- Solomon four-group design
- One-group pretest posttest design

Question No: 34 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

When a researcher tries to say that the results of a test market in Karachi will hold in a national rollout of the new product, this researcher is concerned with:

- Internal validity
- The repeated measures effect
- Constant error
- External validity

External validity is the ability to generalize experimental findings to real life situations.
PAGE 122

Question No: 35 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Obtaining secondary data is typically_____and_____expensive than obtaining primary data.

- Faster; more
- Slower; more
- Faster; less

Page # 131

- Slower; less

AFAAQ

Question No: 36 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Which of the following is a disadvantage of secondary data?

- ► User has no control over their reliability and validity
- ► Inability to convert the data
- ► Typically require additional access to research respondents
- ► All of the given options

Question No: 37 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

The study of documents used by writers is a method of_____.

- ► In-depth analysis
- ► Time series analysis
- ► Regression analysis
- ► None of the given options

Content analysis is also the study of documents through which the writers try to communicate, though some of the documents (like population census) may simply contain figures.
Page # 129

Question No: 38 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Historical-Comparative research focuses on:

- ► Its broad historical processes
- ► Comparing forms
- ► Tracing the development of social forms
- ► All of the given options

Historical-Comparative research focuses on:
• Tracing the development of social forms (patterns) overtime as well as its broad its broad historical processes, and
• Comparing those forms and its developmental processes across cultures (countries/nations).
Page # 142

Question No: 39 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

When a manufacturer studies his most successful retailer in depth in order to determine some better ideas for displaying bicycles in its retail stores, this is an example of:

- ► An experiment
- ► A test market
- ► A case study

Case study: It is an in-depth analysis of a unit which could be an individual person, a couple, a group, or an organization
PAGE # 38

VUAO

► Causal research

Question No: 40 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

An interview conducted by a trained moderator among a small group of respondents in an unstructured and natural manner is a_____.

► Depth interview
► Focus group

Focus group an interview conducted by a trained moderator among a small group of respondents in an unstructured and natural manner

http://books.google.com.pk/books?id=TKb8iORscegC&pg=PA145&lpg=PA145&dq=An+interview+conducted+by+a+trained+moderator+among+a+small+group+of+respondents+in+an+unstructured+and+natural+manner+is+a+Focus+group&source=bl&ots=xSwXM_YgdX&sig=vsawE2ctZCs4EW_ajLWVzulC8yY&hl=en&ei=aaVOTZqoKtOChQed3Jm-Dg&sa=X&oi=book_result&ct=result&resnum=2&ved=0CBwQ6AEwAQ#v=onepage&q=An%20interview%20conducted%20by%20a%20trained%20moderator%20among%20a%20small%20group%20of%20respondents%20in%20an%20unstructured%20and%20natural%20manner%20is%20a%20Focus%20group&f=false

► Case study
► None of the given options

Question No: 41 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Which of the following represents this reference: **Riley, T., & Brecht, M. L. (1998). *The success in mentoring process.* In R. Williams (Ed.) *Mentoring and career success.* pp. 129-150. New York: Wilson Press.**

► Edited book

► Book by a single author
► Book by more than one author
► Chapter in an edited book

Chapter in an edited book
This is an article written by single or multiple authors and is printed in the edited book.
Riley, T., & Brecht, M. L. (1998). The success in mentoring process. In R. Williams (Ed.) *Mentoring and career success.* pp. 129-150. New York: Wilson Press.
Page # 165

Question No: 42 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Following are the characteristics of the research **EXCEPT:**

► Systematic

AIAQ

- Data based
- Subjective approach

Research may be considered as an organized, systematic, data based, critical, objective, scientific inquiry
Page # 02

- Scientific inquiry

Question No: 43 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

A variable that is likely to develop with the passage of time between the independent and dependent variable is called:

- Moderating Variable
- Intervening Variable

Intervening Variables
A basic causal relationship requires only independent and dependent variable.
Page # 20

- Confounding Variable
- Predictor Variable

Question No: 44 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Which type of research is involved in preliminary data collection stage?

- Descriptive
- Exploratory

Preliminary Data Collection
This step may be considered as part of the exploratory research.
Page # 36

- Explanatory
- Cannot be determined at this stage of research

Question No: 45 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Which one of the following is **NOT** a type of scales used in measurement of concepts?

- Normal Scale

It is traditional to classify scales of measurement on the basis of the mathematical comparisons that are allowable with these scales. Four types of scales are nominal, ordinal, interval, and ratio.
Page # 53

- Ordinal Scale
- Interval scale
- Ratio Scale

Question No: 46 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

A measure is reliable if it provides consistent_____.

AIAO

- Hypothesis
- Results

A measure is reliable if it provides consistent results

http://books.google.com.pk/books?id=Cf1D0DvWXI8C&pg=PA364&lpg=PA364&dq=A+measure+is+reliable+if+it+provides+consistent+results&source=bl&ots=lbSOKx-1DA&sig=boaxoP-O26BcJezqkZ-0El29dOs&hl=en&ei=uKlOTeO9HaOShAeI5ZGBBg&sa=X&oi=book_result&ct=result&resnum=3&ved=0CCUQ6AEwAg#v=onepage&q=A%20measure%20is%20reliable%20if%20it%20provides%20consistent%20results&f=false

- Procedure
- Sensitivity

Question No: 47 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Which of the following typically does NOT apply to observers in survey research studies?

- They observe predetermined activities.
- They are participant observers.

http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_airasian_edresearch_7/5/1490/381582.cw/index.html
MCQ # 09

- They obtain information by watching rather than asking.
- They must be careful not to influence the activities they observe.

Question No: 48 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Which of the following is NOT a longitudinal study?

- Panel study
- Trend study
- Cohort study
- Census study

http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_airasian_edresearch_7/5/1490/381582.cw/index.html
MCQ # 12

Question No: 49 (Marks: 3)

Do you think that case studies are empirical? Explain.

Question No: 50 (Marks: 3)

How would you differentiate between **History Effect** and **Mechanical Loss** in Experimental research?

Question No: 51 (Marks: 5)

Write a note on any three varieties of non reactive observations.

AIAAQ

Question No: 52 (Marks: 5)

In research process, once you collect the data, how would you perform the scoring index activity? Explain it with the help of example.

Question No: 53 (Marks: 5)

You want to explore females' cosmetic preferences. How would you prepare focus group study for this topic?

FINALTERM EXAMINATION
Spring 2010
Afaaq_tariq@yahoo.com
STA630- Research Methods (Session - 3)

Time: 90 min
Marks: 69

Student Info	
StudentID:	
Center:	
ExamDate:	

For Teacher's Use Only									
Q No.	**1**	**2**	**3**	**4**	**5**	**6**	**7**	**8**	**Total**
Marks									
Q No.	**9**	**10**	**11**	**12**	**13**	**14**	**15**	**16**	
Marks									
Q No.	**17**	**18**	**19**	**20**	**21**	**22**	**23**	**24**	
Marks									
Q No.	**25**	**26**	**27**	**28**	**29**	**30**	**31**	**32**	
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Q No.	**33**	**34**	**35**	**36**	**37**	**38**	**39**	**40**	
Marks									
Q No.	**41**	**42**	**43**	**44**	**45**	**46**	**47**	**48**	

AFAAQ

Marks									
Q No.	**49**	**50**	**51**	**52**	**53**				
Marks									

AFAAQ

Question No: 1 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

The part of the action research spiral that differentiates this research methodology from other kinds of research is;

- ► Looking at multiple sources of data.
- ► Taking action based on results.

http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_airasian_edresearch_7/5/1490/381555.cw/index.html
MCQ # 6

- ► Thinking about or analyzing data in more than one way.
- ► The kinds of data that are collected.

Question No: 2 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

If a researcher was studying the use of various instructional approaches to the "multiple intelligences" of his students, he is likely to be conducting which of the following type of research?

- ► Basic
- ► Evaluation
- ► Applied

http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_airasian_edresearch_8/38/9865/2525631.cw/index.html#topofquiz1
MCQ # 1

- ► Grounded theory

Question No: 3 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Which type of review compares how different theories address an issue?

- ► Context review
- ► Integrated review
- ► Methodological review
- ► Theoretical review

Theoretical reviews compare how different theories address an issue.
Page # 27

Question No: 4 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Which of the following functions is performed by theoretical framework?

- ► Elaborates the relationship among the variables.
- ► Explains the logic underlying these relationships.
- ► Describes the nature, and direction of the relationships.
- ► All of the given options.

AFAQ

Specifically a theoretical framework:
Elaborates the relationship among the variables
Explains the logic underlying these relationships
Describes the nature, and direction of the relationships

Page # 30

Question No: 5 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Panel and cohort designs differ in that:

► Cohort studies involve quantitative research, whereas panel studies are qualitative.
► A panel study does not need rules to handle new entrants to households.
► Only a cohort study will suffer from sample attrition.
► A panel study can distinguish between age effects and cohort effects, but a cohort design cannot.

Handouts page # 10
ii. *The panel study* is a powerful type of longitudinal research. In panel study, the researcher observes exactly the same people, group, or organization across time periods. It is a difficult to carry out such study. Tracking people over time is often difficult because some people die or cannot be located. Nevertheless, the results of a well-designed panel study are very valuable.
iii. A cohort analysis is similar to the panel study, but rather than observing the exact same people, a category of people who share a similar life experience in a specified time period is studied. The focus is on the cohort, or category, not on specific individuals. Commonly used cohorts include all people born in the same year (called birth cohorts), all people hired at the same time, all people retire on one or two year time frame, and all people who graduate in a given year. Unlike panel studies, researchers do not have to locate the exact same people for cohort studies. The only need to identify those who experienced a common life event.

And

http://www.oup.com/uk/orc/bin/9780199202959/01student/cqs/ch02/?view=za
MCQ # 9

Question No: 6 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Which of the following would LEAST likely be a data source for an action research study of "teachers' questioning techniques in social studies classes"?

► Classroom observation
► Student questionnaires
► Videotaping of classes
► Students' standardized test scores

http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_airasian_edresearch_7/5/1490/381508.cw/index.html
MCQ # 9

Question No: 7 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Which of the following represents excellent advice for conducting an interview?

- ► Listen more and talk less
- ► Don't interrupt
- ► Don't be judgmental about the interviewee's beliefs or views
- ► All of the given options

[PPT]
Qualitative Research Methods

Question No: 8 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Why should a business researcher record and transcribe interviews?

- ► It overcomes all possible ethical considerations.
- ► The response of participants can be more readily shared with senior management.
- ► It allows a more thorough examination of what the interviewee has said.

http://www.oup.com/uk/orc/bin/9780199284986/01student/cqs/ch18/
MCQ # 7

- ► It allows the researcher to demonstrate his/her technical proficiency.

Question No: 9 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

The Pearson product moment correlation is used to demonstrate the relationship between;

- ► Two continuous variables

http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_airasian_edresearch_7/5/1490/381655.cw/index.html
MCQ # 11

- ► Two rank-ordered variables
- ► Variables that are expected to be curvilinearly related
- ► Dichotomous variables

Question No: 10 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

The statistic used to determine the relationship between two variables is:

- ► Analysis of covariance
- ► Chi square
- ► Standard deviation
- ► Pearson "*r*"

http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_airasian_edresearch_7/5/1491/381743.cw/index.htmlQuestionNo:11
MCQ # 17

Question No: 11 (Marks: 1) http://vustudents.ning.com - Please choose one

Researchers organize data into all of the following, EXCEPT:

- ► Field
- ► Table

APAQ

Page # 99
Researchers organize data into fields, records, and files.

- ► Record
- ► File

Question No: 12 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Which of the following is NOT a necessary step in conducting experimental research?

- ► Manipulation of an independent variable
- ► Selection of measuring instruments
- ► Creating a hypothesis stating a causal relationship between variables
- ► Dividing the sample into subgroups to control for extraneous variables

http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_airasian_edresearch_7/5/1491/381867.cw/index.html
MCQ # 02

Question No: 13 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Testing most likely, negatively affect internal validity when:

- ► The information tested is attitudinal in nature
- ► The time between pre- and posttest is short

http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_airasian_edresearch_7/5/1491/381876.cw/index.html
MCQ # 2

- ► The instrument is unreliable
- ► The participants are very low scorers

Question No: 14 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Which of the following questions can be answered using content analysis?

- ► How do managers behave in the face of employment insecurity?
- ► How do the media report corporate re-branding exercises?

http://www.oup.com/uk/orc/bin/9780199284986/01student/cqs/ch12/
MCQ # 01

- ► What effect does organizational size have on marketing strategy?
- ► What are the most popular leisure activities amongst the over-50s?

Question No: 15 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Which one is not the part of non reactive research?

- ► Physical traces
- ► Archives
- ► Observations
- ► Interviews

PAGE # 124
Varieties of Non-Reactive Observations
Physical Traces:
Archives:

AIAQ

Observations:

Question No: 16 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

On which component of his field notes did Mr. Majid focused when he expressed in his notes his thoughts and ideas about what he observed?

► Description
► Reflection

http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_airasian_edresearch_7/5/1489/381392.cw/index.html
MCQ # 01

► Protocol
► Formal data

Question No: 17 (Marks: 1) http://vustudents.ning.com - Please choose one

Which of the following is linked with an abstract model of underlying relations or causal mechanism?

► Historical comparative research PAGE # 148

Synthesis links specific evidence with an abstract model of underlying relations or causal mechanism.

► Social research
► Action research
► Experimental research

Question No: 18 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Historians organize evidence usually in:

► Comparative form
► Narrative form

PAGE # 152

Historians organize evidence as they write works of history. They often write *narrative history*.

► Logical form
► Critical form

Question No: 19 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

What is the difference between a focus group and a group interview?

► A focus group is used to analyse group interaction, whereas a group interview is used as a straight forward data collection tool.

MCQ # 1
http://www.oup.com/uk/orc/bin/9780199284986/01student/cqs/ch19/

► A focus group is used only for political research, whereas group interviews are more widely used in the social sciences.
► A focus group is used at the planning stage of a research project, whereas a group interview is part of the actual data collection.

AFAQ

► **A focus group is used to discuss a wide range of issues, whereas a group interview looks at one specific topic.**

Question No: 20 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

In which component of the method section would you find a discussion of validity and reliability?

► Participants
► Instruments

http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_airasian_edresearch_7/5/1487/380850.cw/site_search_frame/index.html

► Design
► Procedures

Question No: 21 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Which of the following sampling is least reliable but normally the cheapest and easiest to conduct?

► Purposive Sampling
► Snowball Sampling
► Convenience Sampling

Convenience samples are least reliable but normally the cheapest and easiest to conduct
P # 90

► Quota Sampling

Question No: 22 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Which of the following sampling is most often used during the exploratory phase of a research project and is perhaps the best way of getting some basic information quickly and efficiently?

► Convenience Sampling

Convenience sampling is most often used during the exploratory phase of a research project and is perhaps the best way of getting some basic information quickly and efficiently.
P # 90

► Quota Sampling
► Snowball Sampling
► Purposive Sampling

Question No: 23 (Marks: 1) http://vustudents.ning.com- Please choose one

Which of the following is a form of Non-random sampling?

► Snowball sampling
► Convenience sampling
► Quota sampling

AIAQ

► All of the given option

PAGE # 90
OR
Nonrandom Sampling Techniques
The other major type of sampling used in quantitative research is nonrandom sampling (i.e., when you do not use one of the ransom sampling techniques). There are four main types of nonrandom sampling:
The first type of nonrandom sampling is called convenience sampling
The second type of nonrandom sampling is called quota sampling
The third type of nonrandom sampling is called purposive sampling
The fourth type of nonrandom sampling is called snowball sampling
http://www.southalabama.edu/coe/bset/johnson/lectures/lec7.htm
OR
http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Nonprobability_sampling

Question No: 24 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Sampling in qualitative research is similar to which type of sampling in quantitative research?

► Simple random sampling
► Systematic sampling
► Quota sampling
► Purposive sampling PAGE # 90

Question No: 25 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Which of the following relates with an abstract model of underlying relations or causal mechanism?

► Analysis
► Synthesis

Synthesis links specific evidence with an abstract model of underlying relations or causal mechanism.
PAGE # 148

► Results
► Findings

Question No: 26 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

The easiest way to describe the numerical data of one variable is;

► Frequency distribution

The easiest way to describe the numerical data of one variable is with a frequency distribution.
PAGE # 104

AFAAQ

- ► Normal distribution
- ► Poisson distribution
- ► Probability distribution

Question No: 27 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

All of the following are ways to show a table in percentages, EXCEPT;

- ► By margins

There are three ways to percentage a table: by row, by column, and for the total.
Page # 107

- ► By row
- ► By column
- ► For the total

Question No: 28 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Which of the following is **True** for survey research?

- ► Survey research is a subset of experimental research.
- ► Survey research is often used in experimental research.

http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_airasian_edresearch_7/5/1490/381582.cw/index.html
MCQ # 2

- ► Survey research is never used in experimental research.
- ► Survey research is always used in experimental research.

Question No: 29 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

When an interviewer unintentionally and mistakenly checks the wrong response on a checklist during an interview, this is an example of:

- ► Social desirability bias
- ► Interviewer error

A type of non-sampling error caused by mistakes made by the interviewer These may include influencing the respondent in some way, asking questions in the wrong order, or sing slightly different phrasing (or tone of voice) than other interviewers.

- ► Interviewer cheating
- ► Sponsorship bias

Question No: 30 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

When an interviewer asks a respondent: "Why do you shop at Liberty's department store?" this is an example of a:

- ► Unstructured question
- ► Structured question
- ► Disguised question
- ► Social desirability question

AFAQ

Question No: 31 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

All of the following are stages in the selection of a sample **EXCEPT**:

- ► Determine sample size
- ► Analyze data

Stages in the Selection of a Sample
Step 1: Define the target population
Step 2: Select The Sampling Frame
Step 3: Probability OR Non-probability?
Step 4: Plan Selection of sampling units
Step 5: Determine Sample Size
Step 6: Select Sampling units
Step 7: Conduct Fieldwork

- ► Conduct fieldwork
- ► Select a sampling frame

Question No: 32 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Codes are rules for_____data.

- ► Classifying
- ► Interpreting
- ► Recording
- ► All of the given options

Although codes are generally considered to be numerical symbols, they are more broadly defined as the rules for interpreting, classifying, and recording data
PAGE # 99

Question No: 33 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

When a competitor introduces a 25% price cut in order to blunt the effect of a test marketing study, this is an example of a:

- ► Maturation

effect PAGE 120
Maturation Effect: Cause and effect relationship can also be contaminated by the effects of the passage of time – another uncontrollable variable. Such contamination is called Maturation effect.

- ► Testing effect
- ► History effect
- ► Cohort effect

Question No: 34 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

All of the following elements of Observation is/are included in Non Reactive research **EXCEPT**:

AIAAQ

► Count Behaviors
► Time Duration
► **External Appearance**
► Other Records

PAGE # 124
Observations:
• ***External Appearance:*** How people appear may indicate social factors. For example, researcher watches students to see whether they are more likely to wear their college's colors and symbols after the college team won or lost.
• ***Count Behaviors:*** Counting how many people do something can be informative. For example researcher may count the number of men and women who come to a full stop and those who come to a rolling stop at a traffic stop sign. This suggests gender difference in driving behavior.
• ***Time Duration:*** How long people take to do things may indicate their intention. For example
a researcher may measure how long men and women pause in front of a particular painting.
Time taken may indicate their interest in the painting.

Question No: 35 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Which of the following element is not included for behavioral observation?

► Space
► **Direction**
► Frequency
► Accretion

PAGE # 126

Question No: 36 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

The study of documents used by writers is a method of_____.

► In-depth analysis
► Time series analysis
► Regression analysis
► None of the given options

Content analysis is also the study of documents through which the writers try to communicate, though some of the documents (like population census) may simply contain figures.
Page # 129

Question No: 37 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

AFAAC

When a manufacturer studies his most successful retailer in depth in order to determine some better ideas for displaying bicycles in its retail stores, this is an example of:

- ► An experiment
- ► A test market
- ► A case study

Case study: It is an in-depth analysis of a unit which could be an individual person, a couple, a group, or an organization
PAGE # 38

- ► Causal research

Question No: 38 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

The written set of guidelines that describes an outline of topics to be covered by a focus group moderator is called a:

- ► Discussion guide PAGE 155

OR
A detailed written outline of topics the moderator will cover during a focus group discussion.

- ► Concept test
- ► Case study
- ► All of the given options

Question No: 39 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Which of the following is a disadvantage of focus groups?

- ► Requires objective, sensitive, and effective moderators
- ► May not be useful for discussing sensitive topics
- ► High cost
- ► All of the given options

Disadvantages of Focus Groups
Require objective, sensitive, and effective moderators.
May have unique sampling problems.
May not be useful for discussing sensitive topics in face-to-face situations.
Cost a considerable amount of money, particularly when they are not conducted by someone employed by the company desiring the focus group.
Higher cost

Question No: 40 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Which section of a report gives a summary of the contents, including the purpose, description of the participants, the results, and any conclusions being offered?

AFAQ

► Methodology
► **Introduction**
► Abstract

An *abstract* is a summary of a body of information. Sometimes, abstracts are in fact called summaries—sometimes, executive summaries or executive abstracts. There are different kinds of abstracts—your technical report uses two types: the descriptive abstract and the informative abstract.
OR HANDOUTS PAGE 161

► Letter of transmittal

Question No: 41 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Which of the following characteristic of the scientific method is defined as the confirmation or refutation of the observation through the scientific method by using sensory experience?

► **Empirical**
► Verifiable

Verifiable
Observations made through scientific method are to be verified again by using the senses to confirm or refute the previous findings
PAGE # 04

► Observable
► Cumulative

Question No: 42 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Basic research can also be called as

► Practical research
► Fundamental Research

Basic research (also called academic research or pure research or fundamental research).
PAGE # 08

► Action research
► Assessment research

Question No: 43 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Which of the following statement is true about the peer review?

► Name of the article's author is not mentioned to avoid biases
► It should be accepted
► It should be published in a well known journal
► **Name of the author should be mentioned for the further correspondence**

Question No: 44 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

After making the inventory of the relevant variables the next step is to:

AIAQ

- Provide logic for the relationship
- Make inventory of the propositions
- Identify the relationships between the variables

In the discussions the relevant variables are identified, and relationships are postulated. Once the variables are identified, the same focus group discussions help in the formulation of questions, along with the response categories, for the measurement of variables.
PAGE # 156

- Deduce hypothesis

Question No: 45 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Theoretical framework helps to:

- Deduce the hypothesis
- Reject the hypothesis
- Test the hypothesis

From the theoretical framework, then, testable hypotheses can be developed to examine whether theory formulated is valid or not. The hypothesized relationships can thereafter be tested through appropriate statistical analysis.
PAGE # 30

- Accept the hypothesis

Question No: 46 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Which of the following is NOT a method of narrowing a topic?

- Literature review
- Specifying the context
- Talk to the experts
- Pilot testing

Techniques for Narrowing a Topic into a Research Question
1. Examine the literature.
2. Talk over ideas with others.
3. Apply to a specific context.
4. Define the aim or desired outcome of the study.
PAGE # 33

Question No: 47 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

The working definition of the variables is called:

- Theoretical definition
- Dictionary definition
- Operational definition

AIAQ

Operational definition is also called a *working definition* stated in terms of specific testing or measurement criteria.
PAGE # 18

- ► Fundamental definition

Question No: 48 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Which of the following characteristic is reflected by an interval scale?

- ► The distance between each participant's individual scores.
- ► Arithematic operations can be performed after data collection
- ► Classify the data into exclusive categories
- ► All of the given options

http://books.google.com/books?id=eNsVUGTMcDoC&pg=PA138&dq=characteristic+is+reflected+by+an+interval+scale&hl=en&ei=pD5mTJH9MojRcfiPva0P&sa=X&oi=book_result&ct=result&resnum=1&ved=0CCkQ6AEwAA#v=onepage&q=characteristic%20is%20reflected%20by%20an%20interval%20scale&f=false

Question No: 49 (Marks: 3)

What is the logic of field research? How does a field researcher work?

Question No: 50 (Marks: 3)

Historical-Comparative research focuses on some factors, list down those factors?

Question No: 51 (Marks: 5)

Briefly describe the type of observation you would use, the field notes you would develop, and some general principles you would follow to ensure successful data collection.

Question No: 52 (Marks: 5)

What are the functions of a recorder? http://vustudents.ning.com

Question No: 53 (Marks: 5)

Briefly discuss the importance of Data Transformation in Research with the help of example?

FINALTERM EXAMINATION
Spring 2009
AFAAQ_TARIQ@YAHOO.COM
STA630- Research Methods (Session - 1)

AFAAQ

Marks: 80

Question No: 1 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
Which of the following is NOT an assumption of action research?

Action researchers have basic research skills to collect and analyze data.
All professionals need and want feedback on their performance.
Results enable the researchers to evaluate the performance of others.

http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_airasian_edresearch_7/5/1490/381508.cw/index.html
MCQ # 06
Teachers are capable of assuming responsibility for their own professional growth.

Question No: 2 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
Which of the following statements it TRUE for operational definition?

It is one that bears no relation to the underlying concept.
It is an abstract, theoretical definition of a concept
A definition of a concept in terms of specific and empirical measures

http://www.oup.com/uk/orc/bin/9780199202959/01student/cqs/ch06/
MCQ # 01
HANDOUTS PAGE # 18 & 50

It is one that refers to opera singers and their work.

Question No: 3 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
Which of the following statements best defines hypothesis?

A quantitative study
A tentative prediction of the results of the research

http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_airasian_edresearch_8/38/9865/2525651.cw/content/index
MCQ @ 24
A qualitative research design
The operational definition of the study

Question No: 4 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
When the research starts from the effects and tracing the reasons back in time, what does it called?

Case study

AFAAQ

It is more like a clinical analysis in retrospect; starting from the effect and tracing the reasons back in time. The researcher takes the history of the situation and makes use of any other relevant information about the case to identify the factors leading to the present situation

Page # 38

Experiment
Observation studies
Historical comparitive research

Question No: 5 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

The extent to which a test provides scores that are meaningful, appropriate, or useful is referred to as;

Reliability
Accuracy
Internal validity
Validity

http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_airasian_edresearch_8/38/9866/2525945.cw/content/index
MCQ # 18
HANDOUTS PAGE # 55

Question No: 6 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Mr. Hasan s son has applied to a high school in Florida, but the application was denied solely on his low score on the Iowa Test of Basic Skills (ITBS). His son wants to attend this school and contends his current grades and other standardized test scores speak well to both his past work and future academic capability. Which of the following characteristics of the ITBS is being questioned by this student?

Construct validity
Content validity
Predictive validity

Predictive validity:
Criterion validity whereby an indicator predicts future events that are logically related to a construct is called a predictive validity.
PAGE # 56
Concurrent validity

Question No: 7 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Internal consistency estimates of reliability such as the KR-20 or Cronbach's alpha are used more frequently than other estimates such as test-retest or parallel forms because internal consistency estimates;

Are easily calculated
Require only one administration of a test

AIAAQ

http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_airasian_edresearch_7/5/1489/381232.cw/index.html
MCQ # 05
Are more accurate than all other types of estimates
Are usually higher

Question No: 8 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
Which of the following functions is performed by the Odinal scale?

Categorize
Distance
Order

Ordinal Scale
Ordinal scales include the characteristics of the nominal scale plus an indicator of order.
PAGE # 53
Unique origin

Question No: 9 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
Which of the following is measured by the Interval scale?

Order of the object
Magnitude of the object
Categorize the object
All of the given options

On interval measurement scales, one unit on the scale represents the same magnitude on the trait or characteristic being measured across the whole range of the scale.
OR HANDOUTS PAGE # 53

Question No: 10 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
Following are the properties of nominal scale, except;

Least powerful
Suggest no order
Provide categorical information
Provide magnitude of object

Nominal Scale
A nominal scale is the one in which the numbers or letters assigned to objects serve as labels for identification or classification. This measurement scale is the simplest type. With nominal data, we are collecting information on a variable that naturally or by design can be grouped into two or more categories that are mutually exclusive, and collectively exhaustive.

ALAAQ

Nominal scales are the least powerful of the four scales. They suggest no order or distance relationship and have no arithmetic origin. Nevertheless, if no other scale can be used, one can almost always one set of properties into a set of equivalent classes.
PAGE # 53

Question No: 11 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
What is the difference between interval/ratio and ordinal variables?

Ordinal data can be rank ordered, but interval/ratio data cannot.
The distance between categories is equal across the range of interval/ration data.

http://www.oup.com/uk/orc/bin/9780199202959/01student/cqs/ch14/
MCQ # 01
Interval/ratio variables contain only two categories.
Ordinal variables have a fixed zero point, whereas interval/ratio variables do not.

Question No: 12 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
A study design in which the researcher might create_____ to establish cause-and-effect relationship is called Experimental Design.

An artificial setting, control some variables and manipulates the independent variable
A natural setting, control some variables and manipulates the dependent variables
An artificial setting, control some variables and manipulates the dependent variable
All of the given options

Question No: 13 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
Which of the following would LEAST likely be a data source for an action research study of "teachers' questioning techniques in social studies classes"?

Student questionnaires
Videotaping of classes
Students' standardized test scores

http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_airasian_edresearch_7/5/1490/381508.cw/index.html
MCQ # 09
Classroom observation

Question No: 14 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
Teachers are advised to predict the results of student attitudinal questionnaires, because;

It will help them decide if students answered truthfully.
It gives them a point of comparison against which to judge actual responses.

http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_airasian_edresearch_7/5/1490/381508.cw/index.html
MCQ # 10
It will allow them to apply statistical procedures in analyzing results.

AIOU

It helps them familiarize themselves with the questionnaires.

Question No: 15 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
Which of the following is an example of a question about normative standards and values?

How many workers are employed at this plant?
What is your attitude towards the management at this plant?
Do you always cast your vote in trade union elections?

http://www.oup.com/uk/orc/bin/9780199284986/01student/cqs/ch10/
MCQ # 03
Are you aware of the main features of the European Union Directive for informing and consulting employees?

Question No: 16 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
Questions that include negatives should be avoided because:

The respondent may miss out the negative word.
The respondent may be unsure how to answer if the question includes a double negative.
The respondent may be led by the question.
All of the given options.

http://www.oup.com/uk/orc/bin/9780199284986/01student/cqs/
OR
When using a Likert scale it can be difficult to avoid asking a question with a negative, however the researcher should attempt to avoid them if possible.

Question No: 17 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
Random assignment to treatment groups is characteristic of which kind of research?

Causal-comparative
Correlational
Experimental

PAGE # 114
OR
http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_airasian_edresearch_7/5/1491/381743.cw/index.html
MCQ # 05

Descriptive

Question No: 18 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
Which of the following is likely to happen if clear instructions are not given as to how the respondent should answer the question?

AIAQ

Respondents may delete inappropriate answers rather than select appropriate ones.
Respondents may choose only one answer when they need to choose as many as apply.
Respondents may complete questions that are not relevant to them.
All of the given options

http://www.oup.com/uk/orc/bin/9780199284986/01student/cqs/ch09/
MCQ # 07

Question No: 19 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
Which of the following is NOT an example of a problem with using social survey research to investigate behaviour?

Respondents tend to answer by giving the most socially desirable answer.
Respondents may inadvertently omit key terms in the question.
Respondents may not give an honest reply to what they see as a threatening question.
Respondents may be unwilling to reveal information as they believe they are likely to be identified.

http://www.oup.com/uk/orc/bin/9780199284986/01student/cqs/ch11/
MCQ # 01
OR
An advantage of social survey research is that the researcher can ensure that the anonymity of the respondent is maintained by administering the same questions to each individual.

Question No: 20 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
What is the main purpose of pilot testing?

To accumulate responses
To identify respondent
To identify potential problems

Pilot testing is to identify potential problems with the methods, logistics, and the questionnaire.
PAGE # 80
To evaluate the research

Question No: 21 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
Which of the following sampling strategies was used when the three students with the highest GPAs were selected?

Extreme case

http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_airasian_edresearch_7/5/1489/381384.cw/index.html
MCQ # 02

AFAQ

Snowball
Maximum variation
Normal case.

Question No: 22 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
Which of the following best describes qualitative data analysis?

It begins after all the data has been collected.
It is an ongoing, cyclic process integrated into all phases of research.

http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_airasian_edresearch_8/38/9871/2527149.cw/content/index.html
MCQ # 05
It is an awkward, haphazard process.
It builds from abstraction to specific, concrete examples

Question No: 23 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
Which of the following represents the most general conceptualization in qualitative data analysis?

Word
Topic
Category
Pattern

http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_airasian_edresearch_7/5/1490/381483.cw/index.html
MCQ # 01

Question No: 24 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
The control procedure that allows the researcher to determine the effect of the independent variable and the control variable on the dependent variable both separately and in combination is;

Analysis of covariance
Matching
Forming subgroups to represent all levels of the control variable

http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_airasian_edresearch_7/5/1491/381743.cw/index.htmlQuestionNo:11
MCQ # 08
Randomization

Question No: 25 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
Which of the following could NOT be a cause of variation in high school achievement?

AFAQ

Reading ability
Parental involvement
Teacher expectations
College attendance

http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_airasian_edresearch_7/5/1491/381743.cw/index.htmlQuestionNo:11
MCQ # 11

Question No: 26 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
In experimental research, what does a researcher manipulate?

At least one dependent variable
All variables
At least one independent variable

http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_airasian_edresearch_7/5/1491/381820.cw/index.html
MCQ # 01
OR
http://books.google.com.pk/books?id=j09b2rTVRsAC&pg=PA20&lpg#v=onepage&q&f=false

At least one independent variable and one dependent variable

Question No: 27 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
In an experimental study, "the effects of inclusion on academic self-concept of children with special needs", the researcher must control which of the following?

The selection of subjects but not their assignment to a treatment group
The selection and assignment of subjects

http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_airasian_edresearch_7/5/1491/381820.cw/index.html
MCQ # 04

The assignment of subjects to a treatment group but not their selection
Neither the selection nor assignment of subjects

Question No: 28 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
Ecological validity refers to:

The participants to whom results generalize
The instruments used to measure the independent and dependent variables
The internal validity of a study
The context to which results generalize

AIAO

http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_airasian_edresearch_8/38/9869/2526465.cw/index.html
MCQ # 01

Question No: 29 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
Many beginner researchers believe that research involves testing, treating, and testing again . This is an example of:

Comparison group research
Quasi-experimental research
True experimental research
Pre-experimental research

http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_airasian_edresearch_7/5/1491/381820.cw/index.html
MCQ # 15

Question No: 30 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
Single-subject research is LEAST concerned with:

Clinical significance
Internal validity
Validity of measuring instruments
External validity

http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_airasian_edresearch_7/5/1491/381820.cw/index.html
MCQ # 18

Question No: 31 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
On which component of his field notes did Mr. Majid focused when he expressed in his notes his thoughts and ideas about what he observed?

Description
Reflection

http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_airasian_edresearch_7/5/1487/380850.cw/site_search_frame/index.html
Protocol
Formal data

Question No: 32 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
In which section is the researcher allowed greater flexibility to express opinions, discuss implications for educational practice, and suggest additional research?

Review of the literature

AFAQ

Significance of the study
Results
Discussion

http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_airasian_edresearch_7/5/1492/382157.cw/index.html
MCQ # 07

Question No: 33 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
Determining the sample interval (represented by K), randomly selecting a number between 1 to K, and including each K element in your sample are the steps for which form of sampling?

Simple Random Sampling
Stratified Random Sampling
Systematic Sampling

Systematic sampling
Simple or stratified in nature
Systematic in the "picking-up" of element. E.g. every 5th. visitor, every 10th. House, every 15th. minute
Steps:
* Number the population (1,…,N)
* Decide on the sample size, n
* Decide on the interval size, k = N/n
* Select an integer between 1 and k
* Take case for every kth.

unit Cluster sampling

Question No: 34 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
A focus group session is ideally for;

1 hour
1 and half hour

Duration, a focus group session typically lasts up to an hour and a half.
PAGE # 155
2 hours
More than 2 hours

Question No: 35 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
In an experimental research study, the primary goal is to isolate and identify the effect produced by which of the following?

Dependent variable
Extraneous variable
Independent variable

AFAAQ

http://www.southalabama.edu/coe/bset/johnson/mcq/mc9.htm
MCQ # 23
Confounding variable

Question No: 36 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
Which of the following is the process of identifying and classifying each item and giving labels to each category?

Accretion
Count Behaviors
Intensity
Coding

Coding
The process of identifying and classifying each item and giving labels to each category.
PAGE # 126

Question No: 37 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
When do largest percentages form a pattern across cells?

If there is no relationship
If there is non linear relationship
If there is curvilinear relationship

Curvilinear relationship, the largest percentages form a pattern across cells.
PAGE # 107
If there is linear relationship

Question No: 38 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
Which of the following elements is/are not included for structuring Observation in Non reactive research?

Frequency
Intensity
Direction

Accretion

Observations can be structured
Frequency:
Direction:
Intensity:
Space:
PAGE # 126

AFAAQ

Question No: 39 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
A census taker often collects data through which of the following?

Standardized tests
Interviews

http://www.southalabama.edu/coe/bset/johnson/mcq/mc6.htm
MCQ # 20
Secondary data
Observations

Question No: 40 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
What is the particular advantage of secondary analysis to business students?

It is less challenging intellectually
It guarantees positive results
It is less expensive and less time consuming than primary analysis

http://www.oup.com/uk/orc/bin/9780199284986/01student/cqs/ch13/
MCQ # 02
It enables students to gain experience of the workplace

Question No: 41 (Marks: 5)
Defend the use of the term inductive to describe qualitative data analysis and interpretation.

Question No: 42 (Marks: 5)
What are the main parts of a research report?

Question No: 43 (Marks: 10)
Many universities do not allow their students to conduct experimental research to fulfil thesis or dissertation requirements. Provide a rationale for changing this practice, acknowledging the limitations of experimental research, but also citing at least three reasons that action research should be accepted.

Question No: 44 (Marks: 10)
A multination company ABC has launched a new tooth paste Cleanex in Pakistan. After eight months the company wants to analyze the consumer satisfaction about their tooth paste. For research purpose, develop questions for the following scenarios that can be used in questionnaire.
See the consumer preference for tooth paste or tooth powder by using nominal scale.
i. See the consumer preference for Cleanex Tooth Paste by using ordinal scale.
ii. See the important characteristics of the Cleanex Tooth Paste by using interval scale so that the company can modify its strengths and improve its weaknesses.
iii. Check the monthly consumption of the tooth paste by using the ratio scale.

AFAQ

Question No: 45 (Marks: 10)
What is the need of a trivariate table? How can we construct trivariate table and what

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FINALTERM EXAMINATION
Spring 2009
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STA630- Research Methods

Question No: 1 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
An experiment has high_____if one has confidence that the experimental treatment has been the source of change in the dependent variable.

Internal validity

http://www.blurtit.com/q346633.html

External validity

Internal and external validity

Internal and external reliability

Question No: 2 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
_____is the arbitrary and subjective.

Probability sampling

Non- Probability sampling

The selection of units in non-probability sampling is quite arbitrary
PAGE # 90

Cluster sampling

All of the given options

Question No: 3 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
Which of the following is NOT included in the stages of interviewing?

Asking questions

Recording the responses

AFAAQ

Probing

Coding the data

Stages of an Interview
Asking the Questions
Probing
Recording the Responses
Page # 83 & 84

Question No: 4 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
Critical decision areas in questionnaire construction are_____

Question content

Question wording

Response strategy

All of the given options

http://books.google.com.pk/books?id=Cf1D0DvWXI8C&pg=PA336&lpg=PA336&dq=#v=onepage&q&f=false

Question No: 5 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
_____is based on the concept of random sampling.

Non- probability sampling

Probability sampling

The simple random is the best known probability sample,
PAGE # 90

Random sampling

Multiple sampling

Question No: 6 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
A sampling design in which the elements in the population do NOT have a known or predetermined chance of being selected as sample subject is:

Convenience sampling

Stratified sampling

AFAQ

Non-Probability sampling

http://www.slidefinder.net/s/sampling_sample_design_jn602_week/5349303
SLIDE # 09
OR
In non-probability sampling the probability of any particular element of the population being chosen is unknown.
PAGE # 90

Probability sampling

Question No: 7 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
_____is the population for which results are required.

Finite population

Infinite population

Target population

Page # 88
OR
http://www.ehes.info/manuals/EHES_manual/PartA/EHES_Manual_PartA_Chapter2.pdf

None of the given options

Question No: 8 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
Which of the following technique yields a simple random sample?

Choosing volunteers from an introductory psychology class to participate

Listing the individuals by ethnic group and choosing a proportion from within each ethnic group at random

Numbering all the elements of a sampling frame and then using a random number table to pick cases from the table

http://www.southalabama.edu/coe/bset/johnson/mcq/mc7.htm
MCQ # 02

Randomly selecting schools, and then sampling everyone within the school

Question No: 9 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
Which of the following designs permits a comparison of pretest scores to determine the initial equivalence of groups on the pretest before the treatment variable is introduced into the research setting.

AIAAQ

(a) One-group pretest-posttest design

(b) Pretest-posttest control group design

http://www.southalabama.edu/coe/bset/johnson/mcq/mc9.htm
MCQ # 09

(c) Posttest-only design with nonequivalent groups

(d) Both b and c

Question No: 10 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
Where do you provide a step-by-step account of what the researcher and participants did during the research study?

Introduction

Abstract

Procedure

Procedure: The procedure includes the step-by-step how of your experiment. The procedure should include:

- A description of the experimental design and how participants were assigned conditions.
- Identification of your independent variable(s) (IV), dependent variable(s) (DV), and control variables. Give your variables clear, meaningful names so that your readers are not confused.
- Important instructions to participants.
- A step-by-step listing in chronological order of what participants did during the experiment.

http://owl.english.purdue.edu/owl/resource/670/04/

Design

Question No: 11 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
Which of the following has high response rate?

Mail interviewing

VUAQ

Telephone interviewing

Personal interviewing

http://books.google.com.pk/books?id=FqF7n0zGJm0C&pg=PA380&lpg=PA380&#v=onepage&q&f=false
2ND PARAGRAPH

None of the given options

Question No: 12 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
Observation studies are also known as_____research.
Experimental

Field

OBSERVATION STUDIES/FIELD RESEARCH
PAGE 134

Quantitative

None of the given options

Question No: 13 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
Open-ended questions provide primarily_____data.

Unprocessed data

Qualitative data

http://www.southalabama.edu/coe/bset/johnson/mcq/mc6.htm
MCQ # 11

All of the given options

None of the given options

Question No: 14 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
Which one of the following is NOT a major method of data collection:

Questionnaires

Interviews

Focus groups

AFAAQ

All of the given options are methods of data collection

Data collection forms (questionnaires, checklist, interview guide, other forms)
PAGE # 35

Question No: 15 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
Which of the following statement is incorrect?

In non participant observation the observer is just an observer.

In participant observation, the data accuracy is high.

Observation studies can be participant or non-participant. In participant observation the researcher directly observes and participates in small scale social settings in the present time.
PAGE # 134

Participant observation is also referred to as field research.

None of the given options

Question No: 16 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
If the subjects are given a pretest it will not affect their performance in the posttest.

True

False

Question No: 17 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
In non- reactive research the subjects do not have knowledge that they are being studied.

True

In non-reactive research, those being studied are not aware that they are part of a research project.
Page # 124

False

Question No: 18 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
In experimental group the subjects do not under go any treatment; however in control group the subjects are given the treatment.

True

AFAQ

False
Page # 114

Question No: 19 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
When multiple questions are asked in one question, it leads to ambiguous answers provided by the respondents.

True

http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Multiple_choice
OR
Page # 78
Avoid Double-Barreled Questions
Make each question about one and only one. A double barreled question consists of two or more questions joined together. It makes the respondent's answer ambiguous. For example, if asked, "Does this company have pension and health insurance benefits?" a respondent at the company with health insurance benefits only might answer either yes or no. The response has an ambiguous meaning and the researcher cannot be certain of the respondent's intentions. When multiple questions are asked in one question, thee results may be exceedingly difficult to interpret.

False

Question No: 20 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
An advantage of communication analysis is that it provides access to the inaccessible subjects.

True

False

Question No: 21 (Marks: 1)
Pretest is the phase when the_____variable is measured prior to the introduction of treatment.

Question No: 22 (Marks: 1)
If the percentages are calculated column wise in a table, then we will make comparison between the variables in a_**frequency**_.

Question No: 23 (Marks: 1)
In order to make two identical groups for experiment, the procedures to be undertaken are randomization and **matching.**

Question No: 24 (Marks: 1)

AFAQ

The main advantage of **_mail _**questionnaire is that a wide geographical area can be covered in the survey.

Question No: 25 (Marks: 1)
A type of bias in questions occurs when they are phrased in an emotionally charged manner, they are described as**__Loaded__**questions.
Page No.78

Question No: 26 (Marks: 5)
Make one hypothesis for each of the following types of hypotheses. (1 mark each)
i. If-then hypothesis
ii. Directional hypothesis
iii. Non directional hypothesis
iv. Null hypothesis
v. Alternative hypothesis
Answer:

i- If-then hypothesis:

If there is increase in cost there is decrease in profit.

ii. Directional hypothesis:

Increase in absentieesm causes a decrease in productivity level of employees.

iii. Non directional hypothesis:

Productivity level of employees is associated with rate of absenteeism.

iv. Null hypothesis:

There is no association between level of productivity and absenteeism.

v. Alternative hypothesis :

There is a relationship between level of job commitment of officers and their level of efficiency.

Question No: 27 (Marks: 5)
Which is the most powerful scale among Nominal, Ordinal, Interval and Ratio scale, and why?
Answer:
The highest level of measurement is a ratio scale. This has the properties of an interval scale together with a fixed origin or zero point. Examples of variables which are ratio scaled include weights, lengths and times. Ratio scales permit the researcher to compare both differences in scores and the relative magnitude of scores. For instance the difference between 5 and 10 minutes is the same as that between 10 and 15 minutes, and

AFAAQ

10 minutes is twice as long as 5 minutes. Suffice it to say that virtually all statistical operations can be performed on ratio scales.

Question No: 28 (Marks: 5)
A manager finds that off-the-job classroom training has a great impact on the productivity of the employees in her department. However, she also observes that employees over 60 years of age do not seem to derive much benefit and do not improve with such training.

i. Identify the independent, dependent and moderating variables in the given scenario. (3)

Answer:
Inependent Variable: Off-the-job classroom training
Dependent Variable: Employees performance
Moedrating Variable: Employees age over 60 years

ii. How the moderating variable you identified in part (i) is affecting the independent-dependent variable relationship in the scenario? (2)
Answer:
The moderating variable is one that has a strong contingent effect on the independent variable and dependent variable relationship. That is the presence of a third variable modifies the original relationship between the independent and the dependent variable
In the scenario above employees age over 60 years is acting as moderating variable because it is the variable which affects the relationship of employees performance (dependent variable) and off-the-job classrom training (independent variable).which was positive in above case but age over 60 years reduces the positivity .

Question No: 29 (Marks: 5)
The accounts executive has established a new accounting system that utilizes maximum computer technology. Before making further changes, he would like to get a feel for how the accounting clerks react to the new system by acting as if he has no doubts about their acceptability of the new system. He may then casually talk to the first five accounting personnel that walk into his office, trying to gauge their reactions.

i. Describe the type of sampling the director should use in the given scenario, probability or non probability? (1)

Answer:
Director should use probability sampling as probability sampling is the technique in which some known elements of population participated in order to provide useful descriptions.

ii. What type of sampling technique is being used and why? Explain. (2)

Answer:
Director should use probability sampling as probability sampling is the technique in which some known elements of population participated in order to provide useful descriptions.

AIAAO

iii. Give two characteristics of the type of sampling technique that you selected in part (ii).

Answer:

Two characteristics of probability sampling:

1- Random sampling lets a researcher statistically calculate the relationship between the sample and the population – that is the size of *sampling error*

2- All possible samples have a known and specified probability of being drawn.

Question No: 30 (Marks: 5)
You are doing research on "how to increase the efficiency level of labor". For the research purpose you have conducted an interview with the supervisor.
Give two structured and two unstructured questions that you may ask related to your research. (2.5+2.5)

Question No: 31 (Marks: 10)
What is meant by validity and reliability? Describe the situations in which validity and reliability problems occur.

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FINALTERM EXAMINATION
Spring 2009
AFAAQ_TARIQ@YAHOO.COM
STA630- Research Methods (Session - 2)

Marks: 80

Question No: 1 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
Who, among the following, wrote the book "Research Methods for Business"?
Zikmund, W.
Sekaran, U.
Research Methods For Business *(A Skill Building Approach), 4E by* Sekaran U.
Dessler, G.
Neuman, W.C.

Question No: 2 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
On which of the following, Scientific knowledge mostly relies?
Identification of events
Logical understanding
Prior knowledge
All of the given options

AFAAQ

PAGE # 04

Question No: 3 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
Which of the following refers to research supported by measurable evidence?
Opinion
Speculation
Empiricism
PAGE # 03
Rationalism

Question No: 4 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
All of the following are true statements about action research EXCEPT;
Data are systematically analyzed.
Data are collected systematically.
Results are generalizable.

http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_airasian_edresearch_7/5/1490/381508.cw/index.html
MCQ # 02
Results are used to improve practice.

Question No: 5 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
If a researcher is studying the effect of using laptops in his classroom to ascertain their merit and worth, he is likely conducting which of the following types of research?

Evaluation

http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_airasian_edresearch_8/38/9865/2525631.cw/index.html
MCQ # 02
Experimental
Applied
Basic

Question No: 6 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
What is the problem with using strict definitions of important concepts?

They take the focus away from accurate measurement.
They prevent the researcher from assessing alternative ways of viewing a concept.

http://www.oup.com/uk/orc/bin/9780199284986/01student/cqs/ch16/
MCQ # 03
They prevent a consistent approach being achieved with business research.
They prevent research from being truly objective.

AFAQ

Question No: 7 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
A variable that is presumed to cause a change in another variable is known as:
Discontinuous variable
Dependent variable
Independent variable

http://www.southalabama.edu/coe/bset/johnson/mcq/mc2.htm
MCQ # 05
Intervening variable

Question No: 8 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
Which of the following is the difference between measures and indicators?
Measures are unambiguous quantities, whereas indicators are devised from common sense understandings.

http://www.oup.com/uk/orc/bin/9780199202959/01student/cqs/ch06/
MCQ # 03
OR
Measures include things like demographics (of age, income and so on), which can be counted. In fact, usually we think of measures as raw numbers. Often though, what we want to research does not lend itself immediately to straightforward calculation on numbers of things and how they vary but on slightly vaguer concepts. Like job satisfaction, for example. In this case we need a number of attitude statements, which, taken together, can be argued to represent the concept. These separate statements are indicators and often represent our 'common sense' understanding of a concept. Later, these can be coded to turn them into numbers for statistical analysis.
Indicators have a more direct relationship to the underlying concept than measures.
Measures are intuitively devised and then applied as if they were direct indicators of a concept.
Indicators are unambiguous quantities, whereas measures are subjective and value laden.

Question No: 9 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
Which of the following is NOT the implication of Ordinal scale?

Characteristics of nominal scale
Rank the object
Does not provide magnitude of object
Provide rate
PAGE # 53

Question No: 10 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
Measurement reliability refers to which of the following?

Accuracy of the scores
Dependency of the scores

ALQ

Consistency of the scores
Comprehensiveness of the scores

Question No: 11 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
Which of the following statements might assist response rates?
Please photocopy the questionnaire five times and pass on to your work colleagues.
Please make sure that the questionnaire is completed with a fountain pen.
Please read the attached journal article on the ontological foundations of positivism prior to completing the questionnaire.
Please put the completed questionnaire in the enclosed stamped addressed envelope and place in the mail out tray.

http://www.oup.com/uk/orc/bin/9780199284986/01student/cqs/ch09/
MCQ # 03

Question No: 12 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
Why it is important to avoid ambiguous terms while designing questions?

Respondents may not understand the question.
Respondents may operate with a different frame of reference.

http://www.oup.com/uk/orc/bin/9780199284986/01student/cqs/ch10/
MCQ # 05
Respondents may think the question is less important.
Respondents may have to ask for help when completing the questionnaire.

Question No: 13 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
Which of the following is a double-barrelled question?

How satisfied you are with the performance appraisal system?
How satisfied you are with investment levels in new and existing software packages?

A double barreled question consists of two or more questions joined together. It makes the respondent's answer ambiguous. For example, if asked, "Does this company have pension and health insurance benefits?" a respondent at the company with health insurance benefits only might answer either yes or no.
PAGE # 78
How satisfied you are with the organisation's marketing strategy?
How satisfied you are with the levels of customer satisfaction?

Question No: 14 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
The small scale trial run of a particular item is called_____.
Test Run
Pilot test

AFAQ

Pilot testing also called pre-testing means small scale trial run of a particular component; here we are referring to pilot testing of the questionnaire.
PAGE # 80
Post hoc test
T test

Question No: 15 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
Which of the following terms describes an interview protocol in which the topics and questions to be addressed are identified, but the order in which the questions can be asked is not stipulated?

Unstructured
Partially structured
Semistructured

http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_airasian_edresearch_8/38/9870/2526923.cw/content/index
MCQ # 14
Structured

Question No: 16 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
The most important characteristic of the sample in survey research is that it is:

Representative of the target population.

http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_airasian_edresearch_7/5/1490/381619.cw/index.html
MCQ # 04
OR
Usually, the population is too large for the researcher to attempt to survey all of its members. A small, but carefully chosen *sample* can be used to represent the population. The sample reflects the characteristics of the population from which it is drawn.
Convenient to access.
Easily observed in naturalistic settings.
Large enough to compare differences between subgroups.

Question No: 17 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
Which of the following is NOT something a researcher will have to consider while thinking about their sample size?

Time and cost.
Non-response.
Length of questionnaire

http://www.oup.com/uk/orc/bin/9780199284986/01student/cqs/ch07/
MCQ # 05
OR

AIAO

In general bigger is better when considering sample size however all researchers need to be aware of the limitations of their resources.

Heterogeneity of population.

Question No: 18 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
A correlation coefficient of -0.45 is generally considered to be;

No correlation
Low
Moderate
http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_airasian_edresearch_7/5/1490/381655.cw/index.html
MCQ # 06
High

Question No: 19 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
What is a researcher doing when he removes the variance explained by one variable in order to understand the correlation between two other variables?

Statistical significance
Attenuation
Controlling for the variable

http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_airasian_edresearch_7/5/1490/381655.cw/index.html
MCQ # 10
Multiple regression research

Question No: 20 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
Which of the following best describes qualitative data analysis?

It begins after all the data has been collected.
It is an ongoing, cyclic process integrated into all phases of research.

http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_airasian_edresearch_8/38/9871/2527149.cw/content/index
MCQ # 05
It is an awkward, haphazard process.
It builds from abstraction to specific, concrete examples.

Question No: 21 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
The statistic used to determine the relationship between two variables is:
Analysis of covariance

AFAQ

Chi square
Standard deviation
Pearson "r"

http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_airasian_edresearch_7/5/1491/381743.cw/index.htmlQuestionNo:22
MCQ # 17

Question No: 22 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
Which of the following describes the nature of qualitative data interpretation?

Reflection
Integrative
Explanatory
All of the given options

http://wps.prenhall.com/wps/grader
Question No: 23 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
In frequency tables total of columns and rows are called:

Body of table
Cell of table
Area of table
Marginals

Include the totals of the columns and rows. These are called *marginals* They equal the nivariate frequency distribution for the variable.
Page #107

Question No: 24 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
A researcher studies three groups of students who vary in level of self-confidence. She finds that students with higher self-confidence are more popular among their peers. The most plausible conclusion is that

We do not know what causes self-confidence or popularity.
Self-confidence causes popularity.
Popularity causes self-confidence.
Self-confidence and popularity are related.

http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_airasian_edresearch_7/5/1491/381743.cw/index.ht
MCQ # 07

Question No: 25 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

AFAAQ

Educational policy makers often conclude that an intervention didn't work. Often, however, the intervention was not implemented as intended. The validity of the policymakers' conclusion is threatened by

Lack of specificity of variables

http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_airasian_edresearch_8/38/9869/2526465.cw/index.html
MCQ # 05
Selection-treatment interaction
Treatment diffusion
Faulty data analysis procedures

Question No: 26 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
Many beginner researchers believe that research involves testing, treating, and testing again is an example of:

Comparison group research
Quasi-experimental research
True experimental research
Pre-experimental research

http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_airasian_edresearch_7/5/1491/381886.cw/index.html
MCQ #02

Question No: 27 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
Which of the following questions can be answered using content analysis?
How do managers behave in the face of employment insecurity?
How do the media report corporate re-branding exercises?

http://www.oup.com/uk/orc/bin/9780199284986/01student/cqs/ch12/
MCQ # 01
What effect does organizational size have on marketing strategy?
What are the most popular leisure activities amongst the over-50s?

Question No: 28 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
Case study is empirical because;
It investigates a contemporary phenomenon within its real life context.
It is retrospective study in which the researcher follows the research process from effect to its cause.
It is a study back in time.
All of the given options

It investigates a contemporary phenomenon within its real life context. It is retrospective study n which the researcher follows the research process from effect to its cause. It is a study back in time

AIAQ

PAGE # 158

Question No: 29 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
Which component of a research report contains information about the topic studied, iterature review, hypotheses, participants, instruments, procedures, results, and discussion?

Preliminary pages
Main body

http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_airasian_edresearch_8/38/9872/2527359.cw/index.html
MCQ03
Method
Discussion

Question No: 30 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
Which one of the following Test helps in the proper sequence of the questions as wording, translation, coding and structuring?
Test Run
Pre Test

Pre-testing may help in putting questions in proper sequence, using acceptable wording, doing appropriate translation, question spacing, structuring of answers, coding system, and needing instructions for interviewers (probing).
PAGE # 81
Post Hoc Test
T- Test
Question No: 31 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
Which of the following sampling is least reliable but normally the cheapest and easiest to conduct?
Purposive Sampling
Snowball Sampling
Convenience Sampling

Convenience samples are least reliable but normally the cheapest and easiest to conduct.
PAGE # 90
Quota Sampling

Question No: 32 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
Which of the following is a form of Non-random sampling?

Snowball sampling
Convenience sampling
Quota sampling
All of the given option

AIAQ

PAGE # 90
OR
Nonrandom Sampling Techniques
The other major type of sampling used in quantitative research is nonrandom sampling (i.e., when you do not use one of the ransom sampling techniques). There are four main types of nonrandom sampling:
The first type of nonrandom sampling is called convenience sampling
The second type of nonrandom sampling is called quota sampling
The third type of nonrandom sampling is called purposive sampling
The fourth type of nonrandom sampling is called snowball sampling
http://www.southalabama.edu/coe/bset/johnson/lectures/lec7.htm
OR
http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Nonprobability_sampling

Question No: 33 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
Which of the following has greatly facilitated the researcher to conduct tabulation and statistical analysis?

SPSS
MINITAB
SYSTAT
All of the given options

The proliferation of computer technology in business and universities has greatly facilitated tabulation and statistical analysis. Commercial packages eliminate the need to write a new program every time you want to tabulate and analyze data with a computer. SAS, Statistical Package for the Social Sciences (SPSS), SYSTAT, Epi. Info. And MINITAB is commonly used statistical packages.
Page # 104

Question No: 34 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
What is the place of quotations in referencing?

Quotations should be given at the end.
Quotations should be given exactly as they appear in the source.

http://www.latrobe.edu.au/linguistics/resources_hons/Brochure/Para10.pdf
Quotations should be given in left margins only.
Quotations should not be given at all.

Question No: 35 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
Which of the following terms refers to a statistical method that can be used to statistically equate groups on a pretest or some other variable?

Experimental control

AIAQ

Differential influence
Matching
Analysis of covariance

http://www.southalabama.edu/coe/bset/johnson/mcq/mc9.htm
MCQ # 07

Question No: 36 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
Which of the following could be used for randomly assigning participants to groups in an experimental study?

Split-half
Even versus Odd numbers
Use a list of random numbers or a computer randomization program

http://www.southalabama.edu/coe/bset/johnson/mcq/mc9.htm
MCQ#15
Let the researcher decide which group will be the best

Question No: 37 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
The design in which one group of research participants is administered a treatment and is then compared, on the dependent variable, with another group of research participants who did not receive the experimental treatment is known as:

One-group posttest-only design
One-group pretest-posttest design
Posttest-only design with non-equivalent groups

http://www.southalabama.edu/coe/bset/johnson/mcq/mc9.htm
MCQ # 26
Time series design

Question No: 38 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
Which of the following is referred to as the influence of a single independent variable?

Interaction effect
Reactive effect
Main effect

http://www.southalabama.edu/coe/bset/johnson/mcq/mc9.htm
MCQ # 27
Proactive effect

Question No: 39 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
Which of the following types of analysis can be done using secondary analysis?

AFAQ

The analysis of specific subgroups
Longitudinal analysis
Cross-cultural analysis
All of the given options

http://www.oup.com/uk/orc/bin/9780199284986/01student/cqs/ch13/
MCQ # 04

Question No: 40 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
Which of the following is/are advantage(s) of the self-completed questionnaire?

Inability to confirm who completed the questionnaire
Its unsuitability for some kinds of respondents
Inability to ask many questions that are not directly relevant to the respondent
Easy to justify the answer

http://www.oup.com/uk/orc/bin/9780199284986/01student/cqs/ch09/
MCQ # 02 U WILL SE THE REMANING IS DISADVANTAGE of the self-completed questionnaire

Question No: 41 (Marks: 5)
Defend the use of the term inductive to describe qualitative data analysis and interpretation.

Question No: 42 (Marks: 5)
Briefly discuss the Solomon s Four Group Design in experimental research with the help of example?

Question No: 43 (Marks: 10)
A multination company ABC has launched a new tooth paste Cleanex in Pakistan.

After eight months the company wants to analyze the consumer satisfaction about their tooth paste. For research purpose, develop questions for the following scenarios that can be used in questionnaire.
See the consumer preference for tooth paste or tooth powder by using nominal scale.
i. See the consumer preference for Cleanex Tooth Paste by using ordinal scale.
ii. See the important characteristics of the Cleanex Tooth Paste by using interval scale so that the company can modify its strengths and improve its weaknesses.
iii. Check the monthly consumption of the tooth paste by using the ratio scale.

Question No: 44 (Marks: 10)
What are different types of probability sampling? Explain any two with detail.

Question No: 45 (Marks: 10)
What are different advantages and disadvantages of using secondary data?

AFAQ

FINALTERM EXAMINATION
Fall 2009
AFAAQ_TARIQ@YAHOO.COM
STA630- Research Methods

Question No: 1 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

The part of the action research spiral that differentiates this research methodology from other kinds of research is;

- ► Looking at multiple sources of data.
- ► Taking action based on results.

http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_airasian_edresearch_7/5/1490/381555.cw/index.html
MCQ # 06

- ► Thinking about or analyzing data in more than one way.
- ► The kinds of data that are collected.

Question No: 2 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Individuals who engage in action research are most concerned with:

- ► Supporting the way things are being done.
- ► Publishing results
- ► Proving a hypothesis
- ► Improvement

http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_airasian_edresearch_7/5/1490/381508.cw/index.html
MCQ # 20

Question No: 3 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Research may differ along a series of dimensions. Which of the following may be applied to this statement?

- ► The level of manipulation used to elicit data collection.
- ► The data-collection technique.
- ► The type of data collected.
- ► Type, technique and manipulation of data collection

Question No: 4 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Which of the following statements best defines hypothesis?

- ► A quantitative study.
- ► A tentative prediction of the results of the research.

AFAAQ

http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_airasian_edresearch_8/38/9865/2525651.cw/content/index
MCQ # 24

- ► A qualitative research design.
- ► The operational definition of the study.

Question No: 5 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

What is the first step in the research process?

- ► Problem definition
- ► Define broad problem area

The research process consists of a number of steps. The first step in any research is selecting the topic, which could start from the broad area of interest
Page # 33

- ► Theoretical framework
- ► Preliminary data collection

Question No: 6 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

When there is a need of generating new ideas for hypotheses or to interpret the results of some research, which one is the best research deign?

- ► Experiment
- ► Surveys
- ► Focus group discussion

Focus group discussions: It is a discussion of an issue by 6-12 persons with a moderator for 1-2 hours. The issue can be a public concern, a product, a television program, a political candidate, or a policy. Focus groups are useful in exploratory research or to generate new ideas for hypotheses, and the interpenetration of results.
PAGE # 38

- ► Communication analysis

Question No: 7 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Which of the following is an example of deception in business research?

- ► The obtaining of company material without permission.
- ► The researcher wearing a disguise during an observation.
- ► The researcher representing their research as being about a different topic. http://www.oup.com/uk/orc/bin/9780199284986/01student/cqs/ch05/

MCQ # 09

- ► The researcher failing to ask permission to interview someone.

Question No: 8 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Which of the following is least likely to occur as an ethical problem with electronic research?

AIAQ

► Privacy could be invaded.
► People are not likely to be able to stop once they have begun participating.
► Debriefing could be avoided.
► Informed consent cannot be completely monitored.

Question No: 9 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

All of the following are unethical issues, EXCEPT;

► Invoicing irregularities
► Avoiding legal liability
► Misrepresenting results
► Seeking permission for entry

Unethical activities
• Violating nondisclosure agreements.
• Breaking respondent confidentiality.
• Misrepresenting results.
• Deceiving people.
• Invoicing irregularities.
• Avoiding legal liability.
Page # 41

Question No: 10 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Which of the following is the difference between measures and indicators?

► Measures are unambiguous quantities, whereas indicators are devised from common sense understandings.

http://www.oup.com/uk/orc/bin/9780199202959/01student/cqs/ch06/
MCQ # 03

► Indicators have a more direct relationship to the underlying concept than measures.
► Measures are intuitively devised and then applied as if they were direct indicators of a concept.
► Indicators are unambiguous quantities, whereas measures are subjective and value-laden.

Question No: 11 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

The extent to which a test provides scores that are meaningful, appropriate, or useful is referred to as;

► Reliability
► Accuracy
► Internal validity
► Validity

AIAAQ

http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_airasian_edresearch_8/38/9866/2525945.cw/content/index
MCQ # 18

Question No: 12 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Which of the following functions is performed by the Ordinal scale?

- ► Categorize
- ► Distance
- ► Order

Ordinal scales include the characteristics of the nominal scale plus an indicator of order.
PAGE # 53

- ► Unique origin

Question No: 13 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

What is the difference between interval/ratio and ordinal variables?

- ► Ordinal data can be rank ordered, but interval/ratio data cannot.
- ► The distance between categories is equal across the range of interval/ration data.

http://www.oup.com/uk/orc/bin/9780199202959/01student/cqs/ch14/
MCQ # 01

- ► Interval/ratio variables contain only two categories.
- ► Ordinal variables have a fixed zero point, whereas interval/ratio variables do not.

Question No: 14 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Which of the following statement refers to cross-sectional design?

- ► A comparison of two or more variables over a long period of time
- ► The collection of data from more than one case at one moment in time

http://www.oup.com/uk/orc/bin/9780199284986/01student/cqs/ch02/
MCQ # 05

- ► One that is devised when the researcher is in a bad mood
- ► A study of one particular section of society, e.g. the middle classes

Question No: 15 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Which of the following is TRUE for research plan?

- ► It should be detailed.
- ► It should be given to others for review and comments.
- ► It sets out the rationale for a research study.
- ► All of the given options

http://www.scribd.com/doc/22683412/Lecture-Notes-Research-Chaper-1-9

Question No: 16 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Which of the following typically does NOT apply to observers in survey research studies?

AIAO

- They observe predetermined activities.
- They are participant observers.

http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_airasian_edresearch_7/5/1490/381582.cw/index.html
MCQ # 09

- They obtain information by watching rather than asking
- They must be careful not to influence the activities they observe.

Question No: 17 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Which of the following is **not** an advantage of the self-completion questionnaire over the structured interview?

- It is cheaper to administer.
- It is quicker to administer.
- It is easier to prompt the interviewee.

http://www.oup.com/uk/orc/bin/9780199284986/01student/cqs/ch09/
MCQ # 01

- It is easier to remove interviewer effects.

Question No: 18 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Mr. X has coded his observations to hide the identity of each of the three participants in his study. He is ensuring;

- protection from harm
- confidentiality

http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_airasian_edresearch_7/5/1489/381347.cw/index.html
MCQ # 01

- informed consent
- anonymity

Question No: 19 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

The cover letter to a questionnaire study should contain all of the following, EXCEPT;

- A list of participants

http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_airasian_edresearch_7/5/1490/381582.cw/index.html
MCQ # 17

- A self-addressed, stamped envelope
- Purpose of the study
- Reasons to respond

Question No: 20 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Teachers are advised to predict the results of student attitudinal questionnaires, because;

AIAO

► It will help them decide if students answered truthfully.
► It gives them a point of comparison against which to judge actual responses.

http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_airasian_edresearch_7/5/1490/381508.cw/index.html
MCQ # 10
► It will allow them to apply statistical procedures in analyzing results.
► It helps them familiarize themselves with the questionnaires.

Question No: 21 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

In conducting an action research study of "student's organizational skills during class in a particular school", which of the following would NOT likely to provide useful data?

► Interviews with teachers
► Classroom observations
► Parent surveys

http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_airasian_edresearch_7/5/1490/381508.cw/index.html
MCQ # 16
► Teacher's journal entries

Question No: 22 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Why it is helpful to keep a research diary or log book while you are conducting your project?

► To give you something to do in the early stages of your research when nothing is happening.
► Because funding councils generally demand to see written evidence that you were working every day during the period of the research.
► To keep a record of what you did and what happened throughout the research process.

http://www.oup.com/uk/orc/bin/9780199202959/01student/cqs/ch03/
MCQ # 08
► It can be added to your dissertation to ensure that you reach the required word limit.

Question No: 23 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Which of the following is likely to happen if clear instructions are not given as to how the respondent should answer the question?

► Respondents may delete inappropriate answers rather than select appropriate ones.
► Respondents may choose only one answer when they need to choose as many as apply.
► Respondents may complete questions that are not relevant to them.
► All of the given options

AIAO

http://www.oup.com/uk/orc/bin/9780199284986/01student/cqs/ch09/
MCQ # 07

Question No: 24 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Which of the following is NOT a suitable topic for research using a diary?

- ► The amount of time managers spend on particular activities.
- ► The frequency with which managers undertake particular tasks.
- ► The locations in which a trade union representative has discussions with individual members. **Correct**
- ► The volume of female managers in the retail industry.

http://www.oup.com/uk/orc/bin/9780199284986/01student/cqs/ch09/
MCQ # 09

Question No: 25 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Which of the following represents excellent advice for conducting an interview?

- ► Listen more and talk less
- ► Don't interrupt
- ► Don't be judgmental about the interviewee's beliefs or views
- ► All of the given options

Question No: 26 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Which of the following is an example of a dilemma that might face feminist business researchers conducting qualitative interviews with women?

- ► What role to adopt while interviewing male managers?
- ► How many female employees should be interviewed for a representative sample? **Correct**
- ► How to overcome the issue of false consciousness?

http://www.oup.com/uk/orc/bin/9780199284986/01student/cqs/ch18/
MCQ # 09

- ► What data to use while publishing findings?

Question No: 27 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Which of the following sampling strategies was used when the three students with the highest GPAs were selected?

- ► Extreme case

http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_airasian_edresearch_7/5/1489/381384.cw/index.html
MCQ # 02

- ► Snowball
- ► Maximum variation

AHAQ

► Normal case

Question No: 28 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Which type of sampling strategy is exemplified by selecting two types of individuals: those who are extremely happy and those who are extremely sad?

► Snowball
► Intensity

http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_airasian_edresearch_8/38/9866/2525932.cw/index.html
MCQ # 03

► Homogeneous
► Purposive

Question No: 29 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

The logic of purposive sampling is:

► To use participants because the researcher has access to them.
► That a random sample can generalize to a population.
► That a few information-rich participants studied in depth yield many insights about a topic.

http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_airasian_edresearch_7/5/1488/381150.cw/index.html
MCQ # 02
OR
PAGE # 90

► To include all participants, even though they are not all relevant to the problem.

Question No: 30 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Using a sample of 30 participants, a researcher finds a correlation of 0.30 between two variables. The relationship is not statistically significant. If the researcher were to triple her sample size, which of the following is most likely?

► The correlation would be statistically significant.

http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_airasian_edresearch_7/5/1490/381655.cw/index.html
MCQ # 09

► The correlation would be larger.
► The correlation would be smaller.
► Nothing is likely to change.

Question No: 31 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Which of the following steps begins the analysis of qualitative data?

► Reading and memoing
► Describing the content and participants **Correct**
► Classifying and interpreting

AIAQ

► Data management

http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_airasian_edresearch_7/5/1490/381473.cw/index.html
MCQ # 06

Question No: 32 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Which of the following represents the most general conceptualization in qualitative data analysis?

► Word
► Topic **Correct**
► Category
► Pattern

http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_airasian_edresearch_7/5/1490/381483.cw/index.html
MCQ # 01

Question No: 33 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Which of the following BEST differentiates data analysis from interpretation?

► Interpretation requires more conceptual and integrative thinking than data analysis.

http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_airasian_edresearch_8/38/9871/2527149.cw/content/index
MCQ # 11

► Interpretation involves computerized analysis of data.
► Data analysis is explanatory and interpretation is conceptual. **Correct**
► Data analysis involves conceptualization but interpretation does not.

Question No: 34 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

The statistic used to determine the relationship between two variables is:

► Analysis of covariance
► Chi square
► Standard deviation **Correct**
► Pearson "*r*"

http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_airasian_edresearch_7/5/1491/381743.cw/index.htmlQuestionNo:35
MCQ # 17

Question No: 35 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Which of the following is NOT a control procedure used in causal-comparative research?

► Matching
► Subgroups
► Chi square

AIAO

http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_airasian_edresearch_7/5/1491/381743.cw/index.html
MCQ # 18

- ► Analysis of covariance

Question No: 36 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Which of the following best describes qualitative data coding?

- ► Adding all of the scores together and describing them statistically
- ► Identify data segments that contain general episodes
- ► Numerically representing the concepts identified by the participants **Correct**
- ► Dividing data in parts that represent single thoughts

http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_airasian_edresearch_7/5/1490/381473.cw/index.html
MCQ # 04

Question No: 37 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

The bivariate tables derived from trivariate table are called;

- ► Sub table
- ► Bivariates
- ► Partials

A trivariate table has a bivariate table of the independent and dependent variable for each category of the control variable. These new tables are called *partials.*
PAGE # 110

- ► Correlational tables **Correct**

Question No: 38 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Quasi-experimental research is used because:

- ► Random selection is not possible
- ► Neither random selection nor random assignment is possible
- ► Random assignment is not possible

http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_airasian_edresearch_7/5/1491/381820.cw/index.html
MVQ # 16

- ► There are no comparison groups available

Question No: 39 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

A researcher believes that the effects of a treatment will be different for males and females. Which one is the best method to test this possible interaction?

- ► Single-subject design
- ► Factorial design

http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_airasian_edresearch_7/5/1491/381820.cw/index.html

AIOU

MCQ # 17
OR
http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Factorial_experiment

- ► Time-series design **Correct**
- ► Quasi-experimental design

Question No: 40 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

The influence of the researcher's background, personal experiences, preferences, or attitude on an interview or observation is technically defined as:

- ► Participant bias
- ► Observer bias

http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_airasian_edresearch_7/5/1489/381347.cw/index.html
MCQ # 18

- ► Observer effect **Correct**
- ► Nonparticipant effect

Question No: 41 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

On which component of his field notes did Mr. Majid focused when he expressed in his notes his thoughts and ideas about what he observed?

- ► Description **Correct**
- ► Reflection

http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_airasian_edresearch_7/5/1489/381392.cw/index.html
MCQ # 01

- ► Protocol
- ► Formal data

Question No: 42 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Which of the following is linked with an abstract model of underlying relations or causal mechanism?

- ► Historical comparative research

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Synthesis links specific evidence with an abstract model of underlying relations or causal mechanism.

- ► Social research
- ► Action research
- ► Experimental research

Question No: 43 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

AFAQ

In which section is the researcher allowed greater flexibility to express opinions, discuss implications for educational practice, and suggest additional research?

- ► Review of the literature
- ► Significance of the study
- ► Results
- ► Discussion

http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_airasian_edresearch_7/5/1492/382157.cw/index.html
MCA # 07

Question No: 44 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Which of the following can be referred as Haphazard Sampling?

- ► Convenience Sampling

Convenience sampling (also called haphazard or accidental sampling)
PAGE # 90
OR
http://www.starmass.com/en/research_sampling_method.htm

- ► Purposive Sampling
- ► Snowball Sampling **Correct**
- ► Quota Sampling

Question No: 45 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

An important issue in index construction is to----------items.

- ► Reconstruct
- ► Codify
- ► Measure
- ► Weight

An important issue in index construction is whether to weight items.
PAGE # 103

Question No: 46 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Which of the following elements of Observation is/are included in Non Reactive research?

- ► External Appearance
- ► Count Behaviors
- ► Time Duration
- ► All of the given options

Observations of Non-Reactive Observations
• External Appearance

AFAAQ

• Count Behaviors
• Time Duration
PAGE # 124

Question No: 47 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Secondary /existing data may include which of the following?

- ► Official documents
- ► Personal documents
- ► Archived research data **Correct**
- ► All of the given options

http://www.southalabama.edu/coe/bset/johnson/mcq/mc6.htm
MCQ # 07

Question No: 48 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Which of the following major problem exist with non respondents in survey research?

- ► They tend to be alike in many ways.
- ► Data cannot be analyzed for only part of a sample.
- ► They cannot be found to determine if they are similar to respondents. **Correct**
- ► They may have different opinions than respondents.

http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_airasian_edresearch_7/5/1490/381580.cw/index.html
MCQ # 05

Question No: 49 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Which of the following advantage differentiates personal interview from mail, internet and telephonic survey?

- ► Cheaper
- ► Expensive
- ► Easier
- ► Inexpensive

Question No: 50 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Which one of the following methods offers the lowest degree of geographic flexibility?

- ► Mail survey

Mail questionnaires can reach a geographically dispersed sample simultaneously and at a relatively low cost because interviewers are not required.
PAGE # 70

- ► Telephone interview

ALAAO

- ► Door-to-door personal interview
- ► Internet survey

Question No: 51 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Which of the following survey research methods is the most expensive?

- ► Telephone interview
- ► Mail survey
- ► Door-to-door personal interview

As the cost of personal interviews continues to increase
PAGE # 69

- ► Mall intercept personal interview

Question No: 52 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

When a respondent tells the interviewer that he reads "Best Selling English News Paper" on a daily basis so that he can impress the interviewer, this is an example of:

- ► Administrative bias
- ► Interviewer bias

Interviewer Bias
Interviewer's personal likings and dis-likings, the environment, and cultural biases can affect the understanding of the responses, its recording, and its interpretation.
PAGE # 66

- ► Submission bias
- ► Response bias **Correct**

Question No: 53 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

All of the following are stages in the selection of a sample **EXCEPT**:

- ► Determine sample size
- ► Analyze data
- ► Conduct fieldwork
- ► Select a sampling frame

Question No: 54 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

A stratified sample in which the number of sampling units drawn from each stratum is in proportion to the population size of that stratum is called a:

- ► Balanced stratified sample **Correct**
- ► Proportional stratified sample

The number of sampling units drawn from each stratum is in proportion to the relative population size of the stratum, the sample is proportionate stratified sampling.
Page # 94

AFAQ

► Cluster sampling
► Convenience sample

Question No: 55 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Assigning males the value of zero and females the value of one in a database to record the gender of the respondents is an example of:

► Coding

Coding
Entering the answer to survey questions into a computer in abbreviated form. For example, M for male, F for female. Coding in qualitative research uses the same principle, on a larger scale.
http://www.audiencedialogue.net/gloss-data.html
Or
Page # 99
For example, a researchers codes males as 1 and females as 2. Each category of variable and missing information needs a code. A **codebook** is a document (i.e. one or more pages) describing the coding procedure and the location of data for variables in a format that computers can use.

► Editing
► Verification
► Test tabulation

Question No: 56 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Arranging data into a table is called:

► Analysis
► Frequency
► Interpretation
► Tabulation

The classification or placing of data into tabular form is called as tabulation
http://www.tutorvista.com/math/tabulation-of-data-tutoring

Question No: 57 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

A researcher interested in a data matrix that displays the frequency of some combination of possible responses to multiple variables should construct a:

► Contingency table

A contingency table is formed by cross-tabulating the two or more variables. It is contingent because the cases in each category of a variable get distributed into each category of a second variable. The table distributes cases into categories of multiple variables at the same time and shows how the cases, by the category of one variable, are "contingent upon" the categories of the other variables

AFAQ

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- ► Regression equation
- ► Marginal table
- ► None of the given options

Question No: 58 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

When initial subjects are selected randomly and additional subjects are obtained from recommendations of names from the initial subjects, this sampling technique is called:

- ► Judgment sample
- ► Snowball

Snowball sampling is a special nonprobability method used when the desired sample characteristic is rare. It may be extremely difficult or cost prohibitive to locate respondents in these situations. Snowball sampling relies on referrals from initial subjects to generate additional subjects. While this technique can dramatically lower search costs, it comes at the expense of introducing bias because the technique itself reduces the likelihood that the sample will represent a good cross section from the population.
http://www.statpac.com/surveys/sampling.htm

- ► Convenience sample
- ► Cluster sample **Correct**

Question No: 59 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

When different interviewers are used in a pretest from those used in the posttest and this produces different results in the study, this is an example of a:

- ► History effect
- ► Mortality effect
- ► Instrumentation effect

Instrumentation Effects: Instrumentation effects are yet another source of threat to internal validity. These might arise because of a change in the measuring instrument between pretest and posttest, and not because of the instrument's differential impact at the end. For example, in a weightloss experiment, the springs on the scale weaken during the experiment, giving lower readings in the posttest.
A change in the wording of questions (may be done to avoid testing effects), change in interviewers, or change in other procedures to measure the dependent variable can cause instrumentation effect.
Performance of the subjects measured by the units of output in the pretest, but when measuring the out put in posttest the researcher measures it by "the number of units rejected, and the amount of resources expended to produce the units.
Page # 121

- ► Cohort effect

Question No: 60 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Which of the following is a threat to the internal validity of experiment using a repeated measures design?

► Instrumentation effect

Factors Affecting Internal Validity

1. History Effect:
2. Maturation Effect:
3. Testing Effects:
4. Instrumentation Effects: (Page # 121)
5. Selection Bias Effect:
6. Statistical Regression:
7. Mortality:
8. Mechanical Loss:
9. Experimenter Expectancy:

► Cohort effect
► Attrition effect
► All of the given options

Question No: 61 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Most threats to_____are taken care of by the experiment's design, while most threats to_____need to be taken care of by the designer of the experiment.

► Internal validity, external validity

http://www.coe.iup.edu/grbieger/Classes/LTCY698/Module 6/Validity.ppt#263,6

► External validity, internal validity
► Randomization, reliability
► Reliability, randomization

Question No: 62 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

In which of the following, the beginning and end are not clear. The interview can be picked up later?

► Survey Interview
► Field Interview

Field Interview
The beginning and end are not clear. The interview can be picked up later.

► Deception
► None of the given options

Question No: 63 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

The written set of guidelines that describes an outline of topics to be covered by a focus group moderator is called a:

AIAQ

- Discussion guide

The basic idea is to lay out a set of issues for the group to discuss. It is important to bear in mind that the moderator will mostly be improvising comments and questions within the framework set by the guidelines.
Page # 153

- Concept test
- Case study
- All of the given options

Question No: 64 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Which of the following is a disadvantage of focus groups?

- Requires objective, sensitive, and effective moderators
- May not be useful for discussing sensitive topics
- High cost
- All of the given options

Disadvantages of Focus Groups
Require objective, sensitive, and effective moderators.
May have unique sampling problems
May not be useful for discussing sensitive topics in face-to-face situations
Cost a considerable amount of money, particularly when they are not conducted by someone employed by the company desiring the focus group.
Higher cost

Question No: 65 (Marks: 3)

What do we write in executive summary of a research report?

Executive Summary of Research Report:

It is very important part of the report. And it is observed that mostly managers read summary report normally and rest members read whole report.

Executive summary write in four elements:
1. First objective of the report is mentioned and then most important part and specific reason of the project.

2. Main results are presented including purpose.
3. The conclusions of the report based on results.
4. The suggestions on the basis of conclusions that action will be taken
.

Question No: 66 (Marks: 5)

AHAQ

What is different Ethical dilemma of Field research?

Ans

Ethical Dilemmas of Field research

The dilemmas are made when the researchers are alone in fields and have very much little time to make decision. The ethical dilemmas raises when a field researcher get involve into lives of other people.
These dilemmas arise suddenly when some one interacting in the field with others.
Some of these dilemmas:

Confidentiality:

In field some learns a lot and some not very much, similarly some one has some confidential data and don't want to share with anyone which creates it.

Deception:

Deception may arise because of false role, name or identity, some agreed with some one and some one not some time. So because of these things this occurs.

The powerful:

Field researchers are normally those who are without power in society e.g., street people, the poor, and powerful people block their way and criticized them

Involvement with deviations:

Some researchers conduct research on deviants who engage in illegal behavior. This type of things create dilemma due to involvement in illeal activities.

Last field reports:

At the end of research, the knowledge, a researcher gains and his final report or thesis can make a dilemma between the right of privacy and the right to know. In last report if researcher hides some fact or not give the true picture of research then it creates a dilemma.

AFAQ

Question No: 67 (Marks: 10)

By using Likert scale, how would you score a positive and negative statement? Give one example to explain your answer.

Ans:

Likert scale is bused on 5 responses therefore lets take an example and constructed number of statements for each element with five responses.

- Strongly Agree
- Agree
- Undecided
- Disagree
- Strongly Disagree

These statements could be of both positive and negative.

For positive statements

We score from 5 to 1 i.e. strongly agree to strongly disagree

For negative statement

Score will be reversed i.e 1 to 5

1 for strongly agree
2 for agree
3 for undecided
4 for disagree
5 for strongly disagree

AFAAQ

Question No: 68 (Marks: 10)

How observations can be structured in non-reactive research?

Ans

In non reactive research, the people or the things that are being studied are not aware of that.

Non reactive research is structured as follow:

PHYSICAL TRACES:

• Erosion:

In erosion wear and tear has a greater use. For example, a researcher examines that children like those toys which are worn out and children have more interest in them.

ARCHIVES:

• Running Records:

In these records many researches can be done.
For example, a record of thieves in jail record of daily marriages. Etc.

• Other Records:

Irregular records can give a lot
. For example, look into the number of reams of paper purchased by a college principal's office for the last 10 years and compare it with students' enrollment.

OBSERVATIONS:

• Time Duration:

By this type of research, researcher can check the interest of people indifferent things. Like time spending in seeing the signboards on the road.

• External Appearance:

It shows the behavior of people in social factor that how they want to look.
How people appear may indicate social factors. For example, a
researcher can examine that in university how much percentage of student's wear casual dressing and how much formal.

FINALTERM EXAMINATION
Spring 2009
AFAAQ_TARIQ@YAHOO.COM
STA630- Research Methods (Session - 2)

SOLVED By Muhammad Afaaq

Marks: 80

Question No: 1 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
Which of the following is the basis of the Scientific Method?

To test hypothesis in conditions that is conducive to its success.
To formulate a research problem and disprove the hypothesis
To formulate a research problem, test the hypothesis in carefully controlled conditions that challenge the hypothesis.

http://www.uk.sagepub.com/breakwell/downloads/mcq/mcq_01/mcq_01.htm
Mcq # 01
To test hypothesis and if they are disproved, they should be abandoned completely.

Question No: 2 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
An inductive logic is one that:

Involves testing as explicitly defined hypothesis
Does not allow for findings to feed back into the body of knowledge
Uses quantitative methods whenever possible
Allows theory to emerge out of the data

http://www.oup.com/uk/ orc/bin/9780199202959/01student/cqs/ch01/
MCQ # 03
OR
The usual application of inductive theory, however, is to allow theory to emerge from our findings. We find an interesting question, we gather data on it and we 'theories' from our findings. It may be that these 'theories' are, in reality, simply 'interesting insights' rather than 'grand theories' but they can be valuable for all that.

Question No: 3 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
Which of the following is not a concept?

Leadership
Total Quality Management
Human Resource Management
Intelligence Quotient (IQ).

http://www.oup.com/uk/orc/bin/9780199284986/01student/cqs/ch06/
MCQ # 01
OR
Concepts are the building blocks of theory, each of which represents a label given to a common element of the social world. IQ is a measure of the concept of intelligence; it is not a concept in itself.

AFAAQ

Question No: 4 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
Which of the following is the definition of an independent variable?

A variable that is manipulated or controlled by the experimenter

An independent variable is a factor that can be varied or manipulated in an experiment
http://www.everythingbio.com/glos/definition.php?word=independent+variable
A response variable
The behavioral measure made by the experimenter
A dependent variable that is controlled by the experimenter

Question No: 5 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
The cause variable or the one that identifies forces or conditions that act on something else is known as:

Moderating variable
Independent variable

The cause variable, or the one that identifies forces or conditions that act on something else, is the independent variable.
PAGE # 19
Categorical variable
Dependent variable

Question No: 6 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
A measure is reliable if it provides consistent_____.

Hypothesis
Results

A measure is reliable if it provides consistent Results
http://wiki.answers.com/Q/A_measure_is_reliable_if_it_provides_consistent
Procedure
Sensitivity

Question No: 7 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
Which of the following statements relates to concurrent validity?

The measure apparently reflects the content of the concept in question.
A criterion is employed on which cases are known to differ.

http://www.oup.com/uk/orc/bin/9780199284986/01student/cqs/ch06/
MCQ # 04
A future criterion is employed on which cases are known to differ.
A measure is gauged by comparing it to measures of the same concept developed through other methods.

AFAQ

Question No: 8 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
Research may differ along a series of dimensions. Which of the following may be applied to this statement?

The type of data collected.
The data-collection technique
The level of manipulation used to elicit data collection.
All of the given options

http://www.uk.sagepub.com/breakwell/downloads/mcq/mcq_01/mcq_01.htm
MCQ # 06

Question No: 9 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
Cross cultural studies are an example of:

Comparative design

Historical-comparative research is a collection of techniques and approaches. It is a distinct type of research that puts historical time and /or cross-cultural variation at the center of research – that is, which treats what is studied as part of the flow of history and situated in cultural context.
PAGE # 142
OR
http://www.oup.com/uk/orc/bin/9780199202959/01student/cqs/ch02/
Longitudinal design
Experimental design
Case study design

Question No: 10 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
When constructing a questionnaire, there are few principles to which you should adhere. Which of the following is NOT one of those principles?

Avoid using "leading" or "loaded" questions
Avoid double-barreled questions
Avoid ambiguity and confusion
Avoid arranging questions in a sequence

PAGE # 77, 78
Guidelines for Questionnaire Design
1. Questionnaire Relevancy
2. Questionnaire Accuracy
3. Avoid Ambiguity, Confusion, and Vagueness.
4. Avoid Double-Barreled Questions
5. Avoid Leading Questions
6. Avoid Loaded Questions

AFAQ

7. Avoid Burdensome Questions that may Tax the Respondent's Memory
8. Arrange Questions in a Proper Sequence
9. Use Filter Question, if Needed
10. Layout of the questionnaire

Question No: 11 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
Which of the following statements is true about closed ended questions and open ended questions?

A closed ended question means that the chances of unreliable post-coding is small, whereas an open ended question means that there is a possibility of data processing error.
A closed ended question allows for the researchers terminology to be used, whereas an open ended question allows the respondant to use terms they are familiar with.
A closed ended question allows for easy processing, whereas coding an open-ended question can be very time consuming.
A closed ended question has many advantages over open ended question.

http://www.oup.com/uk/orc/bin/9780199284986/01student/cqs/ch10/
MCQ # 02
JUST 4 CONCEPT NOT EXACT MATCH

Question No: 12 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
Which of the following is NOT an example of a problem with using social survey research to investigate behaviour?
Respondents tend to answer by giving the most socially desirable answer.
Respondents may inadvertently omit key terms in the question.
Respondents may not give an honest reply to what they see as a threatening question.
Respondents may be unwilling to reveal information as they believe they are likely to be identified.

http://www.oup.com/uk/orc/bin/9780199284986/01student/cqs/ch11/
MCQ # 01

Question No: 13 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
Which of the following represents excellent advice for conducting an interview?

Listen more and talk less
Don't interrupt
Don't be judgmental about the interviewee's beliefs or views
All of the given options

[PPT]
Qualitative Research Methods

AIAQ

Question No: 14 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
Smaller sample sizes can be used in correlation research when;

The researcher expects no relationship between the variables.
There are only two variables to correlate.
The instruments used to measure the variables have low validity and reliability.
The instruments used to measure the variables have high validity and reliability.

http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_airasian_edresearch_7/5/1491/381698.cw/index.html
MCQ # 02

Question No: 15 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
Which of the following steps begins the analysis of qualitative data?

Reading and memoing
Describing the content and participants
Classifying and interpreting
Data management

http://wps.prenhall.com/chet airasian_edresearch_7/5/1490/381473.cw/index.html
MCQ # 06

Question No: 16 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Which of the following could NOT be a cause of variation in high school achievement?

Reading ability
Parental involvement
Teacher expectations
College attendance

http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_airasian_edresearch_7/5/1491/381743.cw/index.htmlQuestionNo:11
MCQ # 11

Question No: 17 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
The statistic used to determine the relationship between two variables is:

Analysis of covariance
Chi square
Standard deviation
Pearson "r"

AFAAQ

http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_airasian_edresearch_7/5/1491/381743.cw/index.htmlQuestionNo:22
MCQ # 17
OR
The correlation between two variables reflects the degree to which the variables are related. The most common measure of correlation is the Pearson Product Moment Correlation (called Pearson's correlation for short).

Question No: 18 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
A researcher studies three groups of students who vary in level of self-confidence. She finds that students with higher self-confidence are more popular among their peers. The most plausible conclusion is that:

We do not know what causes self-confidence or popularity.
Self-confidence causes popularity.
Popularity causes self-confidence.
Self-confidence and popularity are related.

http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_airasian_edresearch_7/5/1491/381743.cw/index.html
MCQ # 07

Question No: 19 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
Which of the following is true about validity?
A study can be internally valid but not externally valid.
A study can be externally valid but not internally valid.
A study must be both internally and externally valid.

http://www.docstoc.com/docs/14330216/Bias-in-Clinical-Research
SLIDE # 03
The internal and external validity of studies are not related in any way.

Question No: 20 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
Testing most likely, negatively affect internal validity when:

The information tested is attitudinal in nature
The time between pre- and posttest is short

http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_airasian_edresearch_7/5/1491/381818.cw/index.html
MCQ # 10
The instrument is unreliable
The participants are very low scorers

Question No: 21 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
Ecological validity refers to:

The participants to whom results generalize

AIAQ

The instruments used to measure the independent and dependent variables
The internal validity of a study
The context to which results generalize

http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_airasian_edresearch_8/38/9869/2526465.cw/index.html
MCQ # 01

Question No: 22 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
Which one is not the part of non reactive research?

Physical traces
Archives
Observations
Interviews

Varieties of Non-Reactive Observations
Physical Traces:
Archives:
Observations:
PAGE 124

Question No: 23 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
Which advice would you offer a novice researcher conducting his first observation?

Observe only one behavior at a time

http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_airasian_edresearch_8/38/9871/2526978.cw/index.html
MCQ # 08

Allow variables to emerge from the context
Record behaviors only after leaving the site
Develop a preconceived notion of what is going to help structure the observation

Question No: 24 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
How the Procedure for data processing and analysis can be evaluated in Pilot Testing?

Make dummy tables

Procedure for data processing and analysis can be evaluated:
Make dummy tables. See how can we tabulate the data and use the appropriate statistics for purposes of interpretations
Page # 81

Work output of each member
Length of Questionnaire
Format Tools

AFAQ

Question No: 25 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
Which of the following is the complete group of specific population elements relevant to the research project?

Element
Target Population

Target population is the complete group of specific population elements relevant to the research project.
Page # 88
OR
http://www.ehes.info/manuals/EHES_manual/PartA/EHES_Manual_PartA_Chapter2.pdf

Sampling Frame
Sampling Unit

Question No: 26 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
Which of the following is the summary description of a given variable in a population?

Statistic
Observation Unit
Parameter

A parameter is the summary description of a given variable in a population.
Page # 89

Sampling Unit

Question No: 27 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
Which of the following is that element or set of elements considered for selection in some stage of sampling?
Parameter
Sampling Unit

A sampling unit is that element or set of elements considered for selection in some stage of sampling. Sampling may be done in single stage or in multiple stages.
Page # 89

Observation Unit
Statistic

Question No: 28 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
If you are going on the street and suddenly a TV reporter starts taking your interview regarding any issue, which of the following sampling technique is used by the TV reporter?

AFAQ

Purposive Sampling
Snowball Sampling
Convenience Sampling

Convenience Sampling
Convenience sampling (also called *haphazard or accidental sampling*)refers to sampling by obtaining units or people who are most conveniently available. For example, it may be convenient and economical to sample employees in companies in a nearby area, sample from a pool of friends and neighbors. The person-on-the street interview conducted by TV programs is another example. TV interviewers go on the street with camera and microphone to talk to few people who are convenient to interview. The people walking past a
TV studio in thee middle of the day do not represent everyone homemakers, people in the rural areas). Likewise, TV interviewers select people who look "normal" to them and avoid people who are unattractive, poor, very old, or inarticulate.
PAGE # 90

Quota Sampling

Question No: 29 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
Which of the following sampling is most often used during the exploratory phase of are search project and is perhaps the best way of getting some basic information quickly and efficiently?

Convenience Sampling

Convenience sampling is most often used during the exploratory phase of a research project and is perhaps the best way of getting some basic information quickly and efficiently. Often such sample is taken to test ideas or even to gain ideas about a subject of interest.
Page #90

Quota Sampling
Snowball Sampling
Purposive Sampling

Question No: 30 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
Which of the following sampling method is the best way to select a group of people for a study if you are interested in making statements about the larger population?

Convenience sampling
Quota sampling
Purposive sampling
Random sampling

AIAC

http://www.southalabama.edu/coe/bset/johnson/mcq/mc7.htm
MCQ# 27

Question No: 31 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
In which of the following conditions, each part of the construct should be measured with at least one indicator?

Unidimensionality
Scale
Weighing
Index Construction

Each part of the construct should be measured with at least one indicator. Of course, it is better to measure the parts of a construct with multiple indicators.
Page # 102

Question No: 32 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
Which of the following number of variables involved in Descriptive Statistics?

Bivariate
Multivariate
Univariate
All of the given options

Descriptive statistics describe numerical data. They can be categorized by the number of variables involved: univariate, bivariate, or multivariate
Page # 105

Question No: 33 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
All of the following are types of personal communication, except;

Letters
Memos
Telephone conversations
Emails

Personal communication through letters, memos, telephone conversations,
Page # 167

Question No: 34 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
Which of the following terms refers to a statistical method that can be used to statistically equate groups on a pretest or some other variable?

Experimental control

AIAQ

Differential influence
Matching
Analysis of covariance

http://www.southalabama.edu/coe/bset/johnson/mcq/mc9.htm
MCQ # 07

Question No: 35 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
In an experimental research study, the primary goal is to isolate and identify the effect produced by which of the following?

Dependent variable
Extraneous variable
Independent variable

http://www.southalabama.edu/coe/bset/johnson/mcq/mc9.htm
MCQ # 23
Confounding variable

Question No: 36 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
Which of the following is referred to as the influence of a single independent variable?

Interaction effect
Reactive effect
Main effect

http://www.southalabama.edu/coe/bset/johnson/mcq/mc9.htm
MCQ # 27
Proactive effect

Question No: 37 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
Which of the following is the process of marking segments of data with symbols, descriptive words or category?

Concurring
Coding

http://www.southalabama.edu/coe/bset/johnson/mcq/mc17.htm
MCQ # 07

Coloring
Segmenting

Question No: 38 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
A census taker often collects data through which of the following?

AFAQ

Standardized tests
Interviews

http://www.southalabama.edu/coe/bset/johnson/mcq/mc6.htm
MCQ # 20

Secondary data
Observations

Question No: 39 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
Which one is NOT an advantage of personal interviewing?
Interviewer influence

Disadvantages of Personal Interviewing:
5. Interviewer Influence
PAGE # 66

Probing complex questions
Visual aids
High completion rate

Question No: 40 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
All of the following are the characteristics of scientific methods of research, EXCEPT;

Cumulative
Deterministic
Unethical

Important Characteristics of Scientific Method

3. Cumulative
4. Deterministic
7. Rationalism
PAGE # 3, 4, 5

Rationalism

Question No: 41 (Marks: 5)
What are different Ethical Dilemmas of Field research?

Question No: 42 (Marks: 5)
What different measures of central tendency are used? Define each.

Question No: 43 (Marks: 10)
What are different steps in field research?

AFAQ

Question No: 44 (Marks: 10)
How historical comparative research is similar to field research?

Question No: 45 (Marks: 10)
Mr. Ali is a researcher in a well reputed research organization and he is using Stratified Random sampling in his research. You are required to identify the reasons why researchers use the Stratified Random Sampling?

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Question # 1 of 10 (Start time: 11:30:13 AM) Total Marks: 1

What is ordinal data?

Select correct option:

Ordinary data

Well behaved data

Ranked data

Numbers

Question # 2 of 10 (Start time: 11:31:2 AM) Total Mar 1

The organization of concepts in sequence from the most concrete and individual to the most general indicates:

Select correct option:

One that has no relation to the underlying concept.

An abstract conceptual definition of a concept.

The degree of abstraction

An operational definition

Question # 3 of 10 (time: 11:31:57 AM) Total Marks: 1

The facts that should be collected to measure a variable, depend upon the

Select correct option:

Conceptual understanding

Dictionary meaning

Operational definition

All of the above

Ataaq

Question # 4 of 10 (Start time: 11:32:19 AM) Total Marks: 1
Under which of the following research method is not applicable?
Select correct option:

Health care
Business
Government offices
Imaginary worlds

Question # 6 of 10 (Start time: 11:34:03 AM) Total Marks: 1
A one tailed hypothesis predicts----------
Select correct option:

The future
The lottery result
The frequency of the ef
The direction of the effect

Question # 10 (Start time: 11:3 AM) Total Marks: 1
What researc
Select correct option:

A lab experiment
A report
A systematic Enquiry
A survey

Question # 8 of 10 (Start time: 11:34:48 AM) Total Marks: 1
Which of the following is not a proper way to write a literature review?
Select correct option:

Ataaq

Organize common findings or arguments together.

List down a series of research reports with a summary of the findings of each.

Logically link statements or findings,

Address the most important ideas first.

Question # 9 of 10 (Start time: 11:35:34 AM) Total Marks: 1

Logical relationship among the factors identified in the literature review is called_____.

Select correct option:

Research question

Theatrical framework

Problem statement

None of the given options

Question # 10 of 10 (Start time: 11:36:14 AM) Total Marks: 1

Qualitative and Quantitative research are the classification of research on the basis of

Select correct option:

Use of the research

Time dime

Techniques used

Purpose of the researc

Question # 1 of 15 (Start time: 09:40:48 AM) Total Marks: 1

A Literature review that summarizes what is known at a point in time is known as:

Select correct option:

Narrative literature review

Systematic literature review

Integrative review

Historical review

Afaaq

Question # 2 of 15 (Start time: 09:41:11 AM) Total Marks: 1
The purpose of a literature review is to:
Select correct option:

Help you find out what is already known about this area.

Identify any inconsistencies or gaps in the literature.
Demonstrate an awareness of the theoretical context in which the current study can be located.
All of the given options

Question # 3 of 15 (Start time: 09:41:59 AM) Total Marks: 1
What is a relationship between the literature survey and the theoretical framework?
Select correct option:

Literature survey provides a solid foundation for developing the theoretical framework.
Literature survey helps in the identification of the relevant variables.
Literature survey helps in identifying the relationship among variables.
All of the given options

Question # 4 of 15 (Start time: 09:42:25 AM) Total Marks: 1
Which of the following provides a solid basis foundation for the theoretical framework?
Select correct option:

Survey
Literature Review
Experiment
Referencing

Question # 5 of 15 (Start time: 09:42:47 AM) Total Marks: 1
What is a cross-sectional research?
Select correct option:

Afaaq

A study of one particular section of society
A comparison of two or more variables over a long period of time
The collection of data from more than one case at one moment in time
One that is conducted when environment is uncertain

Question # 6 of 15 (Start time: 09:43:14 AM) Total Marks: 1
Logical relationship among the factors identified in the literature is called_____.
Select correct option:

Research question
Theatrical framework
Problem statement
None of the given options

Question # 7 of 15 (Start time: 09:43:38 AM) Total Marks: 1
Hypothesis refers to_____:
Select correct option:

The outcome of an experiment
A conclusion drawn from an experiment
A form of bias in which the subject tries to outguess the experimenter
A tentative statement about the relationship

Question # 8 of 15 (Start time: 09:45:09 AM) Total Marks: 1
Which of the following is Not a source of Literature review?
Select correct option:

Scholarly journals
Experiment
Dissertations
Bibliographical indexes

Ataaq

Question # 9 of 15 (Start time: 09:45:39 AM) Total Marks: 1
Qualitative and Quantitative Research are the classifications of research on the basis of
Select correct option:

Use of the research
Time dimension
Techniques used
Purpose of the research

Question # 10 of 15 (Start time: 09:46:42 AM) Total Marks: 1
Which of following statement is true?
Select correct option:

Theory and Research are dichotomous
Theory and Research are interrelated
There is no difference between Theory and Research
None of the given statements is true

Question # 11 of 15 (Start time: 09:47:06 AM) Total Marks: 1
Which of the following is not a feature of theoretical framework?
Select correct option:

Making an inventory of variables

Specify the direction of relationship

Presenting findings
Making an inventory of propositions

Question # 12 of 15 (Start time: 09:47:27 AM) Total Marks: 1
To say that a theory is falsifiable is to say that;
Select correct option:

It is based on results that are not replicable.

Afaaq

Investigators have replaced it with a simpler or more accurate theory.

We can imagine results that would contradict it.

It is so vague that it fits any and all possible results.

Question # 13 of 15 (Start time: 09:47:54 AM) Total Marks: 1

The following journal article would be an example of_____research;

"The benefits of florescent lighting on production in a factory setting."

Select correct option:

Applied

Interview

Basic

Stupid

Question # 14 of 15 (Start time: 09:48:09 AM) Total Marks: 1

What type of process research is

Select correct option:

A process to discover the truth

A process to invent theories

A process to make new medicines

A process to create theories

Question # 15 of 15 (Start time: 09:48:45 AM) Total Marks: 1

"The extensive use of chocolate causes pimples". The given hypothesis is a (an):

Select correct option:

Descriptive hypothesis

Ataaq

Explanatory hypothesis
Non-Directional hypothesis
Co-relational hypothesis

Question # 1 of 15 (Start time: 01:06:18 PM) Total Marks: 1
_____ meanings attached to a concept create problems of measurements.

Select correct option:

Unambiguous

Vague

Clear

Question # 2 of 15 (Start time: 01:07:22 PM) Total Marks: 1
Which of the following is an example of value in research
Select correct option:

Conscious favor
Sympathy for the loser
Unstructured interviewing
None of the given options

Question # 3 of 15 (Start time: 01:08:49 PM) Total Marks: 1
The scientific method is preferred over other ways of knowing because it is more;
Select correct option:

Reliable

Systematic

Accurate

Afaaq

All of the given options

Question # 4 of 15 (Start time: 01:09:30 PM) Total Marks: 1
In the statement "high motivation results in high efficiency" motivation is the:
Select correct option:

Independent variable
Dependent variable
Extraneous variable
Causal variable

Question # 5 of 15 (Start time: 01:10:48 PM) Total Marks: 1
"Skepticism" is a norm of science. It is better explained by which of the following statement?
Select correct option:

Combining the previous knowledg
Critical reading of the previous researches
Providing the proper refer of qoute ext
Locating research reports in li ies

Question # 6 of 15 (Start time: 01:11:23 PM) Total Marks: 1
Qualitative and Quantitative Research are the classifications of research on the basis of
Select correct option:

Use of the research
Time dimension
Techniques used
Purpose of the research

Question # 7 of 15 (Start time: 01:12:53 PM) Total Marks: 1
What is an hypothesis?
Select correct option:

Ataq

A prediction of a relationship between certain variables.

An experiment that tests certain predictions.

An independent variable.
A dependent variable.

Question # 8 of 15 (Start time: 01:14:01 PM) Total Marks: 1
What is the final step of a scientific investigation?
Select correct option:

Analyze data
Collect data
Report the findings
Determine whether the hypothesis was support

Question # 9 of 15 (S time: 01 PM) Marks: 1
Which of the following s ld not be a co sidera n writing a proposal?
Select correct option:

Understan he problem situat

The appearan e/form posal

Responding to every element exactly as specified by the client

Knowing as much a ssible about the proposal recipients

Question # 10 of 15 (Start time: 01:15:07 PM) Total Marks: 1
To explain, predict, and/or control phenomena are the goal
of----------
Select correct option:

Ataaq

Tradition

Inductive logic

Deductive logic

The scientific method

Question # 11 of 15 (Start time: 01:15:40 PM) Total Marks: 1
Research questions are crucial because they will:
Select correct option:

Guide your decisions about what data to collect and from where.

Help you decide which research area interests you.

Ensure that your findings have external validity.

Prevent you from thinking about research strategy

Question # of 15 (Start time: 6:07 PM) Total Marks: 1
Which of the following is Not a part of research design?
Select correct option:

Data collection technique
Tool of data collection
Objectives of the study
Data processing and analysis

Question # 13 of 15 (Start time: 01:16:39 PM) Total Marks: 1
Which of the following statements is true?
Select correct option:

All concepts are variables and all variables are concepts

Ataan

All variables are concepts but all concepts are not variable

All concepts are variable but all variables are not concepts

None of the above

Question # 14 of 15 (Start time: 01:17:43 PM) Total Marks: 1

A Literature review that summarizes what is known at a point in time is known as:

Select correct option:

Narrative literature review

Systematic literature review

Integrative review

Historical review

Question # 15 of 15 (Start time: 01:18:15 PM) Total Mark

Under which of the following research method is not applicable?

Select correct option:

Health care

Business

Government offices

Imaginary worlds

Question # 1 of 1(tart time: 0 10:36 PM) Total Marks: 1

Which of the following is an example of value-free research?

Select correct optio

Conscious favor

Sympathy for the loser

Unstructured interviewing

None of the given options

Question # 2 of 15 (Start time: 03:11:13 PM) Total Marks: 1

A literature review requires;

Select correct option:

planning

Afaaq

clear w riting
good writing
All of the given option

Question # 3 of 15 (Start time: 03:11:32 PM) Total Marks: 1
What type of process research is?
Select correct option:
A process to discover the truth
A process to invent the machines
A process to make new medicines
A process to create theories

Question # 4 of 15 (Start time: 03:12:15 PM) Total Marks: 1
Why do you need to review the existing literature?
Select correct option:
To give your dissertation a proper academic appearance, with lots of references
Because without it, you never reach th required word-count
To find out what is already know n about your area of interest
To help in your general stu

Question # 5 of 15 (Start time: 03:13:19 PM) Total Marks: 1
What is the final step of a scientific investigation?
Select correct option:
Analyze data
Collect data
Report the findings
Determine w hether the hypothesis w as supported

Question # 6 of 15 (Start time: 03:13:51 PM) Total Marks: 1
When we say that science is parsimonious, we mean that:
Select correct option:
Scientific theories are based on law s.
We must be careful because causes can occur afte specific effects.

Aiaq

The best scientific theories are those that offer the simplest explanations for a law.

Question # 8 of 15 (Start time: 03:15:02 PM) Total Marks: 1
Which of the following is a discrete variable?
Select correct option:
Age
Nationality
Test score
Income
Click here to Save Answ er & Move to Next Question
Answer is Nationality

Question # 9 of 15 (Start time: 03:16:06 PM) Total Marks: 1
"Skepticism" is a norm of science. It is better explain[illegible]hich of t[illegible] following statement?
Select correct option:
Combining the previous know ledge
Critical reading of the previous researches
Providing the proper ref[illegible]ences of qo[illegible]d text
Locating research report[illegible]libr[illegible]es

Question # 10 of 15 (Start time[illegible]16:39 PM[illegible] Marks: 1
Which of fo[illegible]ng statement is true
Select corre[illegible]op[illegible]
Theory and Re[illegible]earch a[illegible]tonomous
Theory and Research are interrelated
There is no differe[illegible]ce between t[illegible]heory and Researc
None of the given s[illegible]tements is true

Question # 11 of 15 (Start time: 03:17:05 PM) Total Marks: 1
Which of the following activities is Not included in debriefing?
Select correct option:
Explanation of any deception
Post study result sharing
Obtaining informed consent
Description of the purpose of study

Ataaq

Question # 12 of 15 (Start time: 03:17:59 PM) Total Marks: 1
The operational definition is also known as
Select correct option:
Working definition
Nominal definition
Conceptual definition
Dictionary definition

Question # 13 of 15 (Start time: 03:18:34 PM) Total Marks: 1
Which of the following statements is true?
Select correct option:
All concepts are variables and all variables are concepts
All variables are concepts but all concepts are not variable
All concepts are variable but all variables are not concepts
None of the above

Question # 14 of 15 (Start time: 03:19:24 PM) Total Marks: 1
Which of the following is Not included in research proposal?
Select correct option:
Problem Statement
Research Design
Results
Bibliography

Question # 15 of 15 (Start time: 03:20:[illegible] PM) Total Marks: 1
The scientific method is [illegible]ed over other ways of knowing because it is more;
Select correct option:
Reliable
Systematic
Accurate
All of the given options

Ataa

Question # 1 of 15 (Start time: 11:08:56 AM) Total Marks: 1
Under which of the following research method is not applicable?

Select correct option:

Health care
Business
Government offices
Imaginary worlds

Question # 2 of 15 (Start time: 11:09:46 AM) Total Marks: 1
The term "Extrapolation" is better explained by the statement:
Select correct option:

Facts lead to the rejection of theory
Identification the gap in knowledge
Theory predicts facts
None of the given options

Question # 3 of 15 (Start time: 11:10:10 AM) Total Marks: 1
Which of the following is not a purpose of a literature review?
Select correct option:

Helps you find out what is already known about this area.
Helps you in getting response from the respondents
Helps you in developing theoretical framework.
Helps you to collect ideas from others and stimulate new ideas.

Question # 4 of 15 (Start time: 11:10:53 AM) Total Marks: 1
A good qualitative problem statement:
Select correct option:

Defines the independent and dependent variables

Conveys a sense of emerging design

Specifies a research hypothesis to be tested
Specifies the relationship between variables that the researcher expects to find.

Afaq

Question # 5 of 15 (Start time: 11:11:31 AM) Total Marks: 1
Qualitative and Quantitative Research are the classifications of research on the basis of
Select correct option:

Use of the research
Time dimension
Techniques used
Purpose of the research

Question # 6 of 15 (Start time: 11:11:59 AM) Total Marks: 1
A statement concerned with the logical relationship among the concepts is called_____.
Select correct option:

Abstract
Theory
Proposition
Research statement

Question # 7 of 15 (Start time: 11:12:17 AM) Total Marks: 1
When we say the science is parsimonious, we mean that:
Select correct option:

Scientific theories are based on laws.

We must be careful because causes can occur after specific effects.

The best scientific theories are those that offer the simplest explanations for a law.

Science accurately describes a wide range of behavior.

Question # 8 of 15 (Start time: 11:13:43 AM) Total Marks: 1

Afaaq

What is a relationship between the literature survey and the theoretical framework?
Select correct option:

Literature survey provides a solid foundation for developing the theoretical framework.
Literature survey helps in the identification of the relevant variables.
Literature survey helps in the identifying the relationship among variables.
All of the given options

Question # 9 of 15 (Start time: 11:14:03 AM) Total Marks:
Which of the following is Not helpful in problem definition?
Select correct option:

Discussion with professionals
Hypothesis
Literature survey
Preliminary data collection

Question # 10 of 15 (Start: 11:15:18 AM) Total Marks: 1
Basic and Applied Research are the classifications of research on the basis of:
Select correct option:

Use of the research
Time dimension
Techniques used
Purpose of the research

Question # 11 of 15 (Start time: 11:15:48 AM) Total Marks: 1
Before a researcher specified the relationship among variables, he must have a (an):
Select correct option:

Inventory of variables
Inventory of propositions

Ataaq

Arrangement of propositions
Schematic diagram

Question # 12 of 15 (Start time: 11:16:10 AM) Total Marks: 1
All of the following are true about theories, except;
Select correct option:

They organize and summarize existing knowledge about a topic.

They are tentative until the facts prove them true.

They provide possible explanations for the phenomenon under study

They lead to testable hypotheses through the process of deduction.

Question # 13 of 15 (Start time: 11:16:50 AM) Total Marks: 1
The application of the scientific method to the study of business problems is called;
Select correct option:

Inductive reasoning

Deductive reasoning

Business research

Grounded theory

Question # 14 of 15 (Start time: 11:17:10 AM) Total Marks: 1
What is the final step of a scientific investigation?
Select correct option:

Analyze data
Collect data
Report the findings
Determine whether the hypothesis was supported

Afaaq

Question # 15 of 15 (Start time: 11:17:36 AM) Total Marks: 1
Which of the following is an example of value-free research?
Select correct option:

Conscious favor
Sympathy for the loser
Unstructured interviewing
None of the given options

Question # 1 of 15 (Start time: 10:26:09 AM) Total Marks: 1
What is the first step in the research process?
Select correct option:

Preliminary data collection

Problem definition

Theoretical framework

Define broad problem area

Question # 15 (Start time: 10:2 AM) Total Marks: 1
The scientific me preferred over r ways of knowing because it is more;
Select correct option:

Reliable

Systematic

Accurate

All of the given options

Question # 3 of 15 (Start time: 10:27:27 AM) Total Marks: 1
Which one of the following is not an assumption of science?

Afaaq

Select correct option:

There are reoccurring patterns in the world.

Events happen because of preceding causes.

We can discover solutions to problems of interest.

Theoretical explanations must agree with common sense.

Question # 4 of 15 (Start time: 10:28:08 AM) Total Marks: 1
The following journal article would be an example of_____research;
"The benefits of florescent lighting on production in a factory setting."
Select correct option:

Applied

Interview

Basic

Stupid

Question # 5 of 15 (Start time: 10:28:57 AM) Total Marks: 1
When we say that a science is parsimonious, we mean that:
Select correct option:

Scientific theories are based on laws.

We must be careful because causes can occur after specific effects.

The best scientific theories are those that offer the simplest explanations for a law.

Science accurately describes a wide range of behavior.

Question # 6 of 15 (Start time: 10:29:05 AM) Total Marks: 1

Ataaq

A Literature review that summarizes what is known at a point in time is known as:
Select correct option:

Narrative literature review
Systematic literature review
Integrative review
Historical review

Question # 7 of 15 (Start time: 10:29:32 AM) Total Marks: 1
What is a cross-sectional research?
Select correct option:

A study of one particular section of society
A comparison of two or more variables over a long p[illegible] time
The collection of data from more than one case at one mo[illegible] in time
One that is conducted when environment is unce[illegible]n

Question # 8 of 15 (Start[illegible]:30:06 AM) Total[illegible]s: 1
The elaboration of the varia[illegible]n the theo[illegible]cal fra[illegible]mework addresses which type of qestions?
Select cor[illegible]tion:

Why we exp[illegible]ct certa[illegible]hips to exist
How we expect cert[illegible]n relatio[illegible]s to exist
Both of the given questions
None of the given questions

Question # 9 of 15 (Start time: 10:30:32 AM) Total Marks: 1
Which of the following is Not a part of research design?
Select correct option:

Data collection technique
Tool of data collection
Objectives of the study
Data processing and analysis

Ataaq

Question # 10 of 15 (Start time: 10:31:10 AM) Total Marks: 1
In the statement 'an examination of the effects of discretionary behaviour on employee performance' employee performance is the:
Select correct option:

Independent variable
Dependent variable
Extraneous variable
Causal variable

Question # 11 of 15 (Start time: 10:31:30 AM) Total Mark :
Research questions are crucial because they will:
Select correct option:

Guide your decisions about what data to collect and from where.

Help you decide which research area interests you.

Ensure that your findings have external validity.

Prevent you from thinking about research strategies.

Question # 12 of 15 (Start time: 10:31:00 AM) Total Marks: 1
Which of the following steps of the scientific method is exemplified by the researcher reviewing the literature and focusing on a specific problem that has yet to be resolved?
Select correct option:

Identify a topic.

Describe the procedures to collect information.

Analyze the collected information.

State the results of the data analysis.

Afaaq

Question # 13 of 15 (Start time: 10:32:25 AM) Total Marks: 1
"There is no relationship between advertising and sales of product A" The given hypothesis is a (an):
Select correct option:

Descriptive hypothesis
Correlational hypothesis
Null hypothesis
Alternative hypothesis

Question # 14 of 15 (Start time: 10:33:55 AM) Total Marks: 1
Quantitative researcher's preoccupation with generalization often attempts to:
Select correct option:

Develop the law like findings of the natural sciences.
Boost their chances of publication.
Enhance the internal validity of the research.
Demonstrate the competence techniques of statistical analysis.

Question # 15 of 15 (Start time: 10:34:28 AM) Total Marks: 1
Logical relationship among the factors identified in the literature review is called_____
Select correct option:

Research question
Theatrical framework
Problem statement
None of the given options

Question # 1 of 15 (Start time: 10:36:31 AM) Total Marks: 1
Which of the following is not an unethical issue?
Select correct option:

Invoicing irregularities

Afaq

Avoiding legal liability

Misrepresenting results

None of the given options

Question # 2 of 15 (Start time: 10:36:58 AM) Total Marks: 1
What research is?
Select correct option:

A lab experiment
A report
A systematic Enquiry
A survey

Question # 3 of 15 (Start time: 10:37:15 AM) Total Marks: 1
Theoretical framework is trying to develop a _____ model of our study.
Select correct option:

Functional

Conceptual

Operational

Practical

Question # 4 of 15 (Start time: 10:37:33 AM) Total Marks: 1
Which of the following is Not included in the Introduction section of a Research proposal?
Select correct option:

Background of the study
Objectives
Sampling technique

Afaaq

Significance

Question # 5 of 15 (Start time: 10:37:46 AM) Total Marks: 1
A variable is:
Select correct option:

Any characteristic of interest that can take on more than one value

Defined as the groups manipulated in experimental research

The complete set of scores we use in statistical analysis

Completely specified only in observational research

Question # 6 of 15 (Start time: 10:38:01 AM) T[illegible] Mark
After a researcher has stated the specific problem to be studied in an experiment, he must then develop a(n):
Select correct option:

Theory

Conclusion

Hypothesis

Summary of the data

Question # 7 of 15 ([illegible]rt time: 10:38:15 AM) Total Marks: 1
Ms. Roshi has been coordinating the Annual Festival at her school for the last several years. She wants to be sure the students and parents enjoy the festival again this year. On which source is she LEAST likely to rely when making decisions about what to do?
Select correct option:

Tradition

Personal experience

Afaaq

Research

Expert opinion

Question # 8 of 15 (Start time: 10:38:29 AM) Total Marks: 1
Which of the following terms represents the most general, broad concept?
Select correct option:

Test

Assessment

Measurement

Instrument

Question # 9 of 15 (Start time: 10:38:55 AM) Total Marks: 1
Which of the following is Not a technique to narrow down the broad problem area?
Select correct option:

Doing a literature survey
Ask questions from the knowledgeable person
Consider the in specific context
Decide about the sample

Question # 10 of 15 (Start time: 10:40:06 AM) Total Marks: 1
Which of the following activities is Not included in debriefing?
Select correct option:

Explanation of any deception
Post study result sharing
Obtaining informed consent
Description of the purpose of study

Question # 11 of 15 (Start time: 10:41:22 AM) Total Marks: 1

Afaaq

The independent variable is;
Select correct option:

The variable manipulated in order to observe its effects
The variable that is measured
The free spirited variable
A confounding variable

Question # 12 of 15 (Start time: 10:41:38 AM) Total Marks: 1
Logical relationship among the factors identified in the literature review is called_____.
Select correct option:

Research question
Theatrical framework
Problem statement
None of the given options

Question # 13 of 15 (Start time: 10:42:55 AM) Total Marks: 1
The term "Extrapolation" is better explained by the statement:
Select correct option:

Facts lead to the rejection of the
Identification of gap in knowledg
Theory predicts facts
None of the given options

Question # 14 of 15 (Start time: 10:43:14 AM) Total Marks: 1
Which of the following is most helpful in defining research problem?
Select correct option:

Hypothesis
Preliminary data collection
Descriptive research
Theoretical framework

Ataaq

Question # 15 of 15 (Start time: 10:44:17 AM) Total Marks: 1
If a measure is consistent over multiple occasions, it has:
Select correct option:

Inter-rater reliability

Construct validity

Internal validity

Test-retest reliability

Sta 630 quiz solved

The following journal article would be an example of _____ research; "The benefits of florescent lighting on production in a factory setting."
Select correct option:

Applied

Interview

Basic

Stupid

Before a researcher specified the relationship among variables, he must have a (an):
Select correct option:

Inventory of variables

Inventory of propositions

Arrangement of propositions

Schematic diagram

Afaaq

To say that a theory is falsifiable is to say that;
Select correct option:

It is based on results that are not replicable.

Investigators have replaced it with a simpler or more accurate theory.

We can imagine results that would contradict it.

It is so vague that it fits any and all possible results.

Which of the following is Not a part of research design
Select correct option:

Data collection technique

Tool of data collection

Objectives of the study

Data processing and analysis

The facts t[illegible]uld be collecte[illegible]measure a variable, depend upon the
Select correct optio[illegible]

Conceptual understanding

Dictionary meaning

Operational definition

All of the above

What is opposite of a variable?
Select correct option:

Ataaq

A constant

An extraneous variable

A dependent variable

A data set

Which of the following statements is true?
Select correct option:

All concepts are variables and all variables are concepts

All variables are concepts but all concepts are not variable

All concepts are variable but all variables are not concept

None of the above

The scientific method is preferred over other ways of knowing because it is more;
Select correct option:

Reliable

Systematic

Accurate

All of the given options

Which of the following is not a feature of theoretical framework?
Select correct option:

Making an inventory of variables

Specify the direction of relationship

Presenting findings

Afaan

Making an inventory of propositions

A statement concerned with the logical relationship among the concepts is called_____.
Select correct option:

Abstract

Theory

Proposition

Research statement

Logical relationship among the factors identified in the literature review is called_____.
Select correct option:

Research question

Theatrical framework

Problem statement

None of the given options

What is the first step in the research process?
Select correct option:

Preliminary data collection

Problem definition

Theoretical framework

Define broad problem area

Ataaq

The researcher protects the confidentiality in following ways, Except;
Select correct option:

Obtaining signed nondisclosure documents

Restricting access to data instruments where the respondent is identified.

Disclosure of data subsets

Restricting access to respondent identification

What is required if there is a chance that data could harm t respondents?
Select correct option:

Change of results

A signed form detailing the types of limits

Free consent of respondents

All of the given options

Which of following is mo t h l in defining research problem?
Select cor ion:

Hypothesis

Preliminary data c ection

Descriptive researc

Theoretical framework

Which of the following is Not a technique to narrow down the broad problem area?
Select correct option:

Doing a literature survey

Ataaq

Ask questions from the knowledgeable persons

Consider topic in specific context

The elaboration of the variables in the theoretical framework addresses which type of qestions?
Select correct option:

Why we expect certain relationships to exist

How we expect certain relationships to exist

Both of the given questions

None of the given questions

Which of the following is included in research proposal?
Select correct option:

Data analysis

Results

Literature review

Conclusions section

Rationalism is the application of:
Select correct option:

Research solution

Logic and arguments

Traditions

Previous findings

Afaaq

Which of the following provides a solid basis foundation for the theoretical framework?
Select correct option:

Survey

Literature Review

Experiment

Referencing

Which of the following is Not included in research proposal?
Select correct option:

Problem Statement

Research Design

Results

Bibliography

An operational definition is:
Select correct option:

One that bears no relation to the underlying concept

An abstract, theoretical definition of a concept

A definition of a concept in terms of specific, empirical measures

One that refers to opera singers and their work

Which of the following should not be a consideration in writing a proposal?
Select correct option:

Afaaq

Understanding the problem situation

The appearance/form of the proposal

Responding to every element exactly as specified by the client

Knowing as much as possible about the proposal recipients

Which of the following is the best hypothesis statement to address the research question, "What impact will the new advertising cam[illegible] have on use of Brand B?"
Select correct option:

The new advertising campaign will impact Brand B usage.

The new advertising campaign will increase Brand [illegible]rial.

The new advertising cam[illegible] will caus[illegible]ed Bran[illegible]sa[illegible]t the expense of Brand C.

The new advertising camp[illegible] will increase[illegible]rand B's market penetration.

The term "Ext[illegible]pola[illegible]on" is [illegible]er explained by the statement:
Select correct o[illegible]on:

Facts lead to the rej[illegible]of theory

Identification of the gap in knowledge

Theory predicts facts

None of the given options

"The extensive use of chocolate causes pimples". The given hypothesis is a (an):

Afaaq

Select correct option:

Descriptive hypothesis

Explanatory hypothesis

Non-Directional hypothesis

Co-relational hypothesis

The facts that should be collected to measure a variable, d upon the
Select correct option:

Conceptual understanding

Dictionary meaning

Operational definition

All of the above

Which of the following i t likely t r as an ethical problem with e-researc
Select cor on:

People are not likely to be able to stop once they have begun participating.

Informed consent c not be completely monitored.

Debriefing could be a oided.

Privacy could be invaded.

A concept is a generalized idea about----.
Select correct option:

A class of objects

Afaaq

Attributes

Occurrences

All of the given options

What is opposite of a variable?
Select correct option:

A constant

An extraneous variable

A dependent variable

A data set

"High productivity is positively associated with job commitment". The given hypothesis is a(an):
Select correct option

Descriptive hypothesis

Explanatory hypothesis

Non-Directional hypothesis

Co-relational hypothesis

Which of the following steps of the scientific method is exemplified by the researcher reviewing the literature and focusing on a specific problem that has yet to be resolved?
Select correct option:

Identify a topic.

Describe the procedures to collect information.

Analyze the collected information.

State the results of the data analysis.

Afaaq

The following journal article would be an example of_____research;
"The benefits of florescent lighting on production in a factory setting."
Select correct option:

Applied

Interview

Basic

Stupid

Question # 2 of 15 (Start time: 08:39:37 PM) Total Ma ks: 1
Which of the following is NOT a purpose of a literature view?
Select correct option:

Helps you find out what is already known about th ea.

Helps you in getting response from the respondents

Helps you in developing retic framewo .

Helps you to learn from o ers' stimulate eas.

Hypothesis to _____:
Select corre optic

The outcome of a xperiment

A conclusion drawn f m th experiment

A form of bias in which the subject tries to outguess the experimenter

A tentative statement about the relationship

Procedures determining what two issues are rarely used in quantitative research?
Select correct option:
Objectivity and subjectivity

Ataaq

Reliability and validity

Accessibility and replicability

Quality and quantity

Which of the following is most helpful in defining research problem?
Select correct option:

Hypothesis

Preliminary data collection

Descriptive research

Theoretical framework

Question # 5 of 15 (Start time: 08:42:02) Total Marks: 1
A variable is:
Select correct option:

Any characteristic of interest that can take on more than one value

Defined as the groups manipulated in experimental research

The complete set of scores we use in statistical analysis

Completely specified only in correlational research

Question # 6 of 15 (Start time: 08:42:35 PM) Total Marks: 1
Which of the following can Not be a part of preliminary data collection?
Select correct option:

Review of literature

Focus group discussion

Making research question

Ataaq

Seek out the informants

Question # 7 of 15 (Start time: 08:43:11 PM) Total Marks: 1
Which of the following is Not included in research proposal?
Select correct option:

Problem Statement

Research Design

Results

Bibliography

Question # 8 of 15 (Start time: 08:44:01 PM) Total Marks: 1
The purpose of a literature review is to:
Select correct option:

Help you find out what is already known about the area.

Identify any inconsistencies or gaps in the literature.

Demonstrate an awareness of the theoretical context in which the current study can be set.

All of the given options

Question # 9 of 15 (Start time: 08:44:51 PM) Total Marks: 1
What is a relationship between the literature survey and the theoretical framework?
Select correct option:

Literature survey provides a solid foundation for developing the theoretical framework.

Literature survey helps in the identification of the relevant variables.

Literature survey helps in the identifying the relationship among variables.

Afaaq

All of the given options

Question # 10 of 15 (Start time: 08:46:08 PM) Total Marks: 1
Which of the following is NOT an unethical issue?
Select correct option:

Invoicing irregularities

Avoiding legal liability

Misrepresenting results

Seek approval for research

Question # 11 of 15 (Start time: 08:46:45 PM) Total Marks: 1
After a researcher has stated the specific problem to be studied in an experiment, he must then develop a(n):
Select correct option:

Theory

Conclusion

Hypothesis

Summary of the data

Question # 12 of 15 (Start time: 08:47:39 PM) Total Marks: 1
Which of the following steps of the scientific method is exemplified by the researcher reviewing the literature and focusing on a specific problem that has yet to be resolved?
Select correct option:

Identify a topic.

Describe the procedures to collect information.

Analyze the collected information.

Afaaq

State the results of the data analysis.

Question # 13 of 15 (Start time: 08:48:03 PM) Total Marks: 1
A one tailed hypothesis predicts---------
Select correct option:

The future

The lottery result

The frequency of the effect

The direction of the effect

Question # 14 of 15 (Start time: 08:48:26 PM) Total Marks: 1
A good qualitative problem statement:
Select correct option:

Defines the independent and dependent variables

Conveys a sense of emerging design

Specifies a research hypothesis to be tested

Specifies the relationship between variables that the researcher expects to find

Question # 15 of 15 (Start time: 08:49:02 PM) Total Marks: 1
"There is no relationship between advertising and sales of product A"
The given hypothesis is a (an):
Select correct option:

Descriptive hypothesis

Co relational hypothesis

Null hypothesis

Afaaq

Alternative hypothesis

Which of the following is not a proper way to write a literature review?
Select correct option:
Organize common findings or arguments together.
List down a series of research reports with a summary of the findings of each not confirmed
Logically link statements or findings,
Address the most important ideas first.

Question # 1 of 15 (Start time: 08:51:56 PM) Total Marks: 1
Theoretical framework is trying to develop a _____ model of our study.
Select correct option:

Functional

Conceptual

Operational

Practical

Question # 2 of 15 (Start time: 08:52:32 PM) Total Marks: 1
In the statement "motivation results in high efficiency" motivation is the:
Select correct option:

Independent variable

Dependent variable

Extraneous variable

Causal variable

Question # 3 of 15 (Start time: 08:53:22 PM) Total Marks: 1
The independent variable is;

Afaaq

Select correct option:

The variable manipulated in order to observe its effects

The variable that is measured

The free spirited variable

A confounding variable

Question # 4 of 15 (Start time: 08:54:07 PM) Total Marks
The application of the scientific method to the study of bus n ss problems is called;
Select correct option:

Inductive reasoning

Deductive reasoning

Business research

Grounded theory

Question # 5 of 15 (Start tim : 54:45 PM) Total Marks: 1
Rights and ations of resear are generally dictated by the_____.
Select correct optio

Age of the respond nt

Experience of the researcher

Norms of the society

Research design

Question # 6 of 15 (Start time: 08:56:04 PM) Total Marks: 1
The following journal article would be an example of_____research; "The benefits of florescent lighting on production in a factory setting."

Afaaq

Select correct option:

Applied

Interview

Basic

Stupid

Question # 7 of 15 (Start time: 08:56:51 PM) Total Marks:
A concept is a generalized idea about---- .
Select correct option:

A class of objects

Attributes

Occurrences

All of the given options

Question # 8 of 15 (Start time: 08:57:[illegible]) Total Marks: 1
When doing research involving deception with human subjects, researchers have an obligation to which of the following?
Select correct option:

Tell subjects the truth about the study's purpose and methods after the study is completed

Let subjects withdraw from the study at any time if they don't want to keep participating

Both of the given options

None of the given options

Question # 9 of 15 (Start time: 08:59:08 PM) Total Marks: 1
All of the following are true about theories, except;

Ataaq

Select correct option:

They organize and summarize existing knowledge about a topic.

They are tentative until the facts prove them true.

They provide possible explanations for the phenomenon under study.

They lead to testable hypotheses through the process of deduction.

Question # 10 of 15 (Start time: 09:00:02 PM) Total Marks
The operational definition is also known as
Select correct option:

Working definition

Nominal definition

Conceptual definition

Dictionary definition

Question # 11 of 15 (Start time: 09:00:02 PM) Total Marks: 1
Which of the following is NOT a characteristic of a good research topic?
Select correct option:

It is ethical.

It can be investigated through the collection and analysis of data.

It focuses on a philosophical or ethical issue.

It is theoretically or practically significant.

Question # 12 of 15 (Start time: 09:01:40 PM) Total Marks: 1
The scientific method is preferred over other ways of knowing because it is more;
Select correct option:

Afaaq

Reliable

Systematic

Accurate

All of the given options

Question # 13 of 15 (Start time: 09:02:10 PM) Total Marks: 1
What is a cross-sectional research?
Select correct option:

A study of one particular section of society

A comparison of two or more variables over a long period of time

The collection of data from more than one case at one moment in time

One that is conducted when environment is unchanging

Question # 14 of 15 (Start time: 09:0 :20 PM) Total Marks: 1
Which of following statement is true?
Select correct option:

Theory and Research are dichotomous

Theory and Research are interrelated

There is no difference between Theory and Research

None of the given statements is true

Question # 15 of 15 (Start time: 09:04:04 PM) Total Marks: 1
Which of the following is at the highest level of abstraction?
Select correct option:

Concept

Afaaq

Proposition

Theory

Hypothesis

Question # 1 of 15 (Start time: 05:28:49 PM)

Total Marks: 1

Null hypothesis states:

Select correct option:

Absence of relationship

Existence of relationsh

The direction of relationshi

Casual rela hip

Ataaq

Question # 2 of 1 (Start time: 05:29:46 PM)

Total Marks: 1

Which of the following statements is true?

Select correct option:

All concepts are variables and all variables are concepts

All variables are concepts but all concepts are not variable

All concepts are variable but all variables are not concepts

None of the above

Question # 3 of 15 (Start time: 05:30:24 PM)

Total Marks: 1

What research is?

Select correct option:

A lab experiment

A report

A systematic Enquiry

A survey

Question # 4 of 15 (Start time: 05:30:56 PM)

Total Marks: 1

A literature review requires;

Select correct option:

Afaaq

Planning

Clear writing

Good writing

All of the given option

Question # 5 of 15 (Start time: 05:31:23 PM)

Total Marks: 1

Which of the following is a discrete variable?

Select correctoption:

Age

Nationality

Test score

Income

Question # 6 of 15 (Start time: 05:41:50 PM)

Total Marks: 1

A good qualitative problem statement:

Select correctoption:

Defines the independent and dependent variables

Conveys a sense of emerging design

Afaaq

Specifies a research hypothesis to be tested

Specifies the relationship between variables that the researcher expects to find.

Question # 7 of 15 (Start time: 05:32:32 PM)

Total Marks: 1

The application of the scientific method to the study of business problems is called;

Select correct option:

Inductive reasoning

Deductive reasoning

Business research

Grounded theory

Afaaq

Question # 8 of 15 (Start time: 05:33:03 PM)

Total Marks: 1

After a researcher has stated the specific problem to be studied in an experiment, he must then develop a (n):

Select correct option:

Theory

Conclusion

Hypothesis

Summary of the data

Question # 9 of 15 (Start time: 05:33:30 PM)

Total Marks: 1

Which of the following is not included in research proposal?

Select correct option:

Problem Statement

Research Design

Results

Bibliography

Question # 10 of 15 (Start time: 05:34:46 PM)

Total Marks: 1

Which of the following is not an example of deception?

Select correct option:

A part of the truth is not communicated to the respondent

To observe code of ethics

Ataaq

To leak out information regarding any confidential matter

To create bias between respondents before the survey

Question # 11 of 15 (Start time: 05:35:39 PM)

Total Marks: 1

Which of the following is NOT a characteristic of a good research topic?

Select correct option:

It is ethical.

It can be investigated through the collection and analysis of data.

It focuses on a philosophical or ethical issue.

It is theoretically or practically significant.

Question # 12 of 15 (Start time: 06:14 PM)

Total Marks:

Which of the following is an example of deception in business research?

Select correct option:

The obtaining of company material without permission.

The researcher wearing a disguise during an observation.

The researcher representing their research as being about a different topic.

The researcher failing to ask permission to interview someone.

Afaaq

Question # 13 of 15 (Start time: 05:36:56 PM)

Total Marks: 1

Which of the following is not a feature of theoretical framework?

Select correct option:

Making an inventory of variables

Specify the direction of relationship

Presenting findings

Making an inventory of propositions

Question # 14 of 15 (Start time: 05:37:39 PM)

Total Marks: 1

Which of the following is not a function of clearly identified research questions?

Select correct option:

They guide your literature search.

They keep you focused throughout the data collection period.

They make the scope of your research as wide as possible.

They are linked together to help you construct a coherent argument.

Question # 15 of 15 (Start time: 05:38:23 PM)

Afaaq

Total Marks: 1

The study of research methods provides you with the knowledge and skills you need

Select correct option:

To solve the problem

To improve the decision-making process

To understand the research of others

All of the given options

The facts that should be collected to measure a variable, depend upon the
Select correct option:
Conceptual understanding
Dictionary meaning
Operational definition
All of the above

Question # 3 of 15 (Start time: 03:04:37 AM) Total Marks: 1
Qualitative and quantitative Research are the classifications of research on the basis of
Select correct option:

Use of the research
Time dimension
Techniques used
Purpose of the research

Question # 2 of 15 (Start time: 03:04:12 AM) Total Marks: 1
A literature review requires;
Select correct option:

planning

Afaaq

clear writing
good writing
All of the given option

Question # 3 of 15 (Start time: 03:05:18 AM) Total Marks: 1
A Literature review that summarizes what is known at a point in time is known as:
Select correct option:

Narrative literature review
Systematic literature review
Integrative review
Historical review

Question # 4 of 15 (Start time: 03:06:27 AM) Total Marks: 1
What is the final step of a scientific investigation?
Select correct option:

Analyze data
Collect data
Report the findings
Determine whether the hypothesis was supported

Question # 5 of 15 (Start time: 03:07:01 AM) Total Marks: 1
According to empiricists, which of the following is the ultimate source of all our concepts and knowledge?
Select correct option:

Perceptions
Theory
Sensory experience
Logics and arguments

Question # 6 of 15 (Start time: 03:07:30 AM) Total Marks: 1
Which of the following is an example of value-free research?
Select correct option:

Conscious favor

Afaaq

Sympathy for the loser
Unstructured interviewing
None of the given options

Question # 7 of 15 (Start time: 03:08:53 AM) Total Marks: 1
The independent variable is;
Select correct option:

The variable manipulated in order to observe its effects
The variable that is measured
The free spirited variable
A confounding variable

Question # 8 of 15 (Start time: 03:10:16 AM) Total Marks: 1
The following journal article would be an example of ___ resea
"The benefits of florescent lighting on production in a factory ing."
Select correct option:

Applied
Interview
Basic

Question # 15 (Start time: 03:1 AM) Total Marks: 1
The study of ss methods provide with the knowledge and skills you need
Select correct option:

To solve the proble
To improve the decis making process
To understand the research of others
All of the given options

Question # 10 of 15 (Start time: 03:12:07 AM) Total Marks: 1
Which of the following true about the relationship between theory building and data collection?
Select correct option:

Afaaq

When studies come out as expected, inductive support for the theory is gained.

If an experiment fails, discarding the experiment is an example of affirming the consequent.

When a hypothesis is not supported, virtually nothing has been learned about the theory.

A good theory will be inclusive enough to explain every possible research outcome.

Question # 11 of 15 (Start time: 03:13:34 AM) Total Marks: 1

The operational definition is also known as

Select correct option:

Working definition

Nominal definition

Conceptual definition

Dictionary definition

Question # 12 of 15 (Start time: 03:14:41 AM) Total Marks: 1

A theory is a coherent set of _____ used as principles of explanations of the apparent relationships of certain observed phenomena.

Select correct option:

Disciplines

Propositions

Empirical Realities

None of the given options

Question # 13 of 15 (Start time: 03:15:29 AM) Total Marks: 1

A concept is a generalized idea about ----- .

Select correct option:

A class of objects

Attributes

Occurrences

All of the given options

Question # 14 of 15 (Start time: 03:16:26 AM) Total Marks: 1

Afaaq

Which of the following is included in research proposal?
Select correct option:

Data analysis
Results
Literature review
Conclusions section

Question # 15 of 15 (Start time: 03:17:54 AM) Total Marks: 1
Research questions are crucial because they will:
Select correct option:

Guide your decisions about what data to collect and from where.
Help you decide which research area interests you.
Ensure that your findings have external validity.
Prevent you from thinking about research strategies.

Question # 1 of 15 (Start time: 02:13:44 AM) Total Marks:
Null hypothesis states:
Select correct option:

Absence of relationship
Existence of relationship
The direction of relationship
Casual relation

Question # 2 of 15 (Start time: 02:14:08 AM) Total Marks: 1
What is the variable called that a researcher manipulates in an experiment?
Select correct option:

Dependent variable
Independent variable
Extraneous variable
None of the given options

Question # 3 of 15 (Start time: 02:14:23 AM) Total Marks: 1
The facts that should be collected to measure a variable, depend upon the
Select correct option:

Afaaq

Conceptual understanding
Dictionary meaning
Operational definition
All of the above

Question # 4 of 15 (Start time: 02:14:54 AM) Total Marks: 1
What is a cross-sectional research?
Select correct option:

A study of one particular section of society
A comparison of two or more variables over a long period of time
The collection of data from more than one case at one moment in time
One that is conducted when environment is uncertain

Question # 5 of 15 (Start time: 02:15:13 AM) Total Marks: 1
Which one of the following tasks is NOT accomplished by the theoretical framework?
Select correct option:

Elaborate the relationship among the variables
Explain the logic underlying the relationship between the variables.
Describe the nature, and direction of the relationships among the variables.
Relates the previous studies.

Question # 6 of 15 (Start time: 02:16:37 AM) Total Marks: 1
The elaboration of the variables in the theoretical framework addresses which type of questions?
Select correct option:

Why we expect certain relationships to exist
How we expect certain relationships to exist
Both of the given questions
None of the given questions

Question # 7 of 15 (Start time: 02:17:35 AM) Total Marks: 1
What is the first step in the research process?
Select correct option:

Afaq

Preliminary data collection
Problem definition
Theoretical framework
Define broad problem area

Question # 8 of 15 (Start time: 02:18:33 AM) Total Marks: 1
Qualitative and Quantitative Research are the classifications of research on the basis of
Select correct option:

Use of the research
Time dimension
Techniques used
Purpose of the research

Question # 9 of 15 (Start time: 02:18:46 AM) Total Marks: 1
Quantitative researcher's preoccupation with generalization is an attempt to:
Select correct option:

Develop the law like findings of the natural sciences.
Boost their chances of publication
Enhance the internal validity of the research.
Demonstrate the complex techniques of statistical analysis.

Question # 10 of 15 (Start time: 02:19:13 AM) Total Marks: 1
Which of the following is an example of value-free research?
Select correct option:

Conscious favor
Sympathy for the loser
Unstructured interviewing
None of the given options

Question # 11 of 15 (Start time: 02:20:01 AM) Total Marks: 1
Ms. Roshi has been coordinating the Annual Festival at her school for the last several years. She wants to be sure the students and parents enjoy the

Afaq

festival again this year. On which source is she LEAST likely to rely when making decisions about what to do?
Select correct option:

Tradition
Personal experience
Research
Expert opinion

Question # 12 of 15 (Start time: 02:21:25 AM) Total Marks: 1
Which of the following is NOT a legitimate research problem as stated?
Select correct option:

What is the relationship between the number of books children read and their reading scores?
Should competitive games be banned from elementary schools?
What does it mean to be a special needs child "included" in Ms. Jones's fourth grade class?
What are the major legal principles applied to educational issues decided by the Supreme Court?

Question # 13 of 15 (Start time: 02:22:45 AM) Total Marks: 1
What is the basis of the Scientific Method?
Select correct option:

To test hypotheses in conditions that are condusive to its success.
To formulate a research problem, and disprove the hypothesis.
To formulate a research problem, test the hypothesis in carefully controlled conditions that challenge the hypothesis.
To test hypotheses and if they are disproved, they should be abandoned completely.

Question # 14 of 15 (Start time: 02:23:54 AM) Total Marks: 1
What is the final step of a scientific investigation?
Select correct option:

Analyze data
Collect data

Afaq

Report the findings
Determine whether the hypothesis was supported

Question # 15 of 15 (Start time: 02:25:23 AM) Total Marks: 1
Which of the following is NOT a characteristic of a good research topic?
Select correct option:

It is ethical.
It can be investigated through the collection and analysis of data.
It focuses on a philosophical or ethical issue.
It is theoretically or practically significant.

Question # 1 of 15 (Start time: 01:38:28 AM) Total Marks: 1
If a researcher is studying the effect of using laptops in his classroom to ascertain their merit and worth, he is likely conducting which type of research?
Select correct option:

Basic
Applied
Evaluation
Experimental

Question # 2 of 15 (Start time: 01:39:29 AM) Total Marks: 1
What is opposite of variable?
Select correct option:

A constant
An extraneous variable
A dependent variable
A data set

Question # 3 of 15 (Start time: 01:40:30 AM) Total Marks: 1
Which of the following is not a feature of theoretical framework?
Select correct option:

Making an inventory of variables
Specify the direction of relationship

Afaaq

Presenting findings
Making an inventory of propositions

Question # 4 of 15 (Start time: 01:41:50 AM) Total Marks: 1
Which of the following is a discrete variable?
Select correct option:

Age
Nationality
Test score
Income

Question # 5 of 15 (Start time: 01:42:35 AM) Total Marks: 1
In_____we collect same type of information from different
respondents in different times.
Select correct option:

Cohort study
Time series Research
Panel study
Case studies

Question # 6 of 15 (Start time: 01:44:02 AM) Total Marks: 1
Why, as scientists, do we not want to rely on authority for explanations?
Select correct option:

Those in authority are often wrong.
Those in authority cannot be challenged.
Those in authority rely too much on objective information.
Those in authority often have no common sense.

Question # 7 of 15 (Start time: 01:45:06 AM) Total Marks: 1
Which of the following is most beneficial to read in an article?
Select correct option:

Methods
Introduction
Figures

Ataaq

References

Question # 8 of 15 (Start time: 01:45:35 AM) Total Marks: 1
Why do you need to review the existing literature?
Select correct option:

To give your dissertation a proper academic appearance, with lots of references
Because without it, you could never reach the required word-count
To find out what is already known about your area of interest
To help in your general studying

Question # 9 of 15 (Start time: 01:46:10 AM) Total Marks: 1
Which of the following is the least appropriate research prob
Select correct option:

Does studying Latin improve the standardized vocabulary t scores of seventh grade students?
Does drilling fifth grade students with multiplication f improve their standardized test scores?
What is the relationship between student math attitudes and math achievement?
Should students have access to controversial novels in school?

Question # 10 of 15 (Start time: 01:47:19 AM) Total Marks: 1
Null hypothesis states
Select correct option:

Absence of relationship
Existence of relationship
The direction of relationship
Casual relationship

Question # 11 of 15 (Start time: 01:48:49 AM) Total Marks: 1
Basic and Applied Research are the classifications of research on the basis of:
Select correct option:

Afaq

Use of the research
Time dimension
Techniques used
Purpose of the research

Question # 12 of 15 (Start time: 01:50:18 AM) Total Marks: 1
What is a cross-sectional research?
Select correct option:

A study of one particular section of society
A comparison of two or more variables over a long period of time
The collection of data from more than one case at one moment in time
One that is conducted when environment is uncertain

Question # 13 of 15 (Start time: 01:51:43 AM) Total Marks: 1
What is the variable called that a researcher manipulates in an experiment?
Select correct option:

Dependent variable
Independent variable
Extraneous variable
None of the given options

Question # 14 of 15 (Start time: 01:53:48 AM) Total Marks: 1
Which of the following is a part of research design?
Select correct option:

Data collection technique
Tool of data collection
Objectives of the study
Data processing and analysis

Question # 15 of 15 (Start time: 01:54:06 AM) Total Marks: 1
A variable is:
Select correct option:

Any characteristic of interest that can take on more than one value

Afaq

Defined as the groups manipulated in experimental research
The complete set of scores we use in statistical analysis
Completely specified only in observational research

Question # 1 of 15 (Start time: 01:09:24 AM) Total Marks: 1
If a researcher was studying the use of various instructional approaches to the "multiple intelligences" of his students, he is likely to be conducting which type of research?
Select correct option:
Basic
Applied
Evaluation
Grounded theory

Question # 2 of 15 (Start time: 01:10:00 AM) Total Marks:
If a measure is consistent over multiple occasions it is as:
Select correct option:

Inter-rater reliability
Construct validity
Internal validity
Test-retest reliability

Question # 3 (Start time: 01:11) Total Marks: 1
Why do you need to review the existing literature?
Select correct option:

To give your dissertation a proper academic appearance, with lots of references
Because without it, you could never reach the required word-count
To find out what is already known about your area of interest
To help in your general studying

Question # 4 of 15 (Start time: 01:12:12 AM) Total Marks: 1
All of the following are true about theories, except;
Select correct option:

They organize and summarize existing knowledge about a topic.

Afaaq

They are tentative until the facts prove them true.
They provide possible explanations for the phenomenon under study
They lead to testable hypotheses through the process of deduction.

Question # 5 of 15 (Start time: 01:13:02 AM) Total Marks: 1
Quantitative social researchers rarely claim to have established causality because:
Select correct option:

They are more concerned with publishing the results of their reliability tests.
They do not believe that this is an appropriate goal to be striving for.
They keep forgetting which of the variables they have manipulated.
They tend to use cross-sectional designs, which produce only correlations.

Question # 6 of 15 (Start time: 01:14:12 AM) Total Marks:
"Skepticism" is a norm of science. It is better explained by which of the following statement?
Select correct option:

Combining the previous knowledge
Critical reading of the previous researches
Providing the proper references for quoted text
Locating research reports in libraries

Question # 7 of 15 (Start time: 01:15:12 AM) Total Marks: 1
Which of the following provides solid basis foundation for the theoretical framework?
Select correct option:

Survey
Literature Review
Experiment
Referencing

Question # 8 of 15 (Start time: 01:15:54 AM) Total Marks: 1
----------surveys are more impersonal than face-to-face interviews.
Select correct option:

Afaq

Mail
Recorded Interview
Focus group
Telephone

Question # 9 of 15 (Start time: 01:17:01 AM) Total Marks: 1
Which of the following is not a feature of theoretical framework?
Select correct option:

Making an inventory of variables
Specify the direction of relationship
Presenting findings
Making an inventory of propositions

Question # 10 of 15 (Start time: 01:17:40 AM) Total Marks: 1
In_____definition, a concept is explained in terms of other concepts.
Select correct option:

Operational definition
Working definition
Theoretical definition
None of the given options

Question # 11 of 15 (Start time: 01:18:08 AM) Total Marks: 1
To explain, predict, and control phenomena are the goal of----------
Select correct option:

Tradition
Inductive logic
Deductive logic
The scientific method

Question # 12 of 15 (Start time: 01:19:08 AM) Total Marks: 1
Which of the following is NOT a characteristic of a good research topic?
Select correct option:

Afaaq

It is ethical.
It can be investigated through the collection and analysis of data.
It focuses on a philosophical or ethical issue.
It is theoretically or practically significant.

Question # 13 of 15 (Start time: 01:19:47 AM) Total Marks: 1
Which of the following is a concept?
Select correct option:

Leadership.
Total Quality Management.
Human Resource Management.
All of the given options

Question # 14 of 15 (Start time: 01:20:14 AM) Total Marks: 1
The most critical areas of an article to read is;
Select correct option:

Results section
Introduction
Abstract
Limitations

Question # 15 of 15 (Start time: 10:20:58 AM) Total Marks: 1
Quantitative researcher's preoccupation with generalization is an attempt to:
Select correct option:

Develop the law like findings of the natural sciences.
Boost their chances of publication.
Enhance the internal validity of their research.
Demonstrate the complex techniques of statistical analysis.

Question # 1 of 15 (Start time: 10:53:07 AM) Total Marks: 1
The most critical areas of an article to read is;
Select correct option:

Afaaq

Results section
Introduction
Abstract
Limitations

Question # 2 of 15 (Start time: 10:53:51 AM) Total Marks: 1
What type of process research is?
Select correct option:

A process to discover the truth
A process to invent the machines
A process to make new medicines
A process to create theories

Question # 3 of 15 (Start time: 10:54:42 AM) Total
Before a researcher specified the relationship ong va s, he must have a (an):
Select correct option:

Inventory of variables
Inventory of proposition
Arrangement of propositions
Schematic diagram

Question # tart time: 10: AM) Total Marks: 1
Which one of he follo not an assumption of science?
Select correct optio

There are reoccurri patterns in the world.
Events happen because of preceding causes.
We can discover solutions to problems of interest.
Theoretical explanations must agree with common sense.

Question # 5 of 15 (Start time: 10:56:03 AM) Total Marks: 1
Quantitative researcher's preoccupation with generalization is an attempt to:

Afaaq

Select correct option:

Develop the law like findings of the natural sciences.
Boost their chances of publication.
Enhance the internal validity of their research.
Demonstrate the complex techniques of statistical analysis.

Question # 6 of 15 (Start time: 10:56:48 AM) Total Marks: 1
Which one of the following creates problems of measurements of a concept?
Select correct option:

Unambiguous meanings
Vague meanings
Clear meanings
Dictionary meanings

Question # 7 of 15 (Start time: 10:57:31 AM) Total Marks: 1
Which of the following is an example of value free research
Select correct option:

Conscious favor
Sympathy for the loser
Unstructured interviewing
None of the given options

Question # 8 of 15 (Start time: 10:58:22 AM) Total Marks: 1
The elaboration of the variables in the theoretical framework addresses which type of questions?
Select correct option:

Why we expect certain relationships to exist
How we expect certain relationships to exist
Both of the given questions
None of the given questions

Ataaq

Question # 9 of 15 (Start time: 10:58:59 AM) Total Marks: 1

Which of the following is at the highest level of abstraction?

Select correct option:

Concept

Proposition

Theory

Hypothesis

Question # 10 of 15 (Start time: 11:00:19 AM) Total Marks: 1

Which of the following is the best hypothesis statement to address the research question, "What impact will the new advertising campaign have on use of Brand B?"

Select correct option:

The new advertising campaign will impact Brand B usage.

The new advertising campaign will increase Brand B usage.

The new advertising campaign will cause increased Brand B usage at the expense of Brand C.

The new advertising campaign will increase Brand B's market penetration.

Question # 11 of 15 (Start time: 11:01:25 AM) Total Marks: 1

Which of following statement is true?

Select correct option:

Theory and Research are dichotomous

Theory and Research are interrelated

There is no difference between Theory and Research

None of the given statements is true

Question # 12 of 15 (Start time: 11:02:15 AM) Total Marks: 1

Afaq

According to Empiricism, which of the following is the ultimate source of all our concepts and knowledge?
Select correct option:

Perceptions
Theory
Sensory experience
Logics and arguments

Question # 13 of 15 (Start time: 11:03:17 AM) Total Marks:
What is the final step of a scientific investigation?
Select correct option:

Analyze data
Collect data
Report thefindings
Determine whether the hypothesis was supported

Question # 14 of 15 (Start 11:04:06 AM) Total Marks: 1
Ms. Roshi has been coordinating the Annual festival at her school for the last several years. She wants to be sure the students and parents enjoy the festival again this year. On which source is she LEAST likely to rely when making decisions about it?
Select correct option:

Tradition
Personal experience
Research
Expert opinion

Question # 15 of 15 (Start time: 11:04:39 AM) Total Marks: 1
Preliminary Data Collection may be considered as part of ----------.
Select correct option:

Afaaq

Descriptive research
Explananory research
Exploratory research
All of the given options

Question # 1 of 15 (Start time: 03:10:36 PM) Total Marks: 1
Which of the following is an example of value-free research?
Select correct option:
Conscious favor
Sympathy for the loser
Unstructured interviewing
None of the given options

Question # 2 of 15 (Start time: 03:11:13 PM) Total Marks:
A literature review requires;
Select correct option:
planning
clear w riting
good writing
All of the given option

Question # 15 (Start time: 03:1 PM) Total Marks: 1
What type of r search is?
Select correct ption:
A process to discover the truth
A process to inve the machines
A process to make w medicines
A process to create t ies

Question # 4 of 15 (Start time: 03:12:15 PM) Total
Why do you need to review the existing literature?
Select correct option:
To give your dissertation a proper academic appearance, with lots of references
Because without it, you could never reach the required word-count
To find out what is already know n about your area o interest

Afaaq

To help in your general studying

Question # 5 of 15 (Start time: 03:13:19 PM) Total Marks: 1
What is the final step of a scientific investigation?
Select correct option:
Analyze data
Collect data
Report thefindings
Determine w hether the hypothesis w as supported

Question # 6 of 15 (Start time: 03:13:51 PM) Total Marks: 1
When we say that science is parsimonious, we mean that:
Select correct option:
Scientific theories are based on law s.
We must be careful because causes can occur afte[illegible]effects.
The best scientific theories are those that offer the simplest explanations for a law.
Science accurately describes a wide range of behavior

Question # 8 of 15 (Sta[illegible]time: 03:1[illegible]PM) [illegible]Marks: 1
Which of the following is [illegible]scr[illegible]e variable?
Select correct option:
Age
Nationality
Test score
Income

Question # 9 of 1[illegible](Start time: 03:16:06 PM) Total Marks: 1
"Skepticism" is a no[illegible]m of science. It is better explained by which of the following
statement?
Select correct option:
Combining the previous know ledge
Critical reading of the previous researches
Providing the proper references of qouted text
Locating research reports in libraries

Question # 10 of 15 (Start time: 03:16:39 PM) Total Marks: 1

Afaq

Which of following statement is true?
Select correct option:
Theory and Research are dichotomous
Theory and Research are interrelated
There is no difference between Theory and Researc
None of the given statements is true

Question # 11 of 15 (Start time: 03:17:05 PM) Total Marks: 1
Which of the following should not be a consideration in writing a proposal?
Select correct option:

Understanding the problem situation

The appearance/form of the proposal

Responding to every element exactly as specified by the client

Knowing as much as possible about the proposal re ents

Question # 12 of 15 (art time: 0 17:59 P Total Marks: 1
The operational definitio known as
Select correct option:
Working definition
Nominal tion
Conceptual de
Dictionary de ition

Question # 13 of 5 (Start time: 03:18:34 PM) Total Marks: 1
Which of the follow g statements is true?
Select correct optio
All concepts are va iables and all variables are concepts
All variables are concepts but all concepts are not variable
All concepts are variable but all variables are not concepts
None of the above

Question # 14 of 15 (Start time: 03:19:24 PM) Total Marks: 1
Which of the following is Not included in research proposal?
Select correct option:

Afaaq

Problem Statement
Research Design
Results
Bibliography

Question # 15 of 15 (Start time: 03:20:16 PM) Total Marks: 1
The scientific method is preferred over other ways of knowing because it is more;
Select correct option:
Reliable
Systematic
Accurate
All of the given options

Question # 1 of 15 (Start time: 10:36:31 AM) Total Marks: 1
Which of the following is not an unethical issue?
Select correct option:

Invoicing irregularities

Avoiding legal liability

Misrepresenting

None of the given options

Question # 2 of 15 (Start time: 10:36:58 AM) Total Marks: 1
What research is?
Select correct option:

A lab experiment
A report
A systematic Enquiry
A survey

Afaaq

Question # 3 of 15 (Start time: 10:37:15 AM) Total Marks: 1
Theoretical framework is trying to develop a_____model of our study.
Select correct option:

Functional

Conceptual

Operational

Practical

Question # 4 of 15 (Start time: 10:37:33 AM) Total Ma
Which of the following is Not included in the Introduction s n of a
Research proposal?
Select correct option:

Background of the stu
Objectives
Sampling technique
Significance

Question # 5 of 15 (Start time: 10:37: AM) Total Marks: 1
A variable is:
Select correct option:

Any characteristic of interest that can take on more than one value

Defined as the groups manipulated in experimental research

The complete set of scores we use in statistical analysis

Completely specified only in observational research

Question # 6 of 15 (Start time: 10:38:01 AM) Total Marks: 1

Afaaq

After a researcher has stated the specific problem to be studied in an experiment, he must then develop a(n):
Select correct option:

Theory

Conclusion

Hypothesis

Summary of the data

Question # 7 of 15 (Start time: 10:38:15 AM) Total Marks: 1
Ms. Roshi has been coordinating the Annual Festival at [illegible] school for the last several years. She wants to be sure the students and parents enjoy the festival again this year. On which source is she LEAST likely to rely when making decisions about what to do?
Select correct option:

Tradition

Personal experience

Research

Expert opinion

Question # 8 of 15 (Start time: [illegible]:29 AM) Total Marks: 1
Which of the following terms represents the most general, broad concept?
Select correct option:

Test

Assessment

Measurement

Instrument

Afaaq

Question # 9 of 15 (Start time: 10:38:55 AM) Total Marks: 1
Which of the following is Not a technique to narrow down the broad problem area?
Select correct option:

Doing a literature survey
Ask questions from the knowledgeable persons
Consider topic in specific context
Decide about the sample

Question # 10 of 15 (Start time: 10:40:06 AM) Total Marks: 1
Which of the following activities is Not included in debriefing?
Select correct option:

Explanation of any deception
Post study result sharing
Obtaining informed consent
Description of the purpose of study

Question # 11 of 15 (Start time: 10:41:22 AM) Total Marks: 1
The independent variable is;
Select correct option:

The variable manipulated in order to observe its effects
The variable that is measured
The free spirited variable
A confounding variable

Question # 12 of 15 (Start time: 10:41:38 AM) Total Marks: 1
Logical relationship among the factors identified in the literature review is called_____.
Select correct option:

Research question
Theatrical framework
Problem statement

Afaaq

None of the given options

Question # 13 of 15 (Start time: 10:42:55 AM) Total Marks: 1
The term "Extrapolation" is better explained by the statement:
Select correct option:

Facts lead to the rejection of theory
Identification of the gap in knowledge
Theory predicts facts
None of the given options

Question # 14 of 15 (Start time: 10:43:14 AM) Total Marks
Which of the following is most helpful in defining
Select correct option:

Hypothesis
Preliminary data
Descriptive research
Theoretical framework

Question # 15 of 15 (Start time: 14:17 AM) Total Marks: 1
If a measure is consistent over multiple occasions, it has:
Select correct option:

Inter-rater reliability

Construct validity

Internal validity

Test-retest reliability

According to scientific method, which of the following is Not an empirical reality?
Select correct option:

Ataaq

Emotions

God's reward for good deeds

Satisfaction

None of the given options

Research may differ along a series of dimensions. Which of the following may be applied to this statement?

Select correct option:

The type of data collected.

The data-collection technique.

The level of manipulation used to elicit data collection.

All of the given options

Quiz Start Time: 05:28 PM

Question # 1 of 15 (Start time: 05:28:49 PM)

Total Marks: 1

Null hypothesis states:

Select correct option:

Absence of relationship

Existence of relationship

The direction of relationship

Casual relationship

Question # 2 of 15 (Start time: 05:29:46 PM)

Total Marks: 1

Afaaq

Which of the following statements is true?

Select correct option:

All concepts are variables and all variables are concepts

All variables are concepts but all concepts are not variable

All concepts are variable but all variables are not concepts

None of the above

Question # 3 of 15 (Start time: 05:3 2 M)

Total Marks: 1

What research is

Select correct option

A lab experiment

A report

A systematic Enquiry

A survey

Question # 4 of 15 (Start time: 05:30:56 PM)

Afaaq

Total Marks: 1

A literature review requires;

Select correct option:

Planning

Clear writing

Good writing

All of the given option

Question # 5 of 15 (Start time: 05:31:23 PM)

Total Marks: 1

Which of the following is a [illegible]te variable

Select corr[illegible]tion:

Age

Nationality

Test score

Income

Question # 6 of 15 (Start time: 05:31:50 PM)

Total Marks: 1

A good qualitative problem statement:

Afaaq

Select correct option:

Defines the independent and dependent variables

Conveys a sense of emerging design

Specifies a research hypothesis to be tested

Specifies the relationship between variables that the researcher expects to find.

Question # 7 of 15 (Start time: 05:32:32 PM)

Total Marks: 1

The application of the scientific method to the study of business problems is called;

Select correct option:

Inductive reasoning

Deductive reasoning

Business research

Grounded theory

Question # 8 of 15 (Start time: 05:33:03 PM)

Afaaq

Total Marks: 1

After a researcher has stated the specific problem to be studied in an experiment, he must then develop a (n):

Select correct option:

Theory

Conclusion

Hypothesis

Summary of the data

Question # 9 of 15 (Start time: 05:33:30 PM)

Total Marks: 1

Which of the following is not included in research proposal?

Select correct option:

Problem Statement

Research Design

Results

Bibliography

Question # 10 of 15 (Start time: 05:34:46 PM)

Total Marks: 1

Which of the following is not an example of deception?

Afaaq

Select correct option:

A part of the truth is not communicated to the respondent
To observe code of ethics

To leak out information regarding any confidential matter

To create bias between respondents before the survey

Question # 11 of 15 (Start time: 05:35:39 PM)

Total Marks: 1

Which of the following is NOT a characteristic of a good research topic?

Select correct option:

It is ethical.

It can be investigated through data collection and analysis of data.

It focuses on a philosophical or ethical issue.

It is theoretically or practically significant.

Question # 12 of 15 (Start time: 05:36:14 PM)

Total Marks: 1

Which of the following is an example of deception in business research?

Select correct option:

The obtaining of company material without permission.

Afaaq

The researcher wearing a disguise during an observation.

The researcher representing their research as being about a different topic.

The researcher failing to ask permission to interview someone.

Question # 13 of 15 (Start time: 05:36:56 PM)

Total Marks: 1

Which of the following is not a feature of theoretical framework

Select correct option:

Making an inventory of variables

Specify the direction of [illegible]ationship

Presenting findings

Making an [illegible]tory of proposition[illegible]

Question # 14 [illegible]f 15 (S[illegible] 05:37:39 PM)

Total Marks: 1

Which of the follow[illegible]not a function of clearly identified research questions?

Select correct option:

They guide your literature search.

They keep you focused throughout the data collection period.

Afaaq

They make the scope of your research as wide as possible.

They are linked together to help you construct a coherent argument.

Question # 15 of 15 (Start time: 05:38:23 PM)

Total Marks: 1

The study of research methods provides you with the knowledge and skills you need

Select correct option:

To solve the problem

To improve the decision-making process

To understand the research of others

All of the given options

Afaaq
STA630 - Research Methods
Mega Quiz file
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Asslam O Alikum

STA630 - Research Methods

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FINALTERM EXAMINATION
Spring 2010
AFAAQ_TARIQ@YAHOO.COM
STA630- Research Methods (Session - 4)

Ref No: 1518507
Time: 90 min
Marks: 69

AFAAQ

Question No: 1 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

An inductive logic is one that:

- Involves testing as explicitly defined hypothesis
- Does not allow for findings to feed back into the body of knowledge.
- Uses quantitative methods whenever possible.
- Allows theory to emerge out of the data.

http://www.oup.com/uk/orc/bin/9780199202959/01student/cqs/ch01/

MCQ # 03

Question No: 2 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Which of the following research questions is BEST answered using action research?

► How can I improve the interaction of students of different ethnicity in my class?

http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_airasian_edresearch_7/5/1490/381508.cw/index.html
MCQ # 3

► What factors influence student interaction in multiethnic classes?

► Is there a difference between male and female acceptance of others in multiethnic classes?

► How do students from Asian countries adjust to classroom practices in U.S. schools?

Question No: 3 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Which of the following is characteristic of action research?

► Variables are tightly controlled.

► Results are generalizable.

► Results demonstrate cause-and-effect relationships.

► Data are usually qualitative.

http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_airasian_edresearch_7/5/1490/381508.cw/index.html
MCQ # 05

Question No: 4 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Research may differ along a series of dimensions. Which of the following may be applied to this statement?

► The level of manipulation used to elicit data collection.

► The data-collection technique.

► The type of data collected.

► Type, technique and manipulation of data collection.

http://www.uk.sagepub.com/breakwell/downloads/mcq/mcq_01/mcq_01.htm
MCQ # 06

Question No: 5 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Which of the following is NOT a drawback to free response items?

► Results from free response items take longer to analyze.

► Many participants tend not to answer free response items.

► Free response items allow participants to add information that was not directly requested.

► Many participants tend to be less truthful in free response items.

http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_airasian_edresearch_7/5/1490/381582.cw/index.html
MCQ # 15

AFAQ

Question No: 6 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

After you locate a source, you should write down all details of the reference, except**;**

- ► Volumes
- ► Full names of the authors
- ► Titles
- ► Price

After you locate a source, you should write down all details of the reference (full names of the authors, titles, volumes, issue, pages)
PAGE # 29

Question No: 7 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Which of the following is an example of a question about normative standards and values?

- ► How many workers are employed at this plant?
- ► What is your attitude towards the management at this plant?
- ► Do you always cast your vote in trade union elections?

http://www.oup.com/uk/orc/bin/9780199284986/01student/cqs/ch10/
MCQ # 03

- ► Are you aware of the main features of the European Union Directive for informing and consulting employees?

Question No: 8 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Which of the following is NOT an example of a problem with using social survey research to investigate behaviour?

- ► Respondents tend to answer by giving the most socially desirable answer.
- ► Respondents may inadvertently omit key terms in the question.
- ► Respondents may not give an honest reply to what they see as a threatening question.
- ► Respondents may be unwilling to reveal information as they believe they are likely to be identified.

http://www.oup.com/uk/orc/bin/9780199284986/01student/cqs/ch11/
MCQ # 01

Question No: 9 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Which of the following is an example of a dilemma that might face feminist business researchers conducting qualitative interviews with women?

- ► What role to adopt while interviewing male managers?
- ► How many female employees should be interviewed for a representative sample?
- ► How to overcome the issue of false consciousness?

http://www.oup.com/uk/orc/bin/9780199284986/01student/cqs/ch18/
MCQ # 09

AIAQ

► What data to use while publishing findings?

Question No: 10 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Which of the following is NOT characteristic of qualitative data?

► Rich descriptions
► Concise

http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_airasian_edresearch_8/38/9871/2527149.cw/content/index#topofquiz1
MCQ # 02

► Voluminous
► Unorganized

Question No: 11 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Why is describing the context equally, as important aspect of qualitative data analysis as is describing the participants?

► Descriptions of context are more objective than descriptions of participants.
► Descriptions of context are based on facts, not perceptions.
► Participants' behavior cannot be separated from the context in which it occurs.

http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_airasian_edresearch_8/38/9871/2527206.cw/index.html
MCQ # 04

► Participants are the context.

Question No: 12 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Which one is not the part of non reactive research?

► Physical traces
► Archives
► Observations
► Interviews

Varieties of Non-Reactive Observations
Physical Traces:
Archives:
Observations:
PAGE 124

Question No: 13 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

The information gained by someone other than researcher conducting the study is called _____.

► Primary data
► Reliable data
► Valid data
► Secondary data

AFAIQ

Secondary data refer to information gathered by someone other than the researcher conducting the present study.
PAGE # 131

Question No: 14 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Which of the following is **not** an example of historical comparative research?

- ► Social Forms
- ► Economic Forms
- ► Civil Wars
- ► Turnover

PAGE # 142,143

Question No: 15 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Which of the following would you recommend to a graduate student to ensure the quality of his research report?

- ► Write a detailed explanation of the methods used to investigate the problem.
- ► Explicitly state underlying assumptions related to the topic.
- ► Acknowledge the limitations of generalizability while assisting the reader in understanding the transferability of the findings.
- ► Detailed method, assumptions and limitation.

http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_airasian_edresearch_7/5/1490/381491.cw/index.html
MCQ # 02

Question No: 16 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

In which of the following Tests, we usually go for personal interviewing to test the questionnaire?

- ► Test Run
- ► Pilot Test

Pilot testing also called pre-testing means small scale trial run of a particular component; here we are referring to pilot testing of the questionnaire.
PAGE # 80

- ► Post Hoc Test
- ► T- Test

Question No: 17 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

In which of the following Tests, we should come to know, does a questionnaire look like an integrated unit?

- ► Test Run
- ► Pilot Test

AFAQ

PAGE # 80, 81
A pilot plant would be a way of testing the integrated unit, studying its operational problems, testing design

- ► Post Hoc Test
- ► T- Test

Question No: 18 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Which of the following is that element or set of elements considered for selection in some stage of sampling?

- ► Parameter
- ► Sampling Unit

A sampling unit is that element or set of elements considered for selection in some stage of sampling.
PAGE 89

- ► Observation Unit
- ► Statistic

Question No: 19 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

If you are going on the street and suddenly a TV reporter starts taking your interview regarding any issue, which of the following sampling technique is used by the TV reporter?

- ► Purposive Sampling
- ► Snowball Sampling
- ► Convenience Sampling

Convenience Sampling
Convenience sampling (also called *haphazard or accidental sampling*) refers to sampling by obtaining units or people who are most conveniently available. For example, it may be convenient and economical to sample employees in companies in a nearby area, sample from a pool of friends and neighbors. The person-on-the street interview conducted by TV programs is another example. TV interviewers go on the street with camera and microphone to talk to few people who are convenient to interview. The people walking past a TV studio in thee middle of the day do not represent everyone (homemakers, people in the rural areas). Likewise, TV interviewers select people who look “normal” to them and avoid people who are unattractive, poor, very old, or inarticulate.
PAGE # 90

- ► Quota Sampling

Question No: 20 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Sampling in qualitative research is similar to which type of sampling in quantitative research?

VUFAQ

- ► Simple random sampling
- ► Systematic sampling
- ► Quota sampling
- ► Purposive sampling

Sampling in qualitative research is similar to which type of sampling in quantitative research?

It is similar to purposive sampling

http://www.google.com.pk/#sclient=psy&hl=en&biw=800&bih=411&q=Sampling+in+qualitative+research+is+similar+to+Purposive+sampling&aq=&aqi=&aql=&oq=&pbx=1&fp=791244bbdd532714

AFTER OPEN DA LINK CLICK ON 1ST [DOC] *Sampling* in Quantitative, *Qualitative*, and Mixed - Chapter 9 ...

Question No: 21 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Which of the following **is NOT** a type of Non-random sampling?

- ► Cluster sampling

PAGE # 90, 91, AND 93

- ► Convenience sampling
- ► Quota sampling
- ► Purposive sampling

Question No: 22 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Historical-Comparative researchers sometimes use;

- ► Time-series data
- ► Primary data
- ► Secondary data

Historical-comparative researchers often use secondary sources or different data types in combination

PAGE # 151

- ► Analyzed data

Question No: 23 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Which of the following refers to the partials replicate or reproduce the same relationship that existed in the bivariate table before considering the control variable?

- ► Replication pattern

The replication pattern is the easiest to understand. It is when the partials replicate or reproduce the same relationship that existed in the bivariate table before considering the control variable.

AFAAQ

PAGE # 110

- Specification pattern
- Suppressor variable pattern
- Negative linear relationship

Question No: 24 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

As a researcher you need **Not** to;

- Master the literature
- Take numerous detailed notes
- Create a bibliography list
- Learn your findings

As the researcher masters the literature and takes numerous detailed notes, he or she completes many specific tasks: creating a bibliography list
PAGE # 147

Question No: 25 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Which of the following relates with an abstract model of underlying relations or causal mechanism?

- Analysis
- Synthesis

Synthesis links specific evidence with an abstract model of underlying relations or causal mechanism.
PAGE # 148

- Results
- Findings

Question No: 26 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Which of the following control techniques available to the researcher, controls both known and unknown variables?

- Building the extraneous variable into the design
- Matching
- Random assignment

Random assignment is the most important technique that can be used to control confounding variables because it has the ability to control for both known and unknown confounding extraneous variables.
http://www.southalabama.edu/coe/bset/johnson/lectures/lec9.htm

VUAAQ

► Analysis of covariance

Question No: 27 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Which of the following is more operational with the help of coding system?

► External Appearance
► Count Behaviors
► Content analysis

Constructs in content analysis are operationalizing with a *coding system*, a set of instructions or rules on how to systematically observe and record content from text.
Page # 126

► Time Duration

Question No: 28 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

What is the particular advantage of secondary analysis to business students?

► It is less challenging intellectually
► It guarantees positive results
► It is less expensive and less time consuming than primary analysis

http://www.oup.com/uk/orc/bin/9780199284986/01student/cqs/ch13/

AFAAQ

MCQ # 02

- ► It enables students to gain experience of the workplace

Question No: 29 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Which of the following similarity is found in Qualitative research and Survey research?

- ► Examine topics primarily from the participants' perspectives
- ► They are guided by predetermined variables to study.
- ► They are descriptive research methods.

http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_airasian_edresearch_7/5/1490/381582.cw/index.html
MCQ # 03

- ► Have large sample sizes.

Question No: 30 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

A single element or group of elements that is eligible for selection via the sampling process is called a:

- ► Sampling panel
- ► Sampling unit

A sampling unit is that element or set of elements considered for selection in some stage of sampling.
PAGE # 89

- ► Sampling error
- ► Sampling quota

Question No: 31 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Codes are rules for_____data.

- ► Classifying
- ► Interpreting
- ► Recording
- ► All of the given options

ALTHOUGH CODES ARE GENERALLY CONSIDERED TO BE NUMERICAL SYMBOLS, THEY ARE MORE BROADLY DEFINED AS THE RULES FOR INTERPRETING, CLASSIFYING, AND RECORDING DATA.
PAGE # 99

Question No: 32 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Which of the following contain the captions for the rows of a table?

- ► Boxheads
- ► Footnotes
- ► Source notes

AFAQ

► None of the given options

A table may contain a caption, row groups, and column groups. A row group contains rows, while a column group contains columns. Rows and columns contain cells. Tables are rendered as layers in a specified order from the bottom up: table, column groups, columns, row groups, rows, and cells.
http://reference.sitepoint.com/css/tableformatting

Question No: 33 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

The experimental design that uses one-group, a treatment, and a posttest is called _____.

► One-shot case study design

One-shot Case Study Design: Also called the one-group posttest-only design, the one-shot case study design has only one group, a treatment, and a posttest
PAGE #117

► Pretest posttest control group design
► Solomon four-group design
► One-group pretest posttest design

Question No: 34 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

When a researcher tries to say that the results of a test market in Karachi will hold in a national rollout of the new product, this researcher is concerned with:

► Internal validity
► The repeated measures effect
► Constant error
► External validity

External validity is the ability to generalize experimental findings to real life situations.
PAGE 122

Question No: 35 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Obtaining secondary data is typically_____and_____expensive than obtaining primary data.

► Faster; more
► Slower; more
► Faster; less

Page # 131

► Slower; less

AFAAQ

Question No: 36 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Which of the following is a disadvantage of secondary data?

- ► User has no control over their reliability and validity
- ► Inability to convert the data
- ► Typically require additional access to research respondents
- ► All of the given options

Question No: 37 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

The study of documents used by writers is a method of_____.

- ► In-depth analysis
- ► Time series analysis
- ► Regression analysis
- ► None of the given options

Content analysis is also the study of documents through which the writers try to communicate, though some of the documents (like population census) may simply contain figures.
Page # 129

Question No: 38 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Historical-Comparative research focuses on:

- ► Its broad historical processes
- ► Comparing forms
- ► Tracing the development of social forms
- ► All of the given options

Historical-Comparative research focuses on:
• Tracing the development of social forms (patterns) overtime as well as its broad its broad historical processes, and
• Comparing those forms and its developmental processes across cultures (countries/nations).
Page # 142

Question No: 39 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

When a manufacturer studies his most successful retailer in depth in order to determine some better ideas for displaying bicycles in its retail stores, this is an example of:

- ► An experiment
- ► A test market
- ► A case study

Case study: It is an in-depth analysis of a unit which could be an individual person, a couple, a group, or an organization
PAGE # 38

VUAO

► Causal research

Question No: 40 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

An interview conducted by a trained moderator among a small group of respondents in an unstructured and natural manner is a_____.

► Depth interview
► Focus group

Focus group an interview conducted by a trained moderator among a small group of respondents in an unstructured and natural manner

http://books.google.com.pk/books?id=TKb8iORscegC&pg=PA145&lpg=PA145&dq=An+interview+conducted+by+a+trained+moderator+among+a+small+group+of+respondents+in+an+unstructured+and+natural+manner+is+a+Focus+group&source=bl&ots=xSwXM_YgdX&sig=vsawE2ctZCs4EW_ajLWVzulC8yY&hl=en&ei=aaVOTZqoKtOChQed3Jm-Dg&sa=X&oi=book_result&ct=result&resnum=2&ved=0CBwQ6AEwAQ#v=onepage&q=An%20interview%20conducted%20by%20a%20trained%20moderator%20among%20a%20small%20group%20of%20respondents%20in%20an%20unstructured%20and%20natural%20manner%20is%20a%20Focus%20group&f=false

► Case study
► None of the given options

Question No: 41 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Which of the following represents this reference: **Riley, T., & Brecht, M. L. (1998). *The success in mentoring process.* In R. Williams (Ed.) *Mentoring and career success.* pp. 129-150. New York: Wilson Press.**

► Edited book

► Book by a single author
► Book by more than one author
► Chapter in an edited book

Chapter in an edited book
This is an article written by single or multiple authors and is printed in the edited book.
Riley, T., & Brecht, M. L. (1998). The success in mentoring process. In R. Williams (Ed.) *Mentoring and career success.* pp. 129-150. New York: Wilson Press.
Page # 165

Question No: 42 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Following are the characteristics of the research **EXCEPT:**

► Systematic

AIAQ

- Data based
- Subjective approach

Research may be considered as an organized, systematic, data based, critical, objective, scientific inquiry
Page # 02

- Scientific inquiry

Question No: 43 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

A variable that is likely to develop with the passage of time between the independent and dependent variable is called:

- Moderating Variable
- Intervening Variable

Intervening Variables
A basic causal relationship requires only independent and dependent variable.
Page # 20

- Confounding Variable
- Predictor Variable

Question No: 44 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Which type of research is involved in preliminary data collection stage?

- Descriptive
- Exploratory

Preliminary Data Collection
This step may be considered as part of the exploratory research.
Page # 36

- Explanatory
- Cannot be determined at this stage of research

Question No: 45 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Which one of the following is **NOT** a type of scales used in measurement of concepts?

- Normal Scale

It is traditional to classify scales of measurement on the basis of the mathematical comparisons that are allowable with these scales. Four types of scales are nominal, ordinal, interval, and ratio.
Page # 53

- Ordinal Scale
- Interval scale
- Ratio Scale

Question No: 46 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

A measure is reliable if it provides consistent_____.

AIAO

- Hypothesis
- Results

A measure is reliable if it provides consistent results

http://books.google.com.pk/books?id=Cf1D0DvWXI8C&pg=PA364&lpg=PA364&dq=A+measure+is+reliable+if+it+provides+consistent+results&source=bl&ots=lbSOKx-1DA&sig=boaxoP-O26BcJezqkZ-0El29dOs&hl=en&ei=uKlOTeO9HaOShAeI5ZGBBg&sa=X&oi=book_result&ct=result&resnum=3&ved=0CCUQ6AEwAg#v=onepage&q=A%20measure%20is%20reliable%20if%20it%20provides%20consistent%20results&f=false

- Procedure
- Sensitivity

Question No: 47 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Which of the following typically does NOT apply to observers in survey research studies?

- They observe predetermined activities.
- They are participant observers.

http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_airasian_edresearch_7/5/1490/381582.cw/index.html
MCQ # 09

- They obtain information by watching rather than asking.
- They must be careful not to influence the activities they observe.

Question No: 48 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Which of the following is NOT a longitudinal study?

- Panel study
- Trend study
- Cohort study
- Census study

http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_airasian_edresearch_7/5/1490/381582.cw/index.html
MCQ # 12

Question No: 49 (Marks: 3)

Do you think that case studies are empirical? Explain.

Question No: 50 (Marks: 3)

How would you differentiate between **History Effect** and **Mechanical Loss** in Experimental research?

Question No: 51 (Marks: 5)

Write a note on any three varieties of non reactive observations.

AIAAQ

Question No: 52 (Marks: 5)

In research process, once you collect the data, how would you perform the scoring index activity? Explain it with the help of example.

Question No: 53 (Marks: 5)

You want to explore females' cosmetic preferences. How would you prepare focus group study for this topic?

FINALTERM EXAMINATION
Spring 2010
Afaaq_tariq@yahoo.com
STA630- Research Methods (Session - 3)

Time: 90 min
Marks: 69

Student Info	
StudentID:	
Center:	
ExamDate:	

For Teacher's Use Only

Q No.	**1**	**2**	**3**	**4**	**5**	**6**	**7**	**8**	**Total**
Marks									
Q No.	**9**	**10**	**11**	**12**	**13**	**14**	**15**	**16**	
Marks									
Q No.	**17**	**18**	**19**	**20**	**21**	**22**	**23**	**24**	
Marks									
Q No.	**25**	**26**	**27**	**28**	**29**	**30**	**31**	**32**	
Marks									
Q No.	**33**	**34**	**35**	**36**	**37**	**38**	**39**	**40**	
Marks									
Q No.	**41**	**42**	**43**	**44**	**45**	**46**	**47**	**48**	

AFAAQ

Marks									
Q No.	**49**	**50**	**51**	**52**	**53**				
Marks									

AFAAQ

Question No: 1 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

The part of the action research spiral that differentiates this research methodology from other kinds of research is;

- ► Looking at multiple sources of data.
- ► Taking action based on results.

http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_airasian_edresearch_7/5/1490/381555.cw/index.html
MCQ # 6

- ► Thinking about or analyzing data in more than one way.
- ► The kinds of data that are collected.

Question No: 2 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

If a researcher was studying the use of various instructional approaches to the "multiple intelligences" of his students, he is likely to be conducting which of the following type of research?

- ► Basic
- ► Evaluation
- ► Applied

http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_airasian_edresearch_8/38/9865/2525631.cw/index.html#topofquiz1
MCQ # 1

- ► Grounded theory

Question No: 3 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Which type of review compares how different theories address an issue?

- ► Context review
- ► Integrated review
- ► Methodological review
- ► Theoretical review

Theoretical reviews compare how different theories address an issue.
Page # 27

Question No: 4 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Which of the following functions is performed by theoretical framework?

- ► Elaborates the relationship among the variables.
- ► Explains the logic underlying these relationships.
- ► Describes the nature, and direction of the relationships.
- ► All of the given options.

AFAAQ

Specifically a theoretical framework:
Elaborates the relationship among the variables
Explains the logic underlying these relationships
Describes the nature, and direction of the relationships

Page # 30

Question No: 5 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Panel and cohort designs differ in that:

► Cohort studies involve quantitative research, whereas panel studies are qualitative.

► A panel study does not need rules to handle new entrants to households.

► Only a cohort study will suffer from sample attrition.

► A panel study can distinguish between age effects and cohort effects, but a cohort design cannot.

Handouts page # 10
ii. *The panel study* is a powerful type of longitudinal research. In panel study, the researcher observes exactly the same people, group, or organization across time periods. It is a difficult to carry out such study. Tracking people over time is often difficult because some people die or cannot be located. Nevertheless, the results of a well-designed panel study are very valuable.
iii. A cohort analysis is similar to the panel study, but rather than observing the exact same people, a category of people who share a similar life experience in a specified time period is studied. The focus is on the cohort, or category, not on specific individuals. Commonly used cohorts include all people born in the same year (called birth cohorts), all people hired at the same time, all people retire on one or two year time frame, and all people who graduate in a given year. Unlike panel studies, researchers do not have to locate the exact same people for cohort studies. The only need to identify those who experienced a common life event.

And

http://www.oup.com/uk/orc/bin/9780199202959/01student/cqs/ch02/?view=za
MCQ # 9

Question No: 6 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Which of the following would LEAST likely be a data source for an action research study of "teachers' questioning techniques in social studies classes"?

► Classroom observation

► Student questionnaires

► Videotaping of classes

► Students' standardized test scores

http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_airasian_edresearch_7/5/1490/381508.cw/index.html
MCQ # 9

Question No: 7 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Which of the following represents excellent advice for conducting an interview?

- ► Listen more and talk less
- ► Don't interrupt
- ► Don't be judgmental about the interviewee's beliefs or views
- ► All of the given options

[PPT]
Qualitative Research Methods

Question No: 8 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Why should a business researcher record and transcribe interviews?

- ► It overcomes all possible ethical considerations.
- ► The response of participants can be more readily shared with senior management.
- ► It allows a more thorough examination of what the interviewee has said.

http://www.oup.com/uk/orc/bin/9780199284986/01student/cqs/ch18/
MCQ # 7

- ► It allows the researcher to demonstrate his/her technical proficiency.

Question No: 9 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

The Pearson product moment correlation is used to demonstrate the relationship between;

- ► Two continuous variables

http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_airasian_edresearch_7/5/1490/381655.cw/index.html
MCQ # 11

- ► Two rank-ordered variables
- ► Variables that are expected to be curvilinearly related
- ► Dichotomous variables

Question No: 10 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

The statistic used to determine the relationship between two variables is:

- ► Analysis of covariance
- ► Chi square
- ► Standard deviation
- ► Pearson "*r*"

http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_airasian_edresearch_7/5/1491/381743.cw/index.htmlQuestionNo:11
MCQ # 17

Question No: 11 (Marks: 1) http://vustudents.ning.com - Please choose one

Researchers organize data into all of the following, EXCEPT:

- ► Field
- ► Table

APAQ

Page # 99
Researchers organize data into fields, records, and files.

- ► Record
- ► File

Question No: 12 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Which of the following is NOT a necessary step in conducting experimental research?

- ► Manipulation of an independent variable
- ► Selection of measuring instruments
- ► Creating a hypothesis stating a causal relationship between variables
- ► Dividing the sample into subgroups to control for extraneous variables

http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_airasian_edresearch_7/5/1491/381867.cw/index.html
MCQ # 02

Question No: 13 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Testing most likely, negatively affect internal validity when:

- ► The information tested is attitudinal in nature
- ► The time between pre- and posttest is short

http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_airasian_edresearch_7/5/1491/381876.cw/index.html
MCQ # 2

- ► The instrument is unreliable
- ► The participants are very low scorers

Question No: 14 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Which of the following questions can be answered using content analysis?

- ► How do managers behave in the face of employment insecurity?
- ► How do the media report corporate re-branding exercises?

http://www.oup.com/uk/orc/bin/9780199284986/01student/cqs/ch12/
MCQ # 01

- ► What effect does organizational size have on marketing strategy?
- ► What are the most popular leisure activities amongst the over-50s?

Question No: 15 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Which one is not the part of non reactive research?

- ► Physical traces
- ► Archives
- ► Observations
- ► Interviews

PAGE # 124
Varieties of Non-Reactive Observations
Physical Traces:
Archives:

AIAQ

Observations:

Question No: 16 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

On which component of his field notes did Mr. Majid focused when he expressed in his notes his thoughts and ideas about what he observed?

► Description
► Reflection

http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_airasian_edresearch_7/5/1489/381392.cw/index.html
MCQ # 01

► Protocol
► Formal data

Question No: 17 (Marks: 1) http://vustudents.ning.com - Please choose one

Which of the following is linked with an abstract model of underlying relations or causal mechanism?

► Historical comparative research PAGE # 148

Synthesis links specific evidence with an abstract model of underlying relations or causal mechanism.

► Social research
► Action research
► Experimental research

Question No: 18 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Historians organize evidence usually in:

► Comparative form
► Narrative form

PAGE # 152

Historians organize evidence as they write works of history. They often write *narrative history*.

► Logical form
► Critical form

Question No: 19 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

What is the difference between a focus group and a group interview?

► A focus group is used to analyse group interaction, whereas a group interview is used as a straight forward data collection tool.

MCQ # 1
http://www.oup.com/uk/orc/bin/9780199284986/01student/cqs/ch19/

► A focus group is used only for political research, whereas group interviews are more widely used in the social sciences.
► A focus group is used at the planning stage of a research project, whereas a group interview is part of the actual data collection.

AFAQ

► **A focus group is used to discuss a wide range of issues, whereas a group interview looks at one specific topic.**

Question No: 20 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

In which component of the method section would you find a discussion of validity and reliability?

► Participants
► Instruments

http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_airasian_edresearch_7/5/1487/380850.cw/site_search_frame/index.html

► Design
► Procedures

Question No: 21 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Which of the following sampling is least reliable but normally the cheapest and easiest to conduct?

► Purposive Sampling
► Snowball Sampling
► Convenience Sampling

Convenience samples are least reliable but normally the cheapest and easiest to conduct
P # 90

► Quota Sampling

Question No: 22 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Which of the following sampling is most often used during the exploratory phase of a research project and is perhaps the best way of getting some basic information quickly and efficiently?

► Convenience Sampling

Convenience sampling is most often used during the exploratory phase of a research project and is perhaps the best way of getting some basic information quickly and efficiently.
P # 90

► Quota Sampling
► Snowball Sampling
► Purposive Sampling

Question No: 23 (Marks: 1) http://vustudents.ning.com- Please choose one

Which of the following is a form of Non-random sampling?

► Snowball sampling
► Convenience sampling
► Quota sampling

AIAQ

► All of the given option

PAGE # 90
OR
Nonrandom Sampling Techniques
The other major type of sampling used in quantitative research is nonrandom sampling (i.e., when you do not use one of the ransom sampling techniques). There are four main types of nonrandom sampling:
The first type of nonrandom sampling is called convenience sampling
The second type of nonrandom sampling is called quota sampling
The third type of nonrandom sampling is called purposive sampling
The fourth type of nonrandom sampling is called snowball sampling
http://www.southalabama.edu/coe/bset/johnson/lectures/lec7.htm
OR
http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Nonprobability_sampling

Question No: 24 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Sampling in qualitative research is similar to which type of sampling in quantitative research?

► Simple random sampling
► Systematic sampling
► Quota sampling
► Purposive sampling

PAGE # 90

Question No: 25 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Which of the following relates with an abstract model of underlying relations or causal mechanism?

► Analysis
► Synthesis

Synthesis links specific evidence with an abstract model of underlying relations or causal mechanism.
PAGE # 148

► Results
► Findings

Question No: 26 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

The easiest way to describe the numerical data of one variable is;

► Frequency distribution

The easiest way to describe the numerical data of one variable is with a frequency distribution.
PAGE # 104

AFAAQ

- ► Normal distribution
- ► Poisson distribution
- ► Probability distribution

Question No: 27 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

All of the following are ways to show a table in percentages, EXCEPT;

- ► By margins

There are three ways to percentage a table: by row, by column, and for the total.
Page # 107

- ► By row
- ► By column
- ► For the total

Question No: 28 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Which of the following is **True** for survey research?

- ► Survey research is a subset of experimental research.
- ► Survey research is often used in experimental research.

http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_airasian_edresearch_7/5/1490/381582.cw/index.html
MCQ # 2

- ► Survey research is never used in experimental research.
- ► Survey research is always used in experimental research.

Question No: 29 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

When an interviewer unintentionally and mistakenly checks the wrong response on a checklist during an interview, this is an example of:

- ► Social desirability bias
- ► Interviewer error

A type of non-sampling error caused by mistakes made by the interviewer These may include influencing the respondent in some way, asking questions in the wrong order, or sing slightly different phrasing (or tone of voice) than other interviewers.

- ► Interviewer cheating
- ► Sponsorship bias

Question No: 30 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

When an interviewer asks a respondent: "Why do you shop at Liberty's department store?" this is an example of a:

- ► Unstructured question
- ► Structured question
- ► Disguised question
- ► Social desirability question

AFAQ

Question No: 31 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

All of the following are stages in the selection of a sample **EXCEPT**:

- ► Determine sample size
- ► Analyze data

Stages in the Selection of a Sample
Step 1: Define the target population
Step 2: Select The Sampling Frame
Step 3: Probability OR Non-probability?
Step 4: Plan Selection of sampling units
Step 5: Determine Sample Size
Step 6: Select Sampling units
Step 7: Conduct Fieldwork

- ► Conduct fieldwork
- ► Select a sampling frame

Question No: 32 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Codes are rules for_____data.

- ► Classifying
- ► Interpreting
- ► Recording
- ► All of the given options

Although codes are generally considered to be numerical symbols, they are more broadly defined as the rules for interpreting, classifying, and recording data
PAGE # 99

Question No: 33 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

When a competitor introduces a 25% price cut in order to blunt the effect of a test marketing study, this is an example of a:

- ► Maturation

effect PAGE 120
Maturation Effect: Cause and effect relationship can also be contaminated by the effects of the passage of time – another uncontrollable variable. Such contamination is called Maturation effect.

- ► Testing effect
- ► History effect
- ► Cohort effect

Question No: 34 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

All of the following elements of Observation is/are included in Non Reactive research **EXCEPT**:

AIAQ

► Count Behaviors
► Time Duration
► **External Appearance**
► Other Records

PAGE # 124
Observations:
• ***External Appearance:*** How people appear may indicate social factors. For example, researcher watches students to see whether they are more likely to wear their college's colors and symbols after the college team won or lost.
• ***Count Behaviors:*** Counting how many people do something can be informative. For example researcher may count the number of men and women who come to a full stop and those who come to a rolling stop at a traffic stop sign. This suggests gender difference in driving behavior.
• ***Time Duration:*** How long people take to do things may indicate their intention. For example
a researcher may measure how long men and women pause in front of a particular painting.
Time taken may indicate their interest in the painting.

Question No: 35 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
Which of the following element is not included for behavioral observation?

► Space
► **Direction**
► Frequency
► Accretion

PAGE # 126

Question No: 36 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
The study of documents used by writers is a method of_____.

► In-depth analysis
► Time series analysis
► Regression analysis
► None of the given options

Content analysis is also the study of documents through which the writers try to communicate, though some of the documents (like population census) may simply contain figures.
Page # 129

Question No: 37 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

AFAAQ

When a manufacturer studies his most successful retailer in depth in order to determine some better ideas for displaying bicycles in its retail stores, this is an example of:

- ► An experiment
- ► A test market
- ► A case study

Case study: It is an in-depth analysis of a unit which could be an individual person, a couple, a group, or an organization
PAGE # 38

- ► Causal research

Question No: 38 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

The written set of guidelines that describes an outline of topics to be covered by a focus group moderator is called a:

- ► Discussion

guide PAGE 155
OR
A detailed written outline of topics the moderator will cover during a focus group discussion.

- ► Concept test
- ► Case study
- ► All of the given options

Question No: 39 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Which of the following is a disadvantage of focus groups?

- ► Requires objective, sensitive, and effective moderators
- ► May not be useful for discussing sensitive topics
- ► High cost
- ► All of the given options

Disadvantages of Focus Groups
Require objective, sensitive, and effective moderators.
May have unique sampling problems.
May not be useful for discussing sensitive topics in face-to-face situations.
Cost a considerable amount of money, particularly when they are not conducted by someone employed by the company desiring the focus group.
Higher cost

Question No: 40 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Which section of a report gives a summary of the contents, including the purpose, description of the participants, the results, and any conclusions being offered?

AFAQ

► Methodology
► **Introduction**
► Abstract

An *abstract* is a summary of a body of information. Sometimes, abstracts are in fact called summaries—sometimes, executive summaries or executive abstracts. There are different kinds of abstracts—your technical report uses two types: the descriptive abstract and the informative abstract.
OR HANDOUTS PAGE 161

► Letter of transmittal

Question No: 41 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Which of the following characteristic of the scientific method is defined as the confirmation or refutation of the observation through the scientific method by using sensory experience?

► **Empirical**
► Verifiable

Verifiable
Observations made through scientific method are to be verified again by using the senses to confirm or refute the previous findings
PAGE # 04

► Observable
► Cumulative

Question No: 42 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Basic research can also be called as

► Practical research
► Fundamental Research

Basic research (also called academic research or pure research or fundamental research).
PAGE # 08

► Action research
► Assessment research

Question No: 43 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Which of the following statement is true about the peer review?

► Name of the article's author is not mentioned to avoid biases
► It should be accepted
► It should be published in a well known journal
► **Name of the author should be mentioned for the further correspondence**

Question No: 44 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

After making the inventory of the relevant variables the next step is to:

AIAQ

- Provide logic for the relationship
- Make inventory of the propositions
- Identify the relationships between the variables

In the discussions the relevant variables are identified, and relationships are postulated. Once the variables are identified, the same focus group discussions help in the formulation of questions, along with the response categories, for the measurement of variables.
PAGE # 156

- Deduce hypothesis

Question No: 45 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Theoretical framework helps to:

- Deduce the hypothesis
- Reject the hypothesis
- Test the hypothesis

From the theoretical framework, then, testable hypotheses can be developed to examine whether theory formulated is valid or not. The hypothesized relationships can thereafter be tested through appropriate statistical analysis.
PAGE # 30

- Accept the hypothesis

Question No: 46 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Which of the following is NOT a method of narrowing a topic?

- Literature review
- Specifying the context
- Talk to the experts
- Pilot testing

Techniques for Narrowing a Topic into a Research Question
1. Examine the literature.
2. Talk over ideas with others.
3. Apply to a specific context.
4. Define the aim or desired outcome of the study.
PAGE # 33

Question No: 47 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

The working definition of the variables is called:

- Theoretical definition
- Dictionary definition
- Operational definition

AIAQ

Operational definition is also called a *working definition* stated in terms of specific testing or measurement criteria.
PAGE # 18

- ► Fundamental definition

Question No: 48 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Which of the following characteristic is reflected by an interval scale?

- ► The distance between each participant's individual scores.
- ► Arithematic operations can be performed after data collection
- ► Classify the data into exclusive categories
- ► All of the given options

http://books.google.com/books?id=eNsVUGTMcDoC&pg=PA138&dq=characteristic+is+reflected+by+an+interval+scale&hl=en&ei=pD5mTJH9MojRcfiPva0P&sa=X&oi=book_result&ct=result&resnum=1&ved=0CCkQ6AEwAA#v=onepage&q=characteristic%20is%20reflected%20by%20an%20interval%20scale&f=false

Question No: 49 (Marks: 3)

What is the logic of field research? How does a field researcher work?

Question No: 50 (Marks: 3)

Historical-Comparative research focuses on some factors, list down those factors?

Question No: 51 (Marks: 5)

Briefly describe the type of observation you would use, the field notes you would develop, and some general principles you would follow to ensure successful data collection.

Question No: 52 (Marks: 5)

What are the functions of a recorder? http://vustudents.ning.com

Question No: 53 (Marks: 5)

Briefly discuss the importance of Data Transformation in Research with the help of example?

FINALTERM EXAMINATION
Spring 2009
AFAAQ_TARIQ@YAHOO.COM
STA630- Research Methods (Session - 1)

AFAAQ

Marks: 80

Question No: 1 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
Which of the following is NOT an assumption of action research?

Action researchers have basic research skills to collect and analyze data.
All professionals need and want feedback on their performance.
Results enable the researchers to evaluate the performance of others.

http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_airasian_edresearch_7/5/1490/381508.cw/index.html
MCQ # 06
Teachers are capable of assuming responsibility for their own professional growth.

Question No: 2 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
Which of the following statements it TRUE for operational definition?

It is one that bears no relation to the underlying concept.
It is an abstract, theoretical definition of a concept
A definition of a concept in terms of specific and empirical measures

http://www.oup.com/uk/orc/bin/9780199202959/01student/cqs/ch06/
MCQ # 01
HANDOUTS PAGE # 18 & 50

It is one that refers to opera singers and their work.

Question No: 3 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
Which of the following statements best defines hypothesis?

A quantitative study
A tentative prediction of the results of the research

http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_airasian_edresearch_8/38/9865/2525651.cw/content/index
MCQ @ 24
A qualitative research design
The operational definition of the study

Question No: 4 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
When the research starts from the effects and tracing the reasons back in time, what does it called?

Case study

AFAAQ

It is more like a clinical analysis in retrospect; starting from the effect and tracing the reasons back in time. The researcher takes the history of the situation and makes use of any other relevant information about the case to identify the factors leading to the present situation

Page # 38

Experiment
Observation studies
Historical comparitive research

Question No: 5 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

The extent to which a test provides scores that are meaningful, appropriate, or useful is referred to as;

Reliability
Accuracy
Internal validity
Validity

http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_airasian_edresearch_8/38/9866/2525945.cw/content/index
MCQ # 18
HANDOUTS PAGE # 55

Question No: 6 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Mr. Hasan s son has applied to a high school in Florida, but the application was denied solely on his low score on the Iowa Test of Basic Skills (ITBS). His son wants to attend this school and contends his current grades and other standardized test scores speak well to both his past work and future academic capability. Which of the following characteristics of the ITBS is being questioned by this student?

Construct validity
Content validity
Predictive validity

Predictive validity:
Criterion validity whereby an indicator predicts future events that are logically related to a construct is called a predictive validity.
PAGE # 56
Concurrent validity

Question No: 7 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Internal consistency estimates of reliability such as the KR-20 or Cronbach's alpha are used more frequently than other estimates such as test-retest or parallel forms because internal consistency estimates;

Are easily calculated
Require only one administration of a test

AIAAQ

http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_airasian_edresearch_7/5/1489/381232.cw/index.html
MCQ # 05
Are more accurate than all other types of estimates
Are usually higher

Question No: 8 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
Which of the following functions is performed by the Odinal scale?

Categorize
Distance
Order

Ordinal Scale
Ordinal scales include the characteristics of the nominal scale plus an indicator of order.
PAGE # 53
Unique origin

Question No: 9 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
Which of the following is measured by the Interval scale?

Order of the object
Magnitude of the object
Categorize the object
All of the given options

On interval measurement scales, one unit on the scale represents the same magnitude on the trait or characteristic being measured across the whole range of the scale.
OR HANDOUTS PAGE # 53

Question No: 10 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
Following are the properties of nominal scale, except;

Least powerful
Suggest no order
Provide categorical information
Provide magnitude of object

Nominal Scale
A nominal scale is the one in which the numbers or letters assigned to objects serve as labels for identification or classification. This measurement scale is the simplest type. With nominal data, we are collecting information on a variable that naturally or by design can be grouped into two or more categories that are mutually exclusive, and collectively exhaustive.

ALAAQ

Nominal scales are the least powerful of the four scales. They suggest no order or distance relationship and have no arithmetic origin. Nevertheless, if no other scale can be used, one can almost always one set of properties into a set of equivalent classes.
PAGE # 53

Question No: 11 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
What is the difference between interval/ratio and ordinal variables?

Ordinal data can be rank ordered, but interval/ratio data cannot.
The distance between categories is equal across the range of interval/ration data.

http://www.oup.com/uk/orc/bin/9780199202959/01student/cqs/ch14/
MCQ # 01
Interval/ratio variables contain only two categories.
Ordinal variables have a fixed zero point, whereas interval/ratio variables do not.

Question No: 12 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
A study design in which the researcher might create_____ to establish cause-and-effect relationship is called Experimental Design.

An artificial setting, control some variables and manipulates the independent variable
A natural setting, control some variables and manipulates the dependent variables
An artificial setting, control some variables and manipulates the dependent variable
All of the given options

Question No: 13 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
Which of the following would LEAST likely be a data source for an action research study of "teachers' questioning techniques in social studies classes"?

Student questionnaires
Videotaping of classes
Students' standardized test scores

http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_airasian_edresearch_7/5/1490/381508.cw/index.html
MCQ # 09
Classroom observation

Question No: 14 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
Teachers are advised to predict the results of student attitudinal questionnaires, because;

It will help them decide if students answered truthfully.
It gives them a point of comparison against which to judge actual responses.

http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_airasian_edresearch_7/5/1490/381508.cw/index.html
MCQ # 10
It will allow them to apply statistical procedures in analyzing results.

AIOU

It helps them familiarize themselves with the questionnaires.

Question No: 15 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
Which of the following is an example of a question about normative standards and values?

How many workers are employed at this plant?
What is your attitude towards the management at this plant?
Do you always cast your vote in trade union elections?

http://www.oup.com/uk/orc/bin/9780199284986/01student/cqs/ch10/
MCQ # 03
Are you aware of the main features of the European Union Directive for informing and consulting employees?

Question No: 16 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
Questions that include negatives should be avoided because:

The respondent may miss out the negative word.
The respondent may be unsure how to answer if the question includes a double negative.
The respondent may be led by the question.
All of the given options.

http://www.oup.com/uk/orc/bin/9780199284986/01student/cqs/
OR
When using a Likert scale it can be difficult to avoid asking a question with a negative, however the researcher should attempt to avoid them if possible.

Question No: 17 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
Random assignment to treatment groups is characteristic of which kind of research?

Causal-comparative
Correlational
Experimental

PAGE # 114
OR
http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_airasian_edresearch_7/5/1491/381743.cw/index.html
MCQ # 05

Descriptive

Question No: 18 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
Which of the following is likely to happen if clear instructions are not given as to how the respondent should answer the question?

AIAQ

Respondents may delete inappropriate answers rather than select appropriate ones.
Respondents may choose only one answer when they need to choose as many as apply.
Respondents may complete questions that are not relevant to them.
All of the given options

http://www.oup.com/uk/orc/bin/9780199284986/01student/cqs/ch09/
MCQ # 07

Question No: 19 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
Which of the following is NOT an example of a problem with using social survey research to investigate behaviour?

Respondents tend to answer by giving the most socially desirable answer.
Respondents may inadvertently omit key terms in the question.
Respondents may not give an honest reply to what they see as a threatening question.
Respondents may be unwilling to reveal information as they believe they are likely to be identified.

http://www.oup.com/uk/orc/bin/9780199284986/01student/cqs/ch11/
MCQ # 01
OR
An advantage of social survey research is that the researcher can ensure that the anonymity of the respondent is maintained by administering the same questions to each individual.

Question No: 20 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
What is the main purpose of pilot testing?

To accumulate responses
To identify respondent
To identify potential problems

Pilot testing is to identify potential problems with the methods, logistics, and the questionnaire.
PAGE # 80
To evaluate the research

Question No: 21 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
Which of the following sampling strategies was used when the three students with the highest GPAs were selected?

Extreme case

http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_airasian_edresearch_7/5/1489/381384.cw/index.html
MCQ # 02

AFAQ

Snowball
Maximum variation
Normal case.

Question No: 22 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
Which of the following best describes qualitative data analysis?

It begins after all the data has been collected.
It is an ongoing, cyclic process integrated into all phases of research.

http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_airasian_edresearch_8/38/9871/2527149.cw/content/index.html
MCQ # 05
It is an awkward, haphazard process.
It builds from abstraction to specific, concrete examples

Question No: 23 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
Which of the following represents the most general conceptualization in qualitative data analysis?

Word
Topic
Category
Pattern

http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_airasian_edresearch_7/5/1490/381483.cw/index.html
MCQ # 01

Question No: 24 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
The control procedure that allows the researcher to determine the effect of the independent variable and the control variable on the dependent variable both separately and in combination is;

Analysis of covariance
Matching
Forming subgroups to represent all levels of the control variable

http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_airasian_edresearch_7/5/1491/381743.cw/index.htmlQuestionNo:11
MCQ # 08
Randomization

Question No: 25 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
Which of the following could NOT be a cause of variation in high school achievement?

AFAQ

Reading ability
Parental involvement
Teacher expectations
College attendance

http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_airasian_edresearch_7/5/1491/381743.cw/index.htmlQuestionNo:11
MCQ # 11

Question No: 26 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
In experimental research, what does a researcher manipulate?

At least one dependent variable
All variables
At least one independent variable

http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_airasian_edresearch_7/5/1491/381820.cw/index.html
MCQ # 01
OR
http://books.google.com.pk/books?id=j09b2rTVRsAC&pg=PA20&lpg#v=onepage&q&f=false

At least one independent variable and one dependent variable

Question No: 27 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
In an experimental study, "the effects of inclusion on academic self-concept of children with special needs", the researcher must control which of the following?

The selection of subjects but not their assignment to a treatment group
The selection and assignment of subjects

http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_airasian_edresearch_7/5/1491/381820.cw/index.html
MCQ # 04

The assignment of subjects to a treatment group but not their selection
Neither the selection nor assignment of subjects

Question No: 28 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
Ecological validity refers to:

The participants to whom results generalize
The instruments used to measure the independent and dependent variables
The internal validity of a study
The context to which results generalize

AIAO

http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_airasian_edresearch_8/38/9869/2526465.cw/index.html
MCQ # 01

Question No: 29 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
Many beginner researchers believe that research involves testing, treating, and testing again . This is an example of:

Comparison group research
Quasi-experimental research
True experimental research
Pre-experimental research

http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_airasian_edresearch_7/5/1491/381820.cw/index.html
MCQ # 15

Question No: 30 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
Single-subject research is LEAST concerned with:

Clinical significance
Internal validity
Validity of measuring instruments
External validity

http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_airasian_edresearch_7/5/1491/381820.cw/index.html
MCQ # 18

Question No: 31 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
On which component of his field notes did Mr. Majid focused when he expressed in his notes his thoughts and ideas about what he observed?

Description
Reflection

http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_airasian_edresearch_7/5/1487/380850.cw/site_search_frame/index.html
Protocol
Formal data

Question No: 32 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
In which section is the researcher allowed greater flexibility to express opinions, discuss implications for educational practice, and suggest additional research?

Review of the literature

AFAQ

Significance of the study
Results
Discussion

http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_airasian_edresearch_7/5/1492/382157.cw/index.html
MCQ # 07

Question No: 33 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
Determining the sample interval (represented by K), randomly selecting a number between 1 to K, and including each K element in your sample are the steps for which form of sampling?

Simple Random Sampling
Stratified Random Sampling
Systematic Sampling

Systematic sampling
Simple or stratified in nature
Systematic in the "picking-up" of element. E.g. every 5th. visitor, every 10th. House, every 15th. minute
Steps:
* Number the population (1,…,N)
* Decide on the sample size, n
* Decide on the interval size, k = N/n
* Select an integer between 1 and k
* Take case for every kth.

unit Cluster sampling

Question No: 34 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
A focus group session is ideally for;

1 hour
1 and half hour

Duration, a focus group session typically lasts up to an hour and a half.
PAGE # 155
2 hours
More than 2 hours

Question No: 35 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
In an experimental research study, the primary goal is to isolate and identify the effect produced by which of the following?

Dependent variable
Extraneous variable
Independent variable

AFAAQ

http://www.southalabama.edu/coe/bset/johnson/mcq/mc9.htm
MCQ # 23
Confounding variable

Question No: 36 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
Which of the following is the process of identifying and classifying each item and giving labels to each category?

Accretion
Count Behaviors
Intensity
Coding

Coding
The process of identifying and classifying each item and giving labels to each category.
PAGE # 126

Question No: 37 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
When do largest percentages form a pattern across cells?

If there is no relationship
If there is non linear relationship
If there is curvilinear relationship

Curvilinear relationship, the largest percentages form a pattern across cells.
PAGE # 107
If there is linear relationship

Question No: 38 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
Which of the following elements is/are not included for structuring Observation in Non reactive research?

Frequency
Intensity
Direction

Accretion

Observations can be structured
Frequency:
Direction:
Intensity:
Space:
PAGE # 126

AFAAQ

Question No: 39 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
A census taker often collects data through which of the following?

Standardized tests
Interviews

http://www.southalabama.edu/coe/bset/johnson/mcq/mc6.htm
MCQ # 20
Secondary data
Observations

Question No: 40 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
What is the particular advantage of secondary analysis to business students?

It is less challenging intellectually
It guarantees positive results
It is less expensive and less time consuming than primary analysis

http://www.oup.com/uk/orc/bin/9780199284986/01student/cqs/ch13/
MCQ # 02
It enables students to gain experience of the workplace

Question No: 41 (Marks: 5)
Defend the use of the term inductive to describe qualitative data analysis and interpretation.

Question No: 42 (Marks: 5)
What are the main parts of a research report?

Question No: 43 (Marks: 10)
Many universities do not allow their students to conduct experimental research to fulfil thesis or dissertation requirements. Provide a rationale for changing this practice, acknowledging the limitations of experimental research, but also citing at least three reasons that action research should be accepted.

Question No: 44 (Marks: 10)
A multination company ABC has launched a new tooth paste Cleanex in Pakistan. After eight months the company wants to analyze the consumer satisfaction about their tooth paste. For research purpose, develop questions for the following scenarios that can be used in questionnaire.
See the consumer preference for tooth paste or tooth powder by using nominal scale.
i. See the consumer preference for Cleanex Tooth Paste by using ordinal scale.
ii. See the important characteristics of the Cleanex Tooth Paste by using interval scale so that the company can modify its strengths and improve its weaknesses.
iii. Check the monthly consumption of the tooth paste by using the ratio scale.

AFAQ

Question No: 45 (Marks: 10)
What is the need of a trivariate table? How can we construct trivariate table and what

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FINALTERM EXAMINATION
Spring 2009
AFAAQ_TARIQ@YAHOO.COM
STA630- Research Methods

Question No: 1 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
An experiment has high_____if one has confidence that the experimental treatment has been the source of change in the dependent variable.

Internal validity

http://www.blurtit.com/q346633.html

External validity

Internal and external validity

Internal and external reliability

Question No: 2 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
_____is the arbitrary and subjective.

Probability sampling

Non- Probability sampling

The selection of units in non-probability sampling is quite arbitrary
PAGE # 90

Cluster sampling

All of the given options

Question No: 3 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
Which of the following is NOT included in the stages of interviewing?

Asking questions

Recording the responses

AFAAQ

Probing

Coding the data

Stages of an Interview
Asking the Questions
Probing
Recording the Responses
Page # 83 & 84

Question No: 4 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
Critical decision areas in questionnaire construction are_____

Question content

Question wording

Response strategy

All of the given options

http://books.google.com.pk/books?id=Cf1D0DvWXI8C&pg=PA336&lpg=PA336&dq=#v=onepage&q&f=false

Question No: 5 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
_____is based on the concept of random sampling.

Non- probability sampling

Probability sampling

The simple random is the best known probability sample,
PAGE # 90

Random sampling

Multiple sampling

Question No: 6 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
A sampling design in which the elements in the population do NOT have a known or predetermined chance of being selected as sample subject is:

Convenience sampling

Stratified sampling

AFAQ

Non-Probability sampling

http://www.slidefinder.net/s/sampling_sample_design_jn602_week/5349303
SLIDE # 09
OR
In non-probability sampling the probability of any particular element of the population being chosen is unknown.
PAGE # 90

Probability sampling

Question No: 7 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
_____is the population for which results are required.

Finite population

Infinite population

Target population

Page # 88
OR
http://www.ehes.info/manuals/EHES_manual/PartA/EHES_Manual_PartA_Chapter2.pdf

None of the given options

Question No: 8 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
Which of the following technique yields a simple random sample?

Choosing volunteers from an introductory psychology class to participate

Listing the individuals by ethnic group and choosing a proportion from within each ethnic group at random

Numbering all the elements of a sampling frame and then using a random number table to pick cases from the table

http://www.southalabama.edu/coe/bset/johnson/mcq/mc7.htm
MCQ # 02

Randomly selecting schools, and then sampling everyone within the school

Question No: 9 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
Which of the following designs permits a comparison of pretest scores to determine the initial equivalence of groups on the pretest before the treatment variable is introduced into the research setting.

AIAAQ

(a) One-group pretest-posttest design

(b) Pretest-posttest control group design

http://www.southalabama.edu/coe/bset/johnson/mcq/mc9.htm
MCQ # 09

(c) Posttest-only design with nonequivalent groups

(d) Both b and c

Question No: 10 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
Where do you provide a step-by-step account of what the researcher and participants did during the research study?

Introduction

Abstract

Procedure

Procedure: The procedure includes the step-by-step how of your experiment. The procedure should include:

- A description of the experimental design and how participants were assigned conditions.
- Identification of your independent variable(s) (IV), dependent variable(s) (DV), and control variables. Give your variables clear, meaningful names so that your readers are not confused.
- Important instructions to participants.
- A step-by-step listing in chronological order of what participants did during the experiment.

http://owl.english.purdue.edu/owl/resource/670/04/

Design

Question No: 11 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
Which of the following has high response rate?

Mail interviewing

Telephone interviewing

Personal interviewing

http://books.google.com.pk/books?id=FqF7n0zGJm0C&pg=PA380&lpg=PA380&#v=onepage&q&f=false
2ND PARAGRAPH

None of the given options

Question No: 12 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
Observation studies are also known as_____research.
Experimental

Field

OBSERVATION STUDIES/FIELD RESEARCH
PAGE 134

Quantitative

None of the given options

Question No: 13 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
Open-ended questions provide primarily_____data.

Unprocessed data

Qualitative data

http://www.southalabama.edu/coe/bset/johnson/mcq/mc6.htm
MCQ # 11

All of the given options

None of the given options

Question No: 14 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
Which one of the following is NOT a major method of data collection:

Questionnaires

Interviews

Focus groups

AFAAQ

All of the given options are methods of data collection

Data collection forms (questionnaires, checklist, interview guide, other forms)
PAGE # 35

Question No: 15 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
Which of the following statement is incorrect?

In non participant observation the observer is just an observer.

In participant observation, the data accuracy is high.

Observation studies can be participant or non-participant. In participant observation the researcher directly observes and participates in small scale social settings in the present time.
PAGE # 134

Participant observation is also referred to as field research.

None of the given options

Question No: 16 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
If the subjects are given a pretest it will not affect their performance in the posttest.

True

False

Question No: 17 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
In non- reactive research the subjects do not have knowledge that they are being studied.

True

In non-reactive research, those being studied are not aware that they are part of a research project.
Page # 124

False

Question No: 18 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
In experimental group the subjects do not under go any treatment; however in control group the subjects are given the treatment.

True

AFAQ

False
Page # 114

Question No: 19 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
When multiple questions are asked in one question, it leads to ambiguous answers provided by the respondents.

True

http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Multiple_choice
OR
Page # 78
Avoid Double-Barreled Questions
Make each question about one and only one. A double barreled question consists of two or more questions joined together. It makes the respondent's answer ambiguous. For example, if asked, "Does this company have pension and health insurance benefits?" a respondent at the company with health insurance benefits only might answer either yes or no. The response has an ambiguous meaning and the researcher cannot be certain of the respondent's intentions. When multiple questions are asked in one question, thee results may be exceedingly difficult to interpret.

False

Question No: 20 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
An advantage of communication analysis is that it provides access to the inaccessible subjects.

True

False

Question No: 21 (Marks: 1)
Pretest is the phase when the_____variable is measured prior to the introduction of treatment.

Question No: 22 (Marks: 1)
If the percentages are calculated column wise in a table, then we will make comparison between the variables in a_**frequency**_.

Question No: 23 (Marks: 1)
In order to make two identical groups for experiment, the procedures to be undertaken are randomization and **matching.**

Question No: 24 (Marks: 1)

AFAQ

The main advantage of **_mail _**questionnaire is that a wide geographical area can be covered in the survey.

Question No: 25 (Marks: 1)
A type of bias in questions occurs when they are phrased in an emotionally charged manner, they are described as**__Loaded__**questions.
Page No.78

Question No: 26 (Marks: 5)
Make one hypothesis for each of the following types of hypotheses. (1 mark each)
i. If-then hypothesis
ii. Directional hypothesis
iii. Non directional hypothesis
iv. Null hypothesis
v. Alternative hypothesis
Answer:

i- If-then hypothesis:

If there is increase in cost there is decrease in profit.

ii. Directional hypothesis:

Increase in absentieesm causes a decrease in productivity level of employees.

iii. Non directional hypothesis:

Productivity level of employees is associated with rate of absenteeism.

iv. Null hypothesis:

There is no association between level of productivity and absenteeism.

v. Alternative hypothesis :

There is a relationship between level of job commitment of officers and their level of efficiency.

Question No: 27 (Marks: 5)
Which is the most powerful scale among Nominal, Ordinal, Interval and Ratio scale, and why?
Answer:
The highest level of measurement is a ratio scale. This has the properties of an interval scale together with a fixed origin or zero point. Examples of variables which are ratio scaled include weights, lengths and times. Ratio scales permit the researcher to compare both differences in scores and the relative magnitude of scores. For instance the difference between 5 and 10 minutes is the same as that between 10 and 15 minutes, and

AFAAQ

10 minutes is twice as long as 5 minutes. Suffice it to say that virtually all statistical operations can be performed on ratio scales.

Question No: 28 (Marks: 5)
A manager finds that off-the-job classroom training has a great impact on the productivity of the employees in her department. However, she also observes that employees over 60 years of age do not seem to derive much benefit and do not improve with such training.

i. Identify the independent, dependent and moderating variables in the given scenario. (3)

Answer:
Inependent Variable: Off-the-job classroom training
Dependent Variable: Employees performance
Moedrating Variable: Employees age over 60 years

ii. How the moderating variable you identified in part (i) is affecting the independent-dependent variable relationship in the scenario? (2)
Answer:
The moderating variable is one that has a strong contingent effect on the independent variable and dependent variable relationship. That is the presence of a third variable modifies the original relationship between the independent and the dependent variable
In the scenario above employees age over 60 years is acting as moderating variable because it is the variable which affects the relationship of employees performance (dependent variable) and off-the-job classrom training (independent variable).which was positive in above case but age over 60 years reduces the positivity .

Question No: 29 (Marks: 5)
The accounts executive has established a new accounting system that utilizes maximum computer technology. Before making further changes, he would like to get a feel for how the accounting clerks react to the new system by acting as if he has no doubts about their acceptability of the new system. He may then casually talk to the first five accounting personnel that walk into his office, trying to gauge their reactions.

i. Describe the type of sampling the director should use in the given scenario, probability or non probability? (1)

Answer:
Director should use probability sampling as probability sampling is the technique in which some known elements of population participated in order to provide useful descriptions.

ii. What type of sampling technique is being used and why? Explain. (2)

Answer:
Director should use probability sampling as probability sampling is the technique in which some known elements of population participated in order to provide useful descriptions.

AIAAO

iii. Give two characteristics of the type of sampling technique that you selected in part (ii).

Answer:

Two characteristics of probability sampling:

1- Random sampling lets a researcher statistically calculate the relationship between the sample and the population – that is the size of *sampling error*

2- All possible samples have a known and specified probability of being drawn.

Question No: 30 (Marks: 5)
You are doing research on "how to increase the efficiency level of labor". For the research purpose you have conducted an interview with the supervisor.
Give two structured and two unstructured questions that you may ask related to your research. (2.5+2.5)

Question No: 31 (Marks: 10)
What is meant by validity and reliability? Describe the situations in which validity and reliability problems occur.

for more contents visit

AFAAQ

FINALTERM EXAMINATION
Spring 2009
AFAAQ_TARIQ@YAHOO.COM
STA630- Research Methods (Session - 2)

Marks: 80

Question No: 1 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
Who, among the following, wrote the book "Research Methods for Business"?
Zikmund, W.
Sekaran, U.
Research Methods For Business *(A Skill Building Approach), 4E by* Sekaran U.
Dessler, G.
Neuman, W.C.

Question No: 2 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
On which of the following, Scientific knowledge mostly relies?
Identification of events
Logical understanding
Prior knowledge
All of the given options

PAGE # 04

Question No: 3 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
Which of the following refers to research supported by measurable evidence?
Opinion
Speculation
Empiricism
PAGE # 03
Rationalism

Question No: 4 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
All of the following are true statements about action research EXCEPT;
Data are systematically analyzed.
Data are collected systematically.
Results are generalizable.

http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_airasian_edresearch_7/5/1490/381508.cw/index.html
MCQ # 02
Results are used to improve practice.

Question No: 5 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
If a researcher is studying the effect of using laptops in his classroom to ascertain their merit and worth, he is likely conducting which of the following types of research?

Evaluation

http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_airasian_edresearch_8/38/9865/2525631.cw/index.html
MCQ # 02
Experimental
Applied
Basic

Question No: 6 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
What is the problem with using strict definitions of important concepts?

They take the focus away from accurate measurement.
They prevent the researcher from assessing alternative ways of viewing a concept.

http://www.oup.com/uk/orc/bin/9780199284986/01student/cqs/ch16/
MCQ # 03
They prevent a consistent approach being achieved with business research.
They prevent research from being truly objective.

AFAQ

Question No: 7 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
A variable that is presumed to cause a change in another variable is known as:
Discontinuous variable
Dependent variable
Independent variable

http://www.southalabama.edu/coe/bset/johnson/mcq/mc2.htm
MCQ # 05
Intervening variable

Question No: 8 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
Which of the following is the difference between measures and indicators?
Measures are unambiguous quantities, whereas indicators are devised from common sense understandings.

http://www.oup.com/uk/orc/bin/9780199202959/01student/cqs/ch06/
MCQ # 03
OR
Measures include things like demographics (of age, income and so on), which can be counted. In fact, usually we think of measures as raw numbers. Often though, what we want to research does not lend itself immediately to straightforward calculation on numbers of things and how they vary but on slightly vaguer concepts. Like job satisfaction, for example. In this case we need a number of attitude statements, which, taken together, can be argued to represent the concept. These separate statements are indicators and often represent our 'common sense' understanding of a concept. Later, these can be coded to turn them into numbers for statistical analysis.
Indicators have a more direct relationship to the underlying concept than measures.
Measures are intuitively devised and then applied as if they were direct indicators of a concept.
Indicators are unambiguous quantities, whereas measures are subjective and value laden.

Question No: 9 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
Which of the following is NOT the implication of Ordinal scale?

Characteristics of nominal scale
Rank the object
Does not provide magnitude of object
Provide rate
PAGE # 53

Question No: 10 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
Measurement reliability refers to which of the following?

Accuracy of the scores
Dependency of the scores

ALQ

Consistency of the scores
Comprehensiveness of the scores

Question No: 11 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
Which of the following statements might assist response rates?
Please photocopy the questionnaire five times and pass on to your work colleagues.
Please make sure that the questionnaire is completed with a fountain pen.
Please read the attached journal article on the ontological foundations of positivism prior to completing the questionnaire.
Please put the completed questionnaire in the enclosed stamped addressed envelope and place in the mail out tray.

http://www.oup.com/uk/orc/bin/9780199284986/01student/cqs/ch09/
MCQ # 03

Question No: 12 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
Why it is important to avoid ambiguous terms while designing questions?

Respondents may not understand the question.
Respondents may operate with a different frame of reference.

http://www.oup.com/uk/orc/bin/9780199284986/01student/cqs/ch10/
MCQ # 05
Respondents may think the question is less important.
Respondents may have to ask for help when completing the questionnaire.

Question No: 13 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
Which of the following is a double-barrelled question?

How satisfied you are with the performance appraisal system?
How satisfied you are with investment levels in new and existing software packages?

A double barreled question consists of two or more questions joined together. It makes the respondent's answer ambiguous. For example, if asked, "Does this company have pension and health insurance benefits?" a respondent at the company with health insurance benefits only might answer either yes or no.
PAGE # 78
How satisfied you are with the organisation's marketing strategy?
How satisfied you are with the levels of customer satisfaction?

Question No: 14 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
The small scale trial run of a particular item is called_____.
Test Run
Pilot test

AFAQ

Pilot testing also called pre-testing means small scale trial run of a particular component; here we are referring to pilot testing of the questionnaire.
PAGE # 80
Post hoc test
T test

Question No: 15 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
Which of the following terms describes an interview protocol in which the topics and questions to be addressed are identified, but the order in which the questions can be asked is not stipulated?

Unstructured
Partially structured
Semistructured

http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_airasian_edresearch_8/38/9870/2526923.cw/content/index
MCQ # 14
Structured

Question No: 16 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
The most important characteristic of the sample in survey research is that it is:

Representative of the target population.

http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_airasian_edresearch_7/5/1490/381619.cw/index.html
MCQ # 04
OR
Usually, the population is too large for the researcher to attempt to survey all of its members. A small, but carefully chosen *sample* can be used to represent the population. The sample reflects the characteristics of the population from which it is drawn.
Convenient to access.
Easily observed in naturalistic settings.
Large enough to compare differences between subgroups.

Question No: 17 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
Which of the following is NOT something a researcher will have to consider while thinking about their sample size?

Time and cost.
Non-response.
Length of questionnaire

http://www.oup.com/uk/orc/bin/9780199284986/01student/cqs/ch07/
MCQ # 05
OR

AIAO

In general bigger is better when considering sample size however all researchers need to be aware of the limitations of their resources.

Heterogeneity of population.

Question No: 18 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
A correlation coefficient of -0.45 is generally considered to be;

No correlation
Low
Moderate
http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_airasian_edresearch_7/5/1490/381655.cw/index.html
MCQ # 06
High

Question No: 19 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
What is a researcher doing when he removes the variance explained by one variable in order to understand the correlation between two other variables?

Statistical significance
Attenuation
Controlling for the variable

http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_airasian_edresearch_7/5/1490/381655.cw/index.html
MCQ # 10
Multiple regression research

Question No: 20 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
Which of the following best describes qualitative data analysis?

It begins after all the data has been collected.
It is an ongoing, cyclic process integrated into all phases of research.

http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_airasian_edresearch_8/38/9871/2527149.cw/content/index
MCQ # 05
It is an awkward, haphazard process.
It builds from abstraction to specific, concrete examples.

Question No: 21 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
The statistic used to determine the relationship between two variables is:
Analysis of covariance

AFAQ

Chi square
Standard deviation
Pearson "r"

http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_airasian_edresearch_7/5/1491/381743.cw/index.htmlQuestionNo:22
MCQ # 17

Question No: 22 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
Which of the following describes the nature of qualitative data interpretation?

Reflection
Integrative
Explanatory
All of the given options

http://wps.prenhall.com/wps/grader
Question No: 23 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
In frequency tables total of columns and rows are called:

Body of table
Cell of table
Area of table
Marginals

Include the totals of the columns and rows. These are called *marginals* They equal the nivariate frequency distribution for the variable.
Page #107

Question No: 24 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
A researcher studies three groups of students who vary in level of self-confidence. She finds that students with higher self-confidence are more popular among their peers. The most plausible conclusion is that

We do not know what causes self-confidence or popularity.
Self-confidence causes popularity.
Popularity causes self-confidence.
Self-confidence and popularity are related.

http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_airasian_edresearch_7/5/1491/381743.cw/index.ht
MCQ # 07

Question No: 25 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

AFAAQ

Educational policy makers often conclude that an intervention didn't work. Often, however, the intervention was not implemented as intended. The validity of the policymakers' conclusion is threatened by

Lack of specificity of variables

http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_airasian_edresearch_8/38/9869/2526465.cw/index.html
MCQ # 05
Selection-treatment interaction
Treatment diffusion
Faulty data analysis procedures

Question No: 26 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
Many beginner researchers believe that research involves testing, treating, and testing again is an example of:

Comparison group research
Quasi-experimental research
True experimental research
Pre-experimental research

http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_airasian_edresearch_7/5/1491/381886.cw/index.html
MCQ #02

Question No: 27 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
Which of the following questions can be answered using content analysis?
How do managers behave in the face of employment insecurity?
How do the media report corporate re-branding exercises?

http://www.oup.com/uk/orc/bin/9780199284986/01student/cqs/ch12/
MCQ # 01
What effect does organizational size have on marketing strategy?
What are the most popular leisure activities amongst the over-50s?

Question No: 28 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
Case study is empirical because;
It investigates a contemporary phenomenon within its real life context.
It is retrospective study in which the researcher follows the research process from effect to its cause.
It is a study back in time.
All of the given options

It investigates a contemporary phenomenon within its real life context. It is retrospective study n which the researcher follows the research process from effect to its cause. It is a study back in time

AIAQ

PAGE # 158

Question No: 29 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
Which component of a research report contains information about the topic studied, iterature review, hypotheses, participants, instruments, procedures, results, and discussion?

Preliminary pages
Main body

http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_airasian_edresearch_8/38/9872/2527359.cw/index.html
MCQ03
Method
Discussion

Question No: 30 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
Which one of the following Test helps in the proper sequence of the questions as wording, translation, coding and structuring?
Test Run
Pre Test

Pre-testing may help in putting questions in proper sequence, using acceptable wording, doing appropriate translation, question spacing, structuring of answers, coding system, and needing instructions for interviewers (probing).
PAGE # 81
Post Hoc Test
T- Test
Question No: 31 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
Which of the following sampling is least reliable but normally the cheapest and easiest to conduct?
Purposive Sampling
Snowball Sampling
Convenience Sampling

Convenience samples are least reliable but normally the cheapest and easiest to conduct.
PAGE # 90
Quota Sampling

Question No: 32 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
Which of the following is a form of Non-random sampling?

Snowball sampling
Convenience sampling
Quota sampling
All of the given option

AIAQ

PAGE # 90
OR
Nonrandom Sampling Techniques
The other major type of sampling used in quantitative research is nonrandom sampling (i.e., when you do not use one of the ransom sampling techniques). There are four main types of nonrandom sampling:
The first type of nonrandom sampling is called convenience sampling
The second type of nonrandom sampling is called quota sampling
The third type of nonrandom sampling is called purposive sampling
The fourth type of nonrandom sampling is called snowball sampling
http://www.southalabama.edu/coe/bset/johnson/lectures/lec7.htm
OR
http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Nonprobability_sampling

Question No: 33 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
Which of the following has greatly facilitated the researcher to conduct tabulation and statistical analysis?

SPSS
MINITAB
SYSTAT
All of the given options

The proliferation of computer technology in business and universities has greatly facilitated tabulation and statistical analysis. Commercial packages eliminate the need to write a new program every time you want to tabulate and analyze data with a computer. SAS, Statistical Package for the Social Sciences (SPSS), SYSTAT, Epi. Info. And MINITAB is commonly used statistical packages.
Page # 104

Question No: 34 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
What is the place of quotations in referencing?

Quotations should be given at the end.
Quotations should be given exactly as they appear in the source.

http://www.latrobe.edu.au/linguistics/resources_hons/Brochure/Para10.pdf
Quotations should be given in left margins only.
Quotations should not be given at all.

Question No: 35 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
Which of the following terms refers to a statistical method that can be used to statistically equate groups on a pretest or some other variable?

Experimental control

AIAQ

Differential influence
Matching
Analysis of covariance

http://www.southalabama.edu/coe/bset/johnson/mcq/mc9.htm
MCQ # 07

Question No: 36 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
Which of the following could be used for randomly assigning participants to groups in an experimental study?

Split-half
Even versus Odd numbers
Use a list of random numbers or a computer randomization program

http://www.southalabama.edu/coe/bset/johnson/mcq/mc9.htm
MCQ#15
Let the researcher decide which group will be the best

Question No: 37 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
The design in which one group of research participants is administered a treatment and is then compared, on the dependent variable, with another group of research participants who did not receive the experimental treatment is known as:

One-group posttest-only design
One-group pretest-posttest design
Posttest-only design with non-equivalent groups

http://www.southalabama.edu/coe/bset/johnson/mcq/mc9.htm
MCQ # 26
Time series design

Question No: 38 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
Which of the following is referred to as the influence of a single independent variable?

Interaction effect
Reactive effect
Main effect

http://www.southalabama.edu/coe/bset/johnson/mcq/mc9.htm
MCQ # 27
Proactive effect

Question No: 39 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
Which of the following types of analysis can be done using secondary analysis?

AFAQ

The analysis of specific subgroups
Longitudinal analysis
Cross-cultural analysis
All of the given options

http://www.oup.com/uk/orc/bin/9780199284986/01student/cqs/ch13/
MCQ # 04

Question No: 40 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
Which of the following is/are advantage(s) of the self-completed questionnaire?

Inability to confirm who completed the questionnaire
Its unsuitability for some kinds of respondents
Inability to ask many questions that are not directly relevant to the respondent
Easy to justify the answer

http://www.oup.com/uk/orc/bin/9780199284986/01student/cqs/ch09/
MCQ # 02 U WILL SE THE REMANING IS DISADVANTAGE of the self-completed questionnaire

Question No: 41 (Marks: 5)
Defend the use of the term inductive to describe qualitative data analysis and interpretation.

Question No: 42 (Marks: 5)
Briefly discuss the Solomon s Four Group Design in experimental research with the help of example?

Question No: 43 (Marks: 10)
A multination company ABC has launched a new tooth paste Cleanex in Pakistan.

After eight months the company wants to analyze the consumer satisfaction about their tooth paste. For research purpose, develop questions for the following scenarios that can be used in questionnaire.
See the consumer preference for tooth paste or tooth powder by using nominal scale.
i. See the consumer preference for Cleanex Tooth Paste by using ordinal scale.
ii. See the important characteristics of the Cleanex Tooth Paste by using interval scale so that the company can modify its strengths and improve its weaknesses.
iii. Check the monthly consumption of the tooth paste by using the ratio scale.

Question No: 44 (Marks: 10)
What are different types of probability sampling? Explain any two with detail.

Question No: 45 (Marks: 10)
What are different advantages and disadvantages of using secondary data?

AFAQ

FINALTERM EXAMINATION
Fall 2009
AFAAQ_TARIQ@YAHOO.COM
STA630- Research Methods

Question No: 1 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

The part of the action research spiral that differentiates this research methodology from other kinds of research is;

- ► Looking at multiple sources of data.
- ► Taking action based on results.

http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_airasian_edresearch_7/5/1490/381555.cw/index.html
MCQ # 06

- ► Thinking about or analyzing data in more than one way.
- ► The kinds of data that are collected.

Question No: 2 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Individuals who engage in action research are most concerned with:

- ► Supporting the way things are being done.
- ► Publishing results
- ► Proving a hypothesis
- ► Improvement

http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_airasian_edresearch_7/5/1490/381508.cw/index.html
MCQ # 20

Question No: 3 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Research may differ along a series of dimensions. Which of the following may be applied to this statement?

- ► The level of manipulation used to elicit data collection.
- ► The data-collection technique.
- ► The type of data collected.
- ► Type, technique and manipulation of data collection

Question No: 4 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Which of the following statements best defines hypothesis?

- ► A quantitative study.
- ► A tentative prediction of the results of the research.

AFAAQ

http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_airasian_edresearch_8/38/9865/2525651.cw/content/index
MCQ # 24

- ► A qualitative research design.
- ► The operational definition of the study.

Question No: 5 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

What is the first step in the research process?

- ► Problem definition
- ► Define broad problem area

The research process consists of a number of steps. The first step in any research is selecting the topic, which could start from the broad area of interest
Page # 33

- ► Theoretical framework
- ► Preliminary data collection

Question No: 6 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

When there is a need of generating new ideas for hypotheses or to interpret the results of some research, which one is the best research deign?

- ► Experiment
- ► Surveys
- ► Focus group discussion

Focus group discussions: It is a discussion of an issue by 6-12 persons with a moderator for 1-2 hours. The issue can be a public concern, a product, a television program, a political candidate, or a policy. Focus groups are useful in exploratory research or to generate new ideas for hypotheses, and the interpenetration of results.
PAGE # 38

- ► Communication analysis

Question No: 7 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Which of the following is an example of deception in business research?

- ► The obtaining of company material without permission.
- ► The researcher wearing a disguise during an observation.
- ► The researcher representing their research as being about a different topic. http://www.oup.com/uk/orc/bin/9780199284986/01student/cqs/ch05/

MCQ # 09

- ► The researcher failing to ask permission to interview someone.

Question No: 8 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Which of the following is least likely to occur as an ethical problem with electronic research?

AIAQ

► Privacy could be invaded.
► People are not likely to be able to stop once they have begun participating.
► Debriefing could be avoided.
► Informed consent cannot be completely monitored.

Question No: 9 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

All of the following are unethical issues, EXCEPT;

► Invoicing irregularities
► Avoiding legal liability
► Misrepresenting results
► Seeking permission for entry

Unethical activities
• Violating nondisclosure agreements.
• Breaking respondent confidentiality.
• Misrepresenting results.
• Deceiving people.
• Invoicing irregularities.
• Avoiding legal liability.
Page # 41

Question No: 10 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Which of the following is the difference between measures and indicators?

► Measures are unambiguous quantities, whereas indicators are devised from common sense understandings.

http://www.oup.com/uk/orc/bin/9780199202959/01student/cqs/ch06/
MCQ # 03

► Indicators have a more direct relationship to the underlying concept than measures.
► Measures are intuitively devised and then applied as if they were direct indicators of a concept.
► Indicators are unambiguous quantities, whereas measures are subjective and value-laden.

Question No: 11 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

The extent to which a test provides scores that are meaningful, appropriate, or useful is referred to as;

► Reliability
► Accuracy
► Internal validity
► Validity

AIAAQ

http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_airasian_edresearch_8/38/9866/2525945.cw/content/index
MCQ # 18

Question No: 12 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Which of the following functions is performed by the Ordinal scale?

- ► Categorize
- ► Distance
- ► Order

Ordinal scales include the characteristics of the nominal scale plus an indicator of order.
PAGE # 53

- ► Unique origin

Question No: 13 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

What is the difference between interval/ratio and ordinal variables?

- ► Ordinal data can be rank ordered, but interval/ratio data cannot.
- ► The distance between categories is equal across the range of interval/ration data.

http://www.oup.com/uk/orc/bin/9780199202959/01student/cqs/ch14/
MCQ # 01

- ► Interval/ratio variables contain only two categories.
- ► Ordinal variables have a fixed zero point, whereas interval/ratio variables do not.

Question No: 14 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Which of the following statement refers to cross-sectional design?

- ► A comparison of two or more variables over a long period of time
- ► The collection of data from more than one case at one moment in time

http://www.oup.com/uk/orc/bin/9780199284986/01student/cqs/ch02/
MCQ # 05

- ► One that is devised when the researcher is in a bad mood
- ► A study of one particular section of society, e.g. the middle classes

Question No: 15 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Which of the following is TRUE for research plan?

- ► It should be detailed.
- ► It should be given to others for review and comments.
- ► It sets out the rationale for a research study.
- ► All of the given options

http://www.scribd.com/doc/22683412/Lecture-Notes-Research-Chaper-1-9

Question No: 16 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Which of the following typically does NOT apply to observers in survey research studies?

AIAO

► They observe predetermined activities.
► They are participant observers.

http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_airasian_edresearch_7/5/1490/381582.cw/index.html
MCQ # 09

► They obtain information by watching rather than asking
► They must be careful not to influence the activities they observe.

Question No: 17 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Which of the following is **not** an advantage of the self-completion questionnaire over the structured interview?

► It is cheaper to administer.
► It is quicker to administer.
► It is easier to prompt the interviewee.

http://www.oup.com/uk/orc/bin/9780199284986/01student/cqs/ch09/
MCQ # 01

► It is easier to remove interviewer effects.

Question No: 18 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Mr. X has coded his observations to hide the identity of each of the three participants in his study. He is ensuring;

► protection from harm
► confidentiality

http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_airasian_edresearch_7/5/1489/381347.cw/index.html
MCQ # 01

► informed consent
► anonymity

Question No: 19 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

The cover letter to a questionnaire study should contain all of the following, EXCEPT;

► A list of participants

http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_airasian_edresearch_7/5/1490/381582.cw/index.html
MCQ # 17

► A self-addressed, stamped envelope
► Purpose of the study
► Reasons to respond

Question No: 20 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Teachers are advised to predict the results of student attitudinal questionnaires, because;

AIAQ

► It will help them decide if students answered truthfully.
► It gives them a point of comparison against which to judge actual responses.

http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_airasian_edresearch_7/5/1490/381508.cw/index.html
MCQ # 10

► It will allow them to apply statistical procedures in analyzing results.
► It helps them familiarize themselves with the questionnaires.

Question No: 21 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

In conducting an action research study of "student's organizational skills during class in a particular school", which of the following would NOT likely to provide useful data?

► Interviews with teachers
► Classroom observations
► Parent surveys

http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_airasian_edresearch_7/5/1490/381508.cw/index.html
MCQ # 16

► Teacher's journal entries

Question No: 22 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Why it is helpful to keep a research diary or log book while you are conducting your project?

► To give you something to do in the early stages of your research when nothing is happening.
► Because funding councils generally demand to see written evidence that you were working every day during the period of the research.
► To keep a record of what you did and what happened throughout the research process.

http://www.oup.com/uk/orc/bin/9780199202959/01student/cqs/ch03/
MCQ # 08

► It can be added to your dissertation to ensure that you reach the required word limit.

Question No: 23 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Which of the following is likely to happen if clear instructions are not given as to how the respondent should answer the question?

► Respondents may delete inappropriate answers rather than select appropriate ones.
► Respondents may choose only one answer when they need to choose as many as apply.
► Respondents may complete questions that are not relevant to them.
► All of the given options

AIAO

http://www.oup.com/uk/orc/bin/9780199284986/01student/cqs/ch09/
MCQ # 07

Question No: 24 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Which of the following is NOT a suitable topic for research using a diary?

- ► The amount of time managers spend on particular activities.
- ► The frequency with which managers undertake particular tasks.
- ► The locations in which a trade union representative has discussions with individual members. **Correct**
- ► The volume of female managers in the retail industry.

http://www.oup.com/uk/orc/bin/9780199284986/01student/cqs/ch09/
MCQ # 09

Question No: 25 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Which of the following represents excellent advice for conducting an interview?

- ► Listen more and talk less
- ► Don't interrupt
- ► Don't be judgmental about the interviewee's beliefs or views
- ► All of the given options

Question No: 26 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Which of the following is an example of a dilemma that might face feminist business researchers conducting qualitative interviews with women?

- ► What role to adopt while interviewing male managers?
- ► How many female employees should be interviewed for a representative sample? **Correct**
- ► How to overcome the issue of false consciousness?

http://www.oup.com/uk/orc/bin/9780199284986/01student/cqs/ch18/
MCQ # 09

- ► What data to use while publishing findings?

Question No: 27 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Which of the following sampling strategies was used when the three students with the highest GPAs were selected?

- ► Extreme case

http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_airasian_edresearch_7/5/1489/381384.cw/index.html
MCQ # 02

- ► Snowball
- ► Maximum variation

AHAQ

► Normal case

Question No: 28 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Which type of sampling strategy is exemplified by selecting two types of individuals: those who are extremely happy and those who are extremely sad?

► Snowball
► Intensity

http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_airasian_edresearch_8/38/9866/2525932.cw/index.html
MCQ # 03

► Homogeneous
► Purposive

Question No: 29 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

The logic of purposive sampling is:

► To use participants because the researcher has access to them.
► That a random sample can generalize to a population.
► That a few information-rich participants studied in depth yield many insights about a topic.

http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_airasian_edresearch_7/5/1488/381150.cw/index.html
MCQ # 02
OR
PAGE # 90

► To include all participants, even though they are not all relevant to the problem.

Question No: 30 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Using a sample of 30 participants, a researcher finds a correlation of 0.30 between two variables. The relationship is not statistically significant. If the researcher were to triple her sample size, which of the following is most likely?

► The correlation would be statistically significant.

http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_airasian_edresearch_7/5/1490/381655.cw/index.html
MCQ # 09

► The correlation would be larger.
► The correlation would be smaller.
► Nothing is likely to change.

Question No: 31 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Which of the following steps begins the analysis of qualitative data?

► Reading and memoing
► Describing the content and participants **Correct**
► Classifying and interpreting

AFAIQ

► Data management

http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_airasian_edresearch_7/5/1490/381473.cw/index.html
MCQ # 06

Question No: 32 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Which of the following represents the most general conceptualization in qualitative data analysis?

► Word
► Topic **Correct**
► Category
► Pattern

http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_airasian_edresearch_7/5/1490/381483.cw/index.html
MCQ # 01

Question No: 33 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Which of the following BEST differentiates data analysis from interpretation?

► Interpretation requires more conceptual and integrative thinking than data analysis.

http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_airasian_edresearch_8/38/9871/2527149.cw/content/index
MCQ # 11

► Interpretation involves computerized analysis of data.
► Data analysis is explanatory and interpretation is conceptual. **Correct**
► Data analysis involves conceptualization but interpretation does not.

Question No: 34 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

The statistic used to determine the relationship between two variables is:

► Analysis of covariance
► Chi square
► Standard deviation **Correct**
► Pearson "*r*"

http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_airasian_edresearch_7/5/1491/381743.cw/index.htmlQuestionNo:35
MCQ # 17

Question No: 35 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Which of the following is NOT a control procedure used in causal-comparative research?

► Matching
► Subgroups
► Chi square

AIAO

http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_airasian_edresearch_7/5/1491/381743.cw/index.html
MCQ # 18

- ► Analysis of covariance

Question No: 36 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Which of the following best describes qualitative data coding?

- ► Adding all of the scores together and describing them statistically
- ► Identify data segments that contain general episodes
- ► Numerically representing the concepts identified by the participants **Correct**
- ► Dividing data in parts that represent single thoughts

http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_airasian_edresearch_7/5/1490/381473.cw/index.html
MCQ # 04

Question No: 37 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

The bivariate tables derived from trivariate table are called;

- ► Sub table
- ► Bivariates
- ► Partials

A trivariate table has a bivariate table of the independent and dependent variable for each category of the control variable. These new tables are called *partials.*
PAGE # 110

- ► Correlational tables **Correct**

Question No: 38 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Quasi-experimental research is used because:

- ► Random selection is not possible
- ► Neither random selection nor random assignment is possible
- ► Random assignment is not possible

http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_airasian_edresearch_7/5/1491/381820.cw/index.html
MVQ # 16

- ► There are no comparison groups available

Question No: 39 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

A researcher believes that the effects of a treatment will be different for males and females. Which one is the best method to test this possible interaction?

- ► Single-subject design
- ► Factorial design

http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_airasian_edresearch_7/5/1491/381820.cw/index.html

AIAQ

MCQ # 17
OR
http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Factorial_experiment

- ► Time-series design **Correct**
- ► Quasi-experimental design

Question No: 40 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

The influence of the researcher's background, personal experiences, preferences, or attitude on an interview or observation is technically defined as:

- ► Participant bias
- ► Observer bias

http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_airasian_edresearch_7/5/1489/381347.cw/index.html
MCQ # 18

- ► Observer effect **Correct**
- ► Nonparticipant effect

Question No: 41 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

On which component of his field notes did Mr. Majid focused when he expressed in his notes his thoughts and ideas about what he observed?

- ► Description **Correct**
- ► Reflection

http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_airasian_edresearch_7/5/1489/381392.cw/index.html
MCQ # 01

- ► Protocol
- ► Formal data

Question No: 42 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Which of the following is linked with an abstract model of underlying relations or causal mechanism?

- ► Historical comparative research

PAGE # 148
Synthesis links specific evidence with an abstract model of underlying relations or causal mechanism.

- ► Social research
- ► Action research
- ► Experimental research

Question No: 43 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

AFAQ

In which section is the researcher allowed greater flexibility to express opinions, discuss implications for educational practice, and suggest additional research?

- ► Review of the literature
- ► Significance of the study
- ► Results
- ► Discussion

http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_airasian_edresearch_7/5/1492/382157.cw/index.html
MCA # 07

Question No: 44 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Which of the following can be referred as Haphazard Sampling?

- ► Convenience Sampling

Convenience sampling (also called haphazard or accidental sampling)
PAGE # 90
OR
http://www.starmass.com/en/research_sampling_method.htm

- ► Purposive Sampling
- ► Snowball Sampling **Correct**
- ► Quota Sampling

Question No: 45 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

An important issue in index construction is to----------items.

- ► Reconstruct
- ► Codify
- ► Measure
- ► Weight

An important issue in index construction is whether to weight items.
PAGE # 103

Question No: 46 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Which of the following elements of Observation is/are included in Non Reactive research?

- ► External Appearance
- ► Count Behaviors
- ► Time Duration
- ► All of the given options

Observations of Non-Reactive Observations
• External Appearance

AFAAQ

• Count Behaviors
• Time Duration
PAGE # 124

Question No: 47 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Secondary /existing data may include which of the following?

- ► Official documents
- ► Personal documents
- ► Archived research data **Correct**
- ► All of the given options

http://www.southalabama.edu/coe/bset/johnson/mcq/mc6.htm
MCQ # 07

Question No: 48 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Which of the following major problem exist with non respondents in survey research?

- ► They tend to be alike in many ways.
- ► Data cannot be analyzed for only part of a sample.
- ► They cannot be found to determine if they are similar to respondents. **Correct**
- ► They may have different opinions than respondents.

http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_airasian_edresearch_7/5/1490/381580.cw/index.html
MCQ # 05

Question No: 49 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Which of the following advantage differentiates personal interview from mail, internet and telephonic survey?

- ► Cheaper
- ► Expensive
- ► Easier
- ► Inexpensive

Question No: 50 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Which one of the following methods offers the lowest degree of geographic flexibility?

- ► Mail survey

Mail questionnaires can reach a geographically dispersed sample simultaneously and at a relatively low cost because interviewers are not required.
PAGE # 70

- ► Telephone interview

ALAAO

- ► Door-to-door personal interview
- ► Internet survey

Question No: 51 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Which of the following survey research methods is the most expensive?

- ► Telephone interview
- ► Mail survey
- ► Door-to-door personal interview

As the cost of personal interviews continues to increase
PAGE # 69

- ► Mall intercept personal interview

Question No: 52 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

When a respondent tells the interviewer that he reads "Best Selling English News Paper" on a daily basis so that he can impress the interviewer, this is an example of:

- ► Administrative bias
- ► Interviewer bias

Interviewer Bias
Interviewer's personal likings and dis-likings, the environment, and cultural biases can affect the understanding of the responses, its recording, and its interpretation.
PAGE # 66

- ► Submission bias
- ► Response bias **Correct**

Question No: 53 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

All of the following are stages in the selection of a sample **EXCEPT**:

- ► Determine sample size
- ► Analyze data
- ► Conduct fieldwork
- ► Select a sampling frame

Question No: 54 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

A stratified sample in which the number of sampling units drawn from each stratum is in proportion to the population size of that stratum is called a:

- ► Balanced stratified sample **Correct**
- ► Proportional stratified sample

The number of sampling units drawn from each stratum is in proportion to the relative population size of the stratum, the sample is proportionate stratified sampling.
Page # 94

AFAQ

► Cluster sampling
► Convenience sample

Question No: 55 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Assigning males the value of zero and females the value of one in a database to record the gender of the respondents is an example of:

► Coding

Coding
Entering the answer to survey questions into a computer in abbreviated form. For example, M for male, F for female. Coding in qualitative research uses the same principle, on a larger scale.
http://www.audiencedialogue.net/gloss-data.html
Or
Page # 99
For example, a researchers codes males as 1 and females as 2. Each category of variable and missing information needs a code. A **codebook** is a document (i.e. one or more pages) describing the coding procedure and the location of data for variables in a format that computers can use.

► Editing
► Verification
► Test tabulation

Question No: 56 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Arranging data into a table is called:

► Analysis
► Frequency
► Interpretation
► Tabulation

The classification or placing of data into tabular form is called as tabulation
http://www.tutorvista.com/math/tabulation-of-data-tutoring

Question No: 57 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

A researcher interested in a data matrix that displays the frequency of some combination of possible responses to multiple variables should construct a:

► Contingency table

A contingency table is formed by cross-tabulating the two or more variables. It is contingent because the cases in each category of a variable get distributed into each category of a second variable. The table distributes cases into categories of multiple variables at the same time and shows how the cases, by the category of one variable, are "contingent upon" the categories of the other variables

AFAQ

Page # 105

- ► Regression equation
- ► Marginal table
- ► None of the given options

Question No: 58 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

When initial subjects are selected randomly and additional subjects are obtained from recommendations of names from the initial subjects, this sampling technique is called:

- ► Judgment sample
- ► Snowball

Snowball sampling is a special nonprobability method used when the desired sample characteristic is rare. It may be extremely difficult or cost prohibitive to locate respondents in these situations. Snowball sampling relies on referrals from initial subjects to generate additional subjects. While this technique can dramatically lower search costs, it comes at the expense of introducing bias because the technique itself reduces the likelihood that the sample will represent a good cross section from the population.
http://www.statpac.com/surveys/sampling.htm

- ► Convenience sample
- ► Cluster sample **Correct**

Question No: 59 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

When different interviewers are used in a pretest from those used in the posttest and this produces different results in the study, this is an example of a:

- ► History effect
- ► Mortality effect
- ► Instrumentation effect

Instrumentation Effects: Instrumentation effects are yet another source of threat to internal validity. These might arise because of a change in the measuring instrument between pretest and posttest, and not because of the instrument's differential impact at the end. For example, in a weightloss experiment, the springs on the scale weaken during the experiment, giving lower readings in the posttest.
A change in the wording of questions (may be done to avoid testing effects), change in interviewers, or change in other procedures to measure the dependent variable can cause instrumentation effect.
Performance of the subjects measured by the units of output in the pretest, but when measuring the out put in posttest the researcher measures it by "the number of units rejected, and the amount of resources expended to produce the units.
Page # 121

- ► Cohort effect

Question No: 60 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Which of the following is a threat to the internal validity of experiment using a repeated measures design?

► Instrumentation effect

Factors Affecting Internal Validity

1. History Effect:
2. Maturation Effect:
3. Testing Effects:
4. Instrumentation Effects: (Page # 121)
5. Selection Bias Effect:
6. Statistical Regression:
7. Mortality:
8. Mechanical Loss:
9. Experimenter Expectancy:

► Cohort effect
► Attrition effect
► All of the given options

Question No: 61 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Most threats to_____are taken care of by the experiment's design, while most threats to_____need to be taken care of by the designer of the experiment.

► Internal validity, external validity

http://www.coe.iup.edu/grbieger/Classes/LTCY698/Module 6/Validity.ppt#263,6

► External validity, internal validity
► Randomization, reliability
► Reliability, randomization

Question No: 62 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

In which of the following, the beginning and end are not clear. The interview can be picked up later?

► Survey Interview
► Field Interview

Field Interview
The beginning and end are not clear. The interview can be picked up later.

► Deception
► None of the given options

Question No: 63 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

The written set of guidelines that describes an outline of topics to be covered by a focus group moderator is called a:

AIAQ

- Discussion guide

The basic idea is to lay out a set of issues for the group to discuss. It is important to bear in mind that the moderator will mostly be improvising comments and questions within the framework set by the guidelines.
Page # 153

- Concept test
- Case study
- All of the given options

Question No: 64 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Which of the following is a disadvantage of focus groups?

- Requires objective, sensitive, and effective moderators
- May not be useful for discussing sensitive topics
- High cost
- All of the given options

Disadvantages of Focus Groups
Require objective, sensitive, and effective moderators.
May have unique sampling problems
May not be useful for discussing sensitive topics in face-to-face situations
Cost a considerable amount of money, particularly when they are not conducted by someone employed by the company desiring the focus group.
Higher cost

Question No: 65 (Marks: 3)

What do we write in executive summary of a research report?

Executive Summary of Research Report:

It is very important part of the report. And it is observed that mostly managers read summary report normally and rest members read whole report.

Executive summary write in four elements:
1. First objective of the report is mentioned and then most important part and specific reason of the project.

2. Main results are presented including purpose.
3. The conclusions of the report based on results.
4. The suggestions on the basis of conclusions that action will be taken
.

Question No: 66 (Marks: 5)

AHAQ

What is different Ethical dilemma of Field research?

Ans

Ethical Dilemmas of Field research

The dilemmas are made when the researchers are alone in fields and have very much little time to make decision. The ethical dilemmas raises when a field researcher get involve into lives of other people.
These dilemmas arise suddenly when some one interacting in the field with others.
Some of these dilemmas:

Confidentiality:

In field some learns a lot and some not very much, similarly some one has some confidential data and don't want to share with anyone which creates it.

Deception:

Deception may arise because of false role, name or identity, some agreed with some one and some one not some time. So because of these things this occurs.

The powerful:

Field researchers are normally those who are without power in society e.g., street people, the poor, and powerful people block their way and criticized them

Involvement with deviations:

Some researchers conduct research on deviants who engage in illegal behavior. This type of things create dilemma due to involvement in illeal activities.

Last field reports:

At the end of research, the knowledge, a researcher gains and his final report or thesis can make a dilemma between the right of privacy and the right to know. In last report if researcher hides some fact or not give the true picture of research then it creates a dilemma.

AFAQ

Question No: 67 (Marks: 10)

By using Likert scale, how would you score a positive and negative statement? Give one example to explain your answer.

Ans:

Likert scale is bused on 5 responses therefore lets take an example and constructed number of statements for each element with five responses.

- Strongly Agree
- Agree
- Undecided
- Disagree
- Strongly Disagree

These statements could be of both positive and negative.

For positive statements

We score from 5 to 1 i.e. strongly agree to strongly disagree

For negative statement

Score will be reversed i.e 1 to 5

1 for strongly agree
2 for agree
3 for undecided
4 for disagree
5 for strongly disagree

AFAAQ

Question No: 68 (Marks: 10)

How observations can be structured in non-reactive research?

Ans

In non reactive research, the people or the things that are being studied are not aware of that.

Non reactive research is structured as follow:

PHYSICAL TRACES:

• Erosion:

In erosion wear and tear has a greater use. For example, a researcher examines that children like those toys which are worn out and children have more interest in them.

ARCHIVES:

• Running Records:

In these records many researches can be done.
For example, a record of thieves in jail record of daily marriages. Etc.

• Other Records:

Irregular records can give a lot
. For example, look into the number of reams of paper purchased by a college principal's office for the last 10 years and compare it with students' enrollment.

OBSERVATIONS:

• Time Duration:

By this type of research, researcher can check the interest of people indifferent things. Like time spending in seeing the signboards on the road.

• External Appearance:

It shows the behavior of people in social factor that how they want to look.
How people appear may indicate social factors. For example, a
researcher can examine that in university how much percentage of student's wear casual dressing and how much formal.

FINALTERM EXAMINATION
Spring 2009
AFAAQ_TARIQ@YAHOO.COM
STA630- Research Methods (Session - 2)

SOLVED By Muhammad Afaaq

Marks: 80

Question No: 1 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
Which of the following is the basis of the Scientific Method?

To test hypothesis in conditions that is conducive to its success.
To formulate a research problem and disprove the hypothesis
To formulate a research problem, test the hypothesis in carefully controlled conditions that challenge the hypothesis.

http://www.uk.sagepub.com/breakwell/downloads/mcq/mcq_01/mcq_01.htm
Mcq # 01
To test hypothesis and if they are disproved, they should be abandoned completely.

Question No: 2 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
An inductive logic is one that:

Involves testing as explicitly defined hypothesis
Does not allow for findings to feed back into the body of knowledge
Uses quantitative methods whenever possible
Allows theory to emerge out of the data

http://www.oup.com/uk/ orc/bin/9780199202959/01student/cqs/ch01/
MCQ # 03
OR
The usual application of inductive theory, however, is to allow theory to emerge from our findings. We find an interesting question, we gather data on it and we 'theories' from our findings. It may be that these 'theories' are, in reality, simply 'interesting insights' rather than 'grand theories' but they can be valuable for all that.

Question No: 3 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
Which of the following is not a concept?

Leadership
Total Quality Management
Human Resource Management
Intelligence Quotient (IQ).

http://www.oup.com/uk/orc/bin/9780199284986/01student/cqs/ch06/
MCQ # 01
OR
Concepts are the building blocks of theory, each of which represents a label given to a common element of the social world. IQ is a measure of the concept of intelligence; it is not a concept in itself.

AFAAQ

Question No: 4 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
Which of the following is the definition of an independent variable?

A variable that is manipulated or controlled by the experimenter

An independent variable is a factor that can be varied or manipulated in an experiment
http://www.everythingbio.com/glos/definition.php?word=independent+variable
A response variable
The behavioral measure made by the experimenter
A dependent variable that is controlled by the experimenter

Question No: 5 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
The cause variable or the one that identifies forces or conditions that act on something else is known as:

Moderating variable
Independent variable

The cause variable, or the one that identifies forces or conditions that act on something else, is the independent variable.
PAGE # 19
Categorical variable
Dependent variable

Question No: 6 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
A measure is reliable if it provides consistent_____.

Hypothesis
Results

A measure is reliable if it provides consistent Results
http://wiki.answers.com/Q/A_measure_is_reliable_if_it_provides_consistent
Procedure
Sensitivity

Question No: 7 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
Which of the following statements relates to concurrent validity?

The measure apparently reflects the content of the concept in question.
A criterion is employed on which cases are known to differ.

http://www.oup.com/uk/orc/bin/9780199284986/01student/cqs/ch06/
MCQ # 04
A future criterion is employed on which cases are known to differ.
A measure is gauged by comparing it to measures of the same concept developed through other methods.

AFAQ

Question No: 8 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
Research may differ along a series of dimensions. Which of the following may be applied to this statement?

The type of data collected.
The data-collection technique
The level of manipulation used to elicit data collection.
All of the given options

http://www.uk.sagepub.com/breakwell/downloads/mcq/mcq_01/mcq_01.htm
MCQ # 06

Question No: 9 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
Cross cultural studies are an example of:

Comparative design

Historical-comparative research is a collection of techniques and approaches. It is a distinct type of research that puts historical time and /or cross-cultural variation at the center of research – that is, which treats what is studied as part of the flow of history and situated in cultural context.
PAGE # 142
OR
http://www.oup.com/uk/orc/bin/9780199202959/01student/cqs/ch02/
Longitudinal design
Experimental design
Case study design

Question No: 10 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
When constructing a questionnaire, there are few principles to which you should adhere. Which of the following is NOT one of those principles?

Avoid using "leading" or "loaded" questions
Avoid double-barreled questions
Avoid ambiguity and confusion
Avoid arranging questions in a sequence

PAGE # 77, 78
Guidelines for Questionnaire Design
1. Questionnaire Relevancy
2. Questionnaire Accuracy
3. Avoid Ambiguity, Confusion, and Vagueness.
4. Avoid Double-Barreled Questions
5. Avoid Leading Questions
6. Avoid Loaded Questions

AFAQ

7. Avoid Burdensome Questions that may Tax the Respondent's Memory
8. Arrange Questions in a Proper Sequence
9. Use Filter Question, if Needed
10. Layout of the questionnaire

Question No: 11 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
Which of the following statements is true about closed ended questions and open ended questions?

A closed ended question means that the chances of unreliable post-coding is small, whereas an open ended question means that there is a possibility of data processing error.
A closed ended question allows for the researchers terminology to be used, whereas an open ended question allows the respondant to use terms they are familiar with.
A closed ended question allows for easy processing, whereas coding an open-ended question can be very time consuming.
A closed ended question has many advantages over open ended question.

http://www.oup.com/uk/orc/bin/9780199284986/01student/cqs/ch10/
MCQ # 02
JUST 4 CONCEPT NOT EXACT MATCH

Question No: 12 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
Which of the following is NOT an example of a problem with using social survey research to investigate behaviour?
Respondents tend to answer by giving the most socially desirable answer.
Respondents may inadvertently omit key terms in the question.
Respondents may not give an honest reply to what they see as a threatening question.
Respondents may be unwilling to reveal information as they believe they are likely to be identified.

http://www.oup.com/uk/orc/bin/9780199284986/01student/cqs/ch11/
MCQ # 01

Question No: 13 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
Which of the following represents excellent advice for conducting an interview?

Listen more and talk less
Don't interrupt
Don't be judgmental about the interviewee's beliefs or views
All of the given options

[PPT]
Qualitative Research Methods

AIAQ

Question No: 14 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
Smaller sample sizes can be used in correlation research when;

The researcher expects no relationship between the variables.
There are only two variables to correlate.
The instruments used to measure the variables have low validity and reliability.
The instruments used to measure the variables have high validity and reliability.

http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_airasian_edresearch_7/5/1491/381698.cw/index.html
MCQ # 02

Question No: 15 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
Which of the following steps begins the analysis of qualitative data?

Reading and memoing
Describing the content and participants
Classifying and interpreting
Data management

http://wps.prenhall.com/chet airasian_edresearch_7/5/1490/381473.cw/index.html
MCQ # 06

Question No: 16 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one

Which of the following could NOT be a cause of variation in high school achievement?

Reading ability
Parental involvement
Teacher expectations
College attendance

http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_airasian_edresearch_7/5/1491/381743.cw/index.htmlQuestionNo:11
MCQ # 11

Question No: 17 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
The statistic used to determine the relationship between two variables is:

Analysis of covariance
Chi square
Standard deviation
Pearson "r"

AFAAQ

http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_airasian_edresearch_7/5/1491/381743.cw/index.htmlQuestionNo:22
MCQ # 17
OR
The correlation between two variables reflects the degree to which the variables are related. The most common measure of correlation is the Pearson Product Moment Correlation (called Pearson's correlation for short).

Question No: 18 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
A researcher studies three groups of students who vary in level of self-confidence. She finds that students with higher self-confidence are more popular among their peers. The most plausible conclusion is that:

We do not know what causes self-confidence or popularity.
Self-confidence causes popularity.
Popularity causes self-confidence.
Self-confidence and popularity are related.

http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_airasian_edresearch_7/5/1491/381743.cw/index.html
MCQ # 07

Question No: 19 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
Which of the following is true about validity?
A study can be internally valid but not externally valid.
A study can be externally valid but not internally valid.
A study must be both internally and externally valid.

http://www.docstoc.com/docs/14330216/Bias-in-Clinical-Research
SLIDE # 03
The internal and external validity of studies are not related in any way.

Question No: 20 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
Testing most likely, negatively affect internal validity when:

The information tested is attitudinal in nature
The time between pre- and posttest is short

http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_airasian_edresearch_7/5/1491/381818.cw/index.html
MCQ # 10
The instrument is unreliable
The participants are very low scorers

Question No: 21 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
Ecological validity refers to:

The participants to whom results generalize

ALAAQ

The instruments used to measure the independent and dependent variables
The internal validity of a study
The context to which results generalize

http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_airasian_edresearch_8/38/9869/2526465.cw/index.html
MCQ # 01

Question No: 22 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
Which one is not the part of non reactive research?

Physical traces
Archives
Observations
Interviews

Varieties of Non-Reactive Observations
Physical Traces:
Archives:
Observations:
PAGE 124

Question No: 23 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
Which advice would you offer a novice researcher conducting his first observation?

Observe only one behavior at a time

http://wps.prenhall.com/chet_airasian_edresearch_8/38/9871/2526978.cw/index.html
MCQ # 08

Allow variables to emerge from the context
Record behaviors only after leaving the site
Develop a preconceived notion of what is going to help structure the observation

Question No: 24 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
How the Procedure for data processing and analysis can be evaluated in Pilot Testing?

Make dummy tables

Procedure for data processing and analysis can be evaluated:
Make dummy tables. See how can we tabulate the data and use the appropriate statistics for purposes of interpretations
Page # 81

Work output of each member
Length of Questionnaire
Format Tools

AFAQ

Question No: 25 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
Which of the following is the complete group of specific population elements relevant to the research project?

Element
Target Population

Target population is the complete group of specific population elements relevant to the research project.
Page # 88
OR
http://www.ehes.info/manuals/EHES_manual/PartA/EHES_Manual_PartA_Chapter2.pdf

Sampling Frame
Sampling Unit

Question No: 26 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
Which of the following is the summary description of a given variable in a population?

Statistic
Observation Unit
Parameter

A parameter is the summary description of a given variable in a population.
Page # 89

Sampling Unit

Question No: 27 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
Which of the following is that element or set of elements considered for selection in some stage of sampling?
Parameter
Sampling Unit

A sampling unit is that element or set of elements considered for selection in some stage of sampling. Sampling may be done in single stage or in multiple stages.
Page # 89

Observation Unit
Statistic

Question No: 28 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
If you are going on the street and suddenly a TV reporter starts taking your interview regarding any issue, which of the following sampling technique is used by the TV reporter?

AFAQ

Purposive Sampling
Snowball Sampling
Convenience Sampling

Convenience Sampling
Convenience sampling (also called *haphazard or accidental sampling*)refers to sampling by obtaining units or people who are most conveniently available. For example, it may be convenient and economical to sample employees in companies in a nearby area, sample from a pool of friends and neighbors. The person-on-the street interview conducted by TV programs is another example. TV interviewers go on the street with camera and microphone to talk to few people who are convenient to interview. The people walking past a
TV studio in thee middle of the day do not represent everyone homemakers, people in the rural areas). Likewise, TV interviewers select people who look "normal" to them and avoid people who are unattractive, poor, very old, or inarticulate.
PAGE # 90

Quota Sampling

Question No: 29 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
Which of the following sampling is most often used during the exploratory phase of are search project and is perhaps the best way of getting some basic information quickly and efficiently?

Convenience Sampling

Convenience sampling is most often used during the exploratory phase of a research project and is perhaps the best way of getting some basic information quickly and efficiently. Often such sample is taken to test ideas or even to gain ideas about a subject of interest.
Page #90

Quota Sampling
Snowball Sampling
Purposive Sampling

Question No: 30 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
Which of the following sampling method is the best way to select a group of people for a study if you are interested in making statements about the larger population?

Convenience sampling
Quota sampling
Purposive sampling
Random sampling

AIAC

http://www.southalabama.edu/coe/bset/johnson/mcq/mc7.htm
MCQ# 27

Question No: 31 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
In which of the following conditions, each part of the construct should be measured with at least one indicator?

Unidimensionality
Scale
Weighing
Index Construction

Each part of the construct should be measured with at least one indicator. Of course, it is better to measure the parts of a construct with multiple indicators.
Page # 102

Question No: 32 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
Which of the following number of variables involved in Descriptive Statistics?

Bivariate
Multivariate
Univariate
All of the given options

Descriptive statistics describe numerical data. They can be categorized by the number of variables involved: univariate, bivariate, or multivariate
Page # 105

Question No: 33 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
All of the following are types of personal communication, except;

Letters
Memos
Telephone conversations
Emails

Personal communication through letters, memos, telephone conversations,
Page # 167

Question No: 34 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
Which of the following terms refers to a statistical method that can be used to statistically equate groups on a pretest or some other variable?

Experimental control

AIAQ

Differential influence
Matching
Analysis of covariance

http://www.southalabama.edu/coe/bset/johnson/mcq/mc9.htm
MCQ # 07

Question No: 35 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
In an experimental research study, the primary goal is to isolate and identify the effect produced by which of the following?

Dependent variable
Extraneous variable
Independent variable

http://www.southalabama.edu/coe/bset/johnson/mcq/mc9.htm
MCQ # 23
Confounding variable

Question No: 36 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
Which of the following is referred to as the influence of a single independent variable?

Interaction effect
Reactive effect
Main effect

http://www.southalabama.edu/coe/bset/johnson/mcq/mc9.htm
MCQ # 27
Proactive effect

Question No: 37 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
Which of the following is the process of marking segments of data with symbols, descriptive words or category?

Concurring
Coding

http://www.southalabama.edu/coe/bset/johnson/mcq/mc17.htm
MCQ # 07

Coloring
Segmenting

Question No: 38 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
A census taker often collects data through which of the following?

AFAQ

Standardized tests
Interviews

http://www.southalabama.edu/coe/bset/johnson/mcq/mc6.htm
MCQ # 20

Secondary data
Observations

Question No: 39 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
Which one is NOT an advantage of personal interviewing?
Interviewer influence

Disadvantages of Personal Interviewing:
5. Interviewer Influence
PAGE # 66

Probing complex questions
Visual aids
High completion rate

Question No: 40 (Marks: 1) - Please choose one
All of the following are the characteristics of scientific methods of research, EXCEPT;

Cumulative
Deterministic
Unethical

Important Characteristics of Scientific Method

3. Cumulative
4. Deterministic
7. Rationalism
PAGE # 3, 4, 5

Rationalism

Question No: 41 (Marks: 5)
What are different Ethical Dilemmas of Field research?

Question No: 42 (Marks: 5)
What different measures of central tendency are used? Define each.

Question No: 43 (Marks: 10)
What are different steps in field research?

AFAQ

Question No: 44 (Marks: 10)
How historical comparative research is similar to field research?

Question No: 45 (Marks: 10)
Mr. Ali is a researcher in a well reputed research organization and he is using Stratified Random sampling in his research. You are required to identify the reasons why researchers use the Stratified Random Sampling?

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If u like me than raise your hand with me
If not then raise ur standard
That's about me … !

AFAAQ

STA630 (RESEARCH METHODS)

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Lesson 1

INTRODUCTION, DEFINITION & VALUE OF RESEARCH

Whether we are aware of it or not, we are surrounded by research. Educators, administrators, government officials, business leaders, human service providers, health care professionals, regularly use social research findings in their jobs. Social research can be used to raise children, reduce crime, improve public health, sell products, improve workers‟ efficiency, or just understand one‟s life.

Assume for the moment that you are the Manager of a restaurant. You are experiencing a significant turn over in your waiter/waitress pool, and long-time customers have been commenting that the friendly atmosphere that has historically drawn them to your door is changing. What will you do? Where will you try to solve this problem? The problem of high turnover and decline in the friendly atmosphere at the restaurant has to be researched.

The study of research methods provides you with the knowledge and skills you need to solve the problem and meet the challenges of a fast-paced decision-making environment. A systematic inquiry whose objective is to provide information to the problems (be they managerial as in our example) is one way to explain research.

What is Research?

General image of the research is that it has something to do with the laboratory where scientists are supposedly doing some experiments. Somebody who is interviewing consumers to find out their opinion about the new packaging of milk is also doing research.

Research is simply the process of finding solutions to a problem after through study and analysis of the situational factors. It is gathering information needed to answer a question, and thereby help in solving a problem.

We do not study in any haphazard manner. Instead, we try to follow a system or a procedure in an organized manner. It is all the more necessary in case we want to repeat the study, or somebody else wants to verify our findings. In the latter case the other person has to follow the same procedure that we followed. Hence not only we have to do the study in a systematic manner but also that system should be known to others.

What is the value of Research?

The nature of research problems could vary. Problems may refer to some undesirable situation or these may refer to simply a curiosity of the researcher that may be agitating his or her mind.

For example, in a recent BA/BS examination of the Punjab University 67 percent of the students failed. That is a colossal wastage of the resources; hence an undesirable situation that needs research is to find a solution. The researcher may come up with a variety of reasons that may relate with the students, the teachers, the curricula, the availability of books, the examination system, the family environment of the student, and many more.

So, a study may be carried out to diagnose the situation, and the recommendations to be applied to overcome the undesirable situation of mass failure of students.

In the same examination result one finds that girls have captured a good number of top positions; and that is happening for the last couple of years. One gets curious and tries to do research for finding out the reasons. This is an academic problem but certainly a research problem. Conducting such **research offers the pleasure of solving a puzzle**. Why the girls are catching most of the top positions in different examination? This might be a puzzle that the research may like to explain. Such findings make a good contribution to the body of knowledge i.e. making some good discoveries as part of the basic research. Finding answer to any enigma is self satisfying.

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The researchers try to make use of their findings for **generating theories and models** that could be used for understanding human behavior and the functioning of different structures both at the micro (organizational) and macro (societal) level.

Therefore, research may be considered as an ***organized, systematic, data based, critical, objective, scientific inquiry or investigation into a specific problem, undertaken with the purpose of finding answers or solutions to it.*** In this way research provides the needed information that guides the planners to make informed decisions to successfully deal with the problems. The information provided could be the result of a careful analysis of data gathered first hand or of the data that are already available with an organization. .

The value of research for policy makers, planners, business managers, and other stakeholders is that it reduces uncertainty by providing information that improves the decision-making process. The decision making process associated with the development and implementation of a strategy involves four interrelated stages:

1. Identifying problems or opportunities;
2. Diagnosing and assessing problems or opportunities;
3. Selecting and implementing a course of action; and
4. Evaluating the course of action.

Identifying problems and solutions to the same problems is in fact applying the research findings to overcome an undesirable situation. Initially a problem may appear to be simply a „tip of the iceberg" but the study by a professional might help locating the magnitude of the issue as well as its solutions. Such research is usually referred to as applied research, which shall be discussed in detail in the coming lectures.

Research helps in developing methodologies

By now we know that the researchers have to develop methodologies for carrying out the research. These methodologies are for the collection of data, data processing and data analysis. For the new researchers these methodologies are already available, most of the researchers just use these. Nevertheless, there is always a scope for improvement and certainly new methodologies are developed. Also we try to borrow methodologies from sister subjects.

Managers and administrators with knowledge of research have an advantage over those who are without. Though a manager/administrator him/herself may not be doing any major research yet he/she will have to understand, predict, and control events that are dysfunctional to the organization.

For example, a new product developed may not be "taking off," or a financial investment may not be "paying off" as anticipated. Such disturbing phenomena have to be understood and explained. Unless this is done, it will not be possible to predict the future of that product or the prospects of that investment, and how future catastrophic outcomes can be controlled. A grasp of research methods will enable managers/administrators to understand, predict, and control their environment.

Managers may not be doing the research themselves, in fact they could hire the services of professionals, and still they should be well conversant with research methodologies. The manager who is knowledgeable about research can interact effectively with outside researchers or consultants. Knowledge about research processes, design, and interpretation of data also helps managers to become discriminating recipients of the research findings presented, and to determine whether or not the recommended solution are appropriate for implementation.

We are surrounded by research

For the understanding of the professional works, incorporation of the new findings in the practical situations, and for the implementation of the recommendations in policy/planning, the managers have

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to be well conversant with researchers. Many of you may be preparing yourselves for such managerial positions, I am sure training in research methodology will certainly be helpful in your career.

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Lesson 2

SCIENTIFIC METHOD OF RESEARCH & ITS SPECIAL FEATURES

Research produces knowledge which could be used for the solution of problems as well as for the generation of universal theories, principles and laws. But all knowledge is not science. The critical factor that separates scientific knowledge from other ways of acquiring knowledge is that it uses scientific approach. What is this approach? Or what is science?

When most people hear the word *science*, the first image that comes to mind is one of test tubes, computers, rocket ships, and people in white lab coats. These outward trappings are part of science. Some sciences, such as the natural sciences deal with the physical and material world. Some other sciences involve the study of people – their beliefs, behavior, interactions, attitudes, institutions, and so forth. They are sometimes called *soft sciences*. This is not that their work is sloppy or lack rigor but because their subject matter, human social life, is fluid, formidable to observe, and hard to measure precisely with laboratory instruments. The subject matter of a science (e.g. human attitudes, protoplasm, or galaxies) determines the techniques and instruments (e.g. surveys, microscopes, or telescopes) used by it.

Science is a way to produce knowledge, which is based on truth and attempts to be universal. In other words science is a method, a procedure to produce knowledge i.e. discovering universalities/principles, laws, and theories through the process of observation and re-observation. Observation here implies that scientists use "sensory experiences" for the study of the phenomena. They use their five senses, which are possessed by every normal human being. They not only do the observation of a phenomenon but also repeat the observation, may be several times. The researchers do so because they want to be accurate and definite about their findings

Re-observation may be made by the same researcher at a different time and place or done by other professionals at some other time or place. All such observations are made in this universe where a normal professional human being can go, make the observation and come back. Therefore we are focusing on this universe not on the one hereafter. By repeating the observation, the researchers want to be definite and positive about their findings. Those who want to be definite and positive are often referred to as **positivists**. The researchers do not leave their findings into scattered bits and pieces. Rather the results are organized, systematized, and made part of the existing body of knowledge; and this is how the knowledge grows. All this procedure for the creation of knowledge is called a scientific method, whereby the consequent knowledge may be referred to as scientific knowledge. In this way *science* refers to both a system for producing knowledge and the knowledge produced from that system. Since the subject matters of the researchers differ, therefore, we have the diversification of different sciences: broadly natural or physical sciences and human sciences.

Important Characteristics of Scientific Method

1. Empirical

Scientific method is concerned with the realities that are observable through "sensory experiences." It generates knowledge which is verifiable by experience or observation. Some of the realities could be directly observed, like the number of students present in the class and how many of them are male and how many female. The same students have attitudes, values, motivations, aspirations, and commitments. These are also realities which cannot be observed directly, but the researchers have designed ways to observe these indirectly. Any reality that cannot be put to "sensory experience" directly or indirectly (existence of heaven, the Day of Judgment, life hereafter, God‟s rewards for good deeds) does not fall within the domain of scientific method.

2. Verifiable

Observations made through scientific method are to be verified again by using the senses to confirm or refute the previous findings. Such confirmations may have to be made by the same researcher or

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others. We will place more faith and credence in those findings and conclusions if similar findings emerge on the basis of data collected by other researchers using the same methods. To the extent that it does happen (i.e. the results are replicated or repeated) we will gain confidence in the scientific nature of our research. Replicability, in this way, is an important characteristic of scientific method. Hence revelations and intuitions are out of the domain of scientific method.

3. Cumulative

Prior to the start of any study the researchers try to scan through the literature and see that their study is not a repetition in ignorance. Instead of reinventing the wheel the researchers take stock of the existing body of knowledge and try to build on it. Also the researchers do not leave their research findings into scattered bits and pieces. Facts and figures are to be provided with language and thereby inferences drawn. The results are to be organized and systematized. Nevertheless, we don‟t want to leave our studies as stand alone. A linkage between the present and the previous body of knowledge has to be established, and that is how the knowledge accumulates. Every new crop of babies does not have to start from a scratch; the existing body of knowledge provides a huge foundation on which the researchers build on and hence the knowledge keeps on growing.

4. Deterministic

Science is based on the assumption that all events have antecedent causes that are subject to identification and logical understanding. For the scientist, nothing "just happens" – it happens for a reason. The scientific researchers try to explain the emerging phenomenon by identifying its causes. Of the identified causes which ones can be the most important? For example, in the 2006 BA/BS examination of the Punjab University 67 percent of the students failed. What could be the determinants of such a mass failure of students? The researcher may try to explain this phenomenon and come up with variety of reasons which may pertain to students, teachers, administration, curriculum, books, examination system, and so on. Looking into such a large number of reasons may be highly cumbersome model for problem solution. It might be appropriate to tell, of all these factors which one is the most important, the second most important, the third most important, which two in combination are the most important. The researcher tries to narrow down the number of reasons in such a way that some action could be taken. Therefore, the achievement of a meaningful, rather than an elaborate and cumbersome, model for problem solution becomes a critical issue in research. That is parsimony which implies the explanation with the minimum number of variables that are responsible for an undesirable situation.

5. Ethical and Ideological Neutrality

The conclusions drawn through interpretation of the results of data analysis should be objective; that is, they should be based on the facts of the findings derived from actual data, and not on our own subjective or emotional values. For instance, if we had a hypothesis that stated that greater participation in decision making will increase organizational commitment, and this was not supported by the results, it makes no sense if the researcher continues to argue that increased opportunities for employee participation would still help. Such an argument would be based, not on the factual, data based research findings, but on the subjective opinion of the researcher. If this was the conviction of the researcher all along, then there was no need to do the research in the first place.

Researchers are human beings, having individual ideologies, religious affiliations, cultural differences which can influence the research findings. Any interference of their personal likings and dis-likings in their research can contaminate the purity of the data, which ultimately can affect the predictions made by the researcher. Therefore, one of the important characteristics of scientific method is to follow the principle of objectivity, uphold neutrality, and present the results in an unbiased manner.

6. Statistical Generalization

Generalisability refers to the scope of the research findings in one organizational setting to other settings. Obviously, the wider the range of applicability of the solutions generated by research, the

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more useful the research is to users. For instance, if a researcher‟s findings that participation in decision making enhances organizational commitment are found to be true in a variety of manufacturing, industrial, and service organizations, and not merely in the particular organization studied by the researcher, the generalisability of the findings to other organizational settings is enhanced. The more generalizable is the research, the greater its usefulness and value.

For wider generalisability, the research sampling design has to be logically developed and a number of other details in the data collection methods need to be meticulously followed. Here the use of statistics is very helpful. Statistics is device for comparing what is observed and what is logically expected. The use of statistics becomes helpful in making generalizations, which is one of the goals of scientific method.

7. Rationalism

Science is fundamentally a rational activity, and the scientific explanation must make sense. Religion may rest on revelations, custom, or traditions, gambling on faith, but science must rest on logical reason.

There are two distinct logical systems important to the scientific quest, referred to as deductive logic and inductive logic. Beveridge describes them as follows:

> *Logicians distinguish between inductive reasoning (from particular instances to general principles, from facts to theories) and deductive reasoning (from the general to the particular, applying a theory to a particular case). In induction one starts from observed data and develops a generalization which explains the relationships between the objects observed. On the other hand, in deductive reasoning one starts from some general law and applies it to a particular instance.*

The classical illustration of deductive logic is the familiar syllogism: “All men are mortal; Mahmood is man; therefore Mahmood is mortal.” A researcher might then follow up this deductive exercise with an empirical test of Mahmood‟s mortality.

Using inductive logic, the researcher might begin by noting that Mahmood is mortal and observing a number of other mortals as well. He might then note that all the observed mortals were men, thereby arriving at the tentative conclusion that all men are mortal.

In practice, scientific research involves both inductive and deductive reasoning as the scientist shifts endlessly back and forth between theory and empirical observations.

There could be some other aspects of scientific method (e.g. self-correcting) but what is important is that **all features are interrelated.** Scientists may not adhere to all these characteristics. For example, objectivity is often violated especially in the study of human behavior, particularly when human beings are studied by the human beings. Personal biases of the researchers do contaminate the findings.

Looking at the important features of scientific method one might say that there are **two power bases of scientific knowledge:** (1) empiricism i.e. sensory experiences or observation, and (2) rationalism i.e. the logical explanations for regularity and then consequential argumentation for making generalizations (theory).

Finally it may be said that anybody who is following the scientific procedure of doing research is doing a scientific research; and the knowledge generated by such research is scientific knowledge. Depending upon the subject matter, we try to divide the sciences into physical or natural sciences and the social sciences. Due to the nature of the subject matter of the social sciences, it is rather very difficult to apply the scientific method of research rigorously and that is why the predictions made by the social researchers are not as dependable as the predictions made by the natural scientists.

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Lesson 3

CLASSIFICATION OF RESEARCH

Research comes in many shapes and sizes. Before a researcher begins to conduct a study, he or she must decide on a specific type of research. Good researchers understand the advantages and disadvantages of each type, although most end up specializing in one.

For classification of research we shall look from four dimensions:

1. The purpose of doing research;
2. The intended uses of research;
3. How it treats time i.e. the time dimension in research; and
4. The research (data collection) techniques used in it.

The four dimensions reinforce each other; that is, a purpose tends to go with certain techniques and particular uses. Few studies are pure types, but the dimensions simplify the complexity of conducting research.

1. Purpose of Doing Research

If we ask someone why he or she is conducting a study, we might get a range of responses: "*My boss told me to do*"; "*It was a class assignment*"; "*I was curious*." There are so many reasons to do research as there are researches. Yet the purposes of research may be organized into three groups based on what the researcher is trying to accomplish – explore a new topic, describe a social phenomenon, or explain why something occurs. Studies may have multiple purposes (e.g. both to explore and to describe) but one purpose is usually dominates.

a. Exploratory/Formulative Research

You may be **exploring a new topic** or issue in order to learn about it. If the issue was new or the researcher has written little on it, you began at the beginning. This is called *exploratory research.* The researcher‟s goal is to formulate more precise questions that future research can answer. Exploratory research may be the first stage in a sequence of studies. A researcher may need to know enough to design and execute a second, more systematic and extensive study.

Initial research conducted to clarify the nature of the problem. When a researcher has a limited amount of experience with or knowledge about a research issue, **exploratory research** is useful preliminary step that helps ensure that a more rigorous, more conclusive future study will not begin with an inadequate understanding of the nature of the management problem. The findings discovered through exploratory research would the researchers to emphasize learning more about the particulars of the findings in subsequent conclusive studies.

Exploratory research rarely yields definitive answers. It addresses the "what" question: "what is this social activity really about?" It is difficult to conduct because there are few guidelines to follow. Specifically there could be a number of goals of exploratory research.

Goals of Exploratory Research:

1. Become familiar with the basic facts, setting, and concerns;
2. Develop well grounded picture of the situation;
3. Develop tentative theories, generate new ideas, conjectures, or hypotheses;
4. Determine the feasibility of conducting the study;
5. Formulate questions and refine issues for more systematic inquiry; and
6. Develop techniques and a sense of direction for future research.

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For exploratory research, the researcher may use different sources for getting information like:

1. Experience surveys,
2. Secondary data analysis,
3. Case studies
4. Pilot studies.

As part of the experience survey the researcher tries to contact individuals who are knowledgeable about a particular research problem. This constitutes an informal experience survey.

Another economical and quick source of background information is secondary data analysis. It is preliminary review of data collected for another purpose to clarify issues in the early stages of a research effort.

The purpose of case study is to obtain information from one or a few situations that are similar to the researcher‟s problem situation. A researcher interested in doing a nationwide survey among union workers, may first look at a few local unions to identify the nature of any problems or topics that should be investigated.

A pilot study implies that some aspect of the research is done on a small scale. For this purpose focus group discussions could be carried out.

b. Descriptive Research:

Descriptive research presents a picture of the specific details of a situation, social setting, or relationship. The major purpose of descriptive research, as the term implies, is to describe characteristics of a population or phenomenon. Descriptive research seeks to determine the answers to *who, what, when, where*, and *how* questions. Labor Force Surveys, Population Census, and Educational Census are examples of such research.

Descriptive study offers to the researcher a profile or description of relevant aspects of the phenomena of interest. Look at the class in research methods and try to give its profile – the characteristics of the students. When we start to look at the relationship of the variables, then it may help in diagnosis analysis.

Goals of Descriptive Research:

1. Describe the situation in terms of its characteristics i.e. provide an accurate profile of a group;
2. Give a verbal or numerical picture (%) of the situation;
3. Present background information;
4. Create a set of categories or classify the information;
5. Clarify sequence, set of stages; and
6. Focus on „who,‟ „what,‟ „when,‟ „where,‟ and „how‟ but not why?

A great deal of social research is descriptive. Descriptive researchers use most data –gathering techniques – surveys, field research, and content analysis.

c. Explanatory Research:

When we encounter an issue that is already known and have a description of it, we might begin to wonder *why* things are the way they are. The desire to know “why,” to explain, is the purpose of *explanatory research*. It builds on exploratory and descriptive research and goes on to identify the reasons for something that occurs. Explanatory research looks for causes and reasons. **For example**, a descriptive research may discover that 10 percent of the parents abuse their children, whereas the explanatory researcher is more interested in learning *why* parents abuse their children.

Goals of Explanatory Research:

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1. Explain things not just reporting. Why? Elaborate and enrich a theory‟s explanation.
2. Determine which of several explanations is best.
3. Determine the accuracy of the theory; test a theory‟s predictions or principle.
4. Advance knowledge about underlying process.
5. Build and elaborate a theory; elaborate and enrich a theory‟s predictions or principle.
6. Extend a theory or principle to new areas, new issues, new topics:
7. Provide evidence to support or refute an explanation or prediction.
8. Test a theory‟s predictions or principles

2. The Uses of Research

Some researchers focus on using research to advance general knowledge, whereas others use it to solve specific problems. Those who seek an understanding of the fundamental nature of social reality are engaged in basic research (also called academic research or pure research or fundamental research). Applied researchers, by contrast, primarily want to apply and tailor knowledge to address a specific practical issue. They want to answer a policy question or solve a pressing social and economic problem.

a. Basic Research

Basic research advances fundamental knowledge about the human world. It focuses on refuting or supporting theories that explain how this world operates, what makes things happen, why social relations are a certain way, and why society changes. Basic research is the source of most new scientific ideas and ways of thinking about the world. It can be exploratory, descriptive, or explanatory; however, explanatory research is the most common.

Basic research generates new ideas, principles and theories, which may not be immediately utilized; though are the foundations of modern progress and development in different fields. Today‟s computers could not exist without the pure research in mathematics conducted over a century ago, for which there was no known practical application at that time.

Police officers trying to prevent delinquency or counselors of youthful offenders may see little relevance to basic research on the question, “Why does deviant behavior occur?” Basic research rarely helps practitioners directly with their everyday concerns. Nevertheless, it stimulates new ways of thinking about deviance that have the potential to revolutionize and dramatically improve how practitioners deal with a problem.

A new idea or fundamental knowledge is not generated only by basic research. Applied research, too, can build new knowledge. Nonetheless, basic research is essential for nourishing the expansion of knowledge. Researchers at the center of the scientific community conduct most of the basic research.

b. Applied Research

Applied researchers try to solve specific policy problems or help practitioners accomplish tasks. Theory is less central to them than seeking a solution on a specific problem for a limited setting. Applied research is frequently a descriptive research, and its main strength is its immediate practical use.

Applied research is conducted when decision must be made about a specific real-life problem. Applied research encompasses those studies undertaken to answer questions about specific problems or to make decisions about a particular course of action or policy. **For example**, an organization contemplating a paperless office and a networking system for the company‟s personal computers may conduct research to learn the amount of time its employees spend at personal computers in an average week.

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c. Basic and Applied Research Compared

The procedures and techniques utilized by basic and applied researchers do not differ substantially. Both employ the scientific method to answer the questions at hand.

The scientific community is the primary consumer of basic research. The consumers of applied research findings are practitioners such as teachers, counselors, and caseworkers, or decision makers such as managers, committees, and officials. Often, someone other than the researcher who conducted the study uses the results of applied research. This means that applied researchers have an obligation to translate findings from scientific technical language into the language of decision makers or practitioners.

The results of applied research are less likely to enter the public domain in publications. Results may be available only to a small number of decision makers or practitioners, who decide whether or how to put the research results into practice and who may or may not use the results.

Applied and basic researchers adopt different orientations toward research methodology. Basic researchers emphasize high standards and try to conduct near-perfect research. Applied researchers make more trade-offs. They may compromise scientific rigor to get quick, usable results. Compromise is no excuse for sloppy research, however. Applied researchers squeeze research into the constraints of an applied setting and balance rigor against practical needs. Such balancing requires an in-depth knowledge of research and an awareness of the consequences of compromising standards.

d. Types of Applied Research

Practitioners use several types of applied research. Some of the major ones are:

i) Action research: The applied research that treats knowledge as a form of power and abolishes the line between research and social action. Those who are being studied participate in the research process; research incorporates ordinary or popular knowledge; research focuses on power with a goal of empowerment; research seeks to raise consciousness or increase awareness; and research is tied directly to political action. The researchers try to advance a cause or improve conditions by expanding public awareness.

They are explicitly political, not value neutral. Because the goal is to improve the conditions of research participants, formal reports, articles, or books become secondary. Action researchers assume that knowledge develops from experience, particularly the experience of social-political action. They also assume that ordinary people can become aware of conditions and learn to take actions that can bring about improvement.

***ii) Impact Assessment Research*:** Its purpose is to estimate the likely consequences of a planned change. Such an assessment is used for planning and making choices among alternative policies – to make an impact assessment of Basha Dam on the environment; to determine changes in housing if a major new highway is built.

***iii) Evaluation Research*:** It addresses the question, "Did it work?" The process of establishing value judgment based on evidence about the achievement of the goals of a program. Evaluation research measures the effectiveness of a program, policy, or way of doing something. "Did the program work?" "Did it achieve its objectives?" Evaluation researchers use several research techniques (survey, field research).

Practitioners involved with a policy or program may conduct evaluation research for their own information or at the request of outside decision makers, who sometime place limits on researchers by setting boundaries on what can be studied and determining the outcome of interest.

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Two types of evaluation research are formative and summative. *Formative evaluation* is built-in monitoring or continuous feedback on a program used for program management. *Summative evaluation* looks at final program outcomes. Both are usually necessary.

3. The Time Dimension in Research:

Another dimension of research is the treatment of time. Some studies give us a snapshot of a single, fixed time point and allow us to analyze it in detail. Other studies provide a moving picture that lets us follow events, people, or sale of products over a period of time. In this way from the angle of time research could be divided into two broad types:

***a. Cross-Sectional Research*:** In cross-sectional research, researchers observe at one point in time. Cross-sectional research is usually the simplest and least costly alternative. Its disadvantage is that it cannot capture the change processes. Cross-sectional research can be exploratory, descriptive, or explanatory, but it is most consistent with a descriptive approach to research.

b. Longitudinal Research: Researchers using longitudinal research examine features of people or other units at more than one time. It is usually more complex and costly than cross-sectional research but it is also more powerful, especially when researchers seek answers to questions about change. There are three types of longitudinal research: time series, panel, and cohort.

i. *Time series research* is longitudinal study in which the same type of information is collected on a group of people or other units across multiple time periods. Researcher can observe stability or change in the features of the units or can track conditions overtime. One could track the characteristics of students registering in the course on Research Methods over a period of four years i.e. the characteristics (Total, age characteristics, gender distribution, subject distribution, and geographic distribution). Such an analysis could tell us the trends in the characteristic over the four years.

ii. *The panel study* is a powerful type of longitudinal research. In panel study, the researcher observes exactly the same people, group, or organization across time periods. It is a difficult to carry out such study. Tracking people over time is often difficult because some people die or cannot be located. Nevertheless, the results of a well-designed panel study are very valuable.

iii. *A cohort analysis* is similar to the panel study, but rather than observing the exact same people, a category of people who share a similar life experience in a specified time period is studied. The focus is on the cohort, or category, not on specific individuals. Commonly used cohorts include all people born in the same year (called birth cohorts); all people hired at the same time, all people retire on one or two year time frame, and all people who graduate in a given year. Unlike panel studies, researchers do not have to locate the exact same people for cohort studies. The only need to identify those who experienced a common life event.

4. Research (data collection) Techniques Used:

Every researcher collects data using one or more techniques. The techniques may be grouped into two categories: *quantitative*, collecting data in the form of numbers, and *qualitative*, collecting data in the form of words or pictures.

a. Quantitative;

The main quantitative techniques are:

1. Experiments
2. Surveys
3. Content Analysis

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4. Using Existing Statistics

b. Qualitative;

The major qualitative techniques of research are:

1. Field Research
2. Case Study
3. Focus Group Discussion

Details about the quantitative and qualitative techniques of research shall be discussed later.

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Lesson 4

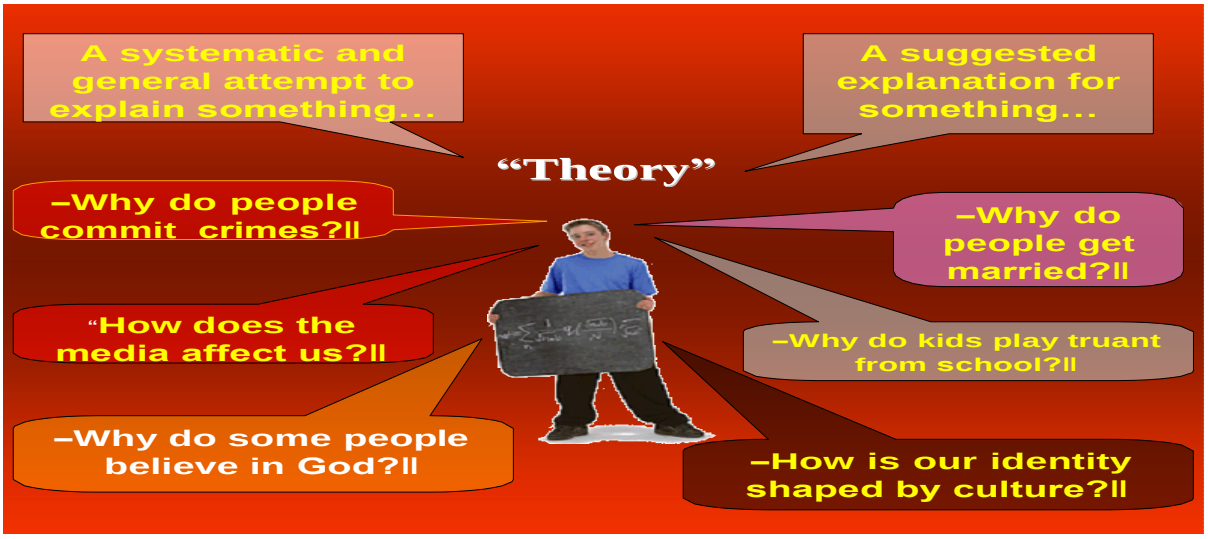
THEORY AND RESEARCH

The purpose of science concerns the expansion of knowledge, the discovery of truth and to make predictions. Theory building is the means by which the basic researchers hope to achieve this purpose. A scientist poses questions like: What produces inflation? Does student-teacher interaction influence students‟ performance? In both these questions there is the element of prediction i.e. that if we do such and such, then so and so will happen. In fact we are looking for explanation for the issue that has been raised in these questions. Underlying the explanation is the whole process through which the phenomenon emerges, and we would like to understand the process to reach prediction.

Prediction and understanding are the two purposes of theory. Accomplishing the first goal allows the theorist to predict the behavior or characteristics of one phenomenon from the knowledge of another phenomenon‟s characteristics. A business researcher may theorize that older investors tend to be more interested in investment income than younger investors. This theory, once verified, should allow researchers to predict the importance of expected dividend yield on the basis of investors‟ age. The researcher would also like to understand the process. In most of the situations prediction and understanding the process go hand in hand i.e. to predict the phenomenon, we must have an explanation of why variables behave as they do. Theories provide these explanations.

Theory

As such theory is a systematic and general attempt to explain something like: Why do people commit crimes? How do the media affect us? Why do some people believe in God? Why do people get married? Why do kids play truant from school? How is our identity shaped by culture? Each of these questions contains a reference to some observed phenomenon. A suggested explanation for the observed phenomenon is theory. More formally, a **theory** is a coherent set of general propositions, used as principles of explanations of the apparent relationship of certain observed phenomena. A key element in this definition is the term proposition.



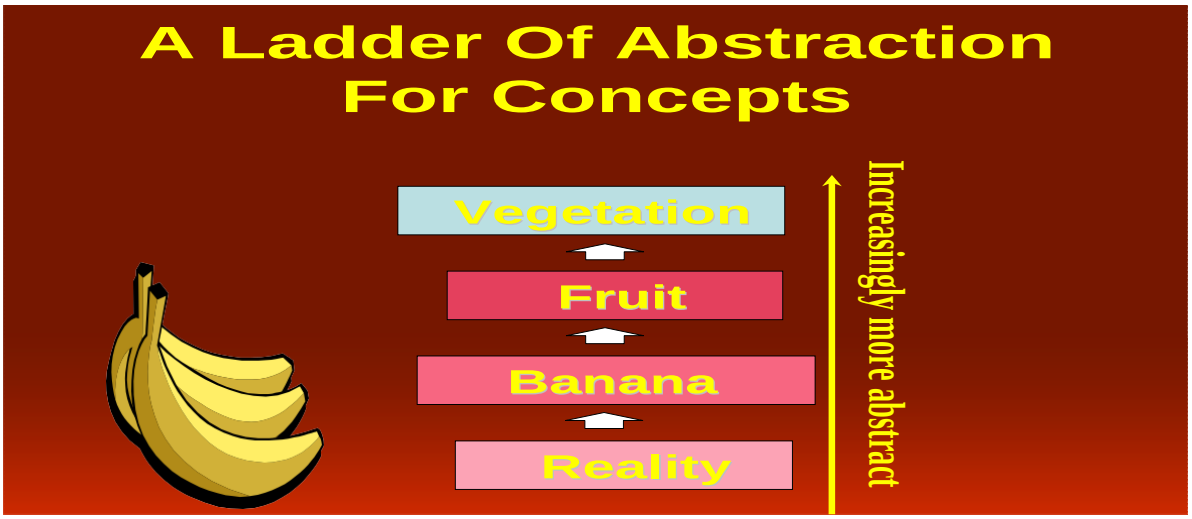
Concepts

Theory development is essentially a process of describing phenomena at increasingly higher levels of abstraction. A **concept** (or construct) is a generalized idea about a class of objects, attributes, occurrences, or processes that has been given a **name**. Such names are created or developed or constructed for the identification of the phenomenon, be it physical or non-physical. All these may be

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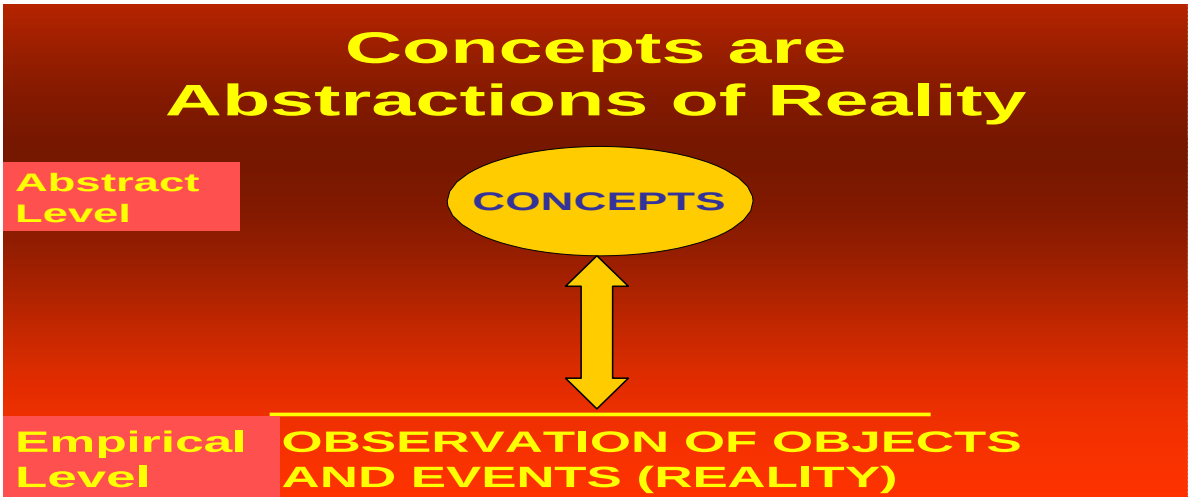
considered as empirical realities e.g. leadership, productivity, morale, motivation, inflation, happiness, banana.

Concepts are the building block of a theory. Concepts abstract reality. That is, concepts are expressed in words, letters, signs, and symbols that refer to various events or objects. For example, the concept "asset" is an abstract term that may, in the concrete world of reality, refer to a specific punch press machine. Concepts, however, may vary in degree of abstraction and we can put them in a ladder of abstraction, indicating different levels.



Moving up the **ladder of abstraction,** the basic concept becomes more abstract, wider in scope, and less amenable to measurement. The scientific researcher operates at two levels: on the abstract level of concepts (and propositions) and on the empirical level of variables (and hypotheses). At the empirical level we "experience" reality – that is we observe the objects or events. In this example the reality has been given a name i.e. banana. Moving up the ladder this reality falls in wider reality i.e. fruit, which in turn becomes part of further wider reality called as vegetation.

Researchers are concerned with the observable world, or what we may call as "reality." We try to construct names to such empirical reality for its identification, which may refer to as concept at an abstract level.



Theorists translate their conceptualization of reality into abstract ideas. Thus theory deals with abstraction. Things are not the essence of theory; ideas are. Concepts in isolation are not theories. Only when we explain how concepts relate to other concepts we begin to construct theories.

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Propositions

Concepts are the basic units of theory development. However, theories require an understanding of the relationship among concepts. Thus, once reality is abstracted into concepts, the scientist is interested in the relationship among various concepts. **Propositions** are statements concerned with the logical relationships among concepts. A proposition explains the logical linkage among certain concepts by asserting a universal connection between concepts.

Theory is an abstraction from observed reality. Concepts are at one level of abstraction. Investigating propositions requires that we increase our level abstract thinking. When we think about theories, we are at the highest level of abstraction because we are investigating the relationship between propositions. Theory is a network of propositions.



Theory and Research

Basic to modern science is an intricate relation between theory and research. The popular understanding of this relationship obscures more than it illuminates. Popular opinion generally conceives of these as direct opposites: theory is confused with speculation, and thus theory remains speculation until it is proved. When this proof is made, theory becomes fact. Facts are thought to be definite, certain, without question, and their meaning to be self-evident.

When we look at what scientists actually do when engaged in research, it becomes clear (1) that theory and fact are not diametrically opposed, but inextricably intertwined; (2) that theory is not speculation; and (3) that scientists are very much concerned with both theory and fact (research).

Hence research produces facts and from facts we can generate theories. Theories are soft mental images whereas research covers the empirical world of hard, settled, and observable things. In this way theory and fact (research) contribute to each other.

Role of Theory

1. Theory as orientation.

A major function of a theoretical system is that it narrows the range of facts to be studied. Any phenomenon or object may be studied in many different ways. A football, for example, can be investigated within an economic framework, as we ascertain the patterns of demand and supply relating to this play object. It may also be the object of chemical research, for it is made of organic chemicals. It has a mass and may be studied as physical object undergoing different stresses and

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attaining certain velocities under various conditions. It may also be seen as the center of many sociologically interesting activities; play, communication, group organization, etc.

Each science and each specialization within a broader field abstracts from reality, keeping its attention upon a few aspects of given phenomena rather than on all aspects. The broad orientation of each field then focuses upon limited range of things while ignoring or making assumptions about others.

2. Theory as a conceptualization and classification.

Every science is organized by a structure of concepts, which refer to major processes and objects to be studied. It is the relationship between these concepts which are stated in "the facts of science." Such terms make up the vocabulary that the scientist uses. If knowledge is to be organized, there must be some system imposed upon the facts which are observable. As a consequence, a major task in any science is the development of development of classification, a structure of concepts, and an increasingly precise set of definitions for these terms.

3. Theory in summarizing role.

A further task which theory performs is to summarize concisely what is already known about the object of study. These summaries may be divided into two simple categories: (1) empirical generalizations, and (2) systems of relationships between propositions.

Although the scientist may think of his field as a complex structure of relationships, most of his daily work is concerned with prior task: the simple addition of data, expressed in empirical generalizations. The demographer may tabulate births and deaths during a given period in order to ascertain the crude rate of reproduction. These facts are useful and are summarized in simple or complex theoretical relationships. As body of summarizing statements develops, it is possible to see *relationships between the statements*. Theorizing on a still larger scale, some may attempt to integrate the major empirical generalizations of an era. It is through systems of propositions that many of our common statements must be interpreted. Facts are seen within a framework rather than in an isolated fashion.

4. Theory predicts facts.

If theory summarizes facts and states a general uniformity beyond the immediate observation, it also becomes a prediction of facts. This prediction has several facets. The most obvious is the extrapolation from the known to the unknown. For example, we may observe that in every known case the introduction of Western technology has led to a sharp drop in the death rate and a relatively minor drop in the birth rate of a given nation, at least during the initial stages. Thus we predict that if Western technology is introduced into a native culture, we shall find this process again taking place. Correspondingly we predict that in a region where Western technology has already been introduced, we shall find that this process has occurred.

5. Theory points gaps in knowledge.

Since theory summarizes the known facts and predicts facts which have not been observed, it must also point to areas which have not yet been explored.

Theory also points to gaps of a more basic kind. While these gaps are being filled, changes in the conceptual scheme usually occur. An example from criminology may be taken. Although a substantial body of knowledge had been built up concerning criminal behavior and it causes. A body of theory dealing with causation was oriented almost exclusively to the crimes committed by the lower classes. Very little attention has been paid to the crimes committed by the middle class or, more

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specifically, to the crimes labeled as "white collar" and which grow out of the usual activities of businessmen. Such a gap would not be visible if our facts were not systematized and organized. As a consequence, we may say that theory does suggest where our knowledge is deficient.

Role of Facts (Research)

Theory and fact are in constant interaction. Developments in one may lead to developments in the other. Theory, implicit or explicit, is basic to knowledge and even perception. Theory is not merely a passive element. It plays an active role in the uncovering of facts. We should expect that "fact" has an equally significant part to play in the development of theory. Science actually depends upon a continuous stimulation of fact by theory and of theory by fact.

1. Facts initiate theory.

Many of the human interest stories in the history of science describe how a striking fact, sometimes stumbled upon, led to important theories. This is what the public thinks of as a "discovery." Examples may be taken from many sciences: accidental finding that the penicillium fungus inhibits bacterial growth; many errors in reading, speaking, or seeing are not accidental but have deep and systematic causes. Many of these stories take an added drama in the retelling, but they express a fundamental fact in the growth of science, that an apparently simple observation may lead to significant theory.

2. Facts lead to the rejection and reformulation of existing theory.

Facts do not completely determine theory, since many possible theories can be developed to take account of a specific set of observation. Nevertheless, facts are the more stubborn of the two. Any theory must adjust to facts and is rejected or reformulated if they cannot be fitted into its structure. Since research is continuing activity, rejection and reformulation are likely to be going on simultaneously. Observations are gradually accumulated which seem to cast doubt upon existing theory. While new tests are being planned, new formulations of theory are developed which might fit these new facts.

3. Facts redefine and clarify theory.

Usually the scientist has investigated his/her problem for a long time prior to actual field or laboratory test and is not surprised by his/her results. It is rare that he/she finds a fact that simply does not fit prior theory. New facts that fit the theory will always redefine the theory, for they state in detail what the theory states in very general terms. They clarify that theory, for they throw further light upon its concepts.

Theory and Research: the Dynamic Duo

Theory and research are interrelated; the dichotomy between theory and research is an artificial. The value of theory and its necessity for conducting good research should be clear. Researchers who proceed without theory rarely conduct top-quality research and frequently find themselves in confusion. Researchers weave together knowledge from different studies into more abstract theory. Likewise, who proceed without linking theory to research or anchoring it to empirical reality are in jeopardy of floating off into incomprehensible speculation and conjecture.

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Lesson 5

CONCEPTS

Things we observe are the observable realities, which could be physical or abstract. For purposes of identification of reality we try to give a name to it. By using the name we communicate with others and over time it becomes part of our language.

A concept is a generalized idea about a class of objects, attributes, occurrences, or processes that has been given a name. In other words a concept is an idea expressed as a symbol or in words. Natural science concepts are often expressed in symbolic forms. Most social science concepts are expressed in words. Words, after all, are symbols too; they are symbols we learn with language. Height is a concept with which all of you are familiar. In a sense, a language is merely an agreement to represent ideas by sound or written characters that people learned at some point in their lives. Learning concepts and theory is like learning language.

Concepts are an Abstraction of Reality

Concepts are everywhere, and you use them all the time. Height is simple concept form everyday experience. What does it mean? It is easy to use the concept of height, but describing the concept itself is difficult. It represents an abstract idea about physical reality, or **an abstraction of reality**. Height is a characteristic of physical objects, the distance from top to bottom. All people, buildings, trees, mountains, books and so forth have height. The word height refers to an abstract idea. We associate its sound and its written form with that idea. There is nothing inherent in the sounds that make up the word and the idea it represents. The connection is arbitrary, but it is still useful. People can express the abstract idea to one another using the symbols.

In other words concepts are the abstractions of reality – physical of non-physical like table, leadership, productivity, and morale are all labels given to some phenomenon (reality). The concepts stand for phenomenon not the phenomenon itself; hence it may be called an abstraction of empirical reality.

Degree of Abstraction

Concepts vary in their level of abstraction. They are on a continuum from the most concrete to the most abstract. Very concrete ones refer to straightforward physical objects or familiar experiences (e.g. height, school, age, family income, or housing). More abstract concepts refer to ideas that have a diffuse, indirect expression (e.g. family dissolution, racism, political power)

The organization of concepts in sequence from the most concrete and individual to the most general indicates the degree of abstraction**.** Moving up the ladder of abstraction, the basic concept becomes more abstract, wider in scope, and less amenable to measurement. The scientific researcher operates at two levels of concepts (and propositions) and on the empirical level of variables. At the empirical level we experience reality – that is we observe objects or events.

Sources of Concepts:

Everyday culture is filled with concepts, but many of them have vague and unclear definitions. Likewise, the values and experiences of people in a culture may limit everyday

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concepts. Nevertheless, we borrow concepts from everyday culture; though these to be refined.

We create concepts from personal experiences, creative thought, or observation. The classical theorist originated many concepts like family system, gender role, socialization, self-worth, frustration, and displaced aggression. We also borrow concepts from sister disciplines.

Importance of Concepts:

Social science concepts form a specialized language, or *jargon.* Specialists use jargon as a short hand way to communicate with one another. Most fields have their own jargon. Physicians, lawyers, engineers, accountants, plumbers, and auto mechanics all have specialized languages. They use their jargon to refer to the ideas and objects with which they work. Special problems grow out of the need for concept precision and inventiveness. Vague meanings attached to a concept create problems of measurement. Therefore, not only the construction of concepts is necessary but also these should be precise and the researchers should have some agreement to its meaning.

Identification of concepts is necessary because we use concepts in hypothesis formulation. Here too one of the characteristics of a good hypothesis is that it should be conceptually clear.

The success of research hinges on (1) how clearly we conceptualize and (2) how well others understand the concept we use. For example we might ask respondents for an estimate of their family income. This may seem to be a simple, unambiguous concept, but we may receive varying and confusing answers unless we restrict or narrow the concept by specifying:

- Time period, such as weekly, monthly, or annually.
- Before or after income taxes.
- For head of the family only or for all family members.
- For salary and wages only or also for dividends, interest, and capital gains.
- Income in kind, such as free rent, employee discounts, or food stamps.

Definitions:

Confusion about the meaning of concepts can destroy a research study‟s value without the researcher or client even knowing it. If words have different meanings to the parties involved, then they are not communicating on the same wave-length. Definitions are one way to reduce this danger.

Dictionary Definitions:

Researchers must struggle with two types of definitions. In the more familiar dictionary, a concept is defined with synonyms. For example, a customer is defined as a patron: a patron, in turn, is defined as customer or client of an establishment; a client is defined as one who employs the services of any professional …, also loosely, a patron of any shop. These circular definitions may be adequate for general communication but not for research.

Dictionary definitions are also called conceptual or theoretical or nominal definitions. *Conceptual definition* is a definition in abstract, theoretical terms. It refers to other ideas or constructs. There is no magical way to turn a construct into precise conceptual definition. It

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involves thinking carefully, observing directly, consulting with others, reading what others have said, and trying possible definitions.

A single construct can have several definitions, and people may disagree over definitions. Conceptual definitions are linked to theoretical frameworks and to value positions. For example, a conflict theorist may define *social class* as the power and property a group of people in a society has or lacks. A structural functionalist defines it in terms of individual who share a social status, life-style, or subjective justification. Although people disagree over definitions, the researcher should always state explicitly which definition he or she is using.

Some constructs are highly abstract and complex. They contain lower level concepts within them (e.g. powerlessness), which can be made even more specific (e.g. a feeling of little power over wherever on lives). Other concepts are concrete and simple (e.g. age). When developing definitions, a researcher needs to be aware of how complex and abstract a construct is. For example, a concrete construct such as age is easier to define (e.g. number of years that have passed since birth) than is a complex, abstract concept such as morale.

Operational Definition

In research we must measure concepts and constructs, and this requires more rigorous definitions. A concept must be made operational in order to be measured. An operational definition gives meanings to a concept by specifying the activities or operations necessary to measure it. An operational definition specifies what must be done to measure the concept under investigation. It is like a manual of instruction or a recipe: do such-and-such in so-and-so manner.

Operational definition is also called a *working definition* stated in terms of specific testing or measurement criteria. The concepts must have empirical referents (i.e. we must be able to count, measure, or in some other way gather the information through our senses). Whether the object to be defined is physical e.g. a machine tool) or highly abstract (e.g. achievement motivation), the definition must specify characteristics and how to be observed. The specification and procedures must be so clear that any competent person using them would classify the objects the same way. So in operational definition we must specify concrete indicators that can be observed/measured (observable indicators).

Use both Definitions in Research

Look at observable phenomenon, we construct a label for it, then try to define it theoretically, which gives a lead to the development of criteria for its measurement, and finally we gather the data.

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Lesson 06

VARIABLES AND TYPES OF VARIABLES

Variable is central idea in research. Simply defined, variable is a concept that varies. There are two types of concepts: those that refer to a fixed phenomenon and those that vary in quantity, intensity, or amount (e.g. amount of education). The second type of concept and measures of the concept are variables. A variable is defined as anything that varies or changes in value. Variables take on two or more values. Because variable represents a quality that can exhibit differences in value, usually magnitude or strength, it may be said that a variable generally is anything that may assume different numerical or categorical values. Once you begin to look for them, you will see variables everywhere. For example gender is a variable; it can take two values: male or female. Marital status is a variable; it can take on values of never married, single, married, divorced, or widowed. Family income is a variable; it can take on values from zero to billions of Rupees. A person‟s attitude toward women empowerment is variable; it can range from highly favorable to highly unfavorable. In this way the variation can be in quantity, intensity, amount, or type; the examples can be production units, absenteeism, gender, religion, motivation, grade, and age. A variable may be situation specific; for example gender is a variable but if in a particular situation like a class of Research Methods if there are only female students, then in this situation gender will not be considered as a variable.

Types of Variable

1. Continuous and Discontinuous variables

Variables have different properties and to these properties we assign numerical values. If the values of a variable can be divided into fractions then we call it a *continuous variable*. Such a variable can take infinite number of values. Income, temperature, age, or a test score are examples of continuous variables. These variables may take on values within a given range or, in some cases, an infinite set.

Any variable that has a limited number of distinct values and which cannot be divided into fractions, is a *discontinuous variable*. Such a variable is also called as *categorical variable* or *classificatory variable*, or *discrete variable*. Some variables have only two values, reflecting the presence or absence of a property: employed-unemployed or male-female have two values. These variables are referred to as dichotomous. There are others that can take added categories such as the demographic variables of race, religion. All such variables that produce data that fit into categories are said to be discrete/categorical/classificatory, since only certain values are possible. An automotive variable, for example, where “Chevrolet” is assigned a 5 and “Honda” is assigned a 6, provides no option for a 5.5 (i.e. the values cannot be divided into fractions).

2. Dependent and Independent Variables

Researchers who focus on causal relations usually begin with an effect, and then search for its causes. The cause variable, or the one that identifies forces or conditions that act on something else, is the *independent variable*. The variable that is the effect or is the result or outcome of another variable is the *dependent variable* (also referred to as outcome variable or effect variable). The independent variable is “independent of” prior causes that act on it, whereas the dependent variable “depends on” the cause.

It is not always easy to determine whether a variable is independent or dependent. Two questions help to identify the independent variable. First, does it come before other variable in time? Second, if the variables occur at the same time, does the researcher suggest that one variable has an impact on another variable? Independent variables affect or have an impact on other variables. When independent variable is present, the dependent variable is also present, and with each unit of increase in the independent variable, there is an increase or decrease in the dependent variable also. In other

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words, the variance in dependent variable is accounted for by the independent variable. Dependent variable is also referred to as *criterion* variable.

In statistical analysis a variable is identified by the symbol (X) for independent variable and by the symbol (Y) for the dependent variable. In the research vocabulary different labels have been associated with the independent and dependent variables like:

Independent variable	**Dependent variable**
Presumed cause	presumed effect
Stimulus	Response
Predicted from …	Predicted to …
Antecedent	Consequence
Manipulated	Measured outcome
Predictor	Criterion

Research studies indicate that successful new product development has an influence on the stock market price of a company. That is, the more successful the new product turns out to be, the higher will be the stock market price of that firm. Therefore, the **success of the new product** is the *independent variable,* and **stock market price** the *dependent variable*.

The degree of perceived success of the new product developed will explain the variance in the stock market price of the company.

It is important to remember that there are no preordained variables waiting to be discovered "out there" that are automatically assigned to be independent or dependent. It is in fact the product of the researcher‟s imagination demonstrated convincingly.

3. Moderating Variables

A moderating variable is one that has a strong *contingent* effect on the independent variable-dependent variable relationship. That is, the presence of a third variable (the moderating variable) modifies the original relationship between the independent and the dependent variable.

For example, a strong relationship has been observed between the quality of library facilities (X) and the performance of the students (Y). Although this relationship is supposed to be true generally, it is nevertheless contingent on the interest and inclination of the students. It means that only those students who have the interest and inclination to use the library will show improved performance in their studies. In this relationship **interest and inclination** is moderating variable i.e. which moderates the strength of the association between X and Y variables.

4. Intervening Variables

A basic causal relationship requires only independent and dependent variable. A third type of variable, the *intervening variable,* appears in more complex causal relationships. It comes between the independent and dependent variables and shows the link or mechanism between them. Advances in knowledge depend not only on documenting cause and effect relationship but also on specifying the mechanisms that account for the causal relation. In a sense, the intervening variable acts as a dependent variable with respect to independent variable and acts as an independent variable toward the dependent variable.

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A theory of suicide states that married people are less likely to commit suicide than single people. The assumption is that married people have greater social integration (e.g. feelings of belonging to a group or family). Hence a major cause of one type of suicide was that people lacked a sense of belonging to group (family). Thus this theory can be restated as a three-variable relationship: marital status (independent variable) causes the degree of social integration (intervening variable), which affects suicide (dependent variable). Specifying the chain of causality makes the linkages in theory clearer and helps a researcher test complex relationships.

Look at another finding that five-day work week results in higher productivity. What is the process of moving from the independent variable to the dependent variable? What exactly is that factor which theoretically affects the observed phenomenon but cannot be seen? Its effects must be inferred from the effects of independent variable on the dependent variable. In this work-week hypothesis, one might view the intervening variable to be the job satisfaction. To rephrase the statement it could be: the introduction of five-day work week (IV) will increase job satisfaction (IVV), which will lead to higher productivity (DV).

5. Extraneous Variables

An almost infinite number of extraneous variables (EV) exist that might conceivably affect a given relationship. Some can be treated as independent or moderating variables, but most must either be assumed or excluded from the study. Such variables have to be identified by the researcher. In order to identify the true relationship between the independent and the dependent variable, the effect of the extraneous variables may have to be controlled. This is necessary if we are conducting an experiment where the effect of the confounding factors has to be controlled. Confounding factors is another name used for extraneous variables.

Relationship among Variables

Once the variables relevant to the topic of research have been identified, then the researcher is interested in the relationship among them. A statement containing the variable is called a proposition. It may contain one or more than one variable. The proposition having one variable in it may be called as univariate proposition, those with two variables as bivariate proposition, and then of course multivariate containing three or more variables. Prior to the formulation of a proposition the researcher has to develop strong logical arguments which could help in establishing the relationship. For example, age at marriage and education are the two variables that could lead to a proposition: the higher the education, the higher the age at marriage. What could be the logic to reach this conclusion? All relationships have to be explained with strong logical arguments.

If the relationship refers to an observable reality, then the proposition can be put to test, and any testable proposition is hypothesis.

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Lesson 7

HYPOTHESIS TESTING & CHARACTERISTICS

We have already seen that propositions are statements about variables considered to be true or false. If the phenomenon under consideration happens to be observable reality then they said statement could be empirically tested. A proposition that can be verified to determine its reality is a hypothesis. Therefore one can say that a hypothesis is a verifiable counterpart of a proposition.

A hypothesis may be defined as a logically conjectured relationship between two or more variables, expressed in the form of a testable statement. Relationship is proposed by using a strong logical argumentation. This logical relationship may be part of theoretical framework of the study.

Let us look at some of the hypotheses:

1. Officers in my organization have higher than average *level of commitment* (variable).
2. *Level of job commitment* of the officers is associated with their *level of efficiency.*
3. *Level of job commitment* of the officers is positively associated with their *level of efficiency.*
4. The higher the *level of job commitment* of the officers the lower their *level of absenteeism.*

These are testable propositions. First hypothesis contains only one variable. The second one has two variables which have been shown to be associated with each other but the nature of association has not been specified (non-directional relationship). In the third hypothesis we have gone a step further where in addition to the relationship between the two variables, the direction of relationship (positive) has also been given. In the fourth hypothesis *level of efficiency* has been replaced with *level of absenteeism*, the direction of relationship between the two variables has been specified (which is negative). In the following discussion you will find these hypotheses being quoted as part of the examples.

Types of Hypotheses:

i. Descriptive Hypothesis

Descriptive hypothesis contains only one variable thereby it is also called as univariate hypothesis. Descriptive hypotheses typically state the existence, size, form, or distribution of some variable.

The first hypothesis contains only one variable. It only shows the distribution of the level of commitment among the officers of the organization which is higher than average. Such a hypothesis is an example of a Descriptive Hypothesis.

Researchers usually use research questions rather than descriptive hypothesis. For example a question can be: What is the level of commitment of the officers in your organization?

ii. Relational Hypothesis

These are the propositions that describe a relationship between two variables. The relationship could be non-directional or directional, positive or negative, causal or simply co-relational.

While stating the relationship between the two variables, if the terms of positive, negative, more than, or less than are used then such hypotheses are directional because the direction of the relationship between the variables (positive/negative) has been indicated (see hypotheses 3 and 4). These hypotheses are relational as well as directional. The directional hypothesis is the one in which the direction of the relationship has been specified.

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Non-directional hypothesis is the one in which the direction of the association has not been specified. The relationship may be very strong but whether it is positive or negative has not been postulated (see hypothesis 2).

Co-relational hypotheses:

State merely that the variables occur together in some specified manner without implying that one causes the other. Such weak claims are often made when we believe that there are more basic causal forces that affect both variables. For example:

Level of job commitment of the officers is positively associated with their *level of efficiency.*

Here we do not make any claim that one variable causes the other to change. That will be possible only if we have control on all other factors that could influence our dependent variable.

Explanatory (causal) hypotheses:

Imply the existence of, or a change in, one variable causes or leads to a change in the other variable. This brings in the notions of independent and the dependent variables. Cause means to "help make happen." So the independent variable may not be the sole reason for the existence of, or change in the dependent variable. The researcher may have to identify the other possible causes, and control their effect in case the causal effect of independent variable has to be determined on the dependent variable. This may be possible in an experimental design of research.

Different ways to state hypotheses

- Hi motivation causes hi efficiency.
- Hi motivation leads to hi efficiency.
- Hi motivation is related to hi efficiency.
- Hi motivation influences hi efficiency.
- Hi motivation is associated with hi efficiency.
- Hi motivation produces hi efficiency.
- Hi motivation results in hi efficiency.
- If hi motivation then hi efficiency.
- The higher the motivation, the higher the efficiency

iii. Null Hypothesis:

It is used for testing the hypothesis formulated by the researcher. Researchers treat evidence that supports a hypothesis differently from the evidence that opposes it. They give negative evidence more importance than to the positive one. It is because the negative evidence tarnishes the hypothesis. It shows that the predictions made by the hypothesis are wrong. The null hypothesis simply states that there is *no relationship* between the variables or the relationship between the variables is "zero." That is how symbolically null hypothesis is denoted as "H0". For example:

H0 = There is no relationship between the *level of job commitment* and the *level of efficiency.* Or

H0 = The relationship between *level of job commitment* and the *level of efficiency* is zero. Or

The two variables are independent of each other.

It does not take into consideration the direction of association (i.e. H0 is *non directional*), which may be a second step in testing the hypothesis. First we look whether or not there is an association then we go for the direction of association and the strength of association. Experts recommend that we test our hypothesis indirectly by testing the null hypothesis. In case we have any credibility in our

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hypothesis then the research data should reject the null hypothesis. Rejection of the null hypothesis leads to the acceptance of the alternative hypothesis.

iv. Alternative Hypothesis

The alternative (to the null) hypothesis simply states that there is a relationship between the variables under study. In our example it could be: there is a relationship between the *level of job commitment* and the *level of efficiency.* Not only there is an association between the two variables under study but also the relationship is perfect which is indicated by the number "1". Thereby the alternative hypothesis is symbolically denoted as "H1". It can be written like this:

H1: There is a relationship between the *level of job commitment* of the officers and their *level of efficiency*.

v. Research Hypothesis

Research hypothesis is the actual hypothesis formulated by the researcher which may also suggest the nature of relationship i.e. the direction of relationship. In our example it could be:

Level of job commitment of the officers is positively associated with their *level of efficiency.*

The Role of the Hypothesis

In research, a hypothesis serves several important functions:

1. **It guides the direction of the study:** Quite frequently one comes across a situation when the researcher tries to collect all possible information on which he could lay his hands on. Later on he may find that only part of it he could utilize. Hence there was an unnecessary use of resources on trivial concerns. In such a situation, hypothesis limits what shall be studied and what shall not be.
2. **It identifies facts that are relevant and those that are not:** Who shall be studied (married couples), in what context they shall be studied (their consumer decision making), and what shall be studied (their individual perceptions of their roles).
3. **It suggests which form of research design is likely to be the most appropriate:** Depending upon the type of hypothesis a decision is made about the relative appropriateness of different research designs for the study under consideration. The design could be a survey design, experimental design, content analysis, case study, participation observation study, and/or Focus Group Discussions.
4. **It provides a framework for organizing the conclusions of the findings**

The Characteristics of a Testable Hypothesis:

- **Hypothesis must be conceptually clear.** The concepts used in the hypothesis should be clearly defined, operationally if possible. Such definitions should be commonly accepted and easily communicable among the research scholars.
- **Hypothesis should have empirical referents.** The variables contained in the hypothesis should be empirical realities. In case these are not empirical realities then it will not be possible to make the observations. Being handicapped by the data collection, it may not be possible to test the hypothesis. Watch for words like ought, should, bad.

- **Hypothesis must be specific.** The hypothesis should not only be specific to a place and situation but also these should be narrowed down with respect to its operation. Let there be no global use of concepts whereby the researcher is using such a broad concept which may all inclusive and may not be able to tell anything. For example somebody may try to propose the relationship between urbanization and family size. Yes urbanization influences in declining the size of families. But urbanization is such comprehensive variable which hide the operation

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of so many other factor which emerge as part of the urbanization process. These factors could be the rise in education levels, women‟s levels of education, women empowerment, emergence of dual earner families, decline in patriarchy, accessibility to health services, role of mass media, and could be more. Therefore the global use of the word „urbanization‟ may not tell much. Hence it is suggested to that the hypothesis should be specific.

- **Hypothesis should be related to available techniques of research.** Hypothesis may have empirical reality; still we are looking for tools and techniques that could be used for the collection of data. If the techniques are not there then the researcher is handicapped. Therefore, either the techniques are already available or the researcher is in a position to develop suitable techniques for the study.

- **Hypothesis should be related to a body of theory.** Hypothesis has to be supported by theoretical argumentation. For this purpose the research may develop his/her theoretical framework which could help in the generation of relevant hypothesis. For the development of a framework the researcher shall depend on the existing body of knowledge. In such an effort a connection between the study in hand and the existing body of knowledge can be established. That is how the study could benefit from the existing knowledge and later on through testing the hypothesis could contribute to the reservoir of knowledge.

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Lesson 8

REVIEW OF LITERATURE

A literature review is based on the assumption that knowledge accumulates and that we learn from and build on what others have done. Scientific research is a collective effort of many researchers who share their results with one another and who pursue knowledge as a community.

Today‟s studies build on those of yesterday. Researchers read studies to compare, replicate, or criticize them for weaknesses.

Goals of a Literature Review

Reviews vary in scope and depth. Different kinds of reviews are stronger at fulfilling different goals of review. The goals of review are:

1. *To demonstrate a familiarity with a body of knowledge and establish credibility.* A review tells the reader that the researcher knows the research in an area and knows the major issues. A good review increases a reader‟s confidence in the researcher‟s professional competence, ability, and background.
2. *To know the path of prior research and how a current research project is linked to it.* A review outlines the direction, ability, and background of research on a question and shows the development of knowledge. A good review places a research project in a context and demonstrates its relevance by making connections to a body of knowledge.
3. *To integrate and summarize what is known in an area*. A review pulls together and synthesizes different results. A good review points out areas where prior studies agree, where they disagree, and where major questions remain. It collects what is known to a point in time and indicates the direction for future research. No reinventing the wheel. No wastage of effort.
4. *To learn from others and stimulate new ideas*. A review tells what others have found so that a researcher can benefit from the efforts of others. A good review identifies blind alleys and suggests hypotheses for replication. It divulges procedures, techniques, and research designs worth copying so that a researcher can better focus hypotheses and gain new insights.
5. *Identification of variables.* Important variables that are likely to influence the problem situation are not left out of the study.
6. *Helps in developing theoretical framework.*

Types of Reviews

When beginning a review, researcher may decide on a topic or field of knowledge to examine, how much depth to go into, and the kind of review to conduct. There are six types of review:

1. ***Self-study reviews*** *increase the reader's confidence.* A review that only demonstrates familiarity with an area is rarely published but it often is part of an educational program. In addition to giving others confidence in a reviewer‟s command of field, it has the side benefit of building the reviewer‟s self-confidence.

2. ***Context reviews*** *place a specific project in the big picture.* One of the goals of review is creating a link to a developing body of knowledge. This is a background or context review. It introduces the rest of a research and establishes the significance and relevance of a research question. It tells the reader how a project fits into the big picture and its implications for a field of knowledge. The review can summarize how the current research continues a developing line of thought, or it can point to a question or unresolved conflict in prior research to be addressed.

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3. ***Historical review*** *traces the development of an issue over time.* It traces the development of an idea or shows how a particular issue or theory has evolved over time. Researchers conduct historical review only on the most important ideas in a field.
4. ***Theoretical reviews*** *compare how different theories address an issue.* It presents different theories that purport to explain the same thing, and then evaluates how well each accounts for findings. In addition to examining the consistency of predictions with findings, a theoretical review may compare theories for the soundness of their assumptions, logical consistency, and scope of explanation. Researchers also use it to integrate two theories or extend a theory to new issues. It sometimes forms a hybrid – the historical theoretical review.
5. ***Integrative review*** *summarizes what is known at a point in time.* It presents the current state of knowledge and pulls together disparate research reports in a fast growing area of knowledge.
6. ***Methodological reviews*** *point out how methodology varies by study.* In it researcher evaluates the methodological strength of past studies. It describes conflicting results and shows how different research designs, samples, measures, and so on account for different results.

Where to find the Research Literature

- Computer: on line systems.
- Scholarly journals.
- Books – containing reports of original research, or collection of research articles. READERS or Book of Readings.
- Dissertations.
- Government documents.
- Policy reports and presented papers.
- Bibliographic indexes.

Referencing Electronic Sources:

- **Ahmad, B. (2005)** ***Technology and immediacy of information.*** **[on line] Available http://www.bnet.act.com**

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Lesson 9

CONDUCTING A SYSTEMATIC LITERATURE REVIEW

Define and refine a topic:

Prior to the review of literature have a good idea of the topic of your interest. Although, the new thoughts emerging out of the review of literature may help in refocusing the topic, still the researcher needs to have some clear research question that could guide him/her in the pursuit of relevant material. Therefore begin a literature review with a clearly defined, well focused research question and a plan. A good review topic should be as focused as a research question. For example "crime" as such may be too broad a topic. A more focus may be a specific "type of crime" or "economic inequality and crime rates." Often a researcher will not finalize a specific research question for a study until he or she has reviewed the literature. The review helps bring greater focus to the research question.

Design a search

The researcher needs to decide on the type of review, its extensiveness and the types of material to include. The key is to be careful, systematic, and organized. Set parameters on your search; how much time you will devote to it, how far back in time you will look, the maximum number of research reports you will examine, how many libraries you will visit, and so forth.

Also decide how to record the bibliographic citations for each reference. May be beginning a file folder or computer file in which you can place possible sources and ideas for new sources.

Locate research reports:

Locating research reports depends on the type of report or "outlet" of research being searched. Use multiple search strategies in order to counteract the limitations of single search method.

Articles in Scholarly Journals: Most social and behavioral research is likely published in scholarly journals. These journals are the vehicles of communication in science. There are dozens of journal, many going back decades, each containing many articles. Locating the relevant articles is formidable task.

Many academic fields have "abstracts" or "indexes" for the scholarly literature. Find them in reference section of the library. (Many available on compute as well). Such indexes and abstracts are published regularly.

Another resource for locating articles is the computerized literature search. Researchers organize computerized searches in several ways – by author, by article title, by subject, or by keyword. A *keyword* is an important term for a topic that is likely to be found in a title. You will want to use six to eight keywords in most computer based searches and consider several synonyms.

Scholarly Books: Finding scholarly books on a subject can be difficult. The subject topics of a library catalog systems are usually incomplete and too broad to be useful. A person has to be well conversant with the library cataloging system.

Dissertations: A publication called *Dissertation Abstract International* lists most dissertations. It organizes dissertations by broad subject category, author, and date.

Government Documents: The "government documents" sections of libraries contain specialized lists of government documents.

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Policy Reports and Presented Papers. The most difficult sources to locate are policy reports and presented papers. They are listed in some bibliographies of published studies; some are listed in the abstracts or indexes.

What to Record:

After you locate a source, you should write down all details of the reference (full names of the authors, titles, volumes, issue, pages)

Write the Review:

A literature review requires planning and good, clear writing, which requires lot of rewriting. Keep your purposes in mind when you write, and communicate clearly and effectively.

To prepare a good review, read articles and other literature critically. Skepticism is the norm of science. It means that you should not accept what is written simply on the basis of authority of its having been published. Question what you read, and evaluate it.

Critically reading research reports requires skills and take time and practice to develop. When reading an article, read carefully to see whether the introduction and title really fit with the rest of the article. Sometimes, titles, abstracts, or the introduction are misleading. They may not fully explain the research project‟s method and results.

The most critical areas of an article to read are the methods and results sections. Few studies are perfect. Researchers do not always describe the methods they used as fully as they should. Sometimes the results presented in tables or charts do not match what the researcher says. Some points may be over emphasized and others ignored. Check the conclusions, theses may not be consistent with the results.

What does a good review look like?

The author should communicate a review‟s purpose to the reader by its organization. The wrong way to write a review is to list a series of research reports with a summary of the findings of each. This fails to communicate a sense of purpose. It reads as a set of notes strung together. Perhaps the reviewer got sloppy and skipped over the important organizing step in writing the review.

The right way to write a review is to organize common findings or arguments together. A well accepted approach is to address the most important ideas first, to logically link statements or findings, and to note discrepancies or weaknesses in the present.

The writing process:

Your audience:

Professional writers say: Always know for whom are you writing. This is because communication is more effective when it is tailored to a specific audience. You should write research report differently depending on whether the primary audience is the instructor, students, professional colleagues, practitioners, or the general public. It goes without saying that the writing should be clear, accurate, and organized.

Instructors assign reports for different reasons and may place requirements on how it is written. In general, instructors want to see writing an organization that reflects clear, logical thinking. Student reports should demonstrate a solid grasp of substantive and methodological concepts. A good way to do this is to use technical terms explicitly when appropriate: they should not be use excessively and incorrectly.

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Lesson 10

THEORETICAL FRAMEWORK

A theoretical framework is conceptual model of how one theorizes or makes logical sense of the relationships among several factors that have been identified as important to the problem under study. These factors which may also be called as variables may have been identified through such processes as interviews with informants, observations, and literature survey. The theoretical framework discusses the interrelationships among the variables that are considered to be integral to the dynamics of the situation being investigated. Developing such a conceptual framework helps us to postulate or hypothesize and test certain relationships and thus improve our understanding of the dynamics of situation.

From the theoretical framework, then, testable hypotheses can be developed to examine whether theory formulated is valid or not. The hypothesized relationships can thereafter be tested through appropriate statistical analysis.

Hence the entire research rests on the basis of the theoretical framework. Even if the testable hypotheses not necessarily generated, developing a good theoretical framework is central to examining the problem under investigation.

There is a relationship between the literature survey and the theoretical framework whereby the former provides a solid foundation for developing the later. Literature survey helps in the identification of the relevant variables, as determined by the previous researches. This in addition to other logical connections, that can be conceptualized; forms the basis for the theoretical model. The theoretical framework elaborates the relationships among the variables, explains the theory underlying these relations, and describes the nature and direction of the relationships. Just as the literature survey sets the stage for a good theoretical framework, this in turn provides the logical base for developing useable hypotheses.

From the preceding discussion it can be concluded that a theoretical framework is none other than identifying the network of relationships among the variables considered important to the study of any given problem situation. Therefore, the theoretical framework offers the conceptual foundation for constructing the edifice of research that is to taken in hand.

Specifically a theoretical framework:

- Elaborates the relationship among the variables.
- Explains the logic underlying these relationships.
- Describes the nature, and direction of the relationships.

In the review of literature it is possible that you may come across a number of theories readily available for adoption as theoretical framework for the study under consideration. Theories are supposed to be generic whereby they could be applicable to different situations. Some concepts borrowed from such theories may have to be replaced with arguments, logic explicated, and the framework may be readily available. It is also possible that the researcher may combine more than one existing theory and come up with an entirely new framework, and in the process may develop new concepts as well.

However, in the absence of the ready-made conceptual framework, the researcher may venture to develop his/her own framework. Though, the researcher has to depend a lot on the existing body of literature for the identification of variables as well as for developing a rigorous logical argumentation for the interrelationships among different variables.

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Whether the researcher uses a ready-made theoretical framework or explicates an entirely new one, there are some essential features that have to be taken into consideration. These features may be called as components of a theoretical framework.

The Components of the Theoretical Framework

A good theoretical framework identifies and labels the important variables in the situation that are relevant to the problem identified. It logically describes the interconnections among these variables. The relationships among the independent variables, the dependent variable(s), and if applicable, the moderating and intervening variables are elaborated.

The elaboration of the variables in the theoretical framework addresses the issues of why or how we expect certain relationships to exist, and the nature and direction of the relationships among the variables of interest. At the end, the whole discussion can be portrayed in a schematic diagram. There are six basic features that should be incorporated in any theoretical framework. These features are:

1. **Make an inventory of variables**: For developing a framework it appears essential to identify the factors relevant to the problem under study. These factors are the empirical realities which can be named at some abstract level called concepts. The concepts taking more than one value are the variables. In other words the researcher makes *an inventory of relevant variables*. The variables considered relevant to the study should be clearly identified and labeled in the discussion.

2. **Specify the direction of relationship**: If the nature and direction of relationship can be theorized on the basis of the findings of previous research, then there should be an indication in the discussion as to whether the relationship should be positive or negative.

3. **Give a clear explanation of why we should expect the proposed relationships to exist.** There should be clear explanation of why we would expect these relationships to exist. The arguments could be drawn from the previous research findings. The discussions should state how two or more variables are related to one another. This should be done for the important relationships that are theorized to exist among the variables. It is essential to theorize logical relationship between different variables.

4. **Make an inventory of propositions**: Stipulation of logical relationship between any two variables means the formulation of a proposition. If such relationships have been proposed between different variables, it will result in the formulation of a number of propositions. Let us call such a collection of propositions as *an inventory of propositions.* Each proposition is backed up by strong theoretical argumentation.

5. **Arrange these propositions in a sequential order**: One proposition generates the next proposition, which generates the next following proposition, which in turn generates the next following proposition, and so on. This is an axiomatic way of the derivation of propositions. Resultantly it will provide us a sequentially arranged set of propositions which are interlinked and interlocked with each other. Theory, if you remember, is an interrelated set of propositions. Therefore, the present interrelated set of propositions relevant to a particular problem is in fact a theoretical framework explaining the pathways of logical relationships between different variables.

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6. **Schematic diagram of the theoretical model be given:** A schematic diagram of the theoretical framework should be given so that the reader can see and easily comprehend the theorized relationships.

Example:

Research Question: Why middle class families decline in their size?

By following the guidelines discussed earlier let us develop a theoretical framework.

1. **Inventory of variables**: Education levels of the couples, age at marriage, working women, rationalism, exposure to mass media of communication, accessibility to health services, practicing of family planning practices, aspirations about the education of children, shift to nuclear families, mobility orientation.
2. **Specify the direction of relationship:** Higher the education higher the age at marriage. Higher the education of women greater the chances of their being career women. Higher the education more the rationalism. Higher the education more selective the exposure to mass media of communication. Higher the education more the accessibility to health services. Higher the education more the practicing of family planning practices. Higher the education of the parents the higher their aspirations about the education of their children. Higher the education of the couple greater the chances of shifting to nuclear families. Higher the education of the couples the higher their mobility orientation.
3. **Give a clear explanation of why we should expect the proposed relationships to exist.** For example higher the education higher the age at marriage. One could build up the argument like this: For purposes of getting high levels of education the youngsters spend about 16 years of their life in educational institutions. Let us say they complete their education at the age of 22 years. After completing education they spend 2-3 years for establishing themselves in their careers. During this period continue deferring their marriage. By the time they decide about their marriage they are about 25 years. Compare this age at marriage with the age at marriage of 16 years. Obviously with this higher age at marriage there is a reduction in the reproductive period of women. Similarly we can develop logic in support of other proposed relationships.
4. **Make an inventory of propositions.** The proposed relationships under item 2 about could be the examples of propositions.
5. **Arrange these propositions in a sequential order**. These propositions can be arranged sequentially.
6. **Schematic diagram of the theoretical model be given**

Voluntary Job Turnover:

- ***Inventory of variables:***

  Equity of pay, job complexity, participation of decision making, job satisfaction, job performance, labor market conditions, number of organization, personal characteristics, expectation of finding an alternatives, intentions to quit, job turnover.

Requirement:

Apply all the components of theoretical framework

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Lesson 11

PROBLEM DEFINITION AND RESEARCH PROPOSAL

The research process consists of a number of steps. The first step in any research is selecting the topic, which could start from the broad area of interest. There is no set formula for the identification of a topic of research. The best guide is to conduct research on something that interest you. Nevertheless, there could be a variety of sources like: personal experiences, emerging curiosities from the issues being reported in the mass media, developments in the knowledge, solving problems (relating to an organization, a family, education, and economy), and "hot" issues pertaining to everyday life.

Broad area of interest could be „labor unions." As one could see from the literature, there are a large number of books and perhaps thousands of articles covering various aspects of labor unions. These articles and books have been written by researchers hailing from different subject specialties and using variety of perspectives. Therefore the researcher should narrow down the topic to some specific aspect of labor unions. For example, to what extent do the labor unions protect the rights of female workers?

Techniques for Narrowing a Topic into a Research Question:

In order to narrow down the focus of research, try to get the background information from different sources. For example:

1. ***Examine the literature:***
   Published articles are an excellent source of ideas for research questions. They are usually at an appropriate level of specificity and suggest research questions that focus on the following:
   a. Explore unexpected findings discovered in previous research.
   b. Follow suggestions an author gives for future research at the end of an article.
   c. Extend an existing explanation or theory to a new topic or setting.
   d. Challenge findings or attempt to refute a relationship.
   e. Specify the intervening process and consider linking relations.
2. ***Talk over ideas with others:***
   a. Ask people who are knowledgeable about the topic for questions about it that they have thought of.
   b. Seek out those who hold opinions that differ from yours on the topic and discuss possible research questions with them.
3. ***Apply to a specific context:***
   a. Focus the topic into a specific historical period of time.
   b. Narrow the topic to a specific society or geographic unit.
   c. Consider which subgroups or categories of people/units are involved and whether there are differences among them.
4. ***Define the aim or desired outcome of the study:***
   a. Will the research question be for an exploratory, explanatory, or descriptive study?
   b. Will the study involve applied or basic research?

From the Research Question to Hypotheses:

Tentative answers to the research question help in the identification of variables that could be used as explanatory factors for building up the argumentation in the development of propositions relevant to the topic. In our example the factors may be the prospects of membership of female workers of labor unions, actual membership, support of their men folk for membership, participation in the general body meetings, membership of the executive body of labor union, and so on. These very propositions become the basis of testable hypotheses. Similarly, the inventory of the propositions is helpful in developing the theoretical framework for the research project.

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Problem Definition:

After the interviews and the literature review, the researcher is in a position to narrow down the problem from its original broad base and define the issues of concern more clearly. It is critical that the focus of further research be unambiguously identified and defined. Problem definition or problem statement is a clear, precise, and succinct statement of the question or issue that is to be investigated with the goal of finding an answer or solution. For example the problem could pertain to (1) existing business problems where the manager is looking for a solution, (2) situation that may not pose any current problems but which the manager feels have scope for improvement, (3) areas where some conceptual clarity is needed for better theory building, or (4) situations in which a researcher is trying to answer a research question empirically because of interest in the topic.

Sponsored Researches:

So far we have been discussing research project primarily from the perspective that a researcher is likely to carry the study on his/her own initiative. Although such an initiator can be a business manager or Organizational Management trying to arrest some of the issues in the organization, yet the actual researcher may be a hired consultant. In such a situation the researcher has to ascertain the decision maker‟s objectives. There might simply be some symptoms, and just like the iceberg principle, the dangerous part of many business problems is neither visible to nor understood by business managers. These symptoms are the management dilemmas which have to be translated into management question and then into research question(s). The management may hire the services of research specialists to do this assignment. As a result the management dilemmas get identified and delineated in the *Terms of Reference,* and consultants may be engaged to carry out the study. In such situations many of the steps (review of literature, theoretical framework, and hypotheses) that have been discussed earlier may be skipped. Certainly the management takes the research decisions keeping in view the urgency of the study, timing of the study, availability of the information, and more importantly the cost benefit equation of the study.

The Research Proposal:

A research *proposal* is a document that presents a plan for a project to reviewers for evaluation. It can be a supervised project submitted to instructors as part of an educational degree (e.g. a Master‟s thesis or a Ph.D. dissertation) or it can be a research project proposed to a funding agency. Its purpose is to convince reviewers that the researcher is capable of successfully conducting the proposed research project. Reviewers have more confidence that a planned project will be successfully completed if the proposal is well written and organized, and carefully planned.

The proposal is just like a research report, but it is written before the research project begins. A proposal describes the research problem and its importance, and gives a detailed account of the methods that will be used and why they are appropriate.

A proposal for quantitative research has most of the parts of a research report: a title, an abstract, a problem statement, a literature review, a method or design section, and a bibliography. It lacks results, discussion, and conclusions section. The proposal has a plan for data collection and analysis. It frequently includes a schedule of the steps to be undertaken and an estimate of the time required for each step.

For funded projects the researchers need to show a track record of past success in the proposal, especially if they are going to be the in charge of the project. Proposals usually include curriculum vitae, letters of support from other researchers, and record if past research.

Research Proposal Sections:

Introduction

- Background of the study

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- Objectives
- Significance

Research Design

- Data collection technique (survey, experiment, qualitative technique)
- Population
- Sample
- Tool of data collection
- Data Gathering
- Data processing and analysis

Report writing

Budget

Time Schedule

Team of Researchers

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Lesson 12

THE RESEARCH PROCESS

Research task is usually treated as a sequential process involving several clearly defined steps. No one claims that research requires completion of each step before going to the next. Recycling, circumventing, and skipping occur. Some steps are begun out of sequence, some are carried out simultaneously, and some may be omitted. Despite these variations, the idea of sequence is useful for developing a project and for keeping the project orderly as it unfolds.

Various approaches suggest somewhat different steps – ranging from five steps to eleven steps. The variation may be due to purposes, and methods used by the researches, though some researchers may combine some of the steps. Also some writers may portray the same steps in a linear way; others may put them in a cyclical form. These steps can be:

1. Broad Problem Area

The process begins with a researcher selecting a *topic* – a general area of study or issue such as divorce, crime, aging, marketing, or powerful elites. A topic appears to be too broad for conducting research. The specific issues that need to be researched within the situation may not be identified at this stage. Such issues might pertain to (1) problem currently existing in an organizational setting that need to be solved (sexual harassment), (2) areas that a manager believes need to be improved in the organization (improving the existing policies), (3) a conceptual or theoretical issue that needs to be tightened up for basic researcher or to understand certain phenomenon (conceptual definition of harassment), and (4) some research questions that a basic researcher wants to answer empirically (impact of harassment on the performance of the workers).

2. Preliminary Data Collection

This step may be considered as part of the **exploratory** research. An exploration typically begins with a search for published data and studies. Such sources can provide secondary data which becomes part of the background information (about the organization, groups of people, context of the issue). Some secondary sources of data are statistical bulletins, government publications, information published or unpublished, case studies, online data, web sites, and the Internet. In addition, the researchers often seek out people who are well informed on the topic, especially those who have clearly stated positions on controversial aspects of the problem. Such persons can be the professional researchers, or the informants to whom the issues relate. In certain situations it may be appropriate to have some focus group discussions with the relevant people. Such discussions help in the identification of variables and having clarification of the issue

3. Problem Definition

After having discussions with the professionals as well as with the persons to whom the issue relates, and the review of literature, the researcher is in a position to narrow down from its original broad base and define the issue clearly. Translate the broad issue into a research question. As part of the applied research convert the management dilemma into a management question, and then on to research question that fits the need to resolve the dilemma. The symptoms of a problem might help tracing the real problem. For example a productivity decline of workers may be an issue. The management may have tried to solve it by the provision of incentive but did not work. The researcher may have to dig deep and find the possible factors like the morale and motivation of the workers having some other antecedents. There could be similar other broad issues which have to be narrowed down to research questions like:

1. To what extent has the new advertising campaign been successful in creating the high quality, consumer-centered corporate image that it was intended to produce?
2. Has the new packaging affected the sale of the products?

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3. Will the day care centers affect the productivity of female workers?
4. Why the divorce rate is on the increase in Pakistan?
5. Why the family in Pakistan is changing?
6. What could be the impact of changing family patterns on the living of senior citizens?

4. Theoretical Framework

Consultations with the informants and professionals, and the review of literature should have helped in the identification of different factors that are considered to be relevant to the topic. The researcher has to make logical relationship among several factors identified earlier. This will help in the delineation of the theoretical framework. The theoretical framework discusses the interrelationships among the variables that are deemed to be integral to the dynamics of the situation being investigated. Developing such a conceptual framework helps to postulate or hypothesize and test certain relationships.

We have already discussed the components of a theoretical framework.

5. Generation of Hypotheses

Once we have identified the important variables relevant to an issue and established the logical reasoning in the theoretical framework, we are in a position to test whether the relationships that have been theorized do in fact hold true. By testing these relationships scientifically, we are in a position to obtain reliable information to determine the relationship among the variables. The results of these tests offer us part of the answers to the formulated research questions, whether these relate basic research or to applied research.

6. Research Design

Research design is a master plan specifying the methods and procedures for collecting and analyzing the needed information. It is a framework or the blueprint that plans the action for research project. The objectives of the study determined during the early stages of the research are included in the design to ensure that the information collected is appropriate for solving the problem. The researcher must specify the sources of information, and the research method or technique (survey or experiment, for example) to be followed in the study.

Broadly there are six basic research methods for descriptive and causal research: surveys, experiments, observation, communication analysis (content analysis), case study, focus group discussion. Use of secondary data may be another method where the data may have been collected by using any of the six basic methods listed earlier. The objectives of the research, the available data sources the urgency of the decision and the cost of obtaining the data will determine the method to be chosen.

Surveys: The most common method of generating primary data is through surveys. Survey is a research technique in which information is gathered from a sample of people using a questionnaire. The task of writing a list of questions and designing the exact format of the printed or written questionnaire is an essential aspect of the development of survey research design.

Research investigators may choose to contact the respondents in person, by telephone, by mail, or on the internet. Each of these techniques has advantages and disadvantages. The researcher‟s task is to choose the most appropriate one for collecting the information needed.

Experiments: Experiments hold the greatest potential for establishing cause-and-effect relationships. The use of experimentation allows investigation of changes in one variable, such as productivity, while manipulating one or more variables, perhaps social rewards or monetary rewards, under controlled conditions. Ideally, experimental control provides a basis for isolating causal factors, because outside (or exogenous) influences do not come into play.

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An experiment controls conditions so that one or more variables can be manipulated in order to test a hypothesis. In the laboratory experiments, compared with the field experiment, it is possible to create controlled conditions for the manipulation of one or more variables and see its effect on the dependent variable by holding the extraneous factors constant.

Observation techniques: Observation can be non-participant or participant. In many situations the objective of a research project is merely to record what can be observed – for example the number of automobiles that pass the proposed site for a gas station. This can be mechanically recorded or observed by any person. This is an unobtrusive study without a respondent‟s direct participation. In participant observation studies, the researcher takes part in the day to day activities, interviews them, and makes observations. Such a study generates qualitative data and lasts for a long duration.

Communication analysis: It is also called content analysis which means gathering and analyzing the content of the text. The content refers to words, meanings, pictures, symbols, ideas, themes, or any message that can be communicated. The text is anything written, visual, or spoken that serves as a medium of communication. It includes books, newspapers, advertisements, speeches, official documents, films or videotapes, photographs, articles of clothing, or works of art.

Case study: It is an in-depth analysis of a unit which could be an individual person, a couple, a group, or an organization. It is more like a clinical analysis in retrospect; starting from the effect and tracing the reasons back in time. The researcher takes the history of the situation and makes use of any other relevant information about the case to identify the factors leading to the present situation.

Focus group discussions: It is a discussion of an issue by 6-12 persons with a moderator for 1-2 hours. The issue can be a public concern, a product, a television program, a political candidate, or a policy. Focus groups are useful in exploratory research or to generate new ideas for hypotheses, and the interpretation of results. It produces qualitative information which may compliment the quantitative data.

Researchers try to evaluate different research designs and select the most appropriate one that helps in getting the relevant information. There is no one best research design for all situations.

7. Data Collection, Data Processing, and Analysis

Data collection is integral part of the research design, though we are dealing it separately. Data collection is determined by the research technique selected for the project. Data can be collected in a variety of ways, in different settings – field or lab – and from different sources. It could include *interviews* – face to face interviews, telephone interviews, computer-assisted interviews, and interviews through electronic media; *questionnaires* that either personally administered, sent through mail, or electronically administered; *observation* of individuals and events which could be participant or non-participant.

Once the fieldwork has been completed, the data must be converted into a format that will answer the research questions and or help testing the hypotheses. Data processing generally begins with the editing and coding of the data. Editing involves checking the data collection forms for omissions, legibility, and consistency in classification. The editing process corrects problems such as interviewer errors prior to the data are transferred to a computer. Coding may be the assigning of numbers or symbols before it goes to the computer. The computer can help in making tables and the application of different statistics.

Analysis is the application of reasoning to understand and interpret the data that have been collected. The appropriate analytical technique is to be determined by the research design, and the nature of the data collected.

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8. Testing the Hypotheses; Answering the Research Questions

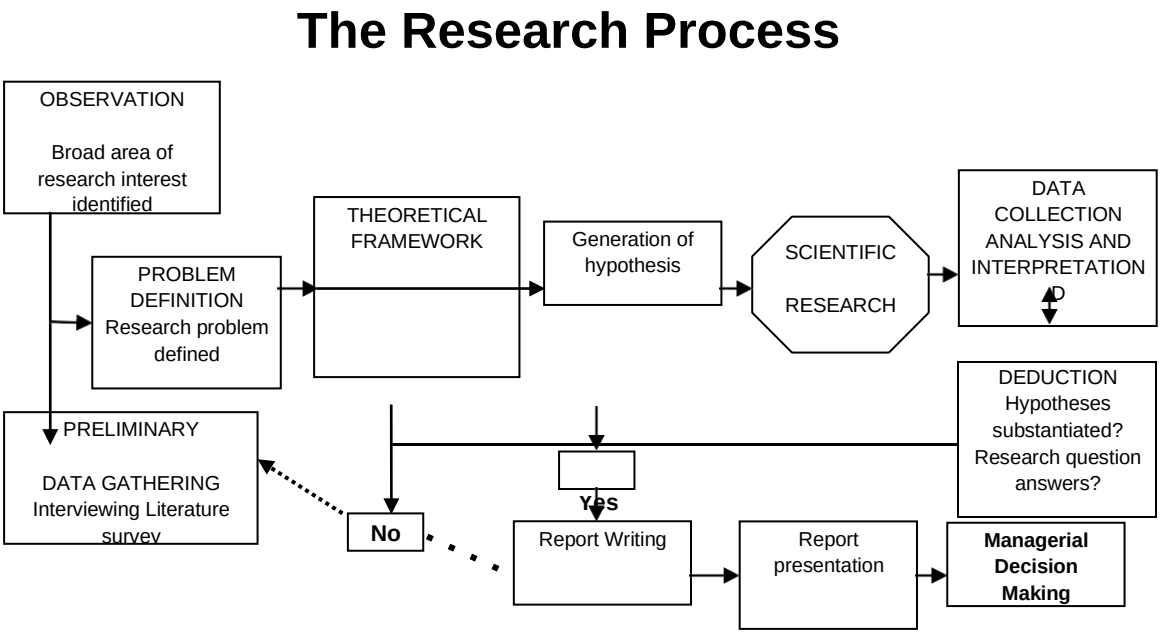
The analysis and interpretation of the data shall be the means to testing the formulated hypotheses as well as finding answers to the research questions. In case of applied research, the research should be helpful in finding solutions to the problems of the organization or society. Making recommendations may also be part of this process.

9. Report Writing

The research report should communicate the research findings effectively. All too often the report is a complicated statement of the study‟s technical aspects and sophisticated research methods. If the study has been conducted for a business management, often the management is not interested in detailed reporting of the research design and statistical findings but wants only the summary of the findings. Research is only as good as the applications made of it. Nevertheless, the research report becomes a historical document, a record that may be referred to in later studies. In case of research for academic purposes the research findings become part of the body of knowledge, and the research may producing research papers for publication in professional journals.

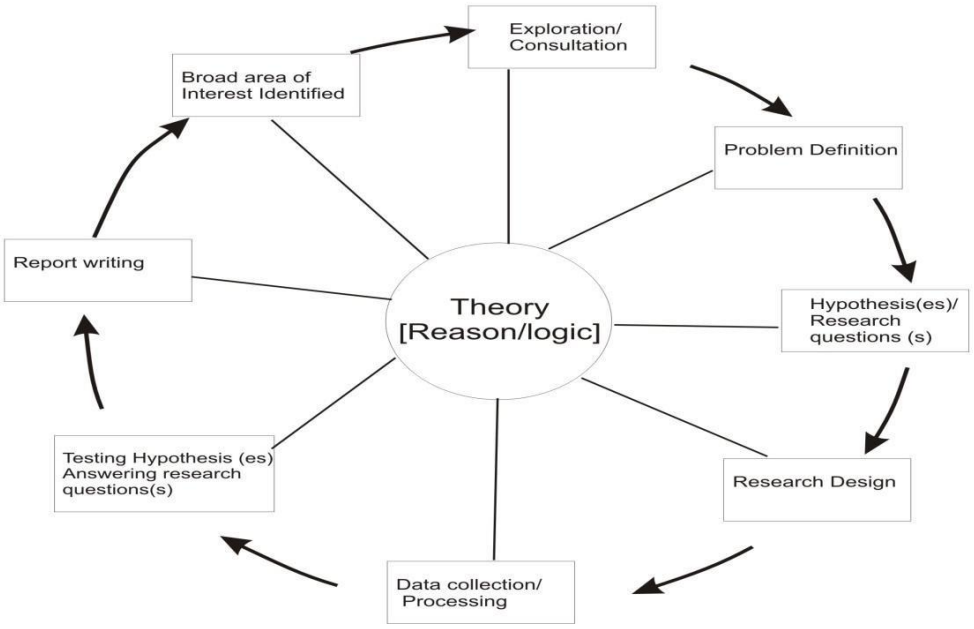
The report has to be presented in the format as it may have been part of the terms of reference if it is a sponsored study. In case of a dissertation the Universities have some standardized styles which have to be followed. Similarly the research papers have to be prepared in accordance with the format specified by the professional journals.

The graphic presentation of the research process may be like this:



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STEPS IN SOCIOLOGICAL INVESTIGATION



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Lesson 13

ETHICAL ISSUES IN RESEARCH

Ethics are norms or standards of behavior that guide moral choices about our behavior and our relationships with others. The goal of ethics in research is to ensure that no one is harmed or suffers adverse consequences from research activities. This objective is usually achieved. However, unethical activities are pervasive and include violating nondisclosure agreements, breaking respondent confidentiality, misrepresenting results, deceiving people, invoicing irregularities, avoiding legal liability, and more.

As discussed earlier, ethical questions are philosophical questions. There is no general agreement among philosophers about the answers to such questions. However the rights and obligations of individuals are generally dictated by the norms of society. Societal norms are codes of behavior adopted by a group; they suggest what a member of a group ought to do under given circumstances. Nevertheless, with changing situations people continue differing with each other whereby societal norms may undergo changes. Codes and regulations guide researchers and sponsors. Review boards and peer groups help researchers examine their research proposals for ethical dilemmas. Responsible researchers anticipate ethical dilemmas and attempt to adjust the design, procedures, and protocols during the planning process rather than treating them as afterthought. Ethical research requires personal integrity from the researcher, the project manager, and the research sponsor.

Codes of ethic applicable at each stage of the research

Goal: To ensure that no one is harmed or suffers adverse consequences from research activities.

Unethical activities

- Violating nondisclosure agreements.
- Breaking respondent confidentiality.
- Misrepresenting results.
- Deceiving people.
- Invoicing irregularities.
- Avoiding legal liability.

Ethical Issues

- Remain to be issues.
- Local norms suggest what ought to be done under the given circumstances.
- Codes of ethics developed to guide researchers and sponsors.
- Review Boards and peer groups help sorting out ethical dilemmas.

Anticipate ethical dilemmas

- Adjust the design, procedures, and protocols accordingly.
- Research ethics require personal integrity of the researcher, the project manager, and research sponsor.

Parties in Research

Mostly three parties:

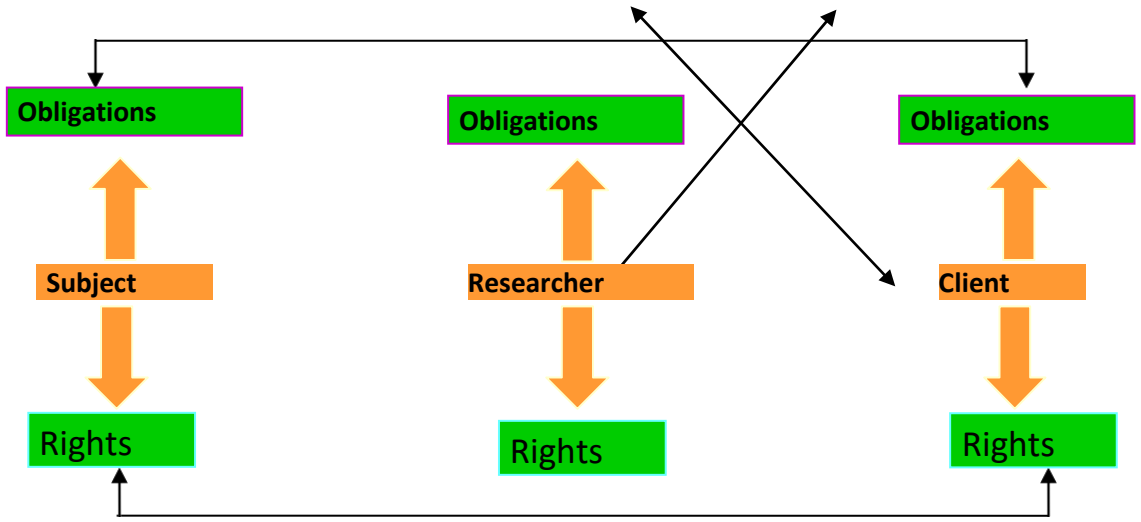
- The researcher
- The sponsoring client (user)
- The respondent (subject)
- Interaction requires ethical questions.
- Each party expects certain rights and feels certain obligations.

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General Rights and Obligations of Parties Concerned

In most research situations, three parties are involved: the *researcher*, the *sponsoring client (user)*, and the *respondent (subject)*. The interaction of each of these parties with one or both of the other two identifies a series of ethical questions. Consciously or unconsciously, each party expects certain rights and feels certain obligations towards the other parties.

Interaction of rights and obligations of parties in research



Ethical Treatment of Participants

When ethics are discussed in research design, we often think first about protecting the rights of the participant, respondent, or subject. Whether data are gathered in an experiment, interview, observation, or survey, the respondent has many rights to be safeguarded. In general the research must be designed so that a respondent does not suffer physical harm, discomfort, pain, embarrassment, or loss of privacy. To safeguard against these, the researcher should follow three guidelines;

1. Explain study benefits.
2. Explain respondent rights and protections.
3. Obtain informed consent.

Benefits:

Whenever direct contact is made with a respondent, the researcher should discuss the study‟s benefits, being careful to neither overstate nor understate the benefits. An interviewer should begin an introduction with his or her name, the name of the research organization, and a brief description of the purpose and benefit of the research. This puts the respondent at ease, let them know to whom they are speaking, and motivates them to answer questions truthfully. In short, knowing why one is being asked questions improve cooperation through honest disclosure of purpose. Inducements to participate, financial or otherwise, should not be disproportionate to the task or presented in a fashion that results in coercion.

Sometimes the actual purpose and benefits of the study or experiment must be concealed from the respondents to avoid introducing bias. The need for concealing objectives leads directly to the problem of deception.

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Lesson 14

ETHICAL ISSUES IN RESEARCH (Cont.)

Ethics are norms or standards of behavior that guide moral choices about our behavior and our relationships with others. The goal of ethics in research is to ensure that no one is harmed or suffers adverse consequences from research activities. This objective is usually achieved. However, unethical activities are pervasive and include violating nondisclosure agreements, breaking respondent confidentiality, misrepresenting results, deceiving people, invoicing irregularities, avoiding legal liability, and more.

Deception:

Deception occurs when the respondents are told only part of the truth or when the truth is fully compromised. Some believe this should never occur. Others suggest two reasons for deception: (1) to prevent biasing the respondents before the survey or experiment and (2) to protect the confidentiality of a third party (e.g. the sponsor). Deception should not be used in an attempt to improve response rates.

The benefits to be gained by deception should be balanced against the risks to the respondents. When possible, an experiment or interview should be redesigned to reduce the reliance on deception. Use of deception is inappropriate unless deceptive techniques are justified by the study‟s expected scientific, educational, or applied value and equally effective alternatives that do not use deception are not feasible. And finally, the respondents must have given their informed consent before participating in the research.

Informed Consent:

Securing informed consent from respondents is a matter of fully disclosing the procedures of the proposed survey or other research design before requesting permission to proceed with the study. There are exceptions that argue for a signed consent form. When dealing with children, it is wise to have a parent or other person with legal standing sign a consent form.

If there is a chance the data could harm the respondent or if the researchers offer any limited protection of confidentiality, a signed form detailing the types of limits should be obtained. For most business research, oral consent is sufficient.

In situations where respondents are intentionally or accidentally deceived, they should be debriefed once the research is complete.

Debriefing:

It involves several activities following the collection of data:

- Explanation of any deception.
- Description of the hypothesis, goal, or purpose of the study.
- Post study sharing of the results.
- Post study follow-up medical or psychological attention.

First, the researcher shares the truth of any deception with the participants and all the reasons for using deception in the context of the study‟s goals. In cases where severe reactions occur, follow-up medical or psychological attention should be provided to continue to ensure the participants remain unharmed by the research.

Even when the research does not deceive the respondents, it is a good practice to offer them follow-up information. This retains the goodwill of the respondent, providing an incentive to participate in future research projects. For surveys and interviews, respondents can be offered a brief report of the findings. Usually they would not ask for additional information.

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For experiments, all participants should be debriefed in order to put the experiment in context. Debriefing usually includes a description of the hypothesis being tested and the purpose of the study. Participants who were not deceived still benefit from the debriefing session. They will be able to understand why the experiment was created. The researchers also gain important insight into what the participants thought about during and after the experiment.

To what extent do debriefing and informed consent reduce the effects of deception? Research suggests that the majority of the respondents do not resent temporary deception and may have more positive feelings about the value of the research after debriefing than those who didn‟t participate in the study.

Rights to Privacy

All individuals have right to privacy, and researchers must respect that right. The privacy guarantee is important not only to retain validity of the research but also to protect respondents. The confidentiality of the survey answers is an important aspect of the respondents‟ right to privacy.

Once the guarantee of confidentiality is given, protecting that confidentiality is essential. The researcher protects the confidentiality in several ways;

- Obtaining signed nondisclosure documents.
- Restricting access to respondent identification.
- Revealing respondent information only with written consent.
- Restricting access to data instruments where the respondent is identified.
- Nondisclosure of data subsets.

Privacy is more than confidentiality. A **right to privacy** means one has the right to refuse to be interviewed or to refuse to answer any question in an interview. Potential participants have a right to privacy in their own homes including not admitting researchers and not answering telephones. To address these rights, ethical researchers do the following:

- Inform respondents of their right to refuse to answer any questions or participate in the study.
- Obtain permission to interview respondents.
- Schedule field and phone interviews.
- Limit the time required for participation.
- Restrict observation to public behavior only.

The obligation to be truthful: When a subject willingly agrees to participate, it is generally expected that he or she will provide truthful answers. Honest cooperation is main obligation of the respondent or the subject.

Ethics and the Sponsor

There are also ethical considerations to keep in mind when dealing with the research client or sponsor has the right to receive ethically conducted research.

Confidentiality of Sponsor

Some sponsors wish to undertake research without revealing themselves. They have a right to several types of confidentiality, including sponsor nondisclosure, purpose nondisclosure, and findings nondisclosure.

Companies have the right to dissociate themselves from sponsorship of a research project. This type of confidentiality is called **sponsorship nondisclosure.** Due to sensitive nature of the management dilemma or the research question, sponsor may hire an outside consulting or research firm to complete research project. This is often done when a company is testing a new product idea, to avoid potential consumers from being influenced by company‟s current image or industry standing.

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Purpose nondisclosure involves protecting the purpose of the study or its details. A research sponsor may be testing a new idea that is not yet patented and may not want the competition to know its plans. It may be investigating employee complaints and may not want to spark union activity. Finally, even if a sponsor feels no need to hide its identity or the study‟s purpose, most sponsors want the research data and findings to be confidential; at least until the management decision is made. Thus sponsors usually demand and receive **findings nondisclosure** between themselves or their researchers and any interested but unapproved parties.

Right to Quality Research

An important ethical consideration is the sponsor‟s **right to quality** research. This right entails:

- Providing research design appropriate for the research question.
- Maximizing the sponsor‟s value for the resources expended.
- Providing data handling and reporting techniques appropriate for the data collected.

Sponsor's Ethics

Occasionally, research specialists may be asked by the sponsors to participate in unethical behavior. Compliance by the researcher would be a breach of ethical standards. Some examples to be avoided are;

- Violating respondent confidentiality.
- Changing data or creating false data to meet the desired objective.
- Changing data presentation or interpretations.
- Interpreting data from a biased perspective.
- Omitting sections of data analysis and conclusions.
- Making recommendations beyond the scope of data collected.

Researchers and Team Members

Another ethical responsibility of researchers is their team‟s safety as well as their own. The responsibility for ethical behavior rests with the researcher who, along with assistants, is charged with protecting the anonymity of both the sponsor and the respondent.

Safety: It is the researcher‟s responsibility to design a project so the safety of all interviewers, surveyors, experimenters, or observers is protected. Several factors may be important to consider in ensuring a researcher‟s **right to safety.**

Ethical behavior of Assistants: Researchers should require ethical compliance from team members just as sponsors expect ethical behavior from researcher. Assistants are expected to carry out the sampling plan, to interview or observe respondents without bias, and to accurately record all necessary data.

Protection of Anonymity: Researchers and assistants should protect the confidentiality of the sponsor‟s information and anonymity of the respondents. Each researcher handling data should be required to sign a confidentiality and nondisclosure statement.

Professional Standards: Various standards of ethics exist for the professional researcher. Many corporations, professional associations, and universities have **code of ethics.** These codes of ethic have to be enforced.

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Lesson 15

MEASUREMENT OF CONCEPTS

In everyday usage, measurement occurs when an established yardstick verifies the height, weight, or another feature of a physical object. How well you like a song, a painting, or the personality of a friend is also measurement. In a dictionary sense, to measure is to discover the extent, dimensions, quantity, or capacity of something, especially by comparison with a standard. We measure casually in daily life, but in research the requirements for measurement are rigorous.

Certain things lend themselves to easy measurement through the use of appropriate instruments, as for example, physiological phenomena pertaining to human beings such as blood pressure, pulse rates, and body temperature, as well as certain physical attributes such as height and weight. But when we get into the realm of people‟s subjective feelings, attitudes, ideology, deviance, and perceptions, the measurement of these factors or variables becomes difficult. Like the natural scientist who invents indirect measures of the "invisible" objects and forces of the physical world (magnetism – the force that moves a metal toward the magnet), the social researcher devises measures for difficult-to-observe aspects of the social world. For example, suppose you heard a principal complain about teacher morale in a school. Teacher morale is an empirical reality, and we can create some instrument for its measurement.

Measurement in Quantitative and Qualitative Research

Both qualitative and quantitative researchers use careful, systematic methods to gather high quality data. Yet, differences in the styles of research and the types of data mean they approach the measurement process differently. Designing precise ways to measure variables is a vital step in planning a study for quantitative researchers. Qualitative researchers use wider variety of techniques to measure and create new measures while collecting data. The two approaches to measurement have three distinctions.

One difference between the two styles involves timing. Quantitative researchers extensively think about variables and convert them into specific actions during a planning stage that occurs before and separate from gathering or analyzing data. Measurement for qualitative researchers occurs in the data collection process, and only a little occurs in a separate, planning stage prior to data gathering.

A second difference involves the data itself. Quantitative researchers want to develop techniques that can produce quantitative data (i.e. data in the form of numbers). Thus, the researcher moves from abstract ideas, or variables, to specific data collection techniques to precise numerical information produced by the techniques. The numerical information is an empirical representation of the abstract ideas. Data for qualitative researchers sometimes is in the form of numbers; more often it includes written or spoken word, actions, sounds, symbols, physical objects, or visual images. The qualitative researcher does not convert all observations into a single, common medium such as numbers. Instead he or she develops many flexible, ongoing processes to measure that leaves the data in various shapes, sizes, and forms.

All researchers combine ideas and data to analyze the social world. In both research styles, data are empirical representation of concepts, and measurement is a process that links data to concepts.

A third difference is how the two styles make such linkages. Quantitative researchers contemplate and reflect on concepts before they gather data. They construct measurement techniques that bridge concepts and data. The measurement techniques define what the data will be and are directions for gathering data.

Qualitative researchers also reflect on ideas before data collection, but they develop many, if not most, of their concepts during data collection activities. Researchers start gathering data and creating

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ways to measure based what they encounter. As they gather data, they reflect on the process and develop new ideas. The ideas give them direction and suggest new ways to measure.

Here we shall focus on quantitative measurement. Here measurement consists of assigning numbers to empirical events in compliance with set rules. This definition implies that measurement is a three-part process:

1. Selecting observable empirical events.
2. Developing a set of mapping rules: a scheme for assigning numbers or symbols to represent aspects of the event being measured.
3. Applying the mapping rule(s) to each observation of that event.

Assume you are studying people who attend an auto show where all new models are on display introduced in a specific year. You are interested in learning the male-to female ratio among attendees. You observe those who enter the show area. If a person is female, you record an F; if male, an M. Any other symbols such as 0 and 1 may also be used if you know what group the symbol identifies.

Researchers might also want to measure the desirability of the styling of the new Espace van. They interview a sample of visitors and assign, with a different mapping rule, their opinions to the following scale:

What is your opinion of the styling of the Espace van?

Very desirable 5_____4_____3_____2_____1 Very undesirable

We can assign a weightage (score) like:

5 if it is very desirable

4 if desirable

3 if neither

2 if undesirable

1 if very undesirable.

All measurement theorists would call such opinion rating scale as a form of measurement.

What is measured?

Variable being studied in research may be classified as objects or as properties. **Objects** include the things of ordinary experience, such as tables, people, books, and automobiles. Objects also include things that are not as concrete, such as genes, attitudes, neutrons, and peer group pressures. **Properties** are the characteristics of the objects. A person‟s physical properties may be stated in terms of weight, height, and posture. Psychological properties include attitudes, intelligence, motivation, perceptions, etc. Social properties include leadership ability, class affiliation, or status. These and many other properties of an individual can be measured in a research study.

In a literal sense, researchers do not measure either objects or properties. They measure indicants of the properties or indicants of the properties of the objects. The properties like age, years of experience, and the number of calls made per week are easier to indicate and there is expected to be lot of agreement.

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In contrast, it is not easy to measure properties like "motivation," "ability to stand stress," "problem-solving ability," and "persuasiveness." Since each property cannot be measured directly, one must infer its presence or absence by observing some indicant or pointer measurement. When you begin to make these inferences, there is often disagreement about how to operationalize the indicants.

The preceding discussion suggests two types of variables: one lends itself to objective and precise measurement; the other is more vague and does not lend itself to accurate measurement because of its subjective nature. However, despite the lack of physical measuring devices to measure the latter type, there are ways to tapping the subjective feelings and perceptions of individuals. One technique is to reduce the abstract notions, or concepts such as motivation, involvement, satisfaction, buyer behavior, stock market exuberance, and the like, to observable behavior and characteristics. In other words, the abstract notions are broken down into observable characteristic behavior. Reducing the abstract concepts to render them measurable in a tangible way is called operationalizing the concepts.

Parts of the Measurement Process

When a researcher measures, he or she takes a concept, idea, or construct and develops a measure (i.e. a technique, a process, a procedure) by which he or she can observe the idea empirically. Quantitative researchers primarily follow a deductive route. To begin with the abstract idea, follow with a measurement procedure, and end with empirical data that represent the ideas. Qualitative researchers primarily follow inductive route. They begin with empirical data, follow with abstract ideas, follow with processes relating with ideas and data, and end with a mixture of ideas and data.

Researchers use two processes: conceptualization and operationalization in measurement.

a. Conceptualization

Conceptualization is the process of taking a construct and refining it by giving it a conceptual or theoretical definition. A conceptual definition is definition in abstract, theoretical terms. It refers to other ideas or constructs. There is no magical way to turn a construct into a precise conceptual definition. It involves thinking carefully, observing directly, consulting with others, reading what others have said, and trying possible definitions.

A good definition has one clear, explicit, and specific meaning. There is no ambiguity or vagueness in the concepts (e.g. street gang, morale, motivation, social class, consumer satisfaction). A single construct can have several definitions, and people may disagree over definitions. Conceptual definitions are linked to theoretical frameworks and to value positions. For example, a conflict theorist may define *social class* as the power and property a group of people in society has or lacks. A structural functionalist defines it in terms of individuals who share a social status, life-style, or subjective identification. Although people disagree over definitions, the researcher should always state explicitly which definition he or she is using.

Before you can measure, you need a concept. You also need to distinguish what you are interested in from other things. The idea that you first need a construct or concept of what is to be measured simply makes sense. How can you observe or measure something unless you know what you are looking for? For example, we want to measure teacher morale. We first define *teacher morale*. What does the construct *morale* mean? As a variable construct, it takes on different values – high versus low or good versus bad morale. Next we create a measure of this construct. This could take the form of survey questions, an examination of school records, or observations of teachers. Also we distinguish morale from other things in the answers to survey questions, school records, or observations.

How can we develop a conceptual definition of *teacher morale*, or at least a tentative working definition to get started? Look in the everyday understanding of morale – something vague like "how people feel about things." Also look in the dictionary, which gives definitions like "confidence, spirit, zeal, cheerfulness, esprit de corps, and mental condition towards something." Look into the review of

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literature and see how other researchers have defined this concept. In this effort we collect various definitions, parts of definitions, and related ideas, whereby we draw the boundaries of the core idea.

We find that most of these definitions say that morale is a spirit, feeling, or mental condition toward something, or a group feeling. But we are interested in *teacher* morale. We can ask teachers to specify as what does this construct mean to them? One strategy is to make a list of examples of high or low teacher morale. High teacher morale includes saying positive things about the school, not complaining about extra-work or enjoying being with students. Low morale includes complaining a lot, not attending school events unless required to, or looking for other jobs.

Morale involves a feeling toward something else; a person has morale with regard to something. A list of various "somethings" toward which teachers have feelings (e.g. students, parents, pay, the school administration, other teachers, the profession of teaching). Are there several kinds of teacher morale or all these "somethings" aspects of one construct? We have to decide whether morale means a single, general feeling with different parts or dimensions, or several distinct feelings.

What unit of analysis does our construct apply to: a group or an individual? Is morale a characteristic of an individual, of a group, or of both?

A researcher must distinguish the construct of interest from related constructs. How is our construct of teacher morale similar to or different from related concepts? For example, does *morale* differ from *mood*? We decide that mood is more individual and temporary than morale. Morale is a group feeling that includes positive or negative feelings about the future as well as other beliefs and feelings.

Who is a teacher? We have to decide.

b. Operationalization

Operationalization is the process of linking the conceptual definition to a specific set of measurement techniques or procedures. It links the language of theory with the language of empirical measures. Theory is full of abstract concepts, assumptions, relationships, definitions, and causality. Empirical measures describe how people concretely measure specific variables. They refer to specific operations or things people use to indicate the presence of a construct that exists in observable reality. Operationalization is done by looking at the behavioral dimensions, facets, or properties denoted by the concept. These are then translated into observable elements so as to develop an index of measurement of the concept. Operationally defining a concept involves a series of steps.

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Lesson 16

MEASUREMENT OF CONCEPTS (CONTINUED)

b. Operationalization

Operationalization is the process of linking the conceptual definition to a specific set of measurement techniques or procedures. It links the language of theory with the language of empirical measures. Theory is full of abstract concepts, assumptions, relationships, definitions, and causality. Empirical measures describe how people concretely measure specific variables. They refer to specific operations or things people use to indicate the presence of a construct that exists in observable reality. Operationalization is done by looking at the behavioral dimensions, facets, or properties denoted by the concept. These are then translated into observable elements so as to develop an index of measurement of the concept. Operationally defining a concept involves a series of steps. Here is an example.

Operational definition: Dimensions and Elements → an example

Let us try to operationally define **job satisfaction,** a concept of interest to educators, managers, and students alike. What behavioral dimensions or facets or characteristics would we expect to find in people with high job satisfaction? Let us first of all have a conceptual definition of job satisfaction. We can start it like this:

- Employees‟ feelings toward their job.
- Degree of satisfaction that individuals obtain from various roles they play in an organization.
- A pleasurable or positive emotional feeling resulting from the appraisal of one‟s job or job experience.
- Employee‟s perception of how well the job provides those things („some things‟) that are important. These things are the dimensions of job satisfaction.

Dimensions of job satisfaction: For measuring job satisfaction it is appropriate to look at this concept from different angles relating with work. While employed in an organization the workers might be looking for many “things.” Each of these things may be considered as a dimension; a person may be highly satisfied on one dimension and may be least satisfied on the other one. Those things that have usually been considered important at the place of work can be:

- The work itself.
- Pay/fringe benefits.
- Promotion opportunities.
- Supervision.
- Coworkers.
- Working conditions.

On each dimension the researcher has to develop logical arguments showing how this particular aspect (thing) relating to a worker‟s job is important whereby it has a bearing on his/her job satisfaction.

Elements of job satisfaction: It means breaking each dimension further into actual patterns of behavior that would be exhibited through the perception of the workers in an organization. Here again the researcher shall develop logical rationale for using a particular element for measuring a specific dimension. For example let us look at each dimension and some of the corresponding elements:

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- **Work itself: Elements →** Opportunities to learn, sense of accomplishment, challenging work, routine work.
- **Pay/fringe benefits: Elements →** Pay according to qualifications, comparison with other organizations, annual increments, and availability of bonuses, old age benefits, insurance benefits, and other allowances.
- **Promotion opportunities: Elements →** Mobility policy, equitable, dead end job.
- **Supervision: Elements →** Employee centered employee participation in decisions.
- **Coworkers: Elements →** Primary group relations, supportive attitude, level of cohesiveness.
- **Working conditions: Elements →** Lighting arrangements, temperature, cleanliness, building security, hygienic conditions, first aid facility, availability of canteen, availability of toilet facilities, availability of place for prayer.

On each element ask question (s), make statements. Look into the scalability of questions. The responses can be put on a scale indicating from high satisfaction to least satisfaction. In many cases the responses are put on a five point scale (usually called Likert scale).

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Lesson 17

MEASUREMENT OF CONCEPTS (CONTINUED)

STATEMENTS:

No.	Statements	S. Agree	Agree	Undecided	Disagree	S. Disagree
1	I have a good opportunity for advancement in my job					
2	I feel very comfortable with my co-workers					
3	My pay is adequate to meet my necessary expenses					
4	My work gives me a sense of accomplishment					
5	My boss is impolite and cold					
6	My job is a dead-end job					
7	The company of my co-workers is boring					
8	Pay at my level is less as compared to other organizations					
9	Most of the time I am frustrated with my work					
10	My boss praises good work and is supportive					
11	There is a chance of frequent promotions in my job					
12	My co-workers are a source of inspiration for me					
13	I receive reasonable annual increments					
14	My work is very challenging to me					
15	My boss is adept in his work					
16	We have an unfair promotion policy in our organization					
17	Working style of my co-workers i different from mine	s				
18	The old-age benefits are quite adequate					

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19	Most of the time I do routine work					
20	My boss does not delegate powers					
21	Opportunity for promotion is some-what limited here					
22	My co-workers try to take credit of my work					
23	My pay is commensurate with my qualification					

Scales and Indexes

Scales and indexes are often used interchangeably. Social researchers do not use a consistent nomenclature to distinguish between the two.

A scale is a measure in which a researcher captures the intensity, direction, level, or potency of a variable construct. It arranges responses or observations on a continuum or in series of categories. A scale can use a single indicator or multiple indicators.

An index is a measure in which a researcher adds or combines several distinct indicators of a construct into a single score. The composite scores is often a simple sum of the multiple indicators. Indexes are often measured at the interval or ratio level.

Researchers sometimes combine the features of scales and indexes in a single measure. This is common when a researcher has a several indicators that are scales (i.e. that measure intensity or direction). The researcher then adds these indicators together to yield a single score, thereby creating an index.

Types of Scales

A scale refers to any series of items that are arranged progressively according to value or magnitude, into which an item can be placed according to its quantification. In other words, a scale is a continuous spectrum or series of categories.

It is traditional to classify scales of measurement on the basis of the mathematical comparisons that are allowable with these scales. Four types of scales are nominal, ordinal, interval, and ratio.

Nominal Scale

A nominal scale is the one in which the numbers or letters assigned to objects serve as labels for identification or classification. This measurement scale is the simplest type. With nominal data, we are collecting information on a variable that naturally or by design can be grouped into two or more categories that are mutually exclusive, and collectively exhaustive.

Nominal scales are the least powerful of the four scales. They suggest no order or distance relationship and have no arithmetic origin. Nevertheless, if no other scale can be used, one can almost always one set of properties into a set of equivalent classes.

Ordinal Scale

Ordinal scales include the characteristics of the nominal scale plus an indicator of order. If *a* is greater than *b* and *b* is greater than *c*, then *a* is greater than *c*. The use of ordinal scale implies a

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statement of “greater than” or “less than” without stating how much greater or less. Other descriptors can be: “superior to,” “happier than,” “poorer than,” or “above.”

Interval Scale

Interval scales have the power of nominal and ordinal scales plus one additional strength: they incorporate the concept of equality of interval (the distance between 1 and 2 equals the distance between 2 and 3). For example, the elapsed time between 3 and 6 A. M. equals the time between 4 and 7 A. M. One cannot say, however, 6 A.M. is twice as late as 3 A.M. because “zero time” is an arbitrary origin. In the consumer price index, if the base year is 1983, the price level during 1983 will be set arbitrarily as 100. Although this is an equal interval measurement scale, the zero point is arbitrary.

Ratio Scale

Ratio scales incorporate all the powers of the previous scales plus the provision for absolute zero or origin. Ratio data represent the actual amounts of variable. Measures of physical dimensions such as weight, height, distance, and area are the examples. The absolute zero represents a point on the scale where there is an absence of the given attribute. If we hear that a person has zero amount of money, we understand the zero value of the amount.

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Lesson 18

CRITERIA FOR GOOD MEASUREMENT

Now that we have seen how to operationally define variables, it is important to make sure that the instrument that we develop to measure a particular concept is indeed accurately measuring the variable, and in fact, we are actually measuring the concept that we set out to measure. This ensures that in operationally defining perceptual and attitudinal variables, we have not overlooked some important dimensions and elements or included some irrelevant ones. The scales developed could often be imperfect and errors are prone to occur in the measurement of attitudinal variables. The use of better instruments will ensure more accuracy in results, which in turn, will enhance the scientific quality of the research. Hence, in some way, we need to assess the "goodness" of the measure developed.

What should be the characteristics of a good measurement? An intuitive answer to this question is that the tool should be an accurate indicator of what we are interested in measuring. In addition, it should be easy and efficient to use. There are three major criteria for evaluating a measurement tool: validity, reliability, and sensitivity.

Validity

Validity is the ability of an instrument (for example measuring an attitude) to measure what it is supposed to measure. That is, when we ask a set of questions (i.e. develop a measuring instrument) with the hope that we are tapping the concept, how can we be reasonably certain that we are indeed measuring the concept we set out to do and not something else? There is no quick answer.

Researchers have attempted to assess validity in different ways, including asking questions such as "Is there consensus among my colleagues that my attitude scale measures what it is supposed to measure?" and "Does my measure correlate with others‟ measures of the „same‟ concept?" and "Does the behavior expected from my measure predict the actual observed behavior?" Researchers expect the answers to provide some evidence of a measure‟s validity.

What is relevant depends on the nature of the research problem and the researcher‟s judgment. One way to approach this question is to organize the answer according to measure-relevant types of validity. One widely accepted classification consists of three major types of validity: (1) content validity, (2) criterion-related validity, and (3) construct validity.

(1) Content Validity: How well the instrument covers all the aspects, is it upto the level of measuring what it is supposed to measure?

The content validity of a measuring instrument (the composite of measurement scales) is the extent to which it provides adequate coverage of the investigative questions guiding the study. If the instrument contains a representative sample of the universe of subject matter of interest, then the content validity is good. To evaluate the content validity of an instrument, one must first agree on what dimensions and elements constitute adequate coverage. To put it differently, content validity is a function of how well the dimensions and elements of a concept have been delineated. Look at the concept of *feminism* which implies a person‟s commitment to a set of beliefs creating full equality between men and women in areas of the arts, intellectual pursuits, family, work, politics, and authority relations. Does this definition provide adequate coverage of the different dimensions of the concept? Then we have the following two questions to measure *feminism*:

1. Should men and women get equal pay for equal work?
2. Should men and women share household tasks?

These two questions do not provide coverage to all the dimensions delineated earlier. It definitely falls short of adequate content validity for measuring *feminism.*

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A panel of persons to judge how well the instrument meets the standard can attest to the content validity of the instrument. A panel independently assesses the test items for a performance test. It judges each item to be essential, useful but not essential, or not necessary in assessing performance of a relevant behavior.

Face validity is considered as a basic and very minimum index of content validity. Face validity indicates that the items that are intended to measure a concept, do on the face of it look like they measure the concept. For example a few people would accept a measure of college student math ability using a question that asked students: 2 + 2 = ? This is not a valid measure of college-level math ability on the face of it. Nevertheless, it is a subjective agreement among professionals that a scale logically appears to reflect accurately what it is supposed to measure. When it appears evident to experts that the measure provides adequate coverage of the concept, a measure has face validity.

(2) Criterion-Related Validity

Criterion validity uses some standard or criterion to indicate a construct accurately. The validity of an indicator is verified by comparing it with another measure of the same construct in which research has confidence. There are two subtypes of this kind of validity.

Concurrent validity: To have concurrent validity, an indicator must be associated with a preexisting indicator that is judged to be valid. For example we create a new test to measure intelligence. For it to be concurrently valid, it should be highly associated with existing IQ tests (assuming the same definition of intelligence is used). It means that most people who score high on the old measure should also score high on the new one, and vice versa. The two measures may not be perfectly associated, but if they measure the same or a similar construct, it is logical for them to yield similar results.

Predictive validity: Criterion validity whereby an indicator predicts future events that are logically related to a construct is called a predictive validity. It cannot be used for all measures. The measure and the action predicted must be distinct from but indicate the same construct. Predictive measurement validity should not be confused with prediction in hypothesis testing, where one variable predicts a different variable in future. Look at the scholastic assessment tests being given to candidates seeking admission in different subjects. These are supposed to measure the scholastic aptitude of the candidates – the ability to perform in institution as well as in the subject. If this test has high predictive validity, then candidates who get high test score will subsequently do well in their subjects. If students with high scores perform the same as students with average or low score, then the test has low predictive validity.

(3) Construct Validity

Construct validity is for measures with multiple indicators. It addresses the question: If the measure is valid, do the various indicators operate in consistent manner? It requires a definition with clearly specified conceptual boundaries. In order to evaluate construct validity, we consider both theory and the measuring instrument being used. This is assessed through convergent validity and discriminant validity.

Convergent Validity: This kind of validity applies when multiple indicators converge or are associated with one another. Convergent validity means that multiple measures of the same construct hang together or operate in similar ways. For example, we construct "education" by asking people how much education they have completed, looking at their institutional records, and asking people to complete a test of school level knowledge. If the measures do not converge (i.e. people who claim to have college degree but have no record of attending college, or those with college degree perform no better than high school dropouts on the test), then our test has weak convergent validity and we should not combine all three indicators into one measure.

Discriminant Validity: Also called divergent validity, discriminant validity is the opposite of convergent validity. It means that the indicators of one construct hang together or converge, but also

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diverge or are negatively associated with opposing constructs. It says that if two constructs A and B are very different, then measures of A and B should not be associated. For example, we have 10 items that measure political conservatism. People answer all 10 in similar ways. But we have also put 5 questions in the same questionnaire that measure political liberalism. Our measure of conservatism has discriminant validity if the 10 conservatism items hang together and are negatively associated with 5 liberalism ones.

Reliability

The reliability of a measure indicates the extent to which it is without bias (error free) and hence ensures consistent measurement across time and across the various items in the instrument. In other words, the reliability of a measure is an indication of the *stability* and *consistency* with which the instrument measures the concept and helps to assess the „goodness" of measure.

Stability of Measures

The ability of the measure to remain the same over time – despite uncontrollable testing conditions or the state of the respondents themselves – is indicative of its stability and low vulnerability to changes in the situation. This attests to its "goodness" because the concept is stably measured, no matter when it is done. Two tests of stability are test-retest reliability and parallel-form reliability.

(1) Test-retest Reliability: Test-retest method of determining reliability involves administering the same scale to the same respondents at two separate times to test for stability. If the measure is stable over time, the test, administered under the same conditions each time, should obtain similar results. For example, suppose a researcher measures job satisfaction and finds that 64 percent of the population is satisfied with their jobs. If the study is repeated a few weeks later under similar conditions, and the researcher again finds that 64 percent of the population is satisfied with their jobs, it appears that the measure has repeatability. The high stability correlation or consistency between the two measures at time 1 and at time 2 indicates high degree of reliability. This was at the aggregate level; the same exercise can be applied at the individual level. When the measuring instrument produces unpredictable results from one testing to the next, the results are said to be unreliable because of error in measurement.

There are two problems with measures of test-retest reliability that are common to all longitudinal studies. Firstly, the first measure may sensitize the respondents to their participation in a research project and subsequently influence the results of the second measure. Further if the time between the measures is long, there may be attitude change or other maturation of the subjects. Thus it is possible for a reliable measure to indicate low or moderate correlation between the first and the second administration, but this low correlation may be due an attitude change over time rather than to lack of reliability.

(2) Parallel-Form Reliability: When responses on two comparable sets of measures tapping the same construct are highly correlated, we have parallel-form reliability. It is also called equivalent-form reliability. Both forms have similar items and same response format, the only changes being the wording and the order or sequence of the questions. What we try to establish here is the error variability resulting from wording and ordering of the questions. If two such comparable forms are highly correlated, we may be fairly certain that the measures are reasonably reliable, with minimal error variance caused by wording, ordering, or other factors.

Internal Consistency of Measures

Internal consistency of measures is indicative of the homogeneity of the items in the measure that tap the construct. In other words, the items should „hang together as a set," and be capable of independently measuring the same concept so that the respondents attach the same overall meaning to each of the items. This can be seen by examining if the items and the subsets of items in the

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measuring instrument are highly correlated. Consistency can be examined through the inter-item consistency reliability and split-half reliability.

(1) Inter-item Consistency reliability: This is a test of consistency of respondents‟ answers to all the items in a measure. To the degree that items are independent measures of the same concept, they will be correlated with one another.

(2) Split-Half reliability: Split half reliability reflects the correlations between two halves of an instrument. The estimates could vary depending on how the items in the measure are split into two halves. The technique of splitting halves is the most basic method for checking internal consistency when measures contain a large number of items. In the split-half method the researcher may take the results obtained from one half of the scale items **(**e.g. odd-numbered items) and check them against the results from the other half of the items (e.g. even numbered items). The high correlation tells us there is similarity (or homogeneity) among its items.

It is important to note that reliability is a necessary but not sufficient condition of the test of goodness of a measure. For example, one could reliably measure a concept establishing high stability and consistency, but it may not be the concept that one had set out to measure. Validity ensures the ability of a scale to measure the intended concept.

Sensitivity: The sensitivity of a scale is an important measurement concept, particularly when changes in attitudes or other hypothetical constructs are under investigation. Sensitivity refers to an instrument‟s ability to accurately measure variability in stimuli or responses. A dichotomous response category, such as “agree or disagree,” does not allow the recording of subtle attitude changes. A more sensitive measure, with numerous items on the scale, may be needed. For example adding “strongly agree,” “mildly agree,” “neither agree nor disagree,” “mildly disagree,” and “strongly disagree” as categories increases a scale‟s sensitivity.

The sensitivity of a scale based on a single question or single item can also be increased by adding additional questions or items. In other words, because index measures allow for greater range of possible scores, they are more sensitive than single item.

Practicality: The scientific requirements of a project call for the measurement process to be reliable and valid, while the operational requirements call for it to be practical. Practicality has been defined as *economy, convenience*, and *interpretability.*

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Lesson 19

RESEARCH DESIGN

A research design is a master plan specifying the methods and procedures for collecting and analyzing the data. It is a strategy or blueprint that plans the action for carrying through the research project data.

A research design involves a series of rational decision-making choices depending upon the various options available to the researchers. Broadly it is composed of different elements like: the purpose of the study, the unit of analysis, time dimension, mode of observation, sampling design, observation tools, data processing, and data analysis. Let us look at each one of these elements.

1. Purpose of the Study

From the perspective of purpose of the study, a research can be exploratory, descriptive, and explanatory (the distinctions we have already discussed). As we have already covered a number of steps in the research process, at this stage it is assumed that we are pretty sure about what we are looking for whereby we have gone much beyond the stage of an exploratory study (all studies have elements of exploration in them).

Beyond the exploratory stage now we are entering into the formal stage of delineating the plan for data collection, data processing, and data analysis. Here our focus is on whether our study is going to be a *descriptive* or *explanatory.* The essential difference between descriptive and explanatory studies lies in their objectives. If the research is concerned with finding out *who, what, where, when, or how much*, then the study is **descriptive.** If it is concerned with learning why – that is how one variable produces changes in another – it is causal. Research on crime as such is descriptive when it measures the types of crimes committed, how often, when, where, and by whom. In an **explanatory study**, we try to explain relationships among variables – for instance, why the crime rate is higher in locality A than in locality B. Every explanatory study in the beginning is likely to be descriptive as well.

Methodological rigor increases as one moves from exploratory study to explanatory study, which may encompass hypothesis testing involving multiple methods of data collection, sophistications in sampling designs, formulation of instruments of data collection, data processing, and data analysis. Since the purpose of the study is likely to determine how rigorous the research design is likely to be, therefore, the researcher would decide very early on about the purpose of his/her study.

Within the explanatory study, researcher may further decide about the type of investigation i.e. causal versus correlational. The researcher must decide whether a causal or correlational study is needed to find an answer to the issue at hand. The former is done when it is necessary to establish a definitive cause-and-effect relationship. If the researcher just wants a mere identification of important factors "associated with" the problem, then a correlational study is called for. Whether the study is basically a correlational or causal will help in deciding about the mode of observation – survey study or an experimental study.

2. Unit of Analysis

The unit of analysis refers to the level of aggregation of the data collected during the subsequent data analysis stage. If, for instance, the problem statement focuses on how to raise the motivational levels of employees in general, then we are interested in individual employees in the organization and would have to find out what we can do to raise their motivation. Here the unit of analysis is the **individual**. We will be looking at the data gathered from each individual and treating each employee"s response as an individual data source.

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If the researcher is interested in studying two-person interactions, then several two-person groups (also known as dyads) will become the unit of analysis. Analysis of husband-wife interactions in families and supervisor-subordinate relationship at the work place, teacher-student relationship in the educational institution are good examples of dyads as unit of analysis.

If the problem statement is related to group effectiveness, the unit of analysis would be at group level. In other words, even though we may gather relevant data from all individuals comprising, say six groups, we would aggregate the individual data into group data so as to see the differences among six **groups.** If we compare different departments in the organization, then data analysis will be done at the department level – that is, the individuals in the department will be treated as one unit – and comparisons made treating the department as a unit of analysis.

The research question determines the unit of analysis. Keeping the research question in view, it is necessary to decide on the unit of analysis since the data collection methods, sample size, and even the variables included in the framework may sometimes be determined or guided by the level at which the data are aggregated for analysis.

Units of analysis in a study are typically also the *units of observation*. Thus, to study voting intentions, we would interview (observe) individual voters. Sometimes, however, we "observe" our units of analysis indirectly. For example, we might ask husbands and wives their individual voting intentions, for purpose of distinguishing couples who agree and disagree politically. We might want to find out whether political disagreements tend to cause family disharmony, perhaps. In this case, our unit of analysis would be families, though the *unit of observation* would be the individual wives and husbands.

3. Time Dimension

Do we make the observations more or less at one time or over a long period, former called as cross-sectional studies and the latter as longitudinal studies. While planning the strategy for data collection the time dimension may be an important component.

Cross-Sectional Studies are carried out once and represent a snapshot of one point in time. Data are collected just once, perhaps over a period of days or weeks or months, in order to answer the research question.

Longitudinal Studies are repeated over an extended period. The advantage of longitudinal studies is that it can track changes over time. For example, the researcher might want to study employees‟ behavior before and after a change in the top management, so as to know what effects the change accomplished. Here, because data are gathered at two different points in time, the study is not cross-sectional or of the one-shot kind, but is carried longitudinally across a period of time. Such studies, as when data on the dependent variable are gathered at two or more points in time to answer the research question, are called longitudinal. Longitudinal studies can be *panel studies* and *cohort studies* which were discussed earlier.

4. Researcher Control of Variables

In terms of researcher‟s ability to manipulate variables, we can differentiate between experimental and ex post facto design. In an **experiment**, the researcher attempts to control and/or manipulate the variables in the study. It is enough that we can cause variables to be changed or held constant in keeping with our research objectives. Experimental design is appropriate when one wishes to discover whether certain variables produce effects in other variables. Experimentation provides the most powerful support possible for hypothesis of causation.

Experimental studies can be contrived and non-contrived. Research can be done in the natural environment where work proceeds normally (i.e. in non-contrived setting) or in artificial, contrived setting. Correlational studies are invariably conducted in non-contrived settings, whereas most rigorous causal studies are done in contrived lab settings. Correlational studies done in organizations

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are called field studies. Studies conducted to establish cause-and-effect relationship using the same natural environment are called **field experiments.** Here the researcher does not interfere with the natural occurrence of events in as much as independent variable is manipulated.

Experiments done to establish cause and effect relationship beyond the possibility of the least doubt require the creation of an artificial, contrived environment in which all the extraneous factor are strictly controlled. Similar subjects are chosen carefully to respond to certain manipulated stimuli. These studies are referred to as **lab experiments**.

With an **ex post facto** design, investigators have no control over the variables in the sense of being able to manipulate them. They can only report what has happened or what is happening. It is important that the researchers using this design not influence the variables; to do so introduce bias. The researcher is limited to holding factors constant by judicious selection of subjects according to strict sampling procedures and by statistical manipulation of findings. Survey research is an example of such study.

5. Choice of Research Design: Mode of Observation

There could be number of ways to collect the data depending upon whether the study is quantitative or qualitative, descriptive or explanatory, cross-sectional or longitudinal, and contrived or non-contrived, the researcher decides about the mode of observation. The modes could be like: survey, experiment, communication analysis (content analysis) field observation, case study, focus group discussion.

6. Sampling Design

The basic idea of sampling is that by selecting some of the elements in population, we may draw conclusions about the entire population. A population element is the subject on which the measurement is being taken. It is the unit of analysis. Sampling has its own advantages and disadvantages. Depending upon the nature of the study the researchers decides about following appropriate type of sampling design.

7. Observation Tools

Observation tool mostly used by social researchers are: questionnaire, interview schedule, interview guide, and check list. In the research design, the researcher will specify the tools of data collection along the logic justifying the appropriateness of the selected tool.

8. Field Data Collection

Depending upon the mode of observation, the researcher will outline the procedure for field operations. The researcher will try to look after the questions like: How the data will be collected? Who will be responsible for the collections of data? What training will be imparted to the field functionaries? How will the quality control of data be maintained?

9. Data Processing and Data Analysis

In the research design the researcher is required to tell how the data shall be processed (manually, mechanically), and analysis plans explicated. In case the qualitative data are to be quantified the procedures should be spelled out. The procedures for the construction of score Indexes, if any, should be explained. The research design should also say something about the analysis plan, the use of statistics, and the inferences to be drawn.

Survey Research: An Overview

Surveys require asking people, who are called **respondents**, for information, using either verbal or written questions. Questionnaires or interviews are utilized to collect data on the telephone, face-to-face, and through other communication media. The more formal term **sample survey** emphasizes that the purpose of contacting respondents is to obtain a representative sample of the target population.

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Thus, a **survey** is defined as a method of gathering **primary data** based on communication with a representative sample of individuals.

Steps in Conducting a Survey

The survey researcher follows a deductive approach. He or she begins with a theoretical or applied research problem and ends with empirical measurement and data analysis. Once a researcher decides that survey is an appropriate method, basic steps in a research project can broadly be divided into six sub-steps.

1. **Develop the hypothesis; decide on type of survey (mail, interview, telephone); write survey questions (decide on response categories, design lay out)**. The researcher develops an instrument – a survey questionnaire or interview schedule – that he or she uses to measure variables. Respondents read the questions themselves and mark answers on a *questionnaire*. An *interview schedule* is a set of questions read to the respondent by an interviewer, who also records the responses. To simplify the discussion, we will use only the term *questionnaire.*
2. **Plan how to record data; pilot test survey instrument.** When preparing the questionnaire, the researcher thinks ahead to how he or she will record and organize data for analysis. The questionnaire is pilot tested on a small set of respondents similar to those in the final survey.
3. **Decide on target population; get sampling frame; decide on sample size; select the sample.**
4. **Locate respondents; conduct interviews; carefully record data.** The researcher locates sampled respondents in person, by telephone, or by mail. Respondents are given information and instructions on completing the questionnaire or interview.
5. **Enter data into computers; recheck all data; perform statistical analysis on data.**
6. **Describe methods and findings in research report; present findings to others for critique and evaluation.**

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Lesson 20

SURVEY RESEARCH

Research Design can be classified by the *approach* used to gather primary data. There are really two alternatives. We can *observe* conditions, behavior, events, people, or processes. Or we can *communicate* with people about various topics, including participants‟ attitudes, motivations, intentions, and expectations.

The **communication approach** involves surveying people and recording their responses for analysis. The great strength of the survey as a primary data collecting approach is its versatility. What media do we use for communicating with people? The traditional face to face communication (interview) for conducting surveys is still in vogue. Nevertheless, the digital technology is having a profound impact on the society as well as on research. Its greatest impact is on the creation of new forms of communication media.

Human Interactive Media and Electronic Interactive Media

When two people engage in conversation, human interaction takes place. **Human interactive media** are personal forms of communication. One human being directs a message to and interacts with another individual (or a small group). When they think of interviewing, most people envision this type of face-to-face dialogue or a conversation on telephone.

Electronic interactive media allows researchers to reach a large audience, to personalize individual messages, and to interact with members of the audience using digital technology. To a large extent electronic interactive media users are controlled by the users themselves. In the context of surveys, respondents are not passive audience members. They are actively involved in a two-way communication when electronic interactive media are utilized.

The Internet, the medium that is radically altering many organizations‟ research strategies, provides a prominent example of the new electronic interactive media.

Non-Interactive Media

The traditional questionnaire received by mail and completed by the respondent does not allow a dialogue or exchange of information for immediate feedback. Self-administered questionnaires printed on paper are also non-interactive.

CHOOSING A COMMUNICATION MEDIA

Once the researcher has determined that surveying is the appropriate data collection approach, various means may be used to secure information from individual. A research can conduct a survey by personal interview, telephone, mail, computer, or a combination of these media.

Personal Interviewing

A personal interview (i.e. face to face communication) is a two way conversation initiated by an interviewer to obtain information from a respondent. The differences in the roles of the interviewer and the respondent are pronounced. They are typically strangers, and the interviewer generally controls the topics and patterns of discussion. The consequences of the event are usually insignificant for the respondent. The respondent is asked to provide information and has little hope of receiving any immediate or direct benefit from this cooperation. Personal interviews may take place in a factory, in a homeowner‟s doorway, in an executive‟s office, in a shopping mall, or in other settings.

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Advantages of Personal Interviewing:

The face-to-face interaction between interviewer and respondent has several characteristics that help researchers obtain complete and precise information. Personal interviews offer many advantages.

1. The Opportunity for Feedback

Personal interviews allow for feedback. For example, an employee who is reluctant to provide sensitive information about his workplace may be reassured by the interviewer that his answers will be strictly confidential. The interviewer may also provide feedback in clarifying any questions an employee or any other respondent has about the instructions or questions. Circumstances may dictate that at the conclusion of the interview, the respondent be given additional information concerning the purpose of the study (part of debriefing). This is easily accomplished in personal interview.

2. Probing Complex Questions

An important characteristic of personal interview is the opportunity to follow up, by probing. If a respondent‟s answer is brief or unclear, the researcher may ask for a clearer or more comprehensive explanation. Probing implies the verbal prompts made by the interviewer when the respondent must be motivated to communicate his or her answer more fully. Probing encourages respondents to enlarge on, clarify, or explain answers. Probing becomes all the more important when the questions don‟t have structured response categories. The complex question that cannot easily be asked in telephone or mail surveys can be handled by skillful interviewers.

3. Length of Interview

If the research objective requires an extremely lengthy questionnaire, personal interviews may be the only alternative. Generally, telephone interviews last fewer than 10 minutes, whereas a personal interview can be much longer, perhaps more than an hour. A rule of thumb for mail questionnaire is that it should not be more than six pages.

4. High Completion Rate

The social interaction between a well-trained interviewer and a respondent in personal interview increases the likelihood that the respondent will answer all items on the questionnaire. The respondent who grows bored with a telephone interview may terminate the interview at his or her discretion simply by hanging up the phone. A respondent‟s self administration of a mail questionnaire requires more effort. Rather than writing a long explanation, the respondent may fail to complete some of the questions on the self administered questionnaire. This will be an **item non-response** – that is, failure to provide an answer to a question. It is less likely to happen with an experienced interviewer and in a face to face situation.

5. Props and Visual Aids

Interviewing respondents face to face allows an investigator to show them a new product sample, a sketch of proposed office, or some other visual aid. The respondents can even taste samples of different products and can give their evaluations. Such an evaluation cannot be done in telephone interview or mail survey.

6. High Participation Rate

While some people are reluctant to participate in a survey, the presence of an interviewer generally increases the percentages of people willing to complete the interview. Respondents are not required to do any reading or writing – all they have to do is to talk. Most people enjoy sharing information and insights with friendly and sympathetic interviewers. Certainly, in personal interviews there is a higher rate of participation rate of the respondents compared with mail surveys and telephone interviews.

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7. Observation of the Non-Verbal Behavior

In a personal interview, the interviewer can catch the facial expressions, body movements, and, depending upon the goals of the study, the environment of the respondent. Such observations may supplement the verbal information.

8. Non-Literates can participate in Study

Since the respondent has neither to read nor to write, therefore, an illiterate or a functionally illiterate person can also take part in the survey study.

9. Interviewer can Prescreen Respondent

In order to ensure that the respondent fits the sampling criteria, the interviewer can do some prescreening of the respondent. In personal interview the interviewer makes it sure that only the relevant respondent provides the information. In case of mail survey we are not sure who actually filled out the questionnaire, but in personal interview, the interview may be able to have some control over the environment of the information providers. In case there are other people around, he may make an excuse from other because he is interested in the true opinion of the sampled person.

10. CAPI – Computer Assisted Personal Interviewing

With the use of such modern technology the responses of the respondents can be entered into a portable microcomputer to reduce error and cost.

Disadvantages of Personal Interviewing:

1. **High Cost**

Personal interviews are generally more expensive than mail, internet, and telephone surveys. The geographic proximity of respondents, the length of the questionnaire, and the number of people who are non-respondents because they could not be contacted all influence the cost of the personal interviews. The training of the field interviewers, supervision, and other logistical support cost may add up the total cost of the study. People usually estimate the cost of personal interviews is usually 15 times higher than the mail survey

2. **Scarcity of Highly Trained Interviewers**

In case of a big study (especially a sponsored study) there shall be a need of highly trained interviewers, who are not easily available. Using unqualified and untrained interviewers are likely to have a negative effect on the quality of the data and the subsequent generalizations.

3. **Lack of Anonymity of Respondent**

Because the respondent in a personal interview is not anonymous therefore he/she may be reluctant to provide confidential information to another person. Though the interviewer provides all the assurance for the confidentiality of the information (by not asking the name or address) but the mere fact the respondent has been located, therefore he/she may not trust.

4. **Callbacks – a Labor Intensive Work**

When the person selected to be in the sample cannot be contacted on the first visit, a systematic procedure is normally initiated to call back at another time. **Callbacks** or attempts to re-contact individuals selected for the sample are the major means to reducing non-response error. It is a labor intensive work and definitely increases the cost.

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5. Interviewer Influence

There is some evidence that the demographic characteristics of the interviewer influence respondents‟ answers. Respondent‟s sex, age, and physical appearance can have an effect on the responses of the respondent.

6. Interviewer Bias

Interviewer‟s personal likings and dis-likings, the environment, and cultural biases can affect the understanding of the responses, its recording, and its interpretation.

7. No Opportunity to Consult

The interview may take place anywhere – place of work, in the shopping mall, at home – the respondent may be unable to consult record, in case he/she has to do so for any specific question.

Less Standardized Wording

Despite the fact that the questions have been printed and have a specified order, these questions are read by the interviewer. The interviewers intentionally or unintentionally may not be able to use the standardized wording which may bias the data. Similarly the order of the questions may be altered.

8. Limitations in Respondents' Availability and Accessibility

Some executive officers or VIPs may not be available or accessible to interviewers. Some of them may not be willing to talk to strangers for security reasons.

9. Some Neighborhoods are Difficult to Visit

Just for security reasons some neighborhoods may not allow outsiders to enter the premises. Even the formal permission may be denied because the residents don‟t want to contact any strangers.

Door to Door Interviews

These are the personal interviews conducted at respondent‟s home or place of work. It is likely to provide more representative sample of the population than mail questionnaire. Some people may prefer to give a verbal response rather than in writing. People who do not have telephones, who have unlisted numbers, or who are otherwise difficult to contact may be reached through door to door interviews.

Door to door interview may exclude individuals living in multiple dwelling units with security systems, such as high rise apartment dwellers, or executives who are too busy to grant a personal interview during business hours.

People, who are at home and willing to participate, especially if interviews are conducted in the day time, are somewhat more likely to be stay-at-home "moms" or retired people. These and other variables related to respondents‟ tendencies to stay at home may affect participation.

Intercept Interviews in Malls and Other High-Traffic Areas

Personal interviews conducted in shopping malls are referred to as mall intercept interviews. Interviewers generally stop and attempt to question shoppers at a central point within the mall or at the entrance. These are low cost. No travel is required to the respondent‟s home – instead the respondent comes to the interviewer, and thus many interviews can be conducted quickly. The incidence of refusal is high, however, because individuals may be in a hurry.

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In mall intercept interviews the researcher must recognize that he or she should not be looking for representative sample of the total population. Each mall will have its own customer characteristics of customers.

Personal interviews in the shopping mall may be appropriate when demographic factors are not likely to influence the survey‟s findings or when target group is a special population segment, such as the parents of children of bike-riding age.

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Lesson 21

INTERCEPT INTERVIEWS IN MALLS AND OTHER HIGH-TRAFFIC AREAS

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Personal interviews in the shopping mall may be appropriate when demographic factors are not likely to influence the survey‟s findings or when target group is a special population segment, such as the parents of children of bike-riding age.

Telephone Interviewing: Telephone interviewing has been a mainstay of commercial survey research. The quality of data obtained by telephone may be comparable to that collected in personal interviews. Respondents may even be more willing to provide detailed and reliable information on a variety of personal topics over the telephone than in personal interviews. Telephone surveys can provide representative samples of general population in most industrialized countries.

Central Location Interviewing: Research agencies and interviewing services typically conduct all telephone interviews from central location. WATS (Wide-Area Telecommunications Service) lines, provided by long distance telephone service at fixed rates, allow interviewers to make unlimited telephone calls throughout the entire country or within a specific geographic area. Such central location interviewing allows firms to hire staffs of professional interviewers and to supervise and control the quality of interviewing more effectively. When telephone interviews are centralized and computerized, the research becomes even more cost-effective.

Computer-Assisted Telephone Interviewing (CATI): Advances in computer technology allow responses to telephone interviews to be entered directly into a computer in a process known as **Computer Assisted Telephone Interviewing (CATI).**Telephone interviewers are seated at computer terminals. A monitor displays the questionnaire, one question at a time, along with pre-coded possible responses to each question. The interviewer reads each question as it is shown on the screen. When the respondent answers, the interviewer enters the response into the computer, and it is automatically stored in the computer‟s memory when the computer displays the next question on the screen. A Computer Assisted Telephone Interviewing requires that answers to the questions be highly structured. A lot of computer programming facilitates telephone interviewing.

The Strengths of Telephone Interviewing:

1. High Speed:

The speed of data collection is a major advantage of telephone interviewing. For example, union officials who wish to survey members‟ attitudes toward a strike may conduct a telephone survey during the last few days of the bargaining process. Whereas data collection with mail or personal interviews can take several weeks, hundreds of interviews can be conducted literally overnight. When the interviewer enters the respondents‟ answers directly into a computerized system, data processing can be done even faster.

2. Saves Cost: As the cost of personal interviews continues to increase, telephone interviews are becoming relatively inexpensive. It is estimated the cost of telephone interviewing is less than 25% of the door to door personal interviews.

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3. Callbacks: An unanswered call, a busy signal, or a respondent who is not at home requires a callback. Telephone callbacks are substantially easier and less expensive than personal interview callbacks.

4. Can Use Computerized Random Digit Dialing

5. Expanded Geographic Area Coverage without Increasing the Cost

6. Uses fewer but highly Skilled Interviewers

7. Reduced Interviewer Bias

8. Better Access to hard-to-reach respondents through repeated callbacks: In some neighborhoods, people are reluctant to allow stranger to come inside their house, or even stop on the doorstep. The same people, however, may be preferably willing to cooperate with a telephone survey request. Likewise, interviewers may be somewhat reluctant to conduct face-to-face interviews in certain neighborhoods, especially during the evening hours. Telephone interviewing avoids these problems.

9. Use Computer Assisted Telephone Interviewing (CATI): Responses can be directly entered into computer file to reduce error and cost.

Weaknesses of Telephone Interviewing

1. **Absence of Face-to-Face Contact:**

Telephone interviews are more impersonal than face-to-face interviews. Respondents may answer embarrassing or confidential questions more willingly in a telephone interview than in a personal interview. People may be more comfortable to answer sensitive and threatening questions through mail surveys. Absence of face-to-face contact can be a liability. The interviewer and the respondent don‟t see each other what they are doing (Responding still responding when he/she is thinking and not speaking. Has the interviewer finished recording the information)?

2. **Response Rate is lower than for Personal Interviews:**

Some individuals refuse to participate in telephone interviews. Telephone researchers can run into several roadblocks when trying to obtain executives‟ cooperation at work. Participants find it easier to terminate a phone interview.

3. **Lack of Visual Medium:**

Since visual aids cannot be utilized in telephone interview, research that requires visual material cannot be conducted by phone.

4. **Limited Duration:**

Length of the interview is limited. Respondents who feel they have spent too much time in the interview will simply hang up. (A good rule of thumb is to plan telephone interviews to be approximately 10 minutes long).

5. Many Numbers are unlisted or not working

6. Less Participant Involvement:

Telephone surveys can result in less thorough responses, and those interviewed by phone find the experience to be less rewarding than a personal interview. Participants report less rapport with telephone interviewers than with personal interviewers.

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7. Distracting Physical Environment:

Multiple phones distract the interview situation which may affect the quality of the data.

Self-Administered Questionnaires

The self-administered questionnaire has become ubiquitous in modern living. Service evaluations of hotels, restaurants, car dealerships, and transportation providers furnish ready examples. Often a short questionnaire is left to be completed by the participants in a convenient location or is packed with the product. Self-administered mail questionnaires are delivered not only through postal services, but also via fax and courier service. Other modalities include computer-delivered and intercept studies.

Mail Questionnaire

A mail survey is a self-administered questionnaire sent to respondents through the mail. This paper-and-pencil method has several advantages and disadvantages.

Advantages of Mail Questionnaire

1. Geographic Flexibility: Mail questionnaires can reach a geographically dispersed sample simultaneously and at a relatively low cost because interviewers are not required. Respondents in isolated areas or those who are otherwise difficult to reach (executives) can be contacted more easily by mail.

2. Sample Accessibility: Researchers can contact participants who may otherwise be inaccessible. Some people, such as major corporate executives and physicians, are difficult to reach in person or by phone, as gatekeepers limit access. But the researchers can often access these special participants by mail or computer.

3. Self-Administered Questionnaires save time: Self-administered questionnaires can be widely distributed to a large number of employees, so organizational problems may be assessed quickly and inexpensively. Questionnaires may be administered during group meetings as well as in the class rooms. The researcher can establish rapport with the respondents, can stay there for any clarifications, and may also be for any debriefing.

4. Saves Cost: Mail questionnaires are relatively inexpensive compared to personal interviews and telephone surveys. However, these may not be so cheap. Most include a follow-up mailing, which requires additional postage and printing of additional questionnaires.

5. Respondent Convenience: Mail surveys and self-administered questionnaires can be filled out whenever the respondent has time. Thus there is a better chance that respondents will take time to think about their response. Many hard-to-reach respondents place high value on responding to surveys at their own convenience and are best contacted by mail. In some situations, particularly in organizational research, mail questionnaires allow respondents time to collect facts (such as records of absenteeism) that they may not be able to recall without checking. In the case of household surveys, the respondents may provide more valid and factual information by checking with family members compared with if they are giving a personal interview.

6. Anonymity: Mail surveys are typically perceived as more impersonal, providing more anonymity than the other communication modes, including other methods for distributing self-administered questionnaires. Absence of interviewer can induce respondents to reveal sensitive or socially undesirable information.

7. Standardized Questions: Mail questionnaires are highly standardized, and the questions are quite structured.

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Disadvantages of Mail Questionnaire

1. Low Response Rate: Mail questionnaire has very low rate of return of the filled questionnaires.

2. Low Completion Rate: There are chances that respondents leave many questions as unanswered, either because they did not understand the question or they avoid.

3. Increases Cost: The researcher keeps on waiting for the return. When enough response is not there, then the reminders are sent, and again there is a waiting time. With the reminders copies of the questionnaires are sent. All this adds to the cost of the study.

4. Interviewer's Absence: Respondent may have different interpretations of the questions. Due to the absence of the interviewer, the respondents are unable to get any help for needed clarifications.

5. No Control on Question Order: In a self-administered/mail questionnaire, the respondent usually reads the whole of the questionnaire prior to answering the questions. The latter questions may influence the answers to the earlier questions; thereby it is likely to bias the data. In interview the questionnaire remains in the hands of the interviewer, and the respondent does not know what question is likely to follow. Therefore, in interview there is a control in the question order.

6. Cannot Use Lengthy Questionnaire: Mail questionnaires vary considerably in length, ranging from extremely short postcard questionnaires to lengthy, multi-page booklets requiring respondents to fill thousands of answers. Lengthy questionnaires are usually avoided by the respondents. A general rule of thumb is that it should not exceed six pages.

7. No Control over the Environment: The researcher does not know about who filled the questionnaire

8. Cannot Catch the Non-Verbal Behavior

9. Non-Literates cannot participate: For participation in the mail/self-administered questionnaire related studies, the respondents have to be educated up to a certain level. Hence the non-educated people are in a way excluded from the study.

Increasing Response Rate

Here are some guidelines for increasing the response rate. Response rate is the number of questionnaires returned or completed, divided by the total number of eligible people who were contacted or asked to participate in the survey.

Cover Letter: The cover letter that accompanies the questionnaire or is printed on the first page of the questionnaire is an important means of inducing a reader to complete and return the questionnaire. In the letter tell why the study is important, who is sponsoring the study, how was the respondent selected, assuring the anonymity of the respondent could help in establishing rapport and motivating the respondent to respond.A personalized letter addressed to a specific individual shows the respondent that he or she is important. Including an individually typed letter on letterhead versus printed form is an important element in increasing the response rate in mail surveys.

Money Helps: The respondent‟s motivation for returning a questionnaire may be increased by offering monetary incentives or premiums. Although pens, lottery tickets, and variety of premiums have been used, monetary incentives appear to be the most effective and least biasing incentive. It attracts the attention and creates a sense of obligation. Money incentive works for all income categories.

Interesting Questions: The topic of the research and thus the point of the questions cannot be manipulated without changing the problem definition. However, certain interesting questions can be added to the questionnaire, perhaps in the beginning, to stimulate the respondents‟ interest and to induce cooperation.

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Lesson 22

SELF ADMINISTERED QUESTIONNAIRES (CONTINUED)

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Follow-Ups

Follow-up implies the communication of the message to respondents through different means for the return of questionnaire. After responses from the first wave of mailing begin to trickle-in, most studies use follow-up, reminder for getting the response. A follow-up may include a duplicate questionnaire or may merely be a reminder to return the original questionnaire. Multiple contacts almost always increase response rates. The more attempts made to reach people, the greater the chances of their responding.

Preliminary Notification

Advance notification, by either letter or telephone, that a questionnaire will be arriving has been successful in increasing the response rates in some situations. Advance notices that go out close to the questionnaire mailing time produce better results than those sent too far in advance. This technique pre-supposes a certain level of development of the country where such facilities are available. Even otherwise, it depends upon the nature of the study as well as the type of respondents selected for the study.

Survey Sponsorship

Sponsorship of the study makes a difference for motivating the respondents to return the questionnaires. It depends upon the goodwill of the sponsoring agency that can activate/deactivate

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the respondent to fill the questionnaire and return it. There is some evidence that "official" and "respected" sponsorship increases the response rate. Sponsorship by well-known and prestigious organizations, such as universities or government agencies, may significantly influence response rates.

Return Envelopes

The inclusion of a stamped, self-addressed envelope encourages response because it simplifies questionnaire return.

Postage

The existing evidence shows that expedited delivery is very effective in increasing response rate. First class or third class mail, stamped mail or metered mail may make a difference.

Personalization

Personalization of the mailing has no clear-cut advantage in terms of improved response rates. Neither personal inside addresses nor individually signed cover letters significantly increased response rates; personally typed cover letters proved to be somewhat effective.

Size, Reproduction, and Color

The size of the paper, the printing, and color may have some effect, though not significant, on the response rate. It is recommended to use the A-4 size paper and while sending it do not fold it. The attractive printing may be another factor influencing the return rate. If questionnaire has different parts, the use of different colors of paper may motivate the respondents to take interest in the study and return the questionnaire.

The manipulation of one or two techniques independently of all others may do little to stimulate response. May be the researcher has to make use of all the possible techniques simultaneously, so that the response rate could be increased. Such an effort is referred to as Total Design Effort (TDE).

E-Mail Surveys:

Questionnaires can be distributed via e-mail. E-mail is relatively new method of communication, and many individuals cannot be reached this way. However, certain projects lend themselves to, such as internal surveys of employees or satisfaction surveys of retail buyers who regularly deal with an organization via e-mail.

The benefits of an e-mail include speed of distribution, lower distribution and processing cost, faster turnaround time, more flexibility, and less handling of paper questionnaires.

Many respondents may feel that they can be more candid in e-mail than in person or on telephone, for the same reason they are candid on other self-administered questionnaires.

In many organizations the employees know that their e-mails are not secure, that "eves-dropping" by a supervisor could occur. Further maintaining the respondent‟s anonymity is difficult, because a reply to an e-mail message typically includes the sender‟s address. Researchers designing e-mail surveys should assure respondents that their responses will be confidential.

Not all e-mail systems have the same capacity: some handle color and graphics well; others are limited to text. The extensive differences in the capabilities of respondents‟ computers and email software limit the types of questions and the layout of the questionnaire.

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Internet Surveys:

An internet survey is a self-administered questionnaire posted on a Web site. Respondents provide answers to questions displayed on screen by highlighting a phrase, clicking an icon, or keying in an answer.

Like any other survey, Internet surveys have both advantages and disadvantages.

Advantages of Internet Surveys

Speed and Cost Effectiveness: Internet survey allow the marketers to reach a large audience (possible a global one), to personalize the individual messages, and to secure confidential answers quickly and cost effectively. The computer to computer self-administered questionnaires eliminate the cost of paper, postage, data entry, and other administrative costs. Once an Internet questionnaire has been developed, the incremental cost of reaching additional respondents is marginal. Hence samples can be larger than with interviews or other types of self-administered questionnaires.

Visual Appeal and Interactivity: Surveys conducted on Internet can be interactive. The researcher can use more sophisticated lines of questioning based on the respondents‟ prior answers. Many of this interactive survey utilize color, sound, and animation, which may help to increase the respondents‟ cooperation and willingness to spend more time answering questions. The Internet is an excellent medium for the presentation of visual materials, such as photographs or drawings of product prototypes, advertisements, and movie trailers.

Respondent Participation and Cooperation: Participation in some Internet surveys occurs because computer users intentionally navigate to a particular Web site where questions are displayed. In some instances individuals expect to encounter a survey at a Web site; in other cases it is totally unexpected.

Accurate Real-Time Data Capture: The computer to computer nature of Internet surveys means that each respondent‟s answers are entered directly into the researcher‟s computer as soon as the questionnaire is submitted. In addition, the questionnaire software may be programmed to reject improper data entry.

Real-time data capture allows for real-time data analysis. A researcher can review up-to-the–minute sample size counts and tabulation data from an Internet survey in real time.

Callbacks: When the sample for Internet survey is drawn from a consumer panel, it is easy to re-contact those who have not yet completed the questionnaire. Computer software can also identify the passwords of those respondents who completed only a portion of the questionnaire and send those people customized messages.

Personalized and Flexible Questioning: There is no interviewer in Internet surveys but the respondent interacts directly with the software on a Web site. In other words the computer program asks questions in sequence determined by a respondent‟s previous answer. The questions appear on the computer screen, and answers are recorded by simply pressing a key clicking an icon, thus immediately entering the data into the computer‟s memory. This ability to sequence the question based on previous responses is a major advantage of computer-assisted surveys.

Respondent Anonymity: Respondents are more likely to provide sensitive information when they can remain anonymous. The anonymity of the Internet encourages respondents to provide honest answers to sensitive questions.

Most respondents do not feel threatening to enter information into the compute because of the absence of the interviewer. They may be assured that no human will ever see their individual responses.

Response Rate: Response rate can be increased by sending e-mail friendly reminders.

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Disadvantages of Internet Surveys

All People cannot participate: Many people in the general public cannot access to Internet. And, all people with Internet access do not have the same level of technology. Many lack powerful computers or software that is compatible with advanced features programmed into many Internet questionnaires. Some individuals have minimum computer skills. They may not know how to navigate through and provide answers to an Internet questionnaire.

No Physical Incentive: Unlike mail surveys, Internet surveys do not offer the opportunity to send a physical incentive to the respondent.

SELECTING THE APPROPRIATE SURVEY RESEARCH DESIGN

The choice of communication method is not as complicated as it might appear. By comparing the research objectives with the strengths and weaknesses of each method, the researcher will be able to choose one that is suited to the needs. Nevertheless, there is no "best" form of survey. Each has advantages and disadvantages. A researcher who must ask highly confidential questions may conduct a mail survey, thus trading off the speed of data collection to avoid any possibility of interviewer bias.

To determine the appropriate technique, the researcher must ask questions such as "Is the assistance of an interviewer necessary? Are respondents likely to be interested in the issues being investigating? Will cooperation be easily attained? How quickly the information is needed? Will the study require a long complex questionnaire? How large is the budget?" The criteria – cost, speed, anonymity, and the like – may be different for each project.

If none of the choices turns out to be a particularly good fit, it is possible to combine the best characteristics of two or more alternatives into a *mixed mode.* Although this decision will incur the costs of the combined modes, the flexibility of tailoring a method to the unique need of the project is often an acceptable trade off.

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Lesson 23

TOOLS FOR DATA COLLECTION

Broadly there are tools of data collection as part of communication surveys. These are:

1. Interview schedule
2. Questionnaire
3. Interview Guide

As discussed earlier interview schedule and questionnaires both are predesigned list of questions used for communication with the respondents. In the case of *interview schedule,* the list of questions remains in the hands of the interviewer who asks questions from the respondent, gets his/her response, and records the responses. *Questionnaire* is also a list of questions, which is handed over to the respondent, who reads the questions and records the answers himself. For purposes of convenience *questionnaire* will refer to both interview schedule as well as questionnaire.

Interview guide is list of topics that are to be covered during the course of interview. Interview guide is used for purposes of an in-depth interviewing. Questions on the topics are formulated on the spot. Most of the questions are open ended. The interviewer may not use the same wording for each respondent; the number of questions may be different; the sequence of questions may also be different.

Guidelines for Questionnaire Design

A survey is only as good as the questions it asks. Questionnaire design is one of the most critical stages in the survey research process. While common sense and good grammar are important in question writing, more is required in the art of questionnaire design. To assume that people will understand the questions is common error. People may not simply know what is being asked. They may be unaware of topic of interest, they may confuse the subject with something else, or the question may not mean the same thing to every respondent. Respondents may simply refuse to answer personal questions. Further, properly wording the questionnaire is crucial, as some problems may be minimized or avoided altogether if a skilled researcher composes the questions.

A good questionnaire forms an integrated whole. The researcher weaves questions together so they flow smoothly. He or she includes introductory remarks and instructions for clarification and measures each variable with one or more survey questions.

What should be asked?

The problem definition will indicate which type of information must be collected to answer the research question; different types of questions may be better at obtaining certain type of information than others.

1. **Questionnaire Relevancy**

A questionnaire is relevant if no unnecessary information is collected and if the information that is needed to solve the problem is obtained.

Asking the wrong or an irrelevant question is a pitfall to be avoided. If the task is to pinpoint compensation problems, for example, questions asking for general information about morale may be inappropriate. To ensure information relevancy, the researcher must be specific about data needs, and there should be a rationale for each item of information.

2. **Questionnaire Accuracy**

Once the researcher has decided what should be asked, the criterion of accuracy becomes of primary concern. Accuracy means that the information is reliable and valid. While experienced researchers

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believe that one should use simple, understandable, unbiased, unambiguous, and nonirritating words. Obtaining accurate answer from respondents is strongly influenced by the researcher‟s ability to design a questionnaire that facilitates recall and that will motivate the respondent to cooperate. Therefore avoid jargon, slang, and abbreviations. The respondents may not understand some basic terminology. Respondents can probably tell the interviewer whether they are married, single, divorced, separated, or widowed, but providing their "marital status" may present a problem. Therefore, asking somebody about his/her *marital status* while the person may not understand the meaning of marital status is likely to mess up the information. Words used in the questionnaire should be readily understandable to all respondents.

3. Avoid Ambiguity, Confusion, and Vagueness.

Ambiguity and vagueness plague most question writers. A researcher might make implicit assumptions without thinking of respondents‟ perspectives. For example, the question, "what is your income?" could mean weekly, monthly, or annual: family or personal; before taxes or after taxes; for this year or last year; from salary or from all sources. The confusion causes inconsistencies in how different respondents assign meaning to and answer the question.

Another source of ambiguity is the use indefinite words or response categories. Consider the words such as *often, occasionally, usually, regularly, frequently, many, good, fair,* and *poor*. Each of these words has many meanings. For one person frequent reading of *Time* magazine may be reading six or seven issues a year; for another it may be two issues a year. The word *fair* has great variety of meanings; the same is true for many indefinite words.

4. Avoid Double-Barreled Questions

Make each question about one and only one. A double barreled question consists of two or more questions joined together. It makes the respondent‟s answer ambiguous. For example, if asked, "Does this company have pension and health insurance benefits?" A respondent at the company with health insurance benefits only might answer either yes or no. The response has an ambiguous meaning and the researcher cannot be certain of the respondent‟s intentions. When multiple questions are asked in one question, the results may be exceedingly difficult to interpret.

5. Avoid Leading Questions

Make respondents feel that all responses are legitimate. Do not let them aware of an answer that the researcher wants. A leading question is the one that leads the respondent to choose one response over another by its wording. For example, the question, "you don‟t smoke, do you?" leads respondents to state that they do not smoke. "Don‟t you think that women should be empowered?" In most the cases the respondent is likely to agree with the statement.

6. Avoid Loaded Question

Loaded questions suggest a socially desirable answer or are emotionally charged. "Should the city government repair all the broken streets?" Most of the people are going to agree with this question simply because this is highly socially desirable. A question which may be challenging the traditionally set patterns of behavior may be considered as emotionally charged i.e. it is loaded with such material which may hit the emotions of the people. Look at some behaviors associated with masculinity in Pakistani society. Let us ask a husband "Have you ever been beaten up by your wife?" Straight away this question may be considered to be a challenge to the masculinity of the person. Hence it may be embarrassing for the person to admit such an experience. Therefore, even if the husband was beaten up by his wife, he might give a socially desirable answer.

7. Avoid Burdensome Questions that may Tax the Respondent's Memory

A simple fact of human life is that people forget. Researchers writing questions about past behavior or events should recognize that certain questions may make serious demand on the respondent‟s

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memory. “How did you feel about your brother when you were 6 years old?” It may very difficult to recall something from the childhood.

8. Arrange Questions in a Proper Sequence

The order of question, or the question sequence, may serve several functions for the researcher. If the opening questions are interesting, simple to comprehend, and easy to answer, respondent‟s cooperation and involvement can be maintained throughout the questionnaire. If respondent‟s curiosity is not aroused at the outset, they can become disinterested and terminate the interview.

Sequencing specific questions before asking about broader issues is a common cause of question order bias. In some situations it may be advisable to ask general question before specific question to obtain the freest opinion of the respondent. This procedure, known as **funnel technique,** allows the researcher to understand the respondent‟s frame of reference before asking specific questions about the level of respondent‟s information and intensity of his or her opinions.

9. Use Filter Question, if Needed

Asking a question that doesn‟t apply to the respondent or that the respondent is not qualified to answer may be irritating or may cause a biased response. Including filter question minimizes the chance of asking questions that are inapplicable. Filter question is that question which screens out respondents not qualified to answer a second question. For example the researcher wants to know about the bringing up of one‟s children. “How much time do you spend playing games with your oldest child?” What if the respondent is unmarried? Even if the respondent is married but does not have the child. In both these situations the question is inapplicable to him/her. Before this question the person may put a filter question whether or not the respondent is married.

10. Layout of the questionnaire

There are two format or layout issues: the overall physical layout of the questionnaire and the format of questions and responses.

- Good layout and physical attractiveness is crucial in mail, Internet, and other self-administered questionnaires. For different reason it is also important to have a good layout in questionnaires designed for personal and telephone interviews.
- Give each question a number and put identifying information on questionnaire. Never cramp questions together or create a confusing appearance.
- Make a cover sheet or face sheet for each, for administrative use. Put the time and date of the interview, the interviewer, the respondent identification number, and interviewer‟s comments and observations on it. Give interviewers and respondents instructions on the questionnaire. Print instructions in a different style from question to distinguish them.
- Lay out is important for mail questionnaires because there is no friendly interviewer to interact with the respondent. Instead the questionnaire‟s appearance persuades the respondents. In mail surveys, include a polite, professional cover letter on letterhead stationery, identifying the researcher and offering a telephone number for any questions. Always end with “Thank you for your participation.”

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Lesson 24

PILOT TESTING OF THE QUESTIONNAIRE

Pilot testing also called pre-testing means small scale trial run of a particular component; here we are referring to pilot testing of the questionnaire. Conventional wisdom suggests that pre-testing not only is an established practice for discovering errors but also is useful for extra training the research team. Ironically, professionals who have participated in scores of studies are more likely to pretest an instrument than is a beginning researcher hurrying to complete a project. Revising questions five or more times is not unusual. Yet inexperienced researchers often underestimate the need to follow the design-test-revise process.

It is important to pilot test the instrument to ensure that the questions are understood by the respondents and there are no problems with the wording or measurement. Pilot testing involves the use of a small number of respondents to test the appropriateness of the questions and their comprehension. Usually, the draft questionnaire is tried out on a group that is selected on a convenience and that is similar in makeup to the one that ultimately will be sampled. Making a mistake with 25 or so subjects can avert the disaster of administering an invalid questionnaire to several hundred individuals. Hence the main purpose of pilot testing is to identify potential problems with the methods, logistics, and the questionnaire.

Administering a questionnaire exactly as planned in the actual study often is not possible. For example, mailing out a questionnaire might require several weeks. Pre-testing a questionnaire in this manner might provide important information on response rate, but it may not point out why questions were skipped or why respondents found certain questions ambiguous or confusing. The ability of personal interviewer to record requests for additional explanation and to register comments indicating respondent‟s difficulty with question sequence or other factors is the primary reason why interviewers are often used for pretest work.

What aspects to be evaluated during pilot testing?

1. Reactions of Respondents:

The reactions of the respondents can be looked at from different angles. The researcher may be familiar with the local culture; still getting the first-hand experience is always useful. Going to the field, contacting the people, and their reactions to the different aspects of research may be a learning experience.

Availability of study population timing. In case we are doing interviewing then pre-testing might help to find out the most appropriate time when the respondent shall be available. The researcher can plan the interviewing accordingly.

- **Acceptability of the questions asked.** An important purpose of pre-testing is to discover participants‟ reaction to the questions. If the participants do not find the experience stimulating when an interviewer is physically present, how will they react on the phone, or in the self-administered mode? Pre-testing should help to discover where repetitiveness or redundancy is bothersome or what topics were not covered that the participant expected. An alert interviewer will look for questions or even sections that the participant perceives to be sensitive or threatening or topics about which the participant knows nothing. Pre-testing will also provide the opportunity to see the acceptability of the wording of the questions in the local cultural context. Some of the issues may be discussed openly while for others people use a disguised language. If people consider the use of certain phrases as offensive, then it is high time to change the wording.
- **Willingness of the respondents to co-operate.** Field testing of the questionnaire will give the idea about the level of cooperation the research team is likely to get from the respondents, particularly if they have to interview them.

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2. Discovering errors in the instrument:

- **Do the tools provide you the information? Reliability. Suitability for analysis.** Tabulation of the results /of a pretest helps determine whether the questionnaire will meet the objectives of the research. A preliminary analysis often illustrates that although respondents can easily comprehend and answer a given question, it is an inappropriate question because it does not help solving the issue. The information may not be suitable for analysis.
- **Time taken/needed to interview/conduct the observation.** Pre-testing can indicate the time taken for interview or to conduct the observation. Too long questionnaires may not be recommended and, therefore, need modification. It can also help in estimating average time being taken to collect information form a respondent. Such an exercise can help in budget estimations.
- **If there is any need to revise the format of the tool.** Question arrangement can play a significant role in the success of the instrument. May be we should start with stimulating questions and place sensitive questions last. Such a situation might be handled through pre-testing. Therefore, pre-testing may help in putting questions in proper sequence, using acceptable wording, doing appropriate translation, question spacing, structuring of answers, coding system, and needing instructions for interviewers (probing).

3. Sampling procedure can be checked:

- **The extent to which instructions given are followed.** Field functionaries are given the instructions for following a sampling procedure. Depending upon the type of sampling to be followed, the field worker must follow the guidelines otherwise the quality of the study will be hampered. During the pre-testing one could see not only the extent to which the instructions are being followed but also locate the problems in carrying out those instructions. Also what could be the solutions to those problems?
- **How much time is needed to locate the respondents?** By following the instructions how easy it is to locate the respondents, and how much time is needed to do that activity. It could help in calculating the overall time for data collection, having relevancy for budgeting the resources.

4. Staffing and activities of research team can be checked:

- **How successful the training has been?** Pre-testing can be seen as a period of extra training. The pre-testing exercise can provide a good opportunity to make an evaluation of the achievement of the objectives of training. For any deficiencies additional training may be provided.
- **What is the work output of each member?** The researcher can calculate the average output of each fieldworker and accordingly calculate the number of workers needed to finish the work on time. It can also help in making the budget estimates.
- **How well the research team works together?** It is a good opportunity to observe the kind of coordination the research team has. The integrated work is likely affect the efficiency of the team. Any shortcomings could be looked after.
- **Is the logistical support adequate?** Of course we are leaving the field functionaries in isolation. They shall be in need of other logistical support like the transportation, boarding, lodging, guidance and supervision. Some of these aspects could also be appraised during the pre-testing

4. Procedure for data processing and analysis can be evaluated:

Make dummy tables. See how can we tabulate the data and use the appropriate statistics for purposes of interpretations

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Lesson 25

INTERVIEWING

A personal interviewer administering a questionnaire door to door, a telephone interviewer calling from a central location, an observer counting pedestrians in a shopping mall, and others involved in the collection of data and the supervision of that process are all **fieldworkers.** The activities they perform vary substantially. The supervision of data collection for a mail survey differs from the data collection in an observation study. Nevertheless there are some basic issues in all kinds of fieldwork. Just for convenience, in this session we shall focus on the interviewing process conducted by personal interviewers. However, many of the issues apply to all fieldworkers, no matter what their specific setting.

Who conducts the fieldwork?

Data collection in a sponsored study is rarely carried out by the person who designs the research project. For a student, depending upon the sample size, data collection is usually done by the student himself/herself. However, the data collection stage is crucial, because the research project is no better than the data collected in the field. Therefore, it is important that the research administrator selects capable people who may be entrusted to collect the data.

There are Field Interviewing Services, who specialize in data gathering. These agencies perform door-to-door surveys, central location telephone interviewing, and other forms of fieldwork for fee. These agencies typically employ field supervisors who oversee and train interviewers, edit questionnaires completed in the field, and confirm that the interviews have been conducted.

Whether the research administrator hires in-house interviewers or selects a field interviewing service, it is desirable to have fieldworkers meet certain job requirements. Although the job requirements for different types of surveys vary, normally interviewers should be healthy, outgoing, honest, accurate, responsible, motivated, and of pleasing appearance – well groomed and properly dressed.

An essential part of the interviewing process is establishing rapport with the respondent.

In-House Training

After personnel are selected, they must be trained. The training that the interviewer will receive after being selected by a company may vary from virtually no training to one week program. Almost always there will be a **briefing session** on the particular project.

The objective of training is to ensure that the data collection instrument is administered uniformly by all fieldworkers. The goal of training session is to ensure that each respondent is provided with common information. If the data are collected in a uniform manner from all respondents, the training session will have been success.

More extensive training programs are likely to cover the following topics:

1. How to make initial contact with the respondent and secure the interview?
2. How to ask survey questions?
3. How to probe?
4. How to record responses? How to terminate the interview?

The Role of the Interviewer

Survey research interviewing is a specialized kind of interviewing. As with most interviewing, its goal is to obtain accurate information from another person.

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The survey interview is a social relationship. Like other social relationships, it involves social roles, norms, and expectations. The interview is a short-term, secondary social interaction between two strangers with the explicit purpose of one person‟s obtaining specific information from the other. The social roles are those of the interviewer and the interviewee or respondent. Information is obtained in a structured conversation in which the interviewer asks prearranged questions and records answers, and the respondent answers.

The role of interviewer is difficult. They obtain cooperation and build rapport, yet remain neutral and objective. They encroach on respondents‟ time and privacy for information that may not benefit the respondents. They try to reduce embarrassment, fear, and suspicion so that respondents feel comfortable revealing information. They explain the nature of the survey research or give hints about social roles in an interview. Good interviewers monitor the pace and direction of the social interaction as well as content of the answers and the behavior of the respondents.

Survey interviewers are non-judgmental and do not reveal their opinions, verbally or nonverbally. If the respondent asks for an interviewer‟s opinion, he or she politely redirects the respondent and indicate that such questions are inappropriate.

Stages of an Interview

Making Initial Contact and Securing the Interview

The interview proceeds through stages, beginning with introduction and entry. Interviewers are trained to make appropriate opening remarks that will convince the person that his or her cooperation is important.

Asslaam-o-Alaykum, my name is_____and I am working for a National Survey Company. We are conducting a survey concerning "women empowerment." I would like to get a few of your ideas.

For the initial contact in a telephone interview, the introduction might be:

Asslaam-o-Alaykum, my name is_____. I am calling from Department of Social Research, Virtual University.

By indicating that telephone call is a long distance, interviewers attempt to capitalize on the fact that most people feel a long distance call is something special, unusual, or important. Giving one‟s personal name personalizes the call.

Personal interviewers may carry a letter of identification that will indicate that the study is bona-fide research project and not a salesman‟s call. The name of the research agency is used to assure the respondent that the caller is trustworthy.

Asking the Questions

The purpose of the interview is, of course, to have the interviewer ask questions and record the respondent‟s answers. Training in the art of stating questions can be extremely beneficial, because interviewer bias can be a source of considerable error in survey research.

There are five major principles for asking questions:

1. Ask the questions exactly as they are worded in the questionnaire.
2. Read each question very slowly.
3. Ask the question in the order in which they are presented in the questionnaire.
4. Repeat questions that are misunderstood or misinterpreted.

Although interviewers are generally trained in these procedures, when working in the field many interviewers do not follow them exactly. Do not take shortcuts when the task becomes monotonous.

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Interviewers may shorten questions or rephrase unconsciously when they rely on their memory of the question rather than reading the question as it is worded.

If the respondents do not understand a question, they will usually ask for some clarification. The recommended procedure is to repeat the question, or if the respondent does not understand a word, the interviewer should respond with "just whatever it means to you.

5. Often the respondents volunteer information relevant to a question that is supposed to be asked at a later point in the research. In this situation the response should be recorded under the question that deals specifically with that subject. Then rather than skip the question that was answered out of sequence, the interviewers should be trained to say something like "We have briefly discussed this, but let me ask you …." By asking every question, the interviewer can be sure that complete answers are recorded.

Probing

Probing means the verbal prompts made by field worker when the respondent must be motivated to communicate his or her answer or to enlarge on, clarify or explain an answer. Probing may be needed for two types of situations. First, it is necessary when the respondent must be motivated to enlarge on, clarify, or explain his or her answer. The interviewer must encourage the respondent to clarify or expand on answers by providing a stimulus that will not suggest the interviewer‟s own ideas. The ability to probe with neutral stimuli is the mark of an experienced interviewer. Second, probing may be necessary in situations in which the respondent begins to ramble or lose track of the question. In such cases the respondent must be led to focus on specific content of the interview and to avoid irrelevant and unnecessary information. Probing is also needed when the interviewer recognizes an irrelevant or inaccurate answer.

He interviewer has several possible probing tactics to choose from, depending on the situation:

- *Repetition of the question.* The respondent who remains completely silent may not have understood the question or may not have decided how to answer it. Mere repetition may encourage the respondent to answer in such cases. For example, if the question is "What is there that you do not like about your supervisor?" and the respondent does not answer, the interviewer may probe: "just to check, is there anything you do not like about your supervisor?"
- *An expectant pause*. If the interviewer believes the respondent has more to say, the "silent probe," accompanied by an expectant look may motivate the respondent to gather his/her thoughts and give a complete response.
- *Repetition of the respondent's reply.* As the interviewer records the response, he or she may repeat the respondent‟s reply verbatim. This may stimulate the respondent to expand on the answer.
- *Neutral questions or comments.* Asking neutral question may indicate the type of information that the interviewer is seeking. For example, if the interviewer believes that the respondent‟s motives should be clarified, he or she might ask, "Why do you feel that way?" If the interviewer feels that there is a need to clarify a word or phrase, then he/she might ask, "What do you mean by_____?"

Recording the Responses

The rules for recording responses to closed ended questions vary with the specific question. The general rule, however, is to place a check in the box that correctly reflects the respondent‟s answer.

The general instructions for recording answers to open-ended response questions is to record the answer verbatim, a task that is difficult for most people. Some of the suggestions are:

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- Record responses during the interview.
- Use the respondent‟s own words.
- Do not summarize or paraphrase the respondent‟sanswer.
- Include everything that pertains to the question objectives.
- Include all your probes.

Terminating the Interview

Fieldworkers should not close the interview before all the information has been secured. The interviewer whose departure is hasty will not be able to record those spontaneous comments respondents sometimes offer after all formal questions have been asked. Avoiding hasty departures is also a matter of courtesy.

Fieldworkers should also answer to the best of their ability any questions the respondent has concerning the nature and purpose of the study. Always leave by observing the local cultural customs. "Don‟t burn your bridges." Because the fieldworker may be required to re-interview the respondent at some future time, he or she should leave the respondent with positive feeling about having cooperated in a worthwhile undertaking. It is extremely important to thank the respondent for his or her cooperation.

The interviewer then goes to a quiet and private place to edit the questionnaire and record other details such as the date, time, and place of interview; a thumbnail sketch of the respondent and interview situation, the respondent‟s attitude; and any unusual circumstances. The interviewer also records personal feelings and anything that was suspected.

Principles of Interviewing

The Basics

Have integrity and be honest. This is the cornerstone of all professional inquiry, regardless of its purpose.

Have patience and tact. Interviewers ask for information from people they do not know. Thus all the rules of human relations that apply to inquiry situations – patience, tact, courtesy – apply "in spades" to interviewing.

Have attention to accuracy and detail. Among the greatest interviewing "sins" are inaccuracy and superficiality, for the professional analyst can misunderstand, and in turn mislead, a client. Do not record the answer unless you fully understand it yourself. Probe for clarification and detailed full answers.

Exhibit a real interest in the inquiry at hand, but keep your opinions to yourself. Impartiality is imperative.

Be a good listener. Some interviewers talk too much, wasting time when respondents could be supplying more pertinent facts or opinions on the topic.

Keep the inquiry and respondents' responses confidential. Do not discuss the studies you are doing with relatives, friends, or associates. Never quote one respondent‟s opinion to another.

Respect others' rights. Survey research depends on the goodwill of others to provide information. There should be no coercion. Impress on prospective respondents that their cooperation is important and valuable.

Interview Bias

- Information obtained during interview should be as free as possible of bias.

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- Bias could be introduced by the interviewer, interviewee, or the situation. Interviewer bias falls into six categories:

Interviewer Bias

1. Interviewer could bias the data if proper rapport is not established Errors by the respondent – forgetting, embarrassment, misunderstanding, or lying because of the presence of others.
2. Unintentional errors or interviewer sloppiness – contacting the wrong person, misreading a question, omitting questions, reading questions in the wrong order, recording wrong answer, or misunderstanding the respondent.
3. Intentional subversion by the interviewer – purposeful alteration of answers, omission or re-wording of questions, or choice of an alternative respondent.
4. Influence due to the interviewer‟s expectations about a respondent‟s appearance, living situation, or other answers.
5. Failure of an interviewer to probe or to probe properly.
6. Influence on the answers due to the interviewer‟s appearance, tone, attitude, reactions to answers, or comments made outside of the interview schedule.

Interviewee Bias

Errors made by the respondent –

1. Interviewees can bias the data when they do not come out with their true opinion but provide information that they think what the interviewer expects of them or would like to hear.
2. They do not understand the question; they may feel difficult or hesitant to clarify.
3. Some interviewees may be turned off because of the personal liking, or the dress of the interviewer, or the manner in which questions are put. So they may not provide truthful answers.
4. Some may provide socially undesirable answers.

Situational Bias

Situational biases in terms of:

1. Non-participants – Unwillingness or inability to participate. Bias the sample.
2. Trust levels and rapport established by different interviewers. Elicit answers of different degrees of openness.
3. The physical setting of the interview. Respondent may not feel comfortable to be interviewed at work.

Some Tips for Interviewing

- Know the culture of the people in advance.
- Appearance – wear acceptable dress.
- Pleasantness and flexibility.
- Carry the letter of authority.
- Establish credibility and rapport. Motivating individuals to respond.
- Familiarity with the questionnaire.
- Following the question wording/ question order
- Recording responses exactly.
- Probing for responses.
- Closing the interview. No false promises. Also don‟t burn your bridges.
- Edit the questionnaire in the first available opportunity.

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Lesson 26

SAMPLE AND SAMPLING TERMINOLOGY

A **sample** is a subset, or some part, of a larger whole. A larger whole could be anything out which sample is taken. That „whole" could be a bucket of water, a bag of sugar, a group of organizations, a group of students, a group of customers, or a group mid-level managers in an organization. A complete group of entities sharing some common set of characteristics is population. In other words, the totality out of which sample is drawn is referred to as **population.**

Why sample?

1. Saves Cost, Labor, and Time

Applied research projects usually have budget and time constraints. Since sample can save financial cost as well as time, therefore, to go for sample study is pragmatic.
Of course, a researcher investigating a population with an extremely small number of population elements may elect to conduct a study on the total population rather than a sample because cost, labor, and time constraints are relatively insignificant.
Although sample study cuts costs, reduces labor requirements, and gathers vital information quickly, yet there could be other reasons.

2. Quality Management/supervision

Professional fieldworkers are a scarce commodity. In a large study rather than employing less qualified staff it may be advisable to do a sample study and employ highly qualified professional fieldworkers. It can certainly affect the quality of the study. At the same time it may be easier to manage a small group and produce quality information. Supervision, record keeping, training, and so forth would all be more difficult in a very large study.

3. Accurate and Reliable Results

Another major reason for sampling is that samples, if properly selected, are sufficiently accurate in most of the cases. If the elements of a population are quite similar, only a small sample is necessary to accurately portray the characteristics of interest. Most of us have had blood samples taken from the finger, the arm, or another part of body. The assumption is that blood is sufficiently similar throughout the body, the characteristics of the blood can be determined on the basis of sample.
When the elements of population are highly homogenous, samples are highly representative of the population. Under these circumstances almost any sample is as good as another.
Samples may be more accurate than census. In a census study of large population there is a greater likelihood of non-sampling errors. In a survey mistakes may occur that are unrelated to the selection of people in the study. For example, a response may be coded incorrectly, or the keyboard operator might make data entry error. Interviewer mistakes, tabulation errors, and other non-sampling errors may increase during census because of the increased volume of work. In sample increased accuracy is possible because the fieldwork and tabulation of the data can be closely supervised than would be possible in a census. In field survey, a small, well trained, closely supervised group may do a more careful and accurate job of collecting information than a large group of nonprofessional interviewers trying to contact everyone.

4. Sampling may be the Only Way
Many research projects, especially those in quality control testing, require the destruction of the items being tested. If the manufacturer of firecrackers wished to find out whether each product met a

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specific production standard, there would be no product left after testing. Similarly, consider the case of electric bulbs. In testing the life of bulbs, if we were to burn every bulb produced, there would be none left to sell. This is destructive sampling.

5. Determine the Period of Study

Interviewing every element of a large population without sampling requires lot of time, may be a year or more. In such a long period study, even the seasonal variation may influence the response pattern of the respondents. For example, if the study was aimed at measuring the level of unemployment in a given large city, the unemployment rate produced by the survey data would not refer to the city as of the beginning of interviewing or as of the end. Researcher may be forced to attribute the unemployment to some hypothetical date, representing to the midpoint of the study period. Hence it will be difficult to determine the exact timing to which the data of the study pertains.

Sampling Terminology

There are a number of technical terms used in books on research and statistics which need explanation. Some of the important terms are:

Element

An element is that unit about which information is collected and which provides the basis of analysis. Typically, in survey research, elements are people or certain types of people. It is that unit about which information is collected and that provides the basis of analysis. It can be a person, groups, families, organizations, corporations, communities, and so forth.

Population

A population is the theoretically specified aggregation of study elements. It is translating the abstract concept into workable concept. For example, let us look at the study of "college students." Theoretically who are the college students? They might include students registered in government colleges and/or private colleges, students of intermediate classes and/or graduate classes, students of professional colleges and/or non-professional colleges, and many other variations. In this way the pool of all available elements is population.

Target Population

Out of the conceptual variations what exactly the researcher wants to focus on. This may also be called a target population. Target population is the complete group of specific population elements relevant to the research project. Target population may also be called *survey population* i.e. that aggregation of elements from which the survey sample is actually selected.

At the outset of the sampling process, it is vitally important to carefully define the target population so that the proper source from which the data is to be collected can be identified. In our example of „college students" finally we may decide to study the college students from government institutions located in Lahore, who are studying social sciences, who are aged 19 years of age, and hailing from rural areas.

Sampling

Sampling is the process of using a small number of items or parts of a larger population to make conclusions about the whole population. It enables the researchers to estimate unknown characteristics of the population.

Sampling Frame

In actual practice the sample will be drawn from a list of population elements that is often different from the target population that has been defined. A sampling frame is the list of elements from which the sample may be drawn. A simple example could be listing of all college students meeting the criteria of target population and who are enrolled on the specified date.

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A sampling frame is also called the *working population* because it provides the list that can be worked with operationally. In our example, such a list could be prepared with help of the staff of the selected colleges.

Sampling Frame Error
A sampling frame error occurs when certain sample elements are excluded or when the entire population is not accurately represented in the sampling frame. The error that occurs when certain sample elements are not listed or available and are not represented in the sampling frame.

Sampling Unit
A sampling unit is that element or set of elements considered for selection in some stage of sampling. Sampling may be done in single stage or in multiple stages. In a simple, single-stage sample, the sampling units are the same as the elements. In more complex samples, however, different levels of sampling units may be employed. For example, a researcher may select a sample of *Mohallahs* in a city, and then select a sample of households from the selected *Mohallahs*, and finally may select a sample of adults from the selected households. The sampling units of these three stages of sampling are respectively *Mohallah*, households, and adults, of which the last of these are the elements. More specifically, the terms "primary sampling units," "secondary sampling units," and "final sampling units" would be used to designate the successive stages.

Observation Unit
An observation unit, or unit of data collection, is an element or aggregation of elements from which the information is collected. Often the unit of analysis and unit of observation are the same – the individual person – but this need not be the case. Thus the researcher may interview heads of household (the observation units) to collect information about every member of the household (the unit of analysis).

Parameter
A parameter is the summary description of a given variable in a population. The mean income of all families in a city and the age distribution of the city"s population are parameters. An important part of survey research involves the estimation of population parameters on the basis of sample observation.

Statistic
A statistic is the summary description of a given variable in a survey sample. Thus the mean income computed from the survey sample and the age distribution of that sample are statistics. Sample statistics are used to make estimates of the population parameters.

Sampling Error
Probability sampling methods seldom, if ever, provide statistics exactly equal to the parameters that they are used to estimate. Probability theory, however, permits us to estimate the error to be expected for a given sample (more information to be sought from professional in Statistics).

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Lesson 27

PROBABILITY AND NON-PROBABILITY SAMPLING

There are several alternative ways of taking a sample. The major alternative sampling plans may be grouped into probability techniques and non-probability techniques. In **probability sampling** every element in the population has a *known nonzero probability* of selection. The simple random is the best known probability sample, in which each member of the population has an equal probability of being selected. Probability sampling designs are used when the representativeness of the sample is of importance in the interest of wider generalizability. When time or other factors, rather than generalizability, become critical, non-probability sampling is generally used.

In non-probability sampling the probability of any particular element of the population being chosen is unknown. The selection of units in non-probability sampling is quite arbitrary, as researchers rely heavily on personal judgment. It should be noted that there are no appropriate statistical techniques for measuring random sampling error from a non-probability sample. Thus projecting the data beyond the sample is statistically inappropriate. Nevertheless, there are occasions when non-probability samples are best suited for the researcher‟s purpose.

Types of non-probability sampling:

In non-probability sampling designs, the elements in the population do not have any probabilities attached to their being chosen as sample subjects. This means that the findings from the study of the sample cannot be confidently generalized to the population. However the researchers may at times be less concerned about generalizability than obtaining some preliminary information in a quick and inexpensive way. Sometimes non-probability could be the only way to collect the data.

Convenience Sampling

Convenience sampling (also called *haphazard or accidental sampling*) refers to sampling by obtaining units or people who are most conveniently available. For example, it may be convenient and economical to sample employees in companies in a nearby area, sample from a pool of friends and neighbors. The person-on-the street interview conducted by TV programs is another example. TV interviewers go on the street with camera and microphone to talk to few people who are convenient to interview. The people walking past a TV studio in the middle of the day do not represent everyone (homemakers, people in the rural areas). Likewise, TV interviewers select people who look “normal” to them and avoid people who are unattractive, poor, very old, or inarticulate.

Another example of haphazard sample is that of a newspaper that asks the readers to clip a questionnaire from the paper and mail it in. Not everyone reads the newspaper, has an interest in the topic, or will take the time to cut out the questionnaire, and mail it. Some will, and the number who does so may seem large, but the sample cannot be used to generalize accurately to the population.

Convenience samples are least reliable but normally the cheapest and easiest to conduct. Convenience sampling is most often used during the exploratory phase of a research project and is perhaps the best way of getting some basic information quickly and efficiently. Often such sample is taken to test ideas or even to gain ideas about a subject of interest.

Purposive Sampling

Depending upon the type of topic, the researcher lays down the criteria for the subjects to be included in the sample. Whoever meets that criteria could be selected in the sample? The researcher might select such cases or might provide the criteria to somebody else and leave it to his/her judgment for the actual selection of the subjects. That is why such a sample is also called as **judgmental or expert opinion sample.** For example a researcher is interested in studying students who are enrolled in a course on research methods, are highly regular, are frequent participants in the class discussions, and

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often come with new ideas. The criteria has been laid down, the researcher may do this job himself/herself, or may ask the teacher of this class to select the students by using the said criteria. In the latter situation we are leaving it to the judgment of the teacher to select the subjects. Similarly we can give some criteria to the fieldworkers and leave it to their judgment to select the subjects accordingly. In a study of working women the researcher may lay down the criteria like: the lady is married, has two children, one of her child is school going age, and is living in nuclear family.

Quota Sampling

A sampling procedure that ensures that certain characteristics of a population sample will be represented to the exact extent that the researcher desires. In this case the researcher first identifies relevant categories of people (e.g. male and female; or under age 30, ages 30 to 60, over 60, etc.) then decides how many to get in each category. Thus the number of people in various categories of sample is fixed. For example the researcher decides to select 5 males and 5 females under age 30, 10 males and 10 females aged 30 to 60, and 5 males and 5 females over age 60 for a 40 person sample. This is quota sampling.

Once the quota has been fixed then the researcher may use convenience sampling. The convenience sampling may introduce **bias**. For example, the field worker might select the individual according to his/her liking, who can easily be contacted, willing to be interviewed, and belong to middle class.

Quota sampling can be considered as a form of proportionate stratified sampling, in which a predetermined proportion of people are sampled from different groups, but on a convenience basis.

Speed of data collection, lower costs, and convenience are the major advantages of quota sampling compared to probability sampling. Quota sampling becomes necessary when a subset of a population is underrepresented, and may not get any representation if equal opportunity is provided to each. Although there are many problems with quota sampling, careful supervision of the data collection may provide a representative sample of the various subgroups within the population.

Snowball Sampling

Snowball sampling (also called *network, chain referral, or reputational sampling*) is a method for identifying and sampling (or selecting) cases in the network. It is based on an analogy to a snowball, which begins small but becomes larger as it is rolled on wet snow and picks up additional snow. It begins with one or a few people or cases and spreads out on the basis of links to the initial cases.

This design has been found quite useful where respondents are difficult to identify and are best located through referral networks. In the initial stage of snowball sampling, individuals are discovered and may or may not be selected through probability methods. This group is then used to locate others who possess similar characteristics and who, in turn, identify others. The “snowball” gather subjects as it rolls along.

For example, a researcher examines friendship networks among teenagers in a community. He or she begins with three teenagers who do not know each other. Each teen names four close friends. The researcher then goes to the four friends and asks each to name four close friends, then goes to those four and does the same thing again, and so forth. Before long, a large number of people are involved. Each person in the sample is directly or indirectly tied to the original teenagers, and several people may have named the same person. The researcher eventually stops, either because no new names are given, indicating a closed network, or because the network is so large that it is at the limit of what he or she can study.

Sequential Sampling

Sequential sampling is similar to purposive sampling with one difference. In purposive sampling, the researcher tries to find as many relevant cases as possible, until time, financial resources, or his or her energy is exhausted. The principle is to get every possible case. In sequential sampling, a researcher

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continues to gather cases until the amount of new information or diversity is filled. The principle is to gather cases until a saturation point is reached. In economic terms, information is gathered, or the incremental benefit for additional cases, levels off or drops significantly. It requires that the researcher continuously evaluates all the collected cases. For example, a researcher locates and plans in-depth interviews with 60 widows over 70 years old who have been living without a spouse for 10 or more years. Depending on the researcher‟s purposes, getting an additional 20 widows whose life experiences, social background, and worldview differ little from the first 60 may be unnecessary.

Theoretical Sampling

In theoretical sampling, what the researcher is sampling (e.g. people, situation, events, time periods, etc.) is carefully selected, as the researcher develops grounded theory. A growing theoretical interest guides the selection of sample cases. The researcher selects cases based on new insights they may provide.

For example, a field researcher may be observing a site and a group of people during week days. Theoretically, the researcher may question whether the people act the same at other times or when other aspects of site change. He or she could then sample other time periods (e.g. nights and weekends) to get more full picture and learn whether important conditions are the same.

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Lesson 28

TYPES OF PROBABILITY SAMPLING

Probability samples that rely on random processes require more work than nonrandom ones. A researcher must identify specific sampling elements (e.g. persons) to include in the sample. For example, if conducting a telephone survey, the researcher needs to try to reach the specific sampled person, by calling back several times, to get an accurate sample.

Random samples are most likely to yield a sample that truly represents the population. In addition, random sampling lets a researcher statistically calculate the relationship between the sample and the population – that is the size of *sampling error*. A non-statistical definition of the sampling error is the deviation between sample result and a population parameter due to random process.

Simple Random Sample

The simple random sample is both the easiest random sample to understand and the one on which other types are modeled. In simple random sampling, a research develops an accurate sampling frame, selects elements from sampling frame according to mathematically random procedure, then locates the exact element that was selected for inclusion in the sample.

After numbering all elements in a sampling frame, the researcher uses a list of random numbers to decide which elements to select. He or she needs as many random numbers as there are elements to be sampled: for example, for a sample of 100, 100 random numbers are needed. The researcher can get random numbers from a random number table, a table of numbers chosen in a mathematically random way. Random-number tables are available in most statistics and research methods books. The numbers are generated by a pure random process so that any number has an equal probability of appearing in any position. Computer programs can also produce lists of random number.

A random starting point should be selected at the outset.

Random sampling does not guarantee that every random sample perfectly represents the population. Instead, it means that most random samples will be close to the population most of the time, and that one can calculate the probability of a particular sample being inaccurate. A researcher estimates the chance that a particular sample is off or unrepresentative by using information from the sample to estimate the sampling distribution. The sampling distribution is the key idea that lets a researcher calculate sampling error and confidence interval.

Systematic Random Sample

Systematic random sampling is simple random sampling with a short cut for random selection. Again, the first step is to number each element in the sampling frame. Instead of using a list of random numbers, researcher calculates a *sampling interval*, and the interval becomes his or her own quasi random selection method. The sampling interval (i.e. 1 in *K where K is some number)* tells the researcher how to select elements from a sampling frame by skipping elements in the frame before one for the sample.

Sampling intervals are easy to compute. We need the sample size and the population size. You can think of the sample interval as the inverse of the sampling ratio. The sampling ratio for 300 names out of 900 will be 300/900 = .333 = 33.3 percent. The sampling interval is 900/300 = 3

Begin with a random start. The easiest way to do this is to point blindly at a number from those from the beginning that are likely to be part of the sampling interval.

When the elements are organized in some kind of cycle or pattern, the systematic sampling will not give a representative sample.

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Stratified Random Sample

When the population is heterogeneous, the use of simple random sample may not produce representative sample. Some of the bigger strata may get over representation while some of the small ones may entirely be eliminated. Look at the variables that are likely to affect the results, and stratify the population in such a way that each stratum becomes homogeneous group within itself. Then draw the required sample by using the table of random numbers. Hence in stratified random sampling a sub-sample is drawn utilizing simple random sampling within each stratum. (Randomization is not done for quota sampling).

There are three reasons why a researcher chooses a stratified random sample: (1) to increase a sample‟s statistical efficiency, (2) to provide adequate data for analyzing the various subpopulations, and (3) to enable different research methods and procedures to be used in different strata.

1. Stratification is usually more efficient statistically than simple random sampling and at worst it is equal to it. With the ideal stratification, each stratum is homogeneous internally and heterogeneous with other strata. This might occur in a sample that includes members of several distinct ethnic groups. In this instance, stratification makes a pronounced improvement in statistical efficiency.
2. Stratified random sampling provides the assurance that the sample will accurately reflect the population on the basis of criterion or criteria used for stratification. This is a concern because occasionally simple random sampling yields a disproportionate number of one group or another, and the sample ends up being less representative than it could be.
3. Random sampling error will be reduced with the use of stratified random sampling because each group is internally homogeneous but there are comparative differences between groups. More technically, a smaller standard error may result from stratified sampling because the groups are adequately represented when strata are combined.
4. It is possible when the researcher wants to study the characteristics of a certain population subgroups. Thus if one wishes to draw some conclusions about activities in different classes of student body, stratified sampling would be used.
5. Stratified sampling is also called for when different methods of data collection are applied in different parts of the population. This might occur when we survey company employees at the home office with one method but mist use a different approach with employees scattered over the country.

Stratification Process

The ideal stratification would be based on the primary variable (the dependent variable) under study. The criterion is identified as an efficient basis for stratification. The criterion for stratification is that it is a characteristic of the population elements known to be related to the dependent variable or other variables of interest. The variable chosen should increase homogeneity within each stratum and increase heterogeneity between strata.

Next, for each separate subgroup or stratum, a list of population elements must be obtained. Serially number the elements within each stratum. Using a table of random numbers or some other device, a separate simple random sample is taken within each stratum. Of course the researcher must determine how large a sample must be drawn from each stratum

Proportionate versus Disproportionate

If the number of sampling units drawn from each stratum is in proportion to the relative population size of the stratum, the sample is proportionate stratified sampling. Sometime, however, a disproportionate stratified sample will be selected to ensure an adequate number of sampling units in every stratum. In a disproportionate, sample size for each stratum is not allocated in proportion to the population size, but is dictated by analytical considerations.

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Cluster Sampling

The purpose of cluster sampling is to sample economically while retaining the characteristics of a probability sample. Groups or chunks of elements that, ideally, would have heterogeneity among the members within each group are chosen for study in cluster sampling. This is in contrast to choosing some elements from the population as in simple random sampling, or stratifying and then choosing members from the strata, or choosing every nth case in the population in systematic sampling. When several groups with intra-group heterogeneity and inter-group homogeneity are found, then a random sampling of the clusters or groups can ideally be done and information gathered from each of the members in the randomly chosen clusters.

Cluster samples offer more heterogeneity within groups and more homogeneity among and homogeneity within each group and heterogeneity across groups.

Cluster sampling addresses two problems: researchers lack a good sampling frame for a dispersed population and the cost to reach a sampled element is very high. A cluster is unit that contains final sampling elements but can be treated temporarily as a sampling element itself. Researcher first samples clusters, each of which contains elements, then draws a second sample from within the clusters selected in the first stage of sampling. In other words, the researcher randomly samples clusters, then randomly samples elements from within the selected clusters. He or she can create a good sampling frame of clusters, even if it is impossible to create one for sampling elements. Once the researcher gets a sample of clusters, creating a sampling frame for elements within each cluster becomes more manageable. A second advantage for geographically dispersed populations is that elements within each cluster are physically closer to each other. This may produce a savings in locating or reaching each element.

A researcher draws several samples in stages in cluster sampling. In a three-stage sample, stage 1 is random sampling of big clusters; stage 2 is random sampling of small clusters within each selected big cluster; and the last stage is sampling of elements from within the sampled small clusters. First, one randomly samples the city blocks, then households within blocks, then individuals within households. This can also be an example of **multistage area sampling.**

The unit costs of cluster sampling are much lower than those of other probability sampling designs. However, cluster sampling exposes itself to greater biases at each stage of sampling.

Double Sampling

This plan is adopted when further information is needed from a subset of the group from which some information has already been collected for the same study. A sampling design where initially a sample is used in a study to collect some preliminary information of interest, and later a sub-sample of this primary sample is used to examine the matter in more detail, is called double sampling.

What is the Appropriate Sample Design?

A researcher who must make a decision concerning the most appropriate sample design for a specific project will identify a number of sampling criteria and evaluate the relative importance of each criterion before selecting a sample design. The most common criteria are:

Degree of Accuracy

Selecting a representative sample is, of course, important to all researchers. However, the error may vary from project to project, especially when cost saving or another benefit may be a trade-off for reduction in accuracy.

Resources

The costs associated with the different sampling techniques vary tremendously. If the researcher‟s financial and human resources are restricted, this limitation of resources will eliminate certain

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methods. For a graduate student working on a master‟s thesis, conducting a national survey is almost always out of the question because of limited resources. Managers usually weigh the cost of research versus the value of information often will opt to save money by using non-probability sampling design rather than make the decision to conduct no research at all.

Advance Knowledge of the Population

Advance knowledge of population characteristics, such as the availability of lists of population members, is an important criterion. A lack of adequate list may automatically rule out any type of probability sampling.

National versus Local Project

Geographic proximity of population elements will influence sample design. When population elements are unequally distributed geographically, a cluster sampling may become more attractive.

Need for Statistical Analysis

The need for statistical projections based on the sample is often a criterion. Non-probability sampling techniques do not allow researcher to use statistical analysis to project the data beyond the sample.

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Lesson 29

DATA ANALYSIS

Once the data begins to flow in, attention turns to data analysis. If the project has been done correctly, the analysis planning is already done. Back at the research design stage or at least by the completion of the proposal or the pilot test, decisions should have been made about how to analyze the data.

During the analysis stage several interrelated procedures are performed to summarize and rearrange the data. The goal of most research is to provide information. There is a difference between raw data and information.

Information refers to a body of facts that are in a format suitable for decision making, whereas **data** are simply recorded measures of certain phenomenon. The raw data collected in the field must be transformed into information that will answer the sponsor‟s (e.g. manager‟s) questions. The conversion of raw data into information requires that the data be edited and coded so that the data may be transferred to a computer or other data storage medium.

If the database is large, there are many advantages to utilizing a computer. Assuming a large database, entering the data into computer follows the coding procedure.

Editing

Occasionally, a fieldworker makes a mistake and records an improbable answer (e.g., birth year: 1843) or interviews an ineligible respondent (e.g., someone too young to qualify). Seemingly contradictory answers, such as “no” to automobile ownership but “yes” to an expenditure on automobile insurance, may appear on a questionnaire. There are many problems like these that must be dealt with before the data can be coded. Editing procedures are conducted to make the data ready for coding and transfer to data storage.

Editing is the process of checking and adjusting the data for omissions, legibility, and consistency. Editing may be differentiated from coding, which is the assignment of numerical scales or classifying symbols to previously edited data.

The purpose of editing is to ensure the completeness, consistency, and readability of the data to be transferred to data storage. The editor‟s task is to check for errors and omissions on the questionnaires or other data collection forms.

The editor may have to reconstruct some data. For instance, a respondent may indicate weekly income rather than monthly income, as requested on the questionnaire. The editor must convert the information to monthly data without adding any extraneous information. The editor “should bring to light all hidden values and extract all possible information from a questionnaire, while adding nothing extraneous.”

Field Editing

In large projects, field supervisors are often responsible for conducting preliminary field edits. The purpose of field editing on the same day by the interview is to catch technical omissions (such as a blank page), check legibility of the handwriting, and clarify responses that are logically or conceptually inconsistent. If a daily field editing is conducted, a supervisor who edits completed questionnaires will frequently be able to question the interviewers, who may be able to recall the interview well enough to correct any problems. The number of “no answers,” or incomplete answers can be reduced with a rapid follow-up simulated by a field edit. The daily edit also allows fieldworkers to re-contact the respondent to fill in omissions before the situation has changed. The field edit may also indicate the need for further training of interviewers.

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In-House Editing

Although almost simultaneous editing in the field is highly desirable, in many situations (particularly with mail questionnaires), early reviewing of the data is not possible. In-house editing rigorously investigates the results of data collection.

Editing for Consistency:

The in-house editor‟s task is to ensure that inconsistent or contradictory responses are adjusted and that answers will not be a problem for coders and keyboard punchers. Consider the situation in which a telephone interviewer has been instructed to interview only registered voters that requires voters to be 18 years old. If the editor‟s reviews of a questionnaire indicate that the respondent was only 17 years of age, the editor‟s task is to eliminate this obviously incorrect sampling unit. Thus, in this example, the editor‟s job is to make sure that the sampling unit is consistent with the objectives of the study.

Editing requires checking for logically consistent responses. The in-house editor must determine if the answers given by a respondent to one question are consistent with those given to other, related questions. Many surveys utilize filter questions or skip questions that direct the sequence of questions, depending upon respondent‟s answer. In some cases the respondent will have answered a sequence of questions that should not have been asked. The editor should adjust these answers, usually to "no answer‟ or "inapplicable," so that the responses will be consistent.

Editing for Completeness:

In some cases the respondent may have answered only the second portion of a two-part question. An in-house editor may have to adjust the answers to the following question for completeness. For example:

Does your organization have more than one Internet Web site? Yes_____No _____

If a respondent checked neither "yes" nor "No", but indicated three Internet Web sites, the editor may check the "yes" to ensure that this answer is not missing from the questionnaire.

Item Non-response:

It is a technical term for an unanswered question on an otherwise complete questionnaire. Specific decision rules for handling this problem should be meticulously outlined in the editorial instructions. In many situations the decision rule will be to do nothing with the unanswered question: the editor merely indicates in item non-response by writing a message instructing the coder to record a "missing value" or blank as the response. However, in case the response is necessary then the editor uses the **plug value.** The decision rule may to "plug in" an average or neutral value in each case of missing data. A blank response in an interval scale item with a mid-point would be to assign the mid-point in the scale as the response to that particular item. Another way is to assign to the item the mean value of the responses of all those who have responded to that particular item. Another choice is to give the item the mean of the responses of this particular respondent to all other questions measuring the variables. Another decision rule may be to alternate the choice of the response categories used as plug values (e.g. "yes" the first time, "no" the second time, "yes" the third time, and so on).

The editor must also decide whether or not an entire questionnaire is "usable." When a questionnaire has too many (say 25%) answers missing, it may not be suitable for the planned data analysis. In such a situation the editor simply records the fact that a particular incomplete questionnaire has been dropped from the sample.

Editing Questions Answered out of Order: Another situation an editor may face is the need to rearrange the answers to an open-ended response to a question. For example, a respondent may have provided the answer to a subsequent question in his answer to an earlier open-ended response

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question. Because the respondent had already clearly identified his answer, the interviewer may have avoided asking the subsequent question. The interviewer may have wanted to avoid hearing "I have already answered that earlier" and to maintain rapport with the respondent and therefore skipped the question. To make the response appear in the same order as on other questionnaires, the editor may remove the out-of-order answer to the section related to the skipped question.

Coding

Coding involves assigning numbers or other symbols to answers so the responses can be grouped into limited number of classes or categories. The classifying of data into limited categories sacrifices some data detail but is necessary for efficient analysis. Nevertheless, it is recommended that try to keep the data in raw form so far it is possible. When the data have been entered into the computer you can always ask the computer to group and regroup the categories. In case the data have been entered in the compute in grouped form, it will not be possible to disaggregate it.

Although codes are generally considered to be numerical symbols, they are more broadly defined as the rules for interpreting, classifying, and recording data. Codes allow data to be processed in a computer. Researchers organize data into fields, records, and files. A **field** is a collection of characters (a character is a single number, letter of the alphabet, or special symbol such as the question mark) that represent a single type of data. A **record** is collection of related fields. A **file** is a collection of related records. File, records, and fields are stored on magnetic tapes, floppy disks, or hard drives.

Researchers use a coding procedure and codebook. A **coding procedure** is a set of rules stating that certain numbers are assigned to variable attributes. For example, a researchers codes males as 1 and females as 2. Each category of variable and missing information needs a code. A **codebook** is a document (i.e. one or more pages) describing the coding procedure and the location of data for variables in a format that computers can use.

When you code data, it is very important to create a well-organized, detailed codebook and make multiple copies of it. If you do not write down the details of the coding procedure, or if you misplace the codebook, you have lost the key to the data and may have to recode the data again.

Researchers begin thinking about a coding procedure and a codebook before they collect data. For example a survey researcher pre-codes a questionnaire before collecting the data. Pre-coding means placing the code categories (e.g. 1 for male, 2 for female) on the questionnaire. Sometimes to reduce dependence on codebooks, researchers also place the location in the computer format on the questionnaire.

If the researcher does not pre-code, his or her first step after collecting and editing of data is to create a codebook. He or she also gives each case an identification number to keep track of the cases. Next, the researcher transfers the information from each questionnaire into a format that computers can read.

Code Construction

When the question has a fixed-alternative (closed ended) format, the number of categories requiring codes is determined during the questionnaire design stage. The codes 8 and 9 are conventionally given to "don"t know" (DK) and "no answer" (NA) respectively. However, many computer program fields recognize a blank field or a certain character symbol, such as a period (.), as indicating a missing value (no answer).

There are two basic rules for code construction. First, the coding categories should be ***exhaustive*** – that is, coding categories should be provided for all subjects or objects or responses. With a categorical variable such as sex, making categories exhaustive is not a problem. However, when the response represents a small number of subjects or when the responses might be categorized in a class not typically found, there may be a problem.

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Second, the coding categories should also be ***mutually exclusive*** and ***independent***. This means that there should be no overlap between the categories, to ensure that a subject or response can be placed in only one category. This frequently requires that an "other" code category be included, so that the categories are all inclusive and mutually exclusive. For example, managerial span of control might be coded 1, 2, 3, 4, and "5 or more." The "5 or more" category ensures everyone a place in a category. When a questionnaire is highly structured, pre-coding of the categories typically occurs before the data are collected. In many cases, such as when researchers are using open-ended response questions, a framework for classifying responses to questions cannot be established before data collection. This situation requires some careful thought concerning the determination of categories after editing process has been completed. This is called post-coding or simply *coding.* The purpose of **coding open-ended response questions** is to reduce the large number of individual responses to a few general categories of answers that can be assigned numerical scores. Code construction in these situations necessarily must reflect the judgment of the researcher. A major objective in code-building process is to accurately transfer the meaning from written answers to numeric codes.

Code Book

A book identifying each variable in a study and its position in the data matrix is known as code book. The book is used to identify a variable‟s description, code name, and field. Here is a sample:

O/V No.	**Field/ col. No.**	**Code values**
--	1-5	Study number
-	6	City
		1 = Lahore
		2 = Rawalpindi
		3 = Karachi
	7 -9	Interview No.
Sex	10	1 = Male
		2 = Female
Age	11-12	Actual
Education	13	1 = Non literate
		2 = Literate

Production Coding

Transferring the data from the questionnaire or data collection form after the data have been collected is called production coding. Depending upon the nature of the data collection form, codes may be written directly on the instrument or on a special coding sheet.

Data Entries

Use of scanner sheets for data collection may facilitate the entry of the responses directly into the computer without manual keying in the data. In studies involving highly structured paper questionnaires, an **Optical scanning system** may be used to read material directly to the computer‟s memory into the computer‟s memory. Optical scanners process the marked-sensed questionnaires and store the answers in a file.

Cleaning Data

The final stage in the coding process is the error checking and verification, or **"data cleaning"** stage, which is a check to make sure that all codes are legitimate. Accuracy is extremely important when coding data. Errors made when coding or entering data into a computer threaten the validity of measures and cause misleading results. A researcher who has perfect sample, perfect measures, and no errors in gathering data, but who makes errors in the coding process or in entering data into a computer, can ruin a whole research project.

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Lesson 30

DATA TRANSFROMATION

Data transformation is the process of changing data from their original form to a format that is more suitable to perform a data analysis that will achieve the research objectives. Researchers often modify the values of a scalar data or create new variables. For example many researchers believe that response bias will be less if interviewers ask consumers for their year of birth rather than their age, even though the objective of the data analysis is to investigate respondents‟ age in years. This does not present a problem for the research analyst, because a simple data transformation is possible. The raw data coded at birth year can be easily transformed to age by subtracting the birth year from the current year.

Collapsing or combining categories of a variable is a common data transformation that reduces the number of categories. For example five categories of Likert scale response categories to a question may be combined like: the “strongly agree” and the “agree” response categories are combined. The “strongly disagree” and the “disagree” response categories are combined into a single category. The result is the collapsing of the five-category scale down to three.

Creating new variables by re-specifying the data numeric or logical transformations is another important data transformation. For example, Likert summated scale reflect the combination of scores (raw data) from various attitudinal statements. The summative score for an attitude scale with three statements is calculated as follows:

Summative Score = Variable 1 + Variable 2 + Variable 3

This calculation can be accomplished by using simple arithmetic or by programming a computer with a data transformation equation that creates the new variable “summative score.”

The researchers have created numerous different scales and indexes to measure social phenomenon. For example scales and indexes have been developed to measure the degree of formalization in bureaucratic organization, the prestige of occupations, the adjustment of people in marriage, the intensity of group interaction, the level of social activity in a community, and the level of socio-economic development of a nation.

Keep it in mind that every social phenomenon can be measured. Some constructs can be measured directly and produce precise numerical values (e.g. family income). Other constructs require the use of surrogates or proxies that indirectly measure a variable (e.g. job satisfaction). Second, a lot can be learned from measures used by other researchers. We are fortunate to have the work of thousands of researchers to draw on. It is not always necessary to start from a scratch. We can use a past scale or index, or we can modify it for our own purposes. The process of creating measures for a construct evolves over time. Measurement is an ongoing process with constant change; new concepts are developed, theoretical definitions are refined, and scales or indexes that measure old or new constructs are improved.

Indexes and Scales

Scales and indexes are often used interchangeably. One researcher‟s scale is another‟s index. Both produce ordinal- or interval- level measures of variable. To add to the confusion, scale and index techniques can be combined in one measure. Scales and indexes give a researcher more information about variables and make it possible to assess the quality of measurement. Scales and indexes increase reliability and validity, and they aid in **data reduction;** that is condense and simplify the information that is collected.

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A **scale** is a measure in which the researcher captures the intensity, direction, level, or potency of a variable construct. It arranges responses or observation on a continuum. A scale can use single indicator or multiple indicators. Most are at the ordinal level of measurement.

An **index** is a measure in which a researcher adds or combines several distinct indicators of a construct into a single score. This composite score is often a simple sum of multiple indicators. It is used for content or convergent validity. Indexes are often measured at the interval or ratio level.

Researchers sometimes combine the features of scales and indexes in a single measure. This is common when a researcher has several indicators that are scales. He or she then adds these indicators together to yield a single score, thereby an index.

Unidimensionality: It means that all the items in a scale or index fit together, or measure a single construct. Unidimensionality says: If you combine several specific pieces of information into a single score or measure, have all the pieces measure the same thing (each sub dimension is part of the construct‟s overall content).

For example, we define the construct "feminist ideology" as a general ideology about gender. Feminist ideology is a highly abstract and general construct. It includes a specific beliefs and attitudes towards social, economic, political, family, sexual relations. The ideology‟s five belief areas parts of a single general construct. The parts are mutually reinforcing and together form a system of beliefs about dignity, strength, and power of women.

Index Construction

You may have heard about a consumer price index (CPI). The CPI, which is a measure of inflation, is created by totaling the cost of buying a list of goods and services (e.g. food, rent, and utilities) and comparing the total to the cost of buying the same list in the previous year. An **index** is combination of items into a single numerical score. Various components or subgroups of a construct are each measured, and then combined into one measure.

There are many types of indexes. For example, if you take an exam with 25 questions, the total number of questions correct is a kind of index. It is a composite measure in which each question measures a small piece of knowledge, and all the questions scored correct or incorrect are totaled to produce a single measure.

One way to demonstrate that indexes are not a very complicated is to use one. Answer yes or no to the seven questions that follow on the characteristics of an occupation. Base your answers on your thoughts regarding the following four occupations: long-distance truck driver, medical doctor, accountant, telephone operator. Score each answer 1 for yes and 0 for no.

1. Does it pay good salary?
2. Is the job secure from layoffs or unemployment?
3. Is the work interesting and challenging?
4. Are its working conditions (e.g. hours, safety, time on the road) good?
5. Are there opportunities for career advancement and promotion?
6. Is it prestigious or looked up to by others?
7. Does it permit self-direction and the freedom to make decisions?

Total the seven answers for each of the four occupations. Which had the highest and which had the lowest score? The seven questions are our operational definition of the construct good occupation. Each question represents a subpart of our theoretical definition.

Creating indexes is so easy that it is important to be careful that every item in the index has face validity. Items without face validity should be excluded. Each part of the construct should be

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measured with at least one indicator. Of course, it is better to measure the parts of a construct with multiple indicators.

Another example of an index is college quality index. Our theoretical definition says that a high quality college has six distinguished characteristics: (1) fewer students per faculty member, (2) a highly educated faculty, (3) more books in the library, (4) fewer students dropping out of college, (5) more students who go to advanced degrees and (6) faculty members who publish books or scholarly articles. We score 100 colleges on each item, and then add the score for each to create an index score of college quality that can be used to compare colleges.

Indexes can be combined with one another. For example, in order to strengthen the college quality index. We add a sub-index on teaching quality. The index contain eight elements: (1) average size of classes, (2) percentage of class time devoted to discussion, (3) number of different classes each faculty member teaches, (4) availability of faculty to students outside the classroom, (5) currency and amount of reading assigned, (6) degree to which assignments promote learning, (7) degree to which faculty get to know each student, and (8) student ratings of instruction. Similar sub-index measures can be created for other parts of the college quality index. They can be combined into a more global measure of college quality. This further elaborates the definition of a construct "quality of college."

Weighting

An important issue in index construction is whether to weight items. Unless it is otherwise stated, assume that an index is un-weighted. Likewise, unless we have a good reason for assigning different weights, use equal weights. A weighted index gives each item equal weight. It involves adding up the items without modification, as if each were multiplied by 1 (or – 1 for negative items that are negative).

Scoring and Score Index

In one our previous discussions we had tried to measure job satisfaction. It was operationalized with the help of dimensions and elements. We had constructed number of statements on each element with 5 response categories using Likert scale i.e. strongly agree, agree, undecided, disagree, and strongly disagree. We could score each of these items from 1 to 5 depending upon the degree of agreement with the statement. The statements have been both positive as well as negative. For positive statements we can score straight away from 5 to 1 i.e. strongly agree to strongly disagree. For the negative statements we have to reverse the score i.e. 1 for "strongly agree," 2 for "agree," 3 for "undecided" to 4 for "disagree," and 5 for "strongly disagree." Reason being that negative multiplied by a negative becomes positive i.e. a negative statement and a person strongly disagreeing with it implies that he or she has a positive responsive so we give a score of 5 in this example. In our example, let us say there were 23 statements measuring for different elements and dimensions measuring job satisfaction. When on each statement the respondent could get a minimum score of 1 and a maximum score of 5, on 23 statements a respondent could get a minimum score of (23 X 1) and a maximum score of (23 X 5) 115. In this way the score index ranges from 23 to 115, the lower end of the score index showing minimum job satisfaction and upper end as the highest job satisfaction. In reality we may not find any on the extremes, rather the respondents could be spread along this continuum. We could use the raw scores of independent and dependent variable and apply appropriate statistics for testing the hypothesis. We could also divide the score index into different categories like high "job satisfaction" and "low satisfaction" for presentation in a table. We cross-classify job satisfaction with some other variable; apply appropriate statistics for testing the hypothesis.

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Lesson 31

DATA PRESENTATION

Tables and graphs (pictorial presentation of data) may simplify and clarify the research data. Tabular and graphic representation of data may take a number of forms, ranging from computer printouts to elaborate pictographs. The purpose of each table or graph, however, is to facilitate the summarization and communication of the meaning of the data.

Although there are number of standardized forms for presenting data in table or graphs, the creative researcher can increase the effectiveness of particular presentation. Bar charts, pie charts, curve diagrams, pictograms, and other graphic forms of presentation create a strong visual impression.

The proliferation of computer technology in business and universities has greatly facilitated tabulation and statistical analysis. Commercial packages eliminate the need to write a new program every time you want to tabulate and analyze data with a computer. SAS, Statistical Package for the Social Sciences (SPSS), SYSTAT, Epi, Info, and MINITAB is commonly used statistical packages. These user friendly packages emphasize statistical calculations and hypothesis testing for varied types of data. They also provide programs for entering and editing data. Most of these packages contain sizeable arrays of programs for descriptive analysis and univariate, bivariate, and multivariate statistical analysis.

Results with one variable

Frequency Distribution

Several useful techniques for displaying data are in use. The easiest way to describe the numerical data of one variable is with a frequency distribution. It can be used with nominal, ordinal, interval, or ratio-level data and takes many forms. For example we have data of 400 students. We can summarize the data on the gender of the students at a glance with raw count or a *frequency distribution*

Table 1: Frequency distribution of students

	Gender	**Frequency**	**Percent**
	Male	300	75
	Female	100	25
	Total	**400**	**100**

We can present the same information in a graphic form. Some common types of graphic presentations are the *histograms, bar chart, and pie chart.* Bar charts or graphs are used for discrete variables. They can have vertical or horizontal orientation with small space between the bars. The terminology is not exact, but histograms are usually upright bar graphs for interval or ratio data.

Presentation of data in these forms lays emphasis on visual representation and graphical techniques over summary statistics. Summary statistics may obscure, conceal, or even misrepresent the

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underlying structure of the data. Therefore it is suggested that data analysis should begin with visual inspection.

The presented data has to be interpreted. The purpose of interpretation is to explain the meaning of data so that we can make inferences and formulate conclusions. Therefore, **interpretation** refers to making inferences pertinent to the meaning and implications of the research investigation and drawing conclusions. In order for interpretation, the data have to be meaningfully analyzed. For purposes of analysis the researchers use statistics.

The word *statistics* has several meanings. It can mean a set of collected numbers (e.g. numbers telling how many people living in a city) as well as a branch of applied mathematics used to manipulate and summarize the features of numbers. Social researchers use both types of statistics. Here, we focus on the second type – ways to manipulate and summarize numbers that represent data from research project.

Descriptive statistics describe numerical data. They can be categorized by the number of variables involved: univariate, bivariate, or multivariate (for one, two, and three or more variables). Univariate statistics describe one variable.

Researchers often want to summarize the information about one variable into a single number. They use three measures of central tendency, or measures of the center of the frequency distribution: mean, median and mode, which are often called averages (a less precise and less clear way to say the same thing). The *mode* is simply the most common or frequently occurring number. The *median* is the middle point. The *mean* also called the arithmetic average, is the most widely used measure of central tendency. A particular central tendency is used depending upon the nature of the data.

Bivariate Tables

The bivariate contingency table is widely used. The table is based on cross-tabulation (cross-classification); that is the cases are organized in the table on the basis of two variables at the same time.

A contingency table is formed by cross-tabulating the two or more variables. It is contingent because the cases in each category of a variable get distributed into each category of a second variable. The table distributes cases into categories of multiple variables at the same time and shows how the cases, by the category of one variable, are "contingent upon" the categories of the other variables.

Constructing Percentage Tables

It is to construct a percentage table, but there are ways to make it look professional. Let us take two variables like the age of the respondents and their attitude towards "women empowerment." Assuming that age affects the attitude towards women empowerment let us hypothesize: the lower the age, the higher the favorable attitude towards "women empowerment." The age range of the respondents is 25 to 70, and the attitude index has three categories of "highly favorable," "medium favorable," and "low favorable." The age variable has so many categories that making a table with that number becomes unwieldy and meaningless. Therefore, we regroup (recode) the age categories into three i.e. under 40 years, 40 – 60 years, and 61 + years.

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Univariate table for age

- Table 2: Age of the respondents

Age (Yrs.)	Frequency	Percent
Under 40	1000	33.3
40 – 60	1000	33.3
61 +	1000	33.3
Total	3000	100

Univariate table for attitude

- Table 3: Attitude towards women empowerment

Attitude	Frequency	Percent
Hi Favorable	1100	37
Lo Favorable	850	28
Med Favorable	1050	35
Total	3000	100

Bivariate table

- Table 4: Age by attitude towards women empowerment

Level of attitude	Age (in years) under 40 F.	%	40 –60 F.	%	61 + F	%	Total F	%
Hi Favorable	600	60	300	30	200	20	1100	37
Med. Favorable	300	30	500	50	250	25	1050	35
Lo Favorable	100	10	200	20	500	50	850	28
Total	1000	100	1000	100	1000	100	3000	100

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Lesson 32

THE PARTS OF THE TABLE

1. Give each table a number.
2. Give each table a title, which names variables and provides background information
3. Label the row and columns variables and give name to each of the variable categories.
4. Include the totals of the columns and rows. These are called *marginal*. They equal the univariate frequency distribution for the variable.
5. Each number or place that corresponds to the intersection of a category for each variable is a *cell of a table.*
6. The numbers with the labeled variable categories and the totals are called the *body of the table*.
7. If there is missing information, report the number of missing cases near the table to account for all original cases.

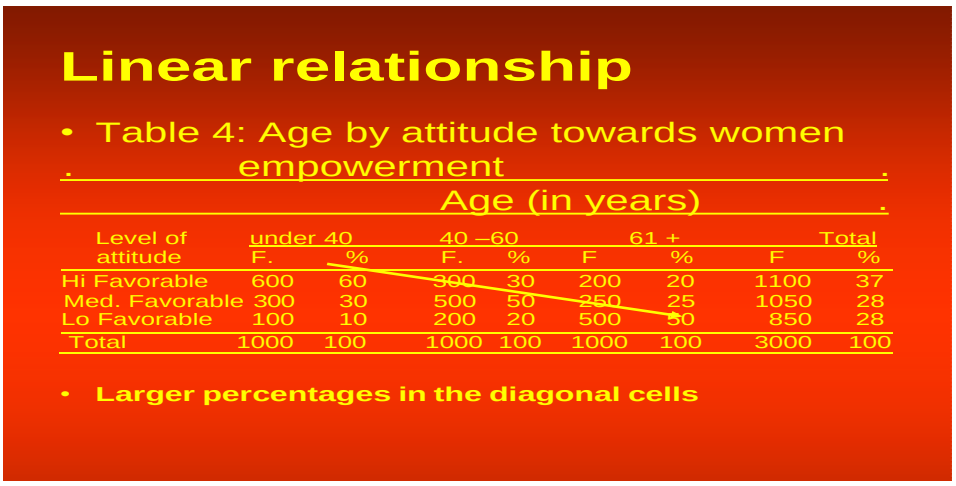
Researchers convert raw count tables into percentages to see bivariate relationship. There are three ways to percentage a table: by row, by column, and for the total. The first two are often used and show relationship.

Is it best to percentage by row or column? Either could be appropriate. A researcher‟s hypothesis may imply looking at row percentages or the column percentages. Here, the hypothesis is that age affects attitude, so column percentages are most helpful. Whenever one factor in a cross-tabulation can be considered the cause of the other, percentage will be most illuminating if they are computed in the direction of the causal factor.

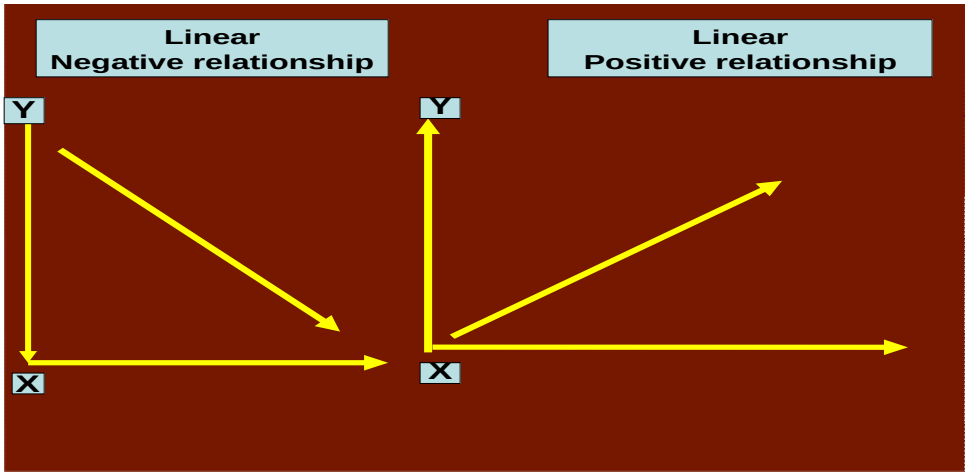
Reading a percentage Table: Once we understand how table is made, reading it and figuring out what it says are much easier. To read a table, first look at the title, the variable labels, and any background information. Next, look at the direction in which percentages have been computed – in rows or columns.

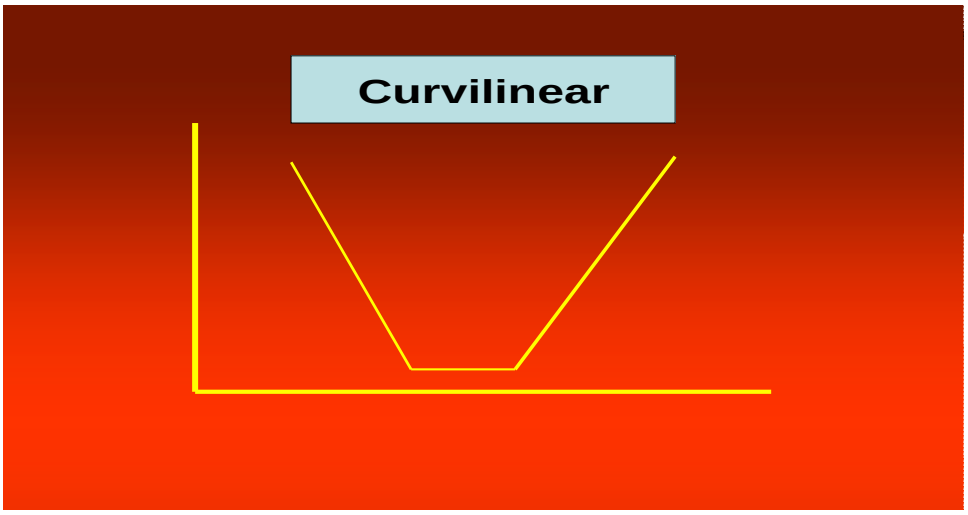
Researchers read percentaged tables to make comparisons. Comparisons are made in the opposite direction from that in which percentages are computed. A rule of thumb is to compare across rows if the table is percentaged down (i.e. by column) and to compare up and down in columns if the table is percentaged across (i.e. by row).

It takes practice to see a relationship in a perentaged table. If there is no relationship in a table, the cell percentages look approximately equal across rows or columns. A linear relationship looks like larger percentages in the diagonal cells. If there is curvilinear relationship, the largest percentages form a pattern across cells. For example, the largest cells might be the upper right, the bottom middle, and the upper left. It is easiest to see a relationship in a moderate-sized table (9 to 16 cells) where most cells have some cases (at least five cases are recommended) and the relationship is strong and precise.



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A simple way to see strong relationships is to circle the largest percentage in each row (in row percentaged tables) or columns (for column-percentaged tables) and see if a line appears.

A simple way to see strong relationship is to circle the largest percentage in applicable row or column and see if a line appears

- Table 4: Age by attitude towards women empowerment

Level of attitude	under 40 F.	%	40 –60 F.	%	61 + F	%	Total F	%
Hi Favorable	600	60	300	30	200	20	1100	37
Med. Favorable	300	30	500	50	250	25	1050	35
Lo Favorable	100	10	200	20	500	50	850	28
Total	1000	100	1000	100	1000	100	3000	100

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The circle-the-largest-cell rule works – with one important caveat. The categories in the percentages table must be ordinal or interval. The lowest variable categories begin at the bottom left. If the categories in a table are not ordered the same way, the rule does not work.

Statistical Control

Showing an association or relationship between two variables is not sufficient to say that an independent variable *causes* a dependent variable. In addition to temporal order and association, a researcher must eliminate alternative explanations – explanations that can make the hypothetical relationship spurious. Experimental researchers do this by choosing a research design that physically controls potential alternative explanations for results (i.e. that threaten internal validity).

In non-experimental research, a researcher controls for alternative explanations with statistics. He or she measures possible alternative explanations with *control variables*, and then examines the control variables with multivariate tables and statistics that help him or her to decide whether a bivariate relationship is spurious. They also show the relative size of the effect of multiple independent variables on dependent variable.

A researcher controls for alternative explanation in multivariate (more than two variables) analysis by introducing a third (sometimes fourth or fifth) variable. For example, a bivariate table shows that young people show more favorable attitude towards women empowerment. But the relationship between age and attitude towards women empowerment may be spurious because men and women may have different attitudes. To test whether the relationship is actually due to gender, a researcher must control for gender; in other words, effects of gender are statistically removed. Once this is done, a researcher can see whether the bivariate relationship between age and attitude towards women empowerment remains.

A researcher controls for a third variable by seeing whether the bivariate relationship persists within categories of the control variable. For example controls for gender, and the relationship between age and attitude persists. This means that both male and females show negative association between age and attitude toward women empowerment. In other words, the control variable has no effect. When this is so, the bivariate relationship is not spurious.

If the bivariate relationship weakens or disappears after the control variable is considered, it means that the age is not real factor that makes the difference in attitude towards women empowerment, rather it is the gender of the respondents.

Statistical control is a key idea in advanced statistical techniques. A measure of association like the correlation co-efficient only suggests a relationship. Until a researcher considers control variables, the bivariate relationship could be spurious. Researchers are cautious in interpreting bivariate relationships until they have considered control variables.

After they introduce control variables, researchers talk about the *net effect* of an independent variable – the effect of independent variable "net of," or in spite of, the control variable. There are two ways to introduce control variables: trivariate percentaged tables and multiple regression analysis.

Constructing Trivariate Tables

In order to meet all the conditions needed for causality, researchers want to "control for" or see whether an alternative explanation explains away a causal relationship. If an alternative explanation explains a relationship, then bivariate relationship is spurious. Alternative explanations are operationalized as a third variable, which are called *control variables* because they control for alternative explanation.

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One way to take such third variables into consideration and see whether they influence the bivariate relationship is to statistically introduce control variables using trivariate or three variable tables. Trivariate tables differ slightly from bivariate tables; they consist of multiple bivariate tables.

A trivariate table has a bivariate table of the independent and dependent variable for each category of the control variable. These new tables are called *partials.* The number of partials depends on the number of categories in control variable. Partial tables look like bivariate tables, but they use a subset of the cases. Only cases with a specific value on the control variable are in the partial. Thus it is possible to break apart a bivariate table to form partials, or combine the partials to restore the initial bivariate table.

Trivariate tables have three limitations. First, they are difficult to interpret if a control variable has more that four categories. Second, control variables can be at any level of measurement, but interval or ratio control variables must be grouped (i.e. converted to an ordinal level), and how cases are grouped can affect the interpretation of effects. Finally, the total number of cases is a limiting factor because the cases are divided among cells in partials. The number of cells in the partials equals the number of cells in the bivariate relationship multiplied by the number of categories in the control variables. For example if the control variable has three categories, and a bivariate table has 12 cells, the partials have 3 X 12 = 36 cells. An average of five cases per cell is recommended, so the researcher will need 5 X 36 = 180 cases at minimum.

Like a bivariate table construction, a trivariate table begins with a compound frequency distribution (CFD), but it is a three-way instead of two-way CFD. An example of a trivariate table with "gender" as control variable for the bivariate table is shown here:

Partial table for males

	Age (in years)							
Level of	Under 40		40—60		61+		Total	
Attitude	F	%	F	%	F.	%	F.	%.
High	300	60	200	33	30	6	530	33
Medium	140	28	270	45	120	24	530	33
Low	60	12	130	22	350	70	540	34
Total	500	100	600	100	500	100	1600	100

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Partial table for females

Level of Attitude	Age (in years) Under 40 F	%	40—60 F	%	61+ F.	%	Total F.	%
High	350	70	200	50	20	4	570	41
Medium	150	30	150	38	220	44	520	37
Low	-	-	50	12	260	52	310	22
Total	500	100	400	100	500	100	1400	100

The replication pattern is the easiest to understand. It is when the partials replicate or reproduce the same relationship that existed in the bivariate table before considering the control variable. It means that the control variable has no effect.

The specification pattern is the next easiest pattern. It occurs when one partial replicate the initial bivariate relationship but other partials do not. For example, we find a strong (negative) bivariate relationship between age of the respondents and attitude towards women empowerment. We control for gender and discover the relationship holds only for males (i.e. the strong negative relationship was in the partial for males, but not for females). This is specification because a researcher can specify the category of the control variable in which the initial relationship persists.

The interpretation pattern describes the situation in which the control variable intervenes between the original independent variable and the dependent variables.

The suppressor variable pattern occurs when the bivariate tables suggest independence but relationship appears in one or both of the partials. For example, the age of the respondents and their attitudes towards women empowerment are independent in a bivariate table. Once the control variable "gender" is introduced, the relationship between the two variables appears in the partial tables. The control variable is suppressor variable because it suppressed the true relationship; the true relationship appears in partials.

Multiple Regression Analysis

Multiple regression controls for many alternative explanations of variables simultaneously (it is rarely possible to use more than one control variable using percentaged tables). Multiple regression is a technique whose calculation you may have learnt in the course on statistics.

Note

In the preceding discussion you have been exposed to the descriptive analysis of the data. Certainly there are statistical tests which can be applied to test the hypothesis, which you may have learnt in your course on statistics.

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Lesson 33

EXPERIMENTAL RESEARCH

Experimental research builds on the principles of positivist approach more directly than do the other research techniques. Researchers in the natural sciences (e.g. chemistry and physics), related applied fields (e.g. engineering, agriculture, and medicines) and the social sciences conduct experiments. The logic that guides an experiment on plant growth in biology or testing a metal in engineering is applied in experiments on human social behavior. Although it is most widely used in psychology, the experiment is found in education, criminal justice, journalism, marketing, nursing, political science, social work, and sociology.

The purpose of experimental research is to allow the researcher to *control* the research situation so that *causal* relationships among variables may be evaluated. The experimenter, therefore, manipulates a single variable in an investigation and holds constant all other, extraneous variables. (Events may be controlled in an experiment in a way that is not possible in a survey). The goal of the experimental design is the confidence that it gives the researcher that his experimental treatment is the cause of the effect he measures.

Experiment is a research design in which conditions are controlled so that one or more variables can be manipulated in order to test a hypothesis. Experimentation is a research design that allows evaluation of causal relationship among variables.

Experiments differ from other research methods in terms of degree of control over the research situation. In a typical experiment one variable (the *independent variable*) is manipulated and its effect on another variable (the *dependent variable*) is measured, while all other variables that may confound such relationship are eliminated or controlled. The experimenter either creates an artificial situation or deliberately manipulates a situation.

Once the experimenter manipulates the independent variable, changes in the dependent variable are measured. The essence of a behavioral experiment is to do something to an individual and observe his or her reaction under conditions where this reaction can be measured against a known baseline.

To establish that variable X cause‟s variable Y, *all three* of the following conditions should be met:

1. Both X and Y should co-vary (i.e. when one goes up, the other should also simultaneously go up (or go down).
2. X (the presumed causal factor) should precede Y. In other words, there must be a time sequence in which the two occur.
3. No other factor should possibly cause the change in the dependent variable Y.

It may thus be seen that to establish causal relationships between two variables in an organizational setting, several variables that might co-vary with the dependent variable have to be controlled. This would then allow us to say that variable X and variable X alone causes the dependent variable Y. Useful as it is to know the cause-and-effect relationships, establishing them is not so easy, because several other variables that co-vary with the dependent variable have to be controlled. It is not always possible to control all the covariates while manipulating the causal factor (the independent variable that is causing the dependent variable) in organizational settings, where events flow or occur naturally and normally. It is, however, possible to first isolate the effects of a variable in a tightly controlled artificial setting (the lab setting), and after testing and establishing the cause-and-effect relationship under these tightly controlled conditions, see how generalizable such relationships are to the field setting.

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The Language of Experiments

Experimental research has its own language or set of terms and concepts. One important term frequently used is *subjects* or *test units*. In experimental research, the cases or people used in research projects and on whom variables are measured are called the *subjects* or *test units*. In other words these are those entities whose responses to the experimental treatment are measured or observed. Individuals, organizational units, sales territories, or other entities may be the test units. Similar terminology is used on different component parts of the experiments.

Parts of Experiments:

We can divide the experiments into seven parts and for each part there is a term. Not all experiments have all these parts, and some have all seven parts plus others. The following seven usually make up a true experiment.

1. Treatment or independent variable.
2. Dependent variable.
3. Pretest.
4. Posttest.
5. Experimental group.
6. Control group.
7. Assignment of subjects.

Treatment or independent variable:

The experimenter has some degree of control over the independent variable. The variable is independent because its value can be manipulated by the experimenter to whatever he or she wishes it to be. In experimental design the variable that can be manipulated to be whatever the experiment wishes. Its value may be changed or altered independently of any other variable.

In most experiments, a researcher creates a situation or enters into an ongoing situation, then modifies it. The treatment (or the stimulus or manipulation) is what the researcher modifies. The term comes from medicine, in which a physician administers a treatment to patients; the physician intervenes in a physical or psychological condition to change it. It is the independent variable or the combination of independent variables.

In experiments, for example, the researcher creates a condition or situation. Look at "the degree of fear or anxiety"; the levels are high-fear or low-fear situation. Instead of asking the subjects, as we do in surveys, whether they are fearful, experimenter puts the subjects into either in a high-fear or low-fear situation. They measure the independent variable by manipulating conditions so that some subjects feel a lot of fear and others feel little.

Researchers go to great lengths to create treatments. They want the treatment to have an impact and produce specific reactions, feelings, or behaviors.

It also possible the researchers look at the alternative manipulations of the independent variable being investigated. In business research, the independent variable is often categorical or classificatory variable, representing some classifiable or qualitative aspects of management strategy. To determine the effects of training, for example, the experimental treatment that represents the independent variable is the training program itself.

Dependent Variable:

Dependent variable is the criterion or standard by which the results are judged. It is assumed that the changes in the dependent variable are consequence of changes in the independent variable. For

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example, measures of turnover, absenteeism, or morale might be alternative choices for the dependent variable, depending on the purpose of the training.

The outcomes in the experimental research are the physical conditions, social behaviors, attitudes, feelings, or beliefs of subjects that change, in response to treatment. Dependent variables can be measured by paper-and-pencil indicators, observations, interviews, or physiological responses (e.g. heartbeat, or sweating palms).

Selection of dependent variable is crucial decision in the design of an experiment.

Pretests and Posttests:

Frequently a researcher measures the dependent variable more than once during an experiment. The *pretest* is the measurement of the dependent variable prior to the introduction of the treatment. The posttest is the measurement of the dependent variable after the treatment has been introduced into the experimental situation.

Experimental and Control Groups:

Experimental researchers often divide subjects into two or more groups for purposes of compassion. A simple experiment has only two groups, only one of which receives the treatment. The experimental group is the group that receives the treatment or in which the treatment is present.

The group that does not receive the treatment is called the "control group." When the independent variable takes on many different values, more than one experimental group is used.

In the simplest type of experiment, only two values of the independent variable are manipulated. For example, consider measuring the influence of a change in work situation, such as playing music over an intercom during working hours, on employee productivity. In the experimental condition (the treatment administered to the **experimental group**), music is played during working hours. In the control condition (the treatment administered to the **control group**), the work situation remains the same, without change. By holding conditions constant in the control group, the researcher controls for potential sources of error in the experiment. Productivity, (the dependent variable) in the two groups is compared at the end of the experiment to determine whether playing the music (the independent variable) has any effect.

Several experimental treatment levels can also be used. The music/productivity experiment, with one experimental and one control group, may not tell the researcher everything he or she wishes to know about the music/productivity relationship. If the researcher wished to understand the functional nature of the relationship between music and productivity at several treatment levels, additional experimental groups with music played for only 2 hours, only for 4 hours, and only for 6 hours might be studied. This type of design would allow the experimenter to get a better idea about the impact of music on productivity.

Assignment of Subjects/Test Units:

Social researchers frequently want to compare. When making comparisons, the researchers want to compare the cases that do not differ with regard to variables that offer alternative explanations. Therefore the groups should be similar in characteristics in such a way that the change in the dependent variable is presumably the outcome of the manipulation of the independent variable, having no alternative explanations.

Random assignment (Randomization) is a method for assigning the cases (e.g. individuals, organizations) to groups for the purpose of making comparisons. It is a way to divide or sort a collection of cases into two or more groups in order to increase one"s confidence that the groups do not differ in a systematic way. It is a mechanical method; the assignment is automatic, and the

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researcher cannot make assignments on the basis of personal preference or the features of specific cases.

Random assignment is random in statistical/mathematical sense, not in everyday sense. In everyday speech, random means unplanned, haphazard, or accidental, but it has a special meaning in mathematics. In probability theory, random describes a process in which each case has a known chance of being selected. Random selection allows the researcher calculate the odds that a specific case will be sorted into one group or the other. A random process is the one in which all cases have an exactly equal chance of ending up in one or the other group.

Random assignment or randomization is unbiased because a researcher‟s desire to confirm a hypothesis or a research subject‟s personal interests does not enter into the selection process. It also assures the researcher that repetitions of an experiment – under the controlled conditions – will show true effects, if they exist. Random assignment of subjects allows the researcher to assume that the groups are identical with respect to all variables except for experimental treatment.

Random assignment of subjects to the various experimental groups is the most common technique used to prevent test units from differing from each other on key variables; it assumes that all the characteristics of these subjects have been similarly randomized. If the experimenter believes that certain extraneous variable may affect the dependent variable, he or she may make sure that the subjects in each group are matched on these characteristics. **Matching** the subjects on the basis of pertinent background information is another technique for controlling assignment errors.

Matching presents a problem: What are the relevant characteristics to match on, and can one locate exact matches? Individual cases differ in thousands of ways, and the researcher cannot know which might be relevant.

Three Types of Controls

1. **Manipulation of the Independent Variable:** In order to examine the causal effects of an independent variable on a dependent variable, certain manipulations need to be tried. Manipulation simply means control over the stimulus that is we create different levels of the independent variable to assess the impact on the dependent variable. Let us say we want to test the effects of lighting on worker production levels among sewing machine operators. To establish cause and effect relationship, we must measure the production levels of all the operators over a 15 day period with the usual amount of light they work with – say 60 watt bulbs. We might then want to split the group of 60 operators into three groups of 20 members each, and while allowing the subgroup to continue to work under the same conditions as before (60-watt electric light bulbs). We might want to manipulate the intensity of the light for the other two subgroups, by making one group work with 75 watt and the other with 100 watt light bulbs. After the different groups have worked with these varying degrees of light exposure for15 days, each group‟s total production for these 15 days may be analyzed to see the difference between the pre-experimental and the post experimental productions among the groups is directly related to the intensity of the light to which they have been exposed. If our hypothesis that better lighting increases the production levels is correct, the subgroups that did not have any change in the lighting (control group), should have no increase in production and the other two groups should show increases, with the one having the most light (100 watts) showing greater increases than those who had the 75 watt lighting.
   In this case the independent variable, lighting, has been manipulated by exposing different groups to different degrees of changes in it. This manipulation of the independent variable is also known treatment, and the results of the treatment are called treatment effects.

2. **Holding Conditions Constant:** When we postulate cause-and-effect relationships between two variables X and Y, it is possible that some other factor, say A, might also influence the dependent variable Y. In such a case, it will not be possible to determine the extent to which Y occurred only because of X, since we do not know how much of the total variation was

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caused by the presence of the other factor A. If the true effect of the X is to be assessed, then the effect of A has to be controlled. This is also called as controlling the effect of contaminating factors or confounding factors.

3. **Control over the Composition of Groups:** If the experimental and control groups have such characteristics that could contaminate the results then the researcher may have to take note of such factors, if there are any. The group differences should not confound the effect of X variable that happens to be under study. The experimental and control groups need to be balanced. For this purpose the researcher may use **random selection** of the subjects and allocating to different groups. Finally the experimental and control groups should also be selected randomly. Another way to have identical groups is by following the procedure of **matching**. One could look at the possible characteristics of the subjects that could contaminate the effect of X variable, and try to distribute these evenly in all the groups. So pick up one subject and try to match it with another subject on the specified characteristics (age, gender, education, marital status) and put one subject in one group and the other in the other group. After the formation of groups, the researcher may randomly decide about experimental and control groups.

Random Assignment

Social researchers frequently want to compare. For example, a researcher has two groups of 15 students and wants to compare the groups on the basis of key differences between them (e.g. a course that one group completed). Or a researcher has five groups of customers and wants to compare the groups on the basis of one characteristic (e.g. geographic location). “Compare apples with apples, don‟t compare apples with oranges.” It means that a valid comparison depends on comparing things that are fundamentally alike. Random assignment facilitates comparison in experiments by creating similar groups.

Random assignment is a method for assignment cases (e.g. individuals, organizations) to groups for the purpose of making comparisons. It is a way to divide or sort a collection of cases into two or more groups in order to increase one‟s confidence that the groups do not differ in a systematic way. It is mechanical method; the assignment is automatic, and the researcher cannot make assignments on the basis of personal preference or the features of specific cases.

Random assignment is random in a statistical or mathematical sense, not in an everyday sense. In everyday speech, random means unplanned, haphazard, or accidental, but it has a specialized meaning in mathematics. In probability theory, *random* describes a process in which each case has a known chance of being selected. Random assignment lets a researcher calculate the odds that a specific case will be sorted into one group over another.

Random assignment or randomization is unbiased because a researcher‟s desire to confirm a hypothesis or a research subject‟s personal interest does not enter into selection process.

Matching

It implies to match the characteristics (such as age, sex) of the cases in each group. Matching is an alternative to random assignment, but it is an infrequently used one.

Matching presents a problem: What are the relevant characteristics to match on, and can one locate exact matches. Individual cases differ in thousands of ways, and the researcher cannot know which might be relevant. Therefore, randomization is preferred over matching. It takes care of the contaminating factors.

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Lesson 34

EXPERIMENTAL RESEARCH (Cont.)

Steps in Conducting an Experiment

Following the basic steps of the research process, experimenters decide on a topic, narrow it into a testable research problem or question, and then develop a hypothesis with variables. Once a researcher has the hypothesis, the steps of experimental research are clear. Broadly there are about 12 steps in conducting an experiment, which are as below:

1. Begin with a straightforward hypothesis that is appropriate for experimental research.
2. Decide on an experimental design that will test the hypothesis within practical limitations. The researcher decides the number of groups to use, how and when to create treatment conditions, the number of times to measure the dependent variable, and what the groups of subjects will experience from beginning till end.
3. Decide how to introduce the treatment or create a situation that induces the independent variable.
4. Develop a valid and reliable measure of the dependent variable.
5. Set up an experimental setting and conduct a pilot test of the treatment and dependent variable measures.
6. Locate appropriate subjects or cases.
7. Randomly assign subjects to groups (if random assignment is used in the chosen research design) and give careful instructions.
8. Gather data for the pretest measure of the dependent variable for all groups (if pretest is used in the chosen design).
9. Introduce the treatment to the experimental group only (or to the relevant groups if there are multiple experimental groups) and monitor all groups.
10. Gather data for posttest measure of the dependent variable.
11. Debrief the subjects by informing them of the true purpose and reasons for the experiment. Ask subjects what they thought was occurring. Debriefing is crucial when subjects have been deceived about some aspect of the treatment.
12. Examine data collected and make comparisons between different groups. Where appropriate, use statistics and graphs to determine whether or not the hypothesis is supported.

Types of Designs

Researchers combine parts of experiment (e.g. pretests, control groups, etc.) together into an experimental design. For example some designs lack pretests, some do not have control groups, and others have many experimental groups. Certain widely used standard designs have names.

Classical Experimental Design:

All designs are variations of the classical experimental design, which has random assignment of subjects, a pretest and a posttest, an experimental group, and a control group.

Quasi-Experimental Designs:

One-shot Case Study Design:

Also called the one-group posttest-only design, the one-shot case study design has only one group, a treatment, and a posttest. Because it is only one group, there is no random assignment. For example, a researcher shows a group of students a horror film, then measures their attitude with a questionnaire. A weakness of this design is that it is difficult to say for sure that the treatment caused the dependent variable. If subjects were the same before and after the treatment, the researcher would not know it.

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***One Group Pretest-posttest Design*:**

This design has one group, a pretest, a treatment, and a posttest. It lacks a control group and random assignment. Continuing with the previous example, the researcher gives a group of students an attitude questionnaire to complete, shows a horror film, then has them complete the same questionnaire second time. This is an improvement over the one-shot case study because the researcher measures the dependent variable both before and after the treatment. But it lacks the control group for comparison. The researcher cannot know whether something other than the treatment occurred between the pretest and the posttest to cause the outcome.

Two Groups Posttest-only Design:

It has two groups, a random assignment of subjects, a posttest, and a treatment. It has all parts of the classical design except a pretest. Continuing with our previous example, the researcher forms two groups through randomization process. He shows group a horror film to one group i.e. the experimental group. The other group is not shown any film. Both groups then complete the questionnaire. The random assignment reduces the chance that the groups differed before the treatment, but without a pretest, a researcher cannot be as certain that the groups began the same on the dependent variable.

True Experimental Designs

Experimental designs, which have at least two groups, a random assignment of subjects to experimental and control groups, only experimental group is exposed to treatment, both groups record information before and after the treatment, are known as ex-post facto experimental designs.

Pretest and Posttest Experimental and Control Group Design:

Two groups, one control group and the other experimental group, are formed randomly. Both the groups are exposed to pretest and posttest. The experimental group is exposed to treatment while the control group is not. Measuring the difference between the differences in the post- and pretests of the two groups would give the net effects of the treatment.

Experimental Group: Pretest (O1) X Posttest (O2)

Control Group: Pretest (O3) - Posttest (O4)

Randomization used for setting up the group.

[(O2 – O1) – (O4 – O3)] = Treatment effect (could be anywhere between 0 to -1 or +1).

Solomon's Four Group Design:

To gain more confidence in internal validity in experimental designs, it is advisable to set up two experimental groups and two control groups. One experimental group and one control group can be given the both pretest and the posttest. The other two groups will be given only the posttest. Here the effects of treatment can be calculated in several different ways as shown in figure 1:

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Figure 1: Solomon's four group design

Group	Pretest	Treatment	Posttest
1. Experimental	O1	X	O2
2. Control	O3	-	O4
3. Experimental	-	X	O5
4. Control	-	-	O6

(O2 – O1) = E

(O4 - O3) = E

(O5 - O6) = E

(O5 - O3) = E

[(O2 - O1) – (O4 – O3)] = E

E = Effect

If all Es are similar, the cause and effect relationship is highly valid.

Interaction Effect

The effect of two variables together is likely to be greater than the individual effect of each put together. The idea of an interaction effect is familiar, especially in the area of medicine or illness. As an example, imagine that for a given population of 100 persons, all of the same age and sex, it was found that if all 100 smoked cigarettes the effect would be a lung cancer rate of 20 percent. Assume that for an identical group of 100 persons who did not smoke but lived in a smoggy environment, 10 percent would get lung cancer. Now consider a third identical group of 100 persons all of whom smoke and also live in a smoggy environment. The additive effect of both smoking and smog would be 20 percent plus 10 percent, or a total of 30 percent (30 people) having cancer. However, imagine that an actual medical survey of the population shows a cancer rate of 37 percent among persons experiencing both smoking and smog. This extra 7 percent can be computed residually as:

Interaction Effect = Total effect – (smoking effect + smog effect) = 37 percent

= 37 percent - (20 percent + 10 percent)

= 37 percent - 30 percent

= 7 percent

In experiments we have the pretests and posttests, in which case we use the same instrument for measuring the dependent variable, for example racial prejudice as an effect of a movie. In pretest is a questionnaire in which items forming the prejudice scale are dispersed at random among other items so that the subject does not know that his or her level of racial prejudice is being measured.

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Nevertheless, the measurement of this variable (prejudice) itself, by presenting questions about race relations may stimulate the subject‟s thinking and actually cause a change in his or her level of racial prejudice. Any pretest effect that occurs will be visible as part of extraneous change (change caused by the test stimulus) in the control group, as the pretest is also presented to the control group. Any change between the pretest and posttest for measuring the dependent variable in the control group may be attributed to the sensitization of the subjects with the instrument. In the experimental group of course a movie (an X variable) was shown due to which we expect a change in the racial prejudice of the subjects. But that is not all. The subjects in the experimental group were also exposed to the instrument for measuring the racial prejudice, hence they were also sensitized. Their posttest results include the combined effect of exposure to a movie and that of sensitization to the instrument. In other words the racial prejudice of the subjects in the experimental group exhibits the interaction effect of the treatment plus that of sensitization of the instrument.

In order to calculate the interaction effect in the experiment we shall have two experimental groups and one control group created by using the randomization process. It may look like this:

Experimental group 1:	**Pretest (O1)**	**X**	**Posttest (O2)**
Control group:	Pretest (O3)	-	Posttest (O4)

Why O4 be different from O3? The difference may be due to sensitization. So let us figure it out. Let us take another experimental group and we do not pretest i.e. no sensitization with the instrument.

Experimental group 2:	**No pretest**	**X**	**Posttest (O5)**

Let us work out the results:

(O2- O1) = D

(O4- O3) = D/

(O5 – O3)= D// (Since all groups are identical, so we can use the pretest of any of the Other two groups)

Interaction effect = D – [D/ + D//]. Substituting it with our example of lung cancer →

37 - [10 + 20] = 37 – 30 = 7

There are many other experimental designs like the randomized block design, Latin square design, natural group design, and factorial design.

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Lesson 35

EXPERIMENTAL RESEARCH (Cont.)

Validity in Experiments

Experiments are judged by two measures. The first, internal validity indicates whether the independent variable was the sole cause of the change in the dependent variable. It implies the researcher‟s ability to eliminate alternative explanations of the dependent variable. Variables, other than the treatment, that affect the dependent variable are threats to internal validity. They threaten the researcher‟s ability to say that the treatment was the true causal factor producing change in the dependent variable. The second measure, external validity, indicates the extent to which the results of the experiment are applicable in the real world.

Internal validity is high in the laboratory experiment, reason being the control over all the confounding factors. External validity (generalizability) is not sure because of the effect of variety of factors. Field experiments have more external validity but less internal validity because it is closer to the real situations.

Factors Affecting Internal Validity

In choosing or evaluating experimental research design, researchers must determine whether they have internal and external validity. There are eight major types of extraneous variables that may jeopardize internal validity: History effect, maturation effect, testing effect, instrumentation effect, selection bias effect, statistical regression, mortality, and mechanical loss.

1. History Effect:

A specific event in the external environment occurring between the first and second measurement that is beyond the control of the experimenter and that affects the validity of an experiment. Advertisement of a particular product (mineral water) and its sale is affected by an event in the society (contamination of drinking water). The researcher does not have control on such happenings which have an impact on the X and Y relationship.

2. Maturation Effect: Cause and effect relationship can also be contaminated by the effects of the passage of time – another uncontrollable variable. Such contamination is called maturation effect. The maturation effects are a function of the processes – biological and psychological – operating within the subjects as a result of the passage of time. Examples of maturation processes could include *growing older, getting tired, feeling hungry, and getting bored*. In other words there could be maturation effect on the dependent variable purely because of the passage of time. For example, let us say that an R & D director intends that an increase in the efficiency of workers would result within three months‟ time if advanced technology is introduced in the work setting. If at the end of three months increased efficiency is indeed found, it will be difficult to claim that the advanced technology (and it alone) increased the efficiency of workers, because with the passage of time, employees would also gained experience, resulting in better performance and therefore improved efficiency. Thus, the internal validity also gets reduced owing to the effects of maturation in as much as it is difficult to pinpoint how much of the increase is attributable to the introduction of the enhanced technology alone.

3. Testing Effects: Frequently, to test the effects of treatment, subjects are given what is called a ***pretest*** (say**,** a short questionnaire eliciting their feelings and attitudes). That is, a measure of the dependent variable is taken (pretest), then the treatment given, and after that a second test, called ***posttest***, administered. The difference between the posttest and the pretest scores is then attributed to the treatment. However, the very fact that the subjects were exposed to the pretest might influence

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their responses on the posttest, which will adversely impact on internal validity. It is also called sensitization through previous testing.

4. Instrumentation Effects: Instrumentation effects are yet another source of threat to internal validity. These might arise because of a change in the measuring instrument between pretest and posttest, and not because of the instrument‟s differential impact at the end. For example, in a weight-loss experiment, the springs on the scale weaken during the experiment, giving lower readings in the posttest.

A change in the wording of questions (may be done to avoid testing effects), change in interviewers, or change in other procedures to measure the dependent variable can cause instrumentation effect.

Performance of the subjects measured by the units of output in the pretest, but when measuring the output in posttest the researcher measures it by the number of units rejected, and the amount of resources expended to produce the units.

5. Selection Bias Effect: Selection bias is the threat that subjects will not form equivalent groups. It is a problem in design without random assignment, hence differential selection of the subjects for the comparison groups. It occurs when subjects in one experimental group have a characteristic that affects the dependent variable. For example, in an experiment on physical aggressiveness, the experimental group unintentionally contains subjects who are sportsmen, whereas the control group is made up of musicians, chess players, and painters.

6. Statistical Regression: Statistical regression is not easy to grasp intuitively. It is a problem of extreme values or a tendency for random error to move group results towards the average. If extremes are taken then they tend to regress toward the mean. Those who are on either end of the extreme would not truly reflect the cause and effect relationship.

One situation arises when subjects are unusual with regard to dependent variable. Because they begin as unusual or extreme, subjects are likely to respond further in the same direction. For example, a researcher wants to see whether violent films make people act violently. The researcher chooses a group of violent criminals from a high security prison, gives them a pretest, shows violent films, and then administers a posttest. To the researcher‟s surprise, the criminals are slightly less violent after the film, whereas a control group of non-prisoners who did see the film are slightly more violent than before. Because the violent criminals began at an extreme, it is unlikely that a treatment could make them more violent; by random chance alone, they appear less extreme when measured a second time.

If participants chosen for experimental group have extreme scores on the dependent variable to begin with then the laws of probability say that those with very low scores on a variable have a greater probability to improve and scoring closer to mean on the posttest after treatment. This phenomenon of low scorers tending to score closer to the mean is known as “regressing toward the mean.”

Likewise, those with high scores have a greater tendency to regress toward the mean – will score lower on the posttest than on pretest. Thus the extremes will not “truly” reflect the causal relationship – a threat to internal validity.

7. Mortality: Mortality, or attrition, arises when some subjects do not continue throughout the experiment. Although the word mortality means death, it does not necessarily mean that subjects have died. If a subset of subjects leaves partway through an experiment, a researcher cannot whether the results would have been different had the subjects stayed. Even with departure of few subjects, the groups do not remain balanced.

Consider for example of a training experiment that investigates the effects of close supervision of salespersons (high pressure) versus low supervision (low supervision). The high pressure condition may misleadingly appear to be superior if those subjects who completed the experiment did very well. If, however, the high-pressure condition caused more subjects to drop-out than the other condition, this apparent superiority may be due to a self-selection bias (those who could not bear the pressure

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had left – mortality) – perhaps only very determined and/or talented salespersons made it through the end of the experiment.

8. Mechanical Loss: A problem may be experienced due to equipment failure. For example, in an experiment if the subjects are told that their behavior is being videotaped, and during the experiment the video equipment failed to work for some subjects, then the validity of the results could become doubtful.

9. Experimenter Expectancy: In addition to the usually listed eight factors affecting the internal validity sometimes **experimenter expectancy** may threaten the causal logic of the relationship between the variables. A researcher may threaten internal validity, not purposefully unethical behavior but by indirectly communicating experimenter expectancy to the subjects. Researchers may highly committed to the hypothesis and indirectly communicate desired findings to subjects. For example, a researcher studying reactions towards disabled deeply believes that females are more sensitive toward the disabled than the males are. Through eye contact, tone of voice, pauses, and other nonverbal communication, the researcher unconsciously encourages female subjects to report positive feelings toward the disabled; the researcher‟s nonverbal behavior is the opposite for male subjects.

The ***double-blind experiment*** is designed to control experimenter expectancy. In it, people who have direct contact with subjects do not know the details of the hypothesis or the treatment. It is ***double*** blind because both the subjects and those in contact with them are blind to details of the experiment. For example a researcher wants to see if new drug is effective. Using capsules of three colors – green, yellow, and pink -- the researcher puts the new drug in the yellow capsule, puts an old drug in the pink one, and take the green capsule a ***placebo*** – a false treatment that appears to be real (e.g., a sugar capsule without any physical effects). Assistants who give the capsules and record the effects do not know which color contains the new drug. Only another person who does not deal with subjects directly knows which colored capsule contains the drug and examines the results.

External Validity

Even if the researcher eliminates all concerns for internal validity, external validity remains a potential problem. External validity is the ability to generalize experimental findings to real life situations. Without external validity, the findings are of little use for both basic and applied research i.e. we shall not be able to develop any theories that could be applicable to similar other situations.

Reactivity: A Threat to External Validity

Subjects may react differently in an experiment than they would in real life; because they know they are in a study. *The Hawthorn Effect,* a specific kind of reactivity to the experimental situation is a good example in this respect. The experiment was conducted in the Hawthorn Electric Company where the performance of the participants was supposed to change due to the change in the environmental conditions i.e. improvement on the environmental conditions will have a positive effect on the performance. The researchers modified many aspects of the working conditions and measured productivity. Productivity rose after each modification. Productivity rose even if there was no real modification but it was announced that there is a modification. The behavior change was simply a reaction to the announcement of modification and some other factors like the participants were being watched and had a feeling of being „very important persons.“

Here the workers did not respond to treatment (modification of working conditions) but to the additional attention they received (being in the experiment ad being the focus of attention).

Demand characteristic (discussed earlier) is another type of reactivity. Here the participants change their behavior as a reaction to the demands of the experimenter who may have inadvertently told the subjects about the expected outcome of the treatment. They change their behavior as demanded by the experimenter.

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Ethical Issues in Lab Experiments

We have already discussed the ethical issues in research. Just for the sake of emphasis, it may be appropriate to very briefly repeat some of those which are specifically relevant to experimental designs. The following actions may be unethical:

- Putting pressure on individuals to participate in experiments through coercion, or apply social pressure.
- Asking demeaning questions from the subjects that hurt their self-respect or giving menial task to subjects that diminish their self-respect.
- Deceiving subjects by deliberately misleading them as to the true purpose of research.
- Exposing participants to physical or mental stress.
- Not allowing subjects to withdraw from the experiment when they want to.
- Using research results to disadvantage the participants, or for purposes not to their liking.
- Not explaining the procedures to be followed in the experiment.
- Exposing subjects to hazardous and unsafe environments.
- Not debriefing the participants fully and accurately after the experiment is over.
- Not preserving the privacy and confidentiality of the information given by the participants.
- Withholding benefits from the control group.

Human Subjects Committee

In order to protect the rights of participating subjects the research institutions have usually set up Ethics Committees. Sometime project specific ethics committees are also formed. Such committees try to look after the rights of the subjects participating in the experiments, as well as in other research techniques.

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Lesson 36

NON-REACTIVE RESEARCH

Experiments and surveys research are both ***reactive***; that is, the people being studied are aware of the fact that they are being studied. In ***non-reactive*** research, those being studied are not aware that they are part of a research project. Such a research is largely based on positivistic principles but is also used by interpretive and critical researchers.

The Logic of Non-Reactive Research

The critical thing about non-reactive or *unobtrusive measures* (i.e. the measures that are not obtrusive or intrusive) is that the people being studied are not aware of it but leave evidence of their social behavior or actions naturally. The researcher infers from the evidence to behavior or attitudes without disrupting those being studied. Unnoticed observation is also a type of non-reactive measure. For example, a researcher may be observing the behavior of drivers from a distance whether drivers stopped at red sign of the traffic lights. The observations can be made both at the day time and at night. It could also be noted whether the driver was a male or a female; whether the driver was alone or with passengers; whether other traffic was present; and whether the car came to a complete stop, a slow stop, or no stop.

Varieties of Non-Reactive Observations

Non-reactive measures are varied, and researchers have been creative in inventing indirect ways to measures behaviors. Because the measures have little in common except being non-reactive, they are best learned through examples like:

Physical Traces:

- *Erosion*: Wear and tear suggests a greater use. For example, a researcher examines children‟s toys at a children‟s play center that were purchased at the same time. Worn out toys suggest greater interest of children in them.
- *Accretion:* Accumulation of physical evidence suggests behavior. A researcher examines the soft drink cans or bottles in the garbage collection. That might indicate the brands and types of soft drinks that are very popular.

Archives:

- *Running Records:* Regularly produced public records may reveal lot of information. For example, a researcher may examine marriage records for brides‟ and grooms‟ recorded ages. The differences might indicate that males marrying younger females are greater than the other way around.
- *Other Records:* Irregular or private records can reveal a lot. For example, a researcher may look into the number of reams of paper purchased by a college principal‟s office for the last 10 years and compare it with students‟ enrollment.

Observations:

- *External Appearance:* How people appear may indicate social factors. For example, a researcher watches students to see whether they are more likely to wear their college‟s colors and symbols after the college team won or lost.
- *Count Behaviors:* Counting how many people do something can be informative. For example a researcher may count the number of men and women who come to a full stop and those who come to a rolling stop at a traffic stop sign. This suggests gender difference in driving behavior.
- *Time Duration:* How long people take to do things may indicate their intention. For example, a researcher may measure how long men and women pause in front of a particular painting. Time taken may indicate their interest in the painting.

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Recording and Documentation

Creating non-reactive measures follows the logic of quantitative measurement, although qualitative researchers also use non-reactive observations. A researcher first conceptualizes a construct, and then links the construct to non-reactive empirical evidence, which is its measure. The operational definition of the variable includes how the researcher systematically notes and records observations.

Content Analysis

Content analysis is a technique for gathering and analyzing the content of a text. The *content* refers to words, meanings, pictures, symbols, ideas, themes, or any message that can be communicated. The *text* is anything written, visual, or spoken that serves as a medium of communication. ***Possible artifacts for study*** could be books, newspaper or magazine articles, advertisements, poems, letters, laws, constitutions, dramas, speeches, official documents, films or videotapes, musical lyrics, photographs, articles of clothing, or works of arts. All these works may be called as documents. The documents can be:

- Personal – letters, diary, autobiography.
- Non-personal – interoffice memos, official documents, proceedings of a meeting.
- Mass media – newspapers, magazines, fiction, films, songs, poems, works of arts.

Content analysis goes back nearly a century and is used in many fields – literature, history, journalism, political science, education, psychology, sociology, and so on. It is also called a study of communication, which means who says what, to whom, why, how, and with what effect.

In content analysis, the researcher uses objective and systematic counting and recording procedures to produce a quantitative description of the symbolic content in a text. It may also be called **"textual coding."** There are qualitative versions of content analysis. The emphasis here is quantitative data about a text‟s content.

Content Analysis is Non-Reactive: It is non-reactive because the placing of words, messages, or symbols in a text to communicate to the reader or receiver occurs without influence from the researcher who analyzes its contents. There is no interaction between the researcher and the creator of the text under analysis.

Content analysis lets a researcher reveal the contents (i.e. messages, meanings, symbols, etc.) in a source of communication (i.e. a book, article, movie, etc.). It lets him/her probe into and discover content in a different way from ordinary way of reading a book or watching a television program.

With content analysis, a researcher can compare content across many texts and analyze it with quantitative techniques (table, charts). In addition, he or she can reveal aspects of the texts content that are difficult to see. For example, you might watch television commercials and feel that women are mostly portrayed working in the house, cooking food, using detergents, looking after children. Content analysis can document – in objective, quantitative terms – whether or not your vague feelings based on unsystematic observation are true. It yields repeatable, precise results about the text.

Content analysis involves random sampling, precise measurement, and operational definitions for abstract constructs. Coding turns aspects of content that represent variables into numbers. After a content analysis researcher gathers the data, he or she enters them into computers and analyzes them with statistics in the same way that an experiment or survey researcher would.

Measurement and Coding

Careful measurement is crucial in content analysis because a researcher takes different and murky symbolic communication and turns it into precise, objective, quantitative data. He or she carefully designs and documents the procedures for coding to make replication possible. For example, a

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researcher wants to determine how frequently television dramas portray elderly characters in terms of negative stereotypes. He or she develops a measure of the construct "negatively stereotypes of the elderly." The conceptualization may result in a list of stereotypes or negative generalizations about older people (e.g., senile, forgetful, frail, hard of hearing, slow, ill, inactive, conservative, etc.) that do not accurately reflect the elderly. Another example could be negative stereotypes about women.

Constructs in content analysis are operationalized with a *coding system,* a set of instructions or rules on how to systematically observe and record content from text. Look at the construct of "leadership role;" for measuring this construct written rules should be provided telling how to classify people. Same is about the concept of "social class." In case the researcher has three categories of upper, middle, and lower class then the researcher must tell what are the characteristics that are associated with upper class, middle class, and the lower class so that the coders could easily classify people in the three proposed categories.

Observations can be structured: Measurement in content analysis uses *structured observation* i.e. systematic, careful observation based on written rules. The rules explain how to categorize and classify observations in terms of:

- *Frequency*: Frequency simply means counting whether or not something occurs and how often (how many times). For example how many elderly people appear on a television program within a given week? What percentage of all characteristics are they, or in what percentage of programs do they appear.
- *Direction:* Direction is noting the direction of messages in the content along some continuum (e.g., positive or negative, supporting or opposed). For example the researcher devises a list of ways an elderly television character can act. Some are positive (e.g., friendly, wise, considerate) and some are negative (e.g., nasty, dull, selfish).
- *Intensity:* Intensity is the strength or power of a message in a direction. For example, the characteristic of forgetfulness can be minor (e.g. not remembering to take the keys when leaving home, taking time to recall the name of someone whom you have not seen in years) or major (e.g., not remembering your name, not recognizing your children).
- *Space:* A researcher can record the size of the text message or the amount of space or volume allocated to it. Space in written text is measured by counting words, sentences, paragraphs, or space on a page (e.g. square inches). For video or audio text, space can be measured by the amount of time allocated. For example, a TV character may be present for a few seconds or continuously in every seen of a two hour program.

The unit analysis can vary a great deal in content analysis. It can be a word, a phrase, a theme, a plot, a newspaper article, a character, and so forth.

Coding

Coding is the process of identifying and classifying each item and giving labels to each category. Later on each category may be assigned a numerical value for its entry into the computer. In content analysis one can look at the manifest coding and latent coding.

Manifest Coding: Coding the visible, surface content in a text is called manifest coding. For example, a researcher counts the number of times a phrase or word (e.g. red) appears in the written text, or whether a specific action (e.g. shaking hands) appears in a photograph or video scene. The coding system lists terms or actions or characters that are then located in text. A researcher can use a computer program to search for words or phrases in the text and have a computer do the counting work.

Manifest coding is highly reliable because the phrase or the word either is or is not present. However, manifest coding does not take the connotation of word into account. The same word can take on different meanings depending on the context. The possibility that there are multiple meanings of a word limits the measurement validity of manifest coding.

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Latent Coding: A researcher using *latent coding* (also called *semantic analysis*) looks for the underlying meaning in the content of a text. For example, the researcher reads the entire paragraph and decides whether it contains vulgar themes or a romantic mood. His or her coding system has general rules to guide his or her interpretation of the text and for determining whether particular themes or mood are present.

Latent coding tends to be less reliable than the manifest coding. It depends on a coder‟s knowledge of language and its social meaning. Training, practice, and written rules improve reliability, but still it is difficult to consistently identify themes, moods, and the like.

Keeping in view the amount of work, often a number of coders are hired. The researcher trains the coders in coding system. Coders should understand the variables, follow the coding system, and ask about ambiguities. A researcher who uses several coders must always check for consistency across coders. He or she does this by asking coders to code the same text independently and then checking for consistency across coders. The researcher measures inter-coder reliability, a type of equivalence reliability, with a statistical coefficient that tells the degree of consistency across among coders. The coefficient is always reported with the results of content analysis research.

How to Conduct Content Analysis Research

Question Formulation: As in most research, content analysis researchers begin with a research question. When the question involves variables that are messages or symbols, content analysis may be appropriate. For example, how women are portrayed in advertisements? The construct here is the portrayal of women which may be measured by looking at the activities they are shown to be doing, the occupations in which they are employed, the way decision making is taking place, etc.

Unit of Analysis: A researcher decides on the unit of analysis (i.e. the amount of text that is assigned a code). In the previous example each advertisement may be a unit of analysis.

Sampling: Researchers often use random sampling in content analysis. First, they define the population and the sampling element. For example, the population might be all words, all sentences, all paragraphs, or all articles in certain type of documents over a period of specified period. Likewise, it could include each conversation, situation, scene, or episode of a certain type of television program over a specified time period. Let us consider that we want to know how women are portrayed in weekly news magazines. The unit of analysis is the article. The population includes all articles published in weekly news magazines during 2001 to 2007. Make a list of English magazines that were published during the said period. Define what is a news magazine? Define what is an article? Decide on the number of magazines. Decide on the sample size. Make a sampling frame. Here the sampling frame shall be all the articles published in the selected magazines during 2001 to 2007. Finally draw the random sample using table of random numbers.

Variables and Constructing Coding Categories: Say a researcher is interested in women‟s portrayal in significant leadership roles. Define “significant leadership role” in operational terms and put it as written rules for classifying people named in the articles. Say the researcher is further interested in positive leadership roles, so the measure will indicate whether the role was positive or negative. Researcher has to make a list of adjectives and phrases reflective of the leadership role being positive or negative. If someone in the article is referred to with one of the adjective, then the direction is decided. For example, the terms *brilliant* and *top performer* are positive, whereas *drug kingpin* and *uninspired* are negative. Researcher should give written rules to classify role of women as portrayed in the articles.

In addition to written rules for coding decisions, a content analysis researcher creates a recording sheet (also called a *coding form* or *tally sheet*) on which to record the information. Each unit should have a separate recording sheet.

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Inferences: The inference a researcher can or cannot make on the basis of results is critical in content analysis. Content analysis describes what is in the text. It cannot reveal the intentions of those who created the text or the effects that messages in the text have on those who receive them.

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Lesson 37

USE OF SECONDARY DATA

Existing statistics/documents

Prior to the discussion of secondary data, let us look at the advantages and disadvantages of the use of content analysis that was covered in the last lecture. In a way content analysis is also the study of documents through which the writers try to communicate, though some of the documents (like population census) may simply contain figures.

Advantages

1. Access to inaccessible subjects: One of the basic advantages of content analysis is that it allows research on subjects to which the researcher does not have physical access. These could be people of old civilizations, say their marriage patterns. These could also be the documents form the archives, speeches of the past leaders (Quaid-e-Azam) who are not alive, the suicide notes, old films, dramas, poems, etc.

2. Non-reactivity: Document study shares with certain types of observations (e.g., indirect observation or non-participant observation through one-way mirror) the advantage of little or no reactivity, particularly when the document was written for some other purpose. This is unobtrusive. Even the creator of that document, and for that matter the characters in the document, is not in contact with the researcher, who may not be alive.

3. Can do longitudinal analysis: Like observation and unlike experiments and survey, document study is especially well suited to study over a long period of time. Many times the objective of the research could be to determine a trend. One could pick up different periods in past and try to make comparisons and figure out the changes (in the status of women) that may have occurred over time. Take two martial periods in Pakistan, study the newspapers and look at the reported crime in the press.

4. Use Sampling: The researcher can use random sampling. One could decide on the population, develop sampling frame and draw simple random sample by following the appropriate procedure. For example how women are portrayed in weekly English news magazines. One could pick up weekly English news magazines, make a listing of articles that have appeared in the magazines (sampling frame), and draw a simple random sample.

5. Can use large sample size: Larger the sample closer the results to the population. In experimentation as well as in survey research there could be limitations due to the availability of the subjects or of the resources but in document analysis the researcher could increase the sample and can have more confidence in generalization. Let us assume that a researcher is studying the matrimonial advertisements in the newspapers over a long period of time, there should be no problem in drawing a sample as large as several thousand or more.

6. Spontaneity: The spontaneous actions or feelings can be recorded when they occurred rather than at a time specified by the researcher. If the respondent was keeping a diary, he or she may have been recording spontaneous feelings about a subject whenever he or she was inspired to do so. The contents of such personal recording could be analyzed later on.

7. Confessions: A person may be more likely to confess in a document, particularly one to be read only after his or her death, than in an interview or mailed questionnaire study. Thus a study of documents such as diaries, posthumously published autobiographies, and suicide notes may be the only way to obtain such information.

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8. Relatively low cost: Although the cost of documentary analysis can vary widely depending on the type of document analyzed, how widely documents are dispersed, and how far one must travel to gain access to them, documentary analysis can be inexpensive compared to large-scale surveys. Many a time‟s documents are gathered together in a centralized location such as library where the researcher can study them for only the cost of travel to the repository.

9. High quality: Although documents vary tremendously in quality, many documents, such as newspaper columns, are written by skilled commentators and may be more valuable than, for example, poorly written responses to mailed questionnaires.

Disadvantages

1. Bias: Many documents used in research were not originally intended for research purposes. The various goals and purposes for which documents are written can bias them in various ways. For example, personal documents such as confessional articles or autobiographies are often written by famous people or people who had some unusual experience such as having been a witness to a specific event. While often providing a unique and valuable research data, these documents usually are written for the purpose of making money. Thus they tend to exaggerate and even fabricate to make good story. They also tend to include those events that make the author look good and exclude those that cast him or her in a negative light.

2. Selective survival: Since documents are usually written on paper, they do not withstand the elements well unless care is taken to preserve them. Thus while documents written by famous people are likely to be preserved, day-to-day documents such as letters and diaries written by common people tend either to be destroyed or to be placed in storage and thus become inaccessible. It is relatively rare for common documents that are not about some events of immediate interest to the researcher (e.g., suicide) and not about famous occurrence or by some famous person to be gathered together in a public repository that is accessible to researchers.

3. Incompleteness: Many documents provide incomplete account to the researcher who has had no prior experience with or knowledge of the events or behavior discussed. A problem with many personal documents such as letters and diaries is that they were not written for research purposes but were designed to be private or even secret. Both these kinds of documents often assume specific knowledge that researcher unfamiliar with certain events will not possess. Diaries are probably the worst in this respect, since they are usually written to be read only by the author and can consist more of “soul searching” and confession than of description. Letters tend to be little more complete, since they are addressed to a second person. Since many letters assume a great amount of prior information on the part of the reader.

4. Lack of availability of documents: In addition to the bias, incompleteness, and selective survival of documents, there are many areas of study for which no documents are available. In many cases information simply was never recorded. In other cases it was recorded, but the documents remain secret or classified, or have been destroyed.

5. Sampling bias: One of the problems of bias occurs because persons of lower educational or income levels are less likely to be represented in the sampling frames. The problem of sampling bias by educational level is more acute for document study than for survey research. It is a safe generalization that a poorly educated people are much less likely than well educated people to write documents.

6. Limited to verbal behavior: By definition, documents provide information only about respondent‟s verbal behavior, and provide no direct information on the respondent‟s nonverbal behavior, either that of the document‟s author or other characters in the document.

7. Lack of standardized format: Documents differ quite widely in regard to their standardization of format. Some documents such as newspapers appear frequently in a standard format. Large dailies always contain such standard components as editorial page, business page, sports page, and weather

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report. Standardization facilitates comparison across time for the same newspapers and comparison across different newspapers at one point in time. However, many other documents, particularly personal documents have no standard format. Comparison is difficult or impossible, since valuable information contained in the document at one point in time may be entirely lacking in an earlier or later documents.

8. Coding difficulties: For a number of reasons, including differences in purpose for which the documents were written, differences in content or subject matter, lack of standardization, and differences in length and format, coding is one of the most difficult tasks facing the content analyst. Documents are generally written arrangements, rather than numbers are quite difficult to quantify. Thus analysis of documents is similar to analysis of open-ended survey questions.

9. Data must be adjusted for comparability over time: Although one of the advantages of document study is that comparisons may be made over a long period of time, since external events cause changes so drastic that even if a common unit of measure is used for the entire period, the value of this unit may have changed so much over time that comparisons are misleading unless corrections are made. Look at the change in measuring distance, temperature, currency, and even literacy in Pakistan.

Use of Secondary Data: Existing Statistics/Documents

Secondary Data

Secondary data refer to information gathered by someone other than the researcher conducting the present study. Secondary data are usually historical, already assembled, and do not require access to respondents or subjects. Many types of information about the social and behavioral world have been collected and are available to the researcher. Some information is in the form of statistical documents (books, reports) that contain numerical information. Other information is in the form of published compilations available in a library or on computerized records. In either case the researcher can search through collections of information with a research question and variables in mind, and then reassemble the information in new ways to address the research question.

Secondary data may be collected by large bureaucratic organization like the Bureau of Statistics or other government or private agencies. These data may have been collected for policy decisions or as part of public service.

The data may be a time bound collection of information (population census) as well as spread over long periods of time (unemployment trends, crime rate). Secondary data are used for making comparisons over time in the country (population trends in the country) as well as across the countries (world population trends).

Selecting Topic for Secondary Analysis

Search through the collections of information with research question and variables in mind, and then reassemble the information in new ways to address the research question.

It is difficult to specify topics that are appropriate for existing statistics research because they are so varied. Any topic on which information has been collected and is publicly available can be studied. In fact, existing statistics projects may not neatly fit into a deductive model of research design. Rather researchers creatively recognize the existing information into the variables for a research question after first finding what data are available.

Experiments are best for topics where the researcher controls a situation and manipulates an independent variable. Survey research is best for topics where the researcher asks questions and learns about reported attitudes and behavior. Content analysis is for topics that involve the content of messages in cultural communication.

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Existing statistics research is best for topics that involve information collected by large bureaucratic organizations. Public or private organizations systematically gather many types of information. Such information is collected for policy decisions or as a public service. It is rarely collected for purposes directly related to a specific research question. Thus existing statistics research is appropriate when a researcher wants to test hypotheses involving variables that are also in official reports of social, economic and political conditions. These include descriptions of organizations or people in them. Often, such information is collected over long periods. For example, existing statistics can be used by researcher who wants to see whether unemployment and crime rates are associated in 100 cities across a 20 year period.

As part of the trends, say in development, researchers try to develop social indicators for measuring the well-being of the people. A *social indicator* is any measure of wellbeing used in policy. There are many specific indicators that are operationalization of well-being. It is hoped that information about social well-being could be combined with widely used indicators of economic performance (e.g., gross national product) to better inform government and other policy making officials.

The main sources of existing statistics are government or international agencies and private sources. An enormous volume and variety of information exists. If you plan to conduct existing statistics research, it is wise to discuss your interests with an information professional – in this case, a reference librarian, who can point you in the direction of possible sources.

Many existing documents are "free" – that is, publicly available at libraries – but the time and effort it takes to research for specific information can be substantial. Researchers who conduct existing statistics research spend many hours in libraries or on the internet.

There are so many sources of existing statistics like: UN publications, UNESCO Statistical Yearbook, UN Statistical Yearbook, Demographic Yearbook, Labor Force Survey of Pakistan, and Population Census Data.

Secondary Survey Data

Secondary analysis is a special case of existing statistics; it is reanalysis of previously collected survey or other data that was originally gathered by others. As opposed to primary research (e.g., experiments, surveys, and content analysis), the focus is on analyzing rather than collecting data.

Secondary analysis is increasingly used by researchers. It is relatively inexpensive; it permits comparisons across groups, nations, or time; it facilitates replication; and permits asking about issues not thought by the original researchers. There are several questions the researcher interested in secondary research should ask: Are the secondary data appropriate for the research question? What theory and hypothesis can a researcher use with the data? Is the researcher already familiar with the substantive area? Does the researcher understand how the data were originally gathered and coded?

Large-scale data collection is expensive and difficult. The cost and time required for major national surveys that uses rigorous techniques are prohibitive for most researchers. Fortunately, the organization, preservation, and dissemination of major survey data sets have improved. Today, there are archives of past surveys open to researchers (e.g., data on Population Census of Pakistan, Demographic Survey of Pakistan).

Reliability and Validity

Existing statistics and secondary data are not trouble free just because a government agency or other source gathered the original data. Researchers must be concerned with validity and reliability, as well as with some problems unique to this research technique.

A common error is the *fallacy of misplaced concreteness*. It occurs when someone gives a false impression of accuracy by quoting statistics in greater detail than warranted by how the statistics are collected and by overloading detail. For example, in order to impress an audience, a politician might

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say that every year 3010,534 persons, instead of saying 3 million persons, are annually being added to the population of Pakistan.

Validity: Validity problems occur when the researcher‟s theoretical definition does not match that of the government agency or organization that collected the information. Official policies and procedures specify definitions for official statistics. For example, a researcher defines a *work injury* as including minor cuts, bruises, and sprains that occur on the job, but the official definition in government reports only includes injuries that require a visit to a physician or hospital. Many work injuries as defined by the researcher will not be in the official statistics. Another example occurs when a researcher defines people *unemployed* if they would work if a good job was available, if they have to work part-time when they want full-time work, and if they have given up looking for work. The official definition, however, includes only those who are now actively seeking work (full or part-time) as unemployed. The official statistics exclude those who stopped looking, who work part-time out of necessity, or who do not look because they believe no work is available. In both the cases the researcher‟s definition differs from that in official statistics.

Another validity problem arises when official statistics are a proxy for a construct in which the researcher is really interested. This is necessary because the researcher cannot collect original data. For example, the researcher wants to know how many people have been robbed, so he or she uses police statistics on robbery arrests as a proxy. But the measure is not entirely valid because many robberies are not reported to the police, and reported robberies do not always result in an arrest.

Another validity problem arises because the researcher lacks control over how information is collected. All information, even that in official government reports, is originally gathered by people in bureaucracies as part of their job. A researcher depends on them for collecting organizing, reporting, and publishing data accurately. Systematic errors in collecting the initial information (e.g., census people who avoid poor neighborhoods and make-up information, or people who put a false age on their ID card); errors in organizing and reporting information (e.g., police department that is sloppy about filing crime reports and loses some); errors in publishing information (e.g., a typographical error in a table) all reduce measurement validity.

Reliability: Stability reliability problems develop when official definition or the method of collecting information changes over time. Official definitions of work injury, disability, unemployment, literacy, poverty, and the like change periodically. Even if the researcher learns of such changes, consistent measurement over time is impossible.

Equivalence reliability can also be a problem. For example, studies of police department suggest that political pressures to increase arrests are closely related to the number of arrests. It could be seen when political pressures in one city may increase arrests (e.g., a crackdown on crime), whereas pressures in another city may decrease arrests (e.g., to show drop in crime shortly before an election in order to make officials look better).

Researchers often use official statistics for international comparisons but national governments collect data differently and the quality of data collection varies.

Inferences from Non-Reactive Data:

A researcher‟s ability to infer causality or to test a theory on the basis of non-reactive data is limited. It is difficult to use unobtrusive measures to establish temporal order and eliminate alternative explanations. In content analysis, a researcher cannot generalize from the content to its effects on those who read the text, but can only use the correlation logic of survey research to show an association among variables. Unlike the case of survey research, a researcher does not ask respondents direct questions to measure variables, but relies on the information available in the text.

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Lesson 38

OBSERVATION STUDIES/FIELD RESEARCH

Observation studies are primarily part of qualitative research. Though qualitative and quantitative researches differ yet they complement each other. Qualitative research produces *soft data*: impressions, words, sentences, photos, symbols. Usually it follows an interpretive approach, the goal of which is to develop an understanding of social life and discover how people construct meanings in natural settings. The research process follows a non-linear approach (spiral).

Quantitative research produces *hard data*: numbers. It follows a positivist approach to research in which the researcher speaks the language of variables and hypotheses. There is a much emphasis on precise measurement of variables and the testing of hypotheses. The researcher tries to establish causality. In most of the case there is a linear approach i.e. it follows sequential steps in doing research.

Participant/Non-Participant Observation

Observation studies can be participant or non-participant. In participant observation the researcher directly observes and participates in small scale social settings in the present time. Such a study is also referred to as **field research**, ethnography, or anthropological study. Here the researchers:

- Study people in their natural settings, or in situ.
- Study people by directly interacting with them.
- Gain an understanding of the social world and make theoretical statements about members" perspective.

The people could be a group who interact with each other on regular basis in a field setting: a street corner, a tea shop, a club, a nomad group, a village, etc.

Non-participant studies are such where the research tries to observe the behavior of people without interacting with them. It could be observing the behavior of shoppers in a departmental store through a mirror or on a closed circuit TV. Somebody might be counting the number of vehicles crossing a particular traffic light.

Field researchers study people in a location or setting. It has been used to study entire communities. Field research has a distinct set of methodologies. Field researchers directly observe and interact with community members in natural settings to get inside their perspectives. They embrace an activist or social constructionist perspective on social life. They do not see people as a neutral medium through which social forces operate, nor do they see social meanings as something "out there" to observe. Instead they believe that people create and define the social world through their interactions. Human experiences are filtered through a subjective sense of reality, which affects how people see and act on events. Thus they replace the positivist emphasis on "objective facts" with a focus on the everyday, face-to-face social processes of negotiation, discussion, and bargaining to construct social meaning.

Ethnography and Ethno-methodology

Two modern extensions of field research, ethnography and ethno-methodology, build on the social constructionist perspective.

Ethnography comes from cultural anthropology. *Ethno* means people or a folk distinct by their culture and ethnography refers to describing something. Thus ethnography means describing a culture and understanding another way of life from the native point of view. It is just an understanding the culture of people from their own perspective.

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Ethno-methodology implies how people create reality and how they interpret it. Ethno-methodologists examine ordinary social interaction in great detail to identify the rules for constructing social reality and common sense, how these rules are applied, and how new rules are created. They try to figure out how certain meanings are attached to a reality.

Logic of Field Research

It is difficult to pin down a specific definition of *field research* because it is more of an orientation toward research than a fixed set of techniques to apply. A field researcher uses various methods to obtain information. A field researcher is a „methodological pragmatist,‟ a resourceful, talented individual who has ingenuity and an ability to think on his or feet while in the field.

Field research is based on naturalism, which involves observing ordinary events in natural settings, not in contrived, invented, or researcher created settings.

A field researcher examines social meanings and grasps multiple perspectives in natural setting. He or she gets inside the meanings system of members and goes back to an outside or research viewpoint. Fieldwork means involvement and detachment, loyalty and betrayal, both openness and secrecy, and most likely, love and hate. The researcher switches perspectives and sees the setting from multiple pints of view simultaneously. Researchers maintains membership in the culture in which they were reared (research culture) while establishing membership in the groups which they are studying.

The researcher‟s direct involvement in the field often has an emotional impact. Field research can be fun and exciting, but it can also disrupt one‟s personal life, physical security, or mental well-being. More than other types of research, it reshapes friendship, family life, self-identity, or personal values.

What Do the Field Researchers Do?

A field researcher does the following:

1. Observes ordinary events and everyday activities as they happen in natural settings, in addition to unusual occurrences.
2. Becomes directly involved with people being studied and personally experiences the process of daily life in the field setting.
3. Acquires an insider‟s point of view while maintaining the analytic perspective or distance of an outsider.
4. Uses a variety of techniques and social skills in a flexible manner as the situation demands.
5. Produces data in the form of extensive, written notes, as well as diagrams, maps, pictures to provide very detailed descriptions.
6. Sees events holistically (as a whole, not in pieces) and individually in their social context.
7. Understands and develops empathy for members in a field setting, and does not just record „cold‟ objective facts.
8. Notices both explicit (recognized, conscious, spoken) and tacit (less recognized, implicit, unspoken) aspects of culture.
9. Observes ongoing social processes without upsetting, or imposing an outside point of view.
10. Copes with high levels of personal stress, uncertainty, ethical dilemmas, and ambiguity.

Steps in Field Research

Naturalism and direct involvement mean that field research is more flexible or less structured than quantitative research. This makes it essential for a researcher to be well organized and prepared for the field. It also means that the steps of project are not entirely predetermined but serve as an approximate guide or road map. Here is just the listing of these steps:

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1. Prepare yourself, read the literature and defocus.
2. Select a site and gain access.
3. Enter the field and establish social relations with members.
4. Adopt a social role, learn the ropes, and get along with members.
5. Watch, listen, and collect quality data.
6. Begin to analyze data, generate and evaluate working hypothesis.
7. Focus on specific aspects of the setting and use theoretical sampling.
8. Conduct field interviews with member informants.
9. Disengage and physically leave the setting.
10. Complete the analysis and write the report.

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Lesson 39

OBSERVATION STUDIES (Contd.)

Steps in Field Research

Background

Naturalism and direct involvement mean that field research is more flexible or less structured than quantitative research. This makes it essential for a researcher to be well organized and prepared for the field. It also means that the steps of project are not entirely predetermined but serve as an approximate guide or road map. These guideline steps are:

1. ***Prepare yourself, read the literature and defocus.*** As with all social and behavioral research, reading the scholarly literature helps the researcher learn concepts, potential pitfalls, data collection methods, and techniques for resolving conflicts. In addition field researcher finds diaries, novels, journalistic accounts, and autobiographies useful for gaining familiarity and preparing emotionally for the field. Field research begins with a general topic, not specific hypotheses. A researcher does not get locked into any initial misconceptions. He or she needs to be well informed but open to discovering new ideas.

   A researcher first empties his or her mind of preconceptions and defocuses. There are two types of defocusing. The first is casting a wide net in order to witness a wide range of situations, people, and setting – getting a feel of the overall setting before deciding what to include or exclude. The second type of defocusing means not focusing exclusively on the role of researcher. It may be important to extend one‟s experience beyond a strictly professional role.

   Another preparation for field research is self-knowledge. A field researcher needs to know him or herself and reflect on personal experiences. He or she can expect anxiety, self-doubt, frustration, and uncertainty in the field. Also all kinds of stereotypes about the community should be emptied.

2. ***Select a site and gain access.*** Although a field research project does not proceed by fixed steps, some common concerns arise in the early stages. These include selecting a site, gaining access to the site, entering the field, and developing rapport with members in the field.

   Field site is the context in which events or activities occur, a socially defined territory with shifting boundaries. A social group may interact across several physical sites. For example, a college football team may interact on the playing field, in the dressing room, at a training camp or at the place where they are staying. The team‟s field site includes all four locations.

   Physical access to a site can be an issue. Sites can be on a continuum, with open and public areas (e.g., public restaurants, airport waiting rooms) at one end and closed and private settings (e.g., private firms, clubs, activities in a person‟s home) at the other end. A researcher may find that he or she is not welcome or not allowed on the site, or there are legal and political barriers to access.

   Look for the gate keepers for getting an entry. A gatekeeper is someone with the formal authority to control access to a site. It can be a thug at the corner, an administrator of a hospital, or the owner of a business. In formal public areas (e.g., sidewalks, public waiting rooms) rarely have gatekeepers; formal organizations have authorities from whom permission must be obtained. Field researchers expect to negotiate with gatekeepers and bargain for access. Entry and access can be visualized as an *access ladder*. A researcher begins at the bottom rung, where access is easy and where he or she is an outsider looking for public information. The next access rung requires increased access. Once close on-site observations

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begin, he or she becomes a passive observer, not questioning what members of community say. With time in the field, the researcher observes specific activities that are potentially sensitive or seeks clarification of what he or she sees or hears. Reaching this access rung is more difficult. Finally, the researcher may try to shape interaction so that it reveals specific information, or he or she may want to see highly sensitive material. This highest rung of access ladder is rarely attained and requires deep trust. Such a situation may be applicable to a site of a public or private organization. In other situations just like entering the village community, the researcher may have to use different kind of access ladder. He or she may have to use local influential and some other contact persons who could introduce the researcher to local leaders and help building the rapport.

3. ***Enter the field and establish social relations with members.*** Present yourself in the field the way it is acceptable to the people to be studied. Develop relations and establish rapport with individual members. Here the researcher may have to learn the local language. A field researcher builds rapport by getting along with members in the field. He or she forges a friendly relationship, shares the same language, and laughs and cries with members. This is a step toward obtaining an understanding of members and moving beyond understanding to empathy – that is seeing and feeling events from another‟s perspective.

4. ***Enter the field: Adopt a social role, learn the ropes, and get along with members.*** At times, a researcher adopts an existing role. Some existing roles provide access to all areas of the site, the ability to observe and interact with all members, the freedom to move around, and a way to balance the requirements of researcher and member. There could be some limitations for the adoption of specific roles. Such limitations may be because of researcher‟s age, race, gender, and attractiveness. At other times, a researcher creates new roles or modifies the existing one. The adoption of field role takes time, and a researcher may adopt several different field roles over time.

   The role may also depend upon the level of involvement in the community‟s activities. The researcher may be a complete observer, observer as participant, participant as observer, and complete participant.

   As a researcher learns the ropes on the field site, he or she learns how to cope with personal stress, how to normalize the social research, and how to act like an “acceptable incompetent.” A researcher is in the field to learn, not to be an expert. Depending on the setting, he or she appears to be friendly but naïve outsider, an acceptable incompetent who is interested in learning about social life of the field. An acceptable incompetent is one who is partially competent (skilled or knowledgeable) in the setting but who‟s accepted as a non-threatening person

5. ***Observing and collecting data: Watch, listen, and collect quality data.*** A great deal of what field researchers do in the field is to pay attention, watch, and listen carefully. They use all the senses, noticing what is seen, heard, smelled, tasted, or touched. The researcher becomes an instrument that absorbs all sources of information.

   Most field research data are in the form of field notes. Good notes are the brick and mortar of field research. Full field notes can contain maps, diagrams, photographs, interviews, tape recordings, videotapes, memos, objects from the field, notes jotted in the field, and detailed notes written away from the field. A field researcher expects to fill many notebooks, or the equivalent in computer memory. He or she may spend more time writing notes than being in the field.

   Writing notes is often boring, tedious work that requires self-discipline. The notes contain extensive descriptive detail drawn from memory. The researcher makes it a daily habit or compulsion to write notes immediately after leaving the field. The notes must be neat and

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organized because the researcher will return to them over and over again. Once written, the notes are private and valuable. A researcher treats them with care and protects confidentiality.

Field researcher is supposed to collect quality data. What does the term high-quality data mean in the field research, and what does a researcher do to get it? For a quantitative researcher, high quality data are reliable and valid; they give precise, consistent measures of the "objective" truth for all researchers. An interpretive approach suggests a different kind of data quality. Instead of assuming one single, objective truth, field researchers hold that members subjectively interpret experiences within social context. What a member takes to be true results from social interaction and interpretation. Thus high quality field data capture such processes and provide an understanding of the member‟s viewpoint.

A field researcher does not eliminate subjective views to get quality data: rather, quality data include his or her subjective responses and experiences. Quality field data are detailed descriptions from the researcher‟s immersion and authentic experiences in the social world of members.

6. ***Begin to analyze data generate and evaluate working hypothesis.*** Right in the field try to look into the research questions and the kind of answers the researcher is getting. The analysis of the answers might help in the generation of hypotheses. Over time are such hypotheses being supported by further field research?

7. ***Focus on specific aspects of the setting and use theoretical sampling.*** Field researcher first gets a general picture, and then focuses on a few specific problems or issues. A researcher decides on specific research questions and develops hypotheses only after being in the field and experiencing it first-hand. At first, everything seems relevant; later, however, selective attention focuses on specific questions and themes.

   Field research sampling differs from survey sampling, although sometime both use snowball sampling. A field researcher samples by taking a smaller, selective set of observations from all possible observations. It is called theoretical sampling because it is guided by the researcher‟s developing theory. Field researchers sample times, situations, types of events, locations, types of people, or context of interest.

   For example, field researcher samples time by observing a setting at different times. He or she observes at all time of the day, on every day of the week, and in all seasons to get a full sense of how the field site stays the same or changes. Another example, when the field researcher samples locations because one location may give depth, but narrow perspective. Sitting or standing in different locations helps the researcher to get a sense of the whole site. Similarly the field researchers sample people by focusing their attention or interaction on different kinds of people (young, adult, old).

8. ***Conduct field interviews with member informants.*** Field researchers use unstructured, non-directive, in-depth interviews, which differs from formal survey research interviews in many ways. The field interview involves asking question, listening, expressing interest, and recording what was said.

   Field interview is a joint production of a research and a member. Members are active participants whose insights, feelings, and cooperation are essential parts of a discussion process that reveals subjective meaning. The interviewer‟s presence and form of involvement – how he or she listens, attends, encourages, interrupts, disagrees, initiates topics, and terminates responses – is integral to the respondent‟s account.

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Field research interviews go by many names: unstructured, depth, ethnographic, open ended, informal, and long. Generally, they involve one or more people being present, occur in the field, and are informal and nondirective.

A comparison of the field research interview and a survey interview could be as below:

Survey Interview	Field Interview
1. It has clear beginning and end.	1. The beginning and end are not clear. The interview can be picked up later.
2. The same standard questions are asked of all respondents in the same sequence.	2. The questions and the order in which they are asked are tailored to specific people and situations.
3. The interviewer appears neutral at all times.	3.The interviewer shows interest in responses, encourages elaboration.
4. The interviewer asks questions, and the respondent answers.	4. It is like a friendly conversational exchange but with more interviewer questions.
5. It is almost always with one respondent alone.	5. It can occur in group setting or with others in area, but varies.
6. It has a professional tone and businesslike focus, diversions are ignored.	6. It is interspersed with jokes, aside, stories, diversions, and anecdotes, which are recorded.
7. Closed-ended questions are common, with rare probes.	7. Open-ended questions are common, and probes are frequent.
8. The interviewer alone controls the pace and direction of interview.	8. The interviewer and member jointly control the pace and direction of the interview.
9. The social context in which the interview occurs is ignored and assumed to make little difference.	9. The social context of the interview is noted and seen as important for interpreting the meaning of responses.
10. The interviewer attempts to mold the communication pattern into a standard framework.	10. The interviewer adjusts to the member‟s norms and language usages.

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9. ***Disengage and physically leave the setting.*** Work in the field can last for a few weeks to a dozen years. In either case at some point of work in the field ends. Some researchers suggest that the end comes naturally when the theory building ceases or reaches a closure; others feel that fieldwork could go on without end and that a firm decision to cut off relations is needed. Experienced field researchers anticipate a process of disengaging and exiting the field. Depending on the intensity of involvement and the length of time in the field, the process can be disruptive or emotionally painful for both the researcher and the members.

   Once researcher decides to leave – because the project reaches a natural end and little new is being learned, or because external factors force it to end (e.g., end of job, gatekeepers order the researcher out) – he or she chooses a method of exiting. The researcher can leave by quick exit (simply not return one day) or slowly withdraw, reducing his or her involvement over weeks. He or she also needs to decide how to tell members and how much advance warning to give. The best way to exist is to follow the local norms and continuing with the friendly relations.

10. ***Complete the analysis and write the report.*** After disengaging from the field setting the researcher writes the report. The researcher may share the written report with the members observed to verify the accuracy and get their approval of its portrayal in print. It may help in determining the validity of the findings. However, it may not be possible to share the findings with marginal groups like addicts, and some deviant groups.

Ethical Dilemmas of Field research

The direct personal involvement of a field researcher in the social lives of other people raises many ethical dilemmas. The dilemmas arise when the researcher is alone in the field and has little time to make a moral decision. Although he or she may be aware of general ethical issues before entering the field, they arise unexpectedly in the course of observing and interacting in the field. Let us look at some of these dilemmas:

Deception: Deception arises in several ways in field research. The research may be covert; or may assume a false role, name, or identity; or may mislead members in some way. The most hotly debated of the ethical issues arising from deception is that of covert versus overt field research. Some support it and see it as necessary for entering into and aiming a full knowledge of many areas of social life. Others oppose it and argue that it undermines a trust between researchers and society. Although its moral status is questionable, there are some field sites or activities that can only be studied covertly. One may have to look into the cost and benefit equation; where the researcher is the best judge.

Covert research is never preferable and never easier than overt research because of the difficulties of maintaining a front and the constant fear of getting caught.

Confidentiality: A researcher learns intimate knowledge that is given in confidence. He or she has a moral obligation to uphold the confidentiality of data. This includes keeping information confidential from others in the field and disguising members‟ names in field notes.

Involvement with deviants: Researchers who conduct research on deviants who engage in illegal behavior face additional dilemmas. They know of and are sometimes involved in illegal activity. They might be getting „guilty knowledge.‟ Such knowledge is of interest not only to law enforcement officials but also to other deviants. The researcher faces a dilemma of building trust and rapport with the deviants, yet not becoming so involved as to violate his or her basic personal moral standards. Usually, the researcher makes an explicit arrangement with the deviant members.

The powerful: Field researchers tend to study those without power in society (e.g., street people, the poor, children, and lower level workers). Powerful elites can block access and have effective

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gatekeepers. Researchers are criticized for ignoring the powerful, and they are also criticized by the powerful for being biased toward the less powerful.

Publishing field reports: The intimate knowledge that a researcher obtains and reports creates a dilemma between the right of privacy and the right to know. A researcher does not publicize member secrets, violate privacy, or harm reputations. Yet if he or she cannot publish anything that might offend or harm someone, some of what the researcher learned will remain hidden, and it may be difficult for others to believe the report if critical details are omitted.

Some researchers suggest asking members of the group under study to look at a report to verify its accuracy and to approve of their portrayal in print. For marginal groups (addicts), this may not be possible, but the researchers must always respect member privacy. On the other hand, censorship or self-censorship can be a danger. A compromise position is that truthful but unflattering material may be published only if it is essential to the researchers‟ larger arguments.

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Lesson 40

HISTORICAL COMPARATIVE RESEARCH

History has several meanings; one of which could refer to „the events of the past.‟ *Historiography* is the method of doing historical research or of gathering and analyzing historical evidence.

Historical-comparative research is a collection of techniques and approaches. It is a distinct type of research that puts historical time and /or cross-cultural variation at the center of research – that is, which treats what is studied as part of the flow of history and situated in cultural context.

Major questions

Historical comparative research is a powerful method for addressing big questions: How did major societal change take place? What fundamental features are common to most societies? Why did current social arrangements take a certain form in some societies but not in others? For example, historical-comparative researchers have addressed the questions of what caused societal revolutions in China, France and Russia; how major social institutions, medicine, have developed and changed over two centuries; how basic relationships, like feelings about the value of children, change; why public policy toward the treatment of elderly developed in one way instead of another way in an industrial country; why South Africa developed a system of greater racial separation as the United States moved toward a greater racial integration.

Historical-comparative research is suited for examining the combination of societal factors that produce a specific outcome (e.g., civil war). It is also appropriate for comparing entire social system to see what is common across societies and what is unique, and to study long term change. An H-C researcher may apply a theory to specific cases to illustrate its usefulness. And he or she compares the same social processes and concepts in different cultural or historical contexts.

Researchers also use H-C method to reinterpret data or challenge old explanations. By asking different questions, finding new evidence, or assembling evidence in a different way, the H-C researcher raises questions about old explanations and finds support for new ones by interpreting the data in its cultural-historical context.

Historical-comparative research can strengthen conceptualization and theory building. By looking at historical events or diverse cultural contexts, a researcher can generate new concepts and broaden his or her perspective. Concepts are less likely to be restricted to a single historical time or to a single culture; they can be grounded in the experiences of people living in a specific cultural and historical context.

Historical-Comparative research focuses on:

- Tracing the development of social forms (patterns) overtime as well as its broad historical processes, and
- Comparing those forms and its developmental processes across cultures (countries/nations).

Historical-Comparative research follows scientific approach:

- Can be a survey of events in history – could be through the study of documents. Organizations generally document themselves, so if one is studying the development of some organization he/she should examine its official documents: charters, policy statements, speeches by the leaders, and so on. Often, official government documents provide the data needed for analysis. To better appreciate the history of race relations in the United States one could examine 200 years of laws and court cases involving race.

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One could also do the communication analysis of different documents related to a particular issue (like the communication among the leaders of Pakistan movement through their letters, communication between the migrants to a new country and their relatives back in their country of origin)

Researcher could also get lot of information by interviewing people who may recall historical events (like interviewing participants in the Pakistan movement).

- Historical-Comparative researchers mostly do a longitudinal analysis i.e. look into the developmental processes of the issues under reference.
- Historical-Comparative researchers make cross-cultural comparisons of the social forms or economic form as well as the developmental processes of those forms, aiming at making generalizations.

Examples:

Social forms: Several researchers have examined the historical development of ideas about different forms of society. They have looked at the progression of social forms from simple to complex, from rural, from rural-agrarian to urban-industrial. The US anthropologist Lewis Morgan, for example, saw a progression from "savagery to "barbarism" to "civilization." Robert Redfield, another anthropologist, has more recently written of a shift from "folk society" to "urban society." Emile Durkheim saw social evolution largely as a process of ever-greater division of labor. Ibn-e-Khaldun looked at the cyclical process of change in the form of societies from nomadic (Al-badawi) to sedentary (Al-hadari). These researchers discuss the forces that produce changes as well as the characteristics of each form of society. The historical evidence collected by researchers from different sources about different societies supports the whole discussion.

Forms of economic systems: Karl Marx examined the forms of economic systems progressing historically from primitive to feudal to capitalistic. All history, he wrote in this context, was a history of class struggle – the "haves" struggling to maintain their advantages and the "have-nots" struggling for a better lot in life. Looking beyond capitalism, Marx saw the development of a „classless" society. In his opinion the economic forces have determined the societal system.

Not all historical studies in the social sciences have had this evolutionary flavor. Some social scientific readings of the historical record, in fact point to grand cycles rather than to linear progression (Ibn-e-Khaldun, P. Sorokin).

Economic forms and ideas: In his analysis of economic history, Karl Marx put forward a view of economic determinism. That is, he felt that economic factors determined the nature of all other aspects of society. Without denying that economic factors could and did affect other aspects of society, Max Weber argued that economic determinism did not explain everything. Indeed, Weber said, economic forms could come from non-economic ideas. In his research in the sociology of religion, Weber examined the extent to which religious institutions were the source of social behavior rather than mere reflection of economic conditions. His most noted statement of this side of the issue is found in *The Protestant Ethic and the Spirit of Capitalism.* John Calvin, a French theologian, was an important figure in the *Protestant* reformation of Christianity. Calvin thought that God had already decided the ultimate salvation or damnation of every individual; this idea is called *predestination*. Calvin also suggested that God communicated his decisions to people by making them either successful or unsuccessful during their earthly existence.

God gave each person an earthly "calling" – an occupation or profession – and manifested his or her success or failure through that medium. Ironically, this point of view led Calvin‟s followers to seek proof of their coming salvation by working hard, saving for economic success.

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In Weber‟s analysis, Calvinism provided an important stimulus for the development of capitalism. Rather than "wasting" their money on worldly comforts, the Calvinists reinvested it in economic enterprises, thus providing the *capital* necessary for the development of capitalism. In arriving at this interpretation of the origin of capitalism, Weber researched the official doctrines of the early Protestant churches, studied the preaching of Calvin and other church leaders, and examined other historical documents.

In three other studies, Weber conducted detailed analyses of Judaism, and the religions of China and India. Among other things, Weber wanted to know why capitalism had not developed in the ancient societies of China, India, and Israel. In none of the three religions did he find any teaching that would have supported the accumulation and reinvestment of capital – strengthening his conclusion about the role of Protestantism in that regard.

Logic of Historical-Comparative Research

Confusion over terms reigns H-C research. Researchers call what they do historical, comparative or historical-comparative, but mean different things. The key question is: Is there a distinct historical-comparative method and logic, or is there just social research that happens to examine social life in the past or in several societies? Some researchers use positivist, quantitative approach to study historical or comparative issues, while others rely on qualitative approach.

Quantitative approach:

Positivist researchers reject the idea that there is a distinct H-C method. They measure variables, test hypotheses, analyze quantitative data, and replicate research to discover generalizable laws that hold across time and societies. They see no fundamental distinction between quantitative social research and historical-comparative research. They apply quantitative research techniques, with some minor adjustments, to study the past or other cultures.

- The researcher can focus on the issue in one society few societies or multiple societies.
- The researcher can focus on the issue in one time in the past or examine the issue across many years/periods in the past.
- The researcher can focus on the issue in the present or a recent past period.
- The researcher‟s analysis could be based primarily on quantitative data or qualitative data.
- Nevertheless, the debate continues.

H-C researchers sometimes use *time-series* data to monitor changing conditions over time, such as data on population, crime rates, unemployment, infant mortality rates, and so forth. The analysis of such data sometimes requires sophistication for purposes of comparability. In case the definitions of the concept vary, it becomes difficult to make comparisons. The definitions not only could vary across nations but also these could vary within the same country over time (In Pakistan the definition of literacy changed from what it was in first population census of 1951 and what we had later on).

Qualitative approach:

There are no easily listed steps to follow in the analysis of historical data. Max Weber used the German term *verstehen* –"understanding" – in reference to an essential quality of research in behavioral sciences. He meant that the researcher must be able to take on, mentally, the circumstances, views, and feelings of those being studied to interpret their actions appropriately.

The historical-comparative researcher must find patterns among the voluminous details describing the subject matter of study. Often this takes the form of what Weber called ideal types: conceptual models composed of the essential characteristics of the phenomena. Thus, for example, Weber himself conducted lot of research on bureaucracy. Having observed numerous bureaucracies, Weber detailed those qualities essential to bureaucracies in general: jurisdictional areas, hierarchically structured authority, written files, and so on. Weber did not merely list those characteristics common to all

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bureaucracies he observed. Rather, he needed to understand fully the essentials of bureaucratic operation to create a theoretical model of the "perfect" (ideal type) bureaucracy.

A distinct, qualitative historical-comparative research differs from the positivist approach. Historical-comparative researchers who use case studies and qualitative data may depart from positivist approach. Their research is an intensive investigation of a limited number of cases in which the social meaning and context are critical. Case studies even in one nation can be very important. Without case studies, scholars "would continue to advance theoretical arguments that are inappropriate, outdated, or totally irrelevant for a specific region".

Historical-comparative researcher focuses on culture (patterns of behavior), tries to see through the eyes of those being studied, reconstructs the lives of the people studied, and examines particular individuals or groups.

A distinct H-C approach borrows from ethnography and cultural anthropology, and some varieties of H-C are close to "thick description" in their attempt to recreate the reality of another time or place.

A Distinct Historical-Comparative Approach

A distinct historical-comparative research method avoids the excesses of the positivist and interpretive approaches. It combines sensitivity to specific historical or cultural contexts with theoretical generalization. Historical-comparative researches may use quantitative data to supplement qualitative data and analysis. The logic and goals of H-C research are closer to those of field research than to those of traditional positivist approaches.

Similarities to Field Research:

First, both H-C research and field research recognize that the researcher‟s point of view is an avoidable part of research. Both involve interpretation, which introduces the interpreter‟s location in time, place, and world-view. H-C research does not try to produce a single, unequivocal set of objective facts. Rather, it is a confrontation of old with new or different world-views. It recognizes that the researcher‟s reading of historical or comparative evidence is influenced by an awareness of the past and by living in the present. Our present day consciousness of history is fundamentally different from the manner in which the past appeared to any foregoing people.

Second, both field and H-C research examine a great diversity of data. In both, the researcher becomes immersed in data to gain an emphatic understanding of events and people. Both capture subjective feelings and note how every day, ordinary activities signify important social meaning. The researcher inquires, selects, and focuses on specific aspects of social life from the vast array of events, actions, symbols, and words. An H-C researcher organizes data and focuses attention on the basis of evolving concepts. He or she examines rituals and symbols and dramatize culture and investigates the motives, reasons, and justifications for behaviors.

Third, both field and H-C researchers often use *grounded theory*. Theory usually emerges during the process of data collection. Both examine data without beginning with fixed hypotheses. Instead, they develop and modify concepts and theory through a dialogue with the data, then apply theory to reorganize evidence. [Historically grounded theory means that concepts emerge from the analytic problem of history: ordering the past into structures, conjectures and events. History and theory can thus be simultaneously constructed.]

Fourthly, both field and H-C research involve a type of translation. The researcher‟s meaning system usually differs from that of people he or she studies, but he or she tries to penetrate and understand their point of view. Once the life, language, and perspective of the people being studied have been mastered, the researcher "translates" it for others who read his or her report.

Fifth, both field and H-C researchers focus on action, process, and sequence and see time process as essential. Both say that people construct a sense of social reality through actions that occur over time.

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Both see social reality simultaneously as something created and changed by people and as imposing a restriction on human choice.

Sixth, generalizations and theory are limited in field and H-C research. Historical and cross-cultural knowledge is incomplete and provisional, based on selective facts and limited questions. Neither deduces propositions or tests hypotheses in order to uncover fixed laws. Likewise replication is unrealistic because each researcher has a unique perspective and assembles a unique body of evidence. Instead, researchers offer plausible accounts and limited generalizations.

Unique Features of H-C Research: Despite its many similarities to field research, some important differences distinguish H-C research. Research on past and on an alien culture share much in common with each other, and what they share distinguishes them from other approaches.

First, the evidence of H-C research is usually limited and indirect. Direct observation and involvement by a researcher is often impossible. An H-C researcher reconstructs what occurred from the evidence, but he or she cannot have absolute confidence in his reconstruction. Historical evidence in particular depends on the survival of data from the past, usually in the form of documents (e.g., letters and newspapers). The researcher is limited to what has not been destroyed and what leaves a trace, record, or other evidence behind.

Second, H-C researchers interpret the evidence. Different people looking at the same evidence often ascribe different meanings to it, so a researcher must reflect on evidence. An understanding of it based on a first glance is rarely possible. The researcher becomes immersed in and absorbs details about a context. For example, a researcher examining the family in the past or a distant country needs to be aware of the full context (e.g., the nature of work, forms of communication, transportation technology, etc.).

Another feature is that a researcher‟s reconstruction of the past or another culture is easily distorted. Compared to the people being studied, H-C researchers is usually more aware of events occurring prior to the time studied, events occurring in places other than the location studied, and events that occurred after the period studied. This awareness gives the researchers a greater sense of coherence than was experienced by those living in the past or in an isolated social setting. Historical explanation surpasses any understanding while events are still occurring. The past we reconstruct is more coherent than the past when it happened.

A researcher cannot see through the eyes of those being studied. Knowledge of the present and changes over time can distort how events, people, laws, or even physical objects are perceived. When the building was newly built (say in 1800) and standing among similar buildings, the people living at the time saw it differently than people do in the 21st century.

H-C researcher does not use deterministic approach. H-C research takes an approach to causality that is more contingent than determinist. An H-C researcher often uses combinational explanations. They are analogous to a chemical reaction in which several ingredients (chemicals, oxygen) are added together under specified conditions (temperature, pressure) to produce an outcome (explosion). This differs from a linear causal explanation. H-C research focuses on whole cases and on comparisons of complex wholes versus separate variables across cases. The logic is more “A, B, and C appeared together in time and place, then D resulted” than “A caused B, and B caused C, and C caused D.”

H-C researcher has the ability to shift between a specific context and a generalized context for purposes of comparison. A researcher examines several specific contexts, notes similarities and differences, then generalizes. He or she looks again at the specific context using the generalization. H-C researchers compare across cultural-geographic units. They develop trans-cultural concepts for purposes of comparative analysis. In comparative research, a researcher translates the specifics of a context into a common, theoretical language. In historical research theoretical concepts are applied across time.

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Lesson 41

HISTORICAL-COMPARATIVE RESEARCH (Contd.)

Conducting historical-comparative research does not involve a rigid set of steps and, with only a few exceptions; it does not use complex or specialized techniques. Nevertheless, some guideline for doing historical-comparative research may be provided.

Conceptualizing the Object of Inquiry

An H-C researcher begins by becoming familiar with the setting and conceptualizes what is being studied. He or she may start with a loose model or set of preliminary concepts and apply them to specific setting. The provisional concepts contain implicit assumptions or organizing categories that he or she uses to see the world, "package" observations, and search through evidence.

Decide on the historical era or comparative settings (nations or units). If the researcher is not already familiar with historical era or comparative settings, he or she conducts an orientation reading (reading several general works). This will help the researcher grasp the specific setting, assemble organizing concepts, subdivide the main issue, and develop lists of questions relating to specific issue.

Locating Evidence

The researcher locates and gathers evidence through extensive bibliographic work. A researcher uses many indexes, catalogs, and reference works that list what libraries contain. For comparative research, this means focusing on specific nations or units and on particular kinds of evidence within each. The researcher frequently spends weeks searching for sources in libraries, travels to several different specialized research libraries, and reads dozens of books and articles. Comparative research often involves learning one or more foreign languages.

As the researcher masters the literature and takes numerous detailed notes, he or she completes many specific tasks: creating a bibliography list (on cards or on computer) with complete citations, taking notes that are neither too skimpy nor too extensive, leaving margins on note cards for adding themes later on, taking all note in the same format, and developing a file on themes or working hypothesis.

A researcher adjusts initial concepts, questions, or focus on the basis of what he or she discovers in the evidence. New issues and questions arise as he or she reads and considers a range of research reports at different levels of analysis (e.g., general context and detailed narratives on specific topic), and multiple studies on a topic, crossing topic boundaries.

Evaluating Quality of Evidence

As the H-C researcher gathers evidence, he or she asks two questions: How relevant is the evidence to emerging research questions and evolving concepts? How accurate and strong is the evidence?

The question of relevance is difficult one. All documents may not be equally valuable in reconstructing the past. As the focus of research shifts, evidence that was not relevant can become relevant. Likewise, some evidence may stimulate new avenues of inquiry and search for additional confirming evidence.

Accuracy of evidence may be looked at for three things: the implicit conceptual framework, particular details that are required and empirical generalizations. H-C researcher evaluates alternative interpretations of evidence and looks for "silences," of cases where the evidence fails to address an event, topic, or issue.

Researchers try to avoid possible fallacies in the evidence. For example, a fallacy of pseudo proof is failure to place something into its full context. The evidence might state that that there was a 50 percent increase in income taxes, but it is not meaningful outside of a context. The researcher must

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ask: Did other taxes decline? Did income increase? Did the tax incase apply to all income? Was everyone affected equally?

Organizing Evidence

As a researcher gathers evidence and locates new sources, he or she begins to organize the data. Obviously, it is unwise to take notes madly and let them pile up haphazardly. A researcher usually begins a preliminary analysis by noting low-level generalizations or themes. For example, in a study of revolution, a researcher develops a theme: The rich peasants supported the old regime. He or she can record this theme in his or her notes and later assign to significance.

Researcher organizes evidence, using theoretical insights to stimulate new ways to organize data and for new questions to ask of evidence. The interaction of data and theory means that a researcher goes beyond a surface examination of the evidence based on theory. For example, a researcher reads a mass of evidence about a protest movement. The preliminary analysis organizes the evidence into a theme: People who are active in protest interact with each other and develop shared cultural meanings. He or she examines theories of culture and movements, then formulates new concept: "oppositional movement subculture." The researcher then uses this concept to re-examine the evidence.

Synthesizing

The researcher refines concepts and moves toward a general explanatory model after most of the evidence is in. Old themes or concepts are discussed or revised, and new ones are created. Concrete events are used to give meaning to concepts.

The researcher looks for patterns across time or units, and draws out similarities and differences with analogies. He or she organizes divergent events into sequences and groups them together to create a larger picture. Plausible explanations are then developed that subsume both concepts and evidence as he or she organizes the evidence into a coherent whole. The researcher then reads and rereads notes and sorts and resorts them into piles or files on the basis of organizing schemes. He or she looks for and writes down the links or connections he or she sees while looking at evidence in different ways.

Synthesis links specific evidence with an abstract model of underlying relations or causal mechanism. A researcher often looks for new evidence to verify specific links that appear only after an explanatory model is developed. He or she evaluates how well the model approximates the evidence and adjusts it accordingly.

Historical-comparative researchers also identify critical indicators and supporting evidence for themes or explanations. A *critical indicator* is unambiguous evidence, which is usually sufficient for inferring a specific theoretical relationship. Researchers seek these indicators for key parts of an explanatory model. Indicators critically confirm a theoretical inference and occur when many details suggest a clear interpretation.

Writing a Report

Combine evidence, concepts, and synthesis into a research report. The way in which the report is written is key in H-C research. Assembling evidence, arguments, and conclusions into a report is always a crucial step; but more than in quantitative approaches, the careful crafting of evidence and explanation makes or breaks H-C research. A researcher distills mountains of evidence into exposition and prepares extensive footnotes. She or he weaves together evidence and arguments to communicate a coherent, convincing picture to readers.

Data and Evidence in Historical context

Historical-comparative researchers draw on four types" historical evidence or data:

1. Primary sources;

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2. Secondary sources;
3. Running records; and
4. Recollections.

Traditional historians rely heavily on primary sources. H-C researchers often use secondary sources or the different data types in combination.

1. Primary Sources: The letters, diaries, newspapers, movies, novels, articles of clothing, photographs, and so forth are those who lived in the past and have survived to the present are the primary sources. They are found in archives (a place where documents are stored), in private collections, in family closets, or in museums. Today‟s documents and objects (our letters, television programs, commercials, clothing, and automobiles) will be primary sources for future historians. An example of a classic primary source is a bundle of yellowed letters written by a husband away at war to his wife and found in a family closet by a researcher.

Published and unpublished written documents are the most important type of primary source. Researchers find them in their original form or preserved in microfilm or on film. They are often the only surviving record of the words, thoughts, and feelings of people in the past. Written documents are helpful for studying societies and historical periods with writing and literate people. A frequent criticism of written sources is that elites or those in official organizations largely wrote them; thus the views of the illiterate, the poor, or those outside official social institutions may be overlooked.

The written word on paper was the main medium of communication prior to the widespread use of telecommunications, computers, and video technology to record events and ideas. In fact, the spread of forms of communication that do not leave a permanent physical record (e.g., telephone conversation), and which have largely replaced letters, written ledgers, and newspapers, make the work of future historians difficult.

***Potential Problems with Primary Sources*:** The key issue is that only a fraction of everything written or used in the past has survived into present. Moreover, whatever is survived is nonrandom sample of what once existed.

H-C researchers attempt to read primary sources with the eyes and assumptions of a contemporary who lived in the past. This means "bracketing," or holding back knowledge of subsequent events and modern values. "If you do not read the primary sources with an open mind and an intention to get inside the minds of the writings and look at things the way *they* saw them, you are wasting time." For example, when reading a source produced by a slaveholder, moralizing against slavery or faulting the author for not seeing its evil is not worthwhile. The H-C researcher holds back moral judgments and becomes a moral relativist while reading primary sources. He or she must think and believe like subjects under study, discover how they performed in their own eyes.

Another problem is that locating primary documents is a time consuming task. A researcher must search through specialized indexes and travel to archives or specialized libraries. Primary sources are often located in dusty, out-of-the-way room full of stacked cardboard boxes containing masses of fading documents. These may be incomplete, unorganized, and various stages of decay. Once the documents or other primary sources are located, the researcher evaluates them subjecting them to external and internal criticism.

External criticism means evaluating the authenticity of a document itself to be certain that it is not a fake or a forgery. Criticism involves asking: Was the document created when it is claimed to have been, in the place where it was supposed to be, and by the person who claims to be its author? Why was the document produced to begin with, and how did it survive? Once the document passes as being authentic, a researcher uses *internal criticism*, an examination of the document‟s contents to establish credibility. A researcher evaluates whether what is recorded was based on what the author directly witnessed or is secondhand information.

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Many types of distortions can appear in primary documents. One is *bowdlerization* – a deliberate distortion designed to protect moral standards or furnish a particular image. For example, photograph is taken of the front of a building. Trash and empty bottles are scattered all around the building, and the paint is faded. The photograph, however, is taken of the one part of the building that has little trash and is framed so that the trash does not show; dark room techniques make the faded paint look new.

2. Secondary Sources: Social researchers often use secondary sources, the books and articles written by specialist historians and other researchers, as an evidence of past conditions. It has its own limitations.

Potential Problems with Secondary Sources: The limitations of secondary historical evidence include problems of inaccurate historical accounts and lack of studies in areas of interest. Such sources cannot be used to test hypotheses. Post facto explanations cannot meet positivist criteria of falsifiability, because few statistical controls can be used and replication is not possible.

The many volumes of secondary sources present a maze of details and interpretations for an H-C researcher. He or she must transform the mass of specialized descriptive studies into an intelligible picture. This picture needs to be consistent with the reflective of the richness of the evidence. It also must bridge the many specific time periods and locals. The researcher faces potential problems with secondary sources.

One problem is reading the work of historians. Historians do not present theory-free, objective "facts." They implicitly frame raw data, categorize information, and shape evidence using concepts. The historian‟s concepts are a mixture drawn from journalism, language of historical actors, ideologies, Philosophy, everyday language in the present, and social science. Most lack a rigorous definition, are vague, are applied inconsistently, and are not mutually exclusive, nor exhaustive.

Second problem is that historian‟s selection procedure is not transparent. They select some information from all possible evidence. From the infinite oceans of facts historian selects those, which are significant for his purpose. Yet, the H-C researcher does not know how this was done. Without knowing the selection process, a historical-comparative researcher must rely on the historian‟s judgments, which can contain biases.

A third problem is in the organization of the evidence. Historians organize evidence as they write works of history. They often write *narrative history*. This compounds problems of undefined concepts and the selection of evidence. In the historical narrative, the writer organizes material chronologically around a single coherent "story." The logic is that of a sequence of unfolding action. Thus, each part of the story is connected to each other part by its place in the time order of events. Together all the parts form a unity or whole. Conjecture and contingency are the key elements of the narrative form. The contingency creates a logical interdependency between earlier and later elements.

With its temporal logic, the narrative organization differs from how the social researchers create explanations. It also differs from quantitative explanation in which the researcher identifies statistical patterns to infer causes. A major difficulty of the narrative is that the organizing tool – time order or position in a sequence of events – does not alone denote theoretical or historical causality. In other word, the narrative meets only one of the three criteria for establishing causality – that of temporal sequence.

Fourth and the last problem is that historiographic schools, personal beliefs, social theories influence a historian, as well as current events at the time research were conducted. Historians writing today examine primary material differently from how those writing in the 1920s did. In addition, there are various schools of historiography (diplomatic, Marxist) that have their own rules for seeking evidence and asking questions. It is also said history gets written by the people in power; it may include what the people in power want to be included.

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3. Running Records: Running records consist of files or existing statistical documents maintained by organizations. An example of a running record is keeping of vital statistics by the government departments in Pakistan; vital statistics relating to births, marriage, divorce, death, and other statistics of vital events. We also have so many documents containing running records relating to demographic statistics, and economic statistics being maintained by different agencies of UNO.

4. Recollections: The words or writing of individuals about their past lives or experiences based on memory are recollections. These can be in the form of memoirs, autobiographies, or interviews. Because memory is imperfect, recollections are often distorted in ways that primary sources are not.

In gathering *oral history*, a type of recollection, a researcher conducts unstructured interviews with people about their lives or events in the past. This approach is especially valuable for non-elite groups or the illiterate.

Evaluating the Documents

Historical-comparative researchers often use secondary sources or different data types in combination. For secondary sources they often use existing documents as well as the data collected by other organizations for research purposes. While looking into the authenticity of these document researchers often want answers to the questions like: Who composed the documents? Why were these written? What methods were used to acquire the information? What are some of the biases in the documents? How representative was the sample? What are the key categories and concepts used? What sorts of theoretical issues and debates do these documents cast light on?

Problems in Comparative Research

Problems in other types of research are magnified in a comparative study. In principle, there is no difference between comparative cross-cultural research and research conducted in a single society. The differences lie, rather, in the magnitude of certain types of problems.

The Units being compared:

For convenience, comparative researchers often use nation-state as their unit of analysis. The nation-state is the major unit used in thinking about the divisions of people across globe today. The nation-state is a socially and politically defined unit. In it, one government has sovereignty over populated territory. The nation-state is not the only unit for comparative research, but also frequently used as a surrogate for culture, which more difficult to define as a concrete, observable unit. The boundaries of nation-state may not match those of a culture. In some situations a single culture is divided into several nations (Muslim culture); in other cases, a nation-state contains more than one culture (Canada). The nation-state is not always the best unit for comparative research. A researcher should ask: What is the relevant comparative unit for my research question – the nation, the culture, a small region, or a subculture?

Problems of Equivalence: Equivalence is a critical issue in all research. It is the issue of making comparisons across divergent contexts, or whether a researcher, living in a specific time period and culture, correctly reads, understands, or conceptualizes data about people from different historical era or culture. Without equivalence, a researcher cannot use the same concepts or measures in different cultures or historical periods, and this makes comparison difficult, if not impossible. It is similar to the problems of validity in quantitative research. Look at the concept of a *friend.* We ask somebody how many friends do you have? People living in different countries may have different meanings attached to it. Even in Pakistan, we have variations in its meaning across the Provinces, and between rural and urban areas.

Ethical problems are less intense in H-C research than in other types of social research because a researcher is less likely to have direct contact with people being studied. Historical-comparative research shares the ethical concerns found in other non-reactive research techniques.

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Lesson 42

FOCUS GROUP DISCUSSION

A visitor to a locality stops by a house and inquires about the address of a resident he wants to see. May be he starts talking with a couple of persons asking for their help. In the meantime, some other passersby, or coming out of other houses join, showing their curiosity about the issue. They ask for some more information about the resident concerned, and then start discussing among them to come up with the exact identification of the resident. As an outcome of this discussion they would guide the visitor to reach the destination. This is quite a common feature in a folk society (village, neighborhood in a city) where we may start talking with a couple of persons and others come and join the conversation. This is an example of *informal* focus group discussion, which is built upon the social networks that operate in a natural setting. These social networks include both kinsfolk and other neighbors. In some cases the participants may be the local decision makers.

In research, focus group discussions (FGD) are a more formal way of getting groups of people to discuss selected issues. A focus group discussion is a group discussion of 6-12 persons guided by a facilitator, during which group members talk freely and spontaneously about a certain topic. There may be some disagreement about the exact number of participants in the discussion, as one comes across variations in numbers (6 to10, 6 to12, 6 to15, 8 to10, 5 to 7) in different books on research methods. The trend has been toward smaller groups due to some problems with the larger groups, which like:

- In a bigger group each participant‟s speaking time is substantially restricted. Dominant/submissive relationships are almost inevitable.
- Frustration or dissatisfaction among group members is likely to result because of some members‟ inability to get a turn to speak. This produces lower quality and quantity of data.
- Participants are often forced into long speeches, often containing irrelevant information, when they get to speak only infrequently.
- The tendency for side conversations between participants increases.

In contrast, smaller group sessions are felt to provide greater depth response for each participant. The group is often more cohesive and interactive, particularly when participants are professionals, such as physicians or pharmacists.

The key factor concerning group size is generally the of group purpose. If the purpose of the group is to generate as many ideas as possible, a larger group may be most useful. If the purpose of the group is to maximize the depth of expression from each participant, a smaller group works better.

The Purpose of FGD

The purpose of an FGD is to obtain in-depth information on concepts, perceptions, and ideas of the group. An FGD aims to be more than a question-answer interaction (Focus group interview is different). Here the idea is that group members discuss the topic among themselves.

Formal Focus Groups

Formal groups are formally constituted, that is these are organized in advance by inviting the selected individuals to participate in the discussion on a specific issue. They are structured groups brought together in which the participants are expected to have similar background, age, sex, education, religion, or similar experiences. Similarity in background is likely to make them comfortable where they could express their viewpoint frankly and freely. If the big boss and his junior officer working in an organization together participate in an FGD, the junior officer may not be able to express his or her opinion freely in the presence of his/her boss. Similarly, in some situations the children may experience some inhibitions in expressing their views on a sensitive issue in the presence of their parents. A lot depends on the kind of issue that is to be discussed.

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The group is guided by a moderator/facilitator. The participants address a specific issue (talk freely, agreement or disagreement among them) within a specified time in accordance with clearly spelled out rules of procedure.

Designing a Focus group Study

As with other approaches to studying social phenomena, designing a focus group study requires careful thought and reflection. Given that focus groups can be used for a variety of purposes within social research, the design of focus group study will depend on its purpose. At one extreme, FGD is used at the exploratory stage of the study (FGD may help in the identification of variables, formulation of questions and response categories) and at the other extreme, when qualitative information is needed on issues about which the researchers have substantial background knowledge and a reasonable grasp of the issues. Here we are focusing on the latter type of design.

How to conduct FGD?

The following guideline may be provided for conducting FGD.

1. Preparation:

- ***Selection of topic, questions to be discussed:*** It is appropriate to define and clarify the concepts to be discussed. The basic idea is to lay out a set of issues for the group to discuss. It is important to bear in mind that the moderator will mostly be improvising comments and questions within the framework set by the guidelines. By keeping the questions open-ended, the moderator can stimulate useful trains of thought in the participants that were not anticipated.

- ***Selecting the study participants:*** Given a clear idea of the issues to be discussed, the next critical step in designing a focus group study is to decide on the characteristics of the individuals who are to be targeted for sessions. It is often important to ensure that the groups all share some common characteristics in relation to the issue under investigation. If you need to obtain information on a topic from several different categories of informants who are likely to discuss the issue from different perspectives, you should organize a focus group for each major category. For example, a group for men and a group for women, or a group for older women and group for younger women. The selection of the participants can be on the basis of purposive or convenience sampling. The participants should receive the invitations at least one or two days before the exercise. The invitations should explain the general purpose of the FGD.

- ***Physical arrangements:*** Communication and interaction during the FGD should be encouraged in every way possible. Arrange the chairs in a circle. Make sure the area will be quite, adequately lighted, etc., and that there will be no disturbances. Try to hold the FGD in a neutral setting that encourages participants to freely express their views. A health center, for example, is not a good place to discuss traditional medical beliefs or preferences for other types of treatment. Neutral setting could also be from the perspective of a place where the participants feel comfortable to come over and above their party factions.

Conducting the session:

- One of the members of the research team should act as a “facilitator” or “moderator” for the focus group. One should serve as “recorder.”

- ***Functions of the Facilitator:*** The facilitator should not act as an expert on the topic. His or her role is to stimulate and support discussion. He should perform the following functions:

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- **Introduce the session**: He or she should introduce himself/herself as facilitator and introduce the recorder. Introduce the participants by name or ask them to introduce themselves (or develop some new interesting way of introduction). Put the participants at ease and explain the purpose of the FGD, the kind of information needed, and how the information will be used (e.g., for planning of a health program, an education program, etc.).

- **Encourage discussion:** The facilitator should be enthusiastic, lively, and humorous and show his/her interest in the group‟s ideas. Formulate questions and encourage as many participants as possible to express their views. Remember there is no "right" or "wrong" answers. Facilitator should react neutrally to both verbal and nonverbal responses.

- **Encourage involvement:** Avoid a question and answer session. Some useful techniques include: asking for clarification (can you tell me more?); reorienting the discussion when it goes off the track (saying: wait, how does this relate to the issue? Using one participant‟s remarks to direct a question to another); bringing in reluctant participants (Using person‟s name, requesting his/her opinion, making more frequent eye contact to encourage his participation); dealing with dominant participants (avoiding eye contact or turning slightly away to discourage the person from speaking, or thanking the person and changing the subject).

- **Avoid being placed in the role of expert:** When the facilitator is asked for his/her opinion by a respondent, remember that he or she is not there to educate of inform. Direct the question back to the group by saying: "What do you think?" "What would you do?" Set aside time, if necessary, after the session to give participants the information they have asked.
  Do not try to give comments on everything that is being said. Do not feel you have to say something during every pause in the discussion. Wait a little and see what happens.

- **Control the timing of the meeting but unobtrusively:** Listen carefully and move the discussion from topic to topic. Subtly control the time allocated to various topics so as to maintain interest. If the participants spontaneously jump from one topic to the other, let the discussion continue for a while because useful additional information may surface and then summarize the points brought up and reorient the discussion.

- **Take time at the end of the meeting to summarize, check for agreement and thank the participants:** Summarize the main issues brought up, check whether all agree and ask for additional comments. Thank the participants and let them know that their ideas had been valuable contribution and will be used for planning the proposed research/intervention/or whatever the purpose of FGD was. Listen to the additional comments made after the meeting. Sometime some valuable information surfaces, which otherwise may remain hidden.

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Lesson 43

FOCUS GROUP DISCUSSION (Contd.)

Functions of the Recorder

The recorder should keep a record of the content of the discussion as well as emotional reactions and important aspects of group interaction. Assessment of the emotional tone of the meeting and the group process will enable the researcher to judge the validity of the information collected during the FGD. Record the following:

- Date, time, and place:
- Names and characteristics of participants:
- General description of the group dynamics (level of participation, presence of a dominant participant, level of interest):
- Opinions of participants, recorded as much as possible in their own words, especially for key statements: and
- Vocabulary used, particularly in focus group discussions that are intended to assist in developing questionnaire or other material as stipulated under the topic.

It is highly recommended that a tape/video recorder (with permission) be used to assist capturing information. Even if a tape/video recorder is used, notes should be taken as well, in case the machine malfunctions and so that information will be available immediately after the session.

A supplementary role for the recorder could be to assist the facilitator (if necessary) by drawing his/her attention to:

- Missed comments from participants, and
- Missed topics (the recorder should have a copy of the discussion guide, key probe questions during the FGD).

If necessary, the recorder could also help resolve conflict situations that facilitator may have difficulty handling.

Number and duration of sessions: The number of **focus group sessions** to be conducted depends upon project needs, resources, and whether new information is still coming from the sessions (that is, whether contrasting views from various groups in the community are still emerging).

One should plan to conduct at least two different focus group discussions for each subgroup (for example two for males and two for females).

For **duration**, a focus group session typically lasts up to an hour and a half. Generally the first session with a particular type of group is longer than the following ones because all of the information is new. Thereafter, if it becomes clear that all the groups have the same opinion on particular topics, the facilitator may be able to move the discussion along more quickly to other topics that still elicit new points of view.

3. Analysis of Results

- After each focus group session, the facilitator and the recorder should meet to review and complete the notes taken during the meeting. This is also the right moment to evaluate how the focus group went and what changes might be made when facilitating future groups.

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- A full report of the discussion should be prepared that reflects the discussion as completely as possible using the participants‟ own words. List the key statements, ideas, and attitudes expressed for each topic of discussion.
- After the transcript of the discussion is prepared, code the statements right away, using the left margin? Write comments in the right margin. Formulate additional questions if certain issues are still unclear or controversial and include them in the next FGD.
- Further categorize the statements for each topic, if required. Compare answers of different subgroups (e.g., answers of young mothers and answers of mothers of above childbearing age in the FGD on changes in weaning practices).
  The findings must be recorded in coherent manner. For example, if young women in all focus group discussions state that they start weaning some 3-6 months earlier than their mothers did and the women above childbearing age confirm this statement, one is likely to have a solid finding. If findings contradict each other, one may need to conduct some more focus group discussions or bring together representatives from two different subgroups to discuss and clarify the differences.

- Summarize the data in a matrix, diagram, flowchart, or narrative, if appropriate, and interpret the findings.
- Select the most useful quotations that emerged from the discussions to illustrate the main ideas.

4. Report Writing

- Start with a description of the selection and composition of the groups of participants and a commentary on the group process, so the reader can assess the validity of the reported findings.
- Present the findings, following a list of topics and guided by the objective(s) of the FGD. Include quotations whenever possible, particularly for key statements.

Uses of Focus Group Discussions

- The primary advantage of focus groups is its ability to quickly and inexpensively grasp the core issues of the topic. One might see focus group discussions as *synergistic* i.e. the combined effort of the group will produce a wider range of information, insights, and ideas than will the accumulation of separately secured responses of a number of individuals. Even in non-exploratory research, focus group discussions produce a lot more information far more quickly, and at less cost than individual interviews.
- As part of exploratory research, focus group discussions help the researcher to focus on the issue and develop relevant research hypotheses. In the discussions the relevant variables are identified, and relationships are postulated. Once the variables are identified, the same focus group discussions help in the formulation of questions, along with the response categories, for the measurement of variables.
- Focus group discussion is an excellent design to get information from non-literates.
- Focus groups discussions are a good means to discover attitudes and opinions that might not be revealed through surveys. This is particularly useful when the researcher is looking at the controversial issue, and the individual might be able to give his opinion as such but not discuss the issue in the light of other viewpoints. In focus group discussions there is usually a *snowballing* effect. A comment by one often triggers a chain of views from other participants.
- Focus group discussions are well accepted in the folk communities, as this form of communication already exists whereby the local communities try to sort out controversial issues.
- Focus group discussions generate new ideas, questions about the issues under consideration. It may be called *serendipity (*surprise ideas). It is more often the case in a group than in an individual interview that some idea will drop out of the blue. The group also affords the opportunity to develop the idea to its full significance.

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- Focus group discussions can supplement the quantitative information on community knowledge, attitude, and practice (KAP), which may have already been collected through survey research.
- Focus group discussions are highly flexible with respect to topic, number of participants, time schedule, location, and logistics of discussion.
- Focus group discussions provide a direct link between the researcher and the population under study. In fact most of the focus group discussions are held close to people"s places of living and work. It helps in getting the realistic picture of the issue directly from the people who are part of it.
- For some researchers, focus group discussions may be a fun. They enjoy discussing the issues directly with the relevant population.

Limitations

- Results of the focus group discussions cannot usually be used for generalization beyond the population from where the participants in FGD came. One important reason being the lack of their representativeness about other populations.
- It is often seen that participants usually agree with the responses from fellow members (for different reasons). Without a sensitive and effective facilitator, a single, self-appointed participant may dominate the session. Researchers have to be cautious when interpreting the results.
- The moderator may influence focus group discussion and may bias the information.
- Focus group discussions may have limited value in exploring complex beliefs of individuals, which they may not share in open discussion.
- It is possible that focus group discussions may paint a picture of what is socially acceptable in the community rather than what is actually occurring or is believed. The picture may be given of what is ideally desirable and not what is really in practice. Participants may like to project a good image of their community to strangers; hence the information may be highly contaminated.

CASE STUDY

Case study is a comprehensive description and analysis of a single situation or a number of specific situations i.e. cases. It is an intensive description and analysis of a case. Researchers often use qualitative approach to explore the case in as rich a detail as possible. The examples could be a case study of a highly successful organization, a project (Orangi Pilot Project, Karachi), a group, a couple, a teacher, and a patient. In a way it is more like a clinical approach to study the case in detail.

If the researcher is looking at highly successful organization then he may have to look into all the factors that may have contributed to its success. The factors may relate to the availability of the financial resources, the management, the work environment, work force, the political atmosphere, and many more. All these factors may be considered as different dimensions for studying the organization. Similarly, one may do the case study of a happily married couple.

Data Sources

Usually the following sources are suggested:

- Naturalistic observations (ethnographic studies)
- Interviews
- Life histories
- Tests (Psychological, clinical)

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In most of the cases the data sources may depend upon the nature of the case under investigation. If we are trying to do the case study of a community, then one shall be looking for naturalistic observations (ethnographic information), in-depth interviews with individuals, life histories of the people, and anything, which may have previously been written about the community.

Preserve the unitary character of the object under study: The researcher tries to study the case as a whole by collecting the breadth of data about the totality of the unit. For the collection of such data a multidisciplinary approach may be used, which could help looking at the case from different perspectives prior to coming to some conclusions. Hence it is not a segmental study; therefore effort is made to study it as a whole and while making the analysis try to present it as a unit.

Case Control studies

It is also possible to select two groups (taking them as cases), one with an effect (study group) and the other without effect (control group). Both the cases are similar except for the effect. One could look at the case of Manga Mandi village, where, a few years back, deformities in the bones of children were observed in one part of the village. Here one could explore the totality of the background of affected and unaffected parts of the locality, each being treated as a unit. One could develop hypothesis by having an in-depth analysis of the affected and unaffected parts.

Case study is empirical

Case study is empirical because:

- It investigates a contemporary phenomenon within its real life context. It is retrospective study in which the researcher follows the research process from effect to its cause. It is a study back in time. Just like a medical practitioner who is treating his patient as a case, tries to diagnose his/her ailment by taking the case history, doing the physical examination, and if necessary, doing some laboratory tests. On the basis of the triangulation of all this information the medical doctor traces the cause of patient‟s present ailment. The information is empirical.
- When the boundaries between the phenomenon and context are not clearly evident, the researcher tries to use multiple sources of evidence. One could say that the researcher is trying to look at the case by using multiple dimensions, and trying to come up with a finding that is empirical.

Limitations

Despite the fact that the case study may be considered empirical yet it lack rigor in its approach. Therefore it has limitations with respect to the reliability of the findings. Also one could question whether the case is representative of some population.

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Lesson 44

REPORT WRITING

Although every report is custom-made for the project it represents, some conventions of report format are universal. These conventions have developed over a long period of time, and they represent a consensus about what parts are necessary to a good research report and how they should be ordered. The consensus is not an inviolable law, though. Each report writing book suggests its own unique format and every report writer has to pick and choose the parts and the order that work best for the project at hand. Many companies and universities also have an in-house, suggested report formats or writing guides that researchers should be aware of.

Report format is the general plan of organization for the parts of a written or oral research report. The researchers tailor the format to the project. The format of a research report may need adjustment for two reasons: (1) to obtain the proper level of formality and (2) to decrease the complexity of the report. We shall look at the most formal type i.e. a report for a large project done within an organization or one done by a research agency for a client company. This sort of report is usually bound with a permanent cover and may be hundreds of pages long.

Students who are writing a thesis shall have to follow the format requirements of the university where they shall be submitting it. Thesis format is little different, and it shall be explained as we proceed.

The Makeup of the Report – the Report Parts

- **Prefatory parts**
  1. Title fly page
  2. Title page
  3. Letter of transmittal
  4. Letter of authorization
  5. Table of contents
  6. Executive summary
- **Main body**
  1. Introduction
  2. Methodology
  3. Results
  4. Conclusions and recommendations
  5. References
- **Appended parts**
  1. Data collection forms (questionnaires, checklist, interview guide, other forms)
  2. Detailed calculations
  3. General tables
  4. Other support material
  5. Bibliography, if needed

Let us now look at each one of the parts of the report.

Prefatory Parts

Title Fly Page: Only the title appears on this page. For the most formal reports, a title fly page precedes the title page. Most of the reports don‟t have it. May be it is more like the dustcover of some books.

Title Page: The title page should include four items: the title of the report, the name(s) of the person(s) for whom the report was prepared, the name(s) of person(s) who prepared it, and the date of release or presentation.

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The title should be brief but include three elements: (1) the variables included in the study, (2) the type of relationship among the variables, and (3) the population to which the results may be applied. Redundancies such as "A report of," "A discussion of," and "A study of" add length to title but little else. Single-word titles are also of little value.

Addresses and titles of recipients and writers may also be included.

(For thesis follow the format as prescribed by the relevant university)

Letter of Transmittal: This element is included in relatively formal and very formal reports. Its purpose is to release or deliver the report to the recipient. It also serves to establish some rapport between the reader and the writer. This is one part of the formal report where a personal, or even a slightly informal, tone should be used. The transmittal letter should not dive into report findings except in the broadest terms. This letter may be like:

Virtual University Lahore

December 15, 2006

Mr. K. M. Khalil

Vice President for Marketing

…….

…….

Subject: Report on Employee Satisfaction and Organizational Commitment

Dear Mr. Khalil,

Here is a report on Employee Satisfaction and Organizational Commitment. The report was prepared according to your authorization letter of April 15, 2006.

……
……
……
……

We are grateful to you for your cooperation in this important study.

Sincerely,

……..

……..

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Letter of Authorization: This is a letter to the researcher approving the project, detailing who has responsibility for the project and indicating what resources are available to support it. The letter not only shows who sponsored the research but also delineates the original request.

Researcher would not write this letter. In many situations, referring to the letter of authorization in the letter of transmittal is sufficient. If so, the letter of authorization need not be included in the report. In case the letter has to be included, exact copy of the original may be reproduced.

Table of Contents: A table of contents is essential to any report. It should list the divisions and subdivisions of the report with page references. The table of contents is based on the final outline of the report, but it should include first-level subdivisions. For short reports it is sufficient to include only the main divisions. If the report includes many figures and tables, lists of these should immediately follow the table of contents. If lots of abbreviations have been used in the report, give a list of abbreviations, alphabetically arranged, after the list of figures/tables.

Executive Summary: It is vital part of the report. Studies have indicated that most managers always read a report‟s summary, whereas only a minority read the rest of the report. Thus the only chance a writer may have to make an impact be in summary.

An executive summary can serve two purposes. It may be a report in miniature – covering all the aspects in the body of the report, but in abbreviated form. Or it may be a concise summary of the major findings and conclusions, including recommendations. On the whole the summary briefly tells why the research project was conducted, what aspects of the problem were considered, what the outcome was, and what should be done.

The summary should be written only after the rest of the report is completed. It represents the essence of the report. Two to three pages are generally sufficient for a properly condensed summary. (For very big reports which run into number of volumes, like the one finds in the feasibility reports of big projects, the summary may be very big.) The summary should be written to be self-sufficient. In fact, it is not uncommon for a summary to be detached from the report and circulated on its own.

The summary contains four elements:

1. The objectives of the report are stated, including the most important background and specific purposes of the project.
2. The major results are presented. The key results regarding each purpose should be included.
3. The conclusions that are based on the results. There should be logical interpretation of the results which could lead to the stated conclusions.
4. The recommendations or suggestions for action, which are based on the conclusions. The recommendations must logically emerge from the results.

In many cases managers prefer not to have recommendations included in the report or summary. The consultant may have to go by the demand of the client.

Note: In many reports you may see that the executive summary comes first which is followed by the table of contents.

For students writing their thesis, in place of executive summary, they write an abstract of their thesis. This abstract is usually of one or two paragraphs. Abstract has information on the topic, the research problem, the basic findings, and any „unusual‟ research design or data collection features.

Main Body

The main body constitutes the bulk of the report. It includes: Introduction, Methodology, Results, Conclusions, and Recommendations of the study.

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Introduction: The introduction prepares the reader for the report by describing the parts of the project: background material, the problem statement, and research objectives of the study. In most projects, introduction can be taken from the research proposal submitted earlier by the consultant. The proposal itself was based on the terms of reference (TOR) supplied by the client.

Background could help in looking at the magnitude of the problem. It may include the results of exploration from an experience survey, focus group discussion, and secondary data from literature review. The background includes definitions, qualifications and assumptions. It gives the reader the information needed to understand the remainder of research report.

Problem statement contains the need for the research project. The problem is usually represented by the research question raised by the client. It explains why the project was worth doing.

Research objectives address the purpose of the project. These objectives may be research questions and associated investigative questions. In correlational or causal studies, the hypothesis statement may be included. At the end of the study the researcher may see the extent to which these objectives have been addressed.

For Thesis: After introduction, for **s**tudents writing their thesis, it is recommended that they should have three separate chapters on review of literature, theoretical framework, and hypothesis or research question along with the operationalization of variables. These chapters may be in line with the steps in research that we discussed as part of the research process.

Methodology: Technical procedures for carrying out the study must be explained in a manner appropriate for the reader. It may be useful to supplement the material in this section with more detailed explanation in the appendix. This part of the report should address seven topics:

1. *Research design:* Was the study exploratory, descriptive, or causal? A specific strategy was used to conduct this study. Why was this particular design suited to the study?
2. *Data collection methods:* Did the data come from primary sources or secondary sources? How the primary data were collected – survey, experiment, observation? It is possible that multiple techniques may have been used – all these have to be explained.
3. *Sample design:* What was the target population? What sampling frame was used? What type of sampling was used? What was the selection procedure used?
4. *Instrument(s) of data collection:* What instrument(s) of data collection was (were) used? Why a particular instrument was selected? Include a copy of each instrument in the appendix.
5. *Fieldwork/data collection:* How many and what type of fieldworkers were used? What training and supervision did they receive? How was the quality control assured?
6. *Analysis:* How was the analysis carried out? How was the data reduction handled? Tell about the scoring scheme used. Outline the statistical methods applied for the analysis of the data.
7. *Limitations:* No report is perfect, so it is important to indicate the report‟s limitations. If there were problems with non-response error or sampling procedures, they should be discussed. The discussion of limitations should avoid overemphasizing the weaknesses. Its aim should be to provide a realistic basis for assessing the results.

Results: The presentation of results will occupy the bulk of the report. This section presents in some logical order those findings of the project that bear on the objectives. The results should be organized as a continuous narrative, designed to be convincing but not oversell the project. Summary tables and charts should be used to aid the discussion. Tables and charts may serve as points of reference to the data being discussed and free the prose from an excess of facts and figures. Comprehensive or detailed charts should be reserved for the appendix.

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Conclusions and recommendations: The last part of the body of the report presents the conclusions and recommendations based on results. Findings state facts; conclusions represent inferences drawn from findings. A writer is sometimes reluctant to make conclusions and leaves the task to the reader. Avoid this temptation when possible. As the researcher, you are the one best informed on the factors that critically influence the findings and conclusions.

Recommendations emerge out of conclusions. These are actually suggestions for action in an applied research. The researcher may present several alternatives with justification. In academic research, the recommendations are often further study suggestions that broaden or test understanding of the subject area.

The conclusions and recommendations are presented here in more detail than in the executive summary, with whatever justification is needed.

References: All citations used in the study must be given by arranging them alphabetically by the last name of the author.

For your thesis

For your thesis the following outline of chapters is suggested:

- Introduction
- Review of Literature
- Theoretical Framework
- Hypothesis and Operationalization of Concepts
- Research Design
- Analysis of Data
- Summary, Conclusions, and Recommendations
- References
- Appendixes

Appended Parts

Appendix: The appendix presents the "too …" material. Any material that is too technical or too detailed to go to the body should appear in appendix. This includes materials of interest only to some readers, or subsidiary materials not directly related to the objectives. Some examples of appendix material are data collection forms (instruments), detailed calculations, discussions of highly technical questions, detailed or comprehensive tables of results, and a bibliography (if appropriate).

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Lesson 45

REFERENCING

There is a general mix up or referencing with bibliography; though the purposes are different. A **bibliography** is the listing of the works that are relevant to the topic of research interest arranged in alphabetical order of the last names of authors. A **reference** list is a subset of the bibliography, which includes details of all the citations used in literature survey and elsewhere in the report, arranged again, in the alphabetical order of the last names of authors. These citations have the goals of crediting the author and enabling the reader to find the works cited.

Giving references in the report or thesis is a must, whereas the bibliography is additional information and is certainly optional. There should be no mixing up of the meanings.

There are different modes of referencing being followed by different disciplines. Find out what mode is followed in your discipline. For example, psychologists follow the publication manual of American Psychological Association (APA), and sociologists follow guidelines given in the manual of American Sociological Association. Similarly other subjects follow their professional associations. Each of these manuals specifies, with examples, how books, journals, newspapers, dissertations, and other materials are to be referenced in manuscripts. Whichever the style you pick up, follow it consistently. Since APA format is followed for referencing in many journals in management area, we shall present that here as a specimen. All the citations mentioned in the research report should find a place in the References section at the end of the report.

Specimen Format for citing different Types of References

Book by a single author

Leshin, C. B. (1997). *Management on the World Wide Web*. Englewood Cliffs, NJ: Prentice- Hall.

Start with the last name, put a comma and then initials with full stop. It is followed by the year of publication in parentheses with a full stop. Then we have the title of the publication; all in small words (unless there is some name which has to be with capital letter as it is in this title) and in italics. Give full stop at the end. It is followed by place of publication with a colon at the end. After the colon give the name of the publisher. Second line of the reference should be indented by giving five spaces.

Give two spaces for separating the references.

Book by more than one author

Cornett, M., Wiley, B. J., & Sankar, S. (1998). *The pleasures of nurturing.* London: McMunster Publishing.

It is the same as the previous one except there is the use & separating the last author from its preceding one. See it is not written „and" but being used as symbol„&."

Edited book

It is a book of readings or called Reader, which contains sections/articles written by a number of authors. These articles may have been published earlier in different journals/books or these may have been specially written for this book. Such a book has an editor or editors who collected these articles, edited them and published.

Pennathur, A., Leong, F. T., & Schuster, K. (Eds.) (1998). *Style and substance of thinking*. New York: Wilson Press.

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Here after the names of the editors, the word editors is abbreviated as "Eds." And put in parentheses. Other instructions remain the same.

Chapter in an edited book

This is an article written by single or multiple authors and is printed in the edited book.

Riley, T., & Brecht, M. L. (1998). The success in mentoring process. In R. Williams (Ed.) *Mentoring and career success.* pp. 129-150. New York: Wilson Press.

We start with the name(s) of the author(s); same instructions. Then the title of the article published in this edited book. The title is in small letters except the letter of the first word. It is not to be put in italics or in bold. Give full stop at the end of the title. Then we tell about the book and its editor in which it was published. Here the editor"s name does not start with the last name, but is kept straight as initials and then the last name. It is followed by the title of the book which is in italics. After the title we specify the pages of the book on which this article appeared. Rest is the same i.e. place of publication and the publisher.

Journal Article

Jean quart, S., & Peluchette, J. (1997). Diversity in the workforce and management models. *Journal of Social Work Studies*, 43 (3), 72-85.

The title of the article is in small letters. The name of the journal is in italics. Such professional journals are well known in the academic community, therefore, the place of publication and the publisher is not given. Instead, its volume and number in the volume is given. All the issues published in one year are one volume. There could be number of issues in a volume. Both the volumes and issues are numbered. In this example 43 is the volume and 3 given in the parentheses is the number in this volume. It is followed by the pages on which this article was published.

Conference Proceedings publications

Gardezi, H. N. (2005). Population policy of Pakistan. In Z. Sathar (Ed.), *Proceedings of the Third Conference on Research and Population,* (pp. 100-107). Islamabad: Population Council.

Doctoral Dissertation

Chaudhary, M.A. (2004). *Medical advances and quality of life.* Unpublished doctoral Dissertation, Virtual University

Paper presented at conference

Qureshi, Q. A. (2005, May 16). *Practical tips for efficient management*. Paper presented at the annual meeting Entrepreneurs, Lahore.

It is possible that the proceeding of a conference have not been published. The researcher got hold of paper that was presented at the conference and wanted to do it citation. Here along with the year of the conference, the date is also given. Title of the paper is in italics. Then give some information about owners of the conference, followed by place where the conference was held.

Unpublished Manuscript

Kashoor, M. A. (2005). *Training and development in the '90s.* Unpublished manuscript, Virtual University.

Newspaper Article

The GM Pact. (2005, May 16). *The Dawn*, p. 4.

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Referencing Electronic Sources

Ahmad, B. (2005). Technology and immediacy of information. [On line] Available http://www.bnet.act.com

Just giving the site on the internet is not sufficient. It is necessary that the name of the author and title of the writing should be given. Internet site is actually in place of the publisher and the place of publication.

Referencing and quotation in Literature review

Cite all references in the body of the report using the author-year method of citation; that is, the last name of the author(s) and the year of publication are given at the appropriate places. Examples of this are as follows:

a. Rashid (2005) has shown …

b. In recent studies of dual earner families (Khalid, 2004; Hameed, 2005) it has been ….

c. In 2004, Maryam compared dual earner and dual career families and found that ….

As can be seen from the above, if the name of the author appears as part of the narrative as in the case of (a), the year of publication alone has to be cited in parentheses. Note that in case (b), both the author and the year are cited in parentheses, separated by comma. If the year and the author are part of the textual discussion as in (c) above, the use of parentheses is not warranted.

Note also the following:

1. Within the same paragraph, you need not include the year after the first citation so long as the study cannot be confused with other studies cited in the article. An example of this is: Gutek (1985) published her findings in the book titled *Sex and the Workplace*. Gutek indicated …
2. When the work is authored by two individuals, always cite both names every time the reference occurs in the text.
3. When a work has more than two authors but fewer than six authors, cite all authors the first time the reference occurs, and subsequently include only the last name of the first author followed by "et al." as per example below:
   Sekaran, U., Martin, T., Trafton, N., and Osborn R. N. (1980) found … (first citation)

   Sekaran et al. (1980) found … (subsequent citations)

4. When a work is authored by six or more individuals cite only the last name of the first author followed by „et al." and the year for the first and subsequent citations. Join the names in a multiple-author citation in running text by the word "and." In parenthetical material, in tables, and in reference list, join the names by an ampersand (&). Examples are given below:
   a. As tucker and Snell (1989) pointed out …

   b. As has been pointed out (Tucker & Snell, 1989) …

5. When a work has no author, cite in the text the first two or three words of the article title. Use double quotation marks around the title of the article. For example, while referring to the newspaper article, the text might be read as: While examining unions ("with GM pact," 1990).
6. When a work"s author is designated as "Anonymous," cite in the text, the word *Anonymous* followed by a comma and the date: (Anonymous, 1979). In the reference list, an anonymous work is alphabetized by the word *Anonymous.*
7. When the same author has several works published in the same year, cite them in the same order as they occur in the reference list, with the in-press citations coming last. For example:

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Research on the mental health of dual-career family members (Sekaran, 1985a, 1985b, 1985c, 1999, in press) indicates …

8. When more than one author has to be cited in the text, these should be in alphabetical order of the first author‟s last name, and the citations should be separated by semicolons as per illustration: In the job design literature (Aldag & Brief, 1976; Alderfer, 1972; Beatty, 1982; Jeanquart, 1998) …

Personal communication through letters, memos, telephone conversations, and the like, should be cited in the text only and not included in the reference list since these are not retrievable data. In the text, provide the initials as well as the last name of the communicator together with date, as in the following example:

R. Qureshi (personal communication, November 15, 2006) feels …

Quotations in Text

Quotations should be given exactly as they appear in the source. The original wording, punctuation, spellings, and italics must be preserved even if they are erroneous. The citation of the source of direct quotation should always include the page number(s) as well as the reference.

Use double quotation marks for quotations in the text. Use single quotation marks to identify the material that was enclosed in double quotation marks in the original source. If you want to emphasize certain words in the quotation, underline them and immediately after the underlined words, insert within brackets the words: *italics added.* Use three ellipsis points (…) to indicate that you have omitted material from the original source.

If the quotation is more than 40 words, set in a free-standing style starting on a new line and indenting the left margin a further five spaces. Type the entire quotation double spaced on the new margin, indenting the first line of paragraphs from the new margin.

If you intend publishing an article in which you have quoted extensively from a copyright work, it is important that you seek written permission from the owner of the copyright. Make sure that you also footnote the permission obtained with respect to the quoted material. Failure to do so may result in unpleasant consequences, including legal action taken through copyright protection laws.

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Lesson 46

QUALITATIVE TECHNIQUES

Common sense and research both involve an attempt to understand various aspects of the world. However, research, but arguably not common sense, involves an explicit, systematic approach to finding things out, often through a process of testing out preconceptions. This process begins with deciding on a research question. It is then necessary to conduct a literature review and to decide on a research design which addresses the research question. Decisions made at this point include considering what kind of data will be collected, how they will be collected, who will be invited to participate and how the data will be analyzed.

Researchers working in the social sciences: psychology, sociology, anthropology etc., interested in studying human behavior and the social world inhabited by human beings, found increasing difficulty in trying to explain human behavior in quantifiable, measurable terms. Measurements tell us how often or how many people behave in a certain way, so if a research question involves exploring how much or how often something happens, it‟s probably appropriate to use quantitative methods. Qualitative research attempts to broaden and/or deepen our understanding of how things came to be the way they are in our social world. If the research question involves exploring how people experience something, or what their views are, exploring a new area where issues are not yet understood or properly identified (e.g. before developing questionnaire items), assessing whether a new service is implementable, looking at „real-life‟ context, your team probably needs to discuss using qualitative methodology.

So, qualitative research is a form of social inquiry that focuses on the way people interpret and make sense of the experiences and the world in which they live. This kind of research has an aim to understand the social reality of individual, group and cultures. Researchers use qualitative research to explore the behavior, experiences, perspectives and feeling of people and what lies at the core of their lives. The basis of qualitative research lies in the interpretive approach of social reality and in the description of lived experience of human beings.

Qualitative researchers contend that it is virtually impossible to understand why someone did something or why something happened in an organization without talking to people about it. Imagine if a police tried to solve a serious crime without being able to talk to the suspects or witnesses. If the police were restricted to using only quantitative data, almost no crimes would be solved. Image if lawyers and judges were not allowed to question or cross-examine witnesses in court, the validity and reliability of any court decision would be thrown into serious doubt. So, likewise, qualitative researchers argue that if you want to understand people`s motivations, their reasons, their actions, and the context for their beliefs and actions in an in-depth way, qualitative research is best.

Comparison of Qualitative and Quantitative Research:

The goal of qualitative research is to gain an in depth understanding and explanation of some particular social phenomenon typically done by attempting to understand the lived experiences of the participants and how they construct meaning and make sense of their experiences. Frequently, the data collection is done by interviewing; however, an understanding of the social phenomenon and personal lived experiences of individuals might be gained via non-intrusive qualitative approaches in which the researcher might use texts, journals, written narratives, observations, or other unobtrusive measures to examine the traces of humans and how they were affected by some ideological, social, psychological, legal, political, and/or technological factors. Qualitative research seeks to answer questions that focus on the meaning, essence, and interpretation of social phenomena with as little disruption to the natural setting as possible. Frequently central qualitative research questions begin with "How?" and/or "Why?" questions, but can begin with a "What?" question as well.

Quantitative research, on the other hand, explores descriptive analysis of characteristics through variables or answers questions about the relationships among variables (values assigned to

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characteristics or factors) with the purpose of measuring, explaining, predicting, confirming, validating, testing, or controlling phenomena.

Quantitative research studies generally end with a summation of the verification process, which is a confirmation or disconfirmation of the hypotheses tested via deductive reasoning. Conclusively, the aim of qualitative research is discovery, while the aim of quantitative research is verification.

Qualitative Research Methods:

All qualitative researchers need to decide how they are going to investigate the social world. How are you going to answer your research questions? For example, do you need to study organization in public sector, consumers, or managers? Do you want to study one case or many?

Although there are various definitions in the literature but simple a research method can be defined as a strategy of enquiry. A research method is a way of finding empirical data about the world. Each research method builds on a set of underlying philosophical assumptions and the choice of research method influences the way in which the researcher collect the data. Specific research methods also imply different skills and research practices.

Five qualitative research methods are discussed in this subject as discussed by John W. Creswell in his book. Following are the five qualitative research methods:

1. Narrative Research.
2. Phenomenology.
3. Grounded Theory.
4. Ethnography.
5. Case Study.

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Lesson 47

NARRATIVE RESEARCH

Narrative research has many forms, uses a variety of analytic practices, and is rooted in different social and humanities disciplines. "Narrative" might be the term assigned to any text or discourse, or, it might be text used within the context of a mode of inquiry in qualitative research, with a specific focus on the stories told by individuals. Narrative can be both a method and the phenomenon of study. As a method, it begins with the experiences as expressed in lived and told stories of individuals. Writers have provided ways for analyzing and understanding the stories lived and told. It can also be defined as a specific type of qualitative design in which "narrative is understood as a spoken or written text giving an account of an event/action or series of events/actions, chronologically connected". The procedures for implementing this research consist of focusing on studying one or two individuals, gathering data through the collection of their stories, reporting individual experiences, and chronologically ordering (or using life course stages) the meaning of those experiences.

Although narrative research originated from literature, history, anthropology, sociology, sociolinguistics, and education, different fields of study have adopted their own approaches.

Types of narrative study.

1. A biographical study is a form of narrative study in which the researcher writes and records the experiences of another person's life.

2. Autobiography is written and recorded by the individuals who are the subject of the study.

3. A life history portrays an individual's entire life, while a personal experience story is a narrative study of an individual's personal experience found in single or multiple episodes, private situations, or communal folklore.

4. An oral history consists of gathering personal reflections of events and their causes and effects from one individual or several individuals.

Narrative studies may have a specific contextual focus, such as teachers or children in classrooms or the stories told about organizations. Narratives may be guided by a theoretical lens or perspective. It may be a feminist lens used to report the stories of women, a lens that shows how women's voices are muted, multiple, and contradictory.

Procedures for Conducting Narrative Research

As a general procedural guide, the methods of conducting a narrative study do not follow a lock-step approach, but instead represent an informal collection of topics.

1. Determine if the research problem or question best fits narrative research. Narrative research is best for capturing the detailed stories or life experiences of a single life or the lives of a small number of individuals.

2. Select one or more individuals who have stories or life experiences to tell, and spend considerable time with them gathering their stories through multiples types of information. Stories are referred as "field texts." Research participants may record their stories in a journal or diary, or the researcher might observe the individuals and record field notes. Researchers may also collect letters sent by the individuals; assemble

3. Collect information about the context of these stories. Narrative researchers situate individual stories within participants' personal experiences (their jobs, their homes), their culture (racial or ethnic), and their historical contexts (time and place).

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4. Analyze the participants' stories, and then "restore' them into a framework that makes sense. Restoring is the process of reorganizing the stories into some general type of framework. This framework may consist of gathering stories, analyzing them for key elements of the story (e.g., time, place, plot, and scene), and then rewriting the stories to place them within a chronological sequence.

5. Collaborate with participants by actively involving them in the research. As researchers collect stories, they negotiate relationships, smooth transitions, and provide ways to be useful to the participants. In

Narrative research, a key theme has been the turn toward the relationship between the researcher and the researched in which both parties will learn and change in the encounter. In this process, the parties negotiate the meaning of the stories, adding a validation check to the analysis. "Narrative inquiry is stories lived and told," said Clandinin and Connolly (2000, p. 20).

Challenges

Given these procedures and the characteristics of narrative research, narrative research is a challenging approach to use. The researcher needs to collect extensive information about the participant, and needs to have a clear understanding of the context of the individual's life. It takes a keen eye to identify in the source material gathered the particular stories that capture the individual's experiences. As Edel (1984) comments, it is important to uncover the "figure under the carpet" that explains the multilayered context of a life. Active collaboration with the participant is necessary, and researchers need to discuss the participant's stories as well as be reflective about their own personal and political background, which shapes how they "restore" the account. Multiple issues arise in the collecting, analyzing, and telling of individual stories. Pinnegar and Daynes (2006) raise these important questions: Who owns the story? Who can tell it? Who can change it? Whose version is convincing? What happens when narratives compete? As a community, what do stories do among us?

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Lesson 48

PHENOMENOLOGY

Whereas a narrative study reports the life of a single individual, a phenomenological study describes the meaning for several individuals of their lived experiences of a concept or a phenomenon. Phenomenologists focus on describing what all participants have in common as they experience a phenomenon (e.g., grief is universally experienced). The basic purpose of phenomenology is to reduce individual experiences with a phenomenon to a description of the universal essence.

This human experience may be phenomena such as insomnia, being left out, anger, grief, or undergoing coronary artery bypass surgery. The inquirer then collects data from persons who have experienced the phenomenon, and develops a composite description of the essence of the experience for all of the individuals. This description consists of "what" they experienced and "how" they experienced it.

Types of Phenomenology

Two approaches to phenomenology are highlighted in this discussion: hermeneutic phenomenology and empirical, transcendental, or psychological phenomenology.

Hermeneutical phenomenology describes research as oriented toward lived experience (phenomenology) and interpreting the "texts" of life (hermeneutics) as available in blogs and tweets etc.

Transcendental or psychological phenomenology is focused less on the interpretations of the researcher and more on a description of the experiences of participants. In addition, it uses a concept of bracketing, in which investigators set aside their experiences, as much as possible, to take a fresh perspective toward the phenomenon under examination. Hence, "transcendental" means "in which everything is perceived freshly, as if for the first time.

The procedures consist of identifying a phenomenon to study, bracketing out one's experiences, and collecting data from several persons who have experienced the phenomenon. The researcher then analyzes the data by reducing the information to significant statements or quotes and combines the statements into themes. Following that, the researcher develops a textural description of the experiences of the persons (what participants experienced), a structural description of their experiences (how they experienced it in terms of the conditions, situations, or context), and a combination of the textural and structural descriptions to convey an overall essence of the experience.

Procedures for Conducting Phenomenological Research

Moustakas's (1994) approach has systematic steps in the data analysis procedure and guidelines for assembling the textual and structural descriptions. The major procedural steps in the process would be as follows:

- The researcher determines if the research problem is best examined using a phenomenological approach. The type of problem best suited for this form of research is one in which it is important to understand several individuals' common or shared experiences of a phenomenon. It would be important to understand these common experiences in order to develop practices or policies, or to develop a deeper understanding about the features of the phenomenon.

- A phenomenon of interest to study, such as anger, professionalism, what it means to be underweight, or what it means to be a wrestler, is identified.

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• Data are collected from the individuals who have experienced the phenomenon. Often data collection in

Phenomenological studies consist of in-depth interviews and multiple interviews with participants. Polkinghorne (1989) recommends that researchers interview from 5 to 25 individuals who have all experienced the phenomenon. Other forms of data may also be collected, such as observations, journals, art, poetry, music, taped conversations, formally written responses, accounts of vicarious experiences of drama, films, poetry, novels and other forms of art.

• The participants are asked two broad, general questions: What have you experienced in terms of the phenomenon? What contexts or situations have typically influenced or affected your experiences of the phenomenon? Other open-ended questions may also be asked.

• Phenomenological data analysis steps are generally similar for all psychological phenomenologists. Building on the data from the first and second research questions, data analysts go through the data (e.g., interview transcriptions) and highlight "significant statements," sentences, or quotes that provide an understanding of how the participants experienced the phenomenon. Moustakas (1994) calls this step horizonalization. Next, the researcher develops clusters of meaning from these significant statements into themes.

• The significant statements and themes are used to write a description of what the participants experienced (textural description). They are also used to write a description of the context or setting that influenced how the participants experienced the phenomenon, called imaginative variation or structural description. Researchers also write about their own experiences and the context and situations that have influenced their experiences.

• From the structural and textural descriptions, the researcher then writes a composite description that presents the "essence" of the phenomenon, called the essential, invariant structure (or essence). Primarily this passage focuses on the common experiences of the participants

Challenges

Phenomenology requires at least some understanding of the broader philosophical assumptions, and these should be identified by the researcher. The participants in the study need to be carefully chosen to be individuals who have all experienced the phenomenon in question, so that the researcher, in the end, can forge a common understanding. Bracketing personal experiences may be difficult for the researcher to implement. An interpretive approach to phenomenology would signal this as impossibility for the researcher to become separated from the text. Thus, the researcher needs to decide how and in what way his or her personal understandings will be introduced into the study.

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Lesson 49

GROUNDED THEORY

Although a phenomenology emphasizes the meaning of an experience for a number of individuals, the intent of a grounded theory study is to move beyond description and to generate or discover a theory, an abstract analytical schema of a process (or action or interaction, Strauss & Corbin, 1998). Participants in the study would all have experienced the process, and the development of the theory might help explain practice or provide a framework for further research. A key idea is that this theory-development does not come "off the shelf," but rather is generated or "grounded" in data from participants who have experienced the process (Strauss & Corbin, 1998). Thus, grounded theory is a qualitative research design in which the inquirer generates a general explanation (a theory) of a process, action, or interaction shaped by the views of a large number of participants (Strauss & Corbin, 1998).

This qualitative design was developed in sociology in 1967 by two researchers, Barney Glaser and Anselm Strauss, who felt that theories used in research were often inappropriate and ill-suited for participants under Study. They elaborated on their ideas through several books. In contrast to the a priori, theoretical orientations in sociology, grounded theorists held that theories should be "grounded" in data which will be taken from the field, especially in the actions, interactions, and social processes of people. Thus, grounded theory provided for the generation of a theory (complete with a diagram and hypotheses) of actions, interactions, or processes through interrelating categories of information based on data collected from individuals.

Types of Grounded Theory Studies

The two popular approaches to grounded theory are the systematic procedures of Strauss and Corbin (1990, 1998) and the constructivist approach of Charmaz (2005, 2006). In the more systematic, the investigator

seeks to systematically develop a theory that explains process, action, or interaction on a topic. The researcher typically conducts 20 to 30 interviews based on several visits "to the field" to collect interview data to saturate the categories (or find information that continues to add to them until no more can be found). A category represents a unit of information composed of events, happenings, and instances (Strauss & Corbin, 1990).

The researcher begins with open coding, coding the data for its major categories of information. From this

coding, axial coding emerges in which the researcher identifies one open coding category to focus on (called the "core" phenomenon), and then goes back to the data and create categories around this core phenomenon. Strauss and Corbin (1990) prescribe the types of categories identified around the core phenomenon. They consist of causal conditions (what factors caused the core phenomenon), strategies (actions taken in response to the core phenomenon), contextual and intervening conditions (broad and specific situational factors that influence the strategies), and consequences (outcomes from using the strategies).

These categories relate to and surround the core phenomenon in a visual model called the axial coding paradigm. The final step, then, is selective coding, in which the researcher takes the model and develops propositions (or hypotheses) that interrelate the categories in the model or assembles a story that describes the interrelationship of categories in the model. This theory, developed by the researcher, is articulated toward the end of a study and can assume several forms, such as a narrative statement, a visual picture, or a series of hypotheses or propositions.

In the discussion of grounded theory, Strauss and Corbin (1998) take the model one step further to develop a conditional matrix. They advance the conditional matrix as a coding device to help the

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researcher make connections between the macro and the micro conditions influencing the phenomenon. This matrix is a set of expanding concentric circles with labels that build outward from the individual, group, and organization to the community, region, nation, and global world. In my experience, this matrix is seldom used in grounded theory research

Procedures for Conducting Grounded Theory Research

Strauss and Corbin (1990, 1998) approach to illustrate grounded theory procedures are illustrated here because their systematic approach is helpful to individuals learning about and applying grounded theory research.

• The researcher needs to begin by determining if grounded theory is best suited to study his or her research problem. Grounded theory is a good design to use when a theory is not available to explain a process. The literature may have models available, but they were developed and tested on samples and populations other than those of interest to the qualitative researcher. Also, theories may be present, but they are incomplete because they do not address potentially valuable variables of interest to the researcher.

• The research questions that the inquirer asks of participants will focus on understanding how• individuals experience the process and identifying the steps in the process (What was the process? How did it unfold?). After initially exploring these issues, the researcher then returns to the participants and asks more detailed questions that help to shape the axial coding phase, questions such as: What was central to the process? (The core phenomenon); what influenced or caused this phenomenon to occur? (Causal conditions); what

strategies were employed during the process? (Strategies); what effect occurred? (Consequences).

• These questions are typically asked in interviews, although other forms of data may also be collected, such as observations, documents, and audiovisual materials. The point is to gather enough information to fully develop (or saturate) the model. This may involve 20 to 30 interviews or 50 to 60 interviews.

• The analysis of the data proceeds in stages. In open coding, the researcher forms categories of information about the phenomenon being studied by segmenting information. Within each category, the investigator finds several properties, or subcategories, and looks for data to dimensionalize, or show the extreme possibilities on a continuum of, the property.

• In axial coding, the investigator assembles the data in new ways after open coding. This is presented using a coding paradigm or logic diagram (i.e., a visual model) in which the researcher identifies a central phenomenon (i.e., a central category about the phenomenon), explores causal conditions (i.e., categories of conditions that influence the phenomenon), specifies strategies (i.e., the actions or interactions that result from the central phenomenon), identifies the 'context and intervening conditions (i.e., the narrow and broad conditions that influence the strategies), and delineates the consequences (i.e., the outcomes of the strategies) for this phenomenon. • In selective coding, the researcher may write a ~'story line" that connects the categories. Alternatively, propositions or hypotheses may be specified that state predicted relationships.

• Finally, the researcher may develop and visually portray a conditional matrix that elucidates the social, historical, and economic conditions influencing the central phenomenon. It is an optional step and one in which the qualitative inquirer thinks about the model from the smallest to the broadest perspective.

• The result of this process of data collection and analysis is a theory, a substantive-level theory, written by a researcher close to a specific problem or population of people. The theory emerges with help from the process of memoing, a process in which the researcher writes down ideas about the evolving theory throughout the process of open, axial, and selective coding.

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Challenges:

A grounded theory study challenges researchers for the following reasons. The investigator needs to set aside, as much as possible, theoretical ideas or notions so that the analytic, substantive theory can emerge. Despite the evolving, inductive nature of this form of qualitative inquiry, the researcher must recognize that this is a systematic approach to research with specific steps in data analysis, if approached from the Strauss and Corbin (1990) perspective. The researcher faces the difficulty of determining when categories are saturated or when the theory is sufficiently detailed. One strategy that might be used to move toward saturation is to use discriminant sampling, in which the researchers gathered additional information from individuals similar to those people initially interviewed to determine if the theory holds true for these additional participants. The researcher needs to recognize that the primary outcome of this study is a theory with specific components: a central phenomenon, causal conditions, strategies, conditions and context, and consequences.

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Lesson 50

ETHNOGRAPHIC RESEARCH

Although a grounded theory researcher develops a theory from examining many individuals who share in the same process, action, or interaction, the study participants are not likely to be located in the same place or interacting on so frequent a basis that they develop shared patterns of behavior, beliefs, and language. An ethnographer is interested in examining these shared patterns, and the unit of analysis is larger than the 20 or so individuals involved in a grounded theory study.

Ethnography focuses on an entire cultural group. Granted, sometimes this cultural group may be small (a few teachers, a few social workers), but typically it is large, involving many people who interact over time (teachers in an entire school, a community social work group). Ethnography is a qualitative design in which the researcher describes and interprets the shared and learned patterns of values, behaviors, beliefs, and language of a culture-sharing group (Harris, 1968).

As both a process and an outcome of research (Agar, 1980), ethnography is a way of studying a culture- sharing group as well as the final, written product of that research. As a process, 'ethnography involves extended observations of the group, most often through participant observation, in which the researcher is immersed in the day-to-day lives of the people and observes and interviews the group participants. Ethnographers study the meaning of the behavior, the language, and the interaction among members of the culture-sharing group.

Types of Ethnographies

There are many forms of ethnography, such as a confessional ethnography, life history, auto-ethnography, feminist ethnography, ethnographic novels, and the visual ethnography found in photography and video, and electronic media. Two popular forms of ethnography will be emphasized here: the realist ethnography and the critical ethnography.

The realist ethnography is a traditional approach used by cultural anthropologists. It reflects a particular stance taken by the researcher toward the individuals being studied. Realist ethnography is an objective account of the situation, typically written in the third person point of view and reporting objectively on the information learned from participants at a site. The ethnographer remains in background as an omniscient reporter of the "facts." The realist also reports objective data in a measured style uncontaminated by personal bias, political goals, and judgment.

For many researchers, ethnography today employs a "critical" approach (Carspecken & Apple, 1992; Madison, 2005; Thomas, 1993) by including in the research an advocacy perspective. The critical ethnography is a type of ethnographic research in which the authors advocate for the emancipation of groups marginalized in society (Thomas, 1993). Critical researchers typically are politically minded individuals who seek, through their research, to speak out against inequality and domination (Carspecken

& Apple, 1992). For example, critical ethnographers might study schools that provide privileges to certain types of students, or counseling practices that serve to overlook the needs of underrepresented groups. A critical ethnographer will study issues of power, empowerment, inequality, inequity, dominance, repression, hegemony, and victimization.

Procedures for Conducting an Ethnography

As with all qualitative inquiry, there is no single way to conduct the research in ethnography. The approach taken here includes elements of both realist ethnography and critical approaches. The steps to conduct ethnography are as follows:

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• Determine if ethnography is the most appropriate design to use to study the research problem. Ethnography is appropriate if the needs are to describe how a cultural group works and to explore the beliefs, language, behaviors, and issues such as power, resistance, and dominance.

• Identify and locate a culture-sharing group to study. Typically, this group is one that has been together for an extended period of time, so that their shared language, patterns of behavior, and attitudes have merged into a discernable pattern. This may also be a group that has been marginalized by society. Because ethnographers spend time talking with and observing this group, access may require finding one or more individuals in the group who will allow the researcher in-a gatekeeper or key informants (or participants).

• Select cultural themes or issues to study about the group. This involves the analysis of the culture-sharing group. The themes may include such topics as enculturation, socialization, learning, cognition, domination, inequality, or child and adult development.

• To study cultural concepts, determine which type of ethnography to use. Perhaps how the group works needs to be described, or the critical ethnography may need to expose issues such as power, hegemony, and to advocate for certain groups. A critical ethnographer, for example, might address an inequity in society or some part of it, use the research to advocate and call for changes, and specify an issue to explore, such as inequality, dominance, oppression, or empowerment.

• Gather information where the group works and lives. This is called fieldwork. Gathering the types of information typically needed in an ethnography involves going to the research site, respecting the daily lives of individuals at the site, and collecting a wide variety of materials. Field issues of respect, reciprocity, deciding who owns the data, and others are central to ethnography. Organize types of ethnographic data into observations, tests and measures, surveys, content analysis, interviews, elicitation methods, audiovisual methods, spatial mapping, and network research.

• Forge a working set of rules or patterns as the final product of this analysis. The final product is a holistic cultural portrait of the group that incorporates the views of the participants (emic) as well as the views of the researcher (etic). It might also advocate for the needs of the group or suggest changes in society to address needs of the group.

Challenges

Ethnography is challenging to use for the following reasons. The researcher needs to have grounding in cultural anthropology and the meaning of a social-cultural system as well as the concepts typically explored by ethnographers. The time to collect data is extensive, involving prolonged time in the field. In many ethnographies, the narratives are written in a literary, almost storytelling approach, an approach that may limit the audience for the work and may be challenging for authors accustomed to traditional approaches to writing social and human science research. There is a possibility that the researcher will "go native" and be unable to complete the study or be compromised in the study. This is but one issue in the complex array of fieldwork issues facing ethnographers who venture into an unfamiliar cultural group or system. Sensitivity to the needs of individual studies is especially important, and the researcher needs to acknowledge his or her impact on the people and the places being studied.

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Lesson 51

CASE STUDY RESEARCH

The entire culture-sharing group in ethnography may be considered a case, but the intent in ethnography is to determine how the culture works rather than to understand an issue or problem using the case as a specific illustration.

Thus, case study research involves the study of an issue explored through one or more cases within a bounded system (i.e., a setting, a context). Although Stake (2005) states that case study research is not a methodology but a choice of what is to be studied (i.e., a case within a bounded system), others present it as a strategy of inquiry, a methodology, or a comprehensive research strategy. We choose to view it as a methodology, a type of design in qualitative research, or an object of study, as well as a product of the inquiry.

Case study research is a qualitative approach in which the investigator explores a bounded system (a case) or multiple bounded systems (cases) over time, through detailed, in-depth data collection involving multiple sources of information (e.g., observations, interviews, audiovisual material, and documents and reports), and reports a case description and case-based themes. For example, several programs (a multi-site study) or a single program (a within-site study) may be selected for study.

The case study approach is familiar to social scientists because of its popularity in psychology (Freud), medicine (case analysis of a problem), law (case law), and political science (case reports). Today, the case study writer has a large array of texts and approaches from which to choose. Yin (2003), for example, espouses both quantitative and qualitative approaches to case study development and discusses explanatory, exploratory, and descriptive qualitative case studies.

Types of Case Studies

Types of qualitative case studies are distinguished by the size of the bounded case, such as whether the case involves one individual, several individuals, a group, an entire program, or an activity. They may also be distinguished in terms of the intent of the case analysis. Three variations exist in terms of intent: the single instrumental case study, the collective or multiple case studies, and the intrinsic case study.

In a single instrumental case study (Stake, 1995), the researcher focuses on an issue or concern, and then selects one bounded case to illustrate this issue. In a collective case study (or multiple case study), the one issue or concern is again selected, but the inquirer selects multiple case studies to illustrate the issue. The researcher might select for study several programs from several research sites or multiple programs within a single site. Often the inquirer purposefully selects multiple cases to show different perspectives on the issue. Yin (2003) suggests that the multiple case study design uses the logic of replication, in which the inquirer replicates the procedures for each case. As a general rule, qualitative researchers are reluctant to generalize from one case to another because the contexts of cases differ. To best generalize, however, the inquirer needs to select representative cases for inclusion in the qualitative study. The final type of case study design is an intrinsic case study in which the focus is on the case itself (e.g., evaluating a program, or studying a student having difficulty) because the case presents an unusual or unique situation. This resembles the focus of narrative research, but the case study analytic procedures of a detailed description of the case, set within its context or surroundings, still hold true.

Procedures for Conducting a Case Study

Several procedures are available for conducting case studies. Following discussion will rely primarily on Stake's (1995) approach to conducting a case study.

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- First, researchers determine if a case study approach is appropriate to the research problem. A case study is a good approach when the inquirer has clearly identifiable cases with boundaries and seeks to provide an in-depth understanding of the cases or a comparison of several cases.

- Researchers next need to identify their case or cases. These cases may involve an individual, several individuals, a program, an event, or an activity. In conducting case study research, I recommend that investigators first consider what type of case study is most promising and useful. The case can be single or collective, multi-sited or within-site, focused on a case or on an issue (intrinsic, instrumental. In choosing which case to study, an array of possibilities for purposeful sampling is available.

- The data collection in case study research is typically extensive, drawing on multiple sources of information, such as observations, interviews, documents, and audiovisual materials. For example, Yin (2003) recommends six types of information to collect: documents, archival records, interviews, direct observations, participant-observations, and physical artifacts.

- The type of analysis of these data can be a holistic analysis of the entire case or an embedded analysis of a specific aspect of the case. Through this data collection, a detailed description of the case emerges in which the researcher details such aspects as the history of the case, the chronology of events, or a day-by- day rendering of the activities of the case. After this description, the researcher might focus on a few key issues (or analysis of themes), not for generalizing beyond the case, but for understanding the complexity of the case. One analytic strategy would be to identify issues within each case and then look for common themes that transcend the cases. This analysis is rich in the context of the case or setting in which the case presents itself. When multiple cases are chosen, a typical format is to first provide a detailed description of each case and themes within the case, called a within-case analysis, followed by a thematic analysis across the cases, called a cross-case analysis, as well as assertions or an interpretation of the meaning of the case.

- In the final interpretive phase, the researcher reports the meaning of the case, whether that meaning comes from learning about the issue of the case (an instrumental case) or learning about an unusual situation (an intrinsic case).

Challenges

One of the challenges inherent in qualitative case study development is that the researcher must identify his or her case. The case study researcher must decide which bounded system to study, recognizing that several might be possible candidates for this selection and realizing that either the case itself or an issue, which a case or cases are selected to illustrate, is worthy of study.

The researcher must consider whether to study a single case or multiple cases. The study of more than one case dilutes the overall analysis; the more cases an individual study, the less the depth in any single case. When a researcher chooses multiple cases, the issue becomes, "How many cases?" There is not a set number of cases. Typically, however, the researcher chooses no more than four or five cases. What motivates the researcher to consider a large number of cases is the idea of "generalizability," a term that holds little meaning for most qualitative researchers.

Selecting the case requires that the researcher establish a rationale for his or her purposeful sampling strategy for selecting the case and for gathering information about the case. Having enough information to present an in-depth picture of the case limits the value of some case studies. Some case studies may not have clean beginning and ending points, and the researcher will need to set boundaries that adequately surround the case.

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Lesson 52

THE FIVE APPROACHES COMPARED

All five approaches have in common the general process of research that begins with research problem and proceeds to the questions, the data, the data analysis, and the research report. They also employ similar data collection processes, including, in varying degrees, interviews, observations, documents, and audiovisual materials. Also, a couple of potential similarities among the designs should be noted.

Narrative research, ethnography, and case study research may seem similar when the unit of analysis is a single individual. True, one may approach the study of a single individual from any of these three approaches; however, the types of data one would collect and analyze would differ considerably. In narrative research, the inquirer focuses on the stories told from the individual and arranges these stories in chronological order. In ethnography, the focus is on setting the individuals' stories within the context of their culture• and culture-sharing group; in case study research, the single case is typically selected to illustrate an issue, and the researcher compiles a detailed description of the setting for the case. As Yin (2003) comments, "You would use the case study method because you deliberately wanted to cover contextual conditions-believing that they might be highly pertinent to your phenomenon of study".

If the researcher wants to study a single individual, the narrative approach or a single case study because ethnography is a much broader picture of the culture. When comparing a narrative study and a single case to study a single individual, the narrative approach is seen as more scholarly because narrative studies tend to focus on single individual; whereas, case studies often involve more than one case.

From these sketches of the five approaches, we can identify fundamental differences among these types of qualitative research.

Characteristics	*Narrative Research*	*Phenomenology*	*Grounded Theory*	*Ethnography*	*Case Study*
Focus	Exploring the life of an individual	Understanding the essence of the experience	Developing a theory grounded in data from the field	Describing and interpreting a culture-sharing group	Developing an in-depth description and analysis of a case or multiple cases
Type of Problem Best Suited for Design	Needing to tell stories of individual experiences	Needing to describe the essence of a lived phenomenon	Grounding a theory in the views of participants	Describing and interpreting the shared patterns of culture of a group	Providing an in-depth understanding of a case or cases
Discipline Background	Drawing from the humanities including anthropology, literature, history, psychology, and sociology	Drawing from philosophy, psychology, and education	Drawing from sociology	Drawing from anthropology and sociology	Drawing from psychology, law, political science, medicine
Unit of Analysis	Studying one or more individuals	Studying several individuals that have shared the experience	Studying a process, action, or interaction involving many individuals	Studying a group that shares the same culture	Studying an event, a program, an activity, more than one individual

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Data Collection Forms	Using primarily interviews and documents	Using primarily interviews with individuals, although documents, observations, and art may also be considered	Using primarily interviews with 20–60 individuals	Using primarily observations and interviews, but perhaps collecting other sources during extended time in field	Using multiple sources, such as interviews, observations, documents, artifacts
Data Analysis Strategies	Analyzing data for stories, "restorying" stories, developing themes, often using a chronology	Analyzing data for significant statements, meaning units, textural and structural description, description of the "essence"	Analyzing data through open coding, axial coding, selective coding	Analyzing data through description of the culture-sharing group; themes about the group	Analyzing data through description of the case and themes of the case as well as cross-case themes
Written Report	Developing a narrative about the stories of an individual's life	Describing the "essence" of the experience	Generating a theory illustrated in a figure	Describing how a culture-sharing group works	Developing a detailed analysis of one or more cases
General Structure of Study	• Introduction (problem, questions) • Research procedures (a narrative, significance of individual, data collection, analysis outcomes) • Report of stories • Individuals theorize about their lives • Narrative segments identified • Patterns of meaning identified (events, processes, epiphanies, themes) • Summary (Adapted from Denzin, 1989a, 1989b)	• Introduction (problem, questions) • Research procedures (a phenomenology and philosophical assumptions, data collection, analysis, outcomes) • Significant statements • Meanings of statements • Themes of meanings • Exhaustive description of phenomenon (Adapted from Moustakas, 1994)	• Introduction (problem, questions) • Research procedures (grounded theory, data collection, analysis, outcomes) • Open coding • Axial coding • Selective coding and theoretical propositions and models • Discussion of theory and contrasts with extant literature (Adapted from Strauss & Corbin, 1990)	• Introduction (problem, questions) • Research procedures (ethnography, data collection, analysis, outcomes) • Description of culture • Analysis of cultural themes • Interpretation, lessons learned, questions raised (Adapted from Wolcott, 1994b)	• Entry vignette • Introduction (problem, questions, case study, data collection, analysis, outcomes) • Description of the case/cases and its/their context • Development of issues • Detail about selected issues • Assertions • Closing vignette (Adapted from Stake, 1995)

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Lesson 53

DATA-COLLECTION IN QUALITATIVE RESEARCH

This lesson is about methods and techniques in data-collection during a qualitative research. The choice of techniques is dependent on the needs of the research. Although this should be true for almost all social research, it is particularly so with qualitative research in that the appropriate method or techniques is often identified and adopted during the research. Qualitative research is also multi-model. The researcher may adopt a variety of research techniques, or a combination of such, as long as they are justified by the needs. The discussion below is therefore not to identify a set of techniques unique to qualitative research, but rather, to introduce the methods and techniques most commonly used in qualitative research, and the issues related to such use.

We shall introduce three broad categories of methods and techniques which are mostly used in qualitative research: observations, interviews and study of documents.

Observations

Observation usually means the researcher's act to find out what people do (Bernard, 1988:62). It is different from other methods in that data occur not necessarily in response to the researcher's stimulus.

Observation may be obtrusive or unobtrusive. A researcher may simply sit in the corner of a school playground and observe how students behave during breaks. He may also stand by the school gate and observe how students behave at the school gate. Such cases of observation may be seen as unobtrusive. In other cases, the researchers may not apply any stimuli, but their presence per se may have some influence on the scene. The most common example in this category is classroom observation. Although the researcher may just sit quietly at the corner of a classroom, the presence of the researcher may change the classroom climate. It is, nonetheless, still observation.

Observation is a basic technique used in almost all qualitative research. Even if other methods or techniques are used, the researcher remains the most essential "sensor" or "instrument" and hence observation always counts (McCracken, 1988:18-20). For example, when interviewing is used, a qualitative researcher also takes into account the tonic or facial expressions of the informant, because they help interpret the verbal responses. Such expressions are only sensed by observation. If the interview is done in the field, then the surroundings of the interview site also provide meaningful data for the research. The surroundings can only be depicted through observation. Hence observation is indispensable in almost all occasions of qualitative research.

Participant Observation

Participant observation is perhaps the most typical of qualitative research. Some authors even use participant observation as a synonym for ethnographic research. Different writers may have slightly different definitions of participant observation. The following description by Fetterman is perhaps the most agreeable to most researchers.

Participant observation is immersion in a culture. Ideally, the ethnographer lives and works in the community for six months to a year or more, learning the language and seeing patterns of behavior over time. Long-term residence helps the researcher internalize the basic beliefs, fears, hopes and expectations of the people under study. (1989:45)

Nonparticipant Observation

Strictly speaking, nonparticipant observation involves merely watching what is happening and recording events on the spot. In the qualitative orientation, because of the non-intervention principle, strict nonparticipant observation should involve no interaction between the observer and the observed.

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Goetz and LeCompte assert that in the strict sense "nonparticipant observation exists only where interactions are viewed through hidden camera and recorder or through one-way mirror" (1984: 143).

Interviewing

Interviewing is widely used in qualitative research. Compared with observation, it is more economical in time, but may achieve less in understanding the culture. The economy in time, however, makes ethnographic interviewing almost the most widely used technique in policy-related research.

Interviewing is trying to understand what people think through their speech. There are different types of interviews, often classified by the degrees of control over the interview. Along this line, we shall briefly introduce three types of interviewing: informal interviewing, unstructured interviewing, semi-structured interviewing, and formally structured interviewing.

Informal Interviewing

Informal interviewing entails no control. It is usually conversations that the researcher recalls after staying in the field. It is different from "observation" in that it is interactive. That is, the informant speaks to the researcher.

Unstructured Interviewing

Unstructured interviewing applies minimum control over the informant and the responses. Unstructured interviewing is formal interviewing. There is no disguise that the occasion is just a friendly chat. Hence, there is always a question to answer, or a topic to discuss. However, the informants have the liberty to choose their own scope, depth, emphases, length and pace of the response. At times, the informant may even choose to deviate from the original question or topic.

Semi-structured Interviewing

Semi-structured interviewing is interviewing with an interview guide (Bernard, 1988:205). Semi-structured interviewing follows all the principles of unstructured interviewing, except that the informants are not expected to move too far beyond the scope d

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